

ACA Marketplace Shoppers (OEP) — Voices by Theme

Appendix to *ACA-Shoppers-Research*. For every measured theme, the most engaged voices (up to 20) in full, with replies and source links. Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/aca-shoppers/research/>

Tab 1 — Fears

The premium at renewal · 36 documents · 20 voices

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

↳ (0): "I hope everyone making these posts are also calling their senators and representatives. They may not respond but they do track constituent issues/concerns."

↳ (0): "...and don't forget to VOTE!!!"

↳ (0): "I just wish we had at least one party running on universal healthcare to vote for."

"I had to retire due to medical issues at 55 so we had to go with Marketplace. It's been pretty good, our premiums are under \$150 per month for 2 people and our deductible for family was \$800. No HSA is allowed but we created a medical bucket in our high yield savings account and just transfer money as needed. We keep our income below \$60,000 too. I fear big changes are coming for 2026 though. Guess we will cross that bridge when it comes. God bless all!"

— YouTube · Want to Retire Early? HERE ARE 4 OPTIONS FOR HEALTH INSURANCE! · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOljsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAg>

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Yes, it is likely that we will see largely increased premiums in the upcoming year. We will release a video previewing 2026 plans soon! Thank you for your comment."

"I can't afford COBRA and I'm under court orders... I recently changed jobs. My benefits with my new employer don't kick in for 60 days. I'm under court orders (Child Support) to provide coverage or I risk paying 100% of any medical costs out of pocket. My childrens' other parent is not willing to work with me and has a history of taking advantage of situations that cause me financial hardship. They are already aware of the lack of coverage since recent Rx had to be paid out of pocket. Although my new position pays better than the last, COBRA coverage is \$1961.25 monthly to continue. Considering my other expenses to just survive, I can't afford an additional \$2k/mo even if it's only for two months. I have two children that are Special Needs so having a PPO plan was the choice to ensure we could see (almost) any doctor we needed. There is no option to only provide coverage for my children. I don't know what to do. I can start looking at other providers. I was told to ask for "Special Enrollment Period" plans as the coverage would only be needed for two months (until my new employer's benefits kick in). It was recommended to check healthcare.gov and affordablehealthplans.com . My concern is running into similar, unaffordable pricing. I need advice. I'm lost and feel like I'm going to face major medical bills here soon if I don't figure out a plan. I'm at work so I can't provide 100% of my attention to searching plans until later this evening. Help me, Reddit Community. You're my only hope."

— r/HealthInsurance · 42 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1w02ffv/>

↳ (0): "Your loss of insurance due to you leaving your job that included health insurance opens a special enrollment period in your state's health insurance marketplace (ACA Marketplace). The marketplace is operated either by your state or the federal government, depending on where you live. All plans available in the marketplace meet certain core standards including coverage of essential services and coverage for preexisting conditions. This last point is really important. Plans bought outside the marketplace may not include coverage for medical issues a person already has. In your children's cases, that would mean their health conditions wouldn't be covered, making the insurance less than useful. Depending on your income, you may get a subsidy for buying a plan through the Marketplace. Given today's date (August 28th) most plans may not go into effect until October 1. Costs incurred prior to the effective date won't be covered by insurance. Medicaid coverage is available in all states, depending on income and other factors. In most states, Medicaid expanded to cover a wide range of people. The Marketplace in your state will indicate if Medicaid is an option in your state. In some cases, Medicaid can be retroactive. You might also consider pursuing CHIP or Medicaid for individuals with disabilities, depending on the exact nature of your children's medical issues."

↳ (0): "Thank you. I'll look into these options."

↳ (0): "How long have you gone without health insurance? COBRA can be signed up for/used retroactively. So for 60 days from the last date of employment you have a window where you can wait to sign up if you need it, and it covers you retroactively for those 60 days. It's a rare instance where you only have to pay for it if you need to use it. For instance, if you do nothing now, and then your child has a large medical expense, you can sign up after the event of the expense, get coverage, and the event will be paid for as long as you signed up within the first 60 days."

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

↳ (0): "Cash on hand/assets only matters if you're 65 or older. You HAVE been eligible all along, and you should feel free to use your services. You're in the exact situation this social safety net is intended for....use it all you want until you find a job and get monthly income again. And no, it would not matter even if you weren't eligible. You could have knowingly lied and committed fraud to get enrolled in Medi-Cal, but if you haven't made claims Medicaid would never know or care. There's nothing spent by them to try to recover. They'd only come after you if you had claims."

↳ (0): "Medicaid goes by going forward current monthly income, not calendar year income. Previous months do not count at all, and there is no asset test for expansion Medicaid. The monthly income limit for 2022 was \$1,563 and for 2023 \$1,677 a month."

↳ (0): "Are you saying that the "cash on hand" question is basically moot and that it's ALL about monthly income?"

"I'm a transplant patient am terrified by the cost of my premiums and prescriptions. How many people are going to die because of this BS!?"

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojoy71/any_selfemployed/nm2uj4z/

"If I get a job part way through the year and cut off my ACA insurance right when my new insurance starts what happens as far as my tax credits? Update : I'm in Michigan I know we estimate for yearly income for the ACA but they wouldn't penalize me for not having or isn't ACA insurance for the months I'm covered by employer insurance right? As of right now I estimated my income higher due to making more money last year but business has taken a dive this year. I'm paying more per month because of that higher estimate and I'm looking for a new job with benefits because it's too unpredictable at this point. For what I've made for the first quarter of the year I prob would have been eligible for Medicaid so I'm also worried about getting screwed for that come tax time next year."

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s3qnb3/if_i_get_a_job_part_way_through_the_year_and_cut/

↳ wijwijwij (3): "Your tax credit will be computed using your full year income."

↳ wijwijwij (3): "You only calculate what tax credit you merit during the months you had ACA coverage (so you wouldn't be "paying back" any tax credit for other months). But your share of the cost of insurance for the months you did have ACA coverage is calculated based not on the income of those months, but your income for the entire year. For example, suppose for Jan, Feb, and Mar you were on ACA and estimated your income was going to be 30K for the year. You'd merit some tax credit (which you can elect to use to directly pay premiums) because that's under 400% federal poverty level. If you end up getting a job and you actually make 80K for the year, which is over 400% federal poverty, when it comes time to "reconcile" things you turn out not to merit any tax credit, so you repay to the treasury what they sent in those three months to your insurer, to square things. That is not "paying back the tax credit as if I used the insurance for the whole year." It's paying back the tax credit because the provisional amount advanced to your insurer in Jan, Feb, Mar was wrong, and you actually didn't merit any help, based on the fact that *later in the year* you earned more money. This is just an artifact of the way ACA legislation was written. It was decided not to try to make eligibility a monthly determination. By the same token, if your income prediction when enrolling in ACA is higher than income turns out to be, you'll find at reconciliation time when you file your taxes, you get additional credit that in effect "pays you back" some of the amounts that went to your ACA insurer, in order that your share for the months you had ACA coverage should match what your income (for the year) indicates."

↳ O_o-22 (2): "So say I'm getting \$500 a month in tax credit but I only use the tax credit for 4 months out of the year and end my ACA insurance for the remaining 8 months. At the end of the year the reconciliation says I should have only gotten \$300 a month due to higher income. Thats a \$200 difference X 4 months so I'd owe \$800 back then?"

"I'm single, on ACA and I pay about \$1.2K per month, no subsidies because I CAN afford it. But even then, I still think it's absolutely ridiculous to pay such high prices and still get insurance denials for care recommended by my doctor or dentist. US healthcare is currently 3rd world care where only the wealthy can afford it, the middle class has anxiety over it and the poor simply can't. You can't call the US the best country in the world when the US govt can't take care of people's health without bankrupting them."

— YouTube · Healthcare premiums to skyrocket Jan. 1 for Obamacare enrollees · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZ_YF6SbtSg&lc=UgyT8iKnr-xb4Sk5GIJ4AaABAg

↳ @MrGabox345 (2): "I am sorry you americans are having a bad time, but I live in the 3rd world and we don't get insurance denials for care recommended by your primary doctor or dentist, that's illegal..."

↳ @anamarques5599 (1): "You don't have health care... You have a health industry 🤔🤔🤔"

↳ @Mxyzptlk30 (0): "@MrGabox345 I should correct myself and say we Americans have 4th world healthcare. 🤔🤔"

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqibrvo/

"I agree with this, it's a nightmare if you do not understand all the ups and downs with copay, premiums, deductibles, ...etc. I Googled so many terms because of my confusion of same, and took notes when needed. I navigated to the silver plans. Check and see if your doctors are listed in that plan or which doctors. A note here, some doctors listed was no longer with the plan, and I found calling the Dr's office to confirm played a large part of picking plans, I don't want to drive 30 miles to see my pcp. Then on marketplace you can also enter your prescriptions you take, my spouse had a few expensive ones. It's a nightmare and you have to be thorough, I spent many evenings learning the terminology. With market place you can save maybe 4 plans to compare, which is a big help. At the end I had a plan picked and a backup plan. I called marketplace, gave my info and details, the rep came up with the same 2 plans. You need to understand Medicare too, by then I already had a much better understanding. When you talk to agents ask about things you don't understand."

— r/HealthInsurance · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pboicez/

"This is a fantastic write up, thank you! Do you have any advice as to how practical a catastrophic plan would be in 2026? From my googling, it appears as though my family could qualify for a hardship exemption as ACA costs will be higher than 7.97% of our income. I don't want to go the uninsured route, but we can't afford the -\$1300/month bronze plan without a subsidy. Thank you!"

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacareaca_changes_to_know_heading/n4i9yli/

"This is me. I have more health problems and see more specialists than the people I know/family I have who are in their late 70's, 80's and even more than my 98 year old grandmother. I am decades younger than that and terrified of what my health will be like at those ages, especially if my Medicaid is taken away. Not one of my health conditions is caused by poor choices like substance abuse or eating poorly or lack of exercise. I lost the genetic lottery and have terrible luck. I have written in my will that I wish to donate my body to science when I die because of the amount of "rare" diseases and syndromes I have. Literally every doctor I have ever had has said to me, "I have never seen this before". So that's been fun. I hope that by studying my body when I'm gone and won't need it, doctors and /or scientists will be able to learn how to help others with issues like mine someday. According to the current rules, despite being too sick to work, I have too many "assets" to qualify for SSI disability. So that will render me *not disabled* in the eyes of this new nightmare government and according to this evil bill. I gave up my teaching career when I was married when I became a stay at home mom/wife 25 years ago so I didn't pay into the social security system for decades which makes me ineligible for SSDI or social security disability. I am not qualified or trained to do any kind of job that would make enough money to be able to afford insurance and all the co-pays, deductibles, co-insurance, and prescriptions. I doubt anyone would even hire me, and I would likely get fired from all the sick days I would need. Prior to having children I was a teacher, and I would never go back to it the way society villainizes teachers for everything, not that my body could even tolerate the schedule and the stress. I cannot understand why they want you to sell your home and your car before you can qualify for SSI disability when you don't have enough work history for SSDI disability, so I don't receive benefits other than Medicaid and have been living solely off my investments which is my "retirement fund" that I started when I was 19. Every month I would contribute whatever I had, even if it was \$50, because I knew someday I wanted to be able to be home with my future children. Just in the short time since the orange monster has been in power. I have lost a scary amount of money and am terrified what I have won't last as long as I need it, thanks to his economic ineptitude. But if I sold my home and car, I would need assistance with housing and transportation. Make that make sense!? Even when it should be a slam dunk, it takes many people years, assistance from lawyers, and multiple attempts to qualify for disability. The system was broken before they came in with their plan to nuke it. I feel fortunate that I started planning for my future at such young age, but once I lose Medicaid, anything I have now will be gone in a very short amount of time, or I will die, which I think is what they want. I am terrified for people who don't have savings or investments, I'm terrified for all those of us who haven't had the energy, resources, or haven't been well enough for the battle to try to qualify for disability, and those of us who don't qualify for either type of disability, and I'm terrified for the elderly and really all of us who rely on this system to help us live. We are not worthless! Every one of us has value! We all have people who love us and rely on us. We are all someone's child and many are someone's parent. Like most people, I have contributed so much to this world, and still do in the ways I'm able to through teaching, my extensive volunteer work, my charitable contributions over the years, and by being a good citizen, friend, mother, daughter, sister, and human. My kids have grown up but are not in a position to help support me in their 20's and I have been single for almost 20 years now. I have no one to help me or take me in or who currently helps to care for me when I'm sick, let alone if I burn through all my savings for my medical care and lose my home, like so many millions of other people. And they don't give a single crap. Every time I see someone saying that we will just be getting what we voted for I want to scream!! I didn't vote for this!!! I actively worked to try to prevent it! It's cruel, immature, and absolutely incorrect to gloat and taunt that people in my shoes deserve it because we voted for it, when we didn't. I really wish people would stop saying that. I hope there is a special corner in hell waiting for every person who helped write this bill and every single one of them who helps to pass this bill for their cruelty and the evil they are intentionally inflicting on people less fortunate than them, apparently just because they can and apparently because they find it fun."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ln1zvj/senator_warren_big_beautiful_score_now_just_shy/n0ebfl4/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/>

↳ (0): "Brokers don't get paid from client. The insurance carriers pay the broker. ACA plans prices go by your income. Prices are ridiculous high."

↳ (0): "That's what I thought too, but I couldn't account for the discrepancy in prices between the brokers prices and healthcare.gov prices. Because one plan was \$30 higher but the more expensive plan was \$50 less from the broker. So I was trying to figure out why that was."

↳ (0): "We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

"Two straight years of income falling slightly below the minimum threshold. How worried should I be? I live in a state without expanded Medicaid and have only been making between 1k to 1500 monthly for the last two years. I estimated my income as best I could, which was right above the minimum for coverage eligibility. My 2024 final income ended up being at 90% of the FPL and 96% for 2025. One of my parents had a stroke last year, which caused me to miss about a full month of work in total. I didn't report this as a life change event, however looking back perhaps I should have. I'm worried that I might not be able to get advance premium tax credits next year after two years in a row of not making as much as I estimated and being below the minimum threshold. What is the most likely outcome and is there anything I can do now to avoid being penalized?"

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sh0wl7/two_straight_years_of_income_falling_slightly/

↳ tiggonfire (6): "Not an expert here but just wondering if you might have miscellaneous income to report that could bring you up to the cutoff....like maybe your dad paid you for some of the care you provided?"

↳ j2c1 (4): "Actually I do have some but I just filed my taxes online this week. It was accepted by the IRS and shows it's being processed now. I don't know why I didn't think of this before. I guess I could try to file an amended return? Edit: the only documentation I have are deposited checks. Would that be enough?"

↳ Artistic-Peppercorn (4): "If your estimated income (that you report to the exchange) is close to your actual income on previous returns, you'll be fine. Yours is very close, so I think you'll be fine. They are going to start checking people whose actual income on a previous tax return is lower than the estimated income, but I don't think you are far enough below that you'd be flagged. The rules are set up to allow some level of misestimation, as long as you're not intentionally lying about what you expect your income to be, because they know it's hard to get it completely correct when projecting a year in advance."

"I'm two years away from Medicare age and self employed. I have a bronze HSA policy this year with an \$8k deductible. I pay \$750 a month with the subsidy....the premium is \$1500. I won't qualify for subsidies next year either and I'm afraid to see what the premium will be. I'll probably just drop health insurance until I qualify for Medicare and hope nothing happens. 🙌 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh6uh41/

"This is key. People like the commenter that you replied to can argue about the temporary nature of Covid subsidies all they want. At the end of the day, though, does it matter when there's a reasonably large portion the population that now find themselves in a spot where, because of accelerating cost of living increases, they make too much for any relief from escalating health care costs but not nearly enough to afford health care on their own? And from the anecdotal stories posted here and elsewhere, it seems like a lot of these people tend to be 50+, an age range where health starts to degrade and access to care becomes more necessary, yet also an age where they are years away from accessing Medicare. I'm dreading to see what my premiums will look like in a few years."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q6f1ge/obamacare_premiums_jump_114_overnight_why_48/ny7wkhs/

"Thinking about my premiums going up \$1000 a month starting in December keeps me up at night."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1n0ntdb/republicans_could_take_midterm_hit_if_obamacare/navsgea/

"Thank you! I'm happy your mom has been able to afford her medicine. It's so sad that we pay so much and get so little in return. I try not to stress about it but fuck it's so hard not too. Then I'm scared it might go up next year and regardless i need my insurance for my family. I make too much for Medicaid I'm stuck in the middle. With my insurance my Ozempic is 800 and Farxiga is 400"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vnce2d/a_shocking_92_percent_of_us_adults_are_not_going/p3ii1am/

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergancy coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAq>

↳ @bookmark692 (0): "The Messiah picked winners and losers with health insurance. F'D everyone, except the politicians."

"Thanks for another great video on this topic Julie! Like you and others that have commented, I'm on ACA now and concerned about the possible hike in premiums next year, not even considering the reduction in subsidies. If this 15% number comes close, it won't be as bad as anticipated. But like you said, anything can happen, and things are always changing. Fingers crossed it's not as bad as I'm expecting. 🙏 "

— YouTube · HOW to ESTIMATE Your 2026 ACA (Marketplace) Premiums! (calculator) · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N7I023Co9ro&lc=Ugyj2ID29m3e4mQPpa94AaABAg>

↳ @woodsparker7902 (2): "@HappyonMonday does the Silver plan cover crossed toes? 🙏🙏 "

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "You're welcome! Yes fingers and toes crossed!!! 🙏🙏🙏 "

"Before the ACA once I had medical coverage, I had to be vigilant about making sure I kept it no matter what the price and kept documentation proving prior coverage whenever I changed jobs or I would be permanently screwed for having been in a car accident when I was 19. People really don't understand what they're playing with when they question the need for universal healthcare."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lz67ob/reminder_what_life_was_like_before_affordable/n33exqm/

Getting sick or hurt and not being able to pay · 24 documents · 20 voices

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q4ew3x/>

↳ (0): "Republicans could not care less if people are uninsured and it actually seems like they enjoy kicking people off insurance, hurting poor people, and punching down while they laugh. And they proclaim to be Christian. Jesus would be disgusted with them!"

↳ (0): "But you don't know what you're going to make in 2026. Estimate your income above the poverty level and get coverage."

↳ (0): "Be prepared to owe if you end up making more than you estimate. This happened to me. Not fun."

"I can't afford COBRA and I'm under court orders... I recently changed jobs. My benefits with my new employer don't kick in for 60 days. I'm under court orders (Child Support) to provide coverage or I risk paying 100% of any medical costs out of pocket. My childrens' other parent is not willing to work with me and has a history of taking advantage of situations that cause me financial hardship. They are already aware of the lack of coverage since recent Rx had to be paid out of pocket. Although my new position pays better than the last, COBRA coverage is \$1961.25 monthly to continue. Considering my other expenses to just survive, I can't afford an additional \$2k/mo even if it's only for two months. I have two children that are Special Needs so having a PPO plan was the choice to ensure we could see (almost) any doctor we needed. There is no option to only provide coverage for my children. I don't know what to do. I can start looking at other providers. I was told to ask for "Special Enrollment Period" plans as the coverage would only be needed for two months (until my new employer's benefits kick in). It was recommended to check healthcare.gov and affordablehealthplans.com . My concern is running into similar, unaffordable pricing. I need advice. I'm lost and feel like I'm going to face major medical bills here soon if I don't figure out a plan. I'm at work so I can't provide 100% of my attention to searching plans until later this evening. Help me, Reddit Community. You're my only hope."

— r/HealthInsurance · 42 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1w02ffv/>

↳ (0): "Your loss of insurance due to you leaving your job that included health insurance opens a special enrollment period in your state's health insurance marketplace (ACA Marketplace). The marketplace is operated either by your state or the federal government, depending on where you live. All plans available in the marketplace meet certain core standards including coverage of essential services and coverage for preexisting conditions. This last point is really important. Plans bought outside the marketplace may not include coverage for medical issues a person already has. In your children's cases, that would mean their health conditions wouldn't be covered, making the insurance less than useful. Depending on your income, you may get a subsidy for buying a plan through the Marketplace. Given today's date (August 28th) most plans may not go into effect until October 1. Costs incurred prior to the effective date won't be covered by insurance. Medicaid coverage is available in all states, depending on income and other factors. In most states, Medicaid expanded to cover a wide range of people. The Marketplace in your state will indicate if Medicaid is an option in your state. In some cases, Medicaid can be retroactive. You might also consider pursuing CHIP or Medicaid for individuals with disabilities, depending on the exact nature of your children's medical issues."

↳ (0): "Thank you. I'll look into these options."

↳ (0): "How long have you gone without health insurance? COBRA can be signed up for/used retroactively. So for 60 days from the last date of employment you have a window where you can wait to sign up if you need it, and it covers you retroactively for those 60 days. It's a rare instance where you only have to pay for it if you need to use it. For instance, if you do nothing now, and then your child has a large medical expense, you can sign up after the event of the expense, get coverage, and the event will be paid for as long as you signed up within the first 60 days."

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

↳ (0): "In short, yes, a provider can always run your information through a carrier website and see if you have insurance or not. Ask for the cash price- say you want to pay cash and not go through insurance."

↳ (0): "They said if I have coverage of any kind (that they don't take of course), then I don't have the option to pay anything but the full cost of the visit :/ I've heard some doctors are more lenient on this than others, which makes me think I should just look for a new doctor. But that feels like a whole other can of worms right now and just kind of overwhelming tbh"

↳ (0): "I mean, OP can ask, but many behavioral health providers don't maintain separate cash-price vs. insurance-price fee schedules. They tend to be more transparent and open about their fees in general, meaning their published fee is the same regardless of payer (although may vary as a function of sliding scales or "scholarships")."

"We need Medicare-For-All/A single payer healthcare system here in the United States, especially during this time with the Coronavirus pandemic! What is more "Pro-Life" than ensuring that every person in America has guaranteed affordable healthcare regardless of their job or social status? Also, if we all had access to basic healthcare, we would all have the "freedom" to live long lives and rarely have to worry about medical bankruptcies. Sure, taxes will go up, but the overall cost will go down so much that everyone will be paying less and saving thousands of dollars every year. Furthermore, if some of us need additional healthcare than Medicare, then we have the "choice" to get additional insurance, but for others Medicare would be more than enough. Finally, if every other developed country (Canada, Germany, the United Kingdom, France, Italy, Sweden, Norway, Denmark, the Netherlands, Switzerland, Japan, South Korea, Australia, and New Zealand) can implement this system and save money, then why can't the United States do the same and help "Make America Great Again" for everybody at least on the issue of healthcare? Oh, and if American citizens die from lacking access to affordable health insurance because the Republicans believe that the government shouldn't provide it then we are failing our country's promise of defending "life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness" for its citizens as well as "promoting the general welfare" of all the people."

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=UgzfpC1om_phrxaXD0B4AaABAg

↳ @DoubleDown310 (2): "Why would they do that, when they can squeeze every penny out of every single American?"

↳ @dvran (1): "Americans wanted capitalism; here you go. Greedy healthcare companies making shareholders happy, large corporations taking over ... it's all to make more billionaires."

↳ @BeatTheBush (1): "@momosan11 I wish but I don't see that happening any time soon. Reform is hard when you have such an ingrained system that will have big money behind to resist it."

"I don't know. But I have some seriously rare illnesses that I did NOT get from not eating well. And I'm currently looking at a rare mitochondrial disease as the likely cause. And I am repeatedly hospitalized due to doctors who are afraid to properly treat me until I am literally critically ill. These are all things I have gone out of my way and begged for help to prevent. It is not my fault. There is no way I can go without health insurance. If I had actually had health insurance in my 20's I would almost certainly not be as sick as I am now and costing so much in health care. And I loathe and despise the absolute assholes in this country who think anyone who is sick is just a lazy person who deserves to be sick and die. I hope they reap what they sowed."

— r/obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh82ain/

"I think something will happen. I think enough for Republicans know that they will lose the house if they don't help the people with yet another Trump expense. Even then, I'm not sure they can hang onto it. Unlike Trump, many of them know how unaffordable surviving has become, well the ones that listen to their constituents know. I guess whether they care is TBD. He sure made sure the wealthy people got their tax cut in his big baby bill, nice and early. Meanwhile, the average American has had everything go up and health insurance is a biggie, some of these increases are huge and they simply can't afford it. Trump likes to threaten to primary people. Trump will be gone in roughly 3 years. He won't rule the GOP forever and that is a simple fact. And even as they try to gerrymander their way into forever wins, they aren't winning all of those and some are TBD. I also find it ironic that Trump always talks about states, states should take the burden of everything. He means everything financial because otherwise, he's still very much wants to tell them what to do. And this is where things get kind of muddy. We elect people to do this in that, but we also don't know what the laws say about what they want to do. I guess you could look them up, but they are painting pretty broad strokes at that point, it would be difficult to pinpoint laws. I didn't know that you could read district on a whim, I always thought it was done only after a census. I think things like this should be left to the people, as California did. If they didn't just ramrod it through, they went to the people and asked what they wanted. I use ACA as does my husband and it has remained affordable for us, but we do a lot of things with our income to keep from meeting that subsidy Cliff. We are self-employed and that is the only way we can get insurance. We cannot get Medicaid, we make too much. And honestly, I don't want it. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, we just can't afford to pay it all. We want to pay part of it. Many people don't realize they ended up on ACA just because of Covid. It wasn't just extended subsidies that were enacted during Covid, it also opened the ACA up to people making up to 700% of the poverty level, that is why the ACA ballooned and they too, got the extended subsidies. I have to wonder what they did before. But I do believe healthcare should be a right. If my husband doesn't have health insurance, he files for disability. He has to. Inherited a bad heart from both parents. His twin had a pacemaker at age 40. My husband had a stent at age 46 and a triple bypass at age 52. He's not overweight, he eats healthy, exercise exercises, but his blood pressure was always an issue and then things got worse. The triple bypass was about 300 K and there is no way we could've paid that. But if we get help with insurance, my husband gets to see his doctors, have his meds and continues to work. To me that seems like the better decision., To help with one thing to keep him off of being totally disabled. Sorry, I went on a rant, I get so stressed by all of this. All right, hike wasn't too bad but I still feel for the people that have had a huge rate hike. It's scary not having insurance. It's scary being hurt or sick and you can't go to the doctor. We are such a wealthy country and so damn great, yet people can't afford health insurance. Right there, that part alone, screams that America is not great."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pazpk6/aca_in_the_senate/nrn7tOf/

"This makes a lot of sense, but my only fear of not having health insurance is the risk of unexpected hospitalizations. How can I mitigate this risk without health insurance?"

— YouTube · The Truth About Health Insurance -- Why Entrepreneurs Should Cancel Their Health Insurance · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2IU7ErdRc44&lc=UgxTq0Wq7C6ZZYCEgvJ4AaABAg>

↳ @Roslyn111 (8): "You can't mitigate without health insurance. The information in this video is incorrect and CMS, the federal entity that oversees Medicare, Medicaid, and the Marketplace/the Affordable Care Act, is cracking down on agents, agencies, etc. spreading misinformation & just implemented new regulations as of June 2023. The IRS also has a stake in the Affordable Care Act, and some people end up with IRS penalties for completing an ACA application incorrectly. You need to speak to a licensed broker in your area to help with quotes for ACA, hospital indemnity, accidental, and possibly critical illness coverage. One of my clients was younger than 35 and almost died because he didn't have insurance. Another young client ended up with rare cancer & I was able to get him covered. We can NEVER predict what's going to happen with our health. And, no, you can't just get health insurance whenever you want. There isn't always an enrollment period to get covered or to switch your coverage. You definitely need a broker for guidance."

↳ @laurenfannaly4195 (3): "@Roslyn111thank you! This guy is saying things that are so irresponsible!!!"

↳ @AsusMemopad-us5lk (0): "One solution: Emigration to a democracy."

"I don't need to read it and I know that. Trump doesn't want to help every day Americans. If he could kick everybody off of every program, he would. Poor people are ick to him. Unless you're obscenely wealthy, you don't count. He doesn't care if you live or die. Our lives changed after we enrolled in ACA. I was skeptical for the first few years and wouldn't even look. My husband has been a small business owner almost just entire adult life and I have been self-employed for 20 years now. We were destitute trying to cover my asthma meds. Two inhalers cost \$1000 per month. I actually had friends that would give them to me, when they could. The ACA gave us the one thing we could not handle on our own, which was health insurance. We could afford paying some, but not all. People don't realize the protections the ACA gives anyone that has any health insurance and the biggest one is insurance companies cannot deny for pre-existing conditions. If the ACA goes under, the protections go with it And they can't get it repealed so they are trying to kill it. I always knew it would be on the chopping block, just a matter of when. He's touched Medicaid, food stamps, this one's a no-brainer. I don't need the money to get my own health insurance. I need the protections we have and some subsidy money, paid to the insurance company He would have some people that would just pocket the money, how are they going to check they actual used it for insurance? How was the not socialism?? Dr. Oz says they have a plan but they don't want to tip their cards. I don't believe it. They're scrambling to put some Quick, not thought out, goofy plan. The cheap ones would all be catastrophic plans. Again, he can't and won't understand because he's never had to worry about a medical bill. If we lose health insurance, we would be homeless, that is how greatly it would affect us. My husband has to have his heart medication. He's not obese, he is extremely active and he eats a big salad with every dinner. It's not anything he did, it's hereditary, from both sides. He would die without his medicine, and there is no way we can afford it on our own. But I would sell everything I own to keep him alive as long as I could. Every time he has chest pains, he has to go to the hospital. Because we can't take a chance. He had a triple bypass at age 52 but I know he has been in the hospital at least three times this year, he is always admitted. It's so great to have to worry about this shit on top of everything else in life. I have never hated anyone like I hate this man. I do, I explicitly, completely hate him. Because the cruelty is the point, it's punishment for not being obscenely wealthy"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1our4kv/obamacare_could_collapse_under_trumps_new_plan/noeif0f/

"All he does is insult everyone's intelligence, every single day. We can look up was spent on the military, and we can get a rough figure of what Medicare for all would look like. If we can afford to do the things that he is doing, including a war, every person should have health insurance. I'm on the cusp of getting diagnosed with cancer and I'm extremely scared. But at least I don't have to worry because I have health insurance, but it's getting more and more un affordable. For the first time in our adult lives, we had to ask for help. I tripped over a curb and it left an extremely bad wound on my leg that took about 10 weeks to heal. My feet were so swollen, both of them even though I only hurt one and I couldn't wear shoes, so I couldn't work. After insurance paid, we ended up owing about \$600 and we are just squeezed so tight at the moment. It hasn't been like this since my husband started his business. People aren't remodeling kitchens or bathrooms, they are also too scared to spend. And it's finally trickled down to us. But again, at least I have health insurance and some agency for people that need help pay that entire part of the Hospital bill that I owed. I was crying because I have never had help as an adult and we have donated so much, clothing, pet things, pet food, donations for back to school backpacks, we tried to give back what we had to take his children. We tried to pay that back as adults, but now here we are in need. I was very thankful we were approved. It's getting rough out here."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w5ertv/trump_lies_that_medicare_for_all_would_cost/p7f20yz/

"Before the ACA once I had medical coverage, I had to be vigilant about making sure I kept it no matter what the price and kept documentation proving prior coverage whenever I changed jobs or I would be permanently screwed for having been in a car accident when I was 19. People really don't understand what they're playing with when they question the need for universal healthcare."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lz67ob/reminder_what_life_was_like_before_affordable/n33exqm/

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but

wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9jkcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>;

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q9bscn/>

↳ (0): "DO NOT USE THIS SCAM COMPANY. PAY EXTRA FOR A BETTER OPTION. THESE PEOPLE WILL SIMPLY TAKE YOUR (AND TAXPAYER) MONEY AND FIND CHICKENSHIT WAYS NOT TO COVER YOUR CLAIMS (Like refusing to give you your PCP even though they're in network)"

↳ (0): "I still have not received any information or contact from them. No information about my plan coverage not even a welcome letter. I received a bill for sure but what it covers .. Who knows because I haven't received any information and none is available online. I'm paying 650 a month out of pocket .. All I can do is hope I don't need it and wait out until next year"

↳ (0): "i strongly suggest switching to a different carrier. these guys are worthless. when you need them to cover something, you'll probably have to hire an attorney to get them to cover anything"

"My insurance company just backed out of covering for my surgery after saying they would do it. They also denied my medication because it was too expensive which led me down the path to surgery. I think I am going to go without health insurance. Scary thinking about it but I'm paying out of pocket anyway."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=UgzHnnToziDw_tFG5Yt4AaABAg

"My husband and I have a very small business and the ACA subsidy is how we afford insurance. My monthly without the subsidy is \$1,877.00 for 2, 59 y/o and 63 y/o. We received our new premium rates and the new monthly bill will be \$2,348.00. Then it all gets further complicated because my tax person is fighting cancer and still hasn't filed our 2024 taxes. You have to reconcile your subsidy via filing taxes to qualify for the subsidy for the following year. I am kind of a nervous wreck. I have chronic genetic conditions, and going without insurance is so very scary."

— YouTube · What Happens if Obamacare Subsidies Expire? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=onsEZntGKCA&lc=UgxM3Ze9-dvXF9v-pjt4AaABAg>

"Open-Enrollment and New Year Gap: What Do I Do? I recently moved from MS to AR, and started my new job in mid-August; before then, I had been uninsured for about a month, being on COBRA beforehand through the summer, and a dependent on my father's insurance up until my 26th birthday in mid-May before that. I was supposed to have health insurance coverage as a new hire within the 30-days, but my access to my benefits and workplace portal was locked due to some technical issues; now, I have to wait until mid-November for open enrollment, but even then, the benefit's don't kick in until 01/01/2027. Does anyone have any recommendations for what to do for health insurance in the meantime? I make \$16.25 per hour, so I don't know if I'd qualify for Medicaid. My main two worries are coverage for any possible emergencies (hospital, ER, etc.), and urgent care visits (I'm a chronic asthmatic, and every time I get the seasonal flu, it goes to my chest and I have to go to urgent care for steroids)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wi4kbp/openenrollment_and_new_year_gap_what_do_i_do/

↳ LacyLove (2): "You waited until today to ask about the benefits? Why did you not log on sooner?"

↳ LacyLove (1): "Whose fault were the tech issues? If it was theres, I would fight back and make them enroll me now. Did you move less than 60 days ago?"

↳ Typical_Log_3337 (1): "My hire date was 08/17, and I thought 30 days was up until 09/17; I tried calling the benefits representative, and they said that the 30 days was up 09/15, not 09/16- the technical issues were theirs, but I definately struggled with communicating with them in-time; spending all of today trying to see if there's a way to fight it At this point, I've accepted that I have to wait until open enrollment- now I just want to know if anyone has any short-term coverage plan recommendations (since some of them seem kind of scammy), or if I'd be eligible for Medicaid coverage in AR, or what"

"Long-term consequences of short-term insurance? I'm a grad student getting kicked off their parents' insurance next week. I have a short term plan from United Healthcare and I am concerned about preexisting conditions. I know they won't cover them and I'm wondering if this will affect future coverage for me when I do get a plan off the ACA market."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpuxb8/longterm_consequences_of_shortterm_insurance/

↳ mira112022 (2): "Why would your current UH plan affect your future coverage through the marketplace (ACA)? BTW, I'd enroll through the ACA as soon as possible. You will be protected much better. As far as preexisting conditions are concerned, if you have an underwritten plan (like you do), you should've given that information to your UH broker, before they accepted you. They usually ask you a bunch of questions before they allow you to enroll."

↳ Tough-Dealer6292 (1): "I don't know, I am new to insurance. I know my current short-term does not cover it. Wasn't sure if a gap in covering pre-existing conditions (even if you're insured otherwise) would affect future coverage of those conditions."

↳ katsrad (1): "Is the short term plan that much cheaper than an ACA plan? You are eligible to enroll through there because aging off is a qualifying life event. You may even qualify for a subsidy."

"Dude I am way ahead of you I have medicaid Medicare I don't pay a dime for it I also receive government subsidies on the side plus I work cash jobs here and there so everything for me is basically for free health care wise never paid a medical bill in my life never paid any deductible I have no debt I pay all my bills in full every month I have a stress-free life I take 4 mile walk a day it's great to live on Easy Street I can't handle stress last time I had stress I freaked out let's not go there it's all good for others like myself dude you just got to know how to work the system and you can get your free healthcare medicaid Medicare it probably depends what state you live in some states are easier to get it than others my state is not bad at all yes I live in a blue state what I did work I always demanded Healthcare most of the time I got it but all the places that I did work that we're good to work for all went under or they work take over by other companies then I left the good old days of working are over basically you have to do what I do to make it in the world today unless you have a really good education other than that just do the same that I did if you can I'm sure you probably could you just have to fight it's not going to be for free you have to fight for what you want in life you can't just sit on your hands and expect it to come to you it doesn't work that way I had to fight fight fight to get where I am I was declined so many times I got sick of seeing the word declined I was actually getting nauseous when I saw the word decline I kept fighting and I would not take no for an answer finally that faithful letter came through your approved 😊 it took years for me to get approved just saying 😊 "

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgydIdE-r4f0nSNoPKB4AaABAq.APW5Z9zkse2APWHQ3G7a2Y>

"This is sick and heartbreaking. I left the US about 6 years ago after getting permanently laid off by my previous employer of 22 years. I decided to take a chance and retire early. Luckily, I am more fortunate than most. I never travelled for vacations and really lived below my means. Anyway, now I live in Europe and I pay about \$3,000 per YEAR (with no deductible) for my private health insurance. I could have no insurance and just use this country's public health care. I don't want to do that because of several reasons - I didn't grow up here and pay into the system, the wait times are longer, the hospitals aren't as nice and the nursing care isn't great (because they are understaffed and overworked). I have already had a major surgery here - a hip replacement. I was in the hospital for 4 days, private room. Total cost was around \$200 for me. That said, I recently had to have another surgery that I thought was much more minor (had to have a parathyroid removed from my neck, a tiny, rice-sized organ) and that cost me much more - around \$3,500. That said, I'm still feeling very grateful."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgzTkFiJnH0pbDjr4LV4AaABAq>

"Obama care was terrible from the start. The marketplace reduced my choice to one provider that nobody took because they never paid the bills. Before aca my deductible was \$50 to see the doctor because I had insurance, now it doesn't even kick in until I pay a \$2,000 deductible. It wasn't expensive. Now that they just give it to everyone and ignore pre existing conditions, we all have to pay so much more we never want to use it or we can't. So the responsible people are subsidizing the dregs of humanity at the cost of being able to support their families because the premiums are too much each month and many can't pay the deductible. It's useless. Do they still give you the not a tax fine that's as much as the premiums for the whole year? Who else feels like their insurance is useless?"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgyBe8ougqsYiFqljlx4AaABAq.APVyrK5jX9XAS0nbtb-B8a>

"I live in the States I just wanna medicaid Medicare I don't pay a penny for health insurance I never paid a co-pay in my life or a medical bill ever I am a Canadian Living in a blue state sign out I was born in Montreal it's good for me here in the states because everything here is for free for me I also get benefits of the government which is really really good the government bought me my own home in a good safe neighborhood I have a bank account full of money I have no financial difficulties at all I basically live a stress-free life I take 4 mile walk today it's great to live a stress-free life it's great to have all the money you need to pay all your bills it's great to be able to pay all your bills in full every month 😊🇨🇦🇺🇸😊 I have no debt just saying 😊 "

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America I People Are Canceling Coverage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=Ugwf6AeZ_lpN82kvMB4AaABAg.APWCTUwAiJEAPWGm1NV98t

"HSAs are ONLY available to people with very high deductibles. To move to a higher deductible ACA plan your out of pocket, copays, etc. all rise substantially and...you lose many of your providers. My deductible doesn't allow me to have an HSA, yet my premium doubled to over \$1K a month. If I went with a higher deductible plan to be HSA eligible, my out of pocket risk more than doubles. HSA isn't the answer!! Without ACA my plan would be \$2300 a month. Even with an HSA I can't save enough to pay that!! I worked 40 years but am not yet Medicare eligible. Forced out of my job. Outsourcing and lost retiree benefits. ACA is the only reason I have medical. Many like me. It's so depressing and unnecessary."

— YouTube · Healthcare premiums to skyrocket Jan. 1 for Obamacare enrollees · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZ_YF6SbtSg&lc=Ugzfom3PaUlvqQYccGZ4AaABAg

The income cliff and paying credits back at tax time · 19 documents · 19 voices

"If I get a job part way through the year and cut off my ACA insurance right when my new insurance starts what happens as far as my tax credits? Update : I'm in Michigan I know we estimate for yearly income for the ACA but they wouldn't penalize me for not having or isn't ACA insurance for the months I'm covered by employer insurance right? As of right now I estimated my income higher due to making more money last year but business has taken a dive this year. I'm paying more per month because of that higher estimate and I'm looking for a new job with benefits because it's too unpredictable at this point. For what I've made for the first quarter of the year I prob would have been eligible for Medicaid so I'm also worried about getting screwed for that come tax time next year."

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s3qnb3/if_i_get_a_job_part_way_through_the_year_and_cut/

↳ wijwijwij (3): "Your tax credit will be computed using your full year income."

↳ wijwijwij (3): "You only calculate what tax credit you merit during the months you had ACA coverage (so you wouldn't be "paying back" any tax credit for other months). But your share of the cost of insurance for the months you did have ACA coverage is calculated based not on the income of those months, but your income for the entire year. For example, suppose for Jan, Feb, and Mar you were on ACA and estimated your income was going to be 30K for the year. You'd merit some tax credit (which you can elect to use to directly pay premiums) because that's under 400% federal poverty level. If you end up getting a job and you actually make 80K for the year, which is over 400% federal poverty, when it comes time to "reconcile" things you turn out not to merit any tax credit, so you repay to the treasury what they sent in those three months to your insurer, to square things. That is not "paying back the tax credit as if I used the insurance for the whole year." It's paying back the tax credit because the provisional amount advanced to your insurer in Jan, Feb, Mar was wrong, and you actually didn't merit any help, based on the fact that *later in the year* you earned more money. This is just an artifact of the way ACA legislation was written. It was decided not to try to make eligibility a monthly determination. By the same token, if your income prediction when enrolling in ACA is higher than income turns out to be, you'll find at reconciliation time when you file your taxes, you get additional credit that in effect "pays you back" some of the amounts that went to your ACA insurer, in order that your share for the months you had ACA coverage should match what your income (for the year) indicates."

↳ O_o-22 (2): "So say I'm getting \$500 a month in tax credit but I only use the tax credit for 4 months out of the year and end my ACA insurance for the remaining 8 months. At the end of the year the reconciliation says I should have only gotten \$300 a month due to higher income. Thats a \$200 difference X 4 months so I'd owe \$800 back then?"

"I what to cancel our marketplace insurance and go without for a while, this guessing your income, has been causing me so much anxiety and sleepless nights. This Marketplace insurance with advanced tax premiums is complicated and can leave you having to pay a lot of \$\$\$ back if you happen to do better than expected, I can't live this way !!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugzf4eVxNzdrhPZ2DZB4AaABAq

↳ @Slm-mb7cq (1): "What did you end up doing? or did you find something better? I'm currently looking ugh"

↳ @splooshkaboom4210 (1): "Have you ever considered medically underwritten insurance?"

↳ @iHealthBrokers (0): "Having to estimate your income can certainly be a little daunting. Have you considered speaking with an accountant? They may be able to provide you with some assurances. Best of luck!"

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tm0cfj/>

↳ (0): "What state are you in? If you live in a state with Medicaid expansion and you truly have zero reportable income, your options are to apply for / receive Medicaid, or don't use Medicaid and instead pay full price for a policy through healthcare.gov."

↳ (0): "Don't only live on cash. Use that time of low income to do some Roth conversions up to the magi limit if you intend on qualifying for Medicaid or higher for ACA with subsidies."

↳ (0): "The assets usually dont matter for medicaid eligibility in most states - they mainly look at monthly income flow. Since you're planning zero income those years you'd probably qualify regardless of your house value and retirement accounts You can still buy private insurance through the marketplace even with zero income but you'd be paying full price without subsidies. Might be worth running numbers on both options since private plans could give you more provider choices but medicaid is obviously much cheaper One thing to consider is maybe taking small distributions from retirement accounts or doing some part time work just to stay above medicaid threshold if you prefer private insurance. Even like 20k annual income would open up the subsidized marketplace plans"

"Two straight years of income falling slightly below the minimum threshold. How worried should I be? I live in a state without expanded Medicaid and have only been making between 1k to 1500 monthly for the last two years. I estimated my income as best I could, which was right above the minimum for coverage eligibility. My 2024 final income ended up being at 90% of the FPL and 96% for 2025. One of my parents had a stroke last year, which caused me to miss about a full month of work in total. I didn't report this as a life change event, however looking back perhaps I should have. I'm worried that I might not be able to get advance premium tax credits next year after two years in a row of not making as much as I estimated and being below the minimum threshold. What is the most likely outcome and is there anything I can do now to avoid being penalized?"

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sh0wl7/two_straight_years_of_income_falling_slightly/

↳ tiggonfire (6): "Not an expert here but just wondering if you might have miscellaneous income to report that could bring you up to the cutoff....like maybe your dad paid you for some of the care you provided?"

↳ j2c1 (4): "Actually I do have some but I just filed my taxes online this week. It was accepted by the IRS and shows it's being processed now. I don't know why I didn't think of this before. I guess I could try to file an amended return? Edit: the only documentation I have are deposited checks. Would that be enough?"

↳ Artistic-Peppercorn (4): "If your estimated income (that you report to the exchange) is close to your actual income on previous returns, you'll be fine. Yours is very close, so I think you'll be fine. They are going to start checking people whose actual income on a previous tax return is lower than the estimated income, but I don't think you are far enough below that you'd be flagged. The rules are set up to allow some level of misestimation, as long as you're not intentionally lying about what you expect your income to be, because they know it's hard to get it completely correct when projecting a year in advance."

"Going into my fourth month without a job. I need to cancel my plan if i reach 6 months of no work right? i lost my job in December and thought id find a job by february but rhings fell through. its been really difficult finding a new job and i feel hopeless I'll find one soon. im scared I'll have to pay back if i exceed 6 months without a job so its recommended i cancel then right? then if i find a job I'll have to wait until enrollment but better than paying this shit back without having \$\$\$"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/

↳ SeaweedWeird7705 (10): "If I were you, I would keep my Obamacare since it's the only way for you to get insurance. If you end up below 100% of the FPL for the year, they typically don't ask you to repay (since you were too LOW). (If you were too high, they would insist on repayment)."

↳ SeaweedWeird7705 (8): "There is no rule that you have to cancel your Obamacare if you lose your job. What is your total income for the year 2026? Is it zero? If your total income for the year is zero, you should consider applying for Medicaid."

↳ PeacefulCW (8): "Everything you said was correct until the paragraph that started with “ you never should've had it to begin with...”. That is absolutely incorrect. Marketplace insurance is based on one's ESTIMATE of their annual income, not necessarily their current income. It's absolutely OK for our OP to have marketplace insurance."

"Needing advice on what to do due to disabled household (looking for Marketplace insurance) Hello there. I'm recently officially (not state wide, though I'm starting the application process soon) disabled per my doctors and unable to return to work. I live with my parents and my aunt, all who are also disabled, although my Dad also works a low paying job to provide additional income. My aunt has never worked but pays us rent and has her own bills to pay on. Basically I am concerned about applying for marketplace insurance (Cobra, just for myself is going to be over 700\$ through my previous workplace, which I nor my family can afford monthly). I will solely be relying on my parents' income which I feel terrible about. Obviously as I am chronically ill I can't go without insurance or my medicine. I am worried that with including the entire household yearly income even though most of that money cannot help towards my insurance, that it will raise the price for me. This is all very new, scary and foreign to me. What are the options and how does this usually work through Marketplace? I'm 28 in TN. I'll be honest I'm not entirely sure what the household income is but I can say at least it is over 30k. *Maybe* nearing 45k annually. Not currently receiving disability but am about to start the application process, probably not eligible for Medicaid until then? But my family members are on Medicaid. Sorry and thank you in advance."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pvw5jg/>

↳ (0): "You have a lot of moving parts here. How old are you? State of residence? Total household income? Are you claimed as a dependent? Do you receive disability? Are you Medicaid eligible? Are your other family members on Medicaid? Impossible to give you advice without more information."

↳ (0): "Apologies. I've been a bit scatterbrained with tons of worry/stress and have memory issues. I'm 28 in TN not claimed as a dependent. I'll be honest I'm not entirely sure what the household income is but I can say at least it is over 30k. *Maybe* nearing 45k annually. Not currently receiving disability but am about to start the application process, probably not eligible for Medicaid until then? But my family members are on Medicaid."

↳ (0): "When the aca marketplace asks your household income, they are asking about your TAX household- who you file taxes with. Not just who you happen to live with. So, if your parents are not claiming you on their taxes, its just yourself. Tennessee is one of 10 states that did not expand medicaid to include eligibility due to low/no income- so youre going to need a state disability approval to get original medicaid. (This is what your family members have). The problem you face now is you have no income/low income and unless you'll make at least 15,650 as your modified adjusted gross income (MAGI) you dont qualify for any aca subsidies either. Youd have to pay full price for an ACA marketplace plan. Head over the healthcare.gov and fill out an application to see what is available to you- compare those plans and pricing to what your cobra would cost you. Its a shame there are still 10 states holding out on expanded medicaid, it really leaves many people in a bind- not making enough for a subsidy but not having expanded medicaid as an option either. If you were in an expanded medicaid state, simply making less than that 15k would be enough for medicaid to be approved (there are a few states with a work requirement but most just grant it based on income)."

"Lost my job, I can likely qualify for Medicaid but wondering if it will have bad implications at tax time So I lost my main job this week. I do have a second little 1099 side hustle that's good for about \$400 a month which is only a little over half my mortgage cost and I have some savings I can dip into. My ACA premium ended up being my second highest monthly bill because I estimated my income higher and because of Trump screwing those of us that use the program. My question is can I switch to Medicaid halfway through the without having to worry about paying back the subsidy? I'm applying for Medicaid today but obviously won't have an approval decision before my premium is due on July 1st, so I will probably have to pay my July premium. It would hurt financially to have to keep paying this inflated amount for the premium till the end of the year when I'm no longer making anywhere near that but I don't want to create an even bigger financial headache come tax time. Any insight appreciated thanks 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ufejkl/lost_my_job_i_can_likely_qualify_for_medicaid_but/

↳ O_o-22 (2): "So the electricity bill used to not be that bad with the AC running in the summer tho last summer it did get high. I hadn't had the unit serviced so yesterday I took the panels off and cleaned the coils. One side was very covered in wispy cottony stuff and I've got some new furnace filters coming so hoping that will cut the costs down, especially this wee since it's supposed to be in the 90s all week. I haven't even had the air on at all in the last two weeks because it's been cool."

↳ Jujulabee (1): "Your premium subsidy is calculated based on annual income as reported to the IRS. If you lost your job presumably your annual income will drop significantly. If you become employed before the end of the year then you would calculate. Also keep in mind that unemployment insurance payments are calculated for income. Medicaid eligibility is based on monthly income and so if your monthly income is low enough to qualify your taking Medicaid wouldn't have impact on your taxable income for the purpose of calculating amount of premium."

↳ O_o-22 (1): "Yeah I knew it would count as income but I'm guessing I'll only get \$1000 a month or so. That is enough to pay my mortgage and all utilities so I'll be alright if it goes through."

"Can we withdraw from 401K Roth to be part of our income and not count towards taxable income or just from a Roth IRA as far as subsidies are concerned? Thanks for your time and videos."

— YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=Ugy3O9q4TyBnPIOfwrh4AaABAg>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (3): "Thanks for watching! When it comes to ACA subsidies, what matters is your Modified Adjusted Gross Income (MAGI). Qualified withdrawals from both a Roth IRA and a Roth 401(k) do not count toward MAGI, as long as you're at least 59½ years old and the account has been open for at least 5 years. To clarify: a "qualified withdrawal" is one made after you're 59½ and the Roth account has been open for 5 years or more. If you withdraw before meeting these requirements, especially from earnings, those dollars could become taxable income, and any taxable portion would count toward MAGI. Contributions to a Roth IRA (your original after-tax deposits) can be withdrawn at any time, tax-free and penalty-free, but earnings are subject to the qualified withdrawal rules. Also, keep in mind that rolling over a Roth 401(k) into a Roth IRA can restart the 5-year clock for the IRA, unless the IRA itself already meets the 5-year rule for all previous money. So, if you're planning a rollover and thinking about withdrawals, timing matters! In short, both Roth IRA and Roth 401(k) plans can be excellent tools for early retirement and ACA planning, as long as you meet the qualified withdrawal requirements. If you're still under 59½ or haven't met the 5-year rule, consult with your tax advisor before making withdrawals. I hope that helps—and really appreciate your support of the channel!"

↳ @minihub67 (0): "@EarlyRetirementRoadmap So, to be clear. If one is 58 but can pull from (after tax portion) of the Roth "contributions" made for decades, "before" turning 59.5.. that would still be OK as a bridge to pull from , even if under 59.5.. just to get the 1.5 years covered until turning 59.5? It could help someone that's 57 or 58 get retired earlier."

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "@minihub67 Thanks for watching & great question—short answer: it depends on if it's a Roth IRA vs. a Roth 401(k). Roth IRA: You can always withdraw your original contributions (basis) at any age, tax- and penalty-free. Because those dollars aren't taxable, they don't increase MAGI for ACA purposes. If you dip into earnings before 59½ (and before the 5-year clock), that part is taxable and does hit MAGI. Roth 401(k): Different rules. Distributions are generally pro-rata (a mix of contributions and earnings), so you usually can't just pull "contributions only." That means a pre-59½ withdrawal can make part of it taxable, which does increase MAGI. Many people roll a Roth 401(k) to a Roth IRA first (when eligible) so the IRA "ordering rules" let them access contributions without affecting MAGI. Hope that helps! Big takeaway: Roth IRA contributions = safe for MAGI. Roth 401(k) withdrawals can be MAGI-impacting unless rolled to a Roth IRA first. Not tax advice—just education so you can plan smart for Open Enrollment."

"Right all that doge stuff to spend more due to doge while Elmo was still the public clown of it. Trump wanted to cut 2.4 trillion, I didn't get the economics or math behind that and my friend sighed and said "maga doesn't know economics, math, how to read or think critically. I mean Greene voted for the bill. Then apparently she asked chatgtp what was in it or someone translated it to Neanderthal so the b6 ape 🦍 could understand and then she was against it. Like her next election comes along, Medicaid, Medicare, Ava cuts have closed hospitals and nursing homes, the Va isn't running or volunteers are trying to keep the doors open, and people have lost their homes, her voters, 97% of peoples taxes had a trump tax raise, read my big fat orange lips, I'm gonna cut taxes bigly! Well, bezos, Zuckerberg, Tim apple, etc might have kissed the ring and bought trump coin, but they do not need tax cuts as individuals. Trickle down economics is a farce rotten Ronnie started in the 1980s and it hollowed out the middle class, he did a ton of damage to unions taking power from workers and giving it to corporations, who do whatever for share holders, record profits? Fire 17,000 people, gotta have a higher stock price so you don't get sued by blackrock. That corporate tax cut Tim Apple got? Bezos and others? 10%? Like corporations pay less in taxes than individuals I'm pretty sure, I'd have to double check on a graph, if corporations... like instead of tariffs and tax cuts for corporations I would have worked with the world trade organization, the U, EU, Japan, China, the commonwealth countries etc, and set a global tax rate, perhaps 22-25%, require health and safety standards globally, agree to pension and health care standard as well as a minimum wage scaled to the local economy, Sweden and some European countries system of everyone being in local unions and setting local wage tiers collectively based on cost of living that the people voting on the pay live through. I mean someone who made 200 million from insider trading, or someone born with a golden spoon in his mouth that still uses it as a coke spoon on the resolute desk, they day it's a Diet Coke button, it's freuds little helper vitamin cocaine, but basically weave aside creepy Mike Johnson, when asked about preventing insider trading or perhaps it was any trading, he said, he'd consider it "BUT congress hadn't gotten a raise since 2016-2018 and this wage loss represented a 33% reduction in pay due to inflation and cost of living, so some trading should be allowed so..."(basically they couldn't get people in congress without a raise or insider trading or something, it's like ok Hb you all resign and give up your pay for life and go to Elon for a handout I hear that works really well... They make like 200,000, for life, they get free healthcare for life, that probably isn't getting cut, potus gets pay for life, then they're like oh we haven't had a raise we need to be able to buy and sell stock... even if they don't break the law of regular people as they do, but bc they make the law they should have it in a blind trust. Perhaps to save mo et cut the lifetime healthcare and pay, have them just pay into social security, need Medicare, and get a 3.4-5% matching 401k like some of us are lucky to have. I'll paste the Gemini quote about shifting from defined contribution, or pensions, peak 50% in the 1960s, due to private sector growth of /r/union jobs. Your mission rn, should you chose to accept it, is to start a discussion, keep it to one post and post your industry wage benefits, healthcare and retirement... Example: begin weave; I made 45k 2006-2008, I have 18,000 in my pension and like 6k in my 401k, my pension will pay 900/mo adjusted for inflation for two years of work for life! If I got hired 2.5 years earlier I'd have healthcare for life for free. I had a 35 hour work week, I had 18,000 in tuition reimbursement and job training money, the union said I could use the \$4000 in job training to take related classes to my job, and use the rest for other classes. I was on medication that made me easy to manipulate and an mba got in there and decided it'd be cheaper to get a temp in my job, I got a call offering 20,000 more in salary with similar vacation and benefits, but then the economy crashed and I got laid off, so I left my union job bc some incompetent bob, he did such a bad job they had to rename my formerly prestigious department, then wait until people forgot about the bob and change it back... biggest regret of my life walking into that trap, but I wanted to own a home, knew housing prices would skyrocket, and going from 45k to 65k was enough if the economy didn't crash. /end weave it's the richest 1-4% that get a tax cut or maybe 1-2% see a tax cut, tariffs might have sounded good to Greene, until the cost of wood, steel, everything went through the roof, food got much more expensive during Covid, Georgia meets federal snap 100% if you buy from Georgia farmers, like a lot of small maga and non maga farms alike went out of business in Georgia and locals could not

afford to outbid big agriculture. Big ag would just double a bid and look around like, ok, get the message? We always win... then they produce worse food bc it's to appease shareholders like blackrock Blackrock is suing united healthcare for providing too much healthcare! Like didn't someone retire to Cancun after United got found out? Usually you have to fire someone to make it look like you're doing something. I'm on Ssdi and section 8 Medicare and Medicaid in affordable housing on snap, that's why I kind of rambled in and out of policy to examples that turn into stories, my older brother died homeless and I'm worried these cuts might make it the same for me. Luckily I have hundreds of relatives and my whole generation are two income households to afford kids, the lucky part of that is who ever puts up an accessory dwelling unit and helps me get by would get daycare, I watched them when they were little, just realized this now, duh. Maybe I should talk to some of them about it. I'd be a lot less freaked out and worried if I wasn't in a position to end up on the street."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1l7mqzy/any_way_you_look_at_it_you_lose_medicaid_work/mwz1r8j/

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1r5uq2v/>

↳ (0): "U file and claim him and ut goes on yours"

↳ (0): "You pay all his expenses. If he made over 5200 you can still claim him and he can file and say he's being claimed as a dependent. But since you claim him it has to go on yours. This happened with my son as I claimed him and he filed as a dependent. It wouldn't let me file his with the 1095 a because he was a dependent. It had to go on mine."

↳ (0): ">Thank you! You're welcome!"

"Will I have to refund the credit? I recently quit my job and my income for the rest of the year will be around 1500/mo but my total income for 2026 is much higher than that. How do the healthcare supplements work n healthcare.gov? I Applied for coverage on heath care.gov but when it came to choosing the plan, I didn't hit confirm because it says that if my 2026 tax returns are higher than I stated I would need to refund the stipend. I don't mind waiting a few months for 2027 without health insurance now, but what if I get the stipend in 2027 and then get a job and then my 2027 tax returns are also too high? So, if I'm making 1500/mo now in Sept 2026 and it takes me 6 months to get a job, will I have to refund the stipend? It's like \$800/months stipend for healthcare they offer but I won't be able to afford to pay that back once I get a job. Any advice?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wia2qt/will_i_have_to_refund_the_credit/

↳ LizzieMac123 (9): "So, just a few clarifying things--- the plans on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) are not supplements, they are full blown ACA Compliant, Comprehensive medical plans (dental is also offered either as part of some medical plans or as a separate stand-alone dental plan). When you say supplements in the insurance world, that usually refers to supplemental health plans like a critical illness, accident or hospital indemnity plan that pays you a set amount IF a covered event happens (IE- IF you break a bone, you could get a payout if your Accident plan covers broken bones). The subsidies offered by the marketplace are an ADVANCED PREMIUM TAX CREDIT- these are calculated based off of your annual income for that tax year. When you sign up for a marketplace plan, you're asked to estimate your annual income for 2026 and enter that number. You are offered a subsidy based on the number you enter. HOWEVER, if your annual income is HIGHER for the year, you will be asked to pay back any subsidy you took that you weren't actually entitled to. IE- say you entered 30k as your income, you'd get a pretty sizable subsidy offered to. If you took that subsidy then ended up making 90k for 2026, you would actually pay back every cent as 90k for a single person is above the income limit for a subsidy. You ALWAYS settle up come tax time, so it's in your best interest to estimate your annual income as accurately as possible and, if your income changes during the year, many folks recommend making those income adjustments throughout the year to help adjust the subsidies and help you avoid having to pay anything back. There are NO CAPS on what you may have to repay starting in 2026, so if you took 5k in subsidies and it turns out you weren't eligible for anything, you'll be paying back all 5k of the subsidy you took. For you, it doesn't matter what you make NOW, it matters what you will make for all of 2026 in total. Medicaid eligibility goes by month, so that is why you may be asked what you make per month now. With Medicaid, you could make a million dollars from Jan-June, but if in July, you make 500, you're eligible for medicaid. With the Marketplace, they're only looking at what you enter in your application and you'll settle up come tax time once you have been issued your W-2s and know for sure what was made for the year."

"I retired in 2023 but wont qualify for medicare until 2026. I was told by a tax pro that since my only (unearned) income is from SS and a bit of interest from a bank (about 30K total) it disqualifies me from getting any ACA (premium tax credit) subsidy for tax year 2024 because its all unearned income. Of course, since I dont work anymore being fully retired, my earned income is 0). Going by the 1040 and 8962 instructions for 2024 it certainly seems like i had a premium tax credit for at least some of my ACA monthly costs coming back to me since im at 200 percent of the poverty level. (i didnt set up advance tax credits for 2024 in the fall of 2023 because i was nervous i would get screwed at 2024 tax time). This sucks, my ACA healthcare is now almost 30 percent of my income. Talk about a donut hole!"

— YouTube · How to Qualify for ACA Health Insurance Subsidies as an Early Retiree · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cDtnJs9uN7M&lc=Ugxzp5AxlcobGA803ld4AaABAq>

↳ @catchristo9406 (1): "That's why I kept telling my brother to start investing fully into a traditional IRA so he could pull out just enough each year to have enough taxable income to qualify for the ACA. He finally listened to me and will save thousands of dollars when he retires a bit early."

"Does anybody know how ACA considers dividend funds like QQQI - say I buy 10k of it at the beginning of year 1. Then I get that the dividends I take out that year count as income. But with these funds the div are subtracted from initial cost - so in year 2 my cost basis is 10k minus 1500 so 8500. If I decide to sell these in year 2, does the 1500 count as "income" for Aca? It will count as capital gains for taxes (cause they don't tax dividends I think)... anybody in here knows what I'm talking about? I'd like to get 40k of qqqi for div income, but afraid of being stuck with huge "income" on paper that can ruin my ACA premium credits down the road if I ever need to sell..."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgzjFs6wDCnH1cDhKXx4AaABAq>

↳ @tachikaze222 (0): "return of capital ia NOT considered income for ACA; check your 1099-DIV, box 3 income doesn't count for ACA"

"What if the ACA subsidy estimate is wrong? My income estimate is right on the mark this year (fixed income 280% of FPL), but in meeting with my tax advisor in preparation for next year, she says I may end up having to pay back some subsidy at tax time, even if my income estimate comes in below the number entered in my ACA application. How is this possible?"

— YouTube · The IRS Mistake That Kills ACA Subsidies · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R_UhpUHc0Tc&lc=Ugwyi-8C_Qdf0R_v3Ud4AaABAq

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (2): "You should be able to log in to your healthcare.gov account and check the math or call them and talk to someone about your question. Worth a call."

↳ @scottsteward398 (1): "After some research, I'm on the hook for choosing a pricey plan than I should have? First time on ACA. Next year I will shop for a plan that isn't more than the SL CSP?"

↳ @J-2024-v8i (0): "@scottsteward398 That shouldn't affect your subsidy. The subsidy is the same at the same level of income for any plan. You just pay more during the year for the pricy plan premium since the subsidy covers less of the premium due. The only way I can think that you would owe part of the subsidy back if your income is lower than the estimate, is if it gets below the threshold for Medicaid, or if in your state there is some other threshold that applies."

"I use ACA but I'm worried about my MAGI being too low. I work part time and they recently cut the number of hours I work. I don't live in an expanded Medicaid state. It has been confusing to lock in how much I will make at the end of the year. What happens if at the end of the year I didn't make enough?"

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugw9hdl8KHvCPCfE7KZ4AaABAg>

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "Normally you would be placed on the Medicaid plan if your income is too low. However, if your 2027 MAGI estimate is high enough you may be able to stay on ACA. I would call the ACA and talk with a representative"

"I have been on ACA for a few years. My income will be going up next year so I'm concerned about what that will do for my subsidies. The plan i have now actually costs less than what I paid in 2025 but is going up I think 9%. Ugh!!!"

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgwG1B4_zJpQN9nj0VV4AaABAg

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "It will be interesting to see how much the subsidies go up to compensate! 🙄 "

"My concern isnt my income going over what i previously claimed but that being without a job for that long would no longer qualify me for the subsidy."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/ofjxgu3/

"From what I have learned,(videos and research) you probably don't want to be on Medicaid, Consider earning some income, drawing from investments, to get a Medicare subsidized policy."

— YouTube · HOW to ESTIMATE Your 2026 ACA (Marketplace) Premiums! (calculator) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N7I023Co9ro&lc=UgwWX5t-CAaAY5RxOht4AaABAg.AL_CYhHeruBAL_VZmXZtQu

"Yup, bascially my plan too ... keep ACA income at \$50k/yr via living small and maybe strategic HELOC draws for any big expenses that come up that I don't want to pull out of the Roth."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVy_wz5Ac7pA&lc=UgwMcou1-AaTNPj7HRR4AaABAg.AOfaGIMHv3HAWa_FCE_IT5

Going without insurance · 14 documents · 14 voices

"Is It Better to not Have Health Insurance or Choose a Very Expensive Plan? So these are the issues that we're facing if we have to choose a marketplace plan. Would you guys rather risk it and go without, or pay a lot for a plan? Here's my potential plan with a 50k income: BCBS PPO, 700/month, 9800 deductible, 11000 max oop. It would eat up my income, but if I don't have any major surgeries or a trip to the ER, then I'd be fine without. However, I'd hate to be uninsured if something happens. Realistically, what would you do? Can hospitals negotiate the price down if a bill is very expensive?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 47 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1p965n4/>

↳ (0): "My 64 year old brother was very healthy and never had to go to the doctor for anything until he was recently diagnosed with stage 4 lung cancer. If he didn't have health insurance m he'd likely go bankrupt. Don't take any chances."

↳ (0): "Chances are, he still will. >60% of medical bankruptcies held "full" insurance."

↳ (0): "For years I was someone who barely used any of my healthcare benefits. After I got bad results on a mammogram it set off a series of tests that had me halfway to my high deductible in six hours. The sticker price of my healthcare costs in the past year have exceeded a quarter million dollars and that is for a straightforward case of breast cancer. If I had been uninsured I would have gone without many of the tests, procedures, and medications I've received and even if the hospital had accepted 10% it would have exceeded the cost of my insurance premium, even after upgrading to Gold for 2025. If it's all you can afford, get the cheapest plan the marketplace has to offer. Even if it seems like it won't cover anything. If you really need it, it will cover plenty."

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/>

↳ (0): "Health shares are NOT insurance."

↳ (0): "you're young and healthy with no preexisting conditions until you aren't. during a routine physical my doctor found a large mass on my thyroid. it happens in the blink of an eye."

↳ (0): "Healthshares are scams"

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

"I what to cancel our marketplace insurance and go without for a while, this guessing your income, has been causing me so much anxiety and sleepless nights. This Marketplace insurance with advanced tax premiums is complicated and can leave you having to pay a lot of \$\$\$ back if you happen to do better than expected, I can't live this way !!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugzf4eVxNzdrhPZ2DZB4AaABAg

↳ @Slm-mb7cq (1): "What did you end up doing? or did you find something better? I'm currently looking ugh"

↳ @splooshkaboom4210 (1): "Have you ever considered medically underwritten insurance?"

↳ @iHealthBrokers (0): "Having to estimate your income can certainly be a little daunting. Have you considered speaking with an accountant? They may be able to provide you with some assurances. Best of luck!"

"This makes a lot of sense, but my only fear of not having health insurance is the risk of unexpected hospitalizations. How can I mitigate this risk without health insurance?"

— YouTube · The Truth About Health Insurance -- Why Entrepreneurs Should Cancel Their Health Insurance · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2IU7ErdRc44&lc=UgxTq0Wq7C6ZZYCEgvJ4AaABAg>

↳ @Roslyn111 (8): "You can't mitigate without health insurance. The information in this video is incorrect and CMS, the federal entity that oversees Medicare, Medicaid, and the Marketplace/the Affordable Care Act, is cracking down on agents, agencies, etc. spreading misinformation & just implemented new regulations as of June 2023. The IRS also has a stake in the Affordable Care Act, and some people end up with IRS penalties for completing an ACA application incorrectly. You need to speak to a licensed broker in your area to help with quotes for ACA, hospital indemnity, accidental, and possibly critical illness coverage. One of my clients was younger than 35 and almost died because he didn't have insurance. Another young client ended up with rare cancer & I was able to get him covered. We can NEVER predict what's going to happen with our health. And, no, you can't just get health insurance whenever you want. There isn't always an enrollment period to get covered or to switch your coverage. You definitely need a broker for guidance."

↳ @laurenfannaly4195 (3): "@Roslyn111thank you! This guy is saying things that are so irresponsible!!!"

↳ @AsusMemopad-us5lk (0): "One solution: Emigration to a democracy."

"This is a fantastic write up, thank you! Do you have any advice as to how practical a catastrophic plan would be in 2026? From my googling, it appears as though my family could qualify for a hardship exemption as ACA costs will be higher than 7.97% of our income. I don't want to go the uninsured route, but we can't afford the -\$1300/month bronze plan without a subsidy. Thank you!"

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacareaca_changes_to_know_heading/n4i9yli/

"Just don't know what to do. Hey all. My husband and I are both self-employed. Currently, I'm still under 26 and on my parents' plan, though not for much longer. My husband is currently uninsured. We don't qualify for any subsidies, as our income is just over the 400% FPL limit. Despite this, we still live paycheck to paycheck as is, due to living in a high-cost of living area. Packing up and moving isn't really an option, as both of our businesses are based here. We simply can't afford to fork over hundreds to thousands of dollars each month for an ACA compliant plan. I've considered non-ACA, but everyone on this sub seems to think it's a terrible idea and they won't cover anything. At this point I'm just at a loss and don't know what to do. I worry about my husband being uninsured, and I'm considering giving up my business and getting a job that can provide us with insurance, though I really don't want to. Any advice is appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wfnwua/just_dont_know_what_to_do/

↳ Poop_Dolla (15): "Do you have an accountant? Are you certain you're taking advantage of all your write offs for your business? In my opinion you have two options if you want a marketplace ACA plan, you can attempt to get your gross income under the threshold by contributing to retirement plans and making sure your deductions are all accounted for, or you can make more to cover the cost of an unsubsidized plan."

↳ katsrad (11): "Non-ACA isn't recommended if you have any pre-existing condition because you can be denied or they are just indemnity plans that pay a small set amount that won't cover the cost of the service. My advice is to look for employment that provides health insurance as a benefit."

↳ saysee23 (8): "Lots of people get jobs to provide insurance, maybe part time at Starbucks so you would not have to give up your business. Non-ACA isn't worth most of the time unless you really like to gamble with your family's health. You said you two "still" live paycheck to paycheck - the part-time or totally different job might help with this. it's never too often to reevaluate your budgets. The other comment about the CPA is a very good idea."

"I'm 60, retired and without health insurance. My pension puts me over the max income to receive any subsidy amount. I just can't justify 16-18k annually for so-so coverage. The providers I see give me very generous discounts and I use CostPlus pharmacy but it is a very big risk to be uninsured. Unfortunately, I retired right before we knew the enhanced subsidies were not going to be extended. I am single and basically one serious illness away from losing everything. My semi-decent pension will not be able to cover even a short hospitalization."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=Ugwhp02bcNjY6t3rVfl4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Oh no! I'm sorry to hear that. There are some other options like farm bureau health insurance (depending on where you live) or healthshare programs."

↳ @ThatGirlinStitches (1): "@Trilobites-and-Tentaculitos It's not that simple. 1500+ monthly premium isn't so easy for a person with a modest pension. Not much left after paying rent, utilities and basic living expenses. There isn't any tax breaks to speak of for those under age 65 and without a spouse or dependents. The cost of medical coverage is too high in this country."

↳ @cindyhenry1410 (0): "Wow this scares me!!"

"W/O insurance My husband works in construction and recently got denied insurance. This really has screwed us because we cannot afford health insurance through marketplace. I'm more concerned because now it means my 1.5 yr old is uninsured. The insurance company denied him for "occupation including flooring", word for word. I think that's a bunch of BS?! All of his coworkers have gotten covered through the same company and do the exact same thing. He tried appealing it and they denied that too. Any advice? We are in Ohio."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmejge/wo_insurance/

↳ LacyLove (39): "So he tried to get a non ACA compliant plan, they do not have the same rules and can pick and chose who they insure. It doesn't matter if they approved his coworkers."

↳ InfluenceWeak (36): "He should really look for a union construction job that offers insurance."

↳ rosebudny (26): "Honestly it is probably crap insurance that won't cover any preexisting conditions."

"My husband and I have a very small business and the ACA subsidy is how we afford insurance. My monthly without the subsidy is \$1,877.00 for 2, 59 y/o and 63 y/o. We received our new premium rates and the new monthly bill will be \$2,348.00. Then it all gets further complicated because my tax person is fighting cancer and still hasn't filed our 2024 taxes. You have to reconcile your subsidy via filing taxes to qualify for the subsidy for the following year. I am kind of a nervous wreck. I have chronic genetic conditions, and going without insurance is so very scary."

— YouTube · What Happens if Obamacare Subsidies Expire? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=onsEZnTGKCA&lc=UgxM3Ze9-dvXF9v-pjt4AaABAg>

"I'm one of those "coast fire" as many YouTuber called. But because I am only 41 year old and scared to live without health insurance, I'm stuck working. Although I'm happy with my job, it still hurts not being able to jump off the working life just for the health insurance."

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=UgxpCp84r7CYLYFAIvV4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "It is scary living without health insurance!"

↳ @jgmatp (0): "As for my family, we're converting quite a lot of money to Roth this year so that we can qualify just shy of the 400%FPL level for several years into the future, (or at 41 you could use a regular brokerage account, selling appreciated shares). Otherwise it would be a ridiculous hit to our budget for many years. I'd suggest every early retiree do the same, if the numbers work for you. Take 1 year of full price health insurance, max out the 24 pct bracket (or 15pct bracket for capital gains) then live for 5 years with subsidies, rinse, repeat. That's about how I'd look at it."

↳ @ivzg3576 (0): "@j@jgmatpwe can't afford to live at 400%FPL right now, we have college student soon. We are pouring into our brokerage account plus employer match in our 401ks. We are almost done with our old 401k rollovers. Can't wait to jump off the cliff at 50 😂"

"Will I have to refund the credit? I recently quit my job and my income for the rest of the year will be around 1500/mo but my total income for 2026 is much higher than that. How do the healthcare supplements work n healthcare.gov? I Applied for coverage on heath care.gov but when it came to choosing the plan, I didn't hit confirm because it says that if my 2026 tax returns are higher than I stated I would need to refund the stipend. I don't mind waiting a few months for 2027 without health insurance now, but what if I get the stipend in 2027 and then get a job and then my 2027 tax returns are also too high? So, if I'm making 1500/mo now in Sept 2026 and it takes me 6 months to get a job, will I have to refund the stipend? It's like \$800/months stipend for healthcare they offer but I won't be able to afford to pay that back once I get a job. Any advice?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wia2qt/will_i_have_to_refund_the_credit/

↳ LizzieMac123 (9): "So, just a few clarifying things--- the plans on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) are not supplements, they are full blown ACA Compliant, Comprehensive medical plans (dental is also offered either as part of some medical plans or as a separate stand-alone dental plan). When you say supplements in the insurance world, that usually refers to supplemental health plans like a critical illness, accident or hospital indemnity plan that pays you a set amount IF a covered event happens (IE- IF you break a bone, you could get a payout if your Accident plan covers broken bones). The subsidies offered by the marketplace are an ADVANCED PREMIUM TAX CREDIT- these are calculated based off of your annual income for that tax year. When you sign up for a marketplace plan, you're asked to estimate your annual income for 2026 and enter that number. You are offered a subsidy based on the number you enter. HOWEVER, if your annual income is HIGHER for the year, you will be asked to pay back any subsidy you took that you weren't actually entitled to. IE- say you entered 30k as your income, you'd get a pretty sizable subsidy offered to. If you took that subsidy then ended up making 90k for 2026, you would actually pay back every cent as 90k for a single person is above the income limit for a subsidy. You ALWAYS settle up come tax time, so it's in your best interest to estimate your annual income as accurately as possible and, if your income changes during the year, many folks recommend making those income adjustments throughout the year to help adjust the subsidies and help you avoid having to pay anything back. There are NO CAPS on what you may have to repay starting in 2026, so if you took 5k in subsidies and it turns out you weren't eligible for anything, you'll be paying back all 5k of the subsidy you took. For you, it doesn't matter what you make NOW, it matters what you will make for all of 2026 in total. Medicaid eligibility goes by month, so that is why you may be asked what you make per month now. With Medicaid, you could make a million dollars from Jan-June, but if in July, you make 500, you're eligible for medicaid. With the Marketplace, they're only looking at what you enter in your application and you'll settle up come tax time once you have been issued your W-2s and know for sure what was made for the year."

"Why Not Health Cost Sharing Ministries? I am an independent stock trader currently paying for a marketplace plan for my family. I do not qualify for ACA premium subsidies. I feel I am getting a raw deal and want to approach buying health insurance as I would any other portfolio problem. The ACA allows anyone to enroll in a marketplace plan regardless of pre-existing condition status. In effect, the government issues every family a European call option on health insurance each year. This option has value, as it reduces the risk of having a catastrophic health event when uninsured from a lifetime of higher costs to just 1 year. That is a massive reduction in tail risk. Why not use that to justify aggressive risk taking elsewhere? My proposal is to go uninsured and enroll in a Health Cost Sharing Ministry. I understand these plans are not legally obligated to pay for care, so it leaves me with more risk. But perhaps I can self-insure that 1 year of risk with my current portfolio. And honestly real insurance companies deny claims all the time so how much more risk is this really? Has anyone made something like this work for them? Calculated \$5,652 per year from Christian Healthcare Ministries versus \$12,564 from Blue Cross on PA exchange. So \$6,912 annual savings. Anything I may be missing? FYI, I understand the topic of Health Cost Sharing Ministries gets political. I'm not really interested in politics and am only asking from a financial standpoint."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmmmap5/why_not_health_cost_sharing_ministries/

↳ Poop_Dolla (27): ""real insurance companies deny claims all the time" This seems like something that you are breezing over in your analysis. "Real" insurance companies play by a set of rules, denials are based on these rules, there is no "Tom was feeling mean last Tuesday and denied a bunch of claims". If you have an issue with a denial, there are avenues for independent review and complaints. This doesn't happen with health sharing ministries. If you're going to do a full risk analysis, this needs to be part of it."

↳ benefits_nerd (7): "Your option framing mostly holds, but you can't exercise it on demand. You can only get back in at open enrollment, and coverage starts Jan 1 at the earliest. Leaving a sharing ministry doesn't get you a special enrollment period because it isn't minimum essential coverage. So a February diagnosis means you carry it for about 11 months, and a bit longer if it lands right after the window closes. On the Blue Cross plan your family's worst case is premiums plus the out-of-pocket max, somewhere in the low \$20ks. With CHM nothing caps your side. Their guidelines limit sharing to \$125k per illness unless you buy the CHM Plus add-on (is that in your \$5,652?), and maintenance prescriptions past 90 days aren't eligible. A cancer year or a NICU stay can run way past that, and you'd be negotiating it as a self-pay patient. And on the denials point, with an insurer you get appeals and external review, and with a ministry the state insurance department can't do anything for you. So you're collecting about \$6.9k a year to be short an uncapped tail on every person in your household. Whether your portfolio can eat that in a down market is your call. Before you decide though, what metal level is the \$12.5k plan? If it's silver or gold, price a bronze. Your worst year is still capped, and since 2026 bronze and catastrophic plans are HSA eligible, so you can put close to \$9k a year in pre-tax and invest it. People who don't qualify for subsidies may also be able to buy catastrophic plans now through a hardship exemption, so ask Pennie about that. That gets you a good chunk of the savings without selling the tail."

↳ aps86rsa (5): "This. The quote is so grossly overstated. But OP is also not necessarily wrong about the idea of being able to get into a real plan. It just happens only annually which may be too late. And that's one of the reasons costs are going up. If the timing works out, people can get coverage without having contributed to the risk pool."

"We're in a similar situation. We pay over 20,000 a year for a high deductible plan on my husband's policy. We've explored alternatives, including purchasing coverage for me through the Marketplace; but our most "affordable" option is to stay on his plan because it is based on pre-taxed income. We've also tried the pay out of pocket approach, and I had a minor health emergency, which cost several thousand. We decided that going uninsured with little children is too risky."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/health_insurance_will_cost_us_almost_18000_this/mjy0vel/

Medicaid: losing it, or being pushed onto it · 11 documents · 11 voices

"I can't afford COBRA and I'm under court orders... I recently changed jobs. My benefits with my new employer don't kick in for 60 days. I'm under court orders (Child Support) to provide coverage or I risk paying 100% of any medical costs out of pocket. My childrens' other parent is not willing to work with me and has a history of taking advantage of situations that cause me financial hardship. They are already aware of the lack of coverage since recent Rx had to be paid out of pocket. Although my new position pays better than the last, COBRA coverage is \$1961.25 monthly to continue. Considering my other expenses to just survive, I can't afford an additional \$2k/mo even if it's only for two months. I have two children that are Special Needs so having a PPO plan was the choice to ensure we could see (almost) any doctor we needed. There is no option to only provide coverage for my children. I don't know what to do. I can start looking at other providers. I was told to ask for "Special Enrollment Period" plans as the coverage would only be needed for two months (until my new employer's benefits kick in). It was recommended to check healthcare.gov and affordablehealthplans.com . My concern is running into similar, unaffordable pricing. I need advice. I'm lost and feel like I'm going to face major medical bills here soon if I don't figure out a plan. I'm at work so I can't provide 100% of my attention to searching plans until later this evening. Help me, Reddit Community. You're my only hope."

— r/HealthInsurance · 42 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1w02ffv/>

↳ (0): "Your loss of insurance due to you leaving your job that included health insurance opens a special enrollment period in your state's health insurance marketplace (ACA Marketplace). The marketplace is operated either by your state or the federal government, depending on where you live. All plans available in the marketplace meet certain core standards including coverage of essential services and coverage for preexisting conditions. This last point is really important. Plans bought outside the marketplace may not include coverage for medical issues a person already has. In your children's cases, that would mean their health conditions wouldn't be covered, making the insurance less than useful. Depending on your income, you may get a subsidy for buying a plan through the Marketplace. Given today's date (August 28th) most plans may not go into effect until October 1. Costs incurred prior to the effective date won't be covered by insurance. Medicaid coverage is available in all states, depending on income and other factors. In most states, Medicaid expanded to cover a wide range of people. The Marketplace in your state will indicate if Medicaid is an option in your state. In some cases, Medicaid can be retroactive. You might also consider pursuing CHIP or Medicaid for individuals with disabilities, depending on the exact nature of your children's medical issues."

↳ (0): "Thank you. I'll look into these options."

↳ (0): "How long have you gone without health insurance? COBRA can be signed up for/used retroactively. So for 60 days from the last date of employment you have a window where you can wait to sign up if you need it, and it covers you retroactively for those 60 days. It's a rare instance where you only have to pay for it if you need to use it. For instance, if you do nothing now, and then your child has a large medical expense, you can sign up after the event of the expense, get coverage, and the event will be paid for as long as you signed up within the first 60 days."

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

↳ (0): "Cash on hand/assets only matters if you're 65 or older. You HAVE been eligible all along, and you should feel free to use your services. You're in the exact situation this social safety net is intended for....use it all you want until you find a job and get monthly income again. And no, it would not matter even if you weren't eligible. You could have knowingly lied and committed fraud to get enrolled in Medi-Cal, but if you haven't made claims Medicaid would never know or care. There's nothing spent by them to try to recover. They'd only come after you if you had claims."

↳ (0): "Medicaid goes by going forward current monthly income, not calendar year income. Previous months do not count at all, and there is no asset test for expansion Medicaid. The monthly income limit for 2022 was \$1,563 and for 2023 \$1,677 a month."

↳ (0): "Are you saying that the "cash on hand" question is basically moot and that it's ALL about monthly income?"

"We need Medicare-For-All/A single payer healthcare system here in the United States, especially during this time with the Coronavirus pandemic! What is more "Pro-Life" than ensuring that every person in America has guaranteed affordable healthcare regardless of their job or social status? Also, if we all had access to basic healthcare, we would all have the "freedom" to live long lives and rarely have to worry about medical bankruptcies. Sure, taxes will go up, but the overall cost will go down so much that everyone will be paying less and saving thousands of dollars every year. Furthermore, if some of us need additional healthcare than Medicare, then we have the "choice" to get additional insurance, but for others Medicare would be more than enough. Finally, if every other developed country (Canada, Germany, the United Kingdom, France, Italy, Sweden, Norway, Denmark, the Netherlands, Switzerland, Japan, South Korea, Australia, and New Zealand) can implement this system and save money, then why can't the United States do the same and help "Make America Great Again" for everybody at least on the issue of healthcare? Oh, and if American citizens die from lacking access to affordable health insurance because the Republicans believe that the government shouldn't provide it then we are failing our country's promise of defending "life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness" for its citizens as well as "promoting the general welfare" of all the people."

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=UgzfpC1om_phrxaXD0B4AaABAg

↳ @DoubleDown310 (2): "Why would they do that, when they can squeeze every penny out of every single American?"

↳ @dvran (1): "Americans wanted capitalism; here you go. Greedy healthcare companies making shareholders happy, large corporations taking over ... it's all to make more billionaires."

↳ @BeatTheBush (1): "@momosan11 I wish but I don't see that happening any time soon. Reform is hard when you have such an ingrained system that will have big money behind to resist it."

"Another solution you forgot to mention: Leave the USA. This isn't even a problem in most countries. Or if you don't want to permanently expatriate, you could go the medical tourism route. I really hate this situation we have in America. I'm 46 and while healthy I do have occasional reasons to go to the doctor. My job has great healthcare benefits and I'm afraid of leaving and losing health insurance."

— YouTube · The Truth About Health Insurance -- Why Entrepreneurs Should Cancel Their Health Insurance · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2IU7ErdRc44&lc=Ugxq0TOOqY0ldrYReJ54AaABAg>

↳ @swavekbu4959 (1): "Same here, I'm 49, healthy, and ready to retire from my job, but don't know what to do about health insurance. I'm considering actually moving back to Canada just for free healthcare, even though I like most about living in the USA."

"This is me. I have more health problems and see more specialists than the people I know/family I have who are in their late 70's, 80's and even more than my 98 year old grandmother. I am decades younger than that and terrified of what my health will be like at those ages, especially if my Medicaid is taken away. Not one of my health conditions is caused by poor choices like substance abuse or eating poorly or lack of exercise. I lost the genetic lottery and have terrible luck. I have written in my will that I wish to donate my body to science when I die because of the amount of "rare" diseases and syndromes I have. Literally every doctor I have ever had has said to me, "I have never seen this before". So that's been fun. I hope that by studying my body when I'm gone and won't need it, doctors and /or scientists will be able to learn how to help others with issues like mine someday. According to the current rules, despite being too sick to work, I have too many "assets" to qualify for SSI disability. So that will render me *not disabled* in the eyes of this new nightmare government and according to this evil bill. I gave up my teaching career when I was married when I became a stay at home mom/wife 25 years ago so I didn't pay into the social security system for decades which makes me ineligible for SSDI or social security disability. I am not qualified or trained to do any kind of job that would make enough money to be able to afford insurance and all the co-pays, deductibles, co-insurance, and prescriptions. I doubt anyone would even hire me, and I would likely get fired from all the sick days I would need. Prior to having children I was a teacher, and I would never go back to it the way society villainizes teachers for everything, not that my body could even tolerate the schedule and the stress. I cannot understand why they want you to sell your home and your car before you can qualify for SSI disability when you don't have enough work history for SSDI disability, so I don't receive benefits other than Medicaid and have been living solely off my investments which is my "retirement fund" that I started when I was 19. Every month I would contribute whatever I had, even if it was \$50, because I knew someday I wanted to be able to be home with my future children. Just in the short time since the orange monster has been in power. I have lost a scary amount of money and am terrified what I have won't last as long as I need it, thanks to his economic ineptitude. But if I sold my home and car, I would need assistance with housing and transportation. Make that make sense!? Even when it should be a slam dunk, it takes many people years, assistance from lawyers, and multiple attempts to qualify for disability. The system was broken before they came in with their plan to nuke it. I feel fortunate that I started planning for my future at such young age, but once I lose Medicaid, anything I have now will be gone in a very short amount of time, or I will die, which I think is what they want. I am terrified for people who don't have savings or investments, I'm terrified for all those of us who haven't had the energy, resources, or haven't been well enough for the battle to try to qualify for disability, and those of us who don't qualify for either type of disability, and I'm terrified for the elderly and really all of us who rely on this system to help us live. We are not worthless! Every one of us has value! We all have people who love us and rely on us. We are all someone's child and many are someone's parent. Like most people, I have contributed so much to this world, and still do in the ways I'm able to through teaching, my extensive volunteer work, my charitable contributions over the years, and by being a good citizen, friend, mother, daughter, sister, and human. My kids have grown up but are not in a position to help support me in their 20's and I have been single for almost 20 years now. I have no one to help me or take me in or who currently helps to care for me when I'm sick, let alone if I burn through all my savings for my medical care and lose my home, like so many millions of other people. And they don't give a single crap. Every time I see someone saying that we will just be getting what we voted for I want to scream!! I didn't vote for this!!! I actively worked to try to prevent it! It's cruel, immature, and absolutely incorrect to gloat and taunt that people in my shoes deserve it because we voted for it, when we didn't. I really wish people would stop saying that. I hope there is a special corner in hell waiting for every person who helped write this bill and every single one of them who helps to pass this bill for their cruelty and the evil they are intentionally inflicting on people less fortunate than them, apparently just because they can and apparently because they find it fun."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ln1zvj/senator_warren_big_beautiful_score_now_just_shy/n0ebfl4/

"I don't need to read it and I know that. Trump doesn't want to help every day Americans. If he could kick everybody off of every program, he would. Poor people are ick to him. Unless you're obscenely wealthy, you don't count. He doesn't care if you live or die. Our lives changed after we enrolled in ACA. I was skeptical for the first few years and wouldn't even look. My husband has been a small business owner almost just entire adult life and I have been self-employed for 20 years now. We were destitute trying to cover my asthma meds. Two inhalers cost \$1000 per month. I actually had friends that would give them to me, when they could. The ACA gave us the one thing we could not handle on our own, which was health insurance. We could afford paying some, but not all. People don't realize the protections the ACA gives anyone that has any health insurance and the biggest one is insurance companies cannot deny for pre-existing conditions. If the ACA goes under, the protections go with it And they can't get it repealed so they are trying to kill it. I always knew it would be on the chopping block, just a matter of when. He's touched Medicaid, food stamps, this one's a no-brainer. I don't need the money to get my own health insurance. I need the protections we have and some subsidy money, paid to the insurance company He would have some people that would just pocket the money, how are they going to check they actual used it for insurance? How was the not socialism?? Dr. Oz says they have a plan but they don't want to tip their cards. I don't believe it. They're scrambling to put some Quick, not thought out, goofy plan. The cheap ones would all be catastrophic plans. Again, he can't and won't understand because he's never had to worry about a medical bill. If we lose health insurance, we would be homeless, that is how greatly it would affect us. My husband has to have his heart medication. He's not obese, he is extremely active and he eats a big salad with every dinner. It's not anything he did, it's hereditary, from both sides. He would die without his medicine, and there is no way we can afford it on our own. But I would sell everything I own to keep him alive as long as I could. Every time he has chest pains, he has to go to the hospital. Because we can't take a chance. He had a triple bypass at age 52 but I know he has been in the hospital at least three times this year, he is always admitted. It's so great to have to worry about this shit on top of everything else in life. I have never hated anyone like I hate this man. I do, I explicitly, completely hate him. Because the cruelty is the point, it's punishment for not being obscenely wealthy"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1our4kv/obamacare_could_collapse_under_trumps_new_plan/noeif0f/

"Regarding the cliff: my husband and I are old genx'ers and are basically retired due to medical reasons. We live in a HCOL area. If we go ONE DOLLAR over \$84,600, our annual ACA premium will jump from approximately \$16,500 to just shy of \$34,000. IN WHAT UNIVERSE IS THAT FAIR OR LOGICAL? He just had a hip replacement that went wrong (thanks, doc), and his hospital bills are over \$200,000 and climbing. And he has to have his other hip replaced in 3 weeks! He's only 57, thin, in great shape, but had a bad luck of the draw. The worst part is that this is the "easy" stuff with our medical issues. The point is, how the hell can we have a 2-person MAGI of \$84.6k, ACA premiums of \$16.5k, max OOP of \$17k (which we have burned through), property taxes of \$15k, and not even get into the daily expenses of living? We thought we had *hopefully* saved enough for a very, very modest retirement, but since it's all in a pre-tax SEP-IRA, every withdrawal counts against our MAGI. With the dismal way things are looking, we're renovating our home now so we can sell it, cash out on the equity to have for our healthcare, and move to another state with a lower COL. That's effed up, but it's how scared we are for our future because of our upcoming medical needs. God, just re-reading everything I wrote makes me burst into tears again for the 1000th time. Maybe we should use his Canadian citizenship and head north... Sorry for the emotional post. It's been a really tough year. Hopefully someone can relate."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vgga4i/senate_dems_post_memo_on_reforms_to_make_health/p1y9oaf/

"Before the ACA once I had medical coverage, I had to be vigilant about making sure I kept it no matter what the price and kept documentation proving prior coverage whenever I changed jobs or I would be permanently screwed for having been in a car accident when I was 19. People really don't understand what they're playing with when they question the need for universal healthcare."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lz67ob/reminder_what_life_was_like_before_affordable/n33exqm/

"Unfortunately not true in my case. I was left without confirmation of coverage for 10 days till my new insurance started. I could have taken a risk and gotten care at that time but I have no way of knowing if they would have reinstated my coverage. As of now I still haven't been contacted by the case manager. So no, they couldn't fix this and I spent those 10 days in fear of needing medical attention."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1st004d/aca_canceled_my_policy_without_my_permission_and/ok97i9z/

"Dude I am way ahead of you I have medicaid Medicare I don't pay a dime for it I also receive government subsidies on the side plus I work cash jobs here and there so everything for me is basically for free health care wise never paid a medical bill in my life never paid any deductible I have no debt I pay all my bills in full every month I have a stress-free life I take 4 mile walk a day it's great to live on Easy Street I can't handle stress last time I had stress I freaked out let's not go there it's all good for others like myself dude you just got to know how to work the system and you can get your free healthcare medicaid Medicare it probably depends what state you live in some states are easier to get it than others my state is not bad at all yes I live in a blue state what I did work I always demanded Healthcare most of the time I got it but all the places that I did work that we're good to work for all went under or they work take over by other companies then I left the good old days of working are over basically you have to do what I do to make it in the world today unless you have a really good education other than that just do the same that I did if you can I'm sure you probably could you just have to fight it's not going to be for free you have to fight for what you want in life you can't just sit on your hands and expect it to come to you it doesn't work that way I had to fight fight fight to get where I am I was declined so many times I got sick of seeing the word declined I was actually getting nauseous when I saw the word decline I kept fighting and I would not take no for an answer finally that faithful letter came through your approved 😊 it took years for me to get approved just saying 😊 "

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgydIdE-r4f0nSNoPKB4AaABAg.APW5Z9zkse2APWHQ3G7a2Y>

"I live in the States I just wanna medicaid Medicare I don't pay a penny for health insurance I never paid a co-pay in my life or a medical bill ever I am a Canadian Living in a blue state sign out I was born in Montreal it's good for me here in the states because everything here is for free for me I also get benefits of the government which is really really good the government bought me my own home in a good safe neighborhood I have a bank account full of money I have no financial difficulties at all I basically live a stress-free life I take 4 mile walk today it's great to live a stress-free life it's great to have all the money you need to pay all your bills it's great to be able to pay all your bills in full every month 😊 🇨🇦 🇺🇸 😊 I have no debt just saying 😊 "

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=Ugwfh6AeZ_lpN82kvMB4AaABAg.APWCTUwAiJEAPWGm1NV98t

Leaving a job or retiring before 65 · 9 documents · 9 voices

"I quit a 20 year career at 50 🥲 with terrific health insurance in order to become self employed. I'm in CA and was able to get Covered CA (ACA) at first which was wonderful. Nowadays at 56 I make too much to qualify. And I have a 15 year old son at home. I get Blue Shield Gold PPO which is \$1500 a month for the two of us. 🥲 But no deductible. This was good news considering I ended up with cancer + brain surgery in the last 3 years! I pay a lot for medical insurance but it gives me peace of mind."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgwwS68tKfQws0fQ-V4AaABAg

↳ @PatricLubomir-r2w (1): "Wow, you've been through so much. ❤️ Leaving a 20-year career to build your own business was a brave decision, and then facing cancer and brain surgery on top of that must have been incredibly challenging. I'm so glad you had solid coverage when you needed it most. Even though \$1,500 a month is a huge expense, I can completely understand why the peace of mind is worth it after everything you've experienced. How are you doing these days? I hope you're feeling much stronger now. And how has being self-employed been for you overall—despite the healthcare costs, has it been everything you hoped it would be?"

↳ @scottunclocked (0): "Thank you for your comments. Great example of the reason why you need good health insurance! You just never know when something major is going to hit you and it isn't worth the risk of ruining your whole retirement because of a massive health care bill. I pray you are doing better after surgery and are recovering!"

↳ @Dravlae (0): "Hope you recover well."

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— r/HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tm0cfj/>

↳ (0): "What state are you in? If you live in a state with Medicaid expansion and you truly have zero reportable income, your options are to apply for / receive Medicaid, or don't use Medicaid and instead pay full price for a policy through healthcare.gov."

↳ (0): "Don't only live on cash. Use that time of low income to do some Roth conversions up to the magi limit if you intend on qualifying for Medicaid or higher for ACA with subsidies."

↳ (0): "The assets usually don't matter for medicaid eligibility in most states - they mainly look at monthly income flow. Since you're planning zero income those years you'd probably qualify regardless of your house value and retirement accounts. You can still buy private insurance through the marketplace even with zero income but you'd be paying full price without subsidies. Might be worth running numbers on both options since private plans could give you more provider choices but medicaid is obviously much cheaper. One thing to consider is maybe taking small distributions from retirement accounts or doing some part time work just to stay above medicaid threshold if you prefer private insurance. Even like 20k annual income would open up the subsidized marketplace plans"

"Cancelled my ACA plan a couple months back. I made too much for the subsidy. My kids are covered under their mom's (my ex) insurance. My bronze plan had a 9k deductible. I'm paying cash moving toward for medical. If I go into a coma.. I don't own a home, my car is worth \$2,500. And they can't touch my retirement, so most of my risk is mitigated. (Under federal law up to \$1,512,350 in IRAs is protected from creditors in bankruptcy)"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America I People Are Canceling Coverage · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgwgRjNmbi3gTenofwB4AaABAg>

"Needing advice on what to do due to disabled household (looking for Marketplace insurance) Hello there. I'm recently officially (not state wide, though I'm starting the application process soon) disabled per my doctors and unable to return to work. I live with my parents and my aunt, all who are also disabled, although my Dad also works a low paying job to provide additional income. My aunt has never worked but pays us rent and has her own bills to pay on. Basically I am concerned about applying for marketplace insurance (Cobra, just for myself is going to be over 700\$ through my previous workplace, which I nor my family can afford monthly). I will solely be relying on my parents' income which I feel terrible about. Obviously as I am chronically ill I can't go without insurance or my medicine. I am worried that with including the entire household yearly income even though most of that money cannot help towards my insurance, that it will raise the price for me. This is all very new, scary and foreign to me. What are the options and how does this usually work through Marketplace? I'm 28 in TN. I'll be honest I'm not entirely sure what the household income is but I can say at least it is over 30k. *Maybe* nearing 45k annually. Not currently receiving disability but am about to start the application process, probably not eligible for Medicaid until then? But my family members are on Medicaid. Sorry and thank you in advance."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pvw5jg/>

↳ (0): "You have a lot of moving parts here. How old are you? State of residence? Total household income? Are you claimed as a dependent? Do you receive disability? Are you Medicaid eligible? Are your other family members on Medicaid? Impossible to give you advice without more information."

↳ (0): "Apologies. I've been a bit scatterbrained with tons of worry/stress and have memory issues. I'm 28 in TN not claimed as a dependent. I'll be honest I'm not entirely sure what the household income is but I can say at least it is over 30k. *Maybe* nearing 45k annually. Not currently receiving disability but am about to start the application process, probably not eligible for Medicaid until then? But my family members are on Medicaid."

↳ (0): "When the aca marketplace asks your household income, they are asking about your TAX household- who you file taxes with. Not just who you happen to live with. So, if your parents are not claiming you on their taxes, its just yourself. Tennessee is one of 10 states that did not expand medicaid to include eligibility due to low/no income- so youre going to need a state disability approval to get original medicaid. (This is what your family members have). The problem you face now is you have no income/low income and unless you'll make at least 15,650 as your modified adjusted gross income (MAGI) you dont qualify for any aca subsidies either. Youd have to pay full price for an ACA marketplace plan. Head over the healthcare.gov and fill out an application to see what is available to you- compare those plans and pricing to what your cobra would cost you. Its a shame there are still 10 states holding out on expanded medicaid, it really leaves many people in a bind- not making enough for a subsidy but not having expanded medicaid as an option either. If you were in an expanded medicaid state, simply making less than that 15k would be enough for medicaid to be approved (there are a few states with a work requirement but most just grant it based on income)."

"Great job on this video. I especially like your editing with the graphics and pop ups I am now in year three of early retirement. Year one we used COBRA. Last year we were on the ACA with a Gold plan. This year we have a Bronze PPO plan. I went with bronze because of the HSA option as we are contributing to it and then paying our out of pocket from the HSA. It is an amazing deal to get the MAGI reduction thanks to the HSA contribution. I have a serious health condition that was discovered after early retirement and the ACA medical, while expensive for our needs, has been great thanks to many of the coverage reasons you mentioned. I did use lever 9 last year and the result was a lower premium the last few months of the year The ACA is in question now and much is up in the air as far as the future. I worry about what will change but would not let what ifs keep you from retiring early. Great video"

— YouTube · ACA Premium Shock? Pay Less All Year · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8zEUYMnF5vI&lc=UgytPVqZ_L-aTafnV2F4AaABAg

↳ @davidnprogress (1): "@EarlyRetirementRoadmap I understand the work that goes into these videos for sure. I know I spend way too much time on mine and they are not near as professional as yours. Keep up the good work."

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Thank you so much David for such a thoughtful comment and for watching! I also really appreciate you noticing the editing and graphics. That's all me, so your compliment means a lot, because it definitely takes a minute to do all the editing 🥹. I use the full-screen graphics to help explain the more complicated stuff especially, and the pop-ups are my way of adding a little lightness along the way. Also, your experience is incredibly valuable to share — the COBRA → ACA Gold → ACA Bronze PPO choice and using the HSA. You nailed it: if you're eligible, HSA contributions are a powerful lever because they can lower MAGI while building a medical "war chest." I'm also really sorry to hear about the health condition you discovered after retiring — but I'm glad ACA coverage has been serving you well. That's exactly why those protections (pre-existing conditions, essential benefits, etc.) matter so much. And great job using Lever #9 — updating the Marketplace estimate during the year can absolutely reduce premiums when your situation changes. I'm with you on the uncertainty too... lots is up in the air, but I agree: don't let "what ifs" be the only thing that prevents an early retirement if the rest of the plan is sound. As an early retiree too, I highly recommend it and am certainly enjoying being able to spend my time the way I want to. I highly recommend as I'm sure you do too! ;) My best to you in 2026 and hopes for your health to continually improve!"

"What if your 59 and healthy but can't find a good enough job, my cobra ends in 2 weeks. I had quit my job last yr to take care of a sick parent that I live with. I've spent \$18k out of my savings for cobra. Only used it for medication. Since I have no income it comes to a complete halt, every person is stumped. I'm a healthy female."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Quit Your Job! · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=edOr4XtsotU&lc=Ugy5AZqSma6QyWhOQgV4AaABAg>

"Excellent video - thank you! Retired 9 years ago at 52. Wife and I been with the ACA for the last 8. The ACA has become cost prohibitive since the Gov failed to renew the enhanced Biden era subsidies. Wife and I can't get our MAGI below \$84K/yr so no subsidies offered now in TX. Currently have worst Bronze plan offered (\$7500 deductible) for \$1,837/month (our biggest monthly expense). Year before same plan was \$1K so 80% increase YOY. Had cataract surgery this year with \$3,300 out of pocket. ACA plan paid nothing. I'm done with it. Heading towards the same type of "catastrophic" plan you chose. At this point, we're simply insuring our net worth with a "max out of pocket" provision. Even if Dems take both houses this year there won't be enough time to raise ACA subsidies for 2027 before enrollment ends. Maybe look again in 2028. After 9 years of early retirement, I can easily say healthcare has been the most stressful part by far. Not a fan of how our Gov has handled healthcare options for its citizens. Hanging in there until 65."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgweZKcUb4nd3RSWpBx4AaABAg

↳ @scottunclocked (0): "Thank you for the compliment and thank you for sharing. We are in a similar spot, really just focused on managing the risk of a very expensive medical event. I am not sure if TX has a Farm Bureau, but if they do, at least check to see what they offer and the costs. Healthcare is an expense that I am foreseeing being challenging every year, especially with the uncertainty of how it could change in the future. Good luck in your search for healthcare."

"I retired at 55 last year, and health insurance was honestly my biggest concern. This video explains the options in a way that's easy to understand. Definitely gave me a few things to think about."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgxHZOeZ8_YuAhwpfH94AaABAg

↳ @scottunclocked (0): "Thanks for the compliment and thanks for sharing. The good news is that there are options, maybe not the best for everyone, but there are and everything doesn't cost \$2000/mth. We were in the same boat. Healthcare is a challenge to understand and a puzzle to solve. Being retired for 1 year, and retired at 55, are you utilizing the Rule of 55? Also, do you have any tips for a newbie at retirement?"

"Would love to know if I can work until 67 and get health insurance through Medicare? I do not want to retire at 65 or collect SS yet. But I need health insurance. My employer does not provide it. I had health insurance through my wife who will be leaving that employer."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgwRcWiphCsy_rCUvVN4AaABAg

↳ @Teffi_Club (1): "Yes, you can keep working and be on Medicare."

Losing coverage or the subsidy · 6 documents · 6 voices

"I'm terrified of losing my Obamacare I'm a one issue voter. I want to keep my Obamacare. Having this allowed me and my husband to quit our terrible soul sucking jobs and start small businesses. It's not perfect and it costs a lot but it's been a life saver. Literally. Now that you know what happened, will I have to get another horrible job that destroys my will to live just to have health insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,425 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1gkt285/>

↳ (0): "Same boat here. We run a small business that employs four people, my husband is a working owner, I do the books. I also do freelance bookkeeping part time for two other businesses. I left a high stress job on the doctor's recommendation. It had no benefits anyway. We are in a tiny town, not many jobs here, much less with benefits. Plus I'm 60 years old with a chronic health condition. Husband has rheumatoid arthritis. Without our ACA plan we are done. Premium would be \$3074 a month non subsidised price. I could foresee us closing the business and putting people out of work so my husband can seek a job with benefits. I'm sorry this is not the way America is supposed to work."

↳ (0): "I would say that anyone who has signed up for a 2025 plan is probably grandfathered in simply because it is ingrained in the health care system so much at this point. By the time Trump is taking office, people's new plans for the year will have already started and even they know the chaos it would cause to try to cancel things immediately. So I'm guessing that for the 2025 year anything that anyone gets for pretty much stay as is. After that however well, we know what they want to do. Speaker Johnson has said as well as several Republican senators that their main goal or at least one of their main goals is to get rid of the ACA. In the past when they tried it, ultimately the supreme Court stopped them telling them they didn't have the authority to do it. The only thing the supreme Court in the past sided with them on was repealing the mandate that required everyone to get a plan to help pay for the system. Everything else they left intact. Since that time however, Trump has put four of his own people in the supreme Court. So I can't imagine they would not side with him now when they approach them about this. The fact that Republicans gained two seats in the Senate and now will have control of the Senate only heightens the possibility that this is going to happen. So again, I think 2025 might be pretty much as is, but after that I would expect sweeping negative changes to health care in this country. No more ACA. A great reduction in the number of people they allow to qualify for Medicaid, etc. The unfortunate thing is even after 4 years and he's gone, he will have put so many people in high position places, this stuff will go on for decades after he's gone. Welcome to the new America folks."

↳ (0): "I'm extremely worried about this because I will lose access to mental health medications that keep me alive and sane. Please, if anyone has any advice or insight on how to keep access to the mental health medications i desperately need please let me know. I am terrified this is going to actually kill me."

"I what to cancel our marketplace insurance and go without for a while, this guessing your income, has been causing me so much anxiety and sleepless nights. This Marketplace insurance with advanced tax premiums is complicated and can leave you having to pay a lot of \$\$\$ back if you happen to do better than expected, I can't live this way !!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugzf4eVxNzdrhPZ2DZB4AaABAq

↳ @Slm-mb7cq (1): "What did you end up doing? or did you find something better? I'm currently looking ugh"

↳ @splooshkaboom4210 (1): "Have you ever considered medically underwritten insurance?"

↳ @iHealthBrokers (0): "Having to estimate your income can certainly be a little daunting. Have you considered speaking with an accountant? They may be able to provide you with some assurances. Best of luck!"

"Going into my fourth month without a job. I need to cancel my plan if i reach 6 months of no work right? i lost my job in December and thought id find a job by february but rhings fell through. its been really difficult finding a new job and i feel hopeless I'll find one soon. im scared I'll have to pay back if i exceed 6 months without a job so its recommended i cancel then right? then if i find a job I'll have to wait until enrollment but better than paying this shit back without having \$\$"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/

↳ SeaweedWeird7705 (10): "If I were you, I would keep my Obamacare since it's the only way for you to get insurance. If you end up below 100% of the FPL for the year, they typically don't ask you to repay (since you were too LOW). (If you were too high, they would insist on repayment)."

↳ SeaweedWeird7705 (8): "There is no rule that you have to cancel your Obamacare if you lose your job. What is your total income for the year 2026? Is it zero? If your total income for the year is zero, you should consider applying for Medicaid."

↳ PeacefulCW (8): "Everything you said was correct until the paragraph that started with “ you never should’ve had it to begin with...”. That is absolutely incorrect. Marketplace insurance is based on one’s ESTIMATE of their annual income, not necessarily their current income. It’s absolutely OK for our OP to have marketplace insurance."

"I retired early and spouse is self-employed. We've been on the ACA for past 8 years. It became a financial nightmare when the ACA enhanced subsidies expired last year. We now pay \$22K/yr for the worst Bronze policy on the TX. ACA menu with a \$7,500 deductible because we dare to have a joint MAGI over \$85K/yr. Not ready to use retirement funds at 61. Will seek a non-ACA "catastrophic" low-cost plan for 2027 with a set "max out of pocket" limit to cover our net worth - not our health. Crap ACA plan already set to increase another 15%+ next year. Without subsidies, the ACA no longer makes financial sense for us. Amazing how the Gov keeps finding Billions to bomb other countries but not for healthcare. That's where they draw the line!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65: The ACA Reality Nobody Tells You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Qz8CyPjA5s&lc=UgzYaD8vIzCNnQm95FI4AaABAg>

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (3): "Congrats on your early retirement. Thanks for sharing your pain with the ACA and the fact that the government is spending on War but not on making American's lives better. Best wishes to you. New ACA video coming on Sunday."

↳ @bugsy2902 (2): "The problem is you get a plan off the ACA they can hold pre-existing against you and they might just deny any claims you have. There are plenty of nightmare stories about them not paying out. My friend went with a private plan and they wouldn't pay her ER visit and that was just \$3K but it can be much worse."

↳ @billymacktexasdetective5827 (1): "The government has NO BUSINESS being in healthcare. Stealing money from one group of people to give to leeches such as yourself is disgusting. How do you sleep at night knowing you want stolen money for yourself?"

"Accidentally clicked "Report a Life Change" and had to go through whole application it seems. Did this mess anything up? Was on Healthcare Marketplace website logged in trying to look at some contact information to make sure it was right and accidentally clicked into the "Report a Life Change". It then made our 2026 application status go from "COMPELTE" to "IN PROGRESS". It basically had us go through the *entire* application again which gave the same determination as we got last year during PY2026 open enrollment (same premium tax credit amount). **I'm just worried and wanted to make sure I didn't mess any coverage up. Is it normal for the system to make you go through *everything* again? We are NOT making any changes to plan (not that we are eligible anyways since we are not in special enrollment period). Do I need to contact the health/dental plan to make sure they received the "updated" application? Just scared to potentially lose coverage. Thank you.**"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sfdqq9/accidentally_clicked_report_a_life_change_and_had/

↳ Salty-Passenger-4801 (1): "No, you are good to go"

↳ ushealthbrokers (1): "If you entered nothing differently you should be fine. Sometimes this will still trigger a request for documents again, like income or non ESI, at least in my state."

↳ NorCal-Dig-15 (1): "Normal! You are okay"

"What if I lost my coverage because my husband is going on disability, do I need get cover for him or just myself?"

— YouTube · Enrolling in Obamacare | 3 Mistakes to Avoid · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZBc-IntJRAU&lc=Ugxc31D8M1KYJ2pKjd4AaABAg>

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

A premium they can pay · 36 documents · 20 voices

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hmjm0o/>

↳ (0): "You know, \$240 for insurance you can actually use? Isn't bad at all. The new Medicare premium for 2025 is \$185. And that? Is for insurance that's about as useful as tits on a nun, and doesn't include vision or dental coverage. Secondly, the Marketplace is open for enrollment until January 15th: https://www.healthcare.gov/subscriber/?gad_source=1&gclid=CjwKCAiAmrS7BhBJEiwAei59i9Oacg0wxG2w-ZA-CIWv7rQmP1f88oKN4m5i8AvwQGxt-DXXSOE0lhoCgioQAvD_BwE&gclsrc=aw.ds You are still eligible for Marketplace coverage and subsidies if: 1. Your employer-offered insurance is more than 9.12% of your annual income, or the lowest-cost option to cover your family is 9.12% of your household's total income. 2. Your employer-offered insurance doesn't meet ACA standards (which is defined generally as those that offer coverage for doctors and hospitals, and generally pay for 60% of medical costs). If you don't qualify for Medicaid? It's because your income is too high to do so. I don't know what to tell you. It sounds like you rolled the dice, took a chance, and lost."

↳ (0): "13 years working in the world of the Affordable Care Act 8 Years of Provider Services dealing with Medical Professionals 7 Years of Customer Service dealing with individuals' questions on claims and benefits 5 years of Medical Claim Processing So what state do you live in? Does your state have a State-Run Health Insurance Marketplace? My state is still in OPEN ENROLLMENT to enroll in a Health Insurance Plan for 2025 with an effective date of February 1, 2025. The deadline for a January 1 Effective date has passed; the deadline line is midnight December 15, 2024. I am not able to use the tools I have to determine if you are eligible for Tax Subsidies to enroll in a healthcare plan with financial assistance. Your age, yearly income, or Adjusted Gross Income, the tax structure of your household, married, children, filing single, etc, are needed to determine this. Secondly, your Employer offers you a health insurance plan (ESI). Most ESI plans meet the Qualified Health Insurance standard (QHP), as set forth by the Affordable Care Act (ACA). There are two things that a QHP must meet A: They must meet "MINIMUM ESSENTIAL VALUE" - which means a healthcare plan must pay at least 60% of all claims AFTER the deductible is met B: They must meet MINIMUM ESSENTIAL COVERAGE" - meaning they MUST cover the 10 essential health care benefits as outlined in the ACA Law they are, Routine Yearly Physical Walk-In Clinic Services Emergency Room Services Laboratory Services - testing blood, Urine Testing, Biopsy services Pharmacy Mental Health Services both in-patient and out-patient Ambulance Services Prenatal Services (I don't remember them all but these are the most important) Without knowing what your employer plan looks like meaning What does it cost per pay period and what would you pay per pay period What is the Deductible on that plan and what is the Max Out of Pocket Expense on that plan ... is the ESI going to cost you more than 9.07% of your income? ...is the ESI plan just an HSA plan? I like BIG HUGE examples to make a point. Let us assume that your ESI plan reads something like this Yearly Deductible: 10,000 Yearly Max Out of Pocket Expense: \$15,000... You get injured, you get transported by ambulance, to the ER

then to Surgery, then to a recovery room, then 5 nights in a hospital with physical therapy, medications, etc...and the total amount owed to the hospital and providers on the day of discharge is \$2 Million. If you were enrolled in the ESI plan, the MOST you pay is \$15,000. Everything else is covered at 100%, you are only responsible for \$15,000. - if the same thing happened again just 4 months later or 2 months later, the total expense you would need to pay is \$0. More information is needed to guide you."

↳ (0): "Non of OPs post makes any sense. They are fishing for upvotes."

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

↳ (0): "Two reasons you might not be seeing subsidies on ACA plans: * your annual income is too low, or you entered it incorrectly. Your annual income must be over the poverty line to be eligible for subsidies * you answered the questions about employer coverage incorrectly, and you're not seeing subsidies because the application believes you have affordable employer coverage available"

↳ (0): "Can you expand on the international bit? That might change things quite a bit"

↳ (0): "The baby will be born there, but it will be a US citizen after some paperwork. My partner and I are both US citizens."

"Senator King continued: "I don't understand the obsession and I never have...with taking health insurance away from people. I don't get it. Trying to take away the Affordable Care Act in 2017 or 2018 and now this. What's driving this? What's the cruelty to do this, to take health insurance away from people knowing that it's going to cost them...up to and including...their lives.""

— r/obamacare · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0y85an/

"Bronze HSA vs other plans, what am I missing? I'm looking at the plans available for my wife and I for a potential early retirement, the options don't really make sense to me. Comparing the Bronze HSA plan to the Silver, Gold and Platinum plans it seems that the Bronze HSA plan premium plus the out of pocket maximum is cheaper, or similar to just the premium of the gold and platinum plans? Why would anyone opt for those plans when they could be at the OOP maximum on the Bronze for less money? Even looking at the Silver plans the premium plus the deductible is similar / less than the Bronze HSA OOP maximum. And the fact that the Bronze HSA plan qualifies you for an HSA is just gravy. You can cover most of your medical expenses tax free. So why do the gold and platinum tiers exist? This is for two people near 60 in California under 400% FPL. Maybe the numbers don't look so weird for people in other circumstances?"

— r/obamacare · 21 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pzpu11/>

↳ (0): ">So why do the gold and platinum tiers exist? Risk tolerance. If you're a healthy active 19-yr-old that is unlikely to get ill and rarely need any healthcare (except for those "hey y'all watch this" moments) then you'll save a ton of money with cheap Bronze plan premiums. For that person it's an easy answer. If your health is "meh" and you're not sure how the year is gonna go, do you take a risk with a Bronze or do you go for, say, a Silver and hope that things go your way? Probably the Silver. But if your health is total crap and you 100% know you're gonna be bouncing off of the deductible and max OOP, then yeah you shoot for Gold or Platinum and get that initial OOP cost out of the way (and then save money after that with the difference between that a Bronze). For that person, too, it's an easy answer. I think your math is assuming that in all cases everyone will hit their deductible and/or max OOP, regardless of plan selected (e.g., "what is my maximum financial exposure"). That is just not the case. We're all different. So it comes down to, "do I feel lucky?" "Well, do ya, punk?"

↳ (0): "I had the option of getting a Bronze plan for 2 for \$17000 per year or a gold plan for \$32000 per year. The deductibles are \$6100 and \$1000. The max OOP for the bronze is \$7750. The max OOP for the gold is \$8500. So, with the bronze plan I pay \$17000 + \$7750 if the sh&t hits the fan and I max out on health needs. Total: \$24750. With the gold plan I pay \$32000 + \$8500 if the sh&t hits the fan. Total: \$40500. So, I'm better off with the bronze plan no matter how you slice it. We have to pay more until we hit our deductible but after that, it's pretty much the same. In the end, it's cheaper to have the bronze plan whether I use health insurance a lot or a little. YMMV"

↳ (0): "On the ACA you can plug in light use, medium use, heavy use and the Bronze plan wins every single time except if I have utter catastrophic issue and then I would pay \$900 more if I choose Bronze over Silver. However that doesn't factor in the money I save by funding the HSA, when you add that it wipes out the difference and HSA wins every situation. Premiums+CoPays makes the other plans much more expensive. Plus when you see the actual price people tend to look for cheaper options if possible."

"I am with you. Cancelled my ACA plan. Went from \$750 to \$2150 a month for my wife and I, and that is from a Gold plan to a crappy bronze plan with \$10K deductible. They can bite me."

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qil7n2/my_premium_went_from_200_to_1500_and_now/o0sa18a/

"It's a Catch-22. I need medical care to stay alive, but I need a W-2 job for high quality affordable medical care, but the job's killing me. I'm in my 40's, and I could afford to retire now if not for the health insurance issue. An ACA family plan is ridiculously expensive and all but the platinum plans are dog 🐕 (high premiums, very high deductibles, very high max OOP, and limited networks that don't cover the halfway decent docs and hospitals in my area). And the platinums are INSANELY expensive and still don't cover many of my needed specialists. And I can't build my HSA as I max out contributions and spending every year. I think my only hope is to try to find a super easy job (even if super low paying) with good benefits and see if I can survive another 7 years until our kids are all off the plan and my husband (self-employed) qualifies for Medicare. Or 5 years if I pay for COBRA for the last 2 years..."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wIGOZsc&lc=Ugwc78xLI9vl1PhI6QR4AaABAq>

"I really cannot fathom this mindset... The premium tax credit forms are *confusing*, so shit, I guess my only options are to go without healthcare that I need or to pay premiums that I absolutely can't afford! What should I do??? Like bro you should figure it the fuck out and get the tax credit. This system was designed for every idiot in America, I'm sure you can manage it if you put your mind to it. Go ask Claude for help if you need to."

— r/HealthInsurance · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wenhgc/just_got_booted_from_my_insurance/p9fj2j4/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/>

↳ (0): "Brokers don't get paid from client. The insurance carriers pay the broker. ACA plans prices go by your income. Prices are ridiculous high."

↳ (0): "That's what I thought too, but I couldn't account for the discrepancy in prices between the brokers prices and healthcare.gov prices. Because one plan was \$30 higher but the more expensive plan was \$50 less from the broker. So I was trying to figure out why that was."

↳ (0): "We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

"I completely disagree on ACA being the #1 best option. If you have no pre-existing conditions, your best option is the private insurance market. ACA would have cost me [alone] over \$2,000 per month for a high deductible plan (my income necessary to make ends meet exceeds eligibility for any ACA subsidy). COBRA was going to cost me over \$1,500 per month and would only last for 18 months (I need 21 months to make it to Medicare age). Solution? I found health insurance in the private marketplace for...now get this...\$750 per month. Even better? My maintenance prescriptions have a \$0 copay and my office visit copay is less than when I was working! I'm laughing all the way to the bank now!"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=Ugz_xhwD-Z5OHxsgwqB4AaABAq

↳ @betoxyz68 (1): "You are absolutely correct! There are excellent private insurance options available in most states with very competitive rates similar to yours. Great job on doing your due diligence and exploring all the options that fit your specific circumstances. It's always smart to look at the full picture before deciding."

↳ @detroitgator1 (1): "Please share how you figured this out. I need to go about 5 years on private insurance"

↳ @betoxyz68 (1): "@detroitgator1im a health insurance agent and licensed in multiple states."

"We only had one psychiatrist in our town. And he literally disappeared overnight and I'm not exaggerating. I played hell finding another psychiatrist. We had no other ones in our area. And this was before telehealth became really popular, so that wasn't a route I could go I ended up signing up for a plan with a local nurse practitioner. Now my insurance doesn't cover this, but it's only \$25 a month and she just writes the prescription that I need a psychiatrist for. I am not driving an hour away until Health is hit or miss. Sometimes the pharmacy won't cover telehealth because they aren't local doctors. The NP route are becoming more and more popular. I still have health insurance, but I go to her for the little things. I don't have to wait four days to get in or two weeks, she answers immediately. She helped me a bunch of times. I fell off my bike and cut my leg open and it got infected. I called my doctors for my insurance, they called back 10 days later. I had already called the NP that I pay \$25 a month for and she had an antibiotic and some cream at the pharmacy within 10 minutes of me texting her, I included pictures. So you may want to look in your area and see if any NP's are doing this. My friend that's an NP, she has different levels or different packages I guess and the cheapest one is \$25, which is the one I have and I can text her or call her anytime The plans go all the way up till like \$400 a month and that gets you in person home visits anytime you want them. These are becoming very popular. I call it concierge NP's because that's kind of what it is. We have two around here and I know both of them. I use the one that I do because I'm also her dog sitter. She just wanted me to prove that I had been on this medication for at least two years and she looked through my pharmacy records and seen that I was. Then she had no problems prescribing it. Then this advice is for everyone out there. Even if you have health insurance and it may be a shitty plan, these are popping up all over. She can write lab orders, imaging orders, she can write anything a doctor does. I don't know if my insurance would cover it, but I do know they cover the prescriptions that she writes. I do all my imaging and lab works through my insurance because I'm going to guess it wouldn't cover it because she's not in network. But signing up for something like this gives you a back up and it's coming very handy for me and it's very affordable at \$25 a month. That's cheaper than going to an urgent care."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omuregf/

"I make \$400 over the limit for free health insurance I have 2 kids a fiancé we live on our own with a car payment and car insurance we're already stretched thin. We went to the hospital for a simple iv because we had a stomach bug and couldn't stop puking so we were extremely dehydrated to the point where we were confused and dizzy. I got a \$2000 hospital bill for a SIMPLE IV that i was only hooked up to for an hour and then we left. The cheapest plan I found had a \$8400 deductible which I absolutely cannot afford. I was just trying to get insurance to pay for my \$2000 iv but in my case the monthly payment for the 2k hospital bill would cost me less than having to pay for the cheapest insurance i could find."

— YouTube · How to Buy Health Insurance on HealthCare.gov (or your State's Marketplace) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fND9DallI2Y&lc=Ugw8cl6lZWVLHEtzpfF4AaABAg>

↳ @SelfEmploymentSidekick (2): "Ugh. I really hate how this works. I remember finding a \$200 line item on a doctor's bill for "Ear wax extraction" because the pediatrician used a cotton swab in my kid's ear real quick during his regular check up. And then there are cases like yours where it would be cheaper to just pay the ridiculous bill rather than pay a ridiculous premium and STILL have to pay the ridiculous bill. Unfortunately, I don't know the best solution for this. I'm just doing my best to help people understand the different options that are available. But I realize the available options aren't good enough."

↳ @pinkorganichorse (0): "When you get free Healthcare, my young son and I can't get any because our premium is too high directly because we are supplementing your subsidy."

"Fuck, could we AT LEAST address the subsidy cliff? How about raise the cost 5% for every 10% above 400% of the FPL? Going from \$40.73/mo to \$1148.20/mo one dollar over the cut-off in my situation for the second cheapest bronze plan is such shit, and is breaking people, many who say fuck it I need to eat and pay rent."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p2rt3s/conservatives_want_to_regulate_the_aca_in/nq15gmf/

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

↳ fizzy-logic (19): "There's way too much going on in that post for me to break it down for you, and way too much both of you haven't made sure to understand about how it all works. There's just too much to walk you through. I normally think it's best to investigate how things work and take care of insurance yourself, as brokers can sometimes steer people wrong, but in your case you may need an insurance broker. BUT also you need to read up on how this shit works, desperately. The fact you said you didn't pay premiums, but you also didn't use it, implies you think that somehow you only pay for insurance if you actually need to use it. I'm not trying to be mean at all, but that lack of the most basic understanding of how insurance works is going to hurt you, your health, your family and your wallet. It's time to learn this stuff, and it won't be something you can read one article in one day and be done. You need to put time into it. But I will add that if someone is offered insurance through work, they are not eligible for any ACA subsidies unless that plan is expensive enough to be deemed unaffordable by ACA standards. You'd have to look up how to determine if the cost was high enough to let you get ACA subsidies, and I honestly don't know that you're gonna do that on your own. Get a broker for all of this mess, or better yet, an organization that helps people file as sort of a charitable work, I think there are some groups that do that. You can look at the ACA website for a list of facilitators in your area, they are free to you. The reason I'd look for someone like that rather than a broker, if possible, is since a broker isn't going to get commission if you are taking a work plan versus an ACA plan, you'll have to get lucky and hope someone gives you good advice even if it turns out they won't be getting a commission (if it turns out you and your wife are better going with her work plan). And there are absolutely brokers who would help even if they need to advise you to take the work plan instead, but there are also ones who convince people to take bad plans and/or fail to explain how it works properly. You can get badly burned financially if you take an ACA plan, didn't understand how it worked, and end up owing back thousands. Same can be said if you get sold a junk, non-ACA insurance plan that doesn't really cover anything when you need it. Added: If your wife is on an ACA plan when she actually has the option to get insurance from work, btw, and that insurance doesn't meet the standard to let her still get ACA credits, she can end up owing back the full amount of credits. This all gets reconciled at tax time - so the credits you get in 2026 are reconciled when you file your 2026 taxes in April of 2027. She would owe back whatever the full monthly premiums were without credits if it turns out she wasn't eligible to have them."

↳ LacyLove (18): "1 She cannot continue to get subsidies if her plan is affordable. 2 yes 3 yes 4 yes 5 no and it begins in November for coverage beginning in 2027. 6 That depends solely on the plans. 7 yes 8. She needs to enroll in her work plan ASAP. Then cancel her marketplace plan. You are 33 years old, it is time you learn about this stuff. You literally have the world's answers at your fingertips. Use them."

↳ Jcarlough (9): "Great questions! It's unfortunate that at 33 years-old you still are inexperienced at a key

component of “adulthood” but kudos for recognizing this and wanting to learn. I *am* curious on your health insurance situation for the past seven years no plan is going to allow a dependent stay enrolled once you hit 26 UNLESS you met the disabled dependent definition. Were you out of the US this whole time? Regardless, to answer your questions. 1. Yes. Your wife’s employer offering affordable health insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage (most do) WILL disqualify her for continuing subsidies. 2. Yes. Failure to enroll also disqualifies her from continuing to receive subsidies. 3. The rest of your questions are irrelevant due to the above. Really, since you currently do not have health insurance, it sounds like your best option is for your spouse to enroll you both into her new employer’s plan.”

“Insurance rates went up on average of 26%. This has nothing to do with the subsidies, it is just a yearly raising of health insurance costs And when you look up who approves those hikes, it’s the state and federal governments. So they approved this average of 26% increase and then you have the added effect of the extended subsidies ending, that is affecting these huge increases as well No, I don’t know when the decision is made to approve or deny rate increases for insurance companies, so I don’t know which administration approved this average of 26% rate hike but whoever did it, did it, knowing that the subsidies would be expiring. It’s like a double whammy. Our premiums went up, but it wasn’t by a ton, it is still manageable, and I am grateful. The ACA saved our lives, while my husband’s. We didn’t have health insurance before that and I didn’t enroll for the first three years because I thought it was too good to be true. We are both self-employed so we are exactly who ACA was made for. We don’t qualify for Medicaid and I wouldn’t want it. We can’t afford to pay some and I want to pay my share, but we can’t afford to pay it all. And in 2013 my husband had a 21 day hospital stay and then had another visit that was quite long because of heart issues. I knew we had to have health insurance. I was shocked when I found out how affordable the ACA was. My husband has had at least eight surgeries, three of which were heart related. It keeps him healthy so he can still work. If not, he would be on disability. He inherited a bad heart from both his mom and his dad. His twin brother had a pacemaker at age 40. It is nothing my husband did, he eats healthy, he’s very active, but he just inherited a bad ticker. He had to have a triple bypass and we were told we could wait a year and then suddenly my husband was at the hospital constantly and we had to do it right then. We had already been working to save up the money because it can be a 2 to 6 months recovery window. My husband was back to work in two months. He was out of the hospital on day five which was a record. It saved us. We had to file bankruptcy before we had health insurance and we had very little debt, but the medical debt was killing us. That 21 day Hospital stay alone was \$400,000. We don’t have any programs that will help you here. And there is no way we could pay that. I don’t want to hand out, we just need a little help. It’s the only help we get. This was all new to me because I spent 20 years in a corporate job and I had excellent health insurance, but I had 20 years and at age 38 because I started there when I was 16, but I wasn’t invested until I was 18. But then we decided to move across the country and I left that job but I left with a pension. But I can’t get that yet. I’m 51 now. So I did things the right way, I was just very naïve on how important health insurance is because I had never been without it before this.”

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q6f1ge/obamacare_premiums_jump_114_overnight_why_48/ny7bhug/

"Question about ACA PTC + unmarried domestic partner employer coverage My partner and I are unmarried and file taxes separately. We live together and have children, whom I claim on my taxes. I've always claimed the children. My partner's employer offers health insurance and gives him the option to cover the kids (the coverage is considered affordable) and also has the option to add a domestic partner. I was told by a Vermont Health Connect eligibility specialist that because we aren't married, the offer of affordable domestic partner coverage doesn't disqualify me from remaining on my Marketplace plan and receiving a Premium Tax Credit like it would if we were married. I've also found IRS guidance saying that someone who can enroll in an employee's employer coverage but isn't a member of the employee's tax family is considered eligible for that coverage for PTC purposes only during months they actually enroll. So essentially, his employer's offer of domestic partner coverage would only disqualify me from receiving a premium tax credit if I was to enroll. Does this sound correct? Specifically, is an affordable offer of employer coverage to an unmarried domestic partner treated differently for PTC purposes than an offer to children? Vermont Health connect told me that my partner's affordable employer insurance offer for our children does make the children ineligible for a PTC. The children and I are not part of his tax family because he doesn't claim any of us as dependents. I'm mainly trying to make sure I haven't been receiving a PTC when I shouldn't have and understand why my partner's offer of affordable coverage makes our children ineligible, but not myself."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wp131z/question_about_aca_ptc_unmarried_domestic_partner/

"I'm planning to engineer my income to below 200% FPL for ACA subsidies. I'll pay from my investments. I have one kid that will cause us to hit the OOP max every year with a chronic disease. I considered engineering our income to 100% FPL so the kids would be eligible for Medicaid, and we would get the maximum ACA subsidies, but it would draw down my basis fast, including Roth, so that's not as optimum for the long-term. After the kids are out of high school they'll be eligible for Medicaid on their own if they move out of this shit hole state, and I'm encouraging them to do so. Long-term, when the kids are independent, we want to leave the country for a better quality of life and reasonable healthcare costs. My spouse is retired now at 46. I'll retire in March at 49. The kids are in high school."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1woyyo6/for_people_retiring_before_65_how_are_you/pbraf9r/

"I just got hit with this in April. I lost my ACA. Never had a job that did a 401k. But I do have \$ in a traditional Roth and an Educational Roth. I'm in MN so they shoved me down to the "Free State Ins" sent me the cards and everything. Then a month ago they sent me a letter that I need to work something like \$500 a month or so many hours a month! I'm 62, raised 4 kids, I've worked since I was 12 and dammit I'm tired and want to enjoy my life. Property, house and car all paid off. I have savings and I live alone and thrifty. Thankfully I am in good health BUT.... They make this game so hard!!!"

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=UgwwvQLdJFtmIR6P2GI4AaABAg>

↳ @susanbibeault (1): "I believe community service can also be used to qualify for Medicaid if that would be preferable to finding part-time work, but I would check with your specific state to be sure and to find out what would be required for documentation."

"My situation has some similarities to yours. I retired at a young age (fully vested) from a state job with a pension. Until I become Medicare eligible, I will remain on the state retirees subsidized medical, dental, and vision insurance. I pay a small monthly fee for this coverage. I am not unethical or immoral for accepting the benefits that I earned. I did not make my health a priority while I was working. I'm playing catch-up addressing issues that I let build up before I retired. If I had continued working fulltime, I don't know if I could have made it to age 65 without a major health breakdown. My physical and mental health continues to improve since I retired. However, some of those improvements require on-going medical intervention. Having access to affordable medical care is not optional if I want to age with the best health possible."

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=Ugz82M1EnXHcMVESX-t4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Thank you for sharing your story! I agree I'm grateful for ACA insurance and my health continues to improve! ☺"

"If I prioritized my health and purchased health insurance...I wouldn't be able to pay my rent, or I'd have to sell my motorcycle (my only transport) and that plus not paying motorcycle insurance still wouldn't be equal to \$500...lol 😂 ...and then no job lol...I mean people always tell me I should buy insurance and it's like my avg quote is \$500 per month...lk you don't like eating out, but I do lol, and you know how many suppers I can eat for \$500?!?!...I ate 8 Del Taco chicken tacos for less than \$8 tonight lol...I need tasty food more than healthcare 😂 ...I've gotten some quotes that are over \$1,000 per month 🤔 🤔 🤔 "

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgwYOe1kA2WU96PAyHF4AaABAg>

"The non-ACA plans are often not good, and you often won't know it until it's too late. Please, please do yourself a favor of studying how ACA plans work. The possibility of having to pay back credits, when that happens and how much it might be, is one of the most vital things people need to understand about how these plans work. I have an ACA plan. Knowing how it works can help you prevent getting into a situation where you have to pay back credits, or at least be aware of it when your income changes and you know you'll have to pay some back, you can plan for it and not be surprised. And to help you decide whether or not to do things that might cause a spike in taxable income if you have a choice (esp important for people with investment income, or those deciding whether or not to decline a little overtime if you know it could put you owing back a lot of money, etc). Knowing how it all works can also help you save quite a lot of money in some instances. Such as if you are on the borderline of being eligible for a Silver plan with CSRs, if you know about this, you can do things to lower your taxable income a little and get a very good plan with low rates and low max oop. But if you aren't educating yourself on how it all works, you may miss out on things like that. I'll add this: For all we know, it's possible you already have a killer silver plan with CSRs for \$100 a month, and you don't realize how good it is. I get how that can happen, it's easy to not know how good your plan is until you see what else is out there. It's not just the monthly premium you need to look at, but what that premium gets you. As in, what is the deductible, what is the max out of pocket, what are co-pays for office visits, etc? A good CSR plan might have very low or \$0 deductible, and a low max out of pocket. But if you haven't educated yourself on health insurance, you could be looking at a \$2K max out of pocket and thinking this is BS! I need better for my \$100 a month! And all the while it's a great plan you won't be able to beat."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wkyb3r/where_do_i_start_looking_for_individual_health/pb0uizi/

"It's a Catch-22. I need medical care to stay alive, but I need a W-2 job for high quality affordable medical care, but the job's killing me. I'm in my 40's, and I could afford to retire now if not for the health insurance issue. An ACA family plan is ridiculously expensive and all but the platinum plans are dog 🐕 (high premiums, very high deductibles, very high max OOP, and limited networks that don't cover the halfway decent docs and hospitals in my area). And the platinums are INSANELY expensive and still don't cover many of my needed specialists. And I can't build my HSA as I max out contributions and spending every year. I think my only hope is to try to find a super easy job (even if super low paying) with good benefits and see if I can survive another 7 years until our kids are all off the plan and my husband (self-employed) qualifies for Medicare. Or 5 years if I pay for COBRA for the last 2 years..."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwc78xLI9v11PhI6QR4AaABAq>

"Is it beneficial to slightly overestimate projected income, to avoid possibly having to pay back subsidies at tax return time? I am trying to get ready to pull the trigger and retire at 62.5 years old. I plan to calculate my income from my Roth IRA (and a tiny part time job). Is it safer to slightly overestimate my income when signing up for ACA, to hopefully avoid the potential of having to pay back anything if I go over what I projected?"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/

↳ Low-Jury-3586 (7): "When you apply, it asks how much of the credit you want to use and you enter the dollar amount. I use only half. Then when I file my taxes, this gets reconciled and I receive the balance of the unused credit. This then helps pay the new year of premiums. Like you, I don't want to worry about any overpayments so I'm more comfortable doing it this way."

↳ CoveredStrangle (7): "You can do Roth conversions from your regular traditional IRA (or 401k)... into your Roth IRA. This Roth conversion amount will count towards your MAGI and help you qualify for ACA."

↳ GlitteringSwan8024 (5): "I estimated my income for 2025 within \$1200 of what it actually was and I still owe \$680! Very frustrating. I can easily pay it but there are probably people who can't. I don't understand how my subsidy amount was off by \$54 per month. I absolutely would overestimate, wish I would have done it for 2026."

"Always been that way. I have had multiple jobs over the decades. Sometimes I hit the jackpot and get great coverage, then I have years of useless healthcare coverage. Those years I get the basic bloodwork and X-rays on my own dime (literally I am paying the preventative care). The issue now is after a lifetime of work I want to retire. How do I get covered for the 60-65 gap? ACA is "limited coverage", almost criminal costs. This country needs a generational shakeup."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/nj43xoe/

"I retired at 47 and the ACA subsidies are returning to exactly the way they worked then. I surely didn't expect the enhanced subsidies to become permanent. I would love it if they did, but people who pursue early retirement have a plan for maximizing subsidies and this shouldn't be a major hurdle for them. Keeping your MAGI low as an early retiree isn't particularly hard and should have been planned for. I'm still hoping for the return of the enhanced subsidies as they make a lot more sense. The cliff was always such a terrible part of the original ACA."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_is_sue/nn3h71t/

"CHIP Costs More than ACA? I am trying to get a feel for ACA costs when I retire in a few years with a family of 4 and 2 kids, adults will be about 50 and kids 16 and 13. Using the PA website (pennie) I am seeing that if I have a MAGI below \$103k, the kids will be kicked to CHIP. The issue is that CHIP will cost about \$2.5k for both of them, and then our Bronze ACA would be another ~\$5k for my wife and I, so \$7.5k total. However, if they were too old to be on CHIP I could get the same Bronze plan for about \$5.5k for a family of 4, so CHIP is actually costing us MORE. If I understand correctly, CHIP has no deductible and very low co-pays, but our kids typically only go for annual visits so our costs are typically very low so I don't think that would ever offset the extra premium cost. Has anyone else needed to INCREASE their MAGI to lower costs by avoiding CHIP? Am I missing something?"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vli30e/chip_costs_more_than_aca/

↳ FI_321 (6): "You can keep your kids on the ACA by not taking the advanced monthly premium tax credits. You will get it all back when you file your taxes and it requires enough income/savings to cover the full premium until you get it refunded. This doesn't work if you want to utilize silver plan cost sharing. I did this for several years to keep my family off Medicaid (CHIP)."

↳ Perplexed-Owl (2): "In the past when I absolutely needed to keep the kids on our ACA/non CHIP plan, we converted small portions of our IRAs to ROTH in low tax brackets. In my case, I had decently healthy kids who would spend the summer away at camps/grandparents, and they needed OOS coverage. since then, our state no longer has any plans with OOS coverage, so it is moot. (The plans have gotten so much worse- the 'network' area is three counties, so even going to an in state school is problematic) A note about teens/young adults on ACA plans. My two were already in college on fantastic financial aid packages when the OOS national network was removed. I ended up having to purchase the plans offered by the colleges, which are extremely comprehensive, but 300\$/ mo each. By the end, I was paying \$300 (kid1), \$300 (kid 2) ~\$300 (older parent on Medicare plus part G and D) \$100 (younger parent on ACA) In previous years, we had managed to get a fantastic plan for all of us for under 100\$ total. As of this moment, the cheapest bronze plan with no subsidy is \$980/ mo just for me. We squeaked by for this year with subsidies, but for 2027 we will have a family size of 2 and also need to do Roth conversions to plan ahead, so maybe 15k just for me plus another ~4K for my spouse."

↳ anabanana100 (2): "As far as I've experienced, you can choose full price CHIP or keep your whole family on an ACA plan at that MAGI. I think the eligibility statement is confusing in the application. Once you get into Medicaid-level incomes is where things get tricky. Cheapest CHIP in my county is 4.8K for 2 kids so yours seems pretty good. The biggest upside I see with CHIP is that it's very low risk should you encounter significant medical needs."

"The ACA was not ever intended for early retirement, so the pain of the enhanced subsidies going away is really self inflicted. Having said that I was really hoping the enhanced subsidies would be extended for the current early retirees but also the ACA was my plan. Now I will just think of another way!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzNb723lBr-pBKrcyJ4AaABAg

↳ @chrisforker7487 (1): "Or live on less than 85k a year!"

"I should first say that I can arrange my affairs to qualify for Medicaid or the ACA (it just depends on how much capital-gains I take vs. Roth distributions). I used to be on Medicaid, but with the upcoming change to Medicaid requiring work requirements (I consider myself fully retired), I wanted to get into an ACA plan (at the bare minimum 138% of poverty income rate); there was also some screwing things with Medicaid such as me not being able to get the plan to do mail-order Rx filling (an important thing since I travel a lot), to say nothing of getting my sleep Rx covered properly (I could get my Medicaid PCP to write the script, but I would have it filled at Health Warehouse), so presuming I could have gotten a proper PCP in the new ACA plan, I would be saving money on Rx. But since I can't get a proper PCP from the ACA plan - nor a psychiatrist that my PCP told me I had to see - I'm stuck going back to my old PCP as a self-pay patient, and getting the sleep Rx from the old mail-order place. And of course, I'm paying \$80/mo for the privilege of this rotten service. That said, I was able to get my annual blood test, and I will getting a feces test for colon cancer, from the new ACA plan (I would have gotten it no matter what plan I would be on). Yes, my new PCP sucks, and I have fired him (I told him that I don't trust him with my health management); I guess I could look for another one, even a nurse-practitioner, but how do you find one that will do the job. Do I say, "Hi, I am a subscriber with the AmWorse Premier plan, and I am looking for a PCP; one of the requirements I have for my PCP is that I get my 10mg Zolpidem Rx - that I have had for 30 years or so, and that I could prove for the last 12 years from my old PCP - which I consider an essential part of my health maintenance. If you run your practice such that you can't do this, then I cannot give you my business"."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omz7nsn/

"I plan to retire at the end of the year and will be living on savings and interest income for the next decade or so until I collect SS. One of the reasons for retiring is to care for my elderly bedridden father full time. I will likely do some consulting but doubt my income will be higher than \$20000. I will have access to cobra but it's \$1500/month. I checked ACA in my state and it said I would qualify for Medicare. This seems implausible since I have significant assets (a paid-for home, money in the bank, and a decent 401k plan). Does Medicaid consider your assets? I called the state office and they said they just look at income. Also, since they don't consider caring for elderly parents as "working" I wonder about the bbb's work requirements. Anyway, thanks for your video—I have a lot of research to do!"

— YouTube · HOW to ESTIMATE Your 2026 ACA (Marketplace) Premiums! (calculator) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N7I023Co9ro&lc=UgwWX5t-CAaAY5RxOht4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "From what I understand, right now they only look at income but that may change in the future. It also sounds like the work requirements won't start until January 1, 2027. So you have some time to figure it out!"

↳ @scottsteward398 (0): "From what I have learned, (videos and research) you probably don't want to be on Medicaid, Consider earning some income, drawing from investments, to get a Medicare subsidized policy."

↳ @Robert9-tz1 (0): "\$1500 a month for COBRA? Is that for one person or for a family? Wow. My COBRA was an excellent plan and was around \$650 a month. It ran out a couple months ago unfortunately."

"Unsubsidized Health Insurance Premiums Ramp Up I know I can just change my age on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) from now until 64 to get this and adjust for inflation, but does anyone know if the unsubsidized health insurance premium "ramp up" rate is available anywhere? I tried to Google it, but couldn't find any information. I'd like to use this information to estimate health insurance premium for the retirement software for scenarios where I continue to work my self-employed job earning way more than the subsidy "cliff" but also being able to contribute more into my retirement accounts, while my husband retires early."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1r6ktck/>

↳ (0): "Searching for "aca federal default age curve" brings up this bulletin from 2016: <https://www.cms.gov/ccio/resources/regulations-and-guidance/downloads/final-guidance-regarding-age-curves-and-state-reporting-12-16-16.pdf> Appendix I has the relevant info. When very bored one night during the 2026 enrollment period, I went through the exact exercise you describe and came up with the following curve for my situation. At a glance it still matches the 2016 numbers very well: <https://preview.redd.it/f2uarcijdxjg1.jpg?width=671&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=c58c8a44084359816ca0777a09e43535c8e4768b>;

↳ (0): "Omg you are the absolute best. Did you know? Haha"

↳ (0): "Yeah, that is still pretty accurate given I am 56 and my quote was for \$1100 (for myself, \$2200 total with wife) (that is for the crappiest bronze plan I could get). Silver was even more expensive. I am no longer on an ACA plan as a result."

"That's where I'm at right now. I want to retire because my elderly parents are needing assistance in their home, but I've continued to work due to needing health insurance. I just asked ChatGPT if we qualify for ACA. Our youngest is in college and lives at home still. I carry the insurance. I didn't want to yank his health coverage out from under him just because I want to retire (I'll be 62 in October). But, guess what! We just found out we qualify for ACA because we don't make a lot of money! I've never been so happy to be so poor in all my life, lol! 🤔 We've saved responsibly over the years and the healthcare issue was the only thing from keeping us from being able to retire. HALLELUJAH!!!! 🎉 🎉 🎉 "

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=UgwHff4X8gD4WW5bh1J4AaABAg.AT_iF2mw-5EATaChQBBG5l

"> I am loving what my Cobra payment will be for 18 months but not so much the Maryland ACA quote I'm seeing even if I stay under the 400% cap for subsidies. Has anyone experienced this too? Am I doing the ACA wrong? You might be doing it wrong. You need to enter early retirement with a plan to keep MAGI in the goldilocks zone. I keep my MAGI below 200 pct of poverty level and thus most of my ACA marketplace premiums are paid for by the IRS when I file my tax returns. I have never seen an ACA plan with higher premiums than my COBRA. Granted, platinum plans are not for sale in my state."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vi9mvg/aca_versus_cobra_payments_cobra_is_cheaper/p2m44kr/

"Hi David, my wife will be 66 next month. She is still working and getting healthcare benefits from her work. I will be 63 in June. We are planning to move south and at that point she will be entirely retired and getting her coverage thru Medicare along with the supplement plan G. I will have to get something, probably thru ACA. With my retirement and her work I don't qualify for any help. The plans for NY are over the place in cost. Any suggestions? Good video."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How We Got Health Insurance · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lwy4jmmT1k&lc=Ugx0L8qkJCeQtwdzeV4AaABAg>

↳ @davidnprogress (0): "The good news is the high income. Bad news is that you will have to pay premium prices most likely for the two year gap before turning 65. Could you wait long enough to go with Cobra? You may just have to budget for the gap and consider it just part of the price of admission to your new great life."

↳ @RetirementIsUnderrated (0): "@davidnprogress Thanks David for the advice. I just talked with my wife and she indicated that I could use the cobra insurance from her work as a single. The problem is if we relocate down south would I still be covered. Thanks for your thoughts. Good stuff"

"@scottunclocked I am looking at early retirement and trying to navigate the best options for healthcare much like yourself. Im lucky that I have a brokerage account with a modest sum in it already and my plan is to add a portion of my 401k money into it with a large withdrawal the first year and eat the taxes on it. Not ideal but it will save me probably \$12k per year in health care costs every year for 5 years or more so the math becomes favorable."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgzY_cAc1lvZpGOGsJ54AaABAg.AZ9ym9tGYhZAZA2AdG8f8x

"do you think US will fix its health insurance cost problem or should I move back to taiwan? I was born in taiwan and came to US when I was 2, so I can have dual US-Taiwan citizenship. I would like to be self-employed. I read that in order to be taiwan citizen, you also have to be able to speak/write chinese, so it will take some investment in time for me to learn to write chinese."

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=UgyPnrkxm9XGXs4hSJ14AaABAg>

"Obamacare is MUCH cheaper than the group insurance plan I am currently on and has better coverage. I plan to retire at 50 or so depending on how the market performs and the ACA is part of my plan. By weighting my early retirement funds to come from taxable accounts, I lower my income and qualify for nice subsidies."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugw0XmXuG9A6Z9qiEvZ4AaABAg>

↳ @dennistylr8746 (2): "@HowToRetire I think \$36,000 is max to qualify for "affordable" Obama care. So in essence, you retire somewhat poor and that's for 2 people. Insurance is cheap at the income but other expenses better be too. All the best..."

↳ @HowToRetire (0): "That's awesome that you've had success with an ACA plan. Lowering your taxable income will certainly help with the premium subsidies."

↳ @8AUGS (0): "@dennistylr8746 Someone says that it is doable, i.e. if you have a substantial cash savings which will supplement that \$36K max, and hopefully last until SS and Medicare kick in. I am "newly and early" retired, and looking into this Healthcare "Headache" Insurance issue."

"I have a job and decent health insurance thru insurance (which I need), but I want to retire and I can't because I cannot afford insurance! I cannot believe this is happening in America!"

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236lZc&lc=UgwLgsO0pSI7zCf-K094AaABAg>

"Same here I just immigrate and I'm doing adjustment of status, my husband is self employee and I'm trying to learn the best health insurance option for us."

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgyLCUFODD0W7donDhh4AaABAg.9ileJsT6TNK9iYx5S_8bSI

"I've been freelancing for 11 years, 2020 was my best year yet. Every invoice that comes in, I pay myself first: 25% goes to taxes, 10% goes to retirement, 5% goes towards vacation/PTO, and I have two other 5% savings goals (for example, building up e-fund, saving for new car, saving up for new computer equipment when I need it, etc. - could be anything). I am extremely disciplined about that, and it feels good to have that money in the bank. (It's hard to write out a big check for taxes, but it's way easier when the money's in your account already!) The other 50% pays for any business overhead expenses (for me, it tends to be ~\$2500 a year no matter what my gross income is) and pays me. I keep my business and personal bank accounts separate, but I'm a sole proprietor and practically, this means I have two checking accounts and two savings accounts at my bank. For the actual retirement account, I have a Traditional IRA that I do my best to max out every year, and it's in a Target Retirement Date fund at Vanguard. Simple. If I have more than the max, I put that money into the market, too - just in non-retirement accounts. If you plan to be making a lot more money, then I think there are some better vehicles for retirement savings, but my accountant said to just go for a Traditional IRA for now, and that's working for me. Getting \$6000 into that account each year is a challenge, and the way to do it is one step at a time! Practically, this means I have retirement savings in a bucket and I put it in the market \$500 at a time. Whatever works for you, what's important is just getting that money working for you. I can't help too much with health insurance, as I have another job (not my primary source of income, the freelancing is) but that pays for my healthcare. It's been a long time, but think I just bought off the marketplace. [Freelancers Union](<https://www.freelancersunion.org/>) has some good resources about that."

— r/freelance · https://www.reddit.com/r/freelance/comments/lb2j90/in_2021_how_do_all_of_you_manage_health_insurance/gls0vxi/

A plan they can actually use · 20 documents · 20 voices

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husband's job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pcor72/>

↳ (0): "We need basic universal healthcare."

↳ (0): "Yup. I'm in a similar boat. My insurance for my family went from \$800 to \$2700. I basically opted out. I can't afford it. Many many more Americans are hurting too. Stay strong."

↳ (0): "If anybody is in the boat where they find themselves not being able to afford it (absolutely no shame here.) Please try to still look for a catastrophic plan that covers emergencies. It's only going to cover emergencies and nothing else after deductible is met."

"ACA not very affordable anymore ACA is not really affordable without the extra subsidy, but California fines you 100 per month for not having it. It's not really fair to fine people who truly can't afford it. I work front desk hotel. The cheapest plan for me is 200 per month. I have to pay 100% out of pocket until I reach 7200 for the year. Just 2 visits to the dermatologist is costing me 1400 on top of the 200 I already pay. If I want something with normal co-pays, it's going to cost me 400 per month. I make between 45K-50K, but the cost of living is so high in California that there isn't much left for stuff like health insurance. It's really not fair that California fines you at this point when the premiums have literally doubled in price. It's very frustrating."

— r/obamacare · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/

↳ discoduck007 (28): "Thank you BBB (Big Billionaires Bonus)"

↳ Mysterious-Art8838 (18): "I completely empathize re the cost but I still think it's worth having. I absolutely have to have it because I have a serious illness. I'm 44f. My monthly is \$605 and my deductible is 12k which I will probably hit after a hospital visit last month. It completely sucks but not having it would suck 1000x more. As it is I try so hard to stay out of the hospital. Last week I collapsed in an urgent care because I waited too long to get help. Thankfully it's attached to a hospital so they called a code blue on me and brought me over lickity split. But I was focused on how much it would cost and whether I could get through it myself, not what I reasonably should have been considering. When I was on the floor of the hospital staring at the ceiling I was thinking oops. Guess I let this go too far. But I try hard to avoid it because it's so freggin expensive. That same visit I left AMA because it's so much more expensive if they admit me."

↳ Florida1974 (16): "So very true. The first guy I fell in love with, he died when he was 36 years old. He kept going to the hospital because of a severe sore throat. They would give him antibiotics and send him home. Months later, they finally caved and did more testing and he had stage four throat cancer. And he died. There was nothing they could do because it was so far advanced. I had they done that test to begin with, it might be different. I am married and we moved 1200 miles away and one day I happen to look at the obituaries, which I never do, from back home. I told my husband about it that night and his jaw fell. Turns out when I was dating this guy, my would be husband was teaching him how to paint houses on the weekends. My husband is eight years older than we were. But we were together for probably 10 years before we realize this. Still gives me chills. But it's so sad that he died, he had young kids back then. So yes, they do let you die."

"I am with you. Cancelled my ACA plan. Went from \$750 to \$2150 a month for my wife and I, and that is from a Gold plan to a crappy bronze plan with \$10K deductible. They can bite me."

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qil7n2/my_premium_went_from_200_to_1500_and_now/o0sa18a/

"Bingo. With kids that have health conditions I've hit my deductible and max out of pocket multiple years. I don't need an HSA, I need low deductibles and out of pocket caps. This is after my 12k a year in premiums."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p6p4cm/why_health_savings_ac_counts_arent_the_fix/nqs78vy/

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

↳ wischywaschy (3): "I can't really help but I also have massive problems with IBX (self-funded plan) with an appeal process and the DOL is trying to help. IBX is a mess - it looks like they don't follow all ERISA regulations and seem very disorganized. The DOL is helpful but they are really short-staffed since they got DOGE'd, so whatever they can do for us is slow. They said to me they can do more when more people complain, so please

complain!"

↳ budrow21 (2): "I would file the appeals directly and continue working through the DoL. You don't have many other options."

↳ theoretalking (2): "Have you tried asking your employer's benefit manager and the broker to follow up with the account manager at IBX since she has not been responsive? The most people you got pushing and fighting for you, the better. sounds like you called your state's DOL? Try the US DOL here: <https://beta.dol.gov/about/agencies/ebsa/ask-ebsa> Have you tried looking up ERISA lawyers on Google? When I did that, I see a bunch lawyers that specialize in ERISA show up. It seems most (or not all) of them offer free consultation. I suggest you try that to find someone in your region."

"Older chronically sick people too. We never get the chance to build an HSA because we are paying ever increasing amounts on copays, deductibles and premiums. And, for me, I can't come up with the deductible. I need copays to help me spread out my expenses. Those plans are usually more expensive. It just seems like another way to fund insurance companies and still leave poorer, sicker, older people in a bind."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p6p4cm/why_health_savings_accounts_arent_the_fix/nqsk4q1/

"My husband's stepmom and father both died last year. We live 2,000 miles away, and my husband was an only child. On top of that, his dad was incapacitated by a stroke right before his wife died, so we had to petition for guardianship because no one had the authority to pay his bills or make decisions on his behalf once she passed away. When she was sick, I flew there for two weeks and helped take care of her. Flew back here after her funeral and then flew there again in July and stayed for 5 months by myself. My husband had to stay here and keep working so we'd keep our health insurance. The nursing facility was 3 hours from my FIL's house, but I couldn't afford to get a hotel nearby for five months, so I stayed in his house and would make the 6-hour round trip to the facility on Saturdays. We are extremely fortunate that we were able to afford to have the two of us live separately for that long. Dad's funds covered his mortgage and utilities, but I was paying for my own groceries and putting gas in the car to get around. The only reason this worked is because I have health problems that make it impossible for me to work full-time, so I am self-employed and was able to work from a different state while I took care of everything there. Most people would not have been able to make it work due to finances, and those are the people who are going to be screwed by these cuts. Because it's very difficult to do caregiving while also trying to pay your own bills."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lflzs7/i_think_the_medicaiddestroying_bill_will_pass/myphsha/

"ACA Marketplace help Our family has been on a marketplace plan over a year now since I became a stay at home mom and my husbands job does not have health insurance. We do not qualify for a subsidy so for our family of 3 we are paying about \$2000 a month for our insurance and I'm due to have another baby next month. We would really like to find a way to save some money in this area and since I don't plan on delivering another baby next year we plan to go for a higher deductible plan but unsure how much different cost that will be. Basically I just need all your tips and tricks because \$2000 a month is outrageous."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpbl8e/aca_marketplace_help/

↳ chickenmcdiddle (10): "Noted, thanks. At that level of income, your hands are tied. Only thing you can do is evaluate options in November once the enrollment period begins to see if there are any other less expensive plans. Since the household income and family size are above the subsidy ceiling, you're left bearing the full cost of these policies."

↳ Mr_Gneiss_Guy (8): "What state are you in, and what's your household income? Will a second dependent push you into tax credit eligibility when they're born?"

↳ chickenmcdiddle (7): "u/IndependentTrust4594 \- please address the follow-up questions in the comment above. Knowing your state and your gross household income (income before taxes) is baseline information needed!"

"My experience with Obamacare is I have 2100 deductible but when I go to the doctor or get blood work done it first goes to the insurance company for Dallas and they show in the explanation of benefits paper what is the allowable amount that doctor can charge for the visit and I just paid that amounts Which is less than what the doctor would normally charge 8% without health insurance I just wish Republicans would stop playing around with Healthcare so that Democrats can finally get ObamaCare work in the way it's supposed to. Every time a republican gets in office they take away things from Obamacare making it more expensive then Democrats have to come in try to restore the basics"

— YouTube · Enrolling in Obamacare | 3 Mistakes to Avoid · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZBc-IntJRAU&lc=UgwULwVgxaW6_rowabB4AaABAg

↳ @FoundersHealth (0): "Yes, for now we have to figure out how to find the best plans in the system for each individual. It's a moving target every year!"

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjvhr9/please_help_best_insurance_in_nj_for_someone/

↳ No-Produce-6720 (8): "I'm not sure if you're meaning to say Medicare, but there is no federal Medicaid. Medicaid is only issued based on the state in which you live. There is no federal option, so I'm unsure what you're referring to there. Aside from that, you need to start at healthcare.gov. That will point you in the right direction for ACA coverage or Medicaid."

↳ katsrad (7): "One thing is that there isn't a federal Medicaid it is going to be provided by the state. There is Federal Medicare which is different and based on age or if you are disabled. The other is use healthcare.gov to

look for plans you are eligible for and if you are eligible for any subsidies. Anything outside that can deny you coverage for pre-existing conditions or not pay claims for those."

↳ gingercatlover1 (2): "Yes, we do! There are a lot of resources."

"HSAs are ONLY available to people with very high deductibles. To move to a higher deductible ACA plan your out of pocket, copays, etc. all rise substantially and...you lose many of your providers. My deductible doesn't allow me to have an HSA, yet my premium doubled to over \$1K a month. If I went with a higher deductible plan to be HSA eligible, my out of pocket risk more than doubles. HSA isn't the answer!! Without ACA my plan would be \$2300 a month. Even with an HSA I can't save enough to pay that!! I worked 40 years but am not yet Medicare eligible. Forced out of my job. Outsourcing and lost retiree benefits. ACA is the only reason I have medical. Many like me. It's so depressing and unnecessary."

— YouTube · Healthcare premiums to skyrocket Jan. 1 for Obamacare enrollees · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZ_YF6SbtSg&lc=Ugzfom3PaUlvqQYccGZ4AaABAq

"better off choosing a catastrophic plan if available, or a high deductible plan if catastrophic not available. We are having to switch to a high deductible with \$16,000 deductible for the two of us because our current plan premiums increased from \$1,800 to \$3,067 per month in 2026. The HDHP premiums are \$2,100 per month 😞 - still INSANE but gonna choose it anyway and hope we dont have to use it much.... The fact that we have to pay \$41,000 out of pocket (premiums plus deductible) before getting any actual insurance in the USA is INSANE and should be illegal. Congress needs to choose their insurance from the ACA instead of getting cushy benefits - that is the only way things will change."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/anyone_considering_a_health_share_in_place_of_aca/noz13li/

"Hi Travis, what would be the tax consequences If I want to cancel the health insurance through market place? I pay no premium and low deductible based on estimated income, but I want to cancel the coverage now because my son can claim me as his dependent and I have coverage from his work. Initially, our plan was to get coverage from market place and earn enough money so that he can't claim me as his dependent. However, since I can get the coverage from his work and don't want to work."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Tax Credit Explained · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8go8HuwI8xk&lc=UgwNmDzLLLtcnO1YUVB4AaABAq>

↳ @TravisSickle (0): "There are not any tax consequences for cancelling a policy."

↳ @milankhadka4685 (0): "@TravisSickle but I have policy for 18 days now."

"I went to the ACA and saw my 2025 plan go up by 490%. So - I had to go from a good silver plan to the bottom of the barrel bronze plan - and face high risks of medical bankruptcy - HUGE deductibles that I would never be able to pay - and even huge Drug cost increases. ALSO - I continually ask my pharmacist for my 1500% cash refund at the Walgreens counter - but he keeps saying he is going to call the Police. What's up with that"

— YouTube · Healthcare premiums to skyrocket Jan. 1 for Obamacare enrollees · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZ_YF6SbtSg&lc=UgxrkgcOMnnev1tVMMR4AaABAq

"I have Pivot short term insurance underwritten by Pan American, found through my insurance broker. It's for 3 years and costs much less monthly than ACA would cost me as I'm not eligible for subsidies (\$550 vs. \$947. I have no preexisting conditions, it has a high deductible and I have to pay a bit towards annual physical, etc. I hope to not ever have to really use it. It has good reviews online fwiw."

— r/obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/pavwcff/

"Horrible waste of money. \$2,000 a month out of pocket for a gold plan and i still have to pay out of pocket everywhere i get treatment. My little boy needs a surgery and im told i have to pay another \$1,500 out of pocket because its not covered under my gold plan i need a gold+ plan for it to be covered, dont waste your money"

— TrustPilot · Oscar Health · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aaa9182ffcd85367bafdb56>

"I'm confused with a deductible, so say I need to go a dermatologist and it's \$400 I would have to pay \$400? Since my deductible is 5000. If so what's the point of insurance unless I to a hospital and have a bill that's like 30000"

— YouTube · How Health Insurance Works I What is a Deductible? Coinsurance? Copay? Premium? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xs7MNNqdN-o&lc=Ugxmftau0IKopBWc5E94AaABAg>

↳ @leshommesdupilly (0): "Not exactly how that work, but it's pretty much that. Just don't expect them to pay everything, or approve every medical decisions of your doctor after you reach your deductible..... I mean, the point of private insurances is to thicken the pockets of a few billionaires. How do you think Aetna increased their profits by 10B, which means 90B dollars for 2022 ?"

"My income is about 38K and my premiums went from \$30/mo to \$290/mo. I'm in CA. I had to downgrade from the Silver plan to the Bronze plan because I can't afford those premiums. Let's hope I don't need to use it."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxFOClgepeTH-OzV4J4AaABAg>

↳ @DrJoshGuitar (0): "@Startingoveragain1234 isn't the bronze plan deductible like 4 or 5k per year?"

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "That's crazy!! At least you can use a HSA with the bronze plan! 😊"

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "@DrJoshGuitar It can be!"

"My premium is \$180/month with my job but I can't afford the \$40 copayments to go to the specialists I need to go to. 🙄 I only pay around \$50/month for all of my meds though so that's good."

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgwfcDpnGLoZIGHs-xl4AaABAg>

"I wish I could just not have health insurance but I'm a type one diabetic I have lupus RA and fibromyalgia it's hard and the copays suck but I'm alive"

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgyvyTKbBc4gAwldUCV4AaABAg>

Not needing care this year · 19 documents · 19 voices

"Georgia - just got my estimate on rate increase. Guess I'll be doing without. I've been using Ambetter for a few years with a few hiccups but overall it worked. Make around 23k per year. Had a Silver plan for around \$150.00. Just got my notice via the GA marketplace. Similar plan that no longer includes the vision and dental I had in the old plan, will be \$479.00. Guess I'll be doing without this year and hope for the best. Multiple health issues and prescriptions. Can't get Medicaid here. Welcome to the new world."

— r/HealthInsurance · 82 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oh2fva/>

↳ (0): "Call your representative! This is what the shutdown is about!"

↳ (0): "I've already sent letters to them. For all the good it will do at this point."

↳ (0): "Make an appointment to see them."

"I work a conventional job. I have no benefits and cannot afford insurance without subsidies. I will go without and pray I don't get sick or hurt. Seriously feels like playing a reverse lottery."

— r/obamacare · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lp1un7/if_the_bbb_passes_and_the_aca_is_gutted_what_are/n0rlrux/

"I'm two years away from Medicare age and self employed. I have a bronze HSA policy this year with an \$8k deductible. I pay \$750 a month with the subsidy....the premium is \$1500. I won't qualify for subsidiaries next year either and I'm afraid to see what the premium will be. I'll probably just drop health insurance until I qualify for medicare and hope nothing happens. 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh6uh41/

"Thanks for another great video on this topic Julie! Like you and others that have commented, I'm on ACA now and concerned about the possible hike in premiums next year, not even considering the reduction in subsidies. If this 15% number comes close, it won't be as bad as anticipated. But like you said, anything can happen, and things are always changing. Fingers crossed it's not as bad as I'm expecting. 🙏 "

— YouTube · HOW to ESTIMATE Your 2026 ACA (Marketplace) Premiums! (calculator) · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N7I023Co9ro&lc=Ugyj2ID29m3e4mQPpa94AaABAq>

↳ @woodsparker7902 (2): "@HappyonMonday does the Silver plan cover crossed toes? 🙏🙏 "

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "You're welcome! Yes fingers and toes crossed!!!! 🙏🙏🙏 "

"Our cobra iwould be \$2000 per month for a couple. ACA is \$2000 per month due to our income. We make above \$84000 and both are with a huge deductibles. We are going with Aflac and catastrophic policy and hope for the best."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgzwuPibcsxOeDECzdB4AaABAg

↳ @scottunclocked (0): "Thank you for sharing what you are going with. We found the "catastrophic" policy with some supplemental insurance an acceptable solution for at least the next few years. How long have you been retired... or is your retirement coming up soon?"

↳ @nonionbeezness (0): "That is unfortunately one of the biggest issues with working in the USA, retiring early in the USA is a financial Albatros around out necks."

↳ @scottunclocked (0): "There are definitely some nuances and challenges to overcome & plan for if retiring before Age 65."

"My plan is to be uninsured and hope for the best."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1woyyo6/for_people_retiring_befor_e_65_how_are_you/pbt4i3o/

""better" in the sense of lower deductible and lower copays. But, that might not make financial sense in your situation. Just like when employed, you have to weigh the available options. Lower decuctables and lower copays and lower out of pocket maximum means higher monthly payment. You have to figure out what makes more sense to you. Not in Texas, but I chose the same insurance company as I had with employer insurance but I chose higher deductible and out of pocket maximum with lower monthly payments for my situation. But I feel comfortable with using the insurance, knock on wood, as I did when it was mostly paid by an employer."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rg8lye/texas_and_obama_care/o7qg3fj/

"How do you feel horrible for myself and other people I don't live in extravagant life I'm very simple but I can't afford my health insurance now. I guess I'm just going to cross my fingers nothing happens this is horrible I've got many friends at the same situation working 60 hours a week and still can't afford it"

— YouTube · 374,000 Californians drop Covered California health insurance · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a0Na8qxXqrs&lc=UgxajZGTUQ7Ntpjtx-14AaABAg>

"This is not a good idea. I fell on a cruise in 2024 I rupture my knees and broken my legs. Without health insurance my hospital bill would have cost me \$585,000+ dollars that was for 3 surgeries to repair my legs. Then I had to stay in a nursing home for 75 days because the hospital could not send me home cause I couldn't walk. I'm single and live alone The nursing home was an additional \$1,100 a night for 75 days... Thank God I had health insurance. On top of that, having health insurance gets you dental care, vision care and a primary doctor that can make sure you are and stay healthy. Not having health insurance Bradley is STUPID. I don't care how much money you save, you can't take that money to heaven when you die. What happens if you get an illness like cancer God forbid, that cost becomes a burden on tax payers because you were too cheap and greedy to bank.all the money you can, cause you didn't want to be a responsible adult and get health insurance? Please don't start a go fund me page if you get sick and can't pay your medical bills and expect someone else to pick up the table cause you were too cheap"

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=Ugx4aRuumYZRKBO0ayJ4AaABAg>

"Our ACA Bronze level coverage will be \$2500 a month with a \$7500 deductible. That is equal to our mortgage. There's no way we can carry this cost every month—we are both self-employed. We will never hit our deductible either so essentially paying \$2500 a month for what?! We are healthy but over 50 so you never know what lingers around the corner. I'm seriously thinking we'll go without and hope for the best. This is absolutely insane to be this old, with a successful career, a decent retirement account and suddenly find ourselves in this position. I can't sleep at night. The stress alone from this is going to send me to the ER. Oh the irony."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o8gdh7/wow_looking_at_my_2026_insurance_its_half_my_rent/njuzl8v/

"@VictoriaDorsano Hi, thanks for your helpful video! Very appreciated for the time you've spent to create this informative video for those that have struggled or forced like my situation where the premium will go up from \$200 to \$450 in a week soon & my adult son (21 y/o) will be kicked out from Medi-Cal (\$0) to go with my plan under Obama Care with a premium \$288! It's so ridiculous!!! I wanted to confirm this above site you provided is the ONLY agent company that can help me purchase DPC + accident plan & is free of charge correct? Thank you again. Stay healthy!"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed | TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=Ugzt3Gpc0VMzfYpEICB4AaABAg.9kR4ZvNIY3v9rMIMFyKqj3>

"Thanks for another great video David. I retired in July 2025 at 57 and my wife has her own business (single person company) so company supplied insurance is not an option. For 2025 we signed up for an ACA Bronze Plan through Kaiser Permanente and our premium (2 person family) was \$918/month and Out of Pocket @ \$14000 with about \$850 in subsidies. For 2026, same Bronze Plan, our premium is jumping to \$1950/month with the subsidies going away. Quite the jump. Hope you stay healthy going forward and keep up the great videos."

— YouTube · Why I Chose a Bronze ACA Plan With Heart Failure (2026 Coverage + HSA Strategy) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vt81218uhdU&lc=Ugx2x-3n1gB8ej-TNj14AaABAg>

↳ @dantheman6607 (1): "At \$1950 a month its like having another mortgage payment. We need more affordable healthcare"

↳ @davidnprogress (0): "Much appreciated, Michael. July! You are just now in the wonderful honeymoon phase. I hope the year is going fantastically for you."

"I retired a year ago, the last company I worked for gave me health insurance, I worked there 10 years. I begged them to cancel the insurance and just pay me the money. They wouldn't do it stating that I had to stay healthy to keep making them money. Well, they spent 60K over the course of 10 years, the money is gone, never went to the doctor, not even once. I could have 60K in my pocket but instead big pharma has it in theirs. 60K down the toilet. BTW, the coverage was lousy, no dental, high deductible, co pays, etc."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America I People Are Canceling Coverage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgzvsE60RR_apej0KU4AaABAg

"There is still no subsidies for people like me. i retired early and my income is considered too high (which is not that much in SF Bay Area). My ACA premium quoted was \$1500/month, so I took the cobra instead which is about \$1060/month. I'm hoping that within two years, there will be subsidies again before my cobra runs out. It's just getting really expensive. Fingers crossed."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugxqd9QTiqMevS-dbz14AaABAg

"Hi! It's important to keep in mind it's only the 'enhanced' subsidies that expire at the end of 2025. I checked to see how much more my premiums would be, and it's \$70/mo. It will be different for everyone, based in state, income, and plan. Either way I am hopeful they will extend the subsidies. Fingers crossed!"

— YouTube · STOP Overpaying For Health Insurance With These ACA Subsidy Tips! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UtYe4NUwRWk&lc=UgzjdRgR8fWJoEOBwPF4AaABAg.AErxF4dUJHAet9tnwZVB6>

"This year I had to pay a \$750 tax penalty to the State of California for not having health insurance. Afterwards I got a \$5 a month health plan with Keiser through the Affordable Care Act. Just got to stay healthy because the deductible is \$8,000 if I get seriously sick and have to be hospitalized."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236lZc&lc=UgwBUPUJvUDXLw6k5kd4AaABAg.9UGINCdi2GG9UGpTHzcEfR>

"I don't need health insurance. I have been living mostly without any health insurance for decades. Stay healthy is more important than secondary lifestyle + expensive health insurance. Billions of people around the world are living fine without health insurance."

— YouTube · Obamacare enrollees get first look at 2026 prices as premiums soar · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2Aznbv0Pnoc&lc=UgwqjKyNC-ZLI0MtPFI4AaABAg>

"My income is about 38K and my premiums went from \$30/mo to \$290/mo. I'm in CA. I had to downgrade from the Silver plan to the Bronze plan because I can't afford those premiums. Let's hope I don't need to use it."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxFOClgepeTH-OzV4J4AaABAg>

↳ @DrJoshGuitar (0): "@Startingoveragain1234 isn't the bronze plan deductible like 4 or 5k per year?"

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "That's crazy!! At least you can use a HSA with the bronze plan! 😊 "

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "@DrJoshGuitar It can be!"

"Thanks! I've always just used TurboTax since 1998, but there was never any situation I was unsure about before. 😂 Fingers crossed I don't have to pay back the subsidy for being too poor."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1r5uq2v/questions_about_how_to_file_taxes_with_premium/o5lrym8/

Making it to 65 and Medicare · 10 documents · 10 voices

"Excellent video!! I retired early and I'm 62 and on the ACA. My biggest concern right now is the current administration is trying to kill the ACA. I have 3 years left until Medicare and feel really vulnerable. I feel like I'm living on a hope and a prayer until 65. Keep the great content coming!!!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugx20_ft51xWWyopGPR4AaABAg

↳ @janetmartin9372 (2): "No. The previous administration added additional subsidies in 2021 and 2023 on top of the original aca. They scheduled them to expire end of 2025. Why should middle income people pay subsidies to higher income people to help them pay their health insurance? We are back to regular aca and there is help for those up to 400 percent of poverty level."

"I completely disagree on ACA being the #1 best option. If you have no pre-existing conditions, your best option is the private insurance market. ACA would have cost me [alone] over \$2,000 per month for a high deductible plan (my income necessary to make ends meet exceeds eligibility for any ACA subsidy). COBRA was going to cost me over \$1,500 per month and would only last for 18 months (I need 21 months to make it to Medicare age). Solution? I found health insurance in the private marketplace for...now get this...\$750 per month. Even better? My maintenance prescriptions have a \$0 copay and my office visit copay is less than when I was working! I'm laughing all the way to the bank now!"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=Ugz_xhwD-Z5OHxsqwgB4AaABAq

↳ @betoxyz68 (1): "You are absolutely correct! There are excellent private insurance options available in most states with very competitive rates similar to yours. Great job on doing your due diligence and exploring all the options that fit your specific circumstances. It's always smart to look at the full picture before deciding."

↳ @detroitgator1 (1): "Please share how you figured this out. I need to go about 5 years on private insurance"

↳ @betoxyz68 (1): "@detroitgator1im a health insurance agent and licensed in multiple states."

"I don't know what we will do, we have the Silver plan at 700 a month and a 12 000 deductible. My husband is a retired firefighter and I retired from the school system early to take care of my mom because nursing home care is terrible. At 63 years old just trying to hang on until Medicare age. My husband still works doing tile work to supplement his pension. Adding up our cost for insurance including home, cars etc we almost pay 1500 month for what if's. Gotta have it aa my husband has had a couple blood clots. Kinda worried to be honest."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh72uuz/

"I am surprised you didn't come talk to me about this. I think I was on the bleeding edge of this back in 2017 when I retired. Not many knew about this but I did and took it as my early retirement wild card. I budgeted \$1000/month for health insurance back then. I paid under \$100/month for the past 8 years. That's \$900/month budgeted for and available for cruises ;) Retirement is good. Now that the cat is out of the bag I hope it doesn't go away too soon. 4 more years is all I need to get to 65 and Medicare :D Lotsa cruises I can do between now and then on that \$900/month!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzByKtz9x11dgh1A6h4AaABAq

"Tomorrow is my retirement anniversary date. 3 years retired now, currently age 60. Been using ACA Bronze plans each year so far. I manage my reportable income so that the premium for the bronze plan has been fully subsidized. It is high deductible insurance, but thats ok for me as I usually only see my doctor for the annual physical. I max out an HSA too, whichh helps lower my MAGI. Ive even been able to do some small Roth conversions while still keeping my MAGI in check. I hope to keep doing this the next 5 years until medicare age. Hopefully ACA is not killed off by politicians. This year I am very aware of the income cliff."

— YouTube · \$1Can Destroy Your ACA Subsidy in Early Retirement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Th4776liNeM&lc=Ugyfy8xDPCjPA67Owmx4AaABAq>

↳ @keithgilbert835 (1): "Congratulations! Thanks for sharing"

"FIRED in NY State. Seeking advice for a decent health plan Worked overseas in Asia for two and a half decades and had the opportunity (and luck) to retire early with decent savings and investments. Early-50s, no wife (yet), no kids (yet)- minimal expenses as I own my apartment, my biggest expense is essentially healthcare. I do volunteer work with NYCHA, the Y, and a few ambulance corps in NYS (Im a paramedic). I am on 3-4 brand name prescription meds and see 2-3 specialists but more importantly, i was raised by paranoid boomers & silencers who drilled that "comprehensive health insurance is the difference between a stress-free life and Skid Row" so I always try to buy the best insurance I can find rather than follow their example and work until im either dead or incapacitated (if only for the insurance bennies). I couldn't find anything decent on the NY Health Exchange - something that I could keep my doctors at Mount Sinai and Weil-Cornell-NYP - so right now I am buying a plan (Cigna Elite PPO) through a broker that put me into a union. Very confusing but apparently legal. The cost is ~ \$2,000/month and I still fight tooth and nail for many procedures (and it doesn't cover vision, dental, mental health...) and it still has a \$1500 deductible and \$50/\$100 + co-pays up the wazoo... I also worry that if a catastrophe does occur, how will this "Cadillac plan through a union" pan out after year one or two? I have heard advice ranging from 1. "take a Bronze plan make sure you have good catastrophic coverage, do everything else in Asia or somewhere with normal pricing, youll save a ton of money" 2. "move your residence to where your family members live (Florida, Connecticut, Hawaii, Michigan) but honestly I prefer to keep my NYC residence. 3. "cancel all of that. wait until you qualify for Medicare. And pray you are still alive and healthy and Medicare still exists." Is there a better route to decent coverage for someone who doesnt qualify for Medicaid but needs decent health care for various ailments (normal for 50+ year olds) and does not have a retirement benefit? Thanks for any info."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjeidw/fired_in_ny_state Seeking advice for a decent/

↳ BaltimoreBee (14): "It's definitely not legal to "put you in a union" to get a private PPO plan. You're being scammed and put in some illegal plan that hasn't been shut down by the government yet. You should definitely have a real ACA plan if you want to protect your assets. Your pathway is to purchase something from the NY exchange...you CAN find something decent, millions of NY'ers do."

↳ WishIWasThatClever (5): "Having recently gone through this process in florida, I had the best success with the following process: 1. Make a list of which companies offer plans on the exchange. 2. Do a high level screening to determine which insurers are accepted at the good facilities. For example, I know where I'd go if I ended up with cancer. And most ACA insurers aren't accepted there. 3. Download the CSV file of ACA plans into Excel. Delete all rows except for those in your county, state. Then keep only the rows for the insurer(s) identified in step 2. At this point, I had about 140 rows in my Excel file. 4. Next I started modeling annual expense scenarios by adding columns to the file and using equations. $12 \times \text{annual premium} + 4 \text{ pcp visits} + 1 \text{ specialist visit} \dots$ etc etc. Use whatever scenario fits your past medical usage. 5. Then do Rx. Figure out the Good Rx annual cost, local mom and pop cash price, and cost with insurance. Then add the lowest value here to what you determined in step 4. 6. Calculate the five year total cost of ownership. I assumed four "normal" years to one OOP Max year. You do what makes sense for your health and history. So $4 \times \text{value from Step 5} + \text{OOP Max}$. As you go through this process, it will become wildly obvious which plans to eliminate. So I kept filtering out more and more rows until I ended up with a bronze BCBS plan that was the best balance of recurring cost and risk."

↳ BunchMaleficent486 (2): "Good luck! I'd suggest getting a small business going, an LLC with a partner and use that business to get small group coverage that will cost you less than what you're paying now and it's "real insurance"; not the stuff you have now. Your parents would NOT approve of your current coverage which may not be there if needed."

"I put the details for my state, for 3 people, my wife, me and my kid who is 10 years. When I keep the income low enough like 50K per year, then my child is getting excluded from coverage and it is asking me to get coverage from medicaid and chip for my child alone. Both of us are able to get coverage through ACA though. I don't want to exclude my child from coverage. So assume, I artificially inflated my income to 80K so that my child will get covered by ACA. Now subsidies will become less during the year, that is fine. But later on when I file the actual income taxes, can I reduce the income to 50K so that I get back those lost subsidies? Since the plan year is already over, will there be any issues that I didn't opt for medicaid and chip for my child and impact any future applications for coverage? I want to keep repeating the same until both my wife and I get to 65 and can get medicare and also keep my child covered through ACA. So basically inflate income during application to keep child covered, then reduce income during actual filing to get subsidies back. Thanks."

— YouTube · How to Qualify for ACA Health Insurance Subsidies as an Early Retiree · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cDtnJs9uN7M&lc=UgzKjczehPm-IR9PBEI4AaABAg>

↳ @dking1362 (1): "I live in IN and am no expert. However, the expert I consulted told me it is much easier and less costly to estimate your income on the low side and then adjust on your taxes than the reverse (I'm talking within a few thousand dollars.) I have to wonder if you would raise red flags if you followed this plan to inflate your income over multiple years. It seems a bit sketchy just listening to it, as you want to be intentionally dishonest about your income? Wouldn't your child be eligible for the most possible coverage through medicaid, if he qualifies? Sounds like a situation for some professional advice. Good luck."

↳ @pathkris2984 (0): "@dking1362 Thanks for your thoughts. When I say inflate income during retirement it is hypothetical during planning the prior year. I can choose to say withdraw 80K from a taxable IRA or I can choose to withdraw 30K from a Roth IRA (or use after tax funds from savings) and then only draw 50K from a taxable IRA - thereby keeping taxable income lower. Not sure if there is anything dishonest here, except that I decide to change my mind on what proportions I withdraw from various retirement accounts. Note that this only during the retirement phase and not during working years. Medicaid or chip gets into assets, while ACA planning works only on income received in the future year."

↳ @dking1362 (0): "@pathkris2984 gotcha! good luck"

"Additional Video with more detail examples of when to use ACA vs COBRA...when transitioning into Retirement / Medicare. My specific example is --> My Birthday is January 5. My Spouse's Birthday is March 25. I'm 1 Year and 3 Month older than my Spouse. Spouse is currently Working...but on my Insurance. Spouse will Retire in March 2027 at age 62. I WANT to Retire in the Fall of 2027. We can "control" our Income numbers for the first 3 years (2027, 2028, 2029)...BUT I will need to pull "some" cash from Retirement Accounts AND I would like to do some ROTH Conversions during that time period. As of today, my COBRA would cost us about \$2K per Month! Trying to figure out how to setup Insurance for the Fall Months when we both are retiring in 2027 (COBRA?)...when we are both Retired but NOT 65 (ACA?)...and when we are "split" - 1 under 65 (ACA?) and one at 65 (Medicare)? [NOTE: Waiting to see how Extended ACA Subsidies "issue" is handled to see what my actual ACA costs would/will be in 2027]"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGp_c_fE&lc=UgxEPT2jooXZ-q46VSI4AaABAg

"Yes, your plan seems solid at this point, so hope everything works out until Medicare kicks in. I retired last year due to "Fork in the Road" in Federal government. I took the DRP plus VERA offer in Feb'2025 and left my job after 25 years of federal service. I am only 51, but fortunately I have my federal health insurance and pension. I also have a few decent taxable accounts, so I am doing ok until I can withdraw from my federal 401k at 59.5. I enjoyed your videos, keep up the good work."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3I_3XBgfCw&lc=Ugy2B2ZhBsvUp1a0HSB4AaABAq.AZ94-k1SdRCAZBt9GcKTh2

"I will turn 62 this year & be eligible for social security but unfortunately this added income will make me \$80 over the yearly income cliff & I'll LOSE my Obamacare tax credits. So no social security for me! 🙄 Hope I live to age 65 to get Medicare & apply for social security then. 🙏"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwNTsFvMoF_pxZBxKZ4AaABAq

Health care that isn't tied to a job · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Paxlovid \$1600? Anthem ACA in Indiana is pretty terrible -- the cheap "negotiated rate" for 5 days of the anti-COVID medication paxlovid is nearly \$1600. I'm skipping it since I can't afford it even with the \$1000 one-time use coupon from Pfizer. The whole year has been basically Anthem denying all my medications or offering a price that's way higher than those weird "discount cards" like GoodRx. Pretty terrible. Anyone else angry yet are ready for actual universal health care? I retired early and this is literally the only insurance plan available to me in my state. These insurance company scammers and big pharma scammers need to be fixed. Things are getting unsustainable. I understand that there's an active movement to dismantle and destroy ACA without any replacement, so that's part of the problem, but really we need actual universal healthcare and to tear down the existing scam organizations."

— r/HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj8crd/paxlovid_1600/

↳ Bogg99 (20): "The same drug manufacturers sell these drugs in other countries for significantly less money. There was a piece of legislation that would cap drugs developed in the US for being sold here for more money than other countries. It would have single handedly saved Medicaid/Medicare billions of dollars. Republicans voted against it."

↳ Turbulent-Pay1150 (18): "No anger with the drug manufacturer who set the price?"

↳ The_Derpy_Walrus (15): "Health history plays no role in ACA insurance plans."

"Dang if only we had some Medicare for all"

— r/obamacare · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uqz4tb/how_much_and_why_aca_marketplace_premiums_are/owc0j14/

"We need Medicare-For-All/A single payer healthcare system here in the United States, especially during this time with the Coronavirus pandemic! What is more "Pro-Life" than ensuring that every person in America has guaranteed affordable healthcare regardless of their job or social status? Also, if we all had access to basic healthcare, we would all have the "freedom" to live long lives and rarely have to worry about medical bankruptcies. Sure, taxes will go up, but the overall cost will go down so much that everyone will be paying less and saving thousands of dollars every year. Furthermore, if some of us need additional healthcare than Medicare, then we have the "choice" to get additional insurance, but for others Medicare would be more than enough. Finally, if every other developed country (Canada, Germany, the United Kingdom, France, Italy, Sweden, Norway, Denmark, the Netherlands, Switzerland, Japan, South Korea, Australia, and New Zealand) can implement this system and save money, then why can't the United States do the same and help "Make America Great Again" for everybody at least on the issue of healthcare? Oh, and if American citizens die from lacking access to affordable health insurance because the Republicans believe that the government shouldn't provide it then we are failing our country's promise of defending "life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness" for its citizens as well as "promoting the general welfare" of all the people."

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=UgzfpC1om_phrxaXD0B4AaABAg

↳ @DoubleDown310 (2): "Why would they do that, when they can squeeze every penny out of every single American?"

↳ @dvran (1): "Americans wanted capitalism; here you go. Greedy healthcare companies making shareholders happy, large corporations taking over ... it's all to make more billionaires."

↳ @BeatTheBush (1): "@momosan11 I wish but I don't see that happening any time soon. Reform is hard when you have such an ingrained system that will have big money behind to resist it."

"I was a child in the 1960s, we never had insurance and we were considered middle class. My family didn't get insurance coverage until the 70s when my mom married my stepdad, who had a professional job that included health insurance. Single payer is what we need. The people who are against it are morons."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=Ugz_0Oc6lTTwAyxDRrZ4AaABAg

"Yeah that's nuts, I don't even both with health insurance in Canada because everything I need is covered through our universal system"

— YouTube · How to Get Health Insurance When Self-Employed · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G eUdFzjUKcw&lc=UgzjfKyoLQkGH0o59QJ4AaABAg.9bXdQ-x8Xnr9bXxfuDSA8A>

"We need single-payer healthcare/ Medicare for All. My partner and I are both going to be self-employed and we will both use the Marketplace. We will each spend a crap ton of money on health insurance, because neither of us want to work for an employer (we both want to be self-employed). It is sooooo expensive. Hopefully we will each make enough money to be able to pay for it in the long run. This health insurance issue is a major reason why people do not create their own business... If more people could afford healthcare, I'm convinced more people would become self-employed. Each of us will have a very very high deductible (something like \$13-14k) and spend a little under \$500 per month or almost \$500 per month EACH on our health care premium. It is insane. Other countries provide free healthcare— sure they may have to pay more in taxes but it just seems to make more sense than what is happening here. People shouldn't have to get married to someone who works for a regular employer to be able to afford health insurance."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/w3xbi0/what_do_you_do_for_health_insurance/ihapuo1/

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

A spouse's job or health deciding the coverage · 79 documents · 20 voices

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>

↳ (0): "Premiums just went through the roof! Judging by estimated cost increases and comparing to what we've been paying ... yeah, I'd say that's about right. I would definitely call someone tho!"

↳ (0): "Welcome to the new normal. Pay or die"

↳ (0): "In America it's 'pay and still die'."

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1h8c09I/>

↳ (0): "The US is the only country that ties your health insurance to your job. That alone is stunning. Then .. the decision whether you get care or not is made by a for-profit corporation. That is unacceptable."

↳ (0): "Yup! Hurricane Helene hit and my doctors in Sylvia and Asheville were unreachable. Called UHC and was told I could go south into GA (out of state) for the remainder of my pregnancy and it to worry about a thing. This was wonderful as the doctors in GA were only 30 mins away compared to the 4-8 hour, 200+ mile round trip they had me doing. That was on October 2nd, I called the GA doctor immediately and was told the soonest they could get me in was October 29th at 7am so I waited, I also scheduled a ride through UHC via 'motiv care' because i can't drive. October 28th, 6:15pm. UHC calls me to tell me that they were unable to secure me a ride and that they would pay for the gas. Very useful for someone who doesn't drive, and only gave me less than 12 hours (less really since you know most people aren't awake at night) to find an alternative ride. At this point I haven't seen anyone since September... My husband was able to get time off work to drive me (thank god). I got the the office and told me it was \$600 and my insurance wasn't going to cover it. I assumed this was going to be one of those call to straighten things out so I called UHC while in the lobby. It was then, and ONLY then.. did UHC inform me that my ability to go out of state for care had a time limit which was October 21st, 8 days short of the soonest the doctor could see me. They failed to both notify me or the doctors office about this. My baby has a chance to have Down syndrome and lacking 2 months of care already was hard enough and putting my baby at risk, I then asked what to do, where to go and what doctor I could see. UHC told me repeatedly to 'just go to the ER' over and over again. Refusing to do anything else despite the fact that going to the ER would do absolutely NOTHING. I returned home having panic attacks and had to rest. I woke up and called back again demanding that they either withhold their verbal contract OR have me see a doctor in NC that isn't in a disaster zone or have me go through one. There is not a single doctor in WNC that I can see, they verbally confirmed this. They also confirmed that indeed, no one from UHC informed anyone about the first end date for 'out of state care'. The agent informed me I would get a case manager and that it would likely be simple as extending the prior approval. BUT because it was filed in a grievance report, it would possibly take up to 30 days to get a reply.. this was October 29th, 2 months without seeing anyone and now forced to wait longer. I called weekly and got no update and told to wait. None of my begging and pleading over for fact that at that time I was 8 months going on 9 months changed anything. I then by a miracle had my Asheville doctor pop up who was doing special ultrasounds to look for physical check marks say I had an appointment on the 21st of November and I took it and was able to get a ride. At that point my baby was not doing so great, small abdomen and needed to be induced soon. But without knowing WHERE, I decided to schedule another ultra sound on December 4th to see if he would slip off the growth chart or improve and give UHC time to tell me where I was going.. NOVEMBER 27th, I received my update. My update? Nothing, if you want to go out of state have your primary care provider to recommend an out of service provider. I had to ask numerous times because my brain broke about this.. That I was previously approved That I have no doctor in my area that aren't in a disaster zone But

they needed me to do the leg work to get seen at 9 months pregnant with 1 week, less than 5 business days to figure it out. Best they could do was file another grievance report that would take another 30 days... Called my pcp asap and got them to work on getting the referral UHC apparently 'needed' and I also called my pregnancy advocate who would call UHC herself and see if she could help. My pcp got the referral in on December 4th. My ultrasound showed my baby was stunted in growth and needed induction asap. My pregnancy advocate was able to get a hold of UHC care management team who was helping set up for GA and assured me they were going to get me in there. December 5th. I was denied the ability to go to the doctor in GA that was 30 mins away because I needed to be induced so soon and they refused to induce unless they got to see me first before hand leaving an availability next week, way too late. So onto the next option. Sylvia, 2 1/2 hours away. They also denied me because they haven't seen my since September.... So my pregnancy advocate who was working with the UHC care management team told me that my only option now. Was to drive 4 1/2 hours to downtown Asheville to give birth... to just show up and tell them you're here to induce and you'll be taken care of.... And that the UHC management would call me to ensure transportation. UHC never reached out. I had to figure out how to get a 4 1/2 hours drive on my own in less than 24 hours... I got a ride to the hospital, got there and was told .. who are you? Why are you here? Who sent you? We don't have any rooms? Had to wait 3 hours to finally get situated into a room... Still here and working on popping this baby but the amount of stress, panic and tears I had to go through because UHC refused to get off their lazy ass and put my baby at risk was not fun. — — — Also to add, I had a driver from motiv care got a speeding ticket while I was in the car, have the car break down in front of my house and under UHC direction had it towed after two weeks with no one reaching out.. Then had the driver threaten my life if I didn't get his car back that night.. it took 9 hours of me having panic attacks and crying my eyes out for them to go beyond just filing a grievance report. I was 6 months pregnant at the time. Another time I had to drive in a car, 5 months pregnant for 6 hours round trip with a driver who's entire car reeked of marijuana. When on my return ride it was obvious it freshly smoked... Filed a report and UHC and motiv care told me they couldn't say for sure if it was the driver or a previous rider so nothing would be done...."

↳ (0): "Commenting here for visibility of your comment because this has left me absolutely speechless. Imaging pushing paper in a DISASTER. What the actual fuck? I am so sorry!!"

"I'm terrified of losing my Obamacare I'm a one issue voter. I want to keep my Obamacare. Having this allowed me and my husband to quit our terrible soul sucking jobs and start small businesses. It's not perfect and it costs a lot but it's been a life saver. Literally. Now that you know what happened, will I have to get another horrible job that destroys my will to live just to have health insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,425 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1gkt285/>

↳ (0): "Same boat here. We run a small business that employs four people, my husband is a working owner, I do the books. I also do freelance bookkeeping part time for two other businesses. I left a high stress job on the doctor's recommendation. It had no benefits anyway. We are in a tiny town, not many jobs here, much less with benefits. Plus I'm 60 years old with a chronic health condition. Husband has rheumatoid arthritis. Without our ACA plan we are done. Premium would be \$3074 a month non subsidised price. I could foresee us closing the business and putting people out of work so my husband can seek a job with benefits. I'm sorry this is not the way America is supposed to work."

↳ (0): "I would say that anyone who has signed up for a 2025 plan is probably grandfathered in simply because it is ingrained in the health care system so much at this point. By the time Trump is taking office, people's new plans for the year will have already started and even they know the chaos it would cause to try to cancel things immediately. So I'm guessing that for the 2025 year anything that anyone gets for pretty much stay as is. After that however well, we know what they want to do. Speaker Johnson has said as well as several Republican senators that their main goal or at least one of their main goals is to get rid of the ACA. In the past when they tried it, ultimately the supreme Court stopped them telling them they didn't have the authority to do it. The only thing the supreme Court in the past sided with them on was repealing the mandate that required everyone to get a plan to help pay for the system. Everything else they left intact. Since that time however, Trump has put four of his own people in the supreme Court. So I can't imagine they would not side with him now when they approach them about this. The fact that Republicans gained two seats in the Senate and now will have control of the Senate only heightens the possibility that this is going to happen. So again, I think 2025 might be pretty much as is, but after that I would expect sweeping negative changes to health care in this country. No more ACA. A great reduction in the number of people they allow to qualify for Medicaid, etc. The unfortunate thing is even after 4 years and he's gone, he will have put so many people in high position places, this stuff will go on for decades after he's gone. Welcome to the new America folks."

↳ (0): "I'm extremely worried about this because I will lose access to mental health medications that keep me alive and sane. Please, if anyone has any advice or insight on how to keep access to the mental health medications i desperately need please let me know. I am terrified this is going to actually kill me."

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>

↳ (0): "We're in a similar situation. We pay over 20,000 a year for a high deductible plan on my husband's policy. We've explored alternatives, including purchasing coverage for me through the Marketplace; but our most "affordable" option is to stay on his plan because it is based on pre-taxed income. We've also tried the pay out of pocket approach, and I had a minor health emergency, which cost several thousand. We decided that going uninsured with little children is too risky."

↳ (0): "... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."

↳ (0): "1700/month here...basically same exact situation you are in. My wife is just like your husband. My employer pays for employee 100%, as soon as I add my family, wife, 2 kids....1700/month...vision, dental,

included. Eastern PA. I've been fighting this for over 10 years with my employer. I love my job, but each year with this nonsense, it gets harder and harder to argue it's worth staying. My mortgage is 1300/month. Good luck, as all I have ever been told is get a new job."

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s4qs2m/>

↳ (0): "Your husband absolutely needs to find a different new job or you do. Going without insurance is way too risky"

↳ (0): "Try to think of it this way: you can't afford not to have insurance through your employer. Also, you're not going to get much sympathy about having to pay 840 per month for 3 people."

↳ (0): "I saw you commented below you have a combined household income of roughly \$93,000. I don't know what zip code you live in, but just picking a random zip code in Kansas City, there are multiple bronze plans for both your husband and daughter in the range of \$550 per month. I believe you may be entering something in on healthcare.gov incorrectly. If your employer does not offer 'affordable' insurance per the ACA-guidelines, you could also qualify for ACA subsidies as well"

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: <https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>;

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

"The government should really open up Medicare with reasonable premiums for those 55 -65. Age discrimination is preventing a lot of people from getting hired these days. Even ACA is costing me 1K a month for me and spouse. My spouse's work insurance was much more expensive. My COBRA just ended after I lost my job 18 months ago and it was 1500 a month going up to 2K this year. I stayed on COBRA because we already satisfied the max out of pocket and it was good insurance."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Retire Before 65 · 72 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l8VY8AcaLww&lc=UgxUWCq0OC_S-rSQahN4AaABAg

↳ @DesigningRetirement (2): "Health sharing ministries like Medishare, Samaritan Ministries, and Christian Healthcare Ministries are an option some people use, but it's crucial to understand what they are and aren't before making this choice - especially for people over 50. What they are: Member-based cost-sharing programs where members contribute monthly "shares" that are used to pay each other's medical expenses. They're often significantly cheaper than ACA plans (\$300-500/month vs. \$800-1,500+) and are based on shared religious values and community support. What they're NOT: Insurance. They have no legal obligation to pay your medical bills. If the ministry determines your situation doesn't meet their guidelines, you're responsible for the full bill - and you have no legal recourse. Critical limitations for people approaching or in retirement: 1. Pre-existing conditions: Most health sharing ministries don't cover pre-existing conditions at all, or impose waiting periods of 1-3+ years. For people over 50, the vast majority have at least one pre-existing condition - high blood pressure, high cholesterol, diabetes, previous surgeries, arthritis, etc. If you develop cancer, need heart surgery, or face other major medical needs related to a pre-existing condition, your bills may not be "shared." 2. No guarantee of payment: If the ministry determines your situation doesn't qualify (didn't follow protocols, didn't get pre-approval, condition isn't "shareable" per their guidelines), you pay the full bill. There's no insurance commissioner to appeal to, no legal protection. 3. Coverage exclusions vary widely: Many exclude mental health care, some exclude certain cancer treatments, some require you to try lower-cost treatments first, some won't share bills if you didn't get pre-approval. You must read the specific guidelines carefully - not the marketing materials, but the actual sharing guidelines. Real-world outcomes - both exist: Some people use health sharing ministries for years successfully, paying for routine care and minor issues at much lower monthly cost than insurance. Other people have been left with \$50,000-200,000+ in medical debt when the ministry denied their shares for cancer treatment, heart surgery, or other major expenses - often after treatment has already occurred, when they're most vulnerable. Where they might work: Healthy people under 50 with no pre-existing conditions People with strong religious convictions about community-based sharing People who have financial resources to self-pay if shares are denied Very short-term bridge situations (though risky) Where they're dangerous: People over 50 (very high likelihood of health issues) Anyone with chronic conditions or health history People who can't afford large unexpected medical bills Anyone facing major illness (exactly when you need guaranteed coverage) My honest perspective: For most people over 50 navigating the gap before Medicare, I strongly encourage sticking with ACA-compliant insurance despite the cost. The guaranteed coverage of pre-existing conditions and legal consumer protections are worth the premium difference when you're at the age where major health issues become more likely. If ACA premiums feel truly unaffordable, explore subsidies based on current income (not last year's - this trips people up), Medicaid eligibility if income is low enough, or working with a healthcare navigator to find the most affordable ACA-compliant option. If you're still considering health sharing ministries: Read the actual sharing guidelines (not marketing materials) - understand exactly what is and isn't shareable Assume you'll need to self-pay for major illness - if you can't afford that risk, don't take it Understand you have no legal recourse if shares are denied Consider your age and health realistically - any pre-existing condition puts you at significant risk The monthly savings aren't worth six-figure medical debt if shares are denied when you need them most. That said, I respect that some people have used them successfully and are comfortable with the risks. Just make sure you understand what you're accepting before making this choice, because the

consequences of getting it wrong are severe."

↳ @patriot2510 (0): "medicare would go bankrupt in one month"

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

↳ (0): "This happens more often than people realize, and no, you are not crazy. Agents or lead generators are motivated by sales. Your agreement and signature are required. What probably occurred is a Marketplace enrollment was completed without your informed consent, often by a third-party agent or lead generator out of need to meet quotas or just greed. Checking eligibility alone does not authorize enrollment. Actual enrollment requires affirmative plan selection and attestation. If that did not occur, this is improper enrollment. Here is what you do, in order. First, call Ambetter immediately and demand the following in writing: • The original application • The agent or broker of record • The date and method of enrollment • The address used and who supplied it • Whether premium tax credits were applied Tell them explicitly you dispute the enrollment as unauthorized and demand a retroactive cancellation to the effective date. Use the phrase unauthorized enrollment without consent. That language matters. Second, contact HealthCare.gov and request a Marketplace case escalation. Ask them to flag the policy as fraudulent enrollment. This is not customer service. This is an eligibility integrity issue. Third, file a complaint with your state Department of Insurance. This creates regulatory pressure and forces documentation. Insurers and agents move fast once DOI is involved. Fourth, protect your tax position. If any premium tax credit was applied, you need a corrected 1095-A showing zero coverage. Otherwise the IRS assumes you accepted subsidized coverage and will claw it back. Fifth, do not pay the bills until the dispute is resolved. Paying can be construed as ratification. Key point: Using your old address is a red flag. That usually indicates data scraping or recycled lead enrollment, not a consumer-initiated action. This is not your fault. It is fixable. But it must be handled surgically and documented. If Ambetter or the Marketplace resists, escalate again and document everything. Paper trails win these cases. In many cases the threat to Department of Insurance is enough."

↳ (0): "CSR from Ambetter here. We do not have the enrollment information that you mention. Only the plan, aptc, effective date and information of the identity of the subscriber. What I do when I receive a call like this is that I call the marketplace and I assist the member to initiate a HICS case for fraud with the rep of marketplace sharing the enrollment dates we have on the system. An investigation is made by a case worker, and once the source it's confirmed was fraudulent they claim back the APTC sent to the health plan, the plan is retroactively cancelled and member receives a letter of termination from the health plan. 9 out of 10 times the fraud is confirmed. The exceptions happen because member did sign up and granted consent to a broker and forgot about it for the rewards card which the brokers did activities and the like so the member could get a few dollars, but I don't expect to see that happen because fewer people qualify for the Silver 94% plan with 0 member responsibility. To avoid that we now have to ask a \$5 dollars payment per month for those accounts that is refunded at the end of the year. Crazy stuff."

↳ (0): "You need to make two calls. One to the insurance commissioner in your state and ask for their help. Second call CMS and make a complaint, ask for the issue to be resolved."

"Bronze HSA vs other plans, what am I missing? I'm looking at the plans available for my wife and I for a potential early retirement, the options don't really make sense to me. Comparing the Bronze HSA plan to the Silver, Gold and Platinum plans it seems that the Bronze HSA plan premium plus the out of pocket maximum is cheaper, or similar to just the premium of the gold and platinum plans? Why would anyone opt for those plans when they could be at the OOP maximum on the Bronze for less money? Even looking at the Silver plans the premium plus the deductible is similar / less than the Bronze HSA OOP maximum. And the fact that the Bronze HSA plan qualifies you for an HSA is just gravy. You can cover most of your medical expenses tax free. So why do the gold and platinum tiers exists? This is for two people near 60 in California under 400% FPL. Maybe the numbers don't look so weird for people in other circumstances?"

— r/obamacare · 21 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pzpu11/>

↳ (0): ">So why do the gold and platinum tiers exists? Risk tolerance. If you're a healthy active 19-yr-old that is unlikely to get ill and rarely need any healthcare (except for those "hey y'all watch this" moments) then you'll save a ton of money with cheap Bronze plan premiums. For that person it's an easy answer. If your health is "meh" and you're not sure how the year is gonna go, do you take a risk with a Bronze or do you go for, say, a Silver and hope that things go your way? Probably the Silver. But if your health is total crap and you 100% know you're gonna be bouncing off of the deductible and max OOP, then yeah you shoot for Gold or Platinum and get that initial OOP cost out of the way (and then save money after that with the difference between that a Bronze). For that person, too, it's an easy answer. I think your math is assuming that in all cases everyone will hit their deductible and/or max OOP, regardless of plan selected (e.g., "what is my maximum financial exposure"). That is just not the case. We're all different. So it comes down to, "do I feel lucky?" "Well, do ya, punk?"

↳ (0): "I had the option of getting a Bronze plan for 2 for \$17000 per year or a gold plan for \$32000 per year. The deductibles are \$6100 and \$1000. The max OOP for the bronze is \$7750. The max OOP for the gold is \$8500. So, with the bronze plan I pay \$17000 + \$7750 if the sh&t hits the fan and I max out on health needs. Total: \$24750. With the gold plan I pay \$32000 + \$8500 if the sh&t hits the fan. Total: \$40500. So, I'm better off with the bronze plan no matter how you slice it. We have to pay more until we hit our deductible but after that, it's pretty much the same. In the end, it's cheaper to have the bronze plan whether I use health insurance a lot or a little. YMMV"

↳ (0): "On the ACA you can plug in light use, medium use, heavy use and the Bronze plan wins every single time except if I have utter catastrophic issue and then I would pay \$900 more if I choose Bronze over Silver. However that doesn't factor in the money I save by funding the HSA, when you add that it it wipes out the difference and HSA wins every situation. Premiums+CoPays makes the other plans much more expensive. Plus when you see the actual price people tend to look for cheaper options if possible."

"Does choosing not to renew marketplace coverage count as a QLE for joining my wife's employer plan outside of open enrollment? My wife's job is a small business that offers a subsidized plan for employees and children of employees. They offer a plan for spouses as well, but it isn't subsidized, so in the past it has been a little more expensive than what I can find on the marketplace. Her open enrollment is in October and when I saw prices this year I assumed I would still be able to find it cheaper through the marketplace. However, marketplace prices were higher this time, but I didn't discover this until after open enrollment closed through her employer. So now I'm trying to figure out if choosing not to renew my marketplace plan would qualify me for a special enrollment period through her employer. I know many of the answers will be "you need to talk to her employer," which unfortunately is easier said than done. Since it is a small business, there is no HR department, there is only her boss (the general manager and one of the owners), and in the past her boss has dragged her feet on answering any insurance related questions until we were practically begging her to reach out to her agent the day before my daughter was going to lose coverage. So I'm trying to avoid asking her boss unless I absolutely need to. It is a BCBS of TN plan if that helps answer my question."

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pg1m66/>

↳ (0): "Probably not since loss of coverage must be involuntary. That said Open Enrollment is still available so you are lucky that you can still get ACA compliant insurance through the marketplace. The premium cost will depend on your income as well as whether you would have been able to get insurance through your wife that is affordable which for 2026 is 9.96% of income. Employers risk loss of tax deductible status for ALL employees if they don't adhere to Open Enrollment periods or if there is a genuine Qualifying Life Event"

↳ (0): "Unfortunatley no. QLEs mostly hinge on the gain of new coverage or the loss of eligibility to the old/existing coverage- you're still eligible to have a marketplace plan, you're choosing not to. It's not a QLE- it's considered a "voluntary" loss of coverage if you don't renew. For example if you got your coverage from your job and then left that job, you lost eligibility to be on the employer plan as an employee (since you're no longer an employee) THAT would be a QLE. If you thought there was a chance you might prefer your wife's coverage, you should have signed up for it- then, if you wanted a marketplace plan instead, you could have used that as a QLE (gain of new coverage) to then drop her work plan- but it doesn't really work backwards, unfortunately."

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1inzqe8/>

↳ (0): "The income limits for Medicaid for pregnant women and new children is much higher, once your child turns 1 the income requirements change, wife is no longer considered in the postpartum period. If your wife was pregnant, or had just recently had the baby (within the last 3 months usually) when you signed up for coverage then they most likely gave baby needy newborn coverage, and wife MAGI pregnant coverage. Children born to mothers on Medicaid get guaranteed eligibility till 1 year old under expanded medicaid rules. Once baby is a year old, child and mother go back to medicaid children, and medicaid adult guidelines. If you make 65k per year you earn too much. If they lost coverage you have the right to apply for marketplace coverage outside of open enrollment period with a qualifying life event. Edit- spelling Edit- I have seen and reported blatant Medicaid fraud on numerous occasions within my job, I've seen hundreds of cases of people 100% committing fraud without a doubt. Income gets reported and they call and say they quit, income is ended, a few months later same thing. I have seen 100s of income discrepancies on one case, client never asked to provide proof, or any information about income and the fact they are no longer employed. I've completed 100s of application, I've worked 1,000s of medicaid cases, never ever seen any fraud cases. Only fraud cases I've seen are with SNAP, which they seem to take much more seriously. Medicaid fraud is expensive for tax payers when it's committed by providers, it's not usually bothered with when committed by individuals. It sounds like your situation is very different, there is proof regarding what you did with the recorded phone call, and the marketplace application you submitted. I think you have no reason to worry about them coming after you for fraud."

↳ (0): "I've read Missouri Medicaid has terrible backups in processing. Just make sure you have records of your transactions with them. <https://missouriindependent.com/2024/06/17/feds-to-scrutinize-missouris-worst-in-the-nation-medicaid-application-delays/>";

↳ (0): "Well that's just it. I have no records. My application was done 100% over the phone with a representative who never requested any documents. She messed up over the phone. And six months later when I went to fill out a change in income form, I did it at their office and turned it in. And they have no records of that either so they don't have one document from me and they approved me. All I have is an application number from before I was approved. 100% verbal with zero documentation."

"COBRA denying everything? My company got sold at the end of last year, and we were all laid off. So I had a choice between going to the Marketplace or using (what I thought would be) a continuation of the same insurance under COBRA. I think it's a PPO or something like that, the higher priced one at work, with the lower deductible. The premium is viciously expensive either way, ACA or COBRA. We are older with pre-existing conditions, my spouse is self-employed, and now, so am I. A bronze plan would have been pointless. So COBRA seemed like the best decision for now. But nothing will go through. Nobody sent a different card or told me to call a different number. Am I missing something? They are turning down previously covered medications, they won't even pay for a dental bill, and the deductible is only \$50! (The COBRA included dental and vision coverage. I selected them all.) This was naturally far more expensive than my rent or any other monthly bill we've ever paid, and we'd love to be able to use it. We have had this insurance for years and it was never a problem, especially for prescriptions. Please tell me if I'm just missing something entirely. Thank you so much!"
— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1rah9t7/>

↳ (0): "Have you reached out to your COBRA administrator and make sure all the paperwork's were submitted correctly? Is your insurance saying your coverage is still active?"

↳ (0): "They must have messed up. Our COBRA operated identically to when we were employed, which is the law. worked great"

↳ (0): "What are the reasons that they're denying your claims?"

"It's a Catch-22. I need medical care to stay alive, but I need a W-2 job for high quality affordable medical care, but the job's killing me. I'm in my 40's, and I could afford to retire now if not for the health insurance issue. An ACA family plan is ridiculously expensive and all but the platinum plans are dog 🐕 (high premiums, very high deductibles, very high max OOP, and limited networks that don't cover the halfway decent docs and hospitals in my area). And the platinums are INSANELY expensive and still don't cover many of my needed specialists. And I can't build my HSA as I max out contributions and spending every year. I think my only hope is to try to find a super easy job (even if super low paying) with good benefits and see if I can survive another 7 years until our kids are all off the plan and my husband (self-employed) qualifies for Medicare. Or 5 years if I pay for COBRA for the last 2 years..."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwc78xLI9vI1PhI6QR4AaABAg>

"I think something will happen. I think enough for Republicans know that they will lose the house if they don't help the people with yet another Trump expense. Even then, I'm not sure they can hang onto it. Unlike Trump, many of them know how unaffordable surviving has become, well the ones that listen to their constituents know. I guess whether they care is TBD. He sure made sure the wealthy people got their tax cut in his big baby bill, nice and early. Meanwhile, the average American has had everything go up and health insurance is a biggie, some of these increases are huge and they simply can't afford it. Trump likes to threaten to primary people. Trump will be gone in roughly 3 years. He won't rule the GOP forever and that is a simple fact. And even as they try to gerrymander their way into forever wins, they aren't winning all of those and some are TBD. I also find it ironic that Trump always talks about states, states should take the burden of everything. He means everything financial because otherwise, he's still very much wants to tell them what to do. And this is where things get kind of muddy. We elect people to do this in that, but we also don't know what the laws say about what they want to do. I guess you could look them up, but they are painting pretty broad strokes at that point, it would be difficult to pinpoint laws. I didn't know that you could read district on a whim, I always thought it was done only after a census. I think things like this should be left to the people, as California did. If they didn't just ramrod it through, they went to the people and asked what they wanted. I use ACA as does my husband and it has remained affordable for us, but we do a lot of things with our income to keep from meeting that subsidy Cliff. We are self-employed and that is the only way we can get insurance. We cannot get Medicaid, we make too much. And honestly, I don't want it. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, we just can't afford to pay it all. We want to pay part of it. Many people don't realize they ended up on ACA just because of Covid. It wasn't just extended subsidies that were enacted during Covid, it also opened the ACA up to people making up to 700% of the poverty level, that is why the ACA ballooned and they too, got the extended subsidies. I have to wonder what they did before. But I do believe healthcare should be a right. If my husband doesn't have health insurance, he files for disability. He has to. Inherited a bad heart from both parents. His twin had a pacemaker at age 40. My husband had a stent at age 46 and a triple bypass at age 52. He's not overweight, he eats healthy, exercise exercises, but his blood pressure was always an issue and then things got worse. The triple bypass was about 300 K and there is no way we could've paid that. But if we get help with insurance, my husband gets to see his doctors, have his meds and continues to work. To me that seems like the better decision., To help with one thing to keep him off of being totally disabled. Sorry, I went on a rant, I get so stressed by all of this. All right, hike wasn't too bad but I still feel for the people that have had a huge rate hike. It's scary not having insurance. It's scary being hurt or sick and you can't go to the doctor. We are such a wealthy country and so damn great, yet people can't afford health insurance. Right there, that part alone, screams that America is not great."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pazpk6/aca_in_the_senate/nrn7tOf/

"Appreciate the info: I just looked at ACA plans for the first time last week. My wife and I are 24 months from being retired, and our combined pensions will make us ineligible for ACA subsidies (as they currently stand). Just understanding how much COBRA, ACA, or private insurance will cost us (we still have dependents under age 26), is a planning tool. If ACA cliff remains, we could end up paying \$200,000+ for health insurance between retirement and Medicare!,"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E&lc=Ugzvm7yxUJFtCV1gSbV4AaABAq>

↳ @EliavD-d5e (0): "Now I've hit \$270,590. I was having this exact conversation with my son the other night- generational wealth isn't just about getting money. It's about teaching everyone not only how to make it, but also how to maintain it. It does no good for me to provide for my family if they don't understand how to manage and sustain it."

↳ @JasonGoetze (0): "Well. A big thanks to Lady Charlotte Parnell - really appreciate her. She's honestly one of the smartest and most supportive people I've ever learned from. Her mindset and the way she explains things changed everything for me"

↳ @JoelDiaz-y6k (0): "What I like about her is her logic behind every undertaking and her ability to make a good profit regardless of the starting investment amount. Imagine having 30,850 from my 5,000 investment."

"Yes, because middle-aged people like generation X, which is what I am, we don't need healthcare at all. Because we have never been screwed when it comes to insurance. I'm tired of this young versus old battle. We are either in this together or we aren't. You pick if it's more important to do thing for your own generation or to do it for the most people possible, we both know which is the right answer I played the corporate game and made sure I got a pension, but I can't exactly draw off of that pension at age 38, which is when I left that company. I still had another 30+ years to work at that age. I didn't realize how lucky I was to have benefits like I did and I hated corporate America. I am not sad that I left and the ACA actually saved mine and my husband's ass as we are both self-employed. But I know we can do better. For all, not just for the young, you got plenty of time before you can even think of retirement."

— r/obamacare · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vd44zd/appalling_cruelty_and_al_i_to_fund_more_tax_cuts/p174eq9/

"Reporting income for ACA Hi all, My wife and I are self employed and applying for marketplace insurance. I've been told that as self employed people, our income should be our gross income minus business expenses. My question is, does the \$31,000 standard deduction (married filing jointly) and other deductions count towards this? I.E. if we pull in \$160,000 for the year, but take the \$31,000 deduction, is our income technically \$129,000? or does it only include business expenses such as office dues, supplies, etc? Is this as easy as just reporting the number on the Modified AGI line on last years tax return?"

— r/obamacare · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1owg2uk/>

↳ (0): "No. The standard deduction is calculated after your MAGI is determined."

↳ (0): "No. If your net after expenses is \$160k, it all counts towards AGI...can't reduce it with the standard deduction. Not sure if you are looking to lower your AGI to get under the cap, but if so consider looking at IRA or solo 401k contributions to get it down."

↳ (0): "No, MAGI is before the standard deduction. Assuming that is 160k net on your Schedule C and that is your only income your are at 498% of FPL for a family of 4. You need to get down to 128k in order to qualify for subsidies. You can do this if you have the cash to fund a combination of SEP (32K)+ IRA (7/8k) + Spousal IRA (7/8k)"

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/ngibrvo/

"The ACA helps people other than self-employed people too. Might wanna look into exactly who the ACA covers. And so sorry I'm self-employed, we built a small business, but that means I shouldn't have healthcare. We could always afford to pay some, we couldn't afford it all. And yes, I spent my years in corporate America, I got a pension before I was 40. But unlike a lot of sloth like Americans, I am not going to retire at age 38. And you also might want to look into the protections that the ACA has given anyone that has any kind of insurance, whether it be ACA, employer sponsored, Medicaid, Medicare, any of it. The most important one is the fact that insurance cannot deny you because of pre-existing health conditions. Another important one is your children can be on your health insurance until they are 26. A 3rd important one is that women, get a free wellness exam every year, no matter what their plan is-meaning deductibles, co-pay, out-of-pocket maximum. None of that matters, women get a free wellness exam, and that is what catches breast cancer, and other uterine cancers, cervical cancer , etc early and saves lives. I love how uneducated people are on what the ACA actually does. If it wasn't around, my husband would either be dead or on disability. Instead, he's still working at the business he built from the ground up, not once, but twice. Because we moved to a different state. Small businesses, entrepreneurship, all of that is part of the bedrock that is the American economy."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q5pt0g/congress_working_hard_on_passing_the_shower_act/ny286yi/

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

↳ wischywaschy (3): "I can't really help but I also have massive problems with IBX (self-funded plan) with an appeal process and the DOL is trying to help. IBX is a mess - it looks like they don't follow all ERISA regulations and seem very disorganized. The DOL is helpful but they are really short-staffed since they got DOGE'd, so whatever they can do for us is slow. They said to me they can do more when more people complain, so please

complain!"

↳ budrow21 (2): "I would file the appeals directly and continue working through the DoL. You don't have many other options."

↳ theoretalking (2): "Have you tried asking your employer's benefit manager and the broker to follow up with the account manager at IBX since she has not been responsive? The most people you got pushing and fighting for you, the better. sounds like you called your state's DOL? Try the US DOL here: <https://beta.dol.gov/about/agencies/ebsa/ask-ebsa> Have you tried looking up ERISA lawyers on Google? When I did that, I see a bunch lawyers that specialize in ERISA show up. It seems most (or not all) of them offer free consultation. I suggest you try that to find someone in your region."

Children on the plan, or left off it · 77 documents · 20 voices

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1h8c09I/>

↳ (0): "The US is the only country that ties your health insurance to your job. That alone is stunning. Then .. the decision whether you get care or not is made by a for-profit corporation. That is unacceptable."

↳ (0): "Yup! Hurricane Helene hit and my doctors in Sylvia and Asheville were unreachable. Called UHC and was told I could go south into GA (out of state) for the remainder of my pregnancy and it to worry about a thing. This was wonderful as the doctors in GA were only 30 mins away compared to the 4-8 hour, 200+ mile round trip they had me doing. That was on October 2nd, I called the GA doctor immediately and was told the soonest they could get me in was October 29th at 7am so I waited, I also scheduled a ride through UHC via 'motiv care' because i can't drive. October 28th, 6:15pm. UHC calls me to tell me that they were unable to secure me a ride and that they would pay for the gas. Very useful for someone who doesn't drive, and only gave me less than 12 hours (less really since you know most people aren't awake at night) to find an alternative ride. At this point I haven't seen anyone since September... My husband was able to get time off work to drive me (thank god). I got the the office and told me it was \$600 and my insurance wasn't going to cover it. I assumed this was going to be one of those call to straighten things out so I called UHC while in the lobby. It was then, and ONLY then.. did UHC inform me that my ability to go out of state for care had a time limit which was October 21st, 8 days short of the soonest the doctor could see me. They failed to both notify me or the doctors office about this. My baby has a chance to have Down syndrome and lacking 2 months of care already was hard enough and putting my baby at risk, I then asked what to do, where to go and what doctor I could see. UHC told me repeatedly to 'just go to the ER' over and over again. Refusing to do anything else despite the fact that going to the ER would do absolutely NOTHING. I returned home having panic attacks and had to rest. I woke up and called back again demanding that they either withhold their verbal contract OR have me see a doctor in NC that isn't in a disaster zone or have me go through one. There is not a single doctor in WNC that I can see, they verbally confirmed this. They also confirmed that indeed, no one from UHC informed anyone about the first end date for 'out of state care'. The agent informed me I would get a case manager and that it would likely be simple as extending the prior approval. BUT because it was filed in a grievance report, it would possibly take up to 30 days to get a reply.. this was October 29th, 2 months without seeing anyone and now forced to wait longer. I called weekly and got no update and told to wait. None of my begging and pleading over for fact that at that time I was 8 months going on 9 months changed anything. I then by a miracle had my Asheville doctor pop up who was doing special ultrasounds to look for physical check marks say I had an appointment on the 21st of November and I took it and was able to get a ride. At that point my baby was not doing so great, small abdomen and needed to be induced soon. But without knowing WHERE, I decided to schedule another ultra sound on December 4th to see if he would slip off the growth chart or improve and give UHC time to tell me where I was going.. NOVEMBER 27th, I received my update. My update? Nothing, if you want to go out of state have your primary care provider to recommend an out of service provider. I had to ask numerous times because my brain broke about this.. That I was previously approved That I have no doctor in my area that aren't in a disaster zone But

they needed me to do the leg work to get seen at 9 months pregnant with 1 week, less than 5 business days to figure it out. Best they could do was file another grievance report that would take another 30 days... Called my pcp asap and got them to work on getting the referral UHC apparently 'needed' and I also called my pregnancy advocate who would call UHC herself and see if she could help. My pcp got the referral in on December 4th. My ultrasound showed my baby was stunted in growth and needed induction asap. My pregnancy advocate was able to get a hold of UHC care management team who was helping set up for GA and assured me they were going to get me in there. December 5th. I was denied the ability to go to the doctor in GA that was 30 mins away because I needed to be induced so soon and they refused to induce unless they got to see me first before hand leaving an availability next week, way too late. So onto the next option. Sylvia, 2 1/2 hours away. They also denied me because they haven't seen my since September.... So my pregnancy advocate who was working with the UHC care management team told me that my only option now. Was to drive 4 1/2 hours to downtown Asheville to give birth... to just show up and tell them you're here to induce and you'll be taken care of.... And that the UHC management would call me to ensure transportation. UHC never reached out. I had to figure out how to get a 4 1/2 hours drive on my own in less than 24 hours... I got a ride to the hospital, got there and was told .. who are you? Why are you here? Who sent you? We don't have any rooms? Had to wait 3 hours to finally get situated into a room... Still here and working on popping this baby but the amount of stress, panic and tears I had to go through because UHC refused to get off their lazy ass and put my baby at risk was not fun. — — — Also to add, I had a driver from motiv care got a speeding ticket while I was in the car, have the car break down in front of my house and under UHC direction had it towed after two weeks with no one reaching out.. Then had the driver threaten my life if I didn't get his car back that night.. it took 9 hours of me having panic attacks and crying my eyes out for them to go beyond just filing a grievance report. I was 6 months pregnant at the time. Another time I had to drive in a car, 5 months pregnant for 6 hours round trip with a driver who's entire car reeked of marijuana. When on my return ride it was obvious it freshly smoked... Filed a report and UHC and motiv care told me they couldn't say for sure if it was the driver or a previous rider so nothing would be done...."

↳ (0): "Commenting here for visibility of your comment because this has left me absolutely speechless. Imaging pushing paper in a DISASTER. What the actual fuck? I am so sorry!!"

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1okz6n1/>

↳ (0): "OP didn't ask for guidance or request any answers. Locking before it spirals even further. Edit: Just to address OP's misguided frustration over the PPACA: In 2021, the Biden administration introduced *enhanced advanced premium tax credits* (eAPTCs) through the American Rescue Plan Act. They were further extended through the Inflation Reduction Act. Through these eAPTCs, folks beyond 400% of the federal poverty level could guarantee they'd spend no more than 8.5% of their household income on health insurance premiums through Marketplace (provided they chose a silver benchmark plan). The reason your subsidies are falling flat is because these enhanced subsidies are not being renewed. This is reason number one behind the government shutdown. One side wants to make these eAPTCs permanent. I'll let you deduce who that is. The PPACA didn't "make a bad situation worse". The current majority party has worked tirelessly to make it worse."

↳ (0): "Wait, how is \$2,925 per month \$60,000 per year?"

↳ (0): "Seems insurance going up regardless of subsidies"

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jqp09o/>

↳ (0): "The facility where the injury took place should cover it. If they somehow don't it needs to be appealed as urgent/emergent care and the insurance company will pay. A needle stick with a known dirty needle is an emergency. Out of network is normally waived for urgent emergent care."

↳ (0): "Any recommendation on who specifically (department?) to target on this? Seems everyone wants to pass the buck. I'd love to call someone and say "This is your problem to solve""

↳ (0): "Back when I was a medical student at a teaching hospital, needle-stick injuries were covered by the OSHA department of the hospital."

"My family's health insurance is set to go from \$170 per month in 2025 to \$1560 in 2026 due to expiring ACA credits. A few clarifying points: - I earn approx \$125k as the sole provider for my family of 4 - I am self employed - This is the cheapest possible plan I could find anywhere - Coverage for this plan is terrible and helps me exactly \$0 with our family's actual health expenses I don't even know how I'm supposed to form thoughts around this. I can barely breathe let alone wrap my mind around this. How the hell am I supposed to survive in this country the way it is now? It seems like the world is actively punishing people who have families, or anyone who is not a multimillionaire. This is just one problem in a cornucopia of financial disasters handed to me as a millennial parent. This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of the housing market and am doomed to ever increasing rent month after month, or how food costs have practically doubled for my family over the past 5 years. How bad is it to go without health insurance in the new year? I literally have no idea what else to do..."
— r/HealthInsurance · 776 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ohoyrp/>

↳ (0): "Additionally, under the new Trump administration ruling, medical debt will begin appearing on credit reports."

↳ (0): "Also self employed, family of 4, earn very close to your number. I paid 1800 a month in 2025. I'm expecting at least a 20% jump... But I still do everything I can to keep my insurance as I have seen people lose everything because they didn't have insurance and an unforeseen medical emergency came up... Also I'm trying to lower income as much as possible. I used to dream of clearing 100,000, now I dream of clearing like 80,000 or less..."

↳ (0): "Is it saying you qualify for zero credits now or just a low amount? You are right around the 400% FPL number so I wonder if what you put in put you right over that %. If so, it may be worth some \$ to talk to a tax professional about how to reduce your magi to get under that number and qualify for subsidies."

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."
— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pcor72/>

↳ (0): "We need basic universal healthcare."

↳ (0): "Yup. I'm in a similar boat. My insurance for my family went from \$800 to \$2700. I basically opted out. I can't afford it. Many many more Americans are hurting too. Stay strong."

↳ (0): "If anybody is in the boat where they find themselves not being able to afford it (absolutely no shame here.) Please try to still look for a catastrophic plan that covers emergencies. It's only going to cover emergencies and nothing else after deductible is met."

"Healthcare just went up from \$32,418 to \$40,632 per year. Family of 4 in NJ. Wife and I are self employed. We each have our own small businesses. We live in NJ and make a comfortable living to the extent that we don't qualify for any ACA subsidies. 5 years ago we were paying \$22,000 for the same plan. It has increased year over year. This is a big one."

— r/HealthInsurance · 585 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ospvcr/>

↳ (0): "That basically is mortgage"

↳ (0): "That's more than my family of 4 insurance AND my mortgage. That's just insane."

↳ (0): "We live in NV, married couple both self employed and on ACA, and our health insurance premium is 30% more than our mortgage. I expect this premium to be 3X our mortgage by the time we are 65."

"Lack of media interest in health insurance cost spikes We're a healthy family of three living in North Texas. Without the enhanced subsidies, our health insurance next year will be \$3,200 per month or about \$40,000 per year. I looked at the rundown of the Sunday news shows this AM, and no one seemed to be talking about the cost of health insurance, and none of the major newspapers had a story about it on their front pages. Am I overestimating the number of people that are going to be affected? It feels like this should be something news programs and newspapers should be covering with a little more urgency."

— r/HealthInsurance · 317 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1p552ho/>

↳ (0): "There's definitely been news stories over the subsidies ending - the NY Times ran a good story on this at the beginning of the shutdown, for example (gift link, no registration needed): [https://www.nytimes.com/interactive/2025/10/02/upshot/shutdown-obamacare-subsidies.html?unlocked_article_code=1.3k8.iTFX.-jFW_AJ-VZJ8&smid=url-share](https://www.nytimes.com/interactive/2025/10/02/upshot/shutdown-obamacare-subsidies.html?unlocked_article_code=1.3k8.iTFX.-jFW_AJ-VZJ8&smid=url-share) Ultimately there's a lot of news on it already - especially from the beginning of the recent shutdown - so I suspect that's a reason that many news organizations may not be publishing new stories. Because there isn't anything new to report on since nothing has changed at this point."

↳ (0): "You can reach out to your local reporter but it's been reported on"

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/>

↳ (0): "You can report any insurance carrier operating an aca marketplace plan to your state department of insurance."

↳ (0): "**Nevada Division of Insurance:** Northern NV (775) 687-0700 or Southern NV (702) 486-4009"

↳ (0): "Name and shame. Who is the insurance carrier? What exact plan did you purchase? Any plan documents you can share here to give us something to review and provide direction? Edit: This thread is kind of all over the place, but since this is a higher-level comment: Imperial *is* a legitimate, ACA-qualified carrier and this is a qualified health plan sold through Nevada Health Link, the state's official marketplace. What's more, since Imperial is a very small carrier with a narrow network, OP didn't have a choice and went to an OON emergency room. So it's crystal clear: Imperial hasn't "not paid anything"--they haven't even been billed for anything. The onus is now on OP to submit a super bill / claim directly to Imperial since this is an OON hospital with no mechanism to submit a claim on their behalf. Annoying, no doubt, but is necessary if they want to have any coverage for this encounter."

"There is no way this is correct , is it from NJ healthcare. Ok folks, my head is about to explode, I just got off the phone with NJgetcovered , plan jumped to \$2700 a month w 20K max oop. BUT what blows my mind is this, my son goes to college outside of NJ and according to get covered , I have to have him on my application BUT his policy (Horizon silver plan EPO plan) is only good in the state of New Jersey ! That can not be right can it, I am paying for health insurance for him but he "loses" it when he leaves the state???? He is a resident of NJ and we claim him on out taxes for at least one more year."

— r/HealthInsurance · 201 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1onh5id/>

↳ (0): "Need more information: * What's the gross household income? * How many folks are in the household (you, spouse, child(ren)? Marketplace plans are typically only workable in the state of origin, less plan's that have access to a national network, though these are increasingly uncommon. Your son would be covered in all 50 states for emergency medicine, but for routine care, it would be to be done at an in-network provider (which typically means someone in NJ). In small states / folks near border towns, it's possible that the network goes beyond state lines. Can't quite tell, though, based on the information provided. What state is your son's college in? Do they have any income?"

↳ (0): "Ok after spending several hours on the phone with insurance co I am screwed, Horizon offers a plan called away from home that in theory would extend him coverage but South Carolina opted out of it, he can not buy in SC because he is not a state resident and the school will not sell him a plan because he is graduating in May and lives off campus. My lovely plan will only cover life threatening items and who knows what that is until some review board decides it. Ah the USA health policies."

↳ (0): ">My lovely plan will only cover life threatening items and who knows what that is until some review board decides it Provided the reason for the visit to the ER rises to the "prudent layperson standard", coverage is in tact. Sniffles? Minor aches / pains? Not an ER visit. Sudden onset chest pain? A situation where your son believes they're at risk of losing life or limb? More reasonable to visit the ER. For all things non-emergency, your son can attempt to use telehealth through their insurance provider. For routine care (annual visits), your son can schedule those for the periods they're back in NJ."

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s4qs2m/>

↳ (0): "Your husband absolutely needs to find a different new job or you do. Going without insurance is way too risky"

↳ (0): "Try to think of it this way: you can't afford not to have insurance through your employer. Also, you're not going to get much sympathy about having to pay 840 per month for 3 people."

↳ (0): "I saw you commented below you have a combined household income of roughly \$93,000. I don't know what zip code you live in, but just picking a random zip code in Kansas City, there are multiple bronze plans for both your husband and daughter in the range of \$550 per month. I believe you may be entering something in on healthcare.gov incorrectly. If your employer does not offer 'affordable' insurance per the ACA-guidelines, you could also qualify for ACA subsidies as well"

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/>

↳ (0): "Health shares are NOT insurance."

↳ (0): "you're young and healthy with no preexisting conditions until you aren't. during a routine physical my doctor found a large mass on my thyroid. it happens in the blink of an eye."

↳ (0): "Healthshares are scams"

"Something is irreparably broken with the way things are right now. No way should my healthy, middle-class family of 5 be expected to pay \$3,000+/month for a high-deductible insurance plan with pitiful coverage that's not accepted by most quality providers. Even if the subsidies are extended, I still have a huge issue with government tax dollars being funneled to health insurance companies to pay for these ridiculously high premiums. We've had to switch to cash pay with no insurance in the past, and cash-pay prices are reasonable, especially as compared to what's billed to insurers."

— r/obamacare · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nmkopxl/

"Some people have a low literacy level. Or aren't proficient in English. Or have a mental disability. Or lack access to the Internet. Or just find selecting an ACA marketplace plan to be confusing. I have a bachelor's degree. I've been a SNAP and Medicaid eligibility worker for over a decade. I still found it difficult to assist my daughter with choosing a marketplace plan, and figuring out which plan would be best for her needs."

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbns7id/

"Does choosing not to renew marketplace coverage count as a QLE for joining my wife's employer plan outside of open enrollment? My wife's job is a small business that offers a subsidized plan for employees and children of employees. They offer a plan for spouses as well, but it isn't subsidized, so in the past it has been a little more expensive than what I can find on the marketplace. Her open enrollment is in October and when I saw prices this year I assumed I would still be able to find it cheaper through the marketplace. However, marketplace prices were higher this time, but I didn't discover this until after open enrollment closed through her employer. So now I'm trying to figure out if choosing not to renew my marketplace plan would qualify me for a special enrollment period through her employer. I know many of the answers will be "you need to talk to her employer," which unfortunately is easier said than done. Since it is a small business, there is no HR department, there is only her boss (the general manager and one of the owners), and in the past her boss has dragged her feet on answering any insurance related questions until we were practically begging her to reach out to her agent the day before my daughter was going to lose coverage. So I'm trying to avoid asking her boss unless I absolutely need to. It is a BCBS of TN plan if that helps answer my question."

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pg1m66/>

↳ (0): "Probably not since loss of coverage must be involuntary. That said Open Enrollment is still available so you are lucky that you can still get ACA compliant insurance through the marketplace. The premium cost will depend on your income as well as whether you would have been able to get insurance through your wife that is affordable which for 2026 is 9.96% of income. Employers risk loss of tax deductible status for ALL employees if they don't adhere to Open Enrollment periods or if there is a genuine Qualifying Life Event"

↳ (0): "Unfortunatley no. QLEs mostly hinge on the gain of new coverage or the loss of eligibility to the old/existing coverage- you're still eligible to have a marketplace plan, you're choosing not to. It's not a QLE- it's considered a "voluntary" loss of coverage if you don't renew. For example if you got your coverage from your job and then left that job, you lost eligibility to be on the employer plan as an employee (since you're no longer an employee) THAT would be a QLE. If you thought there was a chance you might prefer your wife's coverage, you should have signed up for it- then, if you wanted a marketplace plan instead, you could have used that as a QLE (gain of new coverage) to then drop her work plan- but it doesn't really work backwards, unfortunately."

"they big question i have is why are the premium so dang high with out ACA i have a family of 5 and we get crushed . we need to take a look at the real issue . these insurance companies are making record profits on us . and the government is helping subsidize it . we need to fix this system ."

— r/obamacare · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/nm42d26/

"It's a Catch-22. I need medical care to stay alive, but I need a W-2 job for high quality affordable medical care, but the job's killing me. I'm in my 40's, and I could afford to retire now if not for the health insurance issue. An ACA family plan is ridiculously expensive and all but the platinum plans are dog 🐕 (high premiums, very high deductibles, very high max OOP, and limited networks that don't cover the halfway decent docs and hospitals in my area). And the platinums are INSANELY expensive and still don't cover many of my needed specialists. And I can't build my HSA as I max out contributions and spending every year. I think my only hope is to try to find a super easy job (even if super low paying) with good benefits and see if I can survive another 7 years until our kids are all off the plan and my husband (self-employed) qualifies for Medicare. Or 5 years if I pay for COBRA for the last 2 years..."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wIGOZsc&lc=Ugwc78xLI9vI1PhI6QR4AaABAg>

"You need to separate ACA from this problem. Yeah, politicians beat that drum but it's not supported by actual facts. Go look at the FRED charts of expense growth. It accelerated well in advance of ACA. So, the costs have zero to do with ACA. And I have to say that my kids have signed up for ACA RATHER than the private insurance their companies offered (and one of them is in Healthcare) because the private insurance is absolute crap. Little coverage for more money."

— r/obamacare · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qr4vwl/how_is_it_possible_that_health_insurers_have_had/o2ln9u1/

"I'm retiring early, doing Roth conversions, and paying pretty much the full price for an ACA plan. I am very hopeful that this albatross of a program (the ACA) is either axed entirely, or means testing is put in place so that people with a net worth in the millions can't legally pay less for their healthcare plan than a working family of four, struggling to make ends meet. It is unconscionable, what the subsidies have done to this program, especially when you also understand how much it has driven up the overall cost of healthcare. Americans spend more on healthcare these days than they do housing! It's awful and it's all because of the ACA."

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgwKhDfdkjAscNLrBdt4AaABAg>

↳ @jodi7947 (4): "No, our health insurance both sucked and could drop you prior to the ACA. We do need a new system! Hopefully, young citizens will demand new rights and changes to many things that are untenable. It is high time to overhaul the whole US system."

↳ @TheUnRetired (3): "The ACA isn't the real problem; there are way deeper, more fundamental issues than the ACA. But we aren't here to talk politics; rather, practically dealing with the system we have so people can retire early."

↳ @jasonbroom7147 (3): "@TheUnRetired - Healthcare costs have outpaced inflation, wage growth, and even GDP, for decades. That is driven by govt. involvement, including Medicare, Medicaid, and now the ACA. Subsidies for ACA plans have dramatically exacerbated the issue, driving total healthcare up by literally trillions of dollars in just the last 5 years. Again, it now surpasses the cost of housing, which is simply absurd. I agree we have to work with whatever system is in place, but would you be surprised if the subsidies are eliminated because they are simply too expensive for American tax-payers to continue paying? It's one thing I can absolutely see happening, in the not-too-distant future. That's why I'm focusing on Roth conversions instead of trying to game the broken ACA system. It's not only a safe bet, it is a conscionable action; I sleep better at night, knowing I'm not paying less for healthcare than someone working 50 hours a week, trying to raise a young family. YMMV."

"Cancelled my ACA plan a couple months back. I made too much for the subsidy. My kids are covered under their mom's (my ex) insurance. My bronze plan had a 9k deductible. I'm paying cash moving toward for medical. If I go into a coma.. I don't own a home, my car is worth \$2,500. And they can't touch my retirement, so most of my risk is mitigated. (Under federal law up to \$1,512,350 in IRAs is protected from creditors in bankruptcy)"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America I People Are Canceling Coverage · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgwgRjNmbi3gTenofwB4AaABAg>

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

Marriage, divorce and filing status changing the price · 45 documents · 20 voices

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pff3oz/>

↳ (0): "FYI if you get married you get a special enrollment and can enroll her right away."

↳ (0): "This is what my partner and I are doing. We are marrying tomorrow actually, so we can have me enrolled on his health insurance for the new year. My coverage is going up over \$200 with higher deductible and higher co-pays. It's a bit sad that we are "forced" into marriage, when we could have planned a nice elopement with close friends and family, instead of a quick courthouse wedding. Good luck, you aren't the only one dealing with this."

↳ (0): "Getting Married is a life changing event. It opens enrollment and you can get her on instantly."

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

↳ bourbonfan1647 (68): "Elections have consequences. None of this is a surprise. Welcome to the "find out" phase..."

↳ Stop-Looking_For_Me (48): "Well here it is. The numbers don't lie. Healthcare is going to be fun next year for everyone."

↳ Redtoolbox1 (41): "But the billionaires got their tax cuts they so desperately needed 🙌"

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

↳ (0): "[Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling me that a single 36 year old in Arkansas making \$30,000/year is eligible for \$590/month in tax credits for 2026. That covers all but a few pennies/month in premiums on multiple bronze plans. Even the best GOLD plans would be well under \$100/month in premiums. Like \$40-80/month. Something isn't right with this post or we need more info about household size and income, etc."

↳ (0): "Please list the rates of what premium you paid before, and what it will be in 2026, and how many people in the household (single, 2, etc.). Right now, it reads like you're a single household making \$30K, which is too much to lose credits due to being someone who's supposed to apply for Medicaid, and too low to lose subsidies due to being more than 400% of the fpl. And those are the main ways you'd see that kind of jump, is if you lost all subsidies, and it sounds unlikely that you did."

↳ (0): "What were your premiums before, and what would they be after the increase? Is your insurance through an employer or the Marketplace? What about subsidies? For what it's worth, you're not alone. My husband is a retired state employee, and we're too young for Medicare. Our premiums for the two of us through the state retirement system are \$3,900 a month, up \$1,200 a month from last year. The state only kicks in \$200/month. Between premiums and deductibles, we'll be paying well over \$55,000 a year before insurance even kicks in. But we don't have a choice. I'm chronically ill, and my husband was diagnosed with leukemia last year. Like they say, you're well until you're not. Are your meds available in generics? There are a few options for less expensive generics...."

"ACA isn't so affordable Long story short, we'll be losing our healthcare come June. My wife has inherited a long list of health issues, and has been hospitalized 5x since January, anywhere from a week to 2 at a time. Essentially she's been hospitalized for 2 of the last 3 months in total. There's no end in sight for this. I make 62,500 a year, and she made 70,000 a year prior to this, providing insurance from her job as well. She'll be down to whatever SSDI is come June, and has made 60% of her normal wages thus far. I estimate our income at about 90k per year after this. My job is for a semi small family company, and our insurance is ok, but asks about pre-existing conditions. I tried marketplace which said if our income was below 108k per year we qualified for discounts! Yeah no. It's at a minimum \$12k per year in premiums, plus \$18k max out of pockets. I don't know about you, but it's a bit difficult paying 30 grand per year on a 90k income BEFORE taxes. And she will absolutely max the out of pocket week one. These stays are ICU stays, we're already in the millions. If you factor out taxes, we're left with about \$70k, giving me 40k for her, myself, and our 1 year old. This sucks. My only other option would be a divorce, and since her only income would be social security she would then qualify for Medicaid, but I guess that takes 2 years after you have a disability."

— r/HealthInsurance · 323 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jtjbsg/>

↳ (0): "Your ACA subsidy is based of MAGI and not your W2 income. So you may be eligible for a larger ACA subsidy. Your spouse may be eligible for Medicare irrespective of her age, if she is eligible for SSDI"

↳ (0): "The \$18,000 maximum out of pockets is the only place that I know I have some advise on. You can apply for financial assistance wherever you get care. If you have a remaining balance after they award you financial assistance on your bill, you can make payments. For medications, you can use co-payment cards or have the medications donated to your family as you need. For it to be donated, there is a process to apply, but much less intensive than a bonafide medical bill from a hospital or physician's office. If you are able to utilize co-payment cards for the medications your family needs, it does eat at your out of pocket and deductible under some plans. For me, it has eaten roughly \$3,000.00 of my out of pocket so far, alone."

↳ (0): "The 18K is the family max, the individual out of pocket max is more like 9K. So if she is the major consumer of health care the 9K number is more applicable."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: <https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>;

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

↳ Zphr (35): "OP, if you are just over the cliff (up to about 440% FPL), then you have an out due to a change in the OBBBA. Select a Bronze during open enrollment, commit to fully funding the accompanying HSA the Bronze will make you eligible for, and you can reduce your estimated MAGI at application by the full HSA contribution amount. This can pull you back into subsidy eligibility, which will cap your costs for the benchmark Silver at just under 10% of your MAGI, which right near the cliff for a household of two should be about \$700/month. Bronzes are cheaper than the benchmark, so you might be looking at \$400 to \$550/month for the Bronze. You can further reduce your AGI by making contributions to non-Roth retirement accounts if you aren't already doing so. Better to put \$16K into accounts for yourself than pay half or more of that amount in avoidable health insurance premiums."

↳ NBA-014 (19): "This is what the majority of Americans voted for. America is insane."

↳ Stand_With_Students (15): ""Why do we put up with this?" Exactly what I want to know too."

"Married couple retired, 57 years old, ACA plan in Florida which is 2k a month with a 7k deductible each after which they pay 100%. Average yearly cost is \$24K premium plus 7k deductible payment so \$31K a year, we don't qualify for subsidies."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgwwdKXK6chG_tXFMfV4AaABAg

↳ @kona6451 (2): "It's a crime isn't it."

↳ @dgmcfadden2006 (1): "I figure that is where we will be is about 30k."

↳ @jpgaffney3594 (0): "@BillyNewport-ez2vn That is a TON of money! Just curious after you watched this video did you try working with MOVE Health? If so, what was your outcome? Thanks!"

"Help! ACA plan termination notice after reporting a change-in-life event I just received a notice today that my ACA plan has been terminated effective October stating "voluntary withdrawal" even though I never requested this, and I have always paid on time. For the life of me I cannot figure out why. The only thing I can figure out is that this is due to me reporting my daughter as married (by reporting the event as a change-of-life event). This was to remove just her, not all of us. I called Healthcare.gov and they are escalating this, but I'm worried that it won't get fixed. I asked the agent and she says this happens a lot so I'm wondering if anyone else has experienced this when it wasn't due to non-payment. Does anyone have any experience with this? My son is a hemophiliac and I'm worried that I need to start looking for a new job so that I can get other coverage. BTW: I'm not getting tax credits, in case that is relevant."

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmwnck/help_aca_plan_termination_notice_after_reporting/

↳ FollowtheYBRoad (2): "Who did the notice come from? If from the insurance company, call them tomorrow and let them know that you didn't cancel. If you called healthcare.gov and removed only your daughter, did you have them repeat back to you exactly what you wanted to happen?"

↳ boltyboy69 (2): "<https://thehealthcareblog.com/blog/2025/12/08/health-insurance-cancel-culture/>";

↳ LukeMurphey (1): "It was from the insurance company. That is a good point about calling them. I will do that tomorrow. What is weird is the representative pushed through a change in my application and now the ACA eligibility results says that I'm not eligible to choose a plan while at the same time saying that my coverage is ending. You may be onto something that the issue was with the insurance company all along."

"Reporting income for ACA Hi all, My wife and I are self employed and applying for marketplace insurance. I've been told that as self employed people, our income should be our gross income minus business expenses. My question is, does the \$31,000 standard deduction (married filing jointly) and other deductions count towards this? I.E. if we pull in \$160,000 for the year, but take the \$31,000 deduction, is our income technically \$129,000? or does it only include business expenses such as office dues, supplies, etc? Is this as easy as just reporting the number on the Modified AGI line on last years tax return?"

— r/obamacare · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1owg2uk/>

↳ (0): "No. The standard deduction is calculated after your MAGI is determined."

↳ (0): "No. If your net after expenses is \$160k, it all counts towards AGI...can't reduce it with the standard deduction. Not sure if you are looking to lower your AGI to get under the cap, but if so consider looking at IRA or solo 401k contributions to get it down."

↳ (0): "No, MAGI is before the standard deduction. Assuming that is 160k net on your Schedule C and that is your only income your are at 498% of FPL for a family of 4. You need to get down to 128k in order to qualify for subsidies. You can do this if you have the cash to fund a combination of SEP (32K)+ IRA (7/8k) + Spousal IRA (7/8k)"

"I'm separated, did putting "married" on my ACA application cause them to refuse me any subsidies/tax credits? Soon to be ex and I plan to finalize our divorce in January and that's when he's going to take me off his health care plan. I'm 61 and retired, no longer working and my only income is \$3000/month alimony that he sends me (for the next 7 years, in lieu of splitting the house). So in a nutshell, my income now is \$40K/year. When I did the application for the 2026 ACA, the instructions said that if I'm separated to put myself down as married. So I did. It didn't ask anything about his income - I guess it just assumes "family income" of 40K. At any rate, it says my "family" is not eligible for subsidies/tax credit and the plans are showing me the full premium prices. The lowest premium I can see with this application is 1K/month, with deductibles of 8K, and both copays and coinsurance costs. It estimates that my annual out of pocket might be \$22K. So... half of my income for health insurance and care? I'm looking for anything I did wrong or can change to get more affordable care next year. Should I delete my application and do a new one listing myself as single? Also, I've read here in a few threads that the base subsidies are still there and it's only the extended subsidies are on hold by the politicians. But I don't see that they're offering me ANY subsidies. What am I missing?"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1orzhtn/>

↳ (0): "A couple considerations that you'll need to confirm with a tax expert: - if you know 1000% you're getting divorced in 2026, the IRS will consider you a single individual for all of 2026. That may affect how you would fill out the marital status and tax filing portions of your 2026 application. - if you mark your application as Married, you must also mark that you will file your 2026 taxes as Married Filing Jointly to qualify for tax credits/subsidies. Again, tax expert time, but for IRS purposes you are probably considered Single, filing as Single for 2026. - Alimony orders made after 1/1/2019 are typically not considered taxable income and therefore should not be on your application as income. Confirm with a tax expert. If that is your only source of money, for ACA/IRS purposes you may actually have \$0 income and may instead qualify for Medicaid. Bottom line, you've got at least two major issues (marital status/alimony) to sort out with someone qualified to get all the context of your situation to provide you with better advice."

↳ (0): "Wow, thank you. I had no idea about the alimony not being considered income. We're definitely finalizing the divorce in 2026; been separated for a few months now and I've moved to a different state. I'll consult with someone who's knowledgeable about these things. Thanks again!"

↳ (0): "You need to put single, and use your projected salary for 2026 because that's what you'll be, and make, when the policy is active"

"This is me. I have more health problems and see more specialists than the people I know/family I have who are in their late 70's, 80's and even more than my 98 year old grandmother. I am decades younger than that and terrified of what my health will be like at those ages, especially if my Medicaid is taken away. Not one of my health conditions is caused by poor choices like substance abuse or eating poorly or lack of exercise. I lost the genetic lottery and have terrible luck. I have written in my will that I wish to donate my body to science when I die because of the amount of "rare" diseases and syndromes I have. Literally every doctor I have ever had has said to me, "I have never seen this before". So that's been fun. I hope that by studying my body when I'm gone and won't need it, doctors and /or scientists will be able to learn how to help others with issues like mine someday. According to the current rules, despite being too sick to work, I have too many "assets" to qualify for SSI disability. So that will render me *not disabled* in the eyes of this new nightmare government and according to this evil bill. I gave up my teaching career when I was married when I became a stay at home mom/wife 25 years ago so I didn't pay into the social security system for decades which makes me ineligible for SSDI or social security disability. I am not qualified or trained to do any kind of job that would make enough money to be able to afford insurance and all the co-pays, deductibles, co-insurance, and prescriptions. I doubt anyone would even hire me, and I would likely get fired from all the sick days I would need. Prior to having children I was a teacher, and I would never go back to it the way society villainizes teachers for everything, not that my body could even tolerate the schedule and the stress. I cannot understand why they want you to sell your home and your car before you can qualify for SSI disability when you don't have enough work history for SSDI disability, so I don't receive benefits other than Medicaid and have been living solely off my investments which is my "retirement fund" that I started when I was 19. Every month I would contribute whatever I had, even if it was \$50, because I knew someday I wanted to be able to be home with my future children. Just in the short time since the orange monster has been in power. I have lost a scary amount of money and am terrified what I have won't last as long as I need it, thanks to his economic ineptitude. But if I sold my home and car, I would need assistance with housing and transportation. Make that make sense!? Even when it should be a slam dunk, it takes many people years, assistance from lawyers, and multiple attempts to qualify for disability. The system was broken before they came in with their plan to nuke it. I feel fortunate that I started planning for my future at such young age, but once I lose Medicaid, anything I have now will be gone in a very short amount of time, or I will die, which I think is what they want. I am terrified for people who don't have savings or investments, I'm terrified for all those of us who haven't had the energy, resources, or haven't been well enough for the battle to try to qualify for disability, and those of us who don't qualify for either type of disability, and I'm terrified for the elderly and really all of us who rely on this system to help us live. We are not worthless! Every one of us has value! We all have people who love us and rely on us. We are all someone's child and many are someone's parent. Like most people, I have contributed so much to this world, and still do in the ways I'm able to through teaching, my extensive volunteer work, my charitable contributions over the years, and by being a good citizen, friend, mother, daughter, sister, and human. My kids have grown up but are not in a position to help support me in their 20's and I have been single for almost 20 years now. I have no one to help me or take me in or who currently helps to care for me when I'm sick, let alone if I burn through all my savings for my medical care and lose my home, like so many millions of other people. And they don't give a single crap. Every time I see someone saying that we will just be getting what we voted for I want to scream!! I didn't vote for this!!! I actively worked to try to prevent it! It's cruel, immature, and absolutely incorrect to gloat and taunt that people in my shoes deserve it because we voted for it, when we didn't. I really wish people would stop saying that. I hope there is a special corner in hell waiting for every person who helped write this bill and every single one of them who helps to pass this bill for their cruelty and the evil they are intentionally inflicting on people less fortunate than them, apparently just because they can and apparently because they find it fun."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ln1zvj/senator_warren_big_beautiful_score_now_just_shy/n0ebfl4/

"ACA and PTCs, Early Retirement Asking for confirmation of my understanding, under post-OBBA law. *TLDR*, my basic question is, with one spouse on Medicare and one purchasing insurance through ACA, are we still a household of two and is joint MAGI used to determine eligibility? Does MFS change that? Practically speaking, I have retired at age 62 (got laid off and not finding any opportunities) and my COBRA benefits end in March. I'm reviewing longer-term financial planning options to work toward getting PTCs for the next three years until I go on Medicare. Best I can tell, the OBBA brought back the 400% FPL cliff (which is what we've been arguing about) which in 2026 will be \$62,600 MAGI for a household of one, and \$84,600 for a household of two. My spouse is currently on Medicare so I only need to purchase ACA insurance for myself. In this situation are we still a household of two, and does our joint MAGI count? I don't think Married Filing Separate would change that. Using online calculators for my state and county, if we are truly a household of two and total household MAGI is used then we need to remain under \$84,600 MAGI to get PTCs. If we do that, then we will pay \$0 in insurance premiums for me for Bronze level coverage (which is fine, I'm reasonably healthy). However, if our MAGI is \$84,601 or higher then my monthly premiums would be over \$1400/mo for the same coverage. Does this sound correct? Thanks! ***Followup.*** This is the final strategy: \- Decline COBRA coverage for 2026; \- Sign up for ACA coverage with PTCs; \- Actively manage MAGI to less than \$84,600 to retain those PTCs; \- Make a solid Roth conversion in calendar year 2025 to have liquid cash for the next three years; \- Pay the estimated taxes due on the conversion by January 15; \- Don't get sick for the next three years."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1otm8of/>

↳ (0): "You are a household of two. Both MAGI incomes should be included on your application. Note that you **must** file taxes jointly for the year you receive any PTC in order to qualify for assistance. So if you are applying for 2026 coverage and PTC, you must mark that you will file your 2026 tax return as Married Filing Jointly. If you mark on your application that you will file Married Filing Separately, you will not qualify for PTC. If you receive PTC and then file your 2026 taxes as Married Filing Separately, you will likely have to pay back some or all PTC you received in that benefit year."

↳ (0): "Got it, thanks! Those facts are what I was concerned about, and I'll act accordingly. Makes the next three years a bit touchy on how to manage the finances, but I've got a plan (which will result in a very big tax bill for Tax Year 2025...sigh...) Thanks again. Solved!"

↳ (0): "I was in a similar situation (a few years younger) ... we did COBRA our first year and decided to switch to ACA as of the next Jan 1 so that deductibles wouldn't be reset mid year when COBRA ran out and they'd all go to the ACA plan. We're also healthy, but you never know when you might break an ankle or whatever. Just figured I'd throw that out there."

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

↳ BaltimoreBee (52): "Your broker is giving you misinformation and you should stop working with them and find a competent one. Married filed separately automatically disqualifies from any subsidies, it doesn't matter how much you earn. You will definitely owe back 100% of any subsidies they give you if you are married filing separately. The only way you can qualify for subsidies is if you file a joint tax return and those subsidies are based on your combined household income."

↳ Dakota51871 (23): "You're broker not only gave you false information but violate the rules and regulations of their contract with NYS Department of Financial Services. You should definitely file a complaint with DFS by calling 800-342-3736 and the attorney general health care line at 800-428-9071. They work on commission so they will say or do anything to make a sale."

↳ whim_sea (11): "Woah. I'm so glad I asked! Thank you !"

"Depends on your household size and income. If you are above 400% of FPL going forward you will not qualify for any subsidy. That's \$81,000 for a household of two for example. My husband and I would likely no longer qualify as we are small business owners and business income must be added on top of W-2 income. My job does not offer benefits. Our premium without subsidy would be \$2800 a month which is unsustainable."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lp1un7/if_the_bbb_passes_and_the_aca_is_gutted_what_are/n0scn1q/

"Prior to the ACA, I was diagnosed with Menieres Disease and lost my job as a firefighter. Because I lost my job, I lost insurance. I could no longer afford the physical therapy I needed to regain my balance. I also had to go to the health department for birth control (I was newly married) and because I couldn't afford blood pressure meds they wouldn't let me have the pills that worked best for the PCOS. So I took what they gave me, thinking it wouldn't matter much. It did. It screwed up my system so bad that I gained 70 lbs, and it made the PCOS so bad that several years later, when we did have insurance again, we found out I was infertile. Now I have an autoimmune disorder, am obese, have Menieres, PCOS and a host of other issues that I could have followed up on or gotten checked out had we not gone 5 years with no coverage. (My husband's work didn't have insurance, and the high-risk pool would have been 3/4 of our take-home pay a month). My husband is now a diabetic. This means I am functionally trapped in my job until I'm like 68. You know over 20 more years. I can't get to where I can't work, or he will lose coverage. On top of that, we were never able to have kids. So indirectly, our health care system redirected our lives with a miserable, but not fatal illness. I was so happy when the ACA passed, and sickened when I heard family talk about how they didn't want "all those sick people" running up the costs. I AM one of those sick people...."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lz67ob/reminder_what_life_was_like_before_affordable/n3659ba/

"So thankful for ACA to bridge gap between retirement and age 65 medicare, post-divorce from unfaithful spouse. Difficult age to regroup from such upheaval. Self-employed. I chose bronze plan. High deductible, but basically healthy. Premium \$0. The plan also discounts what I pay out of pocket, so has worked well. Max out-of-pocket so far has been about \$2,000, in only one year - included ultrasound, biopsy, labs, and doctor visits - only diagnostics needed, treatment was medication only. Have been on ACA since 2014, and premiums have come down every year since 2016. \$0 for last 2 years and 2021. It is helpful to understand premium tax credit is based on 2nd lowest Silver plan, and income vs poverty level. Thank you!"

— YouTube · How The Obamacare ACA Health Insurance Subsidy Is Calculated · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YftaFfME8-Y&lc=UgzswLoZTTkQY0y2VkR4AaABAg>

↳ @KevinKnauss (2): "ACA has been a blessing for many people, then they turn 65. For many people eligible for Medicare, the cost of health insurance increases unless they qualify for help from Medicaid, which many do not. At a minimum, the Part B premium of Original Medicare will be \$148.50. The cost of either a Medicare Advantage plan OR a Medicare Supplement + a Prescription Drug Plan, can add another \$170 per month on top of the Part B premium. I guess we need to take the savings while we can and hope Medicare costs won't break the bank."

↳ @shakengrain1942 (1): "@KevinKnauss Yes, agree with all that - am only 61, and have been checking ahead into Medicare a bit already. Medicare will be higher for me also. ACA plans are not perfect. Many of the silver/gold plans still require you to pay 20%/30% even 50% coinsurance. And much higher premiums on top of that. I opted for bronze 5 to get a firm cap. I pay no more than \$6,700/year no matter what. Even though high at \$6,700, those silver/gold plan copays and coinsurances can add up to more than that very quickly. I would go on Medicare A/B with Supplement Plan G and prescription plan right now if available to me, but not yet 65. Would cost about \$250-\$270/month, but basically covers all. I can make that work, but not a private plan covering the same. Thank you again."

↳ @KevinKnauss (1): "@shakengrain1942 Wow, you have got your arms wrapped around this costs. Good for you. It can be very confusing."

"I was a child in the 1960s, we never had insurance and we were considered middle class. My family didn't get insurance coverage until the 70s when my mom married my stepdad, who had a professional job that included health insurance. Single payer is what we need. The people who are against it are morons."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=Ugz_0Oc6lTTwAyxDRrZ4AaABAg

"No, you cannot switch plans midyear unless you have a life event, which is marriage, by a house, birth of a child, that's the only time you get special enrollment period. Otherwise you have to wait until November or so when open enrollment starts. I have ACA too, and I had a problem with the dermatologist a couple years ago. I always go and get a full body check because I have a lot of moles. I went a couple of years ago and I had two moles removed and they automatically get sent out for a biopsy. They told me my portion was \$147. And I said no, I met my deductible and out-of-pocket max months ago, so I should owe nothing. Then they hit me with while you at least have to pay the \$30 co-pay for a specialist. I shouldn't have had to pay that, but I did, because they weren't going to let me leave without paying something. I went home and called my insurance and I was correct, I should not have paid a dime. I had met my deductible and out-of-pocket max by February of that year and it was like August by then. My insurance company spent a week trying to get a hold of the billing department. And their excuse was they have different systems and they show different things and it showed that I owed \$147 or whatever it was but they admitted they were wrong. But what the dermatologist wanted to do was give me a credit. How in the hell do you know that I'm coming back to this particular place? You do not know that and neither do I so send a damn check. And they did. Every mole I have ever had removed automatically get sent for a biopsy and I have had probably seven moles removed. And I really don't see how ACA is going to help you. You need to talk to your insurance company."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tnbh0m/imperial_problems_and_a_ca/onyolxp/

"Question about ACA PTC + unmarried domestic partner employer coverage My partner and I are unmarried and file taxes separately. We live together and have children, whom I claim on my taxes. I've always claimed the children. My partner's employer offers health insurance and gives him the option to cover the kids (the coverage is considered affordable) and also has the option to add a domestic partner. I was told by a Vermont Health Connect eligibility specialist that because we aren't married, the offer of affordable domestic partner coverage doesn't disqualify me from remaining on my Marketplace plan and receiving a Premium Tax Credit like it would if we were married. I've also found IRS guidance saying that someone who can enroll in an employee's employer coverage but isn't a member of the employee's tax family is considered eligible for that coverage for PTC purposes only during months they actually enroll. So essentially, his employer's offer of domestic partner coverage would only disqualify me from receiving a premium tax credit if I was to enroll. Does this sound correct? Specifically, is an affordable offer of employer coverage to an unmarried domestic partner treated differently for PTC purposes than an offer to children? Vermont Health connect told me that my partner's affordable employer insurance offer for our children does make the children ineligible for a PTC. The children and I are not part of his tax family because he doesn't claim any of us as dependents. I'm mainly trying to make sure I haven't been receiving a PTC when I shouldn't have and understand why my partner's offer of affordable coverage makes our children ineligible, but not myself."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wp131z/question_about_aca_ptc_unmarried_domestic_partner/

"Our insurance was going from \$850 to \$2370 going from gold plan to silver. Did the math on the bronze plan (\$2160) and mathematically we would come out ahead on silver simply because of regular monthly copays for a few meds and regular doctor visits for chronic condition. Our solution? We took a pay cut in order to cap our income at \$80k this year and that same plan is now \$234 a month. But if we make \$1 over that 400% level (\$84,600 for married couple filing jointly) our cost would go from \$2,808 per year to \$28,440 per year. The math is insane. And of course this is just a temporary solution. Because I'd much rather make more money and so much more that it's still a substantial net gain and not just throwing it all away to insurance cost."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q9mpvb/republican_senators_are_pushing_to_get_enhanced/nz1bibb/

Parents: aging off their plan, helping them, or being helped · 14 documents · 14 voices

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

↳ (0): "I hope everyone making these posts are also calling their senators and representatives. They may not respond but they do track constituent issues/concerns."

↳ (0): "...and don't forget to VOTE!!!"

↳ (0): "I just wish we had at least one party running on universal healthcare to vote for."

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

↳ Stomoyuki (49): "Medicaid eligibility limits your access to Marketplace subsidies, which is why [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling you to apply for Medicaid. My first question is why the out-of-state hospitals won't "accept" PA Medicaid. Medicaid generally provides limited out-of-state coverage, so are they looking for something beyond basic coverage for yourself? Also, you're probably not the first student in your school encountering this issue. I'd contact the student affairs/financial aid office and ask them what they recommend in your situation. They may provide hardship resources you can utilize."

↳ emacs guy (30): "Thanks for the replies, but I think I'm just going to sign up with PA State Medicaid. They will cover life threatening ER out of state but nothing else. Which should be fine, I won't be out state maybe just 4 months max. I just hope I won't get hassled by some of the hospitals if asked. I'll just deal with it then."

↳ LizzieMac123 (13): "Healthcare.gov plan but you'll have to pay full price with no income if you're not allowed to have out of state medicaid in your program."

"Just don't know what to do. Hey all. My husband and I are both self-employed. Currently, I'm still under 26 and on my parents' plan, though not for much longer. My husband is currently uninsured. We don't qualify for any subsidies, as our income is just over the 400% FPL limit. Despite this, we still live paycheck to paycheck as is, due to living in a high-cost of living area. Packing up and moving isn't really an option, as both of our businesses are based here. We simply can't afford to fork over hundreds to thousands of dollars each month for an ACA compliant plan. I've considered non-ACA, but everyone on this sub seems to think it's a terrible idea and they won't cover anything. At this point I'm just at a loss and don't know what to do. I worry about my husband being uninsured, and I'm considering giving up my business and getting a job that can provide us with insurance, though I really don't want to. Any advice is appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wfnwua/just_dont_know_what_to_do/

↳ Poop_Dolla (15): "Do you have an accountant? Are you certain you're taking advantage of all your write offs for your business? In my opinion you have two options if you want a marketplace ACA plan, you can attempt to get your gross income under the threshold by contributing to retirement plans and making sure your deductions are all accounted for, or you can make more to cover the cost of an unsubsidized plan."

↳ katsrad (11): "Non-ACA isn't recommended if you have any pre-existing condition because you can be denied or they are just indemnity plans that pay a small set amount that won't cover the cost of the service. My advice is to look for employment that provides health insurance as a benefit."

↳ saysee23 (8): "Lots of people get jobs to provide insurance, maybe part time at Starbucks so you would not have to give up your business. Non-ACA isn't worth most of the time unless you really like to gamble with your family's health. You said you two "still" live paycheck to paycheck - the part-time or totally different job might help with this. it's never too often to reevaluate your budgets. The other comment about the CPA is a very good idea."

"I live in Virginia and back in 2020 had to be hospitalized from uterine fibroid bleeding that was so severe even the ER nurse said, "I'm glad you came in, because you may have died if you didn't." Needed 4 blood transfusions to be classified as stable. I had no income and lived with my mom although I aged out of her insurance. They did not offer me a cent off through any charity care program told me apply for emergency Medicaid coverage or there's nothing that can be done. I have not been able to get a hysterectomy to cure me from risk of this happening again. What do they expect someone like me to do? I only got covered by the expansion by the skin of my teeth timing wise. I could not work in that severely anemic state I couldn't even get around Walmart by myself. But doesn't count for official disability...and I'm young,31."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lki09f/key_gop_senator_warns_medicaid_cuts_could_spell/mzu50yw/

"I was a child in the 1960s, we never had insurance and we were considered middle class. My family didn't get insurance coverage until the 70s when my mom married my stepdad, who had a professional job that included health insurance. Single payer is what we need. The people who are against it are morons."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=Ugz_0Oc6lTTwAyxDRrZ4AaABAq

"Needing advice on what to do due to disabled household (looking for Marketplace insurance) Hello there. I'm recently officially (not state wide, though I'm starting the application process soon) disabled per my doctors and unable to return to work. I live with my parents and my aunt, all who are also disabled, although my Dad also works a low paying job to provide additional income. My aunt has never worked but pays us rent and has her own bills to pay on. Basically I am concerned about applying for marketplace insurance (Cobra, just for myself is going to be over 700\$ through my previous workplace, which I nor my family can afford monthly). I will solely be relying on my parents' income which I feel terrible about. Obviously as I am chronically ill I can't go without insurance or my medicine. I am worried that with including the entire household yearly income even though most of that money cannot help towards my insurance, that it will raise the price for me. This is all very new, scary and foreign to me. What are the options and how does this usually work through Marketplace? I'm 28 in TN. I'll be honest I'm not entirely sure what the household income is but I can say at least it is over 30k. *Maybe* nearing 45k annually. Not currently receiving disability but am about to start the application process, probably not eligible for Medicaid until then? But my family members are on Medicaid. Sorry and thank you in advance."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pvw5jg/>

↳ (0): "You have a lot of moving parts here. How old are you? State of residence? Total household income? Are you claimed as a dependent? Do you receive disability? Are you Medicaid eligible? Are your other family members on Medicaid? Impossible to give you advice without more information."

↳ (0): "Apologies. I've been a bit scatterbrained with tons of worry/stress and have memory issues. I'm 28 in TN not claimed as a dependent. I'll be honest I'm not entirely sure what the household income is but I can say at least it is over 30k. *Maybe* nearing 45k annually. Not currently receiving disability but am about to start the application process, probably not eligible for Medicaid until then? But my family members are on Medicaid."

↳ (0): "When the aca marketplace asks your household income, they are asking about your TAX household- who you file taxes with. Not just who you happen to live with. So, if your parents are not claiming you on their taxes, its just yourself. Tennessee is one of 10 states that did not expand medicaid to include eligibility due to low/no income- so youre going to need a state disability approval to get original medicaid. (This is what your family members have). The problem you face now is you have no income/low income and unless you'll make at least 15,650 as your modified adjusted gross income (MAGI) you dont qualify for any aca subsidies either. Youd have to pay full price for an ACA marketplace plan. Head over the healthcare.gov and fill out an application to see what is available to you- compare those plans and pricing to what your cobra would cost you. Its a shame there are still 10 states holding out on expanded medicaid, it really leaves many people in a bind- not making enough for a subsidy but not having expanded medicaid as an option either. If you were in an expanded medicaid state, simply making less than that 15k would be enough for medicaid to be approved (there are a few states with a work requirement but most just grant it based on income)."

"COBRA 60-day window question Hi everyone, My parents are really in a bind right now, as my father lost his job/health insurance in July, and now my Mom has a serious medical issue going on. They can't get her on Medicare Part B right now (special enrollment) because they had a gap in coverage in 2025 (what Medicare told us). I had the idea of signing up for COBRA, but that's an issue as well. My Dad's unemployment date was July 10th. He didn't receive anything about COBRA until the end of July. Even so, the paperwork is dated July 14th and the election deadline was 9/12. According to what I read, it seems like you have 60 days from when you got the document, not whenever they decide to date it. He obviously didn't receive the COBRA info 4 days after unemployment. What's the deal here?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wo6utx/cobra_60day_window_question/

↳ chickenmcdiddle (5): "COBRA election window begins on the date the notice is received, not the date the notice is issued. >You have 60 days to enroll in COBRA, starting when your job-based coverage ends or when you receive a COBRA election notice--whichever is later. <https://www.dol.gov/agencies/ebsa/laws-and-regulations/laws/cobra> It sounds like the former employer inappropriately dated the election period."

↳ InspireMia (5): "I agree, but moving quickly to secure COBRA coverage is likely the right move. I'd contact the COBRA administrator and get the notice's mailing date and the end date of the previous coverage in writing, then try to get your dad to sign up as soon as possible. COBRA is often retroactive to the date the previous coverage ended, so there won't be any "gap" in coverage provided your dad is still eligible."

↳ vipe155 (1): "She didn't qualify for a special enrollment period and was told she would have to enroll in Part B and have it go into effect in January of next year."

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjvhr9/please_help_best_insurance_in_nj_for_someone/

↳ No-Produce-6720 (8): "I'm not sure if you're meaning to say Medicare, but there is no federal Medicaid. Medicaid is only issued based on the state in which you live. There is no federal option, so I'm unsure what you're referring to there. Aside from that, you need to start at healthcare.gov. That will point you in the right direction for ACA coverage or Medicaid."

↳ katsrad (7): "One thing is that there isn't a federal Medicaid it is going to be provided by the state. There is Federal Medicare which is different and based on age or if you are disabled. The other is use healthcare.gov to

look for plans you are eligible for and if you are eligible for any subsidies. Anything outside that can deny you coverage for pre-existing conditions or not pay claims for those."

↳ gingercatlover1 (2): "Yes, we do! There are a lot of resources."

"Open-Enrollment and New Year Gap: What Do I Do? I recently moved from MS to AR, and started my new job in mid-August; before then, I had been uninsured for about a month, being on COBRA beforehand through the summer, and a dependent on my father's insurance up until my 26th birthday in mid-May before that. I was supposed to have health insurance coverage as a new hire within the 30-days, but my access to my benefits and workplace portal was locked due to some technical issues; now, I have to wait until mid-November for open enrollment, but even then, the benefit's don't kick in until 01/01/2027. Does anyone have any recommendations for what to do for health insurance in the meantime? I make \$16.25 per hour, so I don't know if I'd qualify for Medicaid. My main two worries are coverage for any possible emergencies (hospital, ER, etc.), and urgent care visits (I'm a chronic asthmatic, and every time I get the seasonal flu, it goes to my chest and I have to go to urgent care for steroids)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wi4kbp/openenrollment_and_new_year_gap_what_do_i_do/

↳ LacyLove (2): "You waited until today to ask about the benefits? Why did you not log on sooner?"

↳ LacyLove (1): "Whose fault were the tech issues? If it was theirs, I would fight back and make them enroll me now. Did you move less than 60 days ago?"

↳ Typical_Log_3337 (1): "My hire date was 08/17, and I thought 30 days was up until 09/17; I tried calling the benefits representative, and they said that the 30 days was up 09/15, not 09/16- the technical issues were theirs, but I definitely struggled with communicating with them in-time; spending all of today trying to see if there's a way to fight it. At this point, I've accepted that I have to wait until open enrollment- now I just want to know if anyone has any short-term coverage plan recommendations (since some of them seem kind of scammy), or if I'd be eligible for Medicaid coverage in AR, or what"

"I thank God for my health every day, even though I don't believe in going to the doctor for every little thing. I feel very strongly about having health insurance because when something happens (not if), I want my husband and family to be protected from losing all the wealth they've worked hard for their entire lives. My Dad, who had the strongest faith of anyone I ever knew, made sure my Mom was taken care of and will never want for anything. She has a Cadillac health plan because of my Dad's planning and care."

— YouTube · My Husband Doesn't Believe In Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Lub47Wc4Tl8&lc=Ugz0eX30_ME5JFiEtF54AaABAg

"I never had health insurance ever since I got off my parent's plan. I recently got Dengue fever (I live in the Philippines). The hospital bill was about \$435. Given the amount I saved from not paying premiums for an individual plan I got a huge bargain. I used part of my emergency fund and I was done."

— YouTube · I'm Young & Healthy, Can I Skip Health Insurance? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WTtjmdyTCRM&lc=UgwsUemslBRaYsdnIUZ4AaABAg>

"I wish my premiums could go exclusively to helping people like you husband get the health care they need and not shareholders and executives. My mom's cancer treatment was also absurdly expensive and if it had been pre-ACA she'd likely be dead. Congrats on your husband's remission!"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pb2hse/cancer_is_expensive/nroj3e3/

"My dad didn't quit his job he lost it due to covid so now he has no health insurance he can't afford it and when I signed him up to covered CA they reply saying he wasn't eligible because his income was very low (unemployment). I also live in the bay!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=Ugy2C3QpAzPY2YueijF4AaABAg>

↳ @BeatTheBush (1): "I think if they did that they would've directed you to Medical?"

↳ @larryjones9773 (0): "@BeatTheBush I think you meant Medi-Cal (California's Medicaid program)."

↳ @Usernameprincess (0): "@BeatTheBush They did.. I don't understand why though? He wanted to keep Kaiser and we have never applied for Medical so Idk if they offer Kaiser?"

"My brother does credit card autopay every month with Blue Cross. I believe you can split among cards as separate manual charges (not autopay!). When I was on ACA I did that with some decent bonuses requiring \$1000 minimum, as no cc fee with them."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qwmyum/paying_for_aca_obamacare/o3rf80u/

Pregnancy and a new baby · 8 documents · 8 voices

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

↳ (0): "Two reasons you might not be seeing subsidies on ACA plans: * your annual income is too low, or you entered it incorrectly. Your annual income must be over the poverty line to be eligible for subsidies * you answered the questions about employer coverage incorrectly, and you're not seeing subsidies because the application believes you have affordable employer coverage available"

↳ (0): "Can you expand on the international bit? That might change things quite a bit"

↳ (0): "The baby will be born there, but it will be a US citizen after some paperwork. My partner and I are both US citizens."

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

↳ (0): "The insurance isnt going to agree to a network exception for your preferred provider. They would have to have the provider sign documents indicating they would agree to accept in network rates, and usually they wont proactively try to set that up unless the provider reaches out to them first. While the process exists, the likelihood of them approving it is extremely low. You can ask for a care manager or case manager. Thats a decent recommendation. They should be able to find you a provider that can actually treat you. Theres a good chance some of the providers were incorrect when they said they dont take marketplace plans, though its possible they were right and the insurance has an outdated directory, but 20 providers in a row seems unlikely. You wont be able to change your plan outside open enrollment. No better way other than contacting your insurance directly, unfortunately."

↳ (0): "Best advice here! Also OP - even *if* you could get your insurance to pay in-network rates (and you may be able to if for some reason there is in-fact no providers) - doing so doesn't prevent the provider from still balance-billing you what insurance doesn't pay due to the lack of contract."

↳ (0): "I would do both options. And also, I would report the insurance company and plan to your state Department of insurance. The insurance companies benefit from having fake doctors on their plans."

"My health insurance doesn't covers anything anymore. I paid \$900 a year for additional optical and dental on top of regular health insurance..... saved me \$50, on my glasses.... (still cost me \$760 for my glasses, but wouldn't cover a dime on contact lenses)..... Dental cost me \$1000 for 2 filings AFTER insurance coverage. Pregnancy cost me \$12,000 out of pocket. And My deductible was only \$100. But apparently it doesn't cover unnecessary things like "epidurals" x-rays, ultrasounds, tylenol.... Tylenol..... but if I have a heart attack at 30yo at least they'll cover that....."

— YouTube · How bad is it if I don't have health insurance? · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Rroep7t-6v8&lc=Ugzgw5hwzVwSih7SI-F4AaABAg>

↳ @Xelenteontae_ (1): "So they are just paying what you give them and pocket the rest and try to give as little as possible?"

↳ @RosannasFamilyZannazone_family (0): "@Xelenteontae_ Yesssss! For 6 years. I paid \$850 a month for health insurance, an additional \$75 a month for dental and vision. So, in total, I paid \$126,000 to health insurance. When I had my daughter she costed about \$35,000. \$12,000 wasn't covered,... So They made \$103,000 off of me (btw, I only made \$38K a year)..."

"Getting pushback from insurance around my new deductible for a newborn Wife and I just recently had our baby and I'm trying to figure out how much I might owe and if insurance is right in their claim before the bills start officially coming in. We work together and because of this it winds up being cheaper to be on our own individual plans instead of together. She has the lower deductible plan and we planned to put the baby on hers. Her previous coverage was a \$2K deductible and then a \$4K max out of pocket in network. Which we hit those probably 4 or 5 months ago. Then the baby was born and we updated hers mid plan year to a family plan to add the baby. She now has a \$4K deductible and a \$8K max out of pocket. Insurance is showing what my wife hit previously though and saying we are still in the deductible phase and have hit the \$2K/\$4K we hit previously. My question though is. Since we show that we have hit \$4K as our previous max out of pocket and the new deductible is \$4K. Should the deductible amount not update to saying we have paid \$4K of it since technically we have paid \$4K this year? IE I was thinking the max we would owe would be \$4K once the bills come. But my wife called insurance and they are saying it should be \$6K because we still have \$2K on the deductible to hit. Is that correct? Or should I call back and pushback on that especially once we receive our first bill?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wea791/getting_pushback_from_insurance_around_my_new/

↳ Minute_Armadillo_167 (19): "This is how our plan has always been. We have 3 kids now. You likely have an individual \$2k/\$4k. So your wife has that and then the baby has that. But there is also a family \$4k/\$8k. This doesn't really change anything when there are only 2 people on the plan. But for my family, once 4k has collectively been met overall, no one has a remaining deductible. Your baby will still have charges until they meet their own deductible."

↳ Guilty-Committee9622 (8): "You total max this year is now 4k deductible and 8k out of pocket She already had 2k applied and has 2k to go. When it switched to family plan it reset the deductible."

↳ Minute_Armadillo_167 (5): "Basically, when you have multiple family members, if 2 have "expensive" years, like max out of pocket, it makes the year "free" for everyone else. 🤔 In the years of having babies, we were max OOP like 5 of 8 years."

"Low Deductible or HSA Plan for 2 adults with potential pregnancy in the future. I am leaving my job to take care of my one year old at home since daycare costs in my area are very high. I will lose my insurance through my employer; however, my employers insurance was pretty expensive and my son qualifies for FAMIS now, and with the tax credits my husbands employer (extremely small family owned business) will pay our monthly premiums for an ACA plan. We are discussing trying to have a second baby to complete our family this year and I'd like help deciding which plan will be most beneficial for us financially, and if the higher premium would be worth it for his company to cover. For my husband and myself I am looking at this plan. Would this be appropriate for us? The other HSA plans are around \$187 a month with \$7500+ Deductibles and 20k OOP max. 40 % coinsurance down all the services. I am not really sure what that means? I know what an HSA is but we honestly don't have a lot of extra funds at the moment to contribute, we are still paying off the hospital bill from last year delivering my one year old (I had a low deductible plan through work for my pregnancy and still ended up with an \$8000 hospital bill). **Sentara M Gold 1000 Ded / \$387 month premium.** Primary Care Visits- \$35 Co Pay Deductible - \$2000 OOP Max - \$19,900 **Pregnancy-** 20% Coinsurance after deductible. **Emergency Care-** 40% Coinsurance after deductible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmdev9/low_deductible_or_hsa_plan_for_2_adults_with/

↳ sweetoptat (1): "Without contributing to HSA and pregnancy/delivery complications, Sentara will be cheaper option. An HSA plan will could be a better choice in a worst case scenario: <https://preview.redd.it/bx8x10gwawqh1.png?width=1037&format=png&auto=webp&s=e8fd0c0f467dca47f62e5d77137e8587427fd0a1> If either plan has individual OOP max limit, then result could be different."

"Hmo help with selecting obgyn I've never had an hmo before, so this is all new and scary to me. Any advice is appreciated! I have an hmo with Blue Shield of California, through the marketplace. My PCP has been changed multiple times this year (side rant, why are Drs allowed to change networks mid year but we aren't?!) so I've never actually met the man. I got pregnant through a fertility clinic and they are getting ready to release me to an obgyn. I called my insurance to check that I don't need a referral (California law) but they told me I did. Ok, fine, whatever. I got an appointment with my PCP, and he said I didn't need a referral, but he'd go ahead and submit one anyway. Now I'm lost as to what my next step is. Do I just browse the blue shield website until I find an obgyn I like? Am I restricted to only certain doctors? No one's really explaining anything, and then when they do they seem to be incorrect and uninformed. If anyone knows how this stuff actually works I'd really appreciate the help! I definitely won't be doing an hmo again, no matter the cost savings"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpd1hx/hmo_help_with_selecting_obgyn/

↳ GroinFlutter (2): "You need to find an obgyn that is in network with your HMO. What medical group is your PCP under? That's the medical group/'network' that you are limited to. Most of these medical groups will have their own websites that show in network providers. You could go there and search for one."

↳ MrsRadon (2): "So, even though I can change the network at any time, I'm still limited to picking a doctor within the network of my PCP? I'm just so confused why I'm paying for blue shield, but I don't have access to the full blue shield network"

↳ ThrowRA50673 (2): "Yes, that's basically how an HMO works. Your PCP is assigned to a medical group/IPA, and that group has its own network of specialists. For most specialist care, you're limited to doctors contracted with that medical group unless an exception or out-of-network authorization is approved. So being "in network with Blue Shield" alone doesn't necessarily mean you can see that doctor."

"On an non ACA insurance plan and I'm pregnant Located in California. I'm the sole breadwinner (29) for my family. (28) (4) (2). I make too much for any kind of covered California or subsidized plan (gross \$144k). Currently, my family of 4 is on a non ACA plan where pregnancy is completely not covered. I just found out I'm pregnant. Luckily, we are planning to pay out of pocket for a midwife who gets good cash rates for scans and tests. However, in case something goes wrong and I have an emergency or have to deliver at a hospital, I need a better plan. My midwife suggested a PPO. Guys what am I doing? I'm looking at minimum coverage, right? I can't get my own individual insurance and leave my family on the current plan, can I? This is all another language to me, and I don't know what I'm doing or how to navigate this, I just know I need to cover my bases in case something catastrophic or unplanned happens."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgjb6o/on_an_non_aca_insurance_plan_and_im_pregnant/

↳ throwfarfaraway1818 (26): "When are you due? If its in the new year, you can sign up during open enrollment without any issues. If its before the end of the year, your options are more limited."

↳ throwfarfaraway1818 (20): "Sounds perfect. You should be perfectly fine to enroll during open enrollment with a plan that starts Jan 1."

↳ silent752 (16): "Then sign up in November and have plan go into effect January 1st"

"Bad. Many people suffered terribly. My husband and I spent years uninsured or underinsured, pre ACA, despite working full time. Not by choice. My husband has diabetes, hypertension, diabetic retinopathy, and stage 4 kidney disease now, as a result. Preventative care wasn't required to be covered, nor was prenatal care or childbirth. My prenatal care and childbirth were barely covered by my insurance, in 1997/1998, and 2002/2003. We had a bankruptcy because of medical bills. Anyone romanticizing those days is a fool, sorry to say. The ACA isn't perfect, but it's a heck of a lot better than what we had before. My adult daughter would be uninsured right now, we're it not for the ACA. She works, but isn't eligible for medical insurance through her job."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oiatmp/how_bad_were_things_before_obamacare_could_an/nlu8vzh/

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

What they were told about income and the subsidy · 24 documents · 20 voices

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>

↳ (0): "We're in a similar situation. We pay over 20,000 a year for a high deductible plan on my husband's policy. We've explored alternatives, including purchasing coverage for me through the Marketplace; but our most "affordable" option is to stay on his plan because it is based on pre-taxed income. We've also tried the pay out of pocket approach, and I had a minor health emergency, which cost several thousand. We decided that going uninsured with little children is too risky."

↳ (0): "... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."

↳ (0): "1700/month here...basically same exact situation you are in. My wife is just like your husband. My employer pays for employee 100%, as soon as I add my family, wife, 2 kids....1700/month...vision, dental,

included. Eastern PA. I've been fighting this for over 10 years with my employer. I love my job, but each year with this nonsense, it gets harder and harder to argue it's worth staying. My mortgage is 1300/month. Good luck, as all I have ever been told is get a new job."

"I thought the income considered for ACA would be income after we retire not total anticipate income for this year. Husband and I are retiring in July this year. I called health broker and was told our 2026 total income does not qualify us for subsidies this year. We can definitely control our MAGI next year. But the cost of health insurance without subsidies for this year is \$2,400 a month for bronze. Crazy"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 155 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgzvkYbznI6KYejn5LV4AaABAq>

↳ @Reanimator7336 (2): "If you work at all in retirement you are not retired."

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "that is crazy - sorry! here's more about MAGI: https://youtu.be/KDE1jO1z3Sg?si=U8m89wRt_jEUXzMG";

↳ @Reanimator7336 (0): "ACA only goes by taxable income per year period. Its not what tax bracket you are in or gross income."

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

↳ Stomoyuki (49): "Medicaid eligibility limits your access to Marketplace subsidies, which is why [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling you to apply for Medicaid. My first question is why the out-of-state hospitals won't "accept" PA Medicaid. Medicaid generally provides limited out-of-state coverage, so are they looking for something beyond basic coverage for yourself? Also, you're probably not the first student in your school encountering this issue. I'd contact the student affairs/financial aid office and ask them what they recommend in your situation. They may provide hardship resources you can utilize."

↳ emacs guy (30): "Thanks for the replies, but I think I'm just going to sign up with PA State Medicaid. They will cover life threatening ER out of state but nothing else. Which should be fine, I won't be out state maybe just 4 months max. I just hope I won't get hassled by some of the hospitals if asked. I'll just deal with it then."

↳ LizzieMac123 (13): "Healthcare.gov plan but you'll have to pay full price with no income if you're not allowed to have out of state medicaid in your program."

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1so9ty7/>

↳ (0): "Sounds like a situation where you need to involve your State Department of Insurance so they can look into this further."

↳ (0): "And your state representative office"

↳ (0): "This is far beyond what anyone here can help with. Out of curiosity - what is the reason for the retroactive termination? At worst, a premium payment issue would terminate coverage effective the last month of no payment. Since your payment issues only began in December, there's another reason why Oscar retroactively cancelled your insurance for all of 2025. Are they claiming you misrepresented yourself and were in fact ineligible?"

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

↳ (0): "Cash on hand/assets only matters if you're 65 or older. You HAVE been eligible all along, and you should feel free to use your services. You're in the exact situation this social safety net is intended for....use it all you want until you find a job and get monthly income again. And no, it would not matter even if you weren't eligible. You could have knowingly lied and committed fraud to get enrolled in Medi-Cal, but if you haven't made claims Medicaid would never know or care. There's nothing spent by them to try to recover. They'd only come after you if you had claims."

↳ (0): "Medicaid goes by going forward current monthly income, not calendar year income. Previous months do not count at all, and there is no asset test for expansion Medicaid. The monthly income limit for 2022 was \$1,563 and for 2023 \$1,677 a month."

↳ (0): "Are you saying that the "cash on hand" question is basically moot and that it's ALL about monthly income?"

"Reporting income for ACA Hi all, My wife and I are self employed and applying for marketplace insurance. I've been told that as self employed people, our income should be our gross income minus business expenses. My question is, does the \$31,000 standard deduction (married filing jointly) and other deductions count towards this? I.E. if we pull in \$160,000 for the year, but take the \$31,000 deduction, is our income technically \$129,000? or does it only include business expenses such as office dues, supplies, etc? Is this as easy as just reporting the number on the Modified AGI line on last years tax return?"

— r/obamacare · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1owg2uk/>

↳ (0): "No. The standard deduction is calculated after your MAGI is determined."

↳ (0): "No. If your net after expenses is \$160k, it all counts towards AGI...can't reduce it with the standard deduction. Not sure if you are looking to lower your AGI to get under the cap, but if so consider looking at IRA or solo 401k contributions to get it down."

↳ (0): "No, MAGI is before the standard deduction. Assuming that is 160k net on your Schedule C and that is your only income your are at 498% of FPL for a family of 4. You need to get down to 128k in order to qualify for subsidies. You can do this if you have the cash to fund a combination of SEP (32K)+ IRA (7/8k) + Spousal IRA (7/8k)"

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/>

↳ (0): "Brokers don't get paid from client. The insurance carriers pay the broker. ACA plans prices go by your income. Prices are ridiculous high."

↳ (0): "That's what I thought too, but I couldn't account for the discrepancy in prices between the brokers prices and healthcare.gov prices. Because one plan was \$30 higher but the more expensive plan was \$50 less from the broker. So I was trying to figure out why that was."

↳ (0): "We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

"I already lost mine in June because they said I didn't do income verification that used to be reviewed once a year (self employed since 2017) and my premium goes from \$1.00 to \$500) I try to call and the line says not working. I uploaded new docs but I'm guaranteed this is all AI so no human will review it."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lp1un7/if the bbb passes and the ac a is gutted what are/n0sdxbt/](https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lp1un7/if_the_bbb_passes_and_the_aca_is_gutted_what_are_n0sdxbt/)

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes/](https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/)

↳ BaltimoreBee (52): "Your broker is giving you misinformation and you should stop working with them and find a competent one. Married filed separately automatically disqualifies from any subsidies, it doesn't matter how much you earn. You will definitely owe back 100% of any subsidies they give you if you are married filing separately. The only way you can qualify for subsidies is if you file a joint tax return and those subsidies are based on your combined household income."

↳ Dakota51871 (23): "You're broker not only gave you false information but violate the rules and regulations of their contract with NYS Department of Financial Services. You should definitely file a complaint with DFS by calling 800-342-3736 and the attorney general health care line at 800-428-9071. They work on commission so they will say or do anything to make a sale."

↳ whim_sea (11): "Woah. I'm so glad I asked! Thank you !"

"Question about ACA PTC + unmarried domestic partner employer coverage My partner and I are unmarried and file taxes separately. We live together and have children, whom I claim on my taxes. I've always claimed the children. My partner's employer offers health insurance and gives him the option to cover the kids (the coverage is considered affordable) and also has the option to add a domestic partner. I was told by a Vermont Health Connect eligibility specialist that because we aren't married, the offer of affordable domestic partner coverage doesn't disqualify me from remaining on my Marketplace plan and receiving a Premium Tax Credit like it would if we were married. I've also found IRS guidance saying that someone who can enroll in an employee's employer coverage but isn't a member of the employee's tax family is considered eligible for that coverage for PTC purposes only during months they actually enroll. So essentially, his employer's offer of domestic partner coverage would only disqualify me from receiving a premium tax credit if I was to enroll. Does this sound correct? Specifically, is an affordable offer of employer coverage to an unmarried domestic partner treated differently for PTC purposes than an offer to children? Vermont Health connect told me that my partner's affordable employer insurance offer for our children does make the children ineligible for a PTC. The children and I are not part of his tax family because he doesn't claim any of us as dependents. I'm mainly trying to make sure I haven't been receiving a PTC when I shouldn't have and understand why my partner's offer of affordable coverage makes our children ineligible, but not myself."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wp131z/question_about_aca_ptc_unmarried_domestic_partner/

"Income reporting for ATPC I applied for ACA coverage in VT in Jan 26. My wife retired Jan 1 with her last pay check Jan 1 and I was going to retire mid march which I did with last pay middle of March. I estimated 2026 MAGI to be less than the 400% FPL (\$70k) That included our early 2026 earnings plus interest income for the rest of the year. We get an ACE plan with ATPC. In May, I get a letter wanting proof of income. We have no recent paystubs since we retired more than 30 days ago. Last years income doesn't reflect this year's income so tax documents don't reflect true income. I called them and they said to update my application with only current income. Our current income is only interest income which puts us under the medicaid threshold where we don't qualify for ATPC with a QHP. We are still on track for a MAGI of ~\$70k, but the online tool seems to completely disregard our early year wage income and instead bases our income on ~\$1500/mo interest income which makes us eligible for medicaid and not APTC. I called them a second time, but they seemed to just want to focus on monthly income going forward. Since it's an income change, we have a new open enrollment window for a health plan or can get medicaid. I'm trying to figure out how I can just keep the insurance we currently have and I have tried to configure the application so it bases APTC approval on the correct MAGI, but no luck. I'm guessing is that I could probably choose the same plan I have now (and may have to reset the deductables) and pay the full amount and receive the tax credits at tax time, but I don't really know. Any idea what is going on and if there is a fix to this?"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tbeakk/income_reporting_for_atpc/

↳ Comfortable_Two6272 (1): "When will your income be realized to hit the projected magi? Q4? Or earlier? If q4 from say dividends can you provide them last year's dividend info? Or if only interest then using last year's interest statements and year to date so far with an explanation letter? So far my state has not asked for mine but thats what I was advised in my state to do. (Mine is q4 dividends. But we are a non expanded state)"

↳ df33702021 (1): "My last year dividend would be less than what I expect this year. I have about \$60k (MAGI) in wage income that ended in March. I estimate ~\$10k in interest, etc that will be spread out over the remainder of 2026. So I won't hit my total estimated MAGI until end of year. I have found that if you just take your total yearly income and divide it by 12 and set payment as monthly and end of income at 12/31/26, the tool works correctly. The state enrollment tool seems to be programmed such that a new monthly income under the medicaid threshold automatically ignores past income. Similar behavior with <https://www.healthcare.gov/income-calculator/> . I suppose because medicaid eligibility is based on monthly income. I thought there were other requirements for medicaid such as amount of money in bank accounts, but the tools don't ask for that. So currently I divided out the wage income over 12 months, mark as monthly payments, and mark no termination date for the income and I'm APTC eligible again. I expect that next time I get asked for documentation (took them 3 months from initial Feb enrollment), I can just adjust my income again and kick the can down the road. I was told over the phone that an income change puts the timeline back to zero and ignore the current documentation request as it will be regenerated on the updated application. Otherwise, it seems I have to ask for a manual income evaluation, but not sure how that will go. thanks! edit: a word"

"I am currently on an ACA Bronze plan and have had this the past two years that I've been retired. I have noticed the Silver plans are quite a bit more in my state. Also Bronze plans (at least for this year) allow for HSA deposits. Not sure if you can do that with Silver. I'm afraid to drop vision and dental because I wear glasses and have had big dental bills in the past. I'll check the math though. And I'm paying about twice as much as you are for one person (health+vision only). At open enrollment I'll look again. Also will see if I can maybe lower my MAGI. I told them \$62K for this year (which is near the max for a single person and still get a subsidy). Lowering this to \$35K or \$40K might be possible but it would require withdrawals from my Roth IRA to make up the difference."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugz860t4k73b15uGt_x4AaABAq

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (5): "Yes. your MAGI is very important and if you can control it and keep it lower you will get better pricing."

↳ @sunnybrookfm-75 (3): "The last 5 years I worked before actually retiring I had to provide my own health insurance the first year where I worked. I used the subsidies like you and paid approximately what you are. In my case it was 180 dollars per month since I'm single. I was earning 15 dollars an hour. I was working 2 jobs. I also had really cheap places to live. We were unionized too thank goodness. When the year was up I got the union healthcare for \$5 a week plus I was on part a of Medicare. The employer had a huge amount of employees so you can do what I'm talking about. I am a retired paralegal and nurse. In addition I have vision problems that caused me to have cataract issues. I had to have them removed from both eyes in my late 50s. I also went completely blind in both eyes for 6 weeks. Some vision came back in 1 eye. I was disqualified from disability because 1 eye functions pretty well. At any rate my vision problems are considered a medical condition. The good news is my doctor tells me my condition has stabilized and I now qualify for low vision benefits. Most of those I would have to pay for out of pocket so I just go along the best I can with what I have. I'm allowed to drive and restrict myself to daytime driving. I go to discount eyeglass providers and pay about 50% less than I would if I went to my doctor for eyeglasses. When I retired I went from health insurance plus pt A Medicare to Medicare and a high deductible medigap plan. I was able to keep health insurance plus pt A Medicare until 67 because my store had a huge amount of employees and had somewhat decent health insurance thru the union. Because of this loophole I was entitled to keep my \$5 dollar a week health insurance until I retired at 67. I am now 73. My retirement age was 66. I eventually added dental insurance I figure if I need implants I can be a dental tourist and get them done abroad if I need to. So far my blood pressure has come down into the normal range now that I'm not working as well. And I've not had to take any medication for my blood pressure. Yay! I'm just taking care of myself. Now mind you this is also because I'm exceptionally frugal. I live on 21k and save 5k a year. Furthermore at the age of 72 I came into a nestegg of 325k from 2 individuals in my life and my own savings. My family left me the 325k. I've not had to touch a nickel of it. And since the 21k is technically my only source of income I owe zero dollars in taxes. Bonus for me 😊😊 . I pay 825 dollars a month in rent and have a small 20 pound dog. My best friend bought my house outright and rents it to me. It is 850 sq ft of heaven. I live in a home built in 1950 that is constantly undergoing renovations. And I live a very simple modest lifestyle. My neighborhood is a working class neighborhood in a downtown area. I live in a wealthy county outside a large metropolitan city. My city has a population of 100k approximately. It is peaceful and quiet. Yes when you are pricing out your healthcare check out both federal and state laws."

↳ @richard1113 (0): "@sunnybrookfm-75 Thank you for sharing your story. It sounds like you're doing ok!"

"I plan to retire at the end of the year and will be living on savings and interest income for the next decade or so until I collect SS. One of the reasons for retiring is to care for my elderly bedridden father full time. I will likely do some consulting but doubt my income will be higher than \$20000. I will have access to cobra but it's \$1500/month. I checked ACA in my state and it said I would qualify for Medicare. This seems implausible since I have significant assets (a paid-for home, money in the bank, and a decent 401k plan). Does Medicaid consider your assets? I called the state office and they said they just look at income. Also, since they don't consider caring for elderly parents as "working" I wonder about the bbb's work requirements. Anyway, thanks for your video—I have a lot of research to do!"

— YouTube · HOW to ESTIMATE Your 2026 ACA (Marketplace) Premiums! (calculator) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=N7I023Co9ro&lc=UgwWX5t-CAaAY5RxOht4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "From what I understand, right now they only look at income but that may change in the future. It also sounds like the work requirements won't start until January 1, 2027. So you have some time to figure it out!"

↳ @scottsteward398 (0): "From what I have learned, (videos and research) you probably don't want to be on Medicaid, Consider earning some income, drawing from investments, to get a Medicare subsidized policy."

↳ @Robert9-tz1 (0): "\$1500 a month for COBRA? Is that for one person or for a family? Wow. My COBRA was an excellent plan and was around \$650 a month. It ran out a couple months ago unfortunately."

"I'm in that mess right now. Just sold my business, 60 years old, ~\$1.2M saved across retirement and taxable accounts, and the ACA side makes zero sense. Everyone says "watch your income," but no one explains what that really means. That advisor you mentioned... did they finally make sense of MAGI and ACA? Because I swear none of this adds up when I try to figure it out myself."

— YouTube · How to Qualify for ACA Health Insurance Subsidies as an Early Retiree · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cDtnJs9uN7M&lc=Ugydxu_GGVuWu8ya0gd4AaABAg.AOcDEut4XcfAPM6SvVB2Hx

"I was told by the marketplace person when I signed up you have to meet the minimum requirement of \$1560 a year to get the subsidy otherwise it's the non-subsidized price of like \$500 a month. I'm almost halfway through the year."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/ofu4ayg/

"VT Question about ACA PTC + unmarried domestic partner employer coverage My partner and I are unmarried and file taxes separately. We live together and have children, whom I claim on my taxes. I've always claimed the children. My partner's employer offers health insurance and gives him the option to cover the kids (the coverage is considered affordable) and also has the option to add a domestic partner. I was told by a Vermont Health Connect eligibility specialist that because we aren't married, the offer of affordable domestic partner coverage doesn't disqualify me from remaining on my Marketplace plan and receiving a Premium Tax Credit like it would if we were married. I've also found IRS guidance saying that someone who can enroll in an employee's employer coverage but isn't a member of the employee's tax family is considered eligible for that coverage for PTC purposes only during months they actually enroll. So essentially, his employer's offer of domestic partner coverage would only disqualify me from receiving a premium tax credit if I was to enroll. Does this sound correct? Specifically, is an affordable offer of employer coverage to an unmarried domestic partner treated differently for PTC purposes than an offer to children? Vermont Health connect told me that my partner's affordable employer insurance offer for our children does make the children ineligible for a PTC. The children and I are not part of his tax family because he doesn't claim any of us as dependents. I'm mainly trying to make sure I haven't been receiving a PTC when I shouldn't have and understand why my partner's offer of affordable coverage makes our children ineligible, but not myself."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpegde/vt_question_about_aca_ptc_unmarried_domestic/

↳ BaltimoreBee (3): "Yes, this is correct. The federal government doesn't recognize domestic partnerships and being eligible for domestic partnership benefits, which come with associated taxes because of the lack of federal recognition, does not disqualify one from APTC."

"My last year dividend would be less than what I expect this year. I have about \$60k (MAGI) in wage income that ended in March. I estimate ~\$10k in interest, etc that will be spread out over the remainder of 2026. So I won't hit my total estimated MAGI until end of year. I have found that if you just take your total yearly income and divide it by 12 and set payment as monthly and end of income at 12/31/26, the tool works correctly. The state enrollment tool seems to be programmed such that a new monthly income under the medicaid threshold automatically ignores past income. Similar behavior with <https://www.healthcare.gov/income-calculator/> . I suppose because medicaid eligibility is based on monthly income. I thought there were other requirements for medicaid such as amount of money in bank accounts, but the tools don't ask for that. So currently I divided out the wage income over 12 months, mark as monthly payments, and mark no termination date for the income and I'm APTC eligible again. I expect that next time I get asked for documentation (took them 3 months from initial Feb enrollment), I can just adjust my income again and kick the can down the road. I was told over the phone that an income change puts the timeline back to zero and ignore the current documentation request as it will be regenerated on the updated application. Otherwise, it seems I have to ask for a manual income evaluation, but not sure how that will go. thanks! edit: a word"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tbeakk/income_reporting_for_atp_c/olrp21e/

"I retired in 2023 but wont qualify for medicare until 2026. I was told by a tax pro that since my only (unearned) income is from SS and a bit of interest from a bank (about 30K total) it disqualifies me from getting any ACA (premium tax credit) subsidy for tax year 2024 because its all unearned income. Of course, since I dont work anymore being fully retired, my earned income is 0). Going by the 1040 and 8962 instructions for 2024 it certainly seems like i had a premium tax credit for at least some of my ACA monthly costs coming back to me since im at 200 percent of the poverty level. (i didnt set up advance tax credits for 2024 in the fall of 2023 because i was nervous i would get screwed at 2024 tax time). This sucks, my ACA healthcare is now almost 30 percent of my income. Talk about a donut hole!"

— YouTube · How to Qualify for ACA Health Insurance Subsidies as an Early Retiree · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cDtnJs9uN7M&lc=Ugxzp5AxlcobGA803ld4AaABAq>

↳ @catchristo9406 (1): "That's why I kept telling my brother to start investing fully into a traditional IRA so he could pull out just enough each year to have enough taxable income to qualify for the ACA. He finally listened to me and will save thousands of dollars when he retires a bit early."

"I was told when i applied that you have to at least meet the minimum requirement or else you have to pay the \$500 (which is what the plan without the subsidy costs) My state doesn't have expanded medicaid so thats out of the question."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/ofkrkla/

"Whenever your estimate for your annual income changes, you should change it for ACA. This is most likely to happen when you calculate your quarterly estimated tax payments - since that's when you're looking at what you've earned so far. But if you look at it another time and realize you're making more or less than expected, go ahead and change it. In the end, it only matters when you file taxes next year and look at whether you got more or less subsidies than you should have. I retired last year and have my portfolio structured so that I have no unexpected annual fluctuations. I get a little income from selling stocks and interest - but most of my stated income comes from my Roth conversions (moving money from a Traditional IRA to a Roth IRA). So I just increase or decrease my Roth conversion to match what I told ACA. That gives me full control - for 2025 my income was only about \$1k off what I told ACA."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qk7mnx/how_often_do_you_report_income_for_aca_coverage/o15gn7y/

What the marketplace told them · 20 documents · 20 voices

"My employer dropped me from health insurance About a year and a half ago I became eligible for health insurance at my new job (one of the reasons I accepted position was for the benefits). After about a month or so of coverage I was asked to come in for a meeting. Our insurance broker was there along with the director of operations. The broker explained that if I continued coverage my coworker's premiums would go up so high that no one could afford them. He said that they could no longer cover me and he would send in someone to help me sign up for coverage on the marketplace (which someone did). I questioned if all this was legal and was told that because their policy is under-written then, yes, it is legal for them to drop me. I should also add that I am a breast cancer survivor. I still get preventative treatment monthly at a local cancer center. It was after the first claim was submitted by the center that this all went down. Was this legal?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 206 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mvkoso/>

↳ (0): "Is the company paying for your marketplace premiums and is it the same level of coverage your company offers to the other employees, including deductibles, co-insurance, and co-pays? Do you have a copy of the company's policy where it says that cancer coverage is excluded? Does this company employ more than 50 people? Need more info to determine if it was legal or not. You might call your state's department of labor and ask."

↳ (0): "I would pay it then they would add the reimbursement to my paycheck. The coverage was similar. I only did it for a few months. I got married and I'm now on my husband's policy. Nowhere did I read that cancer was excluded. More than 50 people during peak seasons, less in the off season."

↳ (0): "If it has fewer than 50 full-time year-round employees it actually doesn't have to offer health insurance at all, but if they do they have to offer it to everyone. You were reimbursed for the premium and the coverage was similar to what the company offered. It sounds like they were doing the right thing for you while keeping costs down for the rest of the employees. Not a lawyer but I don't see anything illegal about it."

"Employer Won't Sign Me Up For Insurance Until Apr 2026 I started a new job today and I was talking to the HR rep about health insurance. She said that the OE period passed in Apr and I wouldn't be able to sign up again until next Apr. Cue me freaking out because I have conditions that need to be managed with meds. I pushed back because any job I worked at you were always allowed to enroll after the probation period. She said she has to check with I guess the insurance broker. She then told me since I'm losing my coverage at my previous job what going on COBRA, which I would think any HR rep would know how ridiculous of a question that is. I just want to make sure I'm right about them needing to allow me to enroll before Apr 2026. **UPDATE:** it is 90 days so I just have to hold out until Oct. HR rep is new and needs to learn the job better."

— r/HealthInsurance · 136 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1luih01/>

↳ (0): "If new job with a new company, then you have a qualifying event. The rep needs to provide you with details for you to enroll. Press them on this."

↳ (0): "The good news is that now you know that your HR contact is an idiot, and that their initial reaction to any request will be NO, rather than curiosity. Your situation is "employer-based health insurance 101". A new job is a qualifying event in any state."

↳ (0): "It's a qualifying event, but we also don't know when the employer stated that coverage begins when they sent out an offer letter. It is not out of the question for there to be a waiting period with no benefits on day 1. The question is what OP was told in the offer letter."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: <https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>;

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

↳ Stomoyuki (49): "Medicaid eligibility limits your access to Marketplace subsidies, which is why [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling you to apply for Medicaid. My first question is why the out-of-state hospitals won't "accept" PA Medicaid. Medicaid generally provides limited out-of-state coverage, so are they looking for something beyond basic coverage for yourself? Also, you're probably not the first student in your school encountering this issue. I'd contact the student affairs/financial aid office and ask them what they recommend in your situation. They may provide hardship resources you can utilize."

↳ emacs guy (30): "Thanks for the replies, but I think I'm just going to sign up with PA State Medicaid. They will cover life threatening ER out of state but nothing else. Which should be fine, I won't be out state maybe just 4 months max. I just hope I won't get hassled by some of the hospitals if asked. I'll just deal with it then."

↳ LizzieMac123 (13): "Healthcare.gov plan but you'll have to pay full price with no income if you're not allowed to have out of state medicaid in your program."

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1so9ty7/>

↳ (0): "Sounds like a situation where you need to involve your State Department of Insurance so they can look into this further."

↳ (0): "And your state representative office"

↳ (0): "This is far beyond what anyone here can help with. Out of curiosity - what is the reason for the retroactive termination? At worst, a premium payment issue would terminate coverage effective the last month of no payment. Since your payment issues only began in December, there's another reason why Oscar retroactively cancelled your insurance for all of 2025. Are they claiming you misrepresented yourself and were in fact ineligible?"

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1inzqe8/>

↳ (0): "The income limits for Medicaid for pregnant women and new children is much higher, once your child turns 1 the income requirements change, wife is no longer considered in the postpartum period. If your wife was pregnant, or had just recently had the baby (within the last 3 months usually) when you signed up for coverage then they most likely gave baby needy newborn coverage, and wife MAGI pregnant coverage. Children born to mothers on Medicaid get guaranteed eligibility till 1 year old under expanded medicaid rules. Once baby is a year old, child and mother go back to medicaid children, and medicaid adult guidelines. If you make 65k per year you earn too much. If they lost coverage you have the right to apply for marketplace coverage outside of open enrollment period with a qualifying life event. Edit- spelling Edit- I have seen and reported blatant Medicaid fraud on numerous occasions within my job, I've seen hundreds of cases of people 100% committing fraud without a doubt. Income gets reported and they call and say they quit, income is ended, a few months later same thing. I have seen 100s of income discrepancies on one case, client never asked to provide proof, or any information about income and the fact they are no longer employed. I've completed 100s of application, I've worked 1,000s of medicaid cases, never ever seen any fraud cases. Only fraud cases I've seen are with SNAP, which they seem to take much more seriously. Medicaid fraud is expensive for tax payers when it's committed by providers, it's not usually bothered with when committed by individuals. It sounds like your situation is very different, there is proof regarding what you did with the recorded phone call, and the marketplace application you submitted. I think you have no reason to worry about them coming after you for fraud."

↳ (0): "I've read Missouri Medicaid has terrible backups in processing. Just make sure you have records of your transactions with them. <https://missouriindependent.com/2024/06/17/feds-to-scrutinize-missouris-worst-in-the-nation-medicaid-application-delays/>";

↳ (0): "Well that's just it. I have no records. My application was done 100% over the phone with a representative who never requested any documents. She messed up over the phone. And six months later when I went to fill out a change in income form, I did it at their office and turned it in. And they have no records of that either so they don't have one document from me and they approved me. All I have is an application number from before I was approved. 100% verbal with zero documentation."

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/ysinnk/>

↳ (0): "I wonder if the sales agent had ulterior motives (difference in commission?)"

↳ (0): "It definitely sounded fishy when I heard it. Thanks"

↳ (0): "Buy on marketplace plan. Direct is not subject to the ACA regulations."

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

↳ TremendouslyMuffled (20): "Medicaid is exactly what you need here, being 18 and no income means you'll almost certainly qualify, and unlike the marketplace it's open year-round"

↳ LizzieMac123 (11): "That is if a parent doesn't claim OP as a dependent on their taxes. If a parent claims OP, they have to include the household income- which is likely the case if the Marketplace told OP they were eligible, but open enrollment is closed vs. sending them to medicaid directly."

↳ Blossom73 (5): "Because you're under 19, your mom's income counts if you live with her and/or are her tax dependent. That's because children's Medicaid ends at age 19 in Texas. Once you turn 19 you unfortunately won't qualify for Medicaid in Texas unless you're pregnant, disabled, as in deemed disabled by the SSA or the state, or an extremely low income parent of a minor child. The monthly income limit for children's Medicaid in TX for a household of 2 is \$2448. \$3714 for CHIP. <https://www.snapscreener.com/medicaid/guides/texas> Is your mom married? Does she have any other dependents?"

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/>

↳ (0): "Brokers don't get paid from client. The insurance carriers pay the broker. ACA plans prices go by your income. Prices are ridiculous high."

↳ (0): "That's what I thought too, but I couldn't account for the discrepancy in prices between the brokers prices and healthcare.gov prices. Because one plan was \$30 higher but the more expensive plan was \$50 less from the broker. So I was trying to figure out why that was."

↳ (0): "We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

↳ BaltimoreBee (52): "Your broker is giving you misinformation and you should stop working with them and find a competent one. Married filed separately automatically disqualifies from any subsidies, it doesn't matter how much you earn. You will definitely owe back 100% of any subsidies they give you if you are married filing separately. The only way you can qualify for subsidies is if you file a joint tax return and those subsidies are based on your combined household income."

↳ Dakota51871 (23): "You're broker not only gave you false information but violate the rules and regulations of their contract with NYS Department of Financial Services. You should definitely file a complaint with DFS by calling 800-342-3736 and the attorney general health care line at 800-428-9071. They work on commission so they will say or do anything to make a sale."

↳ whim_sea (11): "Woah. I'm so glad I asked! Thank you !"

"I live in Virginia and back in 2020 had to be hospitalized from uterine fibroid bleeding that was so severe even the ER nurse said, "Im glad you came in, because you may have died if you didn't." Needed 4 blood transfusions to be classified as stable. I had no income and lived with my mom although I aged out of her insurance. They did not offer me a cent off through any charity care program told me apply for emergency Medicaid coverage or there's nothing that can be done. I have not been able to get a hysterectomy to cure me from risk of this happening again. What do they expect someone like me to do? I only got covered by the expansion by the skin of my teeth timing wise. I could not work in that severely anemic state I couldn't even get around Walmart by myself. But doesn't count for official disability...and I'm young,31."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lki09f/key_gop_senator_warns_medicare_cuts_would_spell_disaster_for_millions/

"Question about ACA PTC + unmarried domestic partner employer coverage My partner and I are unmarried and file taxes separately. We live together and have children, whom I claim on my taxes. I've always claimed the children. My partner's employer offers health insurance and gives him the option to cover the kids (the coverage is considered affordable) and also has the option to add a domestic partner. I was told by a Vermont Health Connect eligibility specialist that because we aren't married, the offer of affordable domestic partner coverage doesn't disqualify me from remaining on my Marketplace plan and receiving a Premium Tax Credit like it would if we were married. I've also found IRS guidance saying that someone who can enroll in an employee's employer coverage but isn't a member of the employee's tax family is considered eligible for that coverage for PTC purposes only during months they actually enroll. So essentially, his employer's offer of domestic partner coverage would only disqualify me from receiving a premium tax credit if I was to enroll. Does this sound correct? Specifically, is an affordable offer of employer coverage to an unmarried domestic partner treated differently for PTC purposes than an offer to children? Vermont Health connect told me that my partner's affordable employer insurance offer for our children does make the children ineligible for a PTC. The children and I are not part of his tax family because he doesn't claim any of us as dependents. I'm mainly trying to make sure I haven't been receiving a PTC when I shouldn't have and understand why my partner's offer of affordable coverage makes our children ineligible, but not myself."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wp131z/question_about_aca_ptc_unmarried_domestic_partner/

"This is kind of ridiculous, but I also have Health First and if I was receiving one cent Health premium bills, I would be calling when I got the first one to see if this was an error or if I truly needed to pay it and then I would pay it if I did owe it I have debited \$.57 before at the store, so I know it's possible to debit a penny or to charge a penny per month So sorry, I can't have that much sympathy for her when she received bills and even a letter that her insurance was ending and she decided to ignore it and think it was a rounding error or an error on their part You don't mess around with insurance because it can snowball. You need to become an expert and your insurance plan and that's exactly what I have done. I've had Health First for about five years now and a couple years ago, I knew I had paid too much. They kept saying I hadn't, Health First. So I filed a grievance and I listed out every payment I had made to any doctor or any prescription. They still wouldn't admit fault, but I got a check for the exact amount. I said I had overpaid by. What changed is you used to go to the doctor and you would pay your co-pay if you had one but other than that, they would bill you. Because they would build the insurance and see what it would be paid and if there was anything left over that was owed, then they would bill you. Now they're trying to collect everything upfront. That year I had went to a dermatologist and when I left and went through the checkout part, they told me it was \$143.50. I had had a full body check and I had had two moles removed. I knew I had reached my out-of-pocket maximum. And I told them that. So then they say I had to pay \$30 which is my co-pay for a specialist. I didn't want to do that, but I caved and did it. I go home and call my insurance company and they say no, you are right, you have met your out-of-pocket max, you didn't owe anything. It took my insurance nearly 3 weeks to get a hold of their billing department and they wanted to give me a credit. How do they know I'm coming back next year??? they don't Send me a check. And they did. But it is your job to know your insurance plan and if you don't, you need to be calling and asking. And I know they don't make it easy. Part of your insurance coverage is on this website and your prescriptions are on a different website and something else is on a different website, they do not make it easy. But it's in your best interest to learn it. So I do see it that it was this woman's fault, she should've called, on that First bill that she got this set of Penny, I would never assume anything with insurance. To me, she looks like a fool for losing her insurance over a penny a month or five cents a month or whatever it was. She tanked herself by not paying that. I would've sent a check every month for a Penny. Or I would've debited it or put it on a credit card. I have the hospital here try to go after me over \$.57. I paid it and I had the confirmation page because I print all of that out. It turns out they decided to take that \$.57 and put it on something else, even though on the screen it showed me it was going towards the bill that I owed \$.57 for. Oh, I got on the phone and raised hell and they actually ended up just erasing the \$.57 altogether. It turns out even though it's showing me that that \$.57 went towards the \$.57 bill I owed, but if you owed anything prior, they can change it and put it towards that. And I didn't know anything prior, it all had just crossed in the mail. The minute I get a bill for something healthwise, it gets paid and goes back out in the mail the next day. I don't like doing online payments when it comes to health bills. I prefer to send a check still."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s8bxnc/an_insurer_canceled_a_womans_coverage_over_a_odismhs/

"VT Question about ACA PTC + unmarried domestic partner employer coverage My partner and I are unmarried and file taxes separately. We live together and have children, whom I claim on my taxes. I've always claimed the children. My partner's employer offers health insurance and gives him the option to cover the kids (the coverage is considered affordable) and also has the option to add a domestic partner. I was told by a Vermont Health Connect eligibility specialist that because we aren't married, the offer of affordable domestic partner coverage doesn't disqualify me from remaining on my Marketplace plan and receiving a Premium Tax Credit like it would if we were married. I've also found IRS guidance saying that someone who can enroll in an employee's employer coverage but isn't a member of the employee's tax family is considered eligible for that coverage for PTC purposes only during months they actually enroll. So essentially, his employer's offer of domestic partner coverage would only disqualify me from receiving a premium tax credit if I was to enroll. Does this sound correct? Specifically, is an affordable offer of employer coverage to an unmarried domestic partner treated differently for PTC purposes than an offer to children? Vermont Health connect told me that my partner's affordable employer insurance offer for our children does make the children ineligible for a PTC. The children and I are not part of his tax family because he doesn't claim any of us as dependents. I'm mainly trying to make sure I haven't been receiving a PTC when I shouldn't have and understand why my partner's offer of affordable coverage makes our children ineligible, but not myself."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpegde/vt_question_about_aca_ptc_unmarried_domestic/

↳ BaltimoreBee (3): "Yes, this is correct. The federal government doesn't recognize domestic partnerships and being eligible for domestic partnership benefits, which come with associated taxes because of the lack of federal recognition, does not disqualify one from APTC."

"Hmo help with selecting obgyn I've never had an hmo before, so this is all new and scary to me. Any advice is appreciated! I have an hmo with Blue Shield of California, through the marketplace. My PCP has been changed multiple times this year (side rant, why are Drs allowed to change networks mid year but we aren't?!) so I've never actually met the man. I got pregnant through a fertility clinic and they are getting ready to release me to an obgyn. I called my insurance to check that I don't need a referral (California law) but they told me I did. Ok, fine, whatever. I got an appointment with my PCP, and he said I didn't need a referral, but he'd go ahead and submit one anyway. Now I'm lost as to what my next step is. Do I just browse the blue shield website until I find an obgyn I like? Am I restricted to only certain doctors? No one's really explaining anything, and then when they do they seem to be incorrect and uninformed. If anyone knows how this stuff actually works I'd really appreciate the help! I definitely won't be doing an hmo again, no matter the cost savings"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpd1hx/hmo_help_with_selecting_obgyn/

↳ GroinFlutter (2): "You need to find an obgyn that is in network with your HMO. What medical group is your PCP under? That's the medical group/'network' that you are limited to. Most of these medical groups will have their own websites that show in network providers. You could go there and search for one."

↳ MrsRadon (2): "So, even though I can change the network at any time, I'm still limited to picking a doctor within the network of my PCP? I'm just so confused why I'm paying for blue shield, but I don't have access to the full blue shield network"

↳ ThrowRA50673 (2): "Yes, that's basically how an HMO works. Your PCP is assigned to a medical group/IPA, and that group has its own network of specialists. For most specialist care, you're limited to doctors contracted with that medical group unless an exception or out-of-network authorization is approved. So being "in network with Blue Shield" alone doesn't necessarily mean you can see that doctor."

"Idk how it worked out that I was paying 25% of premiums. Making about \$16k a year for a single person. Then 2026 it doubled and so it was too much and I was canceled. I moved and then estimated maybe \$13k a year. They said apply for Medicaid and if denied come back. But then it was too late (denied Medicaid which was expected as I have assets). I'm in my late 50s. Only had one ER event which I wound up paying out of pocket over \$500. It wasn't anything crazy serious but they had to do a lot of tests to rule serious things out. I wonder even why bother anymore. That's it as I supposedly had dental coverage but that was a total joke. Wanted to change plans and not bother with dental and just pay for that myself. Could not even look at plans until I produced Medicaid denial letter. My premiums were going to be almost \$700/mo. Just moved and unemployed for now. My only option is to get a job with coverage (haven't had that in ages) or ACA. Or nothing and use health centers. 😞 Oh joy. Ugh."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgznxfeMI1eqcF6tSvx4AaABAq

"Welcome. We currently have a Silver plan with BCBS in Nebraska and are very happy so far. Better coverage than we had with my previous employer. I recommend going to healthcare.gov and creating an account and looking at plans for your state plus doing a Google search to deep dive plans. We have more ACA videos coming out soon. Thanks."

— YouTube · \$1 Can Destroy Your ACA Subsidy in Early Retirement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Th4776liNeM&lc=UgyULAyycp6RGeG_BtB4AaABAq.A_XUa3W7tZhA_XYGXlouuY

"My strong suspicion is that it is an issue with the Marketplace. I called the insurer and they said it was on the Marketplace side too. I have an escalation in place for a reinstatement so I'm just waiting on them to respond."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmwnck/help_aca_plan_termination_notice_after_reporting/pbdl0ar/

"Thank you for the extra tips! We have been working with someone from ACA that told us to wait to apply but start the process now."

— YouTube · ACA 2026 Update: The One Income Strategy That Saves Thousands · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b7tw43UuPrY&lc=UgzMwvxBrGnOm8H7mj14AaABAg.AQMI1mLhIxuAQMgrek-vCK>

"The Affordable Care Act is an abomination! Affordable, it is not and never has been. Our daughter had insurance when the ACA was passed. Her insurance company cancelled her insurance (\$300/mo, \$3,000 deductible) and told her to go on the exchanges. (\$335/mo, \$6,000 deductible). She got screwed. Now the rates are beyond unaffordable. Throw the whole thing in the trash and start over. Obama lied. He said the average American would save \$2,500/mo. No one saved a dime. No one will take on the insurance companies or the drug companies. We have "no-balls" politicians. The Europeans pay 2/3 less for everything. I know. I was there and saw it with my own eyes, working in the healthcare arena."

— YouTube · Obamacare enrollees get first look at 2026 prices as premiums soar · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2Aznbv0Pnoc&lc=UgyyfUVObbYc3nCYMUJ4AaABAg>

What the broker or agent told them · 12 documents · 12 voices

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😬 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>

↳ (0): "We're in a similar situation. We pay over 20,000 a year for a high deductible plan on my husband's policy. We've explored alternatives, including purchasing coverage for me through the Marketplace; but our most "affordable" option is to stay on his plan because it is based on pre-taxed income. We've also tried the pay out of pocket approach, and I had a minor health emergency, which cost several thousand. We decided that going uninsured with little children is too risky."

↳ (0): "... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."

↳ (0): "1700/month here...basically same exact situation you are in. My wife is just like your husband. My employer pays for employee 100%, as soon as I add my family, wife, 2 kids....1700/month...vision, dental,

included. Eastern PA. I've been fighting this for over 10 years with my employer. I love my job, but each year with this nonsense, it gets harder and harder to argue it's worth staying. My mortgage is 1300/month. Good luck, as all I have ever been told is get a new job."

"I thought the income considered for ACA would be income after we retire not total anticipate income for this year. Husband and I are retiring in July this year. I called health broker and was told our 2026 total income does not qualify us for subsidies this year. We can definitely control our MAGI next year. But the cost of health insurance without subsidies for this year is \$2,400 a month for bronze. Crazy"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 155 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgzvkYbznI6KYejn5LV4AaABAq>

↳ @Reanimator7336 (2): "If you work at all in retirement you are not retired."

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "that is crazy - sorry! here's more about MAGI: https://youtu.be/KDE1jO1z3Sg?si=U8m89wRt_jEUXzMG";

↳ @Reanimator7336 (0): "ACA only goes by taxable income per year period. Its not what tax bracket you are in or gross income."

"Employer Won't Sign Me Up For Insurance Until Apr 2026 I started a new job today and I was talking to the HR rep about health insurance. She said that the OE period passed in Apr and I wouldn't be able to sign up again until next Apr. Cue me freaking out because I have conditions that need to be managed with meds. I pushed back because any job I worked at you were always allowed to enroll after the probation period. She said she has to check with I guess the insurance broker. She then told me since I'm losing my coverage at my previous job what going on COBRA, which I would think any HR rep would know how ridiculous of a question that is. I just want to make sure I'm right about them needing to allow me to enroll before Apr 2026. **UPDATE:** it is 90 days so I just have to hold out until Oct. HR rep is new and needs to learn the job better."

— r/HealthInsurance · 136 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1luih01/>

↳ (0): "If new job with a new company, then you have a qualifying event. The rep needs to provide you with details for you to enroll. Press them on this."

↳ (0): "The good news is that now you know that your HR contact is an idiot, and that their initial reaction to any request will be NO, rather than curiosity. Your situation is "employer-based health insurance 101". A new job is a qualifying event in any state."

↳ (0): "It's a qualifying event, but we also don't know when the employer stated that coverage begins when they sent out an offer letter. It is not out of the question for there to be a waiting period with no benefits on day 1. The question is what OP was told in the offer letter."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: <https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>;

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qsd3bg/>

↳ (0): "Why are you trying to do this? What's your goal?"

↳ (0): "This is the right question!"

↳ (0): "It sounds like you're looking to get a secondary plan as your work plan is primary and doesn't provide the treatments you're wanting. If you go this route make sure that the secondary plan will cover non-covered charges from the primary plan. I've seen a lot of secondary plans that won't cover if the primary doesn't even if the plan normally would"

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

↳ (0): "Cash on hand/assets only matters if you're 65 or older. You HAVE been eligible all along, and you should feel free to use your services. You're in the exact situation this social safety net is intended for....use it all you want until you find a job and get monthly income again. And no, it would not matter even if you weren't eligible. You could have knowingly lied and committed fraud to get enrolled in Medi-Cal, but if you haven't made claims Medicaid would never know or care. There's nothing spent by them to try to recover. They'd only come after you if you had claims."

↳ (0): "Medicaid goes by going forward current monthly income, not calendar year income. Previous months do not count at all, and there is no asset test for expansion Medicaid. The monthly income limit for 2022 was \$1,563 and for 2023 \$1,677 a month."

↳ (0): "Are you saying that the "cash on hand" question is basically moot and that it's ALL about monthly income?"

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

↳ wischywaschy (3): "I can't really help but I also have massive problems with IBX (self-funded plan) with an appeal process and the DOL is trying to help. IBX is a mess - it looks like they don't follow all ERISA regulations and seem very disorganized. The DOL is helpful but they are really short-staffed since they got DOGE'd, so whatever they can do for us is slow. They said to me they can do more when more people complain, so please

complain!"

↳ budrow21 (2): "I would file the appeals directly and continue working through the DoL. You don't have many other options."

↳ theoretalking (2): "Have you tried asking your employer's benefit manager and the broker to follow up with the account manager at IBX since she has not been responsive? The most people you got pushing and fighting for you, the better. sounds like you called your state's DOL? Try the US DOL here: <https://beta.dol.gov/about/agencies/ebsa/ask-ebsa> Have you tried looking up ERISA lawyers on Google? When I did that, I see a bunch lawyers that specialize in ERISA show up. It seems most (or not all) of them offer free consultation. I suggest you try that to find someone in your region."

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/>

↳ (0): "Brokers don't get paid from client. The insurance carriers pay the broker. ACA plans prices go by your income. Prices are ridiculous high."

↳ (0): "That's what I thought too, but I couldn't account for the discrepancy in prices between the brokers prices and healthcare.gov prices. Because one plan was \$30 higher but the more expensive plan was \$50 less from the broker. So I was trying to figure out why that was."

↳ (0): "We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

↳ BaltimoreBee (52): "Your broker is giving you misinformation and you should stop working with them and find a competent one. Married filed separately automatically disqualifies from any subsidies, it doesn't matter how much you earn. You will definitely owe back 100% of any subsidies they give you if you are married filing separately. The only way you can qualify for subsidies is if you file a joint tax return and those subsidies are based on your combined household income."

↳ Dakota51871 (23): "You're broker not only gave you false information but violate the rules and regulations of their contract with NYS Department of Financial Services. You should definitely file a complaint with DFS by calling 800-342-3736 and the attorney general health care line at 800-428-9071. They work on commission so they will say or do anything to make a sale."

↳ whim_sea (11): "Woah. I'm so glad I asked! Thank you !"

"It is not open enrollment for ACA, so you would need a life event to enroll right now. And I hope no one sees this and uses it because I would be too afraid of what it might be. I'm trying to be kind. I used a broker many years to sign up for ACA, but they don't do much of what you told me, they just helped me pick a plan that might be best for me. I have no idea what they get, but I worked with the same one for years and her name happened to be the same as mine."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_without_an_agent_on_their/o94hc0r/

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1r5uq2v/>

↳ (0): "U file and claim him and ut goes on yours"

↳ (0): "You pay all his expenses. If he made over 5200 you can still claim him and he can file and say he's being claimed as a dependent. But since you claim him it has to go on yours. This happened with my son as I claimed him and he filed as a dependent. It wouldn't let me file his with the 1095 a because he was a dependent. It had to go on mine."

↳ (0): ">Thank you! You're welcome!"

"Used a friend's broker, told them I would soon be overqualified for my essential plan, just to wind up being enrolled in a different essential plan Hey, I'm not opposed to having low costs on things, and would rather not start paying \$200+ on a plan (if I can even find one with a monthly rate that low), but I'm trying to avoid trouble at tax time since I'll be making more than the \$31,920 limit. I could have just stayed on my current essential plan and just re-enrolled with the same (underestimated) income information. I'm probably just going to remove this broker from my NY marketplace account and figure this out on my own if I can, unless if it seems better to just stay on the essential plan anyway. I have a chronic illness and consider working less/switching careers often, and my income fluctuates a lot in the service industry so I really have to ballpark it every year, I just don't wanna get dinged for underestimating years in a row. I already had to fight my insurance a ton for meds, treatments etc so switching seems like it's gonna be a pain in the ass no matter what, I just don't know what's best."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woj8ho/used_a_friends_broker_told_them_i_would_soon_be/

↳ someguy984 (1): "Next year when you renew the high income will show in your tax return. NY will use that info and assume you are going to continue make the same amount. You would need to explain why your income will drop for them to accept the estimate."

What the plan or the office told them · 11 documents · 11 voices

"Am I misinterpreting my plan or is my insurance violating the ACA Two months ago I had my first annual gyno exam. A few days later I check my myChart and I have a 177.77 bill, which surprised me. I check my BCBS member portal and the EOB. They both say the total was 336, a discount was applied, plan paid 0.00, leaving me to pay a 177.77 copayment. (The insurance claim and EOB both specifically call it a copay). I thought it was a weird amount for a "copayment". I called customer service because I thought Under the Affordable Care Act your insurance can't charge you copayment, coinsurance, or a deductible on preventative care (i.e. routine gyno exams). The guy told me he saw I was entitled to a one covered yearly exam and would investigate it for me and call me back. Then they told me that the billing department says it was billed correctly because my benefits say "Annual Gynecological Exam - one per benefit period Covered - 100% after 100% copay" That wording is extremely confusing to me and more confusing is that my member handbook in the portal literally says... You have coverage for preventive care as required by the Affordable Care Act. As part of this law, you do not have a copayment, coinsurance or deductible when you receive preventive care, which include: • Routine gynecological exams Is this not contradiction and violation of the ACA? The provider was in network and all of the codes were correct."

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wnogvc/am_i_misinterpreting_my_plan_or_is_my_insurance/

↳ emmyjag (64): "What were the billing codes? The routine physical exams that are covered at no cost to you are very very narrowly defined, and any deviation changes the billing code from your free preventive exam to a diagnostic exam"

↳ positivelycat (37): "Sounds like your insurance processed incorrectly then. Try calling again sometimes you get someone newer who don't know what they are talking about"

↳ Melodic_Turnover_340 (18): "Diagnosis: Z01419 Procedure: 99385 I'm pretty sure those are the ones necessary for preventive and not diagnostic ?"

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qsd3bg/>

↳ (0): "Why are you trying to do this? What's your goal?"

↳ (0): "This is the right question!"

↳ (0): "It sounds like you're looking to get a secondary plan as your work plan is primary and doesn't provide the treatments you're wanting. If you go this route make sure that the secondary plan will cover non-covered charges from the primary plan. I've seen a lot of secondary plans that won't cover if the primary doesn't even if the plan normally would"

"How many Americans are on PPO health insurance that covers seeing specialists/doctors across state lines compared to being on insurance that only covers within the state? I'm on Medicaid in Rhode Island for disability and it's frustrating dealing with out of state approvals. Any advice welcomed. I've had long-term neurological issues like neuropathy, muscle pain, and memory issues for nearly 6 years that neurologists in my state (and in Connecticut) haven't been able to definitively diagnose. I am on SSI for disability, which means I get Neighborhood Health Plan of Rhode Island as my primary insurance, with Medicaid as the secondary. I was told by a neurologist I saw across the border in Connecticut recently (Some doctors in CT take my insurance it seems) that being seen at a bigger hospital like Mass General may lead to a definitive diagnosis. From what I was told by his office after they tried referring me to the hospital, Mass General/MGH is no longer accepting my insurance even with prior authorization, when a few years ago i was told by Mass General they were taking my insurance with those stipulations. I was told by MGH's neurology department staff (who were very nice and compassionate about my situation, to be fair to them) that it's possible the hospital chose not to contract with my insurance this year, hence the change, and that because I am on Medicaid, I couldn't even choose to self-pay to go there. They said it's possible in the future the contractual issue could change, and they also told me to try contacting Neighborhood Health myself and explain the situation and see if they could somehow get me approved to be seen at Mass General. I will be calling them this upcoming week. I was curious as to how often Americans are on health insurance plans that cover seeing specialists across state lines, how difficult it is for them to be approved to see specialists in different states, etc. I find it frustrating that my insurance doesn't work across state lines considering this is the smallest state in the country. Not every specialist is going to be here. Logistically it seems to make sense to me that CT/MA should have a deal with RI insurance to cover people if they at least get prior authorization/approval. As of right now Mass General wouldn't take me no matter what, which I find very concerning and depressing. I have had multiple neurologists say I should be seen in a place like Boston to possibly get a definitive diagnosis, why is that not enough to be seen there? That makes no sense to me."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uheytb/how_many_americans_are_on_ppo_health_insurance/

↳ Good_Educator4872 (3): "Originally they wanted to control what plans you could buy. Govt plans always limited coverage to care within the relevant political entity. No one ever accused the designers of Obamacare of being forward thinking. It was about control. The original thinking was to use the British NHS as a model. There were problems with this. We are different than EUROPEAN COUNTRIES. We have the most extensive checks and balances balance system. The states are sovereign political entities. European states have always been organized from the top down. The US. is the inverse. Our constitution is a mutual agreement among sovereign states to cede certain powers to the Federal government. This limits the federal governments ability to dictate internal state action except in delineated areas. Generally, the Fed can only exert oversight in areas the state is not currently regulating. The Federal government doesn't regulate insurance policies unless the state agrees. Insurance is the purview of the states as an example not the Federal Government"

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes. And I had a policy in RI from the market place there (recently moved out of state). It was a BCBS PPO, the lowest level with an HSA. It has a national provider network and allows for seeing doctors, specialists, labs,etc anywhere in the country. I never had even a single issue and I've got doctors in multiple states (though not in RI because well...)."

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes! It's weird because it's almost impossible to get a doctor or most specialists in RI but we have one of the very best marketplaces. But it's only the BCBS PPO with the national provider network so look for one of theirs."

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

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↳ whim_sea (11): "Woah. I'm so glad I asked! Thank you !"

"No, you cannot switch plans midyear unless you have a life event, which is marriage, by a house, birth of a child, that's the only time you get special enrollment period. Otherwise you have to wait until November or so when open enrollment starts. I have ACA too, and I had a problem with the dermatologist a couple years ago. I always go and get a full body check because I have a lot of moles. I went a couple of years ago and I had two moles removed and they automatically get sent out for a biopsy. They told me my portion was \$147. And I said no, I met my deductible and out-of-pocket max months ago, so I should owe nothing. Then they hit me with while you at least have to pay the \$30 co-pay for a specialist. I shouldn't have had to pay that, but I did, because they weren't going to let me leave without paying something. I went home and called my insurance and I was correct, I should not have paid a dime. I had met my deductible and out-of-pocket max by February of that year and it was like August by then. My insurance company spent a week trying to get a hold of the billing department. And their excuse was they have different systems and they show different things and it showed that I owed \$147 or whatever it was but they admitted they were wrong. But what the dermatologist wanted to do was give me a credit. How in the hell do you know that I'm coming back to this particular place? You do not know that and neither do I so send a damn check. And they did. Every mole I have ever had removed automatically get sent for a biopsy and I have had probably seven moles removed. And I really don't see how ACA is going to help you. You need to talk to your insurance company."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tnbh0m/imperial_problems_and_a_ca/onyolxp/

"Things are changing on the ACA. I've been on ACA for 10 years now. I've had the same plan for the last five. I get a pre-authorization for a certain asthma maintenance medication. It's called Symbicort. I've gotten pre-authorization for years. And suddenly they won't cover it. Even though I have pre-authorization. I have appealed it and they won't budge. There are five other meds in that category and I have tried them all. 4 are not effective. One of them does work, but it causes my blood pressure to go sky high. So I actually had to go on blood pressure pills because I have to have some kind of maintenance medication. You can't just use your rescue inhalers as maintenance, you will run out very quickly. Then I finally told me the only reason why they had covered it. All of these other years was because it was cheaper than the generic. But then the generic makers, drop their prices super low and now they won't cover what I need. And I don't think you can switch plans without a qualifying event, which is usually a new job, moving -like across states, not in the same state, marriage, a baby. Otherwise, I think you have to wait until normal renewal time. I think that's why they aren't really answering you. And I guarantee if you call healthcare.gov, they will tell you that it was your job to check to make sure your doctors and your meds were covered. And they do have a field to search for that, when you enroll. But I'll tell you that it's not correct. It said that none of my husband's doctors were in network, yet he called all of his doctors and yes, they were still taking his insurance. Nothing changed, but that stupid place where you search for doctors and meds, it came back with all wrong results. We have always had good luck with ACA. My husband continues to have good luck, but I have had lots of issues. The kicker is all I need is doctors and meds, my husband has had 10 surgeries, at least, a few of them being major surgeries. One was close to \$1 million and they don't bat an eye. They fight me on medicines every single year."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omuq5mx/

"The benefits manager at the ex employer is who is now refusing to respond to emails. She was actually the first and only person at HR we've been able to talk to. You call, it goes to voicemail, you leave a message. Sometimes the problem just gets fixed one day when you checked, other times it's didn't. No one ever called back, even when my husband was an active employee. I have zero faith that I could escalate the matter. I told them this is an ERISA matter that ignored me. I expect this is primarily because the DoL is so under staffed they have no teeth and no attorney will touch it because it's too small an amount for the amount of work it will take to resolve it. When I called the DoL complaint line they didn't give me an option to leave a formal complaint. I guess that's something I'll need to look into. Regarding our coverage, our group coverage was active from 12/1-12/27. On 12/28 we switched to COBRA and an employee at IBX accidentally cancelled our coverage retroactively. This resulted in every claim with a date of service between 12/3 and 12/27 that was submitted on or after 12/28 being denied due to lack of coverage. I assume they meant to cancel our group coverage 12/31, and didn't notice they left off the 1. I have reached out to everyone I have contact information for repeatedly, for the last nine months. I've gotten nowhere but denied claims and now processed claims that they've denied for other reasons, or approved, and then paid out \$0. The account representative at IBX told me she's baffled. Told me she's never seen anything like it, and every reprocessing request or appeal request she puts through comes back denied with some vague reason that makes no sense. "I swear, it's like they're not even reading it"... No 🤖 lady, that's what I've been saying for the last nine months! I"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjr676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/pawjavn/

"Idk how it worked out that I was paying 25% of premiums. Making about \$16k a year for a single person. Then 2026 it doubled and so it was too much and I was canceled. I moved and then estimated maybe \$13k a year. They said apply for Medicaid and if denied come back. But then it was too late (denied Medicaid which was expected as I have assets). I'm in my late 50s. Only had one ER event which I wound up paying out of pocket over \$500. It wasn't anything crazy serious but they had to do a lot of tests to rule serious things out. I wonder even why bother anymore. That's it as I supposedly had dental coverage but that was a total joke. Wanted to change plans and not bother with dental and just pay for that myself. Could not even look at plans until I produced Medicaid denial letter. My premiums were going to be almost \$700/mo. Just moved and unemployed for now. My only option is to get a job with coverage (haven't had that in ages) or ACA. Or nothing and use health centers. 😞 Oh joy. Ugh."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzxufeMI1eqcF6tSvx4AaABAg

"@TravisSickle My husbands work offers health insurance (more than we can afford) and they are saying because they offer a plan for 60% coverage he does not qualify. We were told wrong at the beginning of last year and put that no we had no other options and now terrified we are going to owe big money come tax season. For health insurance we only used 3 times the entire time we had it."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Tax Credit Explained · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8go8HuwI8xk&lc=UgwLj4ZYPzKX-H1uqfI4AaABAg.9M083FvzwHN9UIExCRbKp6>

"@Micheal Scott My husbands work offers health insurance (more than we can afford) and they are saying because they offer a play for 60% coverage he does not qualify. We were told wrong at the beginning of last year and put that no we had no other options and now terrified we are going to owe big money come tax season. For health insurance we only used 3 times the entire time we had it."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Tax Credit Explained · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8go8HuwI8xk&lc=UgwINwB28OVLXeGkVUx4AaABAg.9O1iUouwzGo9UIEmcSOeXT>

"Health insurance is a scam. I have a major spine surgery coming up that I have to get or I'll be paralyzed from waste down. My insurance denied helping me because they said i don't meet their criteria. F-Insurance Companies. I got financial assistance and the Hospital got my surgery covered 100%. So, I dropped health insurance like its a cancer."

— YouTube · My Husband Doesn't Believe In Health Insurance · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Lub47Wc4Tl8&lc=UgyekKRCj9AUpgPppoJ4AaABAg>

What they were told about qualifying · 10 documents · 10 voices

"I thought the income considered for ACA would be income after we retire not total anticipate income for this year. Husband and I are retiring in July this year. I called health broker and was told our 2026 total income does not qualify us for subsidies this year. We can definitely control our MAGI next year. But the cost of health insurance without subsidies for this year is \$2,400 a month for bronze. Crazy"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 155 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgzvkYbznI6KYejn5LV4AaABAg>

↳ @Reanimator7336 (2): "If you work at all in retirement you are not retired."

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "that is crazy - sorry! here's more about MAGI: https://youtu.be/KDE1jO1z3Sg?si=U8m89wRt_jEUXzMG";

↳ @Reanimator7336 (0): "ACA only goes by taxable income per year period. Its not what tax bracket you are in or gross income."

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

↳ TremendouslyMuffled (20): "Medicaid is exactly what you need here, being 18 and no income means you'll almost certainly qualify, and unlike the marketplace it's open year-round"

↳ LizzieMac123 (11): "That is if a parent doesn't claim OP as a dependent on their taxes. If a parent claims OP, they have to include the household income- which is likely the case if the Marketplace told OP they were eligible, but open enrollment is closed vs. sending them to medicaid directly."

↳ Blossom73 (5): "Because you're under 19, your mom's income counts if you live with her and/or are her tax dependent. That's because children's Medicaid ends at age 19 in Texas. Once you turn 19 you unfortunately won't qualify for Medicaid in Texas unless you're pregnant, disabled, as in deemed disabled by the SSA or the state, or an extremely low income parent of a minor child. The monthly income limit for children's Medicaid in TX for a household of 2 is \$2448. \$3714 for CHIP. <https://www.snapscreener.com/medicaid/guides/texas> Is your mom married? Does she have any other dependents?"

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

↳ BaltimoreBee (52): "Your broker is giving you misinformation and you should stop working with them and find a competent one. Married filed separately automatically disqualifies from any subsidies, it doesn't matter how much you earn. You will definitely owe back 100% of any subsidies they give you if you are married filing separately. The only way you can qualify for subsidies is if you file a joint tax return and those subsidies are based on your combined household income."

↳ Dakota51871 (23): "You're broker not only gave you false information but violate the rules and regulations of their contract with NYS Department of Financial Services. You should definitely file a complaint with DFS by calling 800-342-3736 and the attorney general health care line at 800-428-9071. They work on commission so they will say or do anything to make a sale."

↳ whim_sea (11): "Woah. I'm so glad I asked! Thank you !"

"Question about tax credit Excuse some of my ignorance because I only switched to ACA plan for my family of 3 about six months ago after switching employers. I didn't pay a lot of attention to it before because I was on a workplace health plan for 10+ years, so I've been playing catch up. My wife and I are both commission workers so I had to estimate our income when first applying. It came out to about 102k/year, and it seemed that I was told that we did not qualify for the APTC, although now I see that the limit is 106k. Our final gross income from 2025 may end up being lower than my estimation. It's possible that I was confused but I'm currently paying 700\$/mo right now, and my plan is going up to around 840\$/mo next year, but the eligibility summary is telling me that I actually am eligible for up to 247\$/mo from the APTC (as well as currently eligible, I think?). So I guess my question is, I am I think understanding now that the tax credit is only going away for those making over 400% of the federal poverty line, does that mean that I could still claim the 247\$/mo next year, as was as retroactively claim it for the previous 6 months or so when I do my taxes next year? I currently am not receiving any advanced payments. Thanks, sorry if this is a dumb basic question I should know already, but just trying to understand better."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1otf5u3/>

↳ (0): "The answer is yes. The 400% federal poverty limit for a 3 person household is \$106,600. If your modified adjusted gross income is below that you will be able to claim the premium tax credit, both this year and next year. One dollar over that and it goes away. There are ways to lower your MAGI such as an HSA if your plan is eligible or funding a traditional pre-tax IRA."

"Question about ACA PTC + unmarried domestic partner employer coverage My partner and I are unmarried and file taxes separately. We live together and have children, whom I claim on my taxes. I've always claimed the children. My partner's employer offers health insurance and gives him the option to cover the kids (the coverage is considered affordable) and also has the option to add a domestic partner. I was told by a Vermont Health Connect eligibility specialist that because we aren't married, the offer of affordable domestic partner coverage doesn't disqualify me from remaining on my Marketplace plan and receiving a Premium Tax Credit like it would if we were married. I've also found IRS guidance saying that someone who can enroll in an employee's employer coverage but isn't a member of the employee's tax family is considered eligible for that coverage for PTC purposes only during months they actually enroll. So essentially, his employer's offer of domestic partner coverage would only disqualify me from receiving a premium tax credit if I was to enroll. Does this sound correct? Specifically, is an affordable offer of employer coverage to an unmarried domestic partner treated differently for PTC purposes than an offer to children? Vermont Health connect told me that my partner's affordable employer insurance offer for our children does make the children ineligible for a PTC. The children and I are not part of his tax family because he doesn't claim any of us as dependents. I'm mainly trying to make sure I haven't been receiving a PTC when I shouldn't have and understand why my partner's offer of affordable coverage makes our children ineligible, but not myself."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wp131z/question_about_aca_ptc_unmarried_domestic_partner/

"VT Question about ACA PTC + unmarried domestic partner employer coverage My partner and I are unmarried and file taxes separately. We live together and have children, whom I claim on my taxes. I've always claimed the children. My partner's employer offers health insurance and gives him the option to cover the kids (the coverage is considered affordable) and also has the option to add a domestic partner. I was told by a Vermont Health Connect eligibility specialist that because we aren't married, the offer of affordable domestic partner coverage doesn't disqualify me from remaining on my Marketplace plan and receiving a Premium Tax Credit like it would if we were married. I've also found IRS guidance saying that someone who can enroll in an employee's employer coverage but isn't a member of the employee's tax family is considered eligible for that coverage for PTC purposes only during months they actually enroll. So essentially, his employer's offer of domestic partner coverage would only disqualify me from receiving a premium tax credit if I was to enroll. Does this sound correct? Specifically, is an affordable offer of employer coverage to an unmarried domestic partner treated differently for PTC purposes than an offer to children? Vermont Health connect told me that my partner's affordable employer insurance offer for our children does make the children ineligible for a PTC. The children and I are not part of his tax family because he doesn't claim any of us as dependents. I'm mainly trying to make sure I haven't been receiving a PTC when I shouldn't have and understand why my partner's offer of affordable coverage makes our children ineligible, but not myself."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpegde/vt_question_about_aca_ptc_unmarried_domestic/

↳ BaltimoreBee (3): "Yes, this is correct. The federal government doesn't recognize domestic partnerships and being eligible for domestic partnership benefits, which come with associated taxes because of the lack of federal recognition, does not disqualify one from APTC."

"Used a friend's broker, told them I would soon be overqualified for my essential plan, just to wind up being enrolled in a different essential plan Hey, I'm not opposed to having low costs on things, and would rather not start paying \$200+ on a plan (if I can even find one with a monthly rate that low), but I'm trying to avoid trouble at tax time since I'll be making more than the \$31,920 limit. I could have just stayed on my current essential plan and just re-enrolled with the same (underestimated) income information. I'm probably just going to remove this broker from my NY marketplace account and figure this out on my own if I can, unless if it seems better to just stay on the essential plan anyway. I have a chronic illness and consider working less/switching careers often, and my income fluctuates a lot in the service industry so I really have to ballpark it every year, I just don't wanna get dinged for underestimating years in a row. I already had to fight my insurance a ton for meds, treatments etc so switching seems like it's gonna be a pain in the ass no matter what, I just don't know what's best."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woj8ho/used_a_friends_broker_told_them_i_would_soon_be/

↳ someguy984 (1): "Next year when you renew the high income will show in your tax return. NY will use that info and assume you are going to continue make the same amount. You would need to explain why your income will drop for them to accept the estimate."

"I retired in 2023 but wont qualify for medicare until 2026. I was told by a tax pro that since my only (unearned) income is from SS and a bit of interest from a bank (about 30K total) it disqualifies me from getting any ACA (premium tax credit) subsidy for tax year 2024 because its all unearned income. Of course, since I dont work anymore being fully retired, my earned income is 0). Going by the 1040 and 8962 instructions for 2024 it certainly seems like i had a premium tax credit for at least some of my ACA monthly costs coming back to me since im at 200 percent of the poverty level. (i didnt set up advance tax credits for 2024 in the fall of 2023 because i was nervous i would get screwed at 2024 tax time). This sucks, my ACA healthcare is now almost 30 percent of my income. Talk about a donut hole!"

— YouTube · How to Qualify for ACA Health Insurance Subsidies as an Early Retiree · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cDtnJs9uN7M&lc=Ugxzp5AxlcobGA803ld4AaABAg>

↳ @catchristo9406 (1): "That's why I kept telling my brother to start investing fully into a traditional IRA so he could pull out just enough each year to have enough taxable income to qualify for the ACA. He finally listened to me and will save thousands of dollars when he retires a bit early."

"I could care less about someones premiums going up. Because when I applied for it they told me I didn't qualify for any subsidy because I was making to much, \$650.00 clear for two weeks back in 2008 Thats right I said 650 dollars every two weeks clear 😞😞 "

— YouTube · Obamacare costs set to rise in 2026 · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QwA28_sukyU&lc=Ugyh2tf7bhecvf5SiLR4AaABAg

"@davidnprogress No, I spoke with someone. I told her how much I made THIS year. She said, I made too much money to qualify for subsidies. Should I call back? Or go online?"

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgzTILhbVLcu_MUUb2I94AaABAg.AP6vrVMG2bfAP7Rq1TUGdm

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Premiums that doubled or tripled · 105 documents · 20 voices

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

↳ (0): "[Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling me that a single 36 year old in Arkansas making \$30,000/year is eligible for \$590/month in tax credits for 2026. That covers all but a few pennies/month in premiums on multiple bronze plans. Even the best GOLD plans would be well under \$100/month in premiums. Like \$40-80/month. Something isn't right with this post or we need more info about household size and income, etc."

↳ (0): "Please list the rates of what premium you paid before, and what it will be in 2026, and how many people in the household (single, 2, etc.). Right now, it reads like you're a single household making \$30K, which is too much to lose credits due to being someone who's supposed to apply for Medicaid, and too low to lose subsidies due to being more than 400% of the fpl. And those are the main ways you'd see that kind of jump, is if you lost all subsidies, and it sounds unlikely that you did."

↳ (0): "What were your premiums before, and what would they be after the increase? Is your insurance through an employer or the Marketplace? What about subsidies? For what it's worth, you're not alone. My husband is a retired state employee, and we're too young for Medicare. Our premiums for the two of us through the state retirement system are \$3,900 a month, up \$1,200 a month from last year. The state only kicks in \$200/month. Between premiums and deductibles, we'll be paying well over \$55,000 a year before insurance even kicks in. But we don't have a choice. I'm chronically ill, and my husband was diagnosed with leukemia last year. Like they say, you're well until you're not. Are your meds available in generics? There are a few options for less expensive generics...."

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oonov2/>

↳ (0): "The ACA requires insurance companies to spend a minimum percentage of the premiums they collect on medical care and quality improvements. If an insurer spends less than this threshold, they must refund the difference to policyholders in the form of a rebate check or premium credit."

↳ (0): "I didn't know this was a thing until a few weeks ago when my health insurance company sent me a check along with an admission that they underspent our premium dollars."

↳ (0): "Yup, the medical loss ratio. There is a distinct possibility that they don't spend 80% on actual healthcare and would have to issue rebate checks to the owners of the policy."

"My employer dropped me from health insurance About a year and a half ago I became eligible for health insurance at my new job (one of the reasons I accepted position was for the benefits). After about a month or so of coverage I was asked to come in for a meeting. Our insurance broker was there along with the director of operations. The broker explained that if I continued coverage my coworker's premiums would go up so high that no one could afford them. He said that they could no longer cover me and he would send in someone to help me sign up for coverage on the marketplace (which someone did). I questioned if all this was legal and was told that because their policy is under-written then, yes, it is legal for them to drop me. I should also add that I am a breast cancer survivor. I still get preventative treatment monthly at a local cancer center. It was after the first claim was submitted by the center that this all went down. Was this legal?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 206 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mvkoso/>

↳ (0): "Is the company paying for your marketplace premiums and is it the same level of coverage your company offers to the other employees, including deductibles, co-insurance, and co-pays? Do you have a copy of the company's policy where it says that cancer coverage is excluded? Does this company employ more than 50 people? Need more info to determine if it was legal or not. You might call your state's department of labor and ask."

↳ (0): "I would pay it then they would add the reimbursement to my paycheck. The coverage was similar. I only did it for a few months. I got married and I'm now on my husband's policy. Nowhere did I read that cancer was excluded. More than 50 people during peak seasons, less in the off season."

↳ (0): "If it has fewer than 50 full-time year-round employees it actually doesn't have to offer health insurance at all, but if they do they have to offer it to everyone. You were reimbursed for the premium and the coverage was similar to what the company offered. It sounds like they were doing the right thing for you while keeping costs down for the rest of the employees. Not a lawyer but I don't see anything illegal about it."

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

↳ (0): "I hope everyone making these posts are also calling their senators and representatives. They may not respond but they do track constituent issues/concerns."

↳ (0): "...and don't forget to VOTE!!!"

↳ (0): "I just wish we had at least one party running on universal healthcare to vote for."

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99, This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oiti3k/>

↳ (0): "Federal subsidies *are* continuing. Enhanced subsidies--ones introduced in the *Inflation Reduction Act*--are set to expire. These have been tantamount in keeping plans affordable even for folks who make above 400% FPL (ensuring that a Silver benchmark plan wouldn't exceed 8.5% household income)."

↳ (0): "I know--our household income for the last three years has been in excess of 400% of FPL. So I have expected that we will not be getting any subsidy for 2026. However, the premium that was quoted to us for 2026 includes a subsidy--according to the letter based on the income shown in our 2025 application; that income was in excess of 400% of FPL."

↳ (0): "I'm also in Illinois, and for the wife and I the premium was just as I expected - the 27% increase, as well as the loss of the subsidy. Went from \$1040 a month to \$2687. Ugh."

"Georgia - just got my estimate on rate increase. Guess I'll be doing without. I've been using Ambetter for a few years with a few hiccups but overall it worked. Make around 23k per year. Had a Silver plan for around \$150.00. Just got my notice via the GA marketplace. Similar plan that no longer includes the vision and dental I had in the old plan, will be \$479.00. Guess I'll be doing without this year and hope for the best. Multiple health issues and prescriptions. Can't get Medicaid here. Welcome to the new world."

— r/HealthInsurance · 82 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oh2fva/>

↳ (0): "Call your representative! This is what the shutdown is about!"

↳ (0): "I've already sent letters to them. For all the good it will do at this point."

↳ (0): "Make an appointment to see them."

"Man, health insurance prices are wild right now. My premium just jumped AGAIN this year and I genuinely don't know how people with families are supposed to keep up. It feels like every year the coverage shrinks and the bill grows."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=Ugz61D8mrVjl84umMI54AaABAg>

↳ @luigijohnson6732 (2): "Honestly, this whole mess is what pushed me to rethink my financial life. I read The Philosophy of Smart Investing by Jennafer Beaver recently, and she talks a lot about redefining what wealth even means like building stability, not just chasing numbers. She's a financial advisor too, so she breaks it down really clearly. It was actually a short read, but surprisingly grounding."

↳ @leonardives1991 (1): "Same here. I actually had to downgrade my plan because the monthly cost was getting ridiculous. Now I'm paying less, but everything comes with a higher deductible. It's exhausting just trying to stay financially healthy while staying physically healthy."

↳ @normantylor3944 (1): "What's crazy is how many people I know who are just opting out altogether. They're like, "I'll just pay cash when something happens," which is obviously risky, but I get why they're doing it. The whole system feels broken."

"ACA not very affordable anymore ACA is not really affordable without the extra subsidy, but California fines you 100 per month for not having it. It's not really fair to fine people who truly can't afford it. I work front desk hotel. The cheapest plan for me is 200 per month. I have to pay 100% out of pocket until I reach 7200 for the year. Just 2 visits to the dermatologist is costing me 1400 on top of the 200 I already pay. If I want something with normal co-pays, it's going to cost me 400 per month. I make between 45K-50K, but the cost of living is so high in California that there isn't much left for stuff like health insurance. It's really not fair that California fines you at this point when the premiums have literally doubled in price. It's very frustrating."

— r/obamacare · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/

↳ discoduck007 (28): "Thank you BBB (Big Billionaires Bonus)"

↳ Mysterious-Art8838 (18): "I completely empathize re the cost but I still think it's worth having. I absolutely have to have it because I have a serious illness. I'm 44f. My monthly is \$605 and my deductible is 12k which I will probably hit after a hospital visit last month. It completely sucks but not having it would suck 1000x more. As it is I try so hard to stay out of the hospital. Last week I collapsed in an urgent care because I waited too long to get help. Thankfully it's attached to a hospital so they called a code blue on me and brought me over lickity split. But I was focused on how much it would cost and whether I could get through it myself, not what I reasonably should have been considering. When I was on the floor of the hospital staring at the ceiling I was thinking oops. Guess I let this go too far. But I try hard to avoid it because it's so freggin expensive. That same visit I left AMA because it's so much more expensive if they admit me."

↳ Florida1974 (16): "So very true. The first guy I fell in love with, he died when he was 36 years old. He kept going to the hospital because of a severe sore throat. They would give him antibiotics and send him home. Months later, they finally caved and did more testing and he had stage four throat cancer. And he died. There was nothing they could do because it was so far advanced. I had they done that test to begin with, it might be different. I am married and we moved 1200 miles away and one day I happen to look at the obituaries, which I never do, from back home. I told my husband about it that night and his jaw fell. Turns out when I was dating this guy, my would be husband was teaching him how to paint houses on the weekends. My husband is eight years older than we were. But we were together for probably 10 years before we realize this. Still gives me chills. But it's so sad that he died, he had young kids back then. So yes, they do let you die."

"2027 shock 2026 me and dependent \$500 month 2027 \$959 month Got a letter from Florida Blue that if my income and subsidy is the same then this is what my premium will be. I know premiums went up but geez double? I'm limited to what plans I can get because I take a drug that's \$2200 a month. That only gets covered if it's on the formulary and I pay my out pocket maximum. So I can't even think about going to a lower end plan because those don't cover my drugs at all even with prior authorization. Any Florida Blue folks out there in the same boat? Any hope that when open enrollment starts maybe higher premiums will be offset with higher subsidies ? We're all winning right?"

— r/obamacare · 55 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wyq35r/>

↳ (0): "There is no chance of higher subsidies as long as a Republican is in the White House. Thank all of the Trump folks in Florida for this."

↳ (0): "Their replacement plan is coming along any day now, right? Maybe after our DOGE check?"

↳ (0): "This is what Republicans killing subsidies does"

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

"I need OP to sit down as this may shock them. This is better than my current 2025 plan. I have no children, so just for me. I have zero health issues, and never go to the doctor. Even fifteen years ago I was spending \$150/month for \$3000 deductible as a young person. The idea of a \$15/month plan has never been close to a reality for me. I've never seen a \$0 deductible plan. My genuine concern is my plan will jump to \$600, \$700, even \$800/month and my deductible will go from \$12000 to \$15000 or more. This is back breaking to strained budgets."

— r/obamacare · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/nm1cx41/

"Yep. My premium is going up from \$380/mo to \$975/mo. That only covers 50% doctors visits, two prescriptions at month \$60 and a \$6500 deductible. That's \$12,920/year. I'm quitting and going out of pocket which comes to \$2,800/year, no deductible. It's a no brainer."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgwORLDeHm8pzhhOqEh4AaABAg>

↳ @truthseeker1959 (2): "@The_VietnAmerican Misery? Missouri? I see what you did there....lol. 🤔"

↳ @Yourlocalmoderator (1): "Ima guess FL because I'm seeing a massive amount of similar stories coming out of FL like this one."

↳ @The_VietnAmerican (1): "I live in Kansas City, MISERY. 🤔 You know, the land of Coward Josh Hawley. 🇺🇸"

"I remember. I have to point this fact out to people all the time. There is a whole group, mostly MAGA, who think the ACA caused it to happen. Prior to the ACA I had years of 30%+ premium increases."

— r/obamacare · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1urupru/aca_insurers_propose_doubledigit_premium_hikes/owk0052/

"Self-employed independent white male. My premiums tripled. It's a big deal. I'll send you my address so you can make up the difference. I'll refund it when the 10 year (and counting) congressional fix that you refer to is implemented."

— r/obamacare · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ps7j5o/premiums_triple_congress_goes_homes/nv7gfug/

"I am with you. Cancelled my ACA plan. Went from \$750 to \$2150 a month for my wife and I, and that is from a Gold plan to a crappy bronze plan with \$10K deductible. They can bite me."

— r/obamacare · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qil7n2/my_premium_went_from_200_to_1500_and_now/o0sa18a/

"My premium is going from \$275 to \$950/month 😞 and this is for a BRONZE plan with a \$10,000 deductible. I won't have health insurance without the subsidies. 🙄 "

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgygEp4yMOAHLWQGOFR4AaABAg>

↳ @andrewgruici88 (2): "@ChariotoftheGods11 What companies?"

↳ @jerryrichardson2799 (2): "You should have got ACA coverage, unless you make too much."

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Oh no that's awful! I'm so sorry. It must be the state you live in? 😞 "

"My premium on the ACA marketplace is going up by 340% by January. I am a small business owner and don't have a 340% increase in income. Bad for the economy this policy....and terrible for working americans."

— YouTube · Expert explains surging health insurance premiums · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=94S5-5MO9Nw&lc=UgyOrnGbr0AyrPJmDbR4AaABAg>

↳ @benstr8156 (1): "Blame ACA and the Dems for supporting this scam policy. Hope Trump can find a way out of this mess. Obamacare was in place before Trump took his first term."

"27M, COBRA premium increased from \$610 to \$950 after one month. Please help. I'm really in a bind here and just want some clarification and guidance to figure out what my next best steps are. My premium was increased by more than 50%, and I wasn't alerted until today that it would also apply for the September payment. My new insurance won't kick in until the end of October. I haven't made any Cobra payments yet but did "opt in", but I haven't needed to use it yet. But now my body doesn't feel right and I've found a growth. If this turns into a bigger and drawn out health issue, I really don't know how I can make that payment work, but I also don't think I can put this off for another month. I've never had any major health issues before so I really have no clue what I'm in for. Are there any quick to enroll and less expensive health insurance alternatives? Or is this just what I have to work with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wo35q1/27m_cobra_premium_increased_from_610_to_950_after/

↳ chickenmcdiddle (10): "Dropping COBRA voluntarily isn't a QLE, no. But if OP's still within 60 days of their old plan terminating, they may have a shot. They also have a shot if their employer was subsidizing part of the COBRA premium and has since stopped. But as it's written, no, dropping COBRA won't trigger a special enrollment period through Healthcare.gov."

↳ monsterpiece (6): "If you don't have other insurance options you can apply for the ACA plans in your state"

↳ AcanthaceaeOk3738 (6): "If he drops COBRA on his own accord, would he still qualify for a qualifying life event? I honestly don't know the rule. But that might be his best option if it works, assuming the premium is lower than COBRA."

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/ngibrvo/

"This is not exactly how it works, although tbh it's a very complicated system. Basically, many Americans are opposed to getting rid of our current system and implementing universal healthcare because they believe that it would raise their personal taxes, and that the additional tax they pay would go to covering care for others (whom they believe to be largely undeserving of such a free ride). But the absurdity of this is that the huge monthly premiums and deductibles they're paying now dwarf any increase in tax they might realistically have to pay if universal health coverage were in place. So we have the worst of both worlds: very expensive health coverage for some and no coverage at all for others. It is maddening to watch 😞 "

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p24ajw/universal_care/npvyhhs/

The income cliff and paying it back · 91 documents · 20 voices

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

↳ (0): "Man, it's a big risk, and if you lose the bet, you're well and truly bad off. One chronic illness, cancer, pregnancy, broken bone, torn ligament and you are SOL. Sure, you can be seen for emergency care under EMTALA, but they don't have to give you chemo or surgery or insulin once you're past the emergency part. 25 is typically young and healthy, but it isn't a guarantee. Best of luck to you."

↳ (0): "My MS first happened at 25, but bc I didn't have insurance until 29 to get diagnosed I have permanent damage and now disabled and unable to work."

↳ (0): "I don't want to upvote this, because it is terrible that you had to go through that, but I'll upvote anyway because it is a perfect example of how things can turn quickly."

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tmp52c/>

↳ (0): "If she is an in-network provider she has a contract with your insurance provider and has agreed to their reimbursement rates. Confirm with your insurance company that her and her office are in-network. If she's collecting the "remaining balance" from patients she's breaking her contractual obligation. Providers cannot ask you to give up your rights to not be balanced billed. Also, it sounds like you're no longer comfortable with her either way and it'd be best to find another provider"

↳ (0): "OP your insurance can also do a three-way call with the provider and you to explain everything (if they actually are in network)."

↳ (0): "I'm a psychologist. Your therapist is in network and has agreed to the rate that the insurance company set. She or he cannot "balance bill" you. Depending on your state, it may be illegal. Regardless of state, it's unethical and in violation of the agreement that the therapist made with the insurance company as an in-network provider. If you want to go hard, you can report them to their licensing board for unethical behavior. At a minimum, I would not stick with this therapist. They're either uneducated or unethical. You don't want either of those in a therapist."

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

↳ Zphr (35): "OP, if you are just over the cliff (up to about 440% FPL), then you have an out due to a change in the OBBBA. Select a Bronze during open enrollment, commit to fully funding the accompanying HSA the Bronze will make you eligible for, and you can reduce your estimated MAGI at application by the full HSA contribution amount. This can pull you back into subsidy eligibility, which will cap your costs for the benchmark Silver at just under 10% of your MAGI, which right near the cliff for a household of two should be about \$700/month. Bronzes are cheaper than the benchmark, so you might be looking at \$400 to \$550/month for the Bronze. You can further reduce your AGI by making contributions to non-Roth retirement accounts if you aren't already doing so. Better to put \$16K into accounts for yourself than pay half or more of that amount in avoidable health insurance premiums."

↳ NBA-014 (19): "This is what the majority of Americans voted for. America is insane."

↳ Stand_With_Students (15): ""Why do we put up with this?" Exactly what I want to know too."

"IF they extend the subsidies and get rid of the 400% cliff am I better off to overestimate next year's income if I am close to the 400%??? What about this year, can I make changes? I read Hakeem Jeffries said they may pass an extension..I realize thats a big IF. We may be close to the 400% next year and if we go over we will owe all the subsidy back. If they continue subsidies beyond the 400% would I be better to estimate my income at 450% next year so I don't owe back 100% if I do hit 450%? If I don't reach that amount will I get a refund for having overestimated? We may have to do a large withdrawal from IRA as we have an issue that may come up requiring extra \$ next year. Along the same line, I underestimated this year. I still have 10 days to change my income for 2025. Will I save any \$ if I raise my estimated income for this year ? Is it too late?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1psdio2/>

↳ (0): "Do something serious about the cost of healthcare or vote them out of office. I am sick of saving my whole life as a middle class citizen and spending such a high percentage on healthcare. Me and my wife have pre-existing conditions and make 89,000 and our plan is \$2300 per month with high deductibles that make us pay 39,000 out of pocket before we are fully covered. The politicians have allowed the greedy insurance companies , the greedy hospitals, the greedy medical companies, the greedy doctors, the greedy billing companies and the greedy pharmaceuticals to hijack our futures. I am sick of it and why aren't the rest of you. We need universal healthcare because corrupt companies in name of capitalism have ruined it for the rest of us."

↳ (0): "If you get a bronze plan you can get HSA and put in \$8750 plus \$1000 each if over 55 to get under \$84600 (400%) to get subsidies. In case you or others were unaware."

↳ (0): "I would estimate under the 400% but during the year if you realize that you are going over then you got the portal and report your new income amount. Your premiums will go up the rest of the year so tax time won't be as bad. If you get bronze plan you can lower MAGI with the HSA in 26, and 401k/ira but looks like that may be problem. Good luck"

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

↳ (0): "Cash on hand/assets only matters if you're 65 or older. You HAVE been eligible all along, and you should feel free to use your services. You're in the exact situation this social safety net is intended for....use it all you want until you find a job and get monthly income again. And no, it would not matter even if you weren't eligible. You could have knowingly lied and committed fraud to get enrolled in Medi-Cal, but if you haven't made claims Medicaid would never know or care. There's nothing spent by them to try to recover. They'd only come after you if you had claims."

↳ (0): "Medicaid goes by going forward current monthly income, not calendar year income. Previous months do not count at all, and there is no asset test for expansion Medicaid. The monthly income limit for 2022 was \$1,563 and for 2023 \$1,677 a month."

↳ (0): "Are you saying that the "cash on hand" question is basically moot and that it's ALL about monthly income?"

"Ours is actually quite a bit worse, probably due to age (late 50's). If we careen over the cliff of \$84,600 due to not having quite enough expenses or whatever, it will cost us an additional \$19,200 / year. Our anticipated income is just very, very close to the cliff, and that's best case scenario with a bronze plan and full HSA funding to get our MAGI to \$80k. If we topple over, we will pay over \$24,000 / year in premiums for a bronze plan + \$10,750 to fund the HSA. That's 41% of our gross income before we even visit a doctor or fill a prescription, not to mention federal and state taxes. Not much left. WTF, America?"

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/nm32690/

"I think something will happen. I think enough for Republicans know that they will lose the house if they don't help the people with yet another Trump expense. Even then, I'm not sure they can hang onto it. Unlike Trump, many of them know how unaffordable surviving has become, well the ones that listen to their constituents know. I guess whether they care is TBD. He sure made sure the wealthy people got their tax cut in his big baby bill, nice and early. Meanwhile, the average American has had everything go up and health insurance is a biggie, some of these increases are huge and they simply can't afford it. Trump likes to threaten to primary people. Trump will be gone in roughly 3 years. He won't rule the GOP forever and that is a simple fact. And even as they try to gerrymander their way into forever wins, they aren't winning all of those and some are TBD. I also find it ironic that Trump always talks about states, states should take the burden of everything. He means everything financial because otherwise, he's still very much wants to tell them what to do. And this is where things get kind of muddy. We elect people to do this in that, but we also don't know what the laws say about what they want to do. I guess you could look them up, but they are painting pretty broad strokes at that point, it would be difficult to pinpoint laws. I didn't know that you could read district on a whim, I always thought it was done only after a census. I think things like this should be left to the people, as California did. If they didn't just ramrod it through, they went to the people and asked what they wanted. I use ACA as does my husband and it has remained affordable for us, but we do a lot of things with our income to keep from meeting that subsidy Cliff. We are self-employed and that is the only way we can get insurance. We cannot get Medicaid, we make too much. And honestly, I don't want it. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, we just can't afford to pay it all. We want to pay part of it. Many people don't realize they ended up on ACA just because of Covid. It wasn't just extended subsidies that were enacted during Covid, it also opened the ACA up to people making up to 700% of the poverty level, that is why the ACA ballooned and they too, got the extended subsidies. I have to wonder what they did before. But I do believe healthcare should be a right. If my husband doesn't have health insurance, he files for disability. He has to. Inherited a bad heart from both parents. His twin had a pacemaker at age 40. My husband had a stent at age 46 and a triple bypass at age 52. He's not overweight, he eats healthy, exercise exercises, but his blood pressure was always an issue and then things got worse. The triple bypass was about 300 K and there is no way we could've paid that. But if we get help with insurance, my husband gets to see his doctors, have his meds and continues to work. To me that seems like the better decision., To help with one thing to keep him off of being totally disabled. Sorry, I went on a rant, I get so stressed by all of this. All right, hike wasn't too bad but I still feel for the people that have had a huge rate hike. It's scary not having insurance. It's scary being hurt or sick and you can't go to the doctor. We are such a wealthy country and so damn great, yet people can't afford health insurance. Right there, that part alone, screams that America is not great."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pazpk6/aca_in_the_senate/nrn7t0f/

"Yes, they're literally so brainwashed by this bullshit propaganda that they don't realize that keeping our population healthy is for the greater good and would actually cost less. We don't pay that much less and in many cases more - for example, our estimated premium of \$2000+ on an income of \$86,000 next year. Add that to what we pay in federal, state, and local taxes, and don't forget property taxes! It's over 50% of our total income. So our household would be paying more in taxes and insurance compared to Europeans but getting far less with a shitty bronze or even catastrophic plan that covers absolutely fuck all nothing. Don't come at me with how to be poorer to stay under the cliff. I'm working on it FFS. Yay?"

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p24ajw/universal_care/npunnt2/

"Appreciate the info: I just looked at ACA plans for the first time last week. My wife and I are 24 months from being retired, and our combined pensions will make us ineligible for ACA subsidies (as they currently stand). Just understanding how much COBRA, ACA, or private insurance will cost us (we still have dependents under age 26), is a planning tool. If ACA cliff remains, we could end up paying \$200,000+ for health insurance between retirement and Medicare!,"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E&lc=Ugzvm7yxUJFtCV1gSbV4AaABAq>

↳ @EliavD-d5e (0): "Now I've hit \$270,590. I was having this exact conversation with my son the other night- generational wealth isn't just about getting money. It's about teaching everyone not only how to make it, but also how to maintain it. It does no good for me to provide for my family if they don't understand how to manage and sustain it."

↳ @JasonGoetze (0): "Well. A big thanks to Lady Charlotte Parnell - really appreciate her. She's honestly one of the smartest and most supportive people I've ever learned from. Her mindset and the way she explains things changed everything for me"

↳ @JoelDiaz-y6k (0): "What I like about her is her logic behind every undertaking and her ability to make a good profit regardless of the starting investment amount. Imagine having 30,850 from my 5,000 investment."

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqibrvo/

"Is it beneficial to slightly overestimate projected income, to avoid possibly having to pay back subsidies at tax return time? I am trying to get ready to pull the trigger and retire at 62.5 years old. I plan to calculate my income from my Roth IRA (and a tiny part time job). Is it safer to slightly overestimate my income when signing up for ACA, to hopefully avoid the potential of having to pay back anything if I go over what I projected?"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/

↳ Low-Jury-3586 (7): "When you apply, it asks how much of the credit you want to use and you enter the dollar amount. I use only half. Then when I file my taxes, this gets reconciled and I receive the balance of the unused credit. This then helps pay the new year of premiums. Like you, I don't want to worry about any overpayments so I'm more comfortable doing it this way."

↳ CoveredStrangle (7): "You can do Roth conversions from your regular traditional IRA (or 401k)... into your Roth IRA. This Roth conversion amount will count towards your MAGI and help you qualify for ACA."

↳ GlitteringSwan8024 (5): "I estimated my income for 2025 within \$1200 of what it actually was and I still owe \$680! Very frustrating. I can easily pay it but there are probably people who can't. I don't understand how my subsidy amount was off by \$54 per month. I absolutely would overestimate, wish I would have done it for 2026."

"I'm self employed and my AGI sits around the cliff. I have a 5 person household, so we're talking about a \$10,000+ swing between what I could pay depending on which side of the cliff I fall on. And that's worse if you don't include the state subsidy that I get. If I don't qualify for that either then it would be \$16,000 more than if I stay under the cliff."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojoy71/any_selfemployed/nm2iz1i/

"pleasant surprise but want no surprise in tax planning re aca just finished with my 2025 taxes and i will be getting a massive refund while i was expecting to owe a small check to irs 2025 was my full year of r/fire : i have no w2 income and relied on my investment dividends, tax free interests. i fired in mid 2024; so i had half year of w2 income and when i enrolled for aca in late 2024 for 2025 plans i wasn't sure what to put in my income and i only put in estimated total for qualified dividends and omitted (tax free municipal) interest which made a big chunk of my total cash for the year. i believe that i got subsidized aca rate for 2025. later in 2025 during my tax planning session i understood that i was to include tax free interest when enrolling aca. as a result i anticipated that i would be repaying the aca subsidies when i file 2025 return. but i was getting a big tax credit instead; my refund has been approved. when looking over the return i can see that a large portion of the refund is labeled medical and i didn't itemized any medical expenses; i only included the "standard" (i forgot the form number now) sent by aca does anyone understand this? for 2026 enrollment my aca premium is big and totally unsubsidized i believe because i enter a bigger (including tax free interest) income compared to 2025. should i expect at least some credit when 2026 return is filed?"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sx0pb6/pleasant_surprise_but_wa
[nt no surprise in tax/](https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sx0pb6/pleasant_surprise_but_wa)

↳ SeaweedWeird7705 (4): "Tax exempt interest counts towards MAGI for ACA purposes. If your MAGI is over 400% of the FPL, you don't qualify for subsidies. If you have received subsidies that you don't qualify for, you will have to repay the full amount when doing your taxes. I agree with the other comment about calling the ACA to sort this out."

↳ Traditional-Big-1135 (2): "I'd call Aca and update you're income that showed on this return"

↳ TimeMachine2010 (2): "The enhanced subsidies that were in place through the end of 2025 have expired and now we're back to the rules that were in place prior to the pandemic. In 2026, if your MAGI is greater than 400% of the federal poverty level for your household size and location you won't qualify for the ACA premium tax credit. You didn't include your MAGI, household size, or where you live (contiguous 48 states have different limits than Alaska and Hawaii), so it's impossible to say if you should expect at least some credit in 2026. In general, a single person in the contiguous 48 states with a MAGI greater than \$62,600 (4 times the \$15,650 2026 FPL) won't qualify for a premium tax credit. For a household of 2 it's \$84,600. For a household of 3 it's \$106,600, and so on. You might start by reading articles such as this one to understand how the credit works: [2025 2026 2027 Federal Poverty Levels (FPL) for ACA Health Insurance](<https://thefinancebuff.com/federal-poverty-levels-for-obamacare.html>) There are numerous calculators on the internet that will estimate how much, if any, credit you might qualify for"

"It's the extended tax credits, for those above 400% of poverty level. Biden raised the subsidy cliff and that is scheduled to expire this year. It would shut out people above that level for any subsidy. For example I believe 400% is around \$80,000 for two people. So my husband and I right now pay \$527 a month for our plan on \$72k of income. If our small business became more profitable or if I work more, we would be shut out. Our plan is \$2800 a month without the subsidy. That's unsustainable. For lower income persons on the marketplace the loss of enhanced subsidies will mean that many of the Silver plans with cost sharing and zero to no premium will go up substantially. This will disproportionately affect Medicaid non expansion states where ACA enrollment is high. It will have a tremendous impact on a lot of folks."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kminjg/obamacare_in_trouble/ms
[awz3h/](https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kminjg/obamacare_in_trouble/ms)

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"Ironically enough, I got rid of my health insurance in February of 2020. The next WEEK after it expired, I got kidney stones that required surgery. I owed \$25,000 because of that. Thankfully, the hospital has charity wavers and because I was so low income, I got almost the entire balance waived. Honestly, if I had had insurance, I would probably still be paying. Insurance isn't that great these days."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236lZc&lc=Ugy7HfMilSaZ86lQ76J4AaABAq>

"Yea, this was my situation last year. I lost my job due to a health issue and had to enroll with a marketplace plan. I had no clear indicator on what my income was going to be for the full year - as it wasn't clear when I would be returning to work. I hadn't yet made 15k (FPL) for the year, but on my estimate for income I just assumed I'd be out of work for 2 months and calculated that way. Figured that if I went back to work earlier, or got a better job - I'd just pay them the difference on my taxes. But after 4 major surgeries, I didn't work again at all last year (meaning I did not earn enough to 'qualify' for the program and would need to pay back the subsidies in their entirety if this provision was in place). After a couple months, I attempted to apply for short term disability, but was delayed/denied repeatedly. Under this provision, I would have ended up owing \$6,000+ on my taxes in addition to all of my other financial hardships."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yyfl6/

"Yes, and that was the huge benefit of the Enhanced Tax Credit. I had to pay back the APTC 2 years in a row, almost \$60k total for family of 4 at the time, because went over MAGI by about \$2k both years. After the 2nd year it all but wiped out our savings."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wjwjed/planning_to_retire_at_62_have_you_priced_the_3/pakbti3/

"ACA and PTCs, Early Retirement Asking for confirmation of my understanding, under post-OBBA law. *TLDR*, my basic question is, with one spouse on Medicare and one purchasing insurance through ACA, are we still a household of two and is joint MAGI used to determine eligibility? Does MFS change that? Practically speaking, I have retired at age 62 (got laid off and not finding any opportunities) and my COBRA benefits end in March. I'm reviewing longer-term financial planning options to work toward getting PTCs for the next three years until I go on Medicare. Best I can tell, the OBBA brought back the 400% FPL cliff (which is what we've been arguing about) which in 2026 will be \$62,600 MAGI for a household of one, and \$84,600 for a household of two. My spouse is currently on Medicare so I only need to purchase ACA insurance for myself. In this situation are we still a household of two, and does our joint MAGI count? I don't think Married Filing Separate would change that. Using online calculators for my state and county, if we are truly a household of two and total household MAGI is used then we need to remain under \$84,600 MAGI to get PTCs. If we do that, then we will pay \$0 in insurance premiums for me for Bronze level coverage (which is fine, I'm reasonably healthy). However, if our MAGI is \$84,601 or higher then my monthly premiums would be over \$1400/mo for the same coverage. Does this sound correct? Thanks! ***Followup.*** This is the final strategy: \- Decline COBRA coverage for 2026; \- Sign up for ACA coverage with PTCs; \- Actively manage MAGI to less than \$84,600 to retain those PTCs; \- Make a solid Roth conversion in calendar year 2025 to have liquid cash for the next three years; \- Pay the estimated taxes due on the conversion by January 15; \- Don't get sick for the next three years."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1otm8of/>

↳ (0): "You are a household of two. Both MAGI incomes should be included on your application. Note that you *must* file taxes jointly for the year you receive any PTC in order to qualify for assistance. So if you are applying for 2026 coverage and PTC, you must mark that you will file your 2026 tax return as Married Filing Jointly. If you mark on your application that you will file Married Filing Separately, you will not qualify for PTC. If you receive PTC and then file your 2026 taxes as Married Filing Separately, you will likely have to pay back some or all PTC you received in that benefit year."

↳ (0): "Got it, thanks! Those facts are what I was concerned about, and I'll act accordingly. Makes the next three years a bit touchy on how to manage the finances, but I've got a plan (which will result in a very big tax bill for Tax Year 2025...sigh...) Thanks again. Solved!"

↳ (0): "I was in a similar situation (a few years younger) ... we did COBRA our first year and decided to switch to ACA as of the next Jan 1 so that deductibles wouldn't be reset mid year when COBRA ran out and they'd all go to the ACA plan. We're also healthy, but you never know when you might break an ankle or whatever. Just figured I'd throw that out there."

"Yes, but I think more people will be affected than just those on the far side of the subsidy cliff. According to this calculator from Kaiser Family Foundation, my ACA premiums (for a silver plan) would go from 130 a month to 234 a month, or an 80% increase. That's at an income of 40,000, or 252% of the poverty level. <https://www.kff.org/interactive/how-much-more-would-people-pay-in-premiums-if-the-acas-enhanced-subsidies-expired> (But I don't why the calculator says a bronze plan is 0 dollars a month. It's definitely more than that, that's what I have.)"

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lv58e9/yikes_premiums_are_expected_to_increase_by_more/n26imeh/

Insurance companies and the system as a scam · 73 documents · 20 voices

"\$2600/mth, \$6k deductible for wife and I Blue Shield Bronze HSA PPO w/ \$6k deductible is looking like \$2650/mth for 2026, for wife and I (middle aged, in good health). This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed. This is completely unaffordable. Having already cut all our costs to the bone, I only have one option, which is to raise my rates, and hope that my competitors will also be raising theirs too so mine aren't extortionate. The only other thing I could do it seems is to become younger, which I'll try and organize, but seems to have some complex issues. This is going to massively, massively spike inflation."

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o9m8gp/>

↳ (0): "Please don't worry the golden ballroom and Arch monument funding is safe."

↳ (0): "But what about Argentina???"

↳ (0): "They're good, we just doubled down and sent another 20 billion"

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/>

↳ (0): "You can report any insurance carrier operating an aca marketplace plan to your state department of insurance."

↳ (0): "**Nevada Division of Insurance:** Northern NV (775) 687-0700 or Southern NV (702) 486-4009"

↳ (0): "Name and shame. Who is the insurance carrier? What exact plan did you purchase? Any plan documents you can share here to give us something to review and provide direction? Edit: This thread is kind of all over the place, but since this is a higher-level comment: Imperial *is* a legitimate, ACA-qualified carrier and this is a qualified health plan sold through Nevada Health Link, the state's official marketplace. What's more, since Imperial is a very small carrier with a narrow network, OP didn't have a choice and went to an OON emergency room. So it's crystal clear: Imperial hasn't "not paid anything"--they haven't even been billed for anything. The onus is now on OP to submit a super bill / claim directly to Imperial since this is an OON hospital with no mechanism to submit a claim on their behalf. Annoying, no doubt, but is necessary if they want to have any coverage for this encounter."

"Billed \$1600 so far for free preventative colonoscopy I'm 52 years old and never had a colonoscopy so I thought I would take advantage of the \$0 out of pocket preventative colon cancer screening through my ACA health plan. I had the colonoscopy last month and a couple days ago I got an email from the hospital saying that I have a bill. It's \$1600 for the colonoscopy. I went to reddit of course and saw that reddit seems to agree that it should have been free. No polyps were found. I spent hours on the phone yesterday with the hospital and the insurance company. The lady at the hospital told me that I was mistaken about preventative care being free. She said that there are thousands of different plans and each plan does it differently. She said they submitted my claim and the insurance paid for part of it and that I am responsible for the other \$1600. After talking to her for a while I wasn't getting anywhere so we agreed to disagree and I called the insurance company. The insurance rep spoke English as a second language and didn't seem to understand the point I was making. She told me how much the total was, how much insurance had paid, and how much I was responsible for. When I said things like "I think there is a mistake, this should be free of charge since it was preventative" she simply repeated the totals as if she didn't understand. She was supposed to call me back at 2pm today and never called. I guess I will be spending tomorrow on the phone again trying to get the \$1600 taken off my bill. Nobody I have talked to so far is aware of the ACA policy that preventative care is covered in full. They seem to think that I am just saying that to get out of paying my bill. Any advice for what I can say tomorrow. Edit: OK, I just got off the phone with the United Healthcare rep. She said that there was no mistake. She said I had 2 procedures done and only one was preventative. I asked her for the diagnostic codes for the procedures and she only gave me one code G0121. She seemed like she wanted to get me off the phone so I didn't argue. She apologized several times and said there was no mistake, I have to pay the \$1600. I had a referral for "Screening for colon cancer Z12.11" and have no knowledge of any second procedure. EDIT 2 OK I got some more info today. I confirmed that my plan offers the colon cancer screening at 0% copay and no deductible. The insurance says that I got the colon cancer screening paid for (they paid \$150). But I was charged \$1600 for an endoscopy that was not preventative care. All the CPT codes are missing for the non-preventative endoscopy. Here it is called a HC colonoscopy. The person I talked to said that my primary code was Z12.11 and my secondary code was K57.30 <https://preview.redd.it/3qbqhqlod7ug1.png?width=700&format=png&auto=webp&s=7ec1b565073bcc88f0403c5064e0be6ec17b28b6> <https://preview.redd.it/09k2gdppd7ug1.png?width=691&format=png&auto=webp&s=9e15198b82f8833f30009a763184c6e58817a42f> Update 3 I talked to a different insurance rep today and got a completely different reason for my bill. This one acknowledged that I only had one procedure and that it was a colonoscopy, not an endoscopy. She said that while a colonoscopy can be preventative, mine was not preventative because I had it done in a hospital. I asked her where I should have gone to get a preventative colonoscopy and she said that I should have gone to an office. I told her I went to my doctor's office and they referred me to the hospital. She said she understands it is frustrating and offered to help me file a claim adjustment request. So in 10 to 15 days I should be getting the decision. I still think it makes no sense because they paid the claim submitted by the doctor who performed the colonoscopy even though he did it at a hospital. But the claim submitted by the hospital was not preventative because the colonoscopy happened at a hospital."

— r/HealthInsurance · 233 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sg3ast/>

↳ (0): "If it's a true ACA plan, you'd be correct and there seems there would be some sort of issue with them processing. Where did you get your ACA plan? Do you have a copy of the EOB you can post?"

↳ (0): "Did you confirm the doctor you used was in network?"

↳ (0): "Also - an issue we ran into once is that the procedure the colonoscopy being done by the doctor is indeed included but not the facility fee. So you have to pay a facility fee - and even if they are in network they could be not covered."

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tmp52c/>

↳ (0): "If she is an in-network provider she has a contract with your insurance provider and has agreed to their reimbursement rates. Confirm with your insurance company that her and her office are in-network. If she's collecting the "remaining balance" from patients she's breaking her contractual obligation. Providers cannot ask you to give up your rights to not be balanced billed. Also, it sounds like you're no longer comfortable with her either way and it'd be best to find another provider"

↳ (0): "OP your insurance can also do a three-way call with the provider and you to explain everything (if they actually are in network)."

↳ (0): "I'm a psychologist. Your therapist is in network and has agreed to the rate that the insurance company set. She or he cannot "balance bill" you. Depending on your state, it may be illegal. Regardless of state, it's unethical and in violation of the agreement that the therapist made with the insurance company as an in-network provider. If you want to go hard, you can report them to their licensing board for unethical behavior. At a minimum, I would not stick with this therapist. They're either uneducated or unethical. You don't want either of those in a therapist."

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

↳ Zphr (35): "OP, if you are just over the cliff (up to about 440% FPL), then you have an out due to a change in the OBBBA. Select a Bronze during open enrollment, commit to fully funding the accompanying HSA the Bronze will make you eligible for, and you can reduce your estimated MAGI at application by the full HSA contribution amount. This can pull you back into subsidy eligibility, which will cap your costs for the benchmark Silver at just under 10% of your MAGI, which right near the cliff for a household of two should be about \$700/month. Bronzes are cheaper than the benchmark, so you might be looking at \$400 to \$550/month for the Bronze. You can further reduce your AGI by making contributions to non-Roth retirement accounts if you aren't already doing so. Better to put \$16K into accounts for yourself than pay half or more of that amount in avoidable health insurance premiums."

↳ NBA-014 (19): "This is what the majority of Americans voted for. America is insane."

↳ Stand_With_Students (15): ""Why do we put up with this?" Exactly what I want to know too."

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers, but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said " I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— r/HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ovsnbg/>

↳ (0): "Sorry you went through this. ACA plans are often cheaper than COBRA, but to there is a limited window to sign up for the ACA once your employment ends. Otherwise you have to wait for open enrollment, with January 1 coverage. If you are unemployed you may be eligible for Medicaid. I don't live in IL, but in my state the ACA web site and supporting customer service phone reps are very helpful with dates, plan info and eligibility."

↳ (0): "Losing insurance coverage is a qualifying event for applying for ACA/Marketplace insurance. This will probably be much less expensive than COBRA. When you were switched from W-2 to 1099 you were no longer an employee of the company so it makes perfect sense that they would no longer offer you employee benefits. Saying they need to fire you made me giggle because that's technically what they did when they made you a 1099 contractor."

↳ (0): "There are also specific rules governing employee classification. It's hard to imagine OP could go from employee to contractor without meaningful changes in the job."

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— r/HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wase0r/>

↳ (0): "When you're covered by an insurance policy, you're subject to the plan's negotiated rates. When you are uninsured, you're typically eligible to a "cash pay" rate, which is often equal to or even less than insurance negotiated rates. It's simple economics: less administrative burden with cash pay patients (no claims to file, no staff to pay to secure PAs, etc.). But the downside is that without a policy in place, you're financially exposed to *unlimited* costly care. The stuff that piles up quickly outside of routine care / office visits."

↳ (0): "Uninsured patients get a discount that is often comparable to the one insurance companies negotiate. Sometimes the out of pocket expense is less without insurance and sometimes it's more. Most self pay discounts do not come close to 50% of the average insurance allowed amount. You're usually better off with insurance in the long run. Your doctor is not out to scam you. 😊 "

↳ (0): "There's quite a few complex factors that go into this. 1. The contracted rate is between provider and payer, your benefits are not directly in that mix. The provider can collect \$X, split between you and your insurance. The split between what insurance pays and what you pay is based on your benefits (coinsurance, copay, deductible), the contracted rate is similarly not part of this equation. You could have great benefits and pay nothing, or terrible benefits and pay all of it. All the provider knows is that someone owes them \$X. Whether your out of pocket cost with insurance is greater than or less than self pay is a toss up. They are not comparable scenarios. 2. Contracted rates are negotiations between provider and payer. If an insurance company represents a massive portion of the population, they have more bargaining power. A provider may take a lower rate to have access to that patient population in network. Similarly, if your area has one major provider group, providers may be able to negotiate a higher rate. A subtle point: this is big business against big business, neither side is inherently good or bad. If you want to root for the provider, remember that insurance is negotiating on your behalf to get you the lower rate. 3. Providers know they'll never see a full billed amount in payment. Collecting money from self-pay is a grueling task, which is why most want payment up front. In some cases, providers only expect to see ~30% of patient portions actually get paid after the fact, including the cost shares from insured patients. There's no point in trying to collect money no one has, so for the uninsured, they just do the discount up front. Self pay is a take what you can realistically get scenario. 4. Everybody loses money somewhere and makes it back elsewhere. For example, Medicaid typically reimburses less than the cost of providing care and they make up for it through what they make on commercial insurance patients. Providers often lose money on self pay. They've done the math in terms of their typical volume to come up with a sustainable self-pay rate. They may not be able to lose \$500 treating someone for free, but maybe they can lose \$200 and still stay afloat. They would prefer you have insurance so that they lose nothing, but if not, this is

again, take what you can get. Obviously, if everyone was self pay, this wouldn't work. You shouldn't take what you paid for a specific encounter and equate that to how much a service actually cost in resources. It's not an apples-to-apples comparison. Anecdotal data points are rarely representative of the state of healthcare as a whole."

"We retired early and we took the silver plan from the market place. \$2400 a month and it was useless. The deductible and out of pocket was so high, the insurance never paid for anything. What a scam! It honestly drove me back to work, just for the insurance. I sure wish my husband was willing to live out of country for a time."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxWsbWgrBC4jKr28s54AaABAg>

↳ @ariefraiser140 (11): "If you guys were paying \$2400/month that means you guys had a pretty big AGI."

↳ @michaelcoglianese4292 (7): "@ariefraiser140so what? That's still ridiculously high amount for insurance"

↳ @metalgirl (2): "I agree... our insurance is twice that. Stupid high. So not fair!!!"

"Paxlovid \$1600? Anthem ACA in Indiana is pretty terrible -- the cheap "negotiated rate" for 5 days of the anti-COVID medication paxlovid is nearly \$1600. I'm skipping it since I can't afford it even with the \$1000 one-time use coupon from Pfizer. The whole year has been basically Anthem denying all my medications or offering a price that's way higher than those weird "discount cards" like GoodRx. Pretty terrible. Anyone else angry yet are ready for actual universal health care? I retired early and this is literally the only insurance plan available to me in my state. These insurance company scammers and big pharma scammers need to be fixed. Things are getting unsustainable. I understand that there's an active movement to dismantle and destroy ACA without any replacement, so that's part of the problem, but really we need actual universal healthcare and to tear down the existing scam organizations."

— r/HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj8crd/paxlovid_1600/

↳ Bogg99 (20): "The same drug manufacturers sell these drugs in other countries for significantly less money. There was a piece of legislation that would cap drugs developed in the US for being sold here for more money than other countries. It would have single handedly saved Medicaid/Medicare billions of dollars. Republicans voted against it."

↳ Turbulent-Pay1150 (18): "No anger with the drug manufacturer who set the price?"

↳ The_Derpy_Walrus (15): "Health history plays no role in ACA insurance plans."

"Total healthcare coverage for everyone would be simple. Just switch everyone to Medicare with Plan G. Charge a flat rate and the money would be there and the insurance companies would be cut off at the knees from their current theivery of our money and our tax money thru subsidies. They currently get BILLIONS of dollars in subsidies to cover people. Thru the ACA AND thru the Medicare Advantage plans. That money would be better spent just covering everyone and cut out the damn middle man. The flat fee could be something very small like maybe 50 dollars. Or if that sounds too simple, put it on a sliding scale. or Use the IRMA rule. But this has been so obvious to me since I started getting coverage thru the marketplace and found out that my subsidy is about 1400 a MONTH that taxes are being paid to these scammers. And I have to jump thru all sorts of hoops to just get a damn test."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwKReZ8eEKFhxX5ehx4AaABAq>

↳ @wtmayhew (4): "I had to buy Obamacare for two years because I retired before I turned 65. The red stste where I lived decided to do nothing on its own and took the default government site. There were only two silver plans available which had over 1000/month premiums just for myself. I had to get back surgery and even with the silver plan I had there was still a 5000 hospitalization deductible. I'm glad I had a silver plan or it would have been a lot worse. Still, my health care bills for that year were almost 20K. That year federal subsidies cut off completely if your AGI was one penny over 49K the prior year. Affordable Health Care Act, my foot!"

↳ @TheJetstream10 (2): "You can thank the Republican Senate and Orin Hatch for pushing this through Congress--Medicare Advantage--they wanted a slice for private industry to get and they got it, guaranteed government subsidies for coverage and death panels for people who need care."

↳ @bugsy2902 (0): "The subsidies are great if you are poor! But once you make over 400% of poverty you are cut off entirely and good luck getting health insurance then. Mine increased from around \$800 monthly to over \$1300 monthly when I turned 60. Luckily, I'm able to keep my taxable income low thru using a Roth Ira, HSA and have low expenses. Plus, I have a HELOC for emergencies I got before I retired."

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

↳ (0): "In short, yes, a provider can always run your information through a carrier website and see if you have insurance or not. Ask for the cash price- say you want to pay cash and not go through insurance."

↳ (0): "They said if I have coverage of any kind (that they don't take of course), then I don't have the option to pay anything but the full cost of the visit :/ I've heard some doctors are more lenient on this than others, which makes me think I should just look for a new doctor. But that feels like a whole other can of worms right now and just kind of overwhelming tbh"

↳ (0): "I mean, OP can ask, but many behavioral health providers don't maintain separate cash-price vs. insurance-price fee schedules. They tend to be more transparent and open about their fees in general, meaning their published fee is the same regardless of payer (although may vary as a function of sliding scales or "scholarships")."

"I recently had to pay \$1400 upfront for a colonoscopy after insurance. That's less than half my deductible and less than 25% of my out-of-pocket maximum. My oral surgery next week is using my dental insurance – the \$1100 I'm being charged upfront doesn't even count towards my medical deductible. How does that make sense? Those bills would bury many people I know. It's all a scam."

— r/obamacare · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vnce2d/a_shocking_92_percent_of_us_adults_are_not_going/p3gdiz7/

"Agreed. I pay \$100 more per month for a Gold plan with a \$1K deductible. I would rather pay \$1200 more than get hit with a \$7K plus bill. I don't ration care this way either."

— r/obamacare · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v4frri/seems_like_a_good_deal_to_me_what_am_i_missing/ozaw6l6/

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

↳ (0): "Cash on hand/assets only matters if you're 65 or older. You HAVE been eligible all along, and you should feel free to use your services. You're in the exact situation this social safety net is intended for....use it all you want until you find a job and get monthly income again. And no, it would not matter even if you weren't eligible. You could have knowingly lied and committed fraud to get enrolled in Medi-Cal, but if you haven't made claims Medicaid would never know or care. There's nothing spent by them to try to recover. They'd only come after you if you had claims."

↳ (0): "Medicaid goes by going forward current monthly income, not calendar year income. Previous months do not count at all, and there is no asset test for expansion Medicaid. The monthly income limit for 2022 was \$1,563 and for 2023 \$1,677 a month."

↳ (0): "Are you saying that the "cash on hand" question is basically moot and that it's ALL about monthly income?"

"So a big nothing burger, that's what I expected. PBM's are not going to change. But they are a big driver of health insurance costs. I just went through it with an asthma maintenance medication. I can't stay on the one they pre-authorized. I am now on one that cost 3x as much. It makes absolutely no sense. I do care if it's effective and I don't know that yet because I haven't started it. The insurance company tried to blame a new act of Congress and then actually called me incompetent. There is no new act of Congress, they told me a bold faced lie. The act they are quoting was passed in 2022. It's because they want me on a certain medicine. It's likely not even a Dr on the insurance end, making these decisions. I think it's because the PMB managers, the middleman, get a bigger cut if it's certain prescriptions. I got a 90 day supply for zero dollars, as long as it works, I don't care. I'm at my deductible and out-of-pocket max in February 2025. I will never understand it. My husband has had 8 or 9 surgeries. He gets zero pushback and I know he's cost them well over \$1 million. And I swear every year, they go through and axe another one of my meds. I mostly just get routine care and meds, I've only had 3 operations in life and they were all 30 years ago. I had employer based health insurance then. You can't even get me to go to the ER, my husband went at least 4 times last year, by ambulance because of his heart. We don't fool around when it comes to that, his dad died at age 49 from a Widowmaker heart attack. My husband found him. They want to talk about reigning in insurance rates when they are the ones that approve them. I started looking it up on who approves the 26% average increase we have for 2026. This is above and beyond any subsidies. It is the state and federal governments that approve insurance rates. It makes no sense. And I would also guess that the CEOs/executive level people donate to political campaigns. I'd like to see what they've donated to Trump and the Republicans and even Democrats"

— r/obamacare · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pm9zyz/house_gop_unveils_health_care_measure_that_does/ntyfph9/

"I did Cobra for myself and my 2 teen daughters 2 years ago after losing my wife suddenly. It was \$1,995 per month! This country's health care system borders on criminal. I needed time to grieve, but the weight of that monthly expense forced me back to work within weeks. I can see now why so many (in the millions) of American's are retiring to affordable health care countries - South America is a big one. So just an fyi that this is another albeit more involved affordable healthcare option for retirement. Several YouTubers out there with great info on it."

— YouTube · 6 Retirement Health Insurance Options BEFORE Medicare Eligibility Kicks In · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOx1T4WKebc&lc=UgwBtHd7bzkdhJnlzDJ4AaABAg>

↳ @msvice5940 (0): "This is so true. Medical costs in the US are insane. Even with "good" insurance with high premiums, often times you still have to pay a lot out of pocket with copays & deductibles. Since retirement, I am one of those people that have moved south of the border and I must say that the medical costs here are a fraction of what they are in the US. Without insurance, I am able to comfortably cover my medical costs out of pocket & the care is just as good or better than in the US."

↳ @cherrybb3888 (0): "@msvice5940 are you comfortable saying what country you moved to?"

"Just checked my policy apparently until I pay my deductible of 1800 of a doctor visit I would have to pay the full amount at the doctors. I honestly have no idea why I got health insurance. I feel scammed."

— YouTube · How Health Insurance Works I What is a Deductible? Coinsurance? Copay? Premium? · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xs7MNNqdN-o&lc=UgzbyYN1xEpdDQ0j963p4AaABAg>

↳ @pathos92 (0): "It's insurance against catastrophic loss... Like car insurance will pay for when you get in an accident but won't pay for your daily gas"

"For real. We pay 22k/year for 3 people with a 17k deductible. That's criminal."

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/nm1o8z0/

"and a criminal system when I just noticed my deductibles are set so high. Now I understand every year will be as if I didn't have any healthcare coverage. I only go to the doctor yearly for minor things. Therefore, I'll be paying for my bills out of pocket. Then January 1st will be reset again. Also, the coinsurance and copays % may never kick in either yearly until something catastrophic happens (may God forbid)..... That's a crime for us to pay monthly for years after years to only have coverage for something extraordinary that may never happen and we don't want it to happen either. My deductible is 7,000. I never exceed it yearly."

— YouTube · How Health Insurance Works I What is a Deductible? Coinsurance? Copay? Premium? · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xs7MNNqdN-o&lc=Ugwdfdod3L_uT_Flam14AaABAg.9wIRtKMZUOe9wnQRsGBzPy

"I hope and pray that everyone throughout the world has great health, so we don't have to have health insurance . They are greedy"

— YouTube · Are High Deductible Health Insurance Plans a Better Choice? · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GExcbWHS0gU&lc=Ugy4SERIVBkHmt4AU514AaABAg>

Politics deciding their premium · 64 documents · 20 voices

"My daughter is a surg/tech student. The doctor stuck her with a needle during a procedure. My daughter has insurance but not for that hospital. Now she owes \$1800 for getting treated at the hospital where she got stuck. Not sure what to do. My daughter is a surgical tech student. During one of her procedures in February, the doctor accidentally stuck her with a dirty needle. The doctor told her to go down to the triage so she could get the proper care for sticks, which included a blood test (plus a follow-up test 2 weeks later). My daughter has healthcare thru the government (Obamacare, basically). She got a bill from her teaching hospital for her medical care for \$1800. Her insurance is denying it because she isn't covered at the hospital where she works. What should she do? This is such an unusual situation, and I can't find advice anywhere (other than 'call an attorney', which would cost more than the \$1800). Suggestions? (on a good note, the patient was tested for any diseases and came back clean, so no worries on that front)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 929 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkg09o/>

↳ (0): "The facility where the injury took place should cover it. If they somehow don't it needs to be appealed as urgent/emergent care and the insurance company will pay. A needle stick with a known dirty needle is an emergency. Out of network is normally waived for urgent emergent care."

↳ (0): "Any recommendation on who specifically (department?) to target on this? Seems everyone wants to pass the buck. I'd love to call someone and say "This is your problem to solve""

↳ (0): "Back when I was a medical student at a teaching hospital, needle-stick injuries were covered by the OSHA department of the hospital."

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pff3oz/>

↳ (0): "FYI if you get married you get a special enrollment and can enroll her right away."

↳ (0): "This is what my partner and I are doing. We are marrying tomorrow actually, so we can have me enrolled on his health insurance for the new year. My coverage is going up over \$200 with higher deductible and higher co-pays. It's a bit sad that we are "forced" into marriage, when we could have planned a nice elopement with close friends and family, instead of a quick courthouse wedding. Good luck, you aren't the only one dealing with this."

↳ (0): "Getting Married is a life changing event. It opens enrollment and you can get her on instantly."

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

↳ bourbonfan1647 (68): "Elections have consequences. None of this is a surprise. Welcome to the "find out" phase..."

↳ Stop-Looking_For_Me (48): "Well here it is. The numbers don't lie. Healthcare is going to be fun next year for everyone."

↳ Redtoolbox1 (41): "But the billionaires got their tax cuts they so desperately needed 🙌"

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oonov2/>

↳ (0): "The ACA requires insurance companies to spend a minimum percentage of the premiums they collect on medical care and quality improvements. If an insurer spends less than this threshold, they must refund the difference to policyholders in the form of a rebate check or premium credit."

↳ (0): "I didn't know this was a thing until a few weeks ago when my health insurance company sent me a check along with an admission that they underspent our premium dollars."

↳ (0): "Yup, the medical loss ratio. There is a distinct possibility that they don't spend 80% on actual healthcare and would have to issue rebate checks to the owners of the policy."

"At 62 years old, my health insurance is \$1100/month w Kaiser. Based on my income, my subsidy saves me about \$700/month for a payment of \$400. Thank you Obama and Biden. These subsidies could be paid for by those tax cuts for wealthy Americans."

— YouTube · What Happens if Obamacare Subsidies Expire? · 115 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=onSEZNtGKCA&lc=UgyJvuJ3wyZjtmqB9V4AaABAg>

↳ @MossyMozart (5): "@KellyGentry-r5x --- So everybody can have insurance coverage like all the other 1st world countries in the world and some 2nd world ones?"

↳ @KellyGentry-r5x (2): "@MossyMozart The disabled, elderly, and people who work full time are the only people who deserve insurance. No one owes you anything if you are able bodied but refuse to work. America is sick of all leeches making life more expensive for the people who know that no one owes them anything."

↳ @KellyGentry-r5x (0): "You are complaining that your health insurance would raise even though you decided to retire early. Why should taxpayers foot the bill for your selfish choice?"

"Fed Up With Fake News Truly have had it with all of the fake news. Just read a NY post article stating that ACA plans deny 30% of claims and it'll take months to get a doctor's appointment. We have had ACA coverage with a local Texas insurer for 10 years. Have always seen the doc the same day, no issues whatsoever getting to a specialist quick, sometimes even the same day. Never denied a claim. Never any pre authorization. With 3 kids, we use the plan quite a bit. Premium on a gold plan just went down by \$600 a month for 2026. Can't help but think this is all political. Have encouraged my Trump loyalist friends to get ACA coverage for years and they refuse as they believe all of the lies. Sad to think they're paying more for private catastrophic coverage just because something has Obama tied to it. What are y'all's experiences?"

— r/obamacare · 85 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pd4kh7/fed_up_with_fake_news/

↳ redwhiskie319 (34): ""Just read a NY post article stating that ACA plans deny 30% of claims and it'll take months to get a doctor's appointment" You may want to consider the source. You don't get accurate news from the NY Post. Any New Yorker will tell you that. There's a reason its considered the faux news of NYC. And it has quite the history of being against any and everything accomplished by the Democratic party. So its consistent with their brand to publish such garbage. I wouldn't consider anything published by that rag to be remotely authoritative or accurate."

↳ [deleted] (12): "Just agree and let's do M4A and single payer. Solved. This shit is easy."

↳ Strict_Weather9063 (12): "United healthcare has 37% denial rate on all claims. They are one of the largest insurance companies out there. This is what happens when you have for profit health insurance. Edit damn autocorrect doesn't catch wording."

"The government should really open up Medicare with reasonable premiums for those 55 -65. Age discrimination is preventing a lot of people from getting hired these days. Even ACA is costing me 1K a month for me and spouse. My spouse's work insurance was much more expensive. My COBRA just ended after I lost my job 18 months ago and it was 1500 a month going up to 2K this year. I stayed on COBRA because we already satisfied the max out of pocket and it was good insurance."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Retire Before 65 · 72 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l8VY8AcaLww&lc=UgxUWCq0OC_S-rSQahN4AaABAg

↳ @DesigningRetirement (2): "Health sharing ministries like Medishare, Samaritan Ministries, and Christian Healthcare Ministries are an option some people use, but it's crucial to understand what they are and aren't before making this choice - especially for people over 50. What they are: Member-based cost-sharing programs where members contribute monthly "shares" that are used to pay each other's medical expenses. They're often significantly cheaper than ACA plans (\$300-500/month vs. \$800-1,500+) and are based on shared religious values and community support. What they're NOT: Insurance. They have no legal obligation to pay your medical bills. If the ministry determines your situation doesn't meet their guidelines, you're responsible for the full bill - and you have no legal recourse. Critical limitations for people approaching or in retirement: 1. Pre-existing conditions: Most health sharing ministries don't cover pre-existing conditions at all, or impose waiting periods of 1-3+ years. For people over 50, the vast majority have at least one pre-existing condition - high blood pressure, high cholesterol, diabetes, previous surgeries, arthritis, etc. If you develop cancer, need heart surgery, or face other major medical needs related to a pre-existing condition, your bills may not be "shared." 2. No guarantee of payment: If the ministry determines your situation doesn't qualify (didn't follow protocols, didn't get pre-approval, condition isn't "shareable" per their guidelines), you pay the full bill. There's no insurance commissioner to appeal to, no legal protection. 3. Coverage exclusions vary widely: Many exclude mental health care, some exclude certain cancer treatments, some require you to try lower-cost treatments first, some won't share bills if you didn't get pre-approval. You must read the specific guidelines carefully - not the marketing materials, but the actual sharing guidelines. Real-world outcomes - both exist: Some people use health sharing ministries for years successfully, paying for routine care and minor issues at much lower monthly cost than insurance. Other people have been left with \$50,000-200,000+ in medical debt when the ministry denied their shares for cancer treatment, heart surgery, or other major expenses - often after treatment has already occurred, when they're most vulnerable. Where they might work: Healthy people under 50 with no pre-existing conditions People with strong religious convictions about community-based sharing People who have financial resources to self-pay if shares are denied Very short-term bridge situations (though risky) Where they're dangerous: People over 50 (very high likelihood of health issues) Anyone with chronic conditions or health history People who can't afford large unexpected medical bills Anyone facing major illness (exactly when you need guaranteed coverage) My honest perspective: For most people over 50 navigating the gap before Medicare, I strongly encourage sticking with ACA-compliant insurance despite the cost. The guaranteed coverage of pre-existing conditions and legal consumer protections are worth the premium difference when you're at the age where major health issues become more likely. If ACA premiums feel truly unaffordable, explore subsidies based on current income (not last year's - this trips people up), Medicaid eligibility if income is low enough, or working with a healthcare navigator to find the most affordable ACA-compliant option. If you're still considering health sharing ministries: Read the actual sharing guidelines (not marketing materials) - understand exactly what is and isn't shareable Assume you'll need to self-pay for major illness - if you can't afford that risk, don't take it Understand you have no legal recourse if shares are denied Consider your age and health realistically - any pre-existing condition puts you at significant risk The monthly savings aren't worth six-figure medical debt if shares are denied when you need them most. That said, I respect that some people have used them successfully and are comfortable with the risks. Just make sure you understand what you're accepting before making this choice, because the

consequences of getting it wrong are severe."

↳ @patriot2510 (0): "medicare would go bankrupt in one month"

"Something is irreparably broken with the way things are right now. No way should my healthy, middle-class family of 5 be expected to pay \$3,000+/month for a high-deductible insurance plan with pitiful coverage that's not accepted by most quality providers. Even if the subsidies are extended, I still have a huge issue with government tax dollars being funneled to health insurance companies to pay for these ridiculously high premiums. We've had to switch to cash pay with no insurance in the past, and cash-pay prices are reasonable, especially as compared to what's billed to insurers."

— r/obamacare · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nmkopxl/

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

"If I submit ACA application now and enhanced subsidies come back in the coming weeks, can I still get them? I want to see what my updated pricing would be under current circumstances. I've updated my application, but I just want to make sure that if the subsidies come back before open enrollment ends, that I haven't ruled myself out of getting them. I won't actually sign up for a plan yet, just want to submit my application so I can get an idea what I'm working with. Does anybody know whether that's ok without putting myself at risk of missing out if they come back?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1omgk67/>

↳ (0): "My state's Marketplace web page has been updated for the 2026 enrollment. Meaning all of the current RULES are now active for any enrollment for 01/01/2026 - 12/31/2026. IF and I say IF Congress extends the ENHANCED APTC, here is what will currently happen 1: Our web page will be taken down for about 3 hours while the updates are run and the new rules are installed 2: Once completed, the system will then go through all of the applications automatically and grant the enhanced APTC to applications that meet the eligibility benchmarks. Are the Enhanced APTCs going to be moving forward or retroactive? This will depend on what Congress approves. If they are NOT Retro-Active, the Higher APTC amounts will be granted for the first of the month. Therefore, if Congress approves the Enhanced APTC and only grants them moving forward, then an enrollment would look like this (I am going to use a large number to prove my point, and it is NOT REAL Joe Enrolls 01/01/2025 - Silver Level Plan Total cost \$2000 APTC Eligibility \$1500 Member responsibility \$500 \---no enhanced APTC Congress Approves Enhanced APTC effective again for 03/01/2025, therefore 01/01/2025 - 02/28/2025 RATE \$2000 -\$1500 = \$500 03/01/2025 - 12/31/2025 Rate \$2000 - \$1800 = \$200 What about January and February? Well, depending on how the IRS and the ACA make the rule, there are two outcomes 1: Joe, through reconciliation via IRS form 8962 is determined to have been eligible for \$600 in APTC for which he did not receive for Jan and Feb, and is given a CREDIT or 2: Joe is determined that the APTC amount received for the entire year was the correct amount and the IRS does not credit or request any funds 3: Joe under-reported his income, was really NOT eligible for all of the APTC, and received an EXCESS amount of APTC - Joe pays the EXCESSIVE APTC back to the IRS"

↳ (0): "People are saying "yes", but I think that should come with an asterisk. If the language preferred by the Democrats gets included in the budget bill then yes, things will continue as normal for the the enhanced subsidies. However, in the negotiation phase Republicans and Democrats may agree on a compromise that changes the answer. For example, a possible compromise could be that enhanced subsidies are grandfathered so only people who had them previously are eligible for them going forward (note: I'm not aware of anyone proposing that, but at this point nobody has proposed anything other than "get rid of them completely" or "keep them exactly as they were", so we can only speculate as to what a compromise might look like)."

↳ (0): "Yes, right now we have to deal with what we have. You would still receive any enhanced subsidies if they end up passing, which will account for roughly 5-7% premium decrease in premium."

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxtql8/>

↳ (0): "Nope. The moving QLE requires the individual to have had qualified coverage for at least one of the 60 days prior to the move. Moving QLE is predicated on the loss of coverage or moving outside the effective coverage area of the current policy."

↳ (0): "These premiums are unsustainable. These prices are like sending a kid to college each year, and that's before your out of pocket costs. But to your question: No, simply changing residency won't allow you to insure after the fact. If you have an accident or emergency situation like a burst appendix, a new plan would not cover those bills retroactively. A cancer or cardiac diagnosis requiring treatment next month? That could work, but you would still face the up front costs of biopsy, tests and diagnosis."

↳ (0): "The thing is that medical bills without insurance are staggeringly high - far, far more than you could save from not paying these extortionate rates. You can very easily be in the \$100k+ territory for some fairly 'routine' surgeries, without even a night in hospital."

"ACA plans versus just enrolling through private insurer I cannot seem to find an answer to this anywhere I estimate my MAGI to be around ~40k next year. I am not offered health insurance through employer bc I work part time. I have decent amount of assets so I don't have trouble paying higher premiums each month (it also makes my income less predictable with dividends, capital gains etc but i try to keep it as close to 40k as possible with 401k contributions, trad IRA etc.) My question is -- If I go with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a plan there with a subsidy, at the end of the year does it all even out if I were to just pay the higher premium and get the tax rebate when I file taxes? My accountant complains about [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) plans when I file taxes and recommends I just get it directly with the insurer. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1or63n2/>

↳ (0): "I'm an accountant and would never suggest this unless your income was so high you could not possibly qualify for subsidies."

↳ (0): "Yeah I'm also an accountant and I am puzzled by that comment"

↳ (0): "if I understand your question correctly, yes - if you go on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a policy and ask for no subsidy, you will get the subsidy when you file taxes if you qualified. Assuming your accountant files the forms. :). its not exactly hard to file the forms btw. maybe they don't like the manual entry of the 1095-a information. if you don't get the policy from the marketplace, then you will not be eligible for the subsidy."

"they big question i have is why are the premium so dang high with out ACA i have a family of 5 and we get crushed . we need to take a look at the real issue . these insurance companies are making record profits on us . and the government is helping subsidize it . we need to fix this system ."

— r/obamacare · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/nm42d26/

"Excellent video!! I retired early and I'm 62 and on the ACA. My biggest concern right now is the current administration is trying to kill the ACA. I have 3 years left until Medicare and feel really vulnerable. I feel like I'm living on a hope and a prayer until 65. Keep the great content coming!!!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugx20_ft51xWWyopGPR4AaABAg

↳ @janetmartin9372 (2): "No. The previous administration added additional subsidies in 2021 and 2023 on top of the original aca. They scheduled them to expire end of 2025. Why should middle income people pay subsidies to higher income people to help them pay their health insurance? We are back to regular aca and there is help for those up to 400 percent of poverty level."

"Absolutely. However it's American citizens committing the fraud. Florida and New York have the highest rate of corruption from small time medical distributors who file false claims. The Patient's aren't the Frauds, it's the people behind the process. And this government does not care about Medicare Fraud or Obamacare Fraud. How many medical distributors have made away with MILLIONS and not get caught. Makes me sick to my stomach. I was on Obamacare twice in my life (Corporate layoffs. 2x) and because the unemployment is \$250 a week where I live (RED LAND) I did receive and NEED the supplement help. Why isn't Anyone looking at the Insurance Companies??? Or PBMs??? I paid taxes for 40 years, I Earned that subsidy!"

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wnlono/trump_officials_eject_750000_from_obamacare/pbgjwzf/

"I'm separated, did putting "married" on my ACA application cause them to refuse me any subsidies/tax credits? Soon to be ex and I plan to finalize our divorce in January and that's when he's going to take me off his health care plan. I'm 61 and retired, no longer working and my only income is \$3000/month alimony that he sends me (for the next 7 years, in lieu of splitting the house). So in a nutshell, my income now is \$40K/year. When I did the application for the 2026 ACA, the instructions said that if I'm separated to put myself down as married. So I did. It didn't ask anything about his income - I guess it just assumes "family income" of 40K. At any rate, it says my "family" is not eligible for subsidies/tax credit and the plans are showing me the full premium prices. The lowest premium I can see with this application is 1K/month, with deductibles of 8K, and both copays and coinsurance costs. It estimates that my annual out of pocket might be \$22K. So... half of my income for health insurance and care? I'm looking for anything I did wrong or can change to get more affordable care next year. Should I delete my application and do a new one listing myself as single? Also, I've read here in a few threads that the base subsidies are still there and it's only the extended subsidies are on hold by the politicians. But I don't see that they're offering me ANY subsidies. What am I missing?"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1orzhtn/>

↳ (0): "A couple considerations that you'll need to confirm with a tax expert: - if you know 1000% you're getting divorced in 2026, the IRS will consider you a single individual for all of 2026. That may affect how you would fill out the marital status and tax filing portions of your 2026 application. - if you mark your application as Married, you must also mark that you will file your 2026 taxes as Married Filing Jointly to qualify for tax credits/subsidies. Again, tax expert time, but for IRS purposes you are probably considered Single, filing as Single for 2026. - Alimony orders made after 1/1/2019 are typically not considered taxable income and therefore should not be on your application as income. Confirm with a tax expert. If that is your only source of money, for ACA/IRS purposes you may actually have \$0 income and may instead qualify for Medicaid. Bottom line, you've got at least two major issues (marital status/alimony) to sort out with someone qualified to get all the context of your situation to provide you with better advice."

↳ (0): "Wow, thank you. I had no idea about the alimony not being considered income. We're definitely finalizing the divorce in 2026; been separated for a few months now and I've moved to a different state. I'll consult with someone who's knowledgeable about these things. Thanks again!"

↳ (0): "You need to put single, and use your projected salary for 2026 because that's what you'll be, and make, when the policy is active"

"I don't have a problem with having the subsidies continue until 2027; in the meantime there will be a Congressional election, and The People will decide."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nugwj9/the_obamacare_subsidy_fight_is_already_splitting/nh38h4b/

"It's the extended tax credits, for those above 400% of poverty level. Biden raised the subsidy cliff and that is scheduled to expire this year. It would shut out people above that level for any subsidy. For example I believe 400% is around \$80,000 for two people. So my husband and I right now pay \$527 a month for our plan on \$72k of income. If our small business became more profitable or if I work more, we would be shut out. Our plan is \$2800 a month without the subsidy. That's unsustainable. For lower income persons on the marketplace the loss of enhanced subsidies will mean that many of the Silver plans with cost sharing and zero to no premium will go up substantially. This will disproportionately affect Medicaid non expansion states where ACA enrollment is high. It will have a tremendous impact on a lot of folks."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kminjg/obamacare_in_trouble/msawz3h/

"I wasn't anticipating making a lot when I quit my job. So I got the government subsidized health insurance and then towards the end of the year I got a new client and made a lot of money and did not make any changes. Low and behold, I owe the government approximately \$2500 back when I filed my taxes"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgwC9G5F_HnwoQXN6lh4AaABAg

↳ @chadwickcameron (2): "That's a great problem to have. You kept your money and hopefully, YOU made interest on it for a few months. Well done!"

↳ @VictoriaDorsano (1): "Yeah, that's usually what will happen! But I typically like to preserve cash flow initially, then if I need to pay back the subsidy later, oh well. But in either case, it's an unpleasant bill. Congrats on the new client though!"

↳ @jamesphillips7283 (0): "Find 2500 in tax write offs"

"Yes, but I think more people will be affected than just those on the far side of the subsidy cliff. According to this calculator from Kaiser Family Foundation, my ACA premiums (for a silver plan) would go from 130 a month to 234 a month, or an 80% increase. That's at an income of 40,000, or 252% of the poverty level. <https://www.kff.org/interactive/how-much-more-would-people-pay-in-premiums-if-the-acas-enhanced-subsidies-expired/> (But I don't why the calculator says a bronze plan is 0 dollars a month. It's definitely more than that, that's what I have.)"

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lv58e9/yikes_premiums_are_expected_to_increase_by_more/n26imeh/

Too much income for help, too little to afford it · 45 documents · 20 voices

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hmjm0o/>

↳ (0): "You know, \$240 for insurance you can actually use? Isn't bad at all. The new Medicare premium for 2025 is \$185. And that? Is for insurance that's about as useful as tits on a nun, and doesn't include vision or dental coverage. Secondly, the Marketplace is open for enrollment until January 15th: https://www.healthcare.gov/subscriber/?gad_source=1&gclid=CjwKCAiAmrS7BhBJEiwAei59i9Oacg0wxG2w-ZA-CIWv7rQmP1f88oKN4m5i8AvwQGxt-DXXSOE0lhoCgioQAvD_BwE&gclsrc=aw.ds You are still eligible for Marketplace coverage and subsidies if: 1. Your employer-offered insurance is more than 9.12% of your annual income, or the lowest-cost option to cover your family is 9.12% of your household's total income. 2. Your employer-offered insurance doesn't meet ACA standards (which is defined generally as those that offer coverage for doctors and hospitals, and generally pay for 60% of medical costs). If you don't qualify for Medicaid? It's because your income is too high to do so. I don't know what to tell you. It sounds like you rolled the dice, took a chance, and lost."

↳ (0): "13 years working in the world of the Affordable Care Act 8 Years of Provider Services dealing with Medical Professionals 7 Years of Customer Service dealing with individuals' questions on claims and benefits 5 years of Medical Claim Processing So what state do you live in? Does your state have a State-Run Health Insurance Marketplace? My state is still in OPEN ENROLLMENT to enroll in a Health Insurance Plan for 2025 with an effective date of February 1, 2025. The deadline for a January 1 Effective date has passed; the deadline line is midnight December 15, 2024. I am not able to use the tools I have to determine if you are eligible for Tax Subsidies to enroll in a healthcare plan with financial assistance. Your age, yearly income, or Adjusted Gross Income, the tax structure of your household, married, children, filing single, etc, are needed to determine this. Secondly, your Employer offers you a health insurance plan (ESI). Most ESI plans meet the Qualified Health Insurance standard (QHP), as set forth by the Affordable Care Act (ACA). There are two things that a QHP must meet A: They must meet "MINIMUM ESSENTIAL VALUE" - which means a healthcare plan must pay at least 60% of all claims AFTER the deductible is met B: They must meet MINIMUM ESSENTIAL COVERAGE" - meaning they MUST cover the 10 essential health care benefits as outlined in the ACA Law they are, Routine Yearly Physical Walk-In Clinic Services Emergency Room Services Laboratory Services - testing blood, Urine Testing, Biopsy services Pharmacy Mental Health Services both in-patient and out-patient Ambulance Services Prenatal Services (I don't remember them all but these are the most important) Without knowing what your employer plan looks like meaning What does it cost per pay period and what would you pay per pay period What is the Deductible on that plan and what is the Max Out of Pocket Expense on that plan ... is the ESI going to cost you more than 9.07% of your income? ...is the ESI plan just an HSA plan? I like BIG HUGE examples to make a point. Let us assume that your ESI plan reads something like this Yearly Deductible: 10,000 Yearly Max Out of Pocket Expense: \$15,000... You get injured, you get transported by ambulance, to the ER

then to Surgery, then to a recovery room, then 5 nights in a hospital with physical therapy, medications, etc...and the total amount owed to the hospital and providers on the day of discharge is \$2 Million. If you were enrolled in the ESI plan, the MOST you pay is \$15,000. Everything else is covered at 100%, you are only responsible for \$15,000. - if the same thing happened again just 4 months later or 2 months later, the total expense you would need to pay is \$0. More information is needed to guide you."

↳ (0): "Non of OPs post makes any sense. They are fishing for upvotes."

"Someone please explain why I (or anyone) should pay a premium that costs more than the oop max The maths aren't mathing. Someone help me understand what I am missing here. We live in NY. I am a self-employed general contractor. Wife is an attorney and recently left her job to open her own firm so we lost great health insurance through her previous employer. Cobra would cost us around \$7k/ month for 2 healthy adults and our 8yo healthy son. Now we're shopping on the marketplace in what appears to be the worst time in history to be doing so. We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around \$3k/month. Catastrophic is coming in around \$750/month. After a lot of research I can't understand why I would buy anything other than catastrophic. All ACA plans include the same preventive care at no cost. All ACA plans have the same out of pocket maximum limit. Aside from a catastrophe, we would maybe spend \$1k/ year at most seeking care that isn't covered under ACA preventive care. So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 577 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ozntee/>

↳ (0): "All ACA plans don't have the same out of pocket max.. they all have a maximum out of pocket max, but they vary. Sounds like catastrophic would be the choice for you. I have a silver plan and I like it because it has 0 deductible and covers my expensive meds and treatment. You don't need that much coverage it sounds like."

↳ (0): "Before you choose do a search to see what hospitals or providers are in network. During a period of unemployment I chose a cheap bronze plan only there were literally NO doctors or hospitals in my network within 50 miles. While all policies must cover emergency room visits, what constitutes an emergency now can be redefined by your insurance and your bills denied."

↳ (0): "It's layers and layers and layers of fucked up, isn't it?"

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

↳ (0): "Two reasons you might not be seeing subsidies on ACA plans: * your annual income is too low, or you entered it incorrectly. Your annual income must be over the poverty line to be eligible for subsidies * you answered the questions about employer coverage incorrectly, and you're not seeing subsidies because the application believes you have affordable employer coverage available"

↳ (0): "Can you expand on the international bit? That might change things quite a bit"

↳ (0): "The baby will be born there, but it will be a US citizen after some paperwork. My partner and I are both US citizens."

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

"I retired early and was looking into buying a plan on the market place. I don't qualify for any subsidies. Silver plan \$1500 per month with a \$6k deductible. I would need to pay \$24k a year before insurance kicks in. Once insurance kicks in I still have to pay a 30% coinsurance. Affordable Care Act is not very affordable. I wouldn't mind paying the \$1500 if it was a good plan but these HMO plans are horrible."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65: The ACA Reality Nobody Tells You · 28 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Qz8CyPjA5s&lc=Ugy9bM75_-R74GPcIPR4AaABAg

↳ @SPR_NAPALM (6): "It's because Republicans have been whittling it down for the last 10 years. Death of a thousand cuts."

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (2): "Depends on what your MAGI is. That is how they calculate your benefits. Any taxed money or income changes your MAGI."

↳ @g.t.richardson6311 (2): "I'm 65 .. my wife retired and is 60 .. our pensions are good she was a teacher mine is private but decent .. we have plenty other "stuff" we'd qualify for nothing .. I pay her 990 a month .I we budgeted for it."

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxtql8/>

↳ (0): "Nope. The moving QLE requires the individual to have had qualified coverage for at least one of the 60 days prior to the move. Moving QLE is predicated on the loss of coverage or moving outside the effective coverage area of the current policy."

↳ (0): "These premiums are unsustainable. These prices are like sending a kid to college each year, and that's before your out of pocket costs. But to your question: No, simply changing residency won't allow you to insure after the fact. If you have an accident or emergency situation like a burst appendix, a new plan would not cover those bills retroactively. A cancer or cardiac diagnosis requiring treatment next month? That could work, but you would still face the up front costs of biopsy, tests and diagnosis."

↳ (0): "The thing is that medical bills without insurance are staggeringly high - far, far more than you could save from not paying these extortionate rates. You can very easily be in the \$100k+ territory for some fairly 'routine' surgeries, without even a night in hospital."

"Married couple retired, 57 years old, ACA plan in Florida which is 2k a month with a 7k deductible each after which they pay 100%. Average yearly cost is \$24K premium plus 7k deductible payment so \$31K a year, we don't qualify for subsidies."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgwwdKXK6chG_tXFMfV4AaABAg

↳ @kona6451 (2): "It's a crime isn't it."

↳ @dgmcfadden2006 (1): "I figure that is where we will be is about 30k."

↳ @jpgaffney3594 (0): "@BillyNewport-ez2vn That is a TON of money! Just curious after you watched this video did you try working with MOVE Health? If so, what was your outcome? Thanks!"

"I quit a 20 year career at 50 🥹 with terrific health insurance in order to become self employed. I'm in CA and was able to get Covered CA (ACA) at first which was wonderful. Nowadays at 56 I make too much to qualify. And I have a 15 year old son at home. I get Blue Shield Gold PPO which is \$1500 a month for the two of us. 🥹 But no deductible. This was good news considering I ended up with cancer + brain surgery in the last 3 years! I pay a lot for medical insurance but it gives me peace of mind."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgwwS68tKfIQws0fQ-V4AaABAg

↳ @PatricLubomir-r2w (1): "Wow, you've been through so much. ❤️ Leaving a 20-year career to build your own business was a brave decision, and then facing cancer and brain surgery on top of that must have been incredibly challenging. I'm so glad you had solid coverage when you needed it most. Even though \$1,500 a month is a huge expense, I can completely understand why the peace of mind is worth it after everything you've experienced. How are you doing these days? I hope you're feeling much stronger now. And how has being self-employed been for you overall—despite the healthcare costs, has it been everything you hoped it would be?"

↳ @scottunclocked (0): "Thank you for your comments. Great example of the reason why you need good health insurance! You just never know when something major is going to hit you and it isn't worth the risk of ruining your whole retirement because of a massive health care bill. I pray you are doing better after surgery and are recovering!"

↳ @Dravlae (0): "Hope you recover well."

"Thank you. Cobra will be way too expensive and I don't qualify for Medicaid."

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wpgg7y/husband_pased_away_and_i_no_longer_have/pbv8blb/

"Ours is actually quite a bit worse, probably due to age (late 50's). If we careen over the cliff of \$84,600 due to not having quite enough expenses or whatever, it will cost us an additional \$19,200 / year. Our anticipated income is just very, very close to the cliff, and that's best case scenario with a bronze plan and full HSA funding to get our MAGI to \$80k. If we topple over, we will pay over \$24,000 / year in premiums for a bronze plan + \$10,750 to fund the HSA. That's 41% of our gross income before we even visit a doctor or fill a prescription, not to mention federal and state taxes. Not much left. WTF, America?"

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/nm32690/

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqibrvo/

"Cancelled my ACA plan a couple months back. I made too much for the subsidy. My kids are covered under their mom's (my ex) insurance. My bronze plan had a 9k deductible. I'm paying cash moving toward for medical. If I go into a coma.. I don't own a home, my car is worth \$2,500. And they can't touch my retirement, so most of my risk is mitigated. (Under federal law up to \$1,512,350 in IRAs is protected from creditors in bankruptcy)"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgwgRjNmbi3gTenofwB4AaABAg>

"We dropped ours. \$25k worth of premiums only now not going into the kitty. We just couldn't afford the premiums AND everything else that was out of pocket. We each had a 9k deductible on top of the premium outlay. We don't make a ton - but we make too much for extended subsidies and too little to cover those kind of costs for just the possibility we might have a huge emergency \$35k plus health event where insurance won't even start to cover anything."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q6f1ge/obamacare_premiums_jump_114_overnight_why_48/ny7phfx/

"2 people. My wife and I. We make too much for the non-extended subsidies which went away. My plan premium went from \$750 a month for a gold plan, to \$2150 a month for the crappiest bronze plan with a 10K deductible. That is 25% of my income and I am not paying it."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q9mpvb/republican_senators_are_pushing_to_get_enhanced/nz0z7u5/

"Yes, we're with you, in the same shitty boat but late 50's so worse. We had a gold plan last year (there was some fuckery that made it less expensive than a silver plan) for \$1000 / month. Just over the cliff. I'm reading that our premiums for a bronze plan could be \$3000 / month next year. That would be around 40% of our total income before taxes. We're casually considering leaving the country, it's not what we were promised in our youth anyway. It sounds like the administration wants catastrophic plans for people our age? When those were previously only available to people in their 20's (for good reason, people in their 20's don't get sick)? These don't really cover much of anything until you hit a \$10,000+ deductible and according to chat: Likely not favorable for someone in late 50s (unless unusual circumstances)."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh6qs6p/

"This is key. People like the commenter that you replied to can argue about the temporary nature of Covid subsidies all they want. At the end of the day, though, does it matter when there's a reasonably large portion the population that now find themselves in a spot where, because of accelerating cost of living increases, they make too much for any relief from escalating health care costs but not nearly enough to afford health care on their own? And from the anecdotal stories posted here and elsewhere, it seems like a lot of these people tend to be 50+, an age range where health starts to degrade and access to care becomes more necessary, yet also an age where they are years away from accessing Medicare. I'm dreading to see what my premiums will look like in a few years."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q6f1ge/obamacare_premiums_jump_114_overnight_why_48/ny7wkhs/

"I make \$400 over the limit for free health insurance I have 2 kids a fiancé we live on our own with a car payment and car insurance we're already stretched thin. We went to the hospital for a simple iv because we had a stomach bug and couldn't stop puking so we were extremely dehydrated to the point where we were confused and dizzy. I got a \$2000 hospital bill for a SIMPLE IV that i was only hooked up to for an hour and then we left. The cheapest plan I found had a \$8400 deductible which I absolutely cannot afford. I was just trying to get insurance to pay for my \$2000 iv but in my case the monthly payment for the 2k hospital bill would cost me less than having to pay for the cheapest insurance i could find."

— YouTube · How to Buy Health Insurance on HealthCare.gov (or your State's Marketplace) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fND9DallI2Y&lc=Ugw8cl6lZWVLHEtzpfF4AaABAq>

↳ @SelfEmploymentSidekick (2): "Ugh. I really hate how this works. I remember finding a \$200 line item on a doctor's bill for "Ear wax extraction" because the pediatrician used a cotton swab in my kid's ear real quick during his regular check up. And then there are cases like yours where it would be cheaper to just pay the ridiculous bill rather than pay a ridiculous premium and STILL have to pay the ridiculous bill. Unfortunately, I don't know the best solution for this. I'm just doing my best to help people understand the different options that are available. But I realize the available options aren't good enough."

↳ @pinkorganichorse (0): "When you get free Healthcare, my young son and I can't get any because our premium is too high directly because we are supplementing your subsidy."

"Not true at all. I was self-employed before and after the ACA came into effect. My health insurance costs skyrocketed with the ACA. The income cliff for subsidies was a budget killer, and is again now. Since my income is just over the cliff amount, I could easily pay 40 percent of income for insurance and co-pays. It's horrendous. I will concede that the ACA did away with pre-existing conditions underwriting, which is a good thing. But insurance costs have skyrocketed for both employers and ACA enrollees. I'm a firm believer that the government can do very little properly or efficiently, but I'm even willing to accept that something like medicare for all would be preferable. There is no reason that health insurance should be tied to employment."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s2bz1r/why_did_the_aca_not_abolish_the_employer/oc7zmu0/

"Thank you! I'm happy your mom has been able to afford her medicine. It's so sad that we pay so much and get so little in return. I try not to stress about it but fuck it's so hard not too. Then I'm scared it might go up next year and regardless i need my insurance for my family. I make too much for Medicaid I'm stuck in the middle. With my insurance my Ozempic is 800 and Farxiga is 400"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vnce2d/a_shocking_92_percent_of_us_adults_are_not_going/p3ii1am/

"Broken leg might be okay with cash pay but cancer would surely be financially devastating. I was hoping catastrophic insurance changes would help. As of today, all people (not just those <30 years old) who don't qualify for subsidies are eligible for catastrophic coverage. I woke up early to look at what premiums would be for ACA catastrophic coverage only - \$2100/month for my family with a \$21,500 deductible 😞 Luckily, I have employer-sponsored health insurance through my employer right now but the job is very unstable. My husband and I decided today that our family will have to go without health insurance again if I lose my job. We had to go without health insurance for many years before I got this job because ACA premiums were too high - and they're now about 2x as high than the last time I checked our ACA options. We know our providers offer reasonable cash prices and I've discovered a whole network of cash-pay services, labs, and imaging facilities. There's even a hospital that only offers surgery for cash-pay (<https://surgerycenterok.com>) that's within driving distance and could affordably repair broken bones, etc. But cancer or a catastrophic event would bankrupt us."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olugzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nml2egf/

Denied claims and surprise bills · 36 documents · 20 voices

"UHC Denial My son was scheduled to have surgery to correct his pectum excavatum in 2022. His surgeon said he met all the medically required criteria. Two days before the surgery UHC denied the surgery. This was incredibly stressful. Apparently their reasoning was that my 22 year old son had 82% lung capacity based upon th tests due this chronic condition and they only approve patients 80% or less. My son was don't worry mom we'll be ok. He is not angry he was just concerned about me. Later that year my husband lost his job and with it UHC medical insurance. My son(student) and I got coverage through the ACA. The next year with his new insurance ,same doctor he was able to get the surgery. We are blessed. However I still feel traumatized every time I think about the denial from UHC. There are probably lots of other people in the same boat as me. Only a patients doctor should be able to make these life altering decisions not insurance companies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,523 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1h8c09I/>

↳ (0): "The US is the only country that ties your health insurance to your job. That alone is stunning. Then .. the decision whether you get care or not is made by a for-profit corporation. That is unacceptable."

↳ (0): "Yup! Hurricane Helene hit and my doctors in Sylvia and Asheville were unreachable. Called UHC and was told I could go south into GA (out of state) for the remainder of my pregnancy and it to worry about a thing. This was wonderful as the doctors in GA were only 30 mins away compared to the 4-8 hour, 200+ mile round trip they had me doing. That was on October 2nd, I called the GA doctor immediately and was told the soonest they could get me in was October 29th at 7am so I waited, I also scheduled a ride through UHC via 'motiv care' because i can't drive. October 28th, 6:15pm. UHC calls me to tell me that they were unable to secure me a ride and that they would pay for the gas. Very useful for someone who doesn't drive, and only gave me less than 12 hours (less really since you know most people aren't awake at night) to find an alternative ride. At this point I haven't seen anyone since September... My husband was able to get time off work to drive me (thank god). I got the the office and told me it was \$600 and my insurance wasn't going to cover it. I assumed this was going to be one of those call to straighten things out so I called UHC while in the lobby. It was then, and ONLY then.. did UHC inform me that my ability to go out of state for care had a time limit which was October 21st, 8 days short of the soonest the doctor could see me. They failed to both notify me or the doctors office about this. My baby has a chance to have Down syndrome and lacking 2 months of care already was hard enough and putting my baby at risk, I then asked what to do, where to go and what doctor I could see. UHC told me repeatedly to 'just go to the ER' over and over again. Refusing to do anything else despite the fact that going to the ER would do absolutely NOTHING. I returned home having panic attacks and had to rest. I woke up and called back again demanding that they either withhold their verbal contract OR have me see a doctor in NC that isn't in a disaster zone or have me go through one. There is not a single doctor in WNC that I can see, they verbally confirmed this. They also confirmed that indeed, no one from UHC informed anyone about the first end date for 'out of state care'. The agent informed me I would get a case manager and that it would likely be simple as extending the prior approval. BUT because it was filed in a grievance report, it would possibly take up to 30 days to get a reply.. this was October 29th, 2 months without seeing anyone and now forced to wait longer. I called weekly and got no update and told to wait. None of my begging and pleading over for fact that at that time I was 8 months going on 9 months changed anything. I then by a miracle had my Asheville doctor pop up who was doing special ultrasounds to look for physical check marks say I had an appointment on the 21st of November and I took it and was able to get a ride. At that point my baby was not doing so great, small abdomen and needed to be induced soon. But without knowing WHERE, I decided to schedule another ultra sound on December 4th to see if he would slip off the growth chart or improve and give UHC time to tell me where I was going.. NOVEMBER 27th, I received my update. My update? Nothing, if you want to go out of state have your primary care provider to recommend an out of service provider. I had to ask numerous times because my brain broke about this.. That I was previously approved That I have no doctor in my area that aren't in a disaster zone But

they needed me to do the leg work to get seen at 9 months pregnant with 1 week, less than 5 business days to figure it out. Best they could do was file another grievance report that would take another 30 days... Called my pcp asap and got them to work on getting the referral UHC apparently 'needed' and I also called my pregnancy advocate who would call UHC herself and see if she could help. My pcp got the referral in on December 4th. My ultrasound showed my baby was stunted in growth and needed induction asap. My pregnancy advocate was able to get a hold of UHC care management team who was helping set up for GA and assured me they were going to get me in there. December 5th. I was denied the ability to go to the doctor in GA that was 30 mins away because I needed to be induced so soon and they refused to induce unless they got to see me first before hand leaving an availability next week, way too late. So onto the next option. Sylvia, 2 1/2 hours away. They also denied me because they haven't seen my since September.... So my pregnancy advocate who was working with the UHC care management team told me that my only option now. Was to drive 4 1/2 hours to downtown Asheville to give birth... to just show up and tell them you're here to induce and you'll be taken care of.... And that the UHC management would call me to ensure transportation. UHC never reached out. I had to figure out how to get a 4 1/2 hours drive on my own in less than 24 hours... I got a ride to the hospital, got there and was told .. who are you? Why are you here? Who sent you? We don't have any rooms? Had to wait 3 hours to finally get situated into a room... Still here and working on popping this baby but the amount of stress, panic and tears I had to go through because UHC refused to get off their lazy ass and put my baby at risk was not fun. — — — Also to add, I had a driver from motiv care got a speeding ticket while I was in the car, have the car break down in front of my house and under UHC direction had it towed after two weeks with no one reaching out.. Then had the driver threaten my life if I didn't get his car back that night.. it took 9 hours of me having panic attacks and crying my eyes out for them to go beyond just filing a grievance report. I was 6 months pregnant at the time. Another time I had to drive in a car, 5 months pregnant for 6 hours round trip with a driver who's entire car reeked of marijuana. When on my return ride it was obvious it freshly smoked... Filed a report and UHC and motiv care told me they couldn't say for sure if it was the driver or a previous rider so nothing would be done...."

↳ (0): "Commenting here for visibility of your comment because this has left me absolutely speechless. Imaging pushing paper in a DISASTER. What the actual fuck? I am so sorry!!"

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/>

↳ (0): "You can report any insurance carrier operating an aca marketplace plan to your state department of insurance."

↳ (0): "**Nevada Division of Insurance:** Northern NV (775) 687-0700 or Southern NV (702) 486-4009"

↳ (0): "Name and shame. Who is the insurance carrier? What exact plan did you purchase? Any plan documents you can share here to give us something to review and provide direction? Edit: This thread is kind of all over the place, but since this is a higher-level comment: Imperial *is* a legitimate, ACA-qualified carrier and this is a qualified health plan sold through Nevada Health Link, the state's official marketplace. What's more, since Imperial is a very small carrier with a narrow network, OP didn't have a choice and went to an OON emergency room. So it's crystal clear: Imperial hasn't "not paid anything"--they haven't even been billed for anything. The onus is now on OP to submit a super bill / claim directly to Imperial since this is an OON hospital with no mechanism to submit a claim on their behalf. Annoying, no doubt, but is necessary if they want to have any coverage for this encounter."

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tmp52c/>

↳ (0): "If she is an in-network provider she has a contract with your insurance provider and has agreed to their reimbursement rates. Confirm with your insurance company that her and her office are in-network. If she's collecting the "remaining balance" from patients she's breaking her contractual obligation. Providers cannot ask you to give up your rights to not be balanced billed. Also, it sounds like you're no longer comfortable with her either way and it'd be best to find another provider"

↳ (0): "OP your insurance can also do a three-way call with the provider and you to explain everything (if they actually are in network)."

↳ (0): "I'm a psychologist. Your therapist is in network and has agreed to the rate that the insurance company set. She or he cannot "balance bill" you. Depending on your state, it may be illegal. Regardless of state, it's unethical and in violation of the agreement that the therapist made with the insurance company as an in-network provider. If you want to go hard, you can report them to their licensing board for unethical behavior. At a minimum, I would not stick with this therapist. They're either uneducated or unethical. You don't want either of those in a therapist."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: <https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>;

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

"The key to avoiding high healthcare costs is to be healthy. I've been self-employed for over 16 years and have the ACA since it came out. I pick the cheapest plan which gives my coverage in case of an emergency and all my wellness care. I pay \$131 per month for a bronze plan. I have paid up to \$270 per month in past higher earning years. I pay out of pocket for things not covered if I need them and get a 45% self pay discount. I don't pay a lot for healthcare per year and focus on being active and eating healthy non processed foods. I pay less on medical costs than many pay for insurance alone per year. This has been my way to not fund a ridiculously priced industry. I'm nearing 59. Protect your health at all costs!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxcstwBmYAJgMrsGvh4AaABAg>

↳ @sct4040 (12): "Accidents happen too."

↳ @vogeljennifer6318 (8): "Although this is a great mindset, some people don't have the ability to undo medical issues that require care"

↳ @kona6451 (0): "How old are you? That sounds really cheap"

"2027 shock 2026 me and dependent \$500 month 2027 \$959 month Got a letter from Florida Blue that if my income and subsidy is the same then this is what my premium will be. I know premiums went up but geez double? I'm limited to what plans I can get because I take a drug that's \$2200 a month. That only gets covered if it's on the formulary and I pay my out pocket maximum. So I can't even think about going to a lower end plan because those don't cover my drugs at all even with prior authorization. Any Florida Blue folks out there in the same boat? Any hope that when open enrollment starts maybe higher premiums will be offset with higher subsidies ? We're all winning right?"

— r/obamacare · 55 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wyq35r/>

↳ (0): "There is no chance of higher subsidies as long as a Republican is in the White House. Thank all of the Trump folks in Florida for this."

↳ (0): "Their replacement plan is coming along any day now, right? Maybe after our DOGE check?"

↳ (0): "This is what Republicans killing subsidies does"

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

↳ (0): "Two reasons you might not be seeing subsidies on ACA plans: * your annual income is too low, or you entered it incorrectly. Your annual income must be over the poverty line to be eligible for subsidies * you answered the questions about employer coverage incorrectly, and you're not seeing subsidies because the application believes you have affordable employer coverage available"

↳ (0): "Can you expand on the international bit? That might change things quite a bit"

↳ (0): "The baby will be born there, but it will be a US citizen after some paperwork. My partner and I are both US citizens."

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

↳ (0): "This happens more often than people realize, and no, you are not crazy. Agents or lead generators are motivated by sales. Your agreement and signature are required. What probably occurred is a Marketplace enrollment was completed without your informed consent, often by a third-party agent or lead generator out of need to meet quotas or just greed. Checking eligibility alone does not authorize enrollment. Actual enrollment requires affirmative plan selection and attestation. If that did not occur, this is improper enrollment. Here is what you do, in order. First, call Ambetter immediately and demand the following in writing: • The original application • The agent or broker of record • The date and method of enrollment • The address used and who supplied it • Whether premium tax credits were applied Tell them explicitly you dispute the enrollment as unauthorized and demand a retroactive cancellation to the effective date. Use the phrase unauthorized enrollment without consent. That language matters. Second, contact HealthCare.gov and request a Marketplace case escalation. Ask them to flag the policy as fraudulent enrollment. This is not customer service. This is an eligibility integrity issue. Third, file a complaint with your state Department of Insurance. This creates regulatory pressure and forces documentation. Insurers and agents move fast once DOI is involved. Fourth, protect your tax position. If any premium tax credit was applied, you need a corrected 1095-A showing zero coverage. Otherwise the IRS assumes you accepted subsidized coverage and will claw it back. Fifth, do not pay the bills until the dispute is resolved. Paying can be construed as ratification. Key point: Using your old address is a red flag. That usually indicates data scraping or recycled lead enrollment, not a consumer-initiated action. This is not your fault. It is fixable. But it must be handled surgically and documented. If Ambetter or the Marketplace resists, escalate again and document everything. Paper trails win these cases. In many cases the threat to Department of Insurance is enough."

↳ (0): "CSR from Ambetter here. We do not have the enrollment information that you mention. Only the plan, aptc, effective date and information of the identity of the subscriber. What I do when I receive a call like this is that I call the marketplace and I assist the member to initiate a HICS case for fraud with the rep of marketplace sharing the enrollment dates we have on the system. An investigation is made by a case worker, and once the source it's confirmed was fraudulent they claim back the APTC sent to the health plan, the plan is retroactively cancelled and member receives a letter of termination from the health plan. 9 out of 10 times the fraud is confirmed. The exceptions happen because member did sign up and granted consent to a broker and forgot about it for the rewards card which the brokers did activities and the like so the member could get a few dollars, but I don't expect to see that happen because fewer people qualify for the Silver 94% plan with 0 member responsibility. To avoid that we now have to ask a \$5 dollars payment per month for those accounts that is refunded at the end of the year. Crazy stuff."

↳ (0): "You need to make two calls. One to the insurance commissioner in your state and ask for their help. Second call CMS and make a complaint, ask for the issue to be resolved."

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1so9ty7/>

↳ (0): "Sounds like a situation where you need to involve your State Department of Insurance so they can look into this further."

↳ (0): "And your state representative office"

↳ (0): "This is far beyond what anyone here can help with. Out of curiosity - what is the reason for the retroactive termination? At worst, a premium payment issue would terminate coverage effective the last month of no payment. Since your payment issues only began in December, there's another reason why Oscar retroactively cancelled your insurance for all of 2025. Are they claiming you misrepresented yourself and were in fact ineligible?"

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pedcpv/>

↳ (0): "Are you in nyc? I switched to Ambetter Silver for next year bc Anthem is going to be out of network with

Mt Sinai. Hoping I can use most of my Sinai dr's"

↳ (0): "I kind of want to vomit because it's so upsetting that this experience was a "positive" one. But I also get it because the bar is SO low. Like the other commenter I was considering switching because of Sinai system dropping Anthem and most of my doctors being through them. I know the Sinai urgent care I go to sometimes said they will take it but they take HealthFirst also. I'm really not sure which one to choose..."

↳ (0): "Do you know if NYU Langone and its doctors are covered?"

"How many Americans are on PPO health insurance that covers seeing specialists/doctors across state lines compared to being on insurance that only covers within the state? I'm on Medicaid in Rhode Island for disability and it's frustrating dealing with out of state approvals. Any advice welcomed. I've had long-term neurological issues like neuropathy, muscle pain, and memory issues for nearly 6 years that neurologists in my state (and in Connecticut) haven't been able to definitively diagnose. I am on SSI for disability, which means I get Neighborhood Health Plan of Rhode Island as my primary insurance, with Medicaid as the secondary. I was told by a neurologist I saw across the border in Connecticut recently (Some doctors in CT take my insurance it seems) that being seen at a bigger hospital like Mass General may lead to a definitive diagnosis. From what I was told by his office after they tried referring me to the hospital, Mass General/MGH is no longer accepting my insurance even with prior authorization, when a few years ago i was told by Mass General they were taking my insurance with those stipulations. I was told by MGH's neurology department staff (who were very nice and compassionate about my situation, to be fair to them) that it's possible the hospital chose not to contract with my insurance this year, hence the change, and that because I am on Medicaid, I couldn't even choose to self-pay to go there. They said it's possible in the future the contractual issue could change, and they also told me to try contacting Neighborhood Health myself and explain the situation and see if they could somehow get me approved to be seen at Mass General. I will be calling them this upcoming week. I was curious as to how often Americans are on health insurance plans that cover seeing specialists across state lines, how difficult it is for them to be approved to see specialists in different states, etc. I find it frustrating that my insurance doesn't work across state lines considering this is the smallest state in the country. Not every specialist is going to be here. Logistically it seems to make sense to me that CT/MA should have a deal with RI insurance to cover people if they at least get prior authorization/approval. As of right now Mass General wouldn't take me no matter what, which I find very concerning and depressing. I have had multiple neurologists say I should be seen in a place like Boston to possibly get a definitive diagnosis, why is that not enough to be seen there? That makes no sense to me."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uheytb/how_many_americans_are_on_ppo_health_insurance/

↳ Good_Educator4872 (3): "Originally they wanted to control what plans you could buy. Govt plans always limited coverage to care within the relevant political entity. No one ever accused the designers of Obamacare of being forward thinking. It was about control. The original thinking was to use the British NHS as a model. There were problems with this. We are different than EUROPEAN COUNTRIES. We have the most extensive checks and balances balance system. The states are sovereign political entities. European states have always been organized from the top down. The US. is the inverse. Our constitution is a mutual agreement among sovereign states to cede certain powers to the Federal government. This limits the federal governments ability to dictate internal state action except in delineated areas. Generally, the Fed can only exert oversight in areas the state is not currently regulating. The Federal government doesn't regulate insurance policies unless the state agrees. Insurance is the purview of the states as an example not the Federal Government"

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes. And I had a policy in RI from the market place there (recently moved out of state). It was a BCBS PPO, the lowest level with an HSA. It has a national provider network and allows for seeing doctors, specialists, labs,etc anywhere in the country. I never had even a single issue and I've got doctors in multiple states (though not in RI because well...)."

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes! It's weird because it's almost impossible to get a doctor or most specialists in RI but we have one of the very best marketplaces. But it's only the BCBS PPO with the national provider network so look for one of theirs."

"Ambetter admitting to missing three P2P's and recording inaccurate data I have Ambetter through the ACA marketplace and have been trying since March to get ivabradine (Corlanor) 5 mg approved for Inappropriate Sinus Tachycardia (IST). The medication was denied, so my cardiologist and I started the appeal process. We submitted multiple documents and were repeatedly told some variation of, "We just need one more document and you should be approved." Over the next few months, I received conflicting information from different representatives. One rep told me my doctor never submitted an appeal, while another confirmed that the appeal had been received. I was also repeatedly transferred to an offshore team that often couldn't locate my account or case information and could only read from a script. Eventually, Ambetter told us a peer-to-peer (P2P) review was needed. My doctor scheduled and waited for three separate P2P calls. On each occasion, they reserved two hours of their time and never received a call from Ambetter. When I questioned this, I was initially told that my physician likely missed the calls. After pushing for escalation, I was given a complaint number and promised a callback. No one ever called. I later reached someone on the escalation team who seemed genuinely helpful. He reviewed the case notes and stated that he could see all three missed P2P reviews. He also found documentation indicating that my physician's office had supposedly been contacted before a P2P had even been approved, which didn't make sense chronologically. He told me he had rarely seen a case file this disorganized and said he would immediately contact the pharmacy medical director. After I was on hold for approximately 90 minutes, the call disconnected. The next day, I called back with all of my reference numbers and complaint information. The escalation team transferred me back to the main customer service line. Pharmacy transferred me back to escalation. Escalation then sent me back to the main line again. At one point, the pharmacy representative called for me and was literally transferred back into his own department. To make matters worse, I ended up in the ER during this process and nearly lost my job because my symptoms remained uncontrolled while I fought through these delays. At this point, I'm preparing to file a complaint with my states Department of Insurance. My physician's office has documentation of the missed P2P appointments. Has anyone dealt with anything similar with their insurance? Beyond filing with the state and pursuing external review, is there anything else I should be doing? I pay \$550 a month for just me. TL:DR: My insurance has no internal workflow/communication, recorded inaccurate data, and has no actual escalation team. I'm at a loss of how to navigate other than filing with the state."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tx9333/>

↳ (0): "First off, Ambetter sucks. Not just a little, but a lot. The pharmacy area is a joke. The initial round of reviews are done by non US based pharmacists with questionable decision making. Most often this results in denials that are overturned later on. Their decisions on step therapy often recommend options that are not appropriate for patients. The escalation and P2P processes are astoundingly bad. Lots of no callbacks on escalations, never scheduled or no response to P2P requests, and missed scheduled P2P. The only way i've found to push the process forward (from my experience and peers) is to have the patient file a grievance with their state insurance commissioner's office. I usually get a follow up from Ambetter within 24 hours of receipt of the complaint. The key is that on the provider side they must track every call, fax, and email. Have receipts. We print off a detailed log, along with recommended wording for a state grievance. Patients understand we're on their side, but with the low reimbursements that Ambetter offers, it's often done at a deficit for the practice."

↳ (0): "In the future, file a grievance immediately with the insurance once you are beyond 7-14 calendar days from the initial request. Then, file a complaint with the division of insurance immediately if they don't resolve your grievance within 7-14 calendar days. Aka don't pass 30 days without a call to the state division of insurance. Complaint filing should be an easy process at the state level, they want and need to know."

↳ (0): "I'm sorry you're going through this. The first step is to confirm which state your Ambetter plan is based in,

since the appeal process can vary by state. As an agent, when a prior authorization is denied, I immediately submit an expedited appeal so the member can get a final resolution quickly. If that appeal is denied, I help them file an Independent Review Organization (IRO) request right away. The full process usually takes about 14 days. Most denials happen because the medical criteria simply aren't met — for example, when the provider prescribes something off-label, experimental, or fails to submit the required documentation. If the denial is due to a health plan error, the IRO often overturns it at no cost to the member. Sometimes appeals succeed because the Medical Director contacts the provider's office for more information. However, since Medical Directors handle dozens of cases per shift, if they can't connect with the provider promptly, the denial is usually upheld. The IRO process is more thorough because it requests documentation directly from the provider and reviews everything comprehensively. In certain states, like Florida, Centene Pharmacy Services handles appeals directly, leaving agents with little influence. Also, the so-called "Member Escalation Team" is essentially experienced customer service representatives — they don't escalate issues beyond standard procedures. True escalation happens through appeals or grievances, where the health plan must act according to your Evidence of Coverage and applicable law. Corporate staff may get involved, but unless your contract or policy language allows exceptions, their role is limited. Recommended Steps Call Ambetter and request to file an appeal as the patient for the denied prior authorization. Note the complaint number if your state allows appeals by phone, or complete the appeal form and send it to your state's designated address. Wait for the letter of determination. If denial is upheld, submit an IRO request. If the IRO also upholds the denial, you can file a complaint with your state's Department of Insurance. You can also skip directly to the Department of Insurance, but they'll usually redirect you back into the same process I described — only with corporate agents involved. That may be preferable if you'd rather speak with someone based in the U.S., since most contact center agents are overseas. Good luck — persistence is key in these cases, and following the proper steps gives you the best chance of success"

"I just needed the ACA for a little more than a year before I qualify for Medicare in 2026. I recently bought a bronze plan which is more basic than I am used to, and paying 900/month, excluding vision and dental and that is with a monthly supplement. Without the supplement, it will be closer to 1200/month. My ACA plan is so scaled down that it won't cover a bone density screening, so I am postponing it. I can pay the increased rate for a limited period of time until I get Medicare, but it will be tight. With rising costs in all areas of the economy- groceries, utilities, etc.- we will definitely be cutting back across the board so I can make it to Medicare. All of that being said, it's so aggravating that healthcare in this country is deemed a privilege. It really should be a basic human right but somehow, in the richest country on earth, we can't "afford it". The US is becoming unaffordable for everyone except the rich."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5py1yp/

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

↳ wischywaschy (3): "I can't really help but I also have massive problems with IBX (self-funded plan) with an appeal process and the DOL is trying to help. IBX is a mess - it looks like they don't follow all ERISA regulations and seem very disorganized. The DOL is helpful but they are really short-staffed since they got DOGE'd, so whatever they can do for us is slow. They said to me they can do more when more people complain, so please

complain!"

↳ budrow21 (2): "I would file the appeals directly and continue working through the DoL. You don't have many other options."

↳ theoretalking (2): "Have you tried asking your employer's benefit manager and the broker to follow up with the account manager at IBX since she has not been responsive? The most people you got pushing and fighting for you, the better. sounds like you called your state's DOL? Try the US DOL here: <https://beta.dol.gov/about/agencies/ebsa/ask-ebsa> Have you tried looking up ERISA lawyers on Google? When I did that, I see a bunch lawyers that specialize in ERISA show up. It seems most (or not all) of them offer free consultation. I suggest you try that to find someone in your region."

"We only had one psychiatrist in our town. And he literally disappeared overnight and I'm not exaggerating. I played hell finding another psychiatrist. We had no other ones in our area. And this was before telehealth became really popular, so that wasn't a route I could go I ended up signing up for a plan with a local nurse practitioner. Now my insurance doesn't cover this, but it's only \$25 a month and she just writes the prescription that I need a psychiatrist for. I am not driving an hour away until Health is hit or miss. Sometimes the pharmacy won't cover telehealth because they aren't local doctors. The NP route are becoming more and more popular. I still have health insurance, but I go to her for the little things. I don't have to wait four days to get in or two weeks, she answers immediately. She helped me a bunch of times. I fell off my bike and cut my leg open and it got infected. I called my doctors for my insurance, they called back 10 days later. I had already called the NP that I pay \$25 a month for and she had an antibiotic and some cream at the pharmacy within 10 minutes of me texting her, I included pictures. So you may want to look in your area and see if any NP's are doing this. My friend that's an NP, she has different levels or different packages I guess and the cheapest one is \$25, which is the one I have and I can text her or call her anytime The plans go all the way up till like \$400 a month and that gets you in person home visits anytime you want them. These are becoming very popular. I call it concierge NP's because that's kind of what it is. We have two around here and I know both of them. I use the one that I do because I'm also her dog sitter. She just wanted me to prove that I had been on this medication for at least two years and she looked through my pharmacy records and seen that I was. Then she had no problems prescribing it. Then this advice is for everyone out there. Even if you have health insurance and it may be a shitty plan, these are popping up all over. She can write lab orders, imaging orders, she can write anything a doctor does. I don't know if my insurance would cover it, but I do know they cover the prescriptions that she writes. I do all my imaging and lab works through my insurance because I'm going to guess it wouldn't cover it because she's not in network. But signing up for something like this gives you a back up and it's coming very handy for me and it's very affordable at \$25 a month. That's cheaper than going to an urgent care."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omuregf/

"Just don't know what to do. Hey all. My husband and I are both self-employed. Currently, I'm still under 26 and on my parents' plan, though not for much longer. My husband is currently uninsured. We don't qualify for any subsidies, as our income is just over the 400% FPL limit. Despite this, we still live paycheck to paycheck as is, due to living in a high-cost of living area. Packing up and moving isn't really an option, as both of our businesses are based here. We simply can't afford to fork over hundreds to thousands of dollars each month for an ACA compliant plan. I've considered non-ACA, but everyone on this sub seems to think it's a terrible idea and they won't cover anything. At this point I'm just at a loss and don't know what to do. I worry about my husband being uninsured, and I'm considering giving up my business and getting a job that can provide us with insurance, though I really don't want to. Any advice is appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wfnwua/just_dont_know_what_to_do/

↳ Poop_Dolla (15): "Do you have an accountant? Are you certain you're taking advantage of all your write offs for your business? In my opinion you have two options if you want a marketplace ACA plan, you can attempt to get your gross income under the threshold by contributing to retirement plans and making sure your deductions are all accounted for, or you can make more to cover the cost of an unsubsidized plan."

↳ katsrad (11): "Non-ACA isn't recommended if you have any pre-existing condition because you can be denied or they are just indemnity plans that pay a small set amount that won't cover the cost of the service. My advice is to look for employment that provides health insurance as a benefit."

↳ saysee23 (8): "Lots of people get jobs to provide insurance, maybe part time at Starbucks so you would not have to give up your business. Non-ACA isn't worth most of the time unless you really like to gamble with your family's health. You said you two "still" live paycheck to paycheck - the part-time or totally different job might help with this. it's never too often to reevaluate your budgets. The other comment about the CPA is a very good idea."

"Trust your insurer even less than ACA. They don't know shit. I've had pre-authorization for a medicine for years. Last December I go to fill it and it's like \$175 and I had already met my deductible and out-of-pocket maximum in January. I hadn't paid anything for it since January 2025. I call my insurance company, and I get an agent telling me it's a new law that Congress passed, and I called her out immediately because I follow politics closely, so I asked her to tell me what the law was, the new long she kept telling me I was incompetent. Even though she couldn't tell me the law of Congress had passed she just kept repeating it passed one. I don't usually do this, but I asked for her superior. She flat out told me that no, this is not a new congressional law, although it is a congressional law, but it was passed in 2022. I knew I was right. They had given me prior authorization for years, but only because the namebrand was cheaper than the generic. Then the generic lowered their price so low that they stopped covering the namebrand. I tried the generic and it was ineffective, and I had my first asthma attack in decades. I'm not trying to be picky, all my other meds are generics and it all is fine but this particular one, it just did not work for me. It's a maintenance asthma inhaler. So I have this prior authorization and it is useless. The pharmacy is even baffled by it. It's a DAR law, dispense as written. Well, of course it's going to be dispensed as written because I have a prior authorization. If I want that medicine, I have to pay \$175 for it, every month. So now I am on a different one and I will be going on blood pressure meds soon because it raises my blood pressure. I don't have high blood pressure, I never have until I started this medicine. It is effective, but I have to go on another medicine but it's a cheap one. They don't care about my health, they just care about the cost. I hate insurance. It is sorely needed. I had it almost all of my life and then we decided to move to Florida. I retired from my cushy corporate job, but I lost my insurance and I didn't have it for years. So I know what it's like to go without it and even though it's a pain in the ass, I would rather have it than not And I am hoping that nothing comes up for you in the next 10 days or so. My other message was a bit snarky and I apologize. I hate dealing with anything health insurance wise, no matter who I'm dealing with. They make it so much harder than it actually is"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1st004d/aca_canceled_my_policy_without_my_permission_and/ohpu0tq/

"Is Molli health legit or a scam? I got a message from a Molli representative since I'm self-employed, and they claimed to offer "ACA-compliant" health insurance that's cheaper than the marketplace, so I asked more questions; it sounded like a good deal as I'm starting a small business. However, after a lot of prodding they finally admitted you have to answer a "health questionnaire" and then they can deny coverage based on the results. So my question is basically: 1. Is that even legal, to call it ACA-compliant and then deny coverage? and 2. Are they even a legit company? Sounds sketchy. It's depressing actually; I thought their plan looked a little better than the comparable ACA marketplace plan in my state, but now I feel like I just avoided a scam. Thoughts? Am I missing something? Update: filed some reports with relevant regulatory agencies to make them stop this deceptive marketing. What assholes."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1owbjbe/>

↳ (0): "ACA compliant plans cannot deny you coverage based on answers to a health questionnaire. ACA compliant plans available for purchase by individuals will have a medal name (Bronze, Silver, Gold, Platinum) as part of the plan name or will have the word "Catastrophic" as part of the plan name"

↳ (0): "I never said anything about the church group ministry plans. they aren't even insurance-you have to sign 2 waivers. They can pay claims or not pay them. Maybe do a little research on private plans that have been around for years. I feel bad for the people who have to be on the ACA plans. Some people premiums have doubled or tripled and they have no other choice but the ACA. It's the people who are sick with pre-existing conditions. I help those people on those plans and make sure their doctors are in network and their prescriptions are on the formulary. So maybe do a little homework....."

↳ (0): "make sure if you have any children that their pediatrician takes the ACA plan."

"W/O insurance My husband works in construction and recently got denied insurance. This really has screwed us because we cannot afford health insurance through marketplace. I'm more concerned because now it means my 1.5 yr old is uninsured. The insurance company denied him for "occupation including flooring", word for word. I think that's a bunch of BS?! All of his coworkers have gotten covered through the same company and do the exact same thing. He tried appealing it and they denied that too. Any advice? We are in Ohio."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmejge/wo_insurance/

↳ LacyLove (39): "So he tried to get a non ACA compliant plan, they do not have the same rules and can pick and chose who they insure. It doesn't matter if they approved his coworkers."

↳ InfluenceWeak (36): "He should really look for a union construction job that offers insurance."

↳ rosebudny (26): "Honestly it is probably crap insurance that won't cover any preexisting conditions."

"My insurance company just backed out of covering for my surgery after saying they would do it. They also denied my medication because it was too expensive which led me down the path to surgery. I think I am going to go without health insurance. Scary thinking about it but I'm paying out of pocket anyway."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=UgzHnnToziDw_tFG5Yt4AaABAq

Paying cash instead of using the plan · 23 documents · 20 voices

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

↳ (0): "Man, it's a big risk, and if you lose the bet, you're well and truly bad off. One chronic illness, cancer, pregnancy, broken bone, torn ligament and you are SOL. Sure, you can be seen for emergency care under EMTALA, but they don't have to give you chemo or surgery or insulin once you're past the emergency part. 25 is typically young and healthy, but it isn't a guarantee. Best of luck to you."

↳ (0): "My MS first happened at 25, but bc I didn't have insurance until 29 to get diagnosed I have permanent damage and now disabled and unable to work."

↳ (0): "I don't want to upvote this, because it is terrible that you had to go through that, but I'll upvote anyway because it is a perfect example of how things can turn quickly."

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😊 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>

↳ (0): "We're in a similar situation. We pay over 20,000 a year for a high deductible plan on my husband's policy. We've explored alternatives, including purchasing coverage for me through the Marketplace; but our most "affordable" option is to stay on his plan because it is based on pre-taxed income. We've also tried the pay out of pocket approach, and I had a minor health emergency, which cost several thousand. We decided that going uninsured with little children is too risky."

↳ (0): "... I'm trying very hard not to erupt. 20k. I assume that your husband's plan is an employer plan based on how you framed this. So they are also paying thousands. I guess maybe it is reasonable if you have 50 kids. You do have 50 kids don't you? My ACA which is a decent hmo is \$6k a year for just me. Deductible is 12k and I can reasonably expect to hit it every year. After MUCH consternation they couldn't find a way to avoid paying for an rx for me that runs about 90k a year. I was on it with great results keeping me out of the hospital (mostly) for a year. Then they decided they approved it by mistake and canceled the approval. I got really sick after that and wound up hospitalized repeatedly which they paid tens of thousands for. So that was dumb. My dr did not like seeing me hospitalized repeatedly just to prove to insurance I'm sick so he started giving me pharma samples. We did that for 6 months. So 45k of shots. Eventually the rep said they couldn't keep doing it, which was my greatest fear. I knew it would happen I just didn't know when. It took another few months to get approved for the pharma's 'charity' program. So now they give me the drug for free. I live in constant fear of losing access. There is something very strange that I experienced when they first yanked the approvals where I knew I was going to get very sick and there was not much I could do because the drug was out of reach. I was literally planning to be much sicker. Family wants to see me for Tday and I'm like, well I'm probably going to be a whole lot sicker then, probably not doable to get on a plane. I don't spend much time feeling sorry for myself but I ABSOLUTELY think about a parent that has a child that needs a drug they simply can't afford, and so instead having to watch them struggle. The drug exists. We paid to develop it with tax dollars. We sell it abroad at a competitive price. But it's too expensive for a child in the US to benefit. This disgusts me. At some point, we will decide we have had enough of this system. But I wish we were a lot closer to that point than I think we are."

↳ (0): "1700/month here...basically same exact situation you are in. My wife is just like your husband. My employer pays for employee 100%, as soon as I add my family, wife, 2 kids....1700/month...vision, dental,

included. Eastern PA. I've been fighting this for over 10 years with my employer. I love my job, but each year with this nonsense, it gets harder and harder to argue it's worth staying. My mortgage is 1300/month. Good luck, as all I have ever been told is get a new job."

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



— r/HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q4ew3x/>

↳ (0): "Republicans could not care less if people are uninsured and it actually seems like they enjoy kicking people off insurance, hurting poor people, and punching down while they laugh. And they proclaim to be Christian. Jesus would be disgusted with them!"

↳ (0): "But you don't know what you're going to make in 2026. Estimate your income above the poverty level and get coverage."

↳ (0): "Be prepared to owe if you end up making more than you estimate. This happened to me. Not fun."

"The key to avoiding high healthcare costs is to be healthy. I've been self-employed for over 16 years and have the ACA since it came out. I pick the cheapest plan which gives my coverage in case of an emergency and all my wellness care. I pay \$131 per month for a bronze plan. I have paid up to \$270 per month in past higher earning years. I pay out of pocket for things not covered if I need them and get a 45% self pay discount. I don't pay a lot for healthcare per year and focus on being active and eating healthy non processed foods. I pay less on medical costs than many pay for insurance alone per year. This has been my way to not fund a ridiculously priced industry. I'm nearing 59. Protect your health at all costs!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxcstwbmYAJgMrsGvh4AaABAg>

↳ @sct4040 (12): "Accidents happen too."

↳ @vogeljennifer6318 (8): "Although this is a great mindset, some people don't have the ability to undo medical issues that require care"

↳ @kona6451 (0): "How old are you? That sounds really cheap"

"I've just realized that my Ambetter ACA plan is dogsh1t First I see a primary care physician who doesn't want to continue to prescribe the maintenance sleep Rx that I have been on for over 30 years, telling me that I should see a psychiatrist. So I call up Ambetter saying this, but what do you know, there are only 3 psychiatrists in the plan, and none of them want to deal with anyone having insomnia issues. I have put in an escalation with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) to allow me to get another plan (Blue Cross), which although it is \$300/m more, has my current primary-care physician in network. I have escalated wthis with Ambetter, and they are "working on it:, although they have not found a psychiatrist that will work out. I will be seeing my old doc as self-pay (\$130), also getting the Rx on my own. What the h3ll am I paying the \$80/mo for my plan for such garbage. And the ironic thing is that when I was on Medicaid, my primary-care physician was in network (I still had to pay for my Rx, since Medicaid doesn't pay for that Rx either)."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/

↳ FoxontheRun2023 (43): "You really shouldn't complain about \$80. Try paying \$850/mo for a dogshat plan."

↳ False-Can-6608 (17): "I thought the same. I feel for you, I'm over here ticked about paying \$427 a month. It is Ambetter. And I like it. Had cancer treatment in '24 and '25. No complaints. It was \$220 a month before we lost the subsidies."

↳ Sarduci (11): "\$80 a month for a plan is cheap. I was paying \$1400 a month for a \$13k deductible for 5 people. I would LOVE to have been paying only \$400 a month."

"Something is irreparably broken with the way things are right now. No way should my healthy, middle-class family of 5 be expected to pay \$3,000+/month for a high-deductible insurance plan with pitiful coverage that's not accepted by most quality providers. Even if the subsidies are extended, I still have a huge issue with government tax dollars being funneled to health insurance companies to pay for these ridiculously high premiums. We've had to switch to cash pay with no insurance in the past, and cash-pay prices are reasonable, especially as compared to what's billed to insurers."

— r/obamacare · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nmkopxl/

"Paxlovid \$1600? Anthem ACA in Indiana is pretty terrible -- the cheap "negotiated rate" for 5 days of the anti-COVID medication paxlovid is nearly \$1600. I'm skipping it since I can't afford it even with the \$1000 one-time use coupon from Pfizer. The whole year has been basically Anthem denying all my medications or offering a price that's way higher than those weird "discount cards" like GoodRx. Pretty terrible. Anyone else angry yet are ready for actual universal health care? I retired early and this is literally the only insurance plan available to me in my state. These insurance company scammers and big pharma scammers need to be fixed. Things are getting unsustainable. I understand that there's an active movement to dismantle and destroy ACA without any replacement, so that's part of the problem, but really we need actual universal healthcare and to tear down the existing scam organizations."

— r/HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj8crd/paxlovid_1600/

↳ Bogg99 (20): "The same drug manufacturers sell these drugs in other countries for significantly less money. There was a piece of legislation that would cap drugs developed in the US for being sold here for more money than other countries. It would have single handedly saved Medicaid/Medicare billions of dollars. Republicans voted against it."

↳ Turbulent-Pay1150 (18): "No anger with the drug manufacturer who set the price?"

↳ The_Derpy_Walrus (15): "Health history plays no role in ACA insurance plans."

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

↳ (0): "In short, yes, a provider can always run your information through a carrier website and see if you have insurance or not. Ask for the cash price- say you want to pay cash and not go through insurance."

↳ (0): "They said if I have coverage of any kind (that they don't take of course), then I don't have the option to pay anything but the full cost of the visit :/ I've heard some doctors are more lenient on this than others, which makes me think I should just look for a new doctor. But that feels like a whole other can of worms right now and just kind of overwhelming tbh"

↳ (0): "I mean, OP can ask, but many behavioral health providers don't maintain separate cash-price vs. insurance-price fee schedules. They tend to be more transparent and open about their fees in general, meaning their published fee is the same regardless of payer (although may vary as a function of sliding scales or "scholarships")."

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1lwkch/>

↳ (0): "It's a class H felony in NC for a provider that accepts medicaid (opted in) to take out of pocket payment for services that would be covered under medicaid. Say you went to a dentist that accepted it, they can only bill you for procedures not covered under medicaid like a crown. They wouldn't be able to bill you for services that are covered under medicaid like a cavity filing. If they never opted in to accept medicaid, then it is not fraud. They never agreed to medicaid terms and conditions at all. If you are concerned, before you do anything, you can always call NCDOL or medicaid and make sure you are okay."

↳ (0): "Yes, it can be. Medicaid is for people who cannot pay their own medical expenses. If you show that you have means to pay for your own medical expenses, the state will assume you do not need Medicaid and have been fraudulently receiving benefits. In my state (MD), there are some Medicaid MCOs that do not require referrals from your PCP to receive specialty care. If you are healthy enough to not need to be followed by a PCP, then it matters a lot less if you cannot find one."

↳ (0): "And provider (practitioner/facility) that is contracted with Medicaid must sign a participation agreement that includes the following: In accordance with 10A NCAC 22J .0106 Providers may bill a patient accepted as a Medicaid patient only in the following situations: For allowable deductibles, co-insurance, or co-payments; Before the service is provided the provider has informed the patient that the patient may be billed for a service that is not one covered by Medicaid regardless of the type of provider or is beyond the limits on Medicaid services; The patient is 65 years of age or older and is enrolled in the Medicare program at the time services are received but has failed to supply a Medicare number as proof of coverage; or The patient is no longer eligible for Medicaid as defined in 10A NCAC 21B."

"I did not have health insurance until I was thirty five. I used Planned Parenthood for women's health, walk in clinics (cash pay) in the rare event I got sick, and paid cash for dental cleanings and exams (no cavities). When I decided to start a family, I got health insurance."

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgxYkKzxxCIWdiWSr554AaABAg>

↳ @bradleyonabudget (10): "Oh wow, you really managed to make it work! There's resources out there. Good call once you started a family :)"

"How many Americans are on PPO health insurance that covers seeing specialists/doctors across state lines compared to being on insurance that only covers within the state? I'm on Medicaid in Rhode Island for disability and it's frustrating dealing with out of state approvals. Any advice welcomed. I've had long-term neurological issues like neuropathy, muscle pain, and memory issues for nearly 6 years that neurologists in my state (and in Connecticut) haven't been able to definitively diagnose. I am on SSI for disability, which means I get Neighborhood Health Plan of Rhode Island as my primary insurance, with Medicaid as the secondary. I was told by a neurologist I saw across the border in Connecticut recently (Some doctors in CT take my insurance it seems) that being seen at a bigger hospital like Mass General may lead to a definitive diagnosis. From what I was told by his office after they tried referring me to the hospital, Mass General/MGH is no longer accepting my insurance even with prior authorization, when a few years ago i was told by Mass General they were taking my insurance with those stipulations. I was told by MGH's neurology department staff (who were very nice and compassionate about my situation, to be fair to them) that it's possible the hospital chose not to contract with my insurance this year, hence the change, and that because I am on Medicaid, I couldn't even choose to self-pay to go there. They said it's possible in the future the contractual issue could change, and they also told me to try contacting Neighborhood Health myself and explain the situation and see if they could somehow get me approved to be seen at Mass General. I will be calling them this upcoming week. I was curious as to how often Americans are on health insurance plans that cover seeing specialists across state lines, how difficult it is for them to be approved to see specialists in different states, etc. I find it frustrating that my insurance doesn't work across state lines considering this is the smallest state in the country. Not every specialist is going to be here. Logistically it seems to make sense to me that CT/MA should have a deal with RI insurance to cover people if they at least get prior authorization/approval. As of right now Mass General wouldn't take me no matter what, which I find very concerning and depressing. I have had multiple neurologists say I should be seen in a place like Boston to possibly get a definitive diagnosis, why is that not enough to be seen there? That makes no sense to me."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uheytb/how_many_americans_are_on_ppo_health_insurance/

↳ Good_Educator4872 (3): "Originally they wanted to control what plans you could buy. Govt plans always limited coverage to care within the relevant political entity. No one ever accused the designers of Obamacare of being forward thinking. It was about control. The original thinking was to use the British NHS as a model. There were problems with this. We are different than EUROPEAN COUNTRIES. We have the most extensive checks and balances balance system. The states are sovereign political entities. European states have always been organized from the top down. The US. is the inverse. Our constitution is a mutual agreement among sovereign states to cede certain powers to the Federal government. This limits the federal governments ability to dictate internal state action except in delineated areas. Generally, the Fed can only exert oversight in areas the state is not currently regulating. The Federal government doesn't regulate insurance policies unless the state agrees. Insurance is the purview of the states as an example not the Federal Government"

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes. And I had a policy in RI from the market place there (recently moved out of state). It was a BCBS PPO, the lowest level with an HSA. It has a national provider network and allows for seeing doctors, specialists, labs,etc anywhere in the country. I never had even a single issue and I've got doctors in multiple states (though not in RI because well...)."

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes! It's weird because it's almost impossible to get a doctor or most specialists in RI but we have one of the very best marketplaces. But it's only the BCBS PPO with the national provider network so look for one of theirs."

"Accidentally went to OON primary care doctor and stuck with a huge bill TL;DR: Scheduled a primary care visit for an interim med refill, ended up with a \$662 bill because my specific plan isn't in-network for primary care. Billing refuses to adjust beyond \$50, won't let me pay cash rate, and I don't qualify for financial aid. MyChart currently shows the estimated cash-pay is \$303. Looking for any realistic options to dispute or reduce this. I'm in WA state and could really use advice on whether I have any remaining options here. Last fall, I scheduled a primary care visit with a clinic that's part of a large hospital system. Before booking, I checked their website and saw that my Marketplace insurance (Ambetter) was listed as in-network. I admittedly did not call my insurance to verify the specifics of my individual plan — I understand that's ultimately my responsibility. That said, I was in the middle of a very busy week and relied on the website information in good faith when scheduling. The visit was very straightforward: an interim refill of my long-standing ADHD medication, which I've been stable on for years. The new doctor reviewed the records that my psychiatrist had already released, confirming my stable medication history. I was temporarily on an Ambetter plan and my regular psychiatrist wasn't in-network at the time, so this was just to avoid a gap in treatment. The doctor asked for a urine drug screen, which I hadn't anticipated. My psychiatrist has never required one, and the year before, a similar interim refill at the same clinic didn't include it. I also wasn't told beforehand that it would incur a separate out-of-pocket charge or how much it would cost. A month later, I received a bill for \$662. Only then did I learn that while the hospital system lists Ambetter as in-network, my specific Ambetter plan is only considered in-network for specialist visits — not for primary care. So the visit processed as out-of-network. I requested a billing review and, after multiple calls, was reluctantly offered a \$50 adjustment. I don't qualify for financial assistance, and they wouldn't let me pay the cash-pay rate because I was technically insured at the time of service. When I explained my situation and financial stress, they were dismissive and said the only option is a payment plan—and they won't place my account on hold while I figure out next steps. What's especially frustrating is that their MyChart currently lists the estimated cash-pay cost for CPT 99204 plus the urine test as $\$233 + \$70 = \$303$. Even after the \$50 adjustment, I'm being charged more than double that. I fully understand I'm responsible for checking network status, and I'm not trying to avoid paying something. But it's hard to reconcile being charged such a ridiculous amount for what was essentially a simple refill appointment. At this point I'm trying to understand whether I have any realistic options left, or if this is just one of those expensive lessons."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1rcdnxm/>

↳ (0): "IMO, the \$50 credit was a win. I've seen many instances where providers/facilities don't even do that. Outside of possibly negotiating a prompt pay discount, I'm not sure that you have any other options. And since they've written off the \$50, that may not even be an option."

↳ (0): "It doesn't help you now and I'm not sure if Ambetter has this option, but for future reference, some insurance companies (Oscar) have the option to fill a gap prescription and/or virtually see a PCP that can write one. And as you've learned, always check if your specific plan is covered and In Network. I think that most people don't get that offices don't universally accept every plan from a company."

↳ (0): "Controlled substances for ADHD are almost always excluded from services like that."

"Imperial problems and ACA So my dermatologist has been unable to communicate with my ACA insurance (Imperial) to get the necessary approval to biopsy some spots. The doctor's office basically came back to me saying they have done all they can do and are giving up and i was "welcome to self pay". I have called imperial to get answers to other questions and have gotten false information or "We don't know and we don't have a department either we or you can talk to to find out". I requested a manager callback and received none. Any suggestions on how to deal with this? Is there some kind of oversight organization or patient advocate organization I can go to to complain? Is there a path to being able to switch insurance via marketplace mid year? I tried calling the marketplace today, but they are closed for the holiday....I intend to follow up there but wanted to also cast a net here in case people have info that can help. Thank you in advance!"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tnbh0m/imperial_problems_and_a_ca/

↳ RoundChampionship840 (8): "Report this to your state insurance commissioner"

↳ branchymolecule (4): "I don't think it works that way anymore. Beware of cancelling your coverage."

↳ StephenDolo (3): "You can apply for Medicaid and get quickly denied/ and that will trigger a Special enrollment period, where you can switch plans middle of the year. Google ACA SEP, there are many different life events that can trigger a SEP where you can switch plans."

"Cobra Lapsed.... STRESSED.... Long story short, I had a choice last November between relocating or severance package and chose the severance package that came with Cobra coverage. The company sponsored coverage ended on 5/31 and if I continue to self pay I would have coverage til May 27 next year. TLDR I was abroad in June and didn't pay my first month of self payment in time. Upon return, I saw a letter stating that the grace period for each coverage period is the end of that respective month. For example, July's grace period ends tomorrow, July 31, 2026, and August's ends on August 31, 2026. I reached out immediately, assuming I could still activate the account since I was within the July grace period. But of course that's when I learned how this all worked, huge mistake on my part and I am so mad at myself. I am currently in appeal process, on the second appeal now where they're now needing approval from my company to reinstate the account. The team at health equity said usually they are able to reinstate the account through second appeal based on what they have seen? (I talked to 3 different phone representatives) I talked to the benefit team at my former employer and they seem to be willing to help but did ask why the payment lapsed. I explained my situation. How likely is my account able to be reinstated? There are some benefits I'd really like to utilize from my former plan and I know I really fucked up and slipped up. Huge life lesson here.... Any advise or folks with experience on this would be appreciated :(Stressed out. I did reach out to marketplace to get an application in place just in case the appeal is denied, but I am really hoping for the best."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vbdehm/>

↳ (0): "I cannot speak to the likelihood of reinstatement, but can speak to the timeline you're working against for Marketplace. You have 60 days from when your COBRA subsidy expired to choose a policy. You're running on borrowed time, since it's essentially day 60. What state are you in? Have you found new employment? Are you married? Trying to get more information to see if Medicaid is at all an option, since that program is always enrolling new members so long as they meet eligibility criteria."

↳ (0): "the insurance broker I worked with said if application is in before day 60 they will still honor it thankfully. yes another life lesson here for sure. smh on my part sigh"

↳ (0): "Update on this: Luckily I got off exchange Blue shield silver insurance in time within the 60 days deadline (cheaper than the covered California silver loaded version) Now just crossing my fingers that the appeal with Cobra / My former employer goes through so my cobra account can be reinstated. But in the mean time I am covered if all else fails. Still hoping for the best....!"

"I've been trying to tell people this for months now. It doesn't matter if they extend them. Insurance companies are greedy and will continue to increase premiums. And then claim healthcare costs are going up. Maybe so. But it really comes down to your stock holders. That's what they care about. This doesn't affect me as I don't have insurance and haven't for about 15 years I think it's all a scam. When I did have it I paid 4k for my premium and it didn't cover anything. I always was still forking more money over. My thyroid panel cost me 400\$. I can self pay and it's a little over 100\$. Went to ER and it was 1200. Cash pay is way cheaper. Insurance just helps make the CEO and their stakeholders more money."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oh07yi/people_in_here_should_be_aware_that_market_rates/nlmp29/

"Broken leg might be okay with cash pay but cancer would surely be financially devastating. I was hoping catastrophic insurance changes would help. As of today, all people (not just those <30 years old) who don't qualify for subsidies are eligible for catastrophic coverage. I woke up early to look at what premiums would be for ACA catastrophic coverage only - \$2100/month for my family with a \$21,500 deductible 😞 Luckily, I have employer-sponsored health insurance through my employer right now but the job is very unstable. My husband and I decided today that our family will have to go without health insurance again if I lose my job. We had to go without health insurance for many years before I got this job because ACA premiums were too high - and they're now about 2x as high than the last time I checked our ACA options. We know our providers offer reasonable cash prices and I've discovered a whole network of cash-pay services, labs, and imaging facilities. There's even a hospital that only offers surgery for cash-pay (<https://surgerycenterok.com>) that's within driving distance and could affordably repair broken bones, etc. But cancer or a catastrophic event would bankrupt us."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nml2egf/

"I don't think I understand. If the generic dropped their prices very low, why don't you just buy the generic out of pocket? If the insurance covered the brand name but doesn't now, do they cover the generic? I don't understand prescription coverage. I have a bronze plan with no prescription coverage, or very little. I'm honestly not sure because I don't use it. I just use GoodRx. Have you check Good Rx and Mark Cuban's plan for the generic drug you need? Some of my generics are under \$12 for a three-month supply."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omvf7n1/

"I should first say that I can arrange my affairs to qualify for Medicaid or the ACA (it just depends on how much capital-gains I take vs. Roth distributions). I used to be on Medicaid, but with the upcoming change to Medicaid requiring work requirements (I consider myself fully retired), I wanted to get into an ACA plan (at the bare minimum 138% of poverty income rate); there was also some screwing things with Medicaid such as me not being able to get the plan to do mail-order Rx filling (an important thing since I travel a lot), to say nothing of getting my sleep Rx covered properly (I could get my Medicaid PCP to write the script, but I would have it filled at Health Warehouse), so presuming I could have gotten a proper PCP in the new ACA plan, I would be saving money on Rx. But since I can't get a proper PCP from the ACA plan - nor a psychiatrist that my PCP told me I had to see - I'm stuck going back to my old PCP as a self-pay patient, and getting the sleep Rx from the old mail-order place. And of course, I'm paying \$80/mo for the privilege of this rotten service. That said, I was able to get my annual blood test, and I will getting a feces test for colon cancer, from the new ACA plan (I would have gotten it no matter what plan I would be on). Yes, my new PCP sucks, and I have fired him (I told him that I don't trust him with my health management); I guess I could looks for another one, even a nurse-practioner, but how do you find one that will do the job. Do I say, "Hi, I am a subscriber with the AmWorse Premier plan, and I am looking for a PCP; one of the requirements I have for my PCP is that I get my 10mg Zolpidem Rx - that I have had for 30 years or so, and that I could prove for the last 12 years from my old PCP - which I consider an essential part of my health maintenance. If you run your practice such that you can't do this, then I cannot give you my business"."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omz7nsn/

"I havent had insurance in years. Been blessed to not need anything major. I got quotes for health insurance and when I added how much it costs yearly my self pay doctor's appts were a quarter of the price. So I just get a quote every year and put that monthly amount into a savings instead of insurance company."

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgzA4bLnZOHz7gYNR0F4AaABAg>

"On an non ACA insurance plan and I'm pregnant Located in California. I'm the sole breadwinner (29) for my family. (28) (4) (2). I make too much for any kind of covered California or subsidized plan (gross \$144k). Currently, my family of 4 is on a non ACA plan where pregnancy is completely not covered. I just found out I'm pregnant. Luckily, we are planning to pay out of pocket for a midwife who gets good cash rates for scans and tests. However, in case something goes wrong and I have an emergency or have to deliver at a hospital, I need a better plan. My midwife suggested a PPO. Guys what am I doing? I'm looking at minimum coverage, right? I can't get my own individual insurance and leave my family on the current plan, can I? This is all another language to me, and I don't know what I'm doing or how to navigate this, I just know I need to cover my bases in case something catastrophic or unplanned happens."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgjb6o/on_an_non_aca_insurance_plan_and_im_pregnant/

↳ throwfarfaraway1818 (26): "When are you due? If its in the new year, you can sign up during open enrollment without any issues. If its before the end of the year, your options are more limited."

↳ throwfarfaraway1818 (20): "Sounds perfect. You should be perfectly fine to enroll during open enrollment with a plan that starts Jan 1."

↳ silent752 (16): "Then sign up in November and have plan go into effect January 1st"

Deductibles so high the plan is useless · 15 documents · 15 voices

"Sat through new job orientation in a deep red state and the cognitive dissonance was something else Just started a new job in a red state. Orientation day, 50+ new hires packed into a hall, and eventually we get to the health insurance and benefits section. That's when the room came alive. People complaining left and right about insurance companies ripping them off. My meds aren't covered. My deductible is insane. I can't get the care I actually need. Half the room had a story. And honestly, looking around, a lot of these folks clearly have real health issues and genuinely need coverage that works. Meanwhile HR is up there basically doing damage control, pitching workarounds and cheaper tiers like "this plan gets you more bang for your buck" which is corporate speak for "we know it's bad, here's how to make it slightly less bad." Here's the part that got me. Based on where I am and the conversations around me, most of this room votes red every single time. The same people furious about unaffordable meds and garbage coverage are voting for the party actively working to gut affordable healthcare. They'll rage at the insurance company all day but never connect it to the ballot they cast. Nobody in that room made the connection. Not one person. They see the symptom every day and keep voting for the disease. I just sat there quietly filling out my forms."

— r/obamacare · 325 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v5g93m/sat_through_new_job_orientation_in_a_deep_red/

↳ Consistent_Ad_6400 (76): "Exactly this. I live in a blue state but my town is 90% red. Trump loves the uneducated voter. The BBB had this all in black and white. Come 2027 with the medicaid work requirement....maybe then they will see...but doubtful"

↳ Mistral1111 (59): "An ignorant electorate is their jam"

↳ hikerdaze (36): "I love Obamacare!!! Rump screwed it up a bit this year and I hear it's going to be even worse next year. While my Republican brother was working and had insurance through his employer, he HATED Obamacare and told anyone who'd listen how evil it was. He's currently out of work, but guess what he has now? Um, yeah."

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— r/HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/>

↳ (0): "You can report any insurance carrier operating an aca marketplace plan to your state department of insurance."

↳ (0): "**Nevada Division of Insurance:** Northern NV (775) 687-0700 or Southern NV (702) 486-4009"

↳ (0): "Name and shame. Who is the insurance carrier? What exact plan did you purchase? Any plan documents you can share here to give us something to review and provide direction? Edit: This thread is kind of all over the place, but since this is a higher-level comment: Imperial *is* a legitimate, ACA-qualified carrier and this is a qualified health plan sold through Nevada Health Link, the state's official marketplace. What's more, since Imperial is a very small carrier with a narrow network, OP didn't have a choice and went to an OON emergency room. So it's crystal clear: Imperial hasn't "not paid anything"--they haven't even been billed for anything. The onus is now on OP to submit a super bill / claim directly to Imperial since this is an OON hospital with no mechanism to submit a claim on their behalf. Annoying, no doubt, but is necessary if they want to have any coverage for this encounter."

"We retired early and we took the silver plan from the market place. \$2400 a month and it was useless. The deductible and out of pocket was so high, the insurance never paid for anything. What a scam! It honestly drove me back to work, just for the insurance. I sure wish my husband was willing to live out of country for a time."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxWsbWgrBC4jKr28s54AaABAg>

↳ @ariefraiser140 (11): "If you guys were paying \$2400/month that means you guys had a pretty big AGI."

↳ @michaelcoglianese4292 (7): "@ariefraiser140so what? That's still ridiculously high amount for insurance"

↳ @metalgirl (2): "I agree... our insurance is twice that. Stupid high. So not fair!!!"

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

↳ (0): "In short, yes, a provider can always run your information through a carrier website and see if you have insurance or not. Ask for the cash price- say you want to pay cash and not go through insurance."

↳ (0): "They said if I have coverage of any kind (that they don't take of course), then I don't have the option to pay anything but the full cost of the visit :/ I've heard some doctors are more lenient on this than others, which makes me think I should just look for a new doctor. But that feels like a whole other can of worms right now and just kind of overwhelming tbh"

↳ (0): "I mean, OP can ask, but many behavioral health providers don't maintain separate cash-price vs. insurance-price fee schedules. They tend to be more transparent and open about their fees in general, meaning their published fee is the same regardless of payer (although may vary as a function of sliding scales or "scholarships")."

"and a criminal system when I just noticed my deductibles are set so high. Now I understand every year will be as if I didn't have any healthcare coverage. I only go to the doctor yearly for minor things. Therefore, I'll be paying for my bills out of pocket. Then January 1st will be reset again. Also, the coinsurance and copays % may never kick in either yearly until something catastrophic happens (may God forbid)..... That's a crime for us to pay monthly for years after years to only have coverage for something extraordinary that may never happen and we don't want it to happen either. My deductible is 7,000. I never exceed it yearly."

— YouTube · How Health Insurance Works | What is a Deductible? Coinsurance? Copay? Premium? · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xs7MNNqdN-o&lc=Ugwdfdod3L_uT_Flam14AaABA9.9wIRtKMZUOe9wnQRsGBzPy

"I can afford health insurance but I can't afford to use it."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p6p4cm/why_health_savings_accounts_arent_the_fix/nqslloe/

"I got a 13 cent raise that puts me \$100 above the income qualifier for Medicaid. I applied for ACA- the cheapest plan is \$600 a month, and the deductible is insane. There is no budgeting for this. I'm not buying "fun" things and choosing to just not save my money. I cannot afford \$600 a month for health insurance period. I don't have streaming services. I only eat at home. I don't buy luxury items of any kind. I have no spare income every month. Your solution is not a solution whatsoever. It's you assuming that poor people are just lying about what they can afford, and are spending money on things other than bills. It's insulting, and, frankly, demeaning."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mmpvpr/why_young_americans_dread_turning_26_health/n85eeqo/

"I commend this nyt reporter for actually providing information instead of the usual nyt anti Trump anti Republican spin. I will say that I'm a bit suspicious of her numbers, but let's assume they are correct. If I recall correctly, one person might have to pay \$36 a month more. That's about \$400 a year. Not crying over that. Nor am I shedding a tear for someone making \$65k a year. It used to be (before society crumbled) that people expected to pay for what they got. They did not expect the government to set up "government run grocery stores", etc. Result: people feel entitled to get free stuff from the government and complain when stuff is not completely free for them. While it's not exactly on point, I used to volunteer to do taxes for people in the hood before I retired. Lots of people refused to sign up cuz they didn't want to pay for healthcare, so I'd try to work it so they didn't pay the penalty. Obamacare is a disaster and since we gave trillions of \$ away during COVID, we now have a crippling debt. Course, our "betters" in DC would rather fight political battles than try to balance the expectations of those wanting Obamacare, our debt crisis, and the disastrous Obamacare system...but such is life in our crumbling society. Course, country boys can survive... even if they live in the burbs or the concrete jungle."

— YouTube · What Happens if Obamacare Subsidies Expire? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=onsEZtGKCA&lc=UgzYOa-U1YcHxy3YsZl4AaABA9>

"@scottunclocked Thanks for the heads up. It might still work out if we use COBRA for the first year or so. I'll have to see what is available to me at the time. Either way the money is budgeted even if we can't use the HSA account so we're in good shape."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgwF47BQPWeD6c5OmKd4AaABA9.AZCdI-sI5j4AZD-9cldV2l

"I feel the same about my plan.. The deductible is so high, etc."

— YouTube · 6 Retirement Health Insurance Options BEFORE Medicare Eligibility Kicks In · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOx1T4WKebc&lc=UgxE946j3efQXHvNdYp4AaABAg.9lXrewQcVLa9oINzv13iHp>

"If you're a woman - do NOT get Ambetter. . I'm self-employed and paying for Ambetter from the marketplace, which is commercial insurance and supposed to be decent for the co-pay about \$400. Everything about this insurance is bad. 1. ZocDoc, the largest online scheduling system for doctors, doesn't even recognise Ambetter in my state and I can't use the convenient website to schedule any of the appointments. I can't overstate how inconvenient that is. 2. Impossible to find providers - the website doesn't update them frequently, you have to call multiple times to find someone who actual is in network. The number of providers is so tiny you have to wait for weeks to get an appointment. 3. Doesn't cover anything! Refused to cover my yearly mammograms (prescribed by my doctor based on my personal medical history!) and covers literary ZERO of anything fertility-related. Not a single fertility test is covered. This insurance is a punishment for women, please stay away. I'm leaving 2 stars because customer service actually was trying to help me and I was able to reach a human being relative easy."

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69039842f7718f8c00735d85>

"I think you live in a state where a high deductible policy wouldn't cost you too much. Health insurance is for accidents and catastrophic illnesses. Growing up my family went through my sister having a childhood illness that destroyed our family financially and when we were finally getting back on our feet my mom wasn't able to work anymore. This is why I had student loan debt which despite a decent job, I finally paid off when my son was in high school. I bought a house before I was 40 but I live in a rural state where this wasn't so difficult to do. I did it all by myself. Then I got cancer. I didn't smoke or drink or tan. It was STUPID. Luckily had health insurance and my work had disability insurance. Then I worked extra jobs to pay for what my insurance didn't cover. It took years to pay off my cancer debt. Now I'm old, downsized, luckily I know how to live on a part time income. I wish you luck. Consider health insurance and so happy to see you utilizing free/low cost testing services."

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgxzS5bUSnnrHtvi2N94AaABAg>

"@f1zzg1g_47 Im so sorry about what happened to you. I hope that person is paying for what he did to you. Of course you have to have medical care. Now my question is this: What can a person like me need to do to also be able to get (afford) medical care? I make \$48,000/ year, I am in my late 50s, I really don't know if I have a health condition or not because I haven't had health insurance since I changed jobs, 10 years ago, my previous job closed and I had to find another one, and this new employer doesn't offer insurance. So I can't afford health insurance, prices are like \$550-\$650++ a month, and the coverages are minimal and the out of pocket are outrageous. I haven't see a doctor nor have a full physical exam since 2014. I am trying to do my best taking care of me, like eating healthy, exercising with youtube videos, managing stress, etc. But, do you think I deserve to have medical care too? I think I do.... but I can't afford it."

— YouTube · TRUTH about the Affordable Care Act · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J0WBbhOzSCY&lc=UgzK9BozG4kXZbaCXId4AaABAg.9uwaC0KJPxUABf6NLMFx7N>

"Our ACA Bronze level coverage will be \$2500 a month with a \$7500 deductible. That is equal to our mortgage. There's no way we can carry this cost every month—we are both self-employed. We will never hit our deductible either so essentially paying \$2500 a month for what?! We are healthy but over 50 so you never know what lingers around the corner. I'm seriously thinking we'll go without and hope for the best. This is absolutely insane to be this old, with a successful career, a decent retirement account and suddenly find ourselves in this position. I can't sleep at night. The stress alone from this is going to send me to the ER. Oh the irony."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o8gdh7/wow_looking_at_my_2026_insurance_its_half_my_rent/njuzl8v/

"I went to the ACA and saw my 2025 plan go up by 490%. So - I had to go from a good silver plan to the bottom of the barrel bronze plan - and face high risks of medical bankruptcy - HUGE deductibles that I would never be able to pay - and even huge Drug cost increases. ALSO - I continually ask my pharmacist for my 1500% cash refund at the Walgreens counter - but he keeps saying he is going to call the Police. What's up with that"

— YouTube · Healthcare premiums to skyrocket Jan. 1 for Obamacare enrollees · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZ_YF6SbtSg&lc=UgxrkgcOMnnev1tVMMR4AaABAq

Resentment over who pays (in both directions) · 10 documents · 10 voices

"I don't have that obamacare , I got mine on the exchange /s"

— r/obamacare · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ofrwc/the_new_aca_rates_will_post_next_saturday_and_all/nlbnrvr/

"I did not buy mine through the ACA. I got mine directly from an insurance carrier. My premium is going up \$500. I had to go with a more affordable and cheaper plan that doesn't cover much of anything. I'm guessing there is a connection as to why these premiums have gone so high related to the ACA credits expiring."

— YouTube · Health insurance premiums set to soar as ACA subsidies expire · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zWP4luZpu4&lc=UgzmaNfyNuF7YKdevv54AaABAq>

↳ @emmacooper3573 (7): "It is, that's why the democrats were trying to keep the government closed because the Obama' affordable care act contract was about to expire and they TRIED to keep this from happening. People were getting upset with the government being closed and food/benefits becoming scarcely low, they were hungry and wanted it opened and THIS is what happened.....let's see what happens to the next government shutdown MAYBE a new revised affordable care act could be written in BUT maybe not, the newly built ballroom need more money?"

↳ @3y4c (0): "Thank the Republicans for this Trump and Kennedy don't want us to have health insurance so they can kiss my ass I hope their family doesn't need a doctor because they will need a referral to get the help they need I know this because I broke my acko and had to wait until I got a referral to get my ankle fixed this is what you get when you put a Republican in office you get fucked"

↳ @metaldreams3595 (0): "@emmacooper3573not bad Emma youre sort of close. Due to COVID the Dems wanted this package passed that simply was not sustainable. They promised the GOP it would be only temporary. Set to expire in 2025, the Dems...the worst money managers in history, went back on their word and didn't want it to expire. Listen that's how they got the GOP to vote for it. That it was temporary. Peoples premiums went back to pre COVID amounts. Were seeing a lot of lying going on but that's how y'all roll."

"I'm tired of my tax dollars being other people's subsidies... Go back to work if you need to. Bring back private insurances. I have always been self employed and bought my insurance without subsidies. Obamacare made it tricky but I got it done."

— YouTube · HOW the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA) CHANGES Early Retirement HEALTH INSURANCE · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6rMBAlebcU&lc=UgwnLfxJKYMUUV9G3gmx4AaABAg>

↳ @40NorthFinances (0): "I hear you. The system is definitely messed up. Sadly, no easy solutions. Thanks for watching."

↳ @savannahsmiles1797 (0): "ACA was a nightmare...as an insurance producer I wanted to personally SLAP Obama for it. Now you have JD, Thiel and Vivek running Chapter Insurance...medicare plans. We need to keep the slimy hands of politicians out of healthcare."

"Comments are so misinformed. Ohhh my lord my tax dollars shouldn't be subsidizing healthcare. You literally just subsidized the largest tax cut in history for the super wealthy and the super wealthy pay most of the taxes in this country We're supposed to be the most developed nation and we have the worst healthcare system in the world . Literally authoritarian governments have better healthcare than us . I'm not even on an ACA plan and my premiums doubled next year while deductibles went up. Healthcare should be a basic human right for everyone the fact we fund the armed services with 1 trillion dollars while bitching about healthcare is insane"

— YouTube · Bay Area man stunned by increase in his health insurance premiums · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vRu7QQVEZLo&lc=UgxDxTU56tZ8jvnfG1R4AaABAg>

"People like this that retire early and get on the ACA subsidies really get underneath my skin. Both of you are not at retirement age so go back to work. Yes, you have enough to live often but you don't in the other way because me as a taxpayer is paying you to take an early retirement and I am tired of it. I'm 46 years old. I've been working for 30 years of my life and I pay \$1400 a month for health insurance. While you guys are setting Home getting it for free out of my tax dollars when I work 55+ hours a week to afford my bills and my health insurance."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=Ugys8cbVY_urJJ4wR014AaABAg

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "I understand it's frustrating to feel like your hard-earned tax dollars are being misused, but the math behind how the ACA works doesn't actually support this. First, the vast majority of federal income taxes go toward programs like Medicare, Medicaid, national defense, and Social Security. ACA marketplace subsidies make up only about 1% to 2% of the total federal budget. Even on a high salary of \$100,000, a taxpayer only contributes about \$130 to \$270 per year total to ACA subsidies—not thousands of dollars. Second, early retirees using the ACA aren't 'getting it for free' on your dime; they paid massive amounts of federal income taxes during their working years to fund the system. Furthermore, to qualify for subsidies, their taxable income (from investments or capital gains) must fall within specific legal limits. They are simply using the law exactly as it was designed for any citizen transitioning between jobs or retiring. The reason your health insurance is \$1,400 a month isn't because of early retirees; it is due to high corporate healthcare costs, administrative overhead, and the fact that you are likely buying a private plan outside the marketplace exchanges without any employer subsidization."

"Don't blame Obama. Blame the GOP for doing everything they could to destroy the program. My Obamacare worked great until Trumps dumb tax cut for billionaires got rid of the individual mandate which resulted in my policy doubling from \$300 to \$600 a month. Not to mention SCOTUS letting states choose to not expand Medicaid. Because of that, people with insurance are paying for people who don't."

— YouTube · 9 Health Insurance Options for Early Retirement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qt0r9YBsUzM&lc=UgxtlEENuZLROaeO5Bp4AaABAg.A440OLpCGVzA449jEeQQoC>

"@donaldspaulding6973 I agree, keep voting republican so we can gut the ACA further. What a crap law it is. Before ACA, my max out of pocket was \$3600, after it's \$13,200. And my deductible tripled. I'm sick of all of you leeches with your hands in my pocket because you made bad life choices."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65: The ACA Reality Nobody Tells You · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Qz8CyPjA5s&lc=UgxPKa3UjMGNe3MFW1V4AaABAg.AZ4owN_J-LiAZPTJ5RhGms

"Yes we didn't know anything about ACA and health insurance for immigrants since I got mine through my job. A friend of mine introduced me the broker and she was very wishy washy, we did get online and try on our own. But the disparity in prices is too much so I had to ask."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pbezr8/need_help_understanding_aca_subsidies/nrqjzwn/

"It's not freeloaders. I work more than full time, and i'm on Obamacare, as well as ten of millions of other Americans."

— YouTube · Obamacare enrollees get first look at 2026 prices as premiums soar · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2Aznbv0Pnoc&lc=UgyPoO8S59_VKbD1Kwx4AaABAg.AOs_zk8CR-vAOsjM99BQF1

"It's affordable because I have to subsidize other people. WTF."

— YouTube · Obamacare enrollees get first look at 2026 prices as premiums soar · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2Aznbv0Pnoc&lc=UgznUIYHUgFJtYaROMJ4AaABAg>

The marketplace itself: website, verification, hold times · 8 documents · 8 voices

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come of it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hsvb50/>

↳ (0): "This is a blunder by your former employer if they failed to notify your COBRA administrator. First step is to contact your former employer and get some answers and see what their solution is. Notice should have been sent to you for any changes to your coverage. Something else to consider: since you're in the new year (and I'm assuming your deductible resets on a calendar year basis), you may consider subsidized coverage through your state's ACA marketplace, or even Medicaid if you're eligible. Not enough info shared in your OP to make that determination, but it may help save some coin while you're still (again, assuming here) unemployed."

↳ (0): "I believe this would be on the COBRA vendor. Your prior employer pays the cobra vendor to send out policy documents. I'm sure there is a way for the cobra vendor to alert the ex-employer and they get the policy reinstated, especially since you're paid to date."

↳ (0): "Contact your former employer, bc they made a mistake in not communicating the proper info to the COBRA administrator. They should be able to fix this quickly, and your enrollment in the new policy should be retrospective to Jan 1. Keep your appointments. The worst case scenario is that you pay for the first PT session out of pocket and then submit the superbill to the new insurer and they will reimburse you. It usually takes 4-6 weeks for the claim to be evaluated and a check to be cut."

"Billed \$1600 so far for free preventative colonoscopy I'm 52 years old and never had a colonoscopy so I thought I would take advantage of the \$0 out of pocket preventative colon cancer screening through my ACA health plan. I had the colonoscopy last month and a couple days ago I got an email from the hospital saying that I have a bill. It's \$1600 for the colonoscopy. I went to reddit of course and saw that reddit seems to agree that it should have been free. No polyps were found. I spent hours on the phone yesterday with the hospital and the insurance company. The lady at the hospital told me that I was mistaken about preventative care being free. She said that there are thousands of different plans and each plan does it differently. She said they submitted my claim and the insurance paid for part of it and that I am responsible for the other \$1600. After talking to her for a while I wasn't getting anywhere so we agreed to disagree and I called the insurance company. The insurance rep spoke English as a second language and didn't seem to understand the point I was making. She told me how much the total was, how much insurance had paid, and how much I was responsible for. When I said things like "I think there is a mistake, this should be free of charge since it was preventative" she simply repeated the totals as if she didn't understand. She was supposed to call me back at 2pm today and never called. I guess I will be spending tomorrow on the phone again trying to get the \$1600 taken off my bill. Nobody I have talked to so far is aware of the ACA policy that preventative care is covered in full. They seem to think that I am just saying that to get out of paying my bill. Any advice for what I can say tomorrow. Edit: OK, I just got off the phone with the United Healthcare rep. She said that there was no mistake. She said I had 2 procedures done and only one was preventative. I asked her for the diagnostic codes for the procedures and she only gave me one code G0121. She seemed like she wanted to get me off the phone so I didn't argue. She apologized several times and said there was no mistake, I have to pay the \$1600. I had a referral for "Screening for colon cancer Z12.11" and have no knowledge of any second procedure. EDIT 2 OK I got some more info today. I confirmed that my plan offers the colon cancer screening at 0% copay and no deductible. The insurance says that I got the colon cancer screening paid for (they paid \$150). But I was charged \$1600 for an endoscopy that was not preventative care. All the CPT codes are missing for the non-preventative endoscopy. Here it is called a HC colonoscopy. The person I talked to said that my primary code was Z12.11 and my secondary code was K57.30 <https://preview.redd.it/3qbqhqlod7ug1.png?width=700&format=png&auto=webp&s=7ec1b565073bcc88f0403c5064e0be6ec17b28b6> <https://preview.redd.it/09k2gdppd7ug1.png?width=691&format=png&auto=webp&s=9e15198b82f8833f30009a763184c6e58817a42f> Update 3 I talked to a different insurance rep today and got a completely different reason for my bill. This one acknowledged that I only had one procedure and that it was a colonoscopy, not an endoscopy. She said that while a colonoscopy can be preventative, mine was not preventative because I had it done in a hospital. I asked her where I should have gone to get a preventative colonoscopy and she said that I should have gone to an office. I told her I went to my doctor's office and they referred me to the hospital. She said she understands it is frustrating and offered to help me file a claim adjustment request. So in 10 to 15 days I should be getting the decision. I still think it makes no sense because they paid the claim submitted by the doctor who performed the colonoscopy even though he did it at a hospital. But the claim submitted by the hospital was not preventative because the colonoscopy happened at a hospital."

— r/HealthInsurance · 233 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sg3ast/>

↳ (0): "If it's a true ACA plan, you'd be correct and there seems there would be some sort of issue with them processing. Where did you get your ACA plan? Do you have a copy of the EOB you can post?"

↳ (0): "Did you confirm the doctor you used was in network?"

↳ (0): "Also - an issue we ran into once is that the procedure the colonoscopy being done by the doctor is indeed included but not the facility fee. So you have to pay a facility fee - and even if they are in network they could be not covered."

"Ambetter admitting to missing three P2P's and recording inaccurate data I have Ambetter through the ACA marketplace and have been trying since March to get ivabradine (Corlanor) 5 mg approved for Inappropriate Sinus Tachycardia (IST). The medication was denied, so my cardiologist and I started the appeal process. We submitted multiple documents and were repeatedly told some variation of, "We just need one more document and you should be approved." Over the next few months, I received conflicting information from different representatives. One rep told me my doctor never submitted an appeal, while another confirmed that the appeal had been received. I was also repeatedly transferred to an offshore team that often couldn't locate my account or case information and could only read from a script. Eventually, Ambetter told us a peer-to-peer (P2P) review was needed. My doctor scheduled and waited for three separate P2P calls. On each occasion, they reserved two hours of their time and never received a call from Ambetter. When I questioned this, I was initially told that my physician likely missed the calls. After pushing for escalation, I was given a complaint number and promised a callback. No one ever called. I later reached someone on the escalation team who seemed genuinely helpful. He reviewed the case notes and stated that he could see all three missed P2P reviews. He also found documentation indicating that my physician's office had supposedly been contacted before a P2P had even been approved, which didn't make sense chronologically. He told me he had rarely seen a case file this disorganized and said he would immediately contact the pharmacy medical director. After I was on hold for approximately 90 minutes, the call disconnected. The next day, I called back with all of my reference numbers and complaint information. The escalation team transferred me back to the main customer service line. Pharmacy transferred me back to escalation. Escalation then sent me back to the main line again. At one point, the pharmacy representative called for me and was literally transferred back into his own department. To make matters worse, I ended up in the ER during this process and nearly lost my job because my symptoms remained uncontrolled while I fought through these delays. At this point, I'm preparing to file a complaint with my states Department of Insurance. My physician's office has documentation of the missed P2P appointments. Has anyone dealt with anything similar with their insurance? Beyond filing with the state and pursuing external review, is there anything else I should be doing? I pay \$550 a month for just me. TL:DR: My insurance has no internal workflow/communication, recorded inaccurate data, and has no actual escalation team. I'm at a loss of how to navigate other than filing with the state."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tx9333/>

↳ (0): "First off, Ambetter sucks. Not just a little, but a lot. The pharmacy area is a joke. The initial round of reviews are done by non US based pharmacists with questionable decision making. Most often this results in denials that are overturned later on. Their decisions on step therapy often recommend options that are not appropriate for patients. The escalation and P2P processes are astoundingly bad. Lots of no callbacks on escalations, never scheduled or no response to P2P requests, and missed scheduled P2P. The only way i've found to push the process forward (from my experience and peers) is to have the patient file a grievance with their state insurance commissioner's office. I usually get a follow up from Ambetter within 24 hours of receipt of the complaint. The key is that on the provider side they must track every call, fax, and email. Have receipts. We print off a detailed log, along with recommended wording for a state grievance. Patients understand we're on their side, but with the low reimbursements that Ambetter offers, it's often done at a deficit for the practice."

↳ (0): "In the future, file a grievance immediately with the insurance once you are beyond 7-14 calendar days from the initial request. Then, file a complaint with the division of insurance immediately if they don't resolve your grievance within 7-14 calendar days. Aka don't pass 30 days without a call to the state division of insurance. Complaint filing should be an easy process at the state level, they want and need to know."

↳ (0): "I'm sorry you're going through this. The first step is to confirm which state your Ambetter plan is based in,

since the appeal process can vary by state. As an agent, when a prior authorization is denied, I immediately submit an expedited appeal so the member can get a final resolution quickly. If that appeal is denied, I help them file an Independent Review Organization (IRO) request right away. The full process usually takes about 14 days. Most denials happen because the medical criteria simply aren't met — for example, when the provider prescribes something off-label, experimental, or fails to submit the required documentation. If the denial is due to a health plan error, the IRO often overturns it at no cost to the member. Sometimes appeals succeed because the Medical Director contacts the provider's office for more information. However, since Medical Directors handle dozens of cases per shift, if they can't connect with the provider promptly, the denial is usually upheld. The IRO process is more thorough because it requests documentation directly from the provider and reviews everything comprehensively. In certain states, like Florida, Centene Pharmacy Services handles appeals directly, leaving agents with little influence. Also, the so-called "Member Escalation Team" is essentially experienced customer service representatives — they don't escalate issues beyond standard procedures. True escalation happens through appeals or grievances, where the health plan must act according to your Evidence of Coverage and applicable law. Corporate staff may get involved, but unless your contract or policy language allows exceptions, their role is limited. Recommended Steps Call Ambetter and request to file an appeal as the patient for the denied prior authorization. Note the complaint number if your state allows appeals by phone, or complete the appeal form and send it to your state's designated address. Wait for the letter of determination. If denial is upheld, submit an IRO request. If the IRO also upholds the denial, you can file a complaint with your state's Department of Insurance. You can also skip directly to the Department of Insurance, but they'll usually redirect you back into the same process I described — only with corporate agents involved. That may be preferable if you'd rather speak with someone based in the U.S., since most contact center agents are overseas. Good luck — persistence is key in these cases, and following the proper steps gives you the best chance of success"

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

↳ fizzy-logic (19): "There's way too much going on in that post for me to break it down for you, and way too much both of you haven't made sure to understand about how it all works. There's just too much to walk you through. I normally think it's best to investigate how things work and take care of insurance yourself, as brokers can sometimes steer people wrong, but in your case you may need an insurance broker. BUT also you need to read up on how this shit works, desperately. The fact you said you didn't pay premiums, but you also didn't use it, implies you think that somehow you only pay for insurance if you actually need to use it. I'm not trying to be mean at all, but that lack of the most basic understanding of how insurance works is going to hurt you, your health, your family and your wallet. It's time to learn this stuff, and it won't be something you can read one article in one day and be done. You need to put time into it. But I will add that if someone is offered insurance through work, they are not eligible for any ACA subsidies unless that plan is expensive enough to be deemed unaffordable by ACA standards. You'd have to look up how to determine if the cost was high enough to let you get ACA subsidies, and I honestly don't know that you're gonna do that on your own. Get a broker for all of this mess, or better yet, an organization that helps people file as sort of a charitable work, I think there are some groups that do that. You can look at the ACA website for a list of facilitators in your area, they are free to you. The reason I'd look for someone like that rather than a broker, if possible, is since a broker isn't going to get commission if you are taking a work plan versus an ACA plan, you'll have to get lucky and hope someone gives you good advice even if it turns out they won't be getting a commission (if it turns out you and your wife are better going with her work plan). And there are absolutely brokers who would help even if they need to advise you to take the work plan instead, but there are also ones who convince people to take bad plans and/or fail to explain how it works properly. You can get badly burned financially if you take an ACA plan, didn't understand how it worked, and end up owing back thousands. Same can be said if you get sold a junk, non-ACA insurance plan that doesn't really cover anything when you need it. Added: If your wife is on an ACA plan when she actually has the option to get insurance from work, btw, and that insurance doesn't meet the standard to let her still get ACA credits, she can end up owing back the full amount of credits. This all gets reconciled at tax time - so the credits you get in 2026 are reconciled when you file your 2026 taxes in April of 2027. She would owe back whatever the full monthly premiums were without credits if it turns out she wasn't eligible to have them."

↳ LacyLove (18): "1 She cannot continue to get subsidies if her plan is affordable. 2 yes 3 yes 4 yes 5 no and it begins in November for coverage beginning in 2027. 6 That depends solely on the plans. 7 yes 8. She needs to enroll in her work plan ASAP. Then cancel her marketplace plan. You are 33 years old, it is time you learn about this stuff. You literally have the world's answers at your fingertips. Use them."

↳ Jcarlough (9): "Great questions! It's unfortunate that at 33 years-old you still are inexperienced at a key

component of “adulting” but kudos for recognizing this and wanting to learn. I *am* curious on your health insurance situation for the past seven years no plan is going to allow a dependent stay enrolled once you hit 26 UNLESS you met the disabled dependent definition. Were you out of the US this whole time? Regardless, to answer your questions. 1. Yes. Your wife’s employer offering affordable health insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage (most do) WILL disqualify her for continuing subsidies. 2. Yes. Failure to enroll also disqualifies her from continuing to receive subsidies. 3. The rest of your questions are irrelevant due to the above. Really, since you currently do not have health insurance, it sounds like your best option is for your spouse to enroll you both into her new employer’s plan."

"Complicated situation involving COBRA and deceased spouse. Any suggestions? Hi all, tl;dr: How do I get off COBRA and on to my employer's health insurance outside of open enrollment? **NOTE: I am ONLY looking for completely 100% LEGAL options. No funny business. No risk to my family's health insurance coverage, no risk of lapse in coverage, etc.** I'll try to keep this simple and only include important details. Located in New York state My wife got a new job in 2023 with awesome health insurance (NYSHIP Empire plan). She was diagnosed with brain cancer 6 months later and had to stop her job to do treatment. Her job kept her on the payroll for a year and then we did COBRA for her insurance, because while it was expensive (3400/month for our family - 2 kids), it completely covered her treatment - not even any copays. It was fuss free and seemed worth it at the time. While she was expected to beat the cancer, she had a massive relapse in summer 2025 and was in hospice from June thru Nov, when she passed. the entire time, we've been paying for her cobra and while I've had to fight for some things, it's mostly been good. My workplace is a startup/small business that participates in one of these group insurance for startup things that's externally managed (justworks). Open enrollment was last December. I was distraught after her death/ not really looking at every detail at the time, so I figured that I'd just cancel cobra a few months after she passed, once the dust settled, hospital bills were all done, etc, and move to my employer's plan, since we no longer need the super coverage. Unfortunately, I'm being told that voluntarily cancelling cobra doesn't count as a qualifying life event (QLE), that I have to have an involuntary loss of coverage in order to jump on to my employer's plan out of the normal open enrollment. I've asked justworks and they've said there's nothing they can do. I clearly explained the situation to them, asked for an extension on the open enrollment period due to extenuating circumstances, offered to back-pay premiums to the open enrollment period, etc). They say they've reviewed the situation and have no avenues to help me, and that I have to wait for the next open enrollment period, or have some QLE that justifies getting on to the plan. I've asked the COBRA company about how to generate an involuntary loss of coverage. I haven't heard back from them, but I'm not expecting that to be a possibility. The list of options as I see it is: 1) Continue paying cobra until the next open enrollment (cost: about \$37,000 at the current rate for the remaining time - this is rough) 2) Find another job, quit mine and get on their plan - but I like my job and am unlikely to find a comparable one. moreover, that would likely be a net loss, as I'm paid well. I'd sooner take option #1 than this. 3) Find another job that pays health insurance from day 1, get hired, take a vacation from my good job, jump on their plan, quit a week later, and use that as a QLE to get on my good employer's plan. Kind of a dick move and probably difficult to pull off, but I think technically this would work? 3b) I have friends that own businesses. I could possibly ask one of them to, as a favor, hire me for a month, give me health insurance (I'd pay them for it, etc), then I quit and jump on my employer's plan. The issues with this are a) I'm not sure it's above board legally, because I'd just be doing this to generate a QLE - is this legal?) b) I need to convince one of them to let me do it, which is a bit of a long shot. and c) is there a minimum amount of time that I'd need to hold another policy for it to "count"? 4) Get lousy insurance from the NY state marketplace, drop cobra, and hold it until open enrollment with my employer in December. My kids and I are relatively healthy, so this might be fine? Does anyone have any better suggestions? None of these options are particularly compelling. I'm hoping someone knows some specific (SAFE, LEGAL and LEGIT) method I can use/nobody has thought of. yet. Thank you!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1r7ttk3/>

↳ (0): "I am sorry for your loss. The simplest (least moving parts) plan is that the expiration of COBRA eligibility is a QLE baked into program design. COBRA doesn't last forever. The basic coverage concept is for 18 months after an employee separates. If the employee is found to be disabled by the federal government within 60 days of the separation, the COBRA period is extended to 29 months (that lines up with federal benefits programs). If an employee dies, their family members that were participating in an employer's health insurance program can participate in COBRA for 36 months. You may be getting close to the 18 month window. I don't know if periods "stack," (e.g., if the employee dies while on COBRA, can the 36 month option be triggered?). You wife'

employer's HR department or the plan administrator should be able to tell you when your COBRA eligibility ends. That will trigger a 60 day eligibility period for enrollment in a marketplace offering or other ACA compliant program. Best wishes for your future."

↳ (0): "Best as I can tell, we have 36 months available to us due to the NY state mini cobra as well as the death of my spouse. This takes us to summer 2027, but I'd switch to my employer in Dec 2026 during general enrollment."

↳ (0): "As you've learned, canceling COBRA voluntarily is not a QLE. Your option 4 would not work since you also need a QLE to get insurance on the marketplace outside of open enrollment. Since you're on COBRA, when is that scheduled to end? In most cases, you can only stay on for 18 months. Once that's up, that's your QLE to enroll in your employer's plan."

"marketplace, healthcare, overlap, tax, implications... I am not sure this is the right sub Reddit for my question but hopefully someone can help or shed light on my situation. it's pretty simple. I recently started a new job after working for a small business and purchasing my own independent insurance for many years. I did not select my new employer sponsored insurance plan until August 31 of this year even though I was hired July 1 of this year. I assumed that coverage began September 1 but upon completion of paperwork, realize it started August 1. I'm not really sure how that's possible but that is what my plan states. So, I didn't know I had to cancel my marketplace plan immediately and somehow thought that they just canceled each other out. That sounds really stupid when I say it out loud, but I thought if I got one coverage, it would just terminate the other coverage, but I realize now it does not work that way. So now when I get my 1095 a at the end of the year, it will show that I had a Marketplace plan with high discount for all of Aug and 9 days of Sept (unless I'm stuck with the whole month of September as well. It depends if they can prorate the days.) that I technically did not qualify for. I'm essentially on the hook for the contributed amount, correct? I don't qualify for the discount. I just don't understand why I have to pay back that money if I didn't use the plan (or can't because the other insurance is primary and Trump's the marketplace plan) because all of my appointments and prescriptions are gonna be rerun through the new insurance. I was told I had to do that manually regardless. Does anything I'm saying have truth to it? Am I missing something? If I do everything correctly and go through any insurance claim for an appointment or prescription during that timeframe to have my primary insurance run and pay the difference, what are my tax implications? If I do none of that, what are my tax implications? Does it eventually catch up to me or do I have to deal with it at the end of the year in some way shape or form? TLDR: I had marketplace insurance as well as employer sponsored insurance that overlapped. What happens on my 1095 a when it comes time to pay taxes? Will I suffer an expensive payback situation for credits that I received at the same time as my other plan was active? I mean expensive is relative. I think the credits are like maximum \$500 a month so if I was charged for two months it would be about \$1000. it's an extra thousand dollars that I don't have to put towards health insurance though."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wdgszl/marketplace_healthcare_overlap_tax_implications/

↳ AffectionateWallaby2 (1): "Great summary and exactly what I anticipated. Is there no course of action to fight these kinds of situations? This just seems wrong. I mean, yeah it is my fault for not canceling, but I imagine this happens all the time. The marketplace is confusing program. if you're not well-versed in Florida healthcare credits. It can be very confusing and you can get yourself into financial trouble pretty quickly. I wonder if anyone has ever tried to fight this type of situation."

↳ AffectionateWallaby2 (1): "also, my new plan is more expensive in terms of prescriptions and doctors visits as well as diagnostics, etc. If they are not going to credit me or help me out with the overlap, then why go back and rerun any claims made during the overlap to pay more out-of-pocket differences? Do you think they could come after me for that? Technically the employer, sponsored insurance is primary and should have been used, but it wasn't. I know that this is my responsibility going forward, but do I have to retro everything?"

"US Expat - Just returned and Uninsured I just came back to the US after a few years. Wife is still working overseas until I get settled in. Looking for a job now in the Northern Virginia area but unsure what insurance to get until I land a job that pays health benefits. Looked at marketplace but considering our household income (over six figures annually), the cheapest plan is over \$550. I would appreciate suggestions on what options I have available. I am 50 year old man and on a couple of daily meds."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wh5rjr/us_expat_just_returned_and_uninsured/

↳ Low_Mud_3691 (14): "\$550 is pretty normal. Getting a job would be your best bet to possibly get a lower premium."

↳ LacyLove (6): "If you want an ACA plan, then you have your options, a job that has health insurance or the marketplace which is expensive."

↳ EmZee2022 (4): "Agreed. It'll cover you in case of major emergencies. Likely not much else - if it's ACA-compliant it will include basic preventive care like an annual physical, flu shots etc. but those annual physicals can be traps - seems like every other day someone posts here about how their visit was billed differently and they got nailed on the cost. Given that you'll need some prescriptions to be renewed, your visit would likely not be treated as preventive. At 550 a month, it's likely got a very high deductible too. Ouch. And you're in a HCOL area (neighbor!)."

"@RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith Just be careful to double check everything with a second source. Heck, I called the ACA call center yesterday, and their hold greeting has the wrong enrollment dates in its messaging. Nuts. I have also found that most do not understand the MAGI benefits of an HSA, so they do not provide good information. It can be a good addition to early retirement financial strategy"

— YouTube · ACA 2026 Update: The One Income Strategy That Saves Thousands · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b7tw43UuPrY&lc=UgzMwvxBrGnOm8H7mj14AaABAg.AQMI1mLhIxuAQMpOGZA-zk>

Narrow networks and doctors who don't take marketplace plans · 7 documents · 7 voices

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1lwkch/>

↳ (0): "It's a class H felony in NC for a provider that accepts medicaid (opted in) to take out of pocket payment for services that would be covered under medicaid. Say you went to a dentist that accepted it, they can only bill you for procedures not covered under medicaid like a crown. They wouldn't be able to bill you for services that are covered under medicaid like a cavity filing. If they never opted in to accept medicaid, then it is not fraud. They never agreed to medicaid terms and conditions at all. If you are concerned, before you do anything, you can always call NCDOL or medicaid and make sure you are okay."

↳ (0): "Yes, it can be. Medicaid is for people who cannot pay their own medical expenses. If you show that you have means to pay for your own medical expenses, the state will assume you do not need Medicaid and have been fraudulently receiving benefits. In my state (MD), there are some Medicaid MCOs that do not require referrals from your PCP to receive specialty care. If you are healthy enough to not need to be followed by a PCP, then it matters a lot less if you cannot find one."

↳ (0): "And provider (practitioner/facility) that is contracted with Medicaid must sign a participation agreement that includes the following: In accordance with 10A NCAC 22J .0106 Providers may bill a patient accepted as a Medicaid patient only in the following situations: For allowable deductibles, co-insurance, or co-payments; Before the service is provided the provider has informed the patient that the patient may be billed for a service that is not one covered by Medicaid regardless of the type of provider or is beyond the limits on Medicaid services; The patient is 65 years of age or older and is enrolled in the Medicare program at the time services are received but has failed to supply a Medicare number as proof of coverage; or The patient is no longer eligible for Medicaid as defined in 10A NCAC 21B."

"How many Americans are on PPO health insurance that covers seeing specialists/doctors across state lines compared to being on insurance that only covers within the state? I'm on Medicaid in Rhode Island for disability and it's frustrating dealing with out of state approvals. Any advice welcomed. I've had long-term neurological issues like neuropathy, muscle pain, and memory issues for nearly 6 years that neurologists in my state (and in Connecticut) haven't been able to definitively diagnose. I am on SSI for disability, which means I get Neighborhood Health Plan of Rhode Island as my primary insurance, with Medicaid as the secondary. I was told by a neurologist I saw across the border in Connecticut recently (Some doctors in CT take my insurance it seems) that being seen at a bigger hospital like Mass General may lead to a definitive diagnosis. From what I was told by his office after they tried referring me to the hospital, Mass General/MGH is no longer accepting my insurance even with prior authorization, when a few years ago i was told by Mass General they were taking my insurance with those stipulations. I was told by MGH's neurology department staff (who were very nice and compassionate about my situation, to be fair to them) that it's possible the hospital chose not to contract with my insurance this year, hence the change, and that because I am on Medicaid, I couldn't even choose to self-pay to go there. They said it's possible in the future the contractual issue could change, and they also told me to try contacting Neighborhood Health myself and explain the situation and see if they could somehow get me approved to be seen at Mass General. I will be calling them this upcoming week. I was curious as to how often Americans are on health insurance plans that cover seeing specialists across state lines, how difficult it is for them to be approved to see specialists in different states, etc. I find it frustrating that my insurance doesn't work across state lines considering this is the smallest state in the country. Not every specialist is going to be here. Logistically it seems to make sense to me that CT/MA should have a deal with RI insurance to cover people if they at least get prior authorization/approval. As of right now Mass General wouldn't take me no matter what, which I find very concerning and depressing. I have had multiple neurologists say I should be seen in a place like Boston to possibly get a definitive diagnosis, why is that not enough to be seen there? That makes no sense to me."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uheytb/how_many_americans_are_on_ppo_health_insurance/

↳ Good_Educator4872 (3): "Originally they wanted to control what plans you could buy. Govt plans always limited coverage to care within the relevant political entity. No one ever accused the designers of Obamacare of being forward thinking. It was about control. The original thinking was to use the British NHS as a model. There were problems with this. We are different than EUROPEAN COUNTRIES. We have the most extensive checks and balances balance system. The states are sovereign political entities. European states have always been organized from the top down. The US. is the inverse. Our constitution is a mutual agreement among sovereign states to cede certain powers to the Federal government. This limits the federal governments ability to dictate internal state action except in delineated areas. Generally, the Fed can only exert oversight in areas the state is not currently regulating. The Federal government doesn't regulate insurance policies unless the state agrees. Insurance is the purview of the states as an example not the Federal Government"

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes. And I had a policy in RI from the market place there (recently moved out of state). It was a BCBS PPO, the lowest level with an HSA. It has a national provider network and allows for seeing doctors, specialists, labs,etc anywhere in the country. I never had even a single issue and I've got doctors in multiple states (though not in RI because well...)."

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes! It's weird because it's almost impossible to get a doctor or most specialists in RI but we have one of the very best marketplaces. But it's only the BCBS PPO with the national provider network so look for one of theirs."

"There is a page on MD Anderson's webpage regarding what insurance they accept and it does say "no ACA plans". I have seen the page myself recently and will look for it for you in a bit (after dinner). Here: <https://www.mdanderson.org/patients-family/becoming-our-patient/planning-for-care/insurance-billing-financial-support/insurance-plans.html> Yet it is not as simple as it sounds. However, I spoke to them about it and they are specifically mentioning it in regards to the ACA plans available in TX. And that's because not only are there not any PPO plans available on the TX marketplace but they also don't accept any of the plans that are available on the TX ACA marketplace (it is slim pickings and not very good plans). So that's why they say they don't take any ACA plans. But I have an ACA plan from another state that offers better plans (because not all do, it's not just TX with only crap plans available) and they had no problem accepting my ACA plan. In fact, as others have surmised, they didn't know it was ACA or not. All they really knew was that my (very good) plan was a BCBS PPO with a National Provider Network and that's a plan they accept. FWIW, there's not a hospital or cancer center that doesn't accept my plan. So it isn't that MD Anderson doesn't accept any ACA plans. It's that they don't accept lesser/crappy plans and that's all that is offered on the TX ACA marketplace (as well as some other states)."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/nj7wo7a/

"My company plan was a third of the price of the ACA plan, Cobra or Medicare. And when I changed I had to change several doctors. Most appointments are check ups so waiting isn't a big problem, but appointments I used to get in 3-5 days are now weeks, and some are months. A side note: there are some cheaper Medicare advantage plans available, but it means I have to go to all network doctors as many of mine don't take HMO's. So going it on your own you have Medicare A and B. A is free B is a few hundred dollars. Then you need part D, part N (or G) and vision, dental and dermatology plans. That's what it takes to match what I had in my employee plan. If M4A is run like it is today, it's not less expensive or a good plan. Second note: mine was an individual plan, family plans got substantially more expensive."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vu7oma/people_with_existing_corporate_health_plans_and/p54f5gr/

"There is at least one major flaw in ACA. The idea behind ACA was to provide affordable access to healthcare. Unfortunately, it provides just affordable access to insurance, and that insurance is not accepted by many physicians. Seriously. I live in a major metro with a huge base of primary care physicians as well as specialists. And my experience has been that most doctors don't accept my ACA policy. I have to drive 45 minutes to get to my primary care physician, simply because he was the only doctor I could find who accepted my coverage. So when politicians pat themselves on the back for ACA, I submit that they haven't improved healthcare at all. They've just made it easy for us to find insurance."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvyzBI8&lc=Ugwov4rykJWpFucCV-B4AaABAq>

"Ask i know it's that when obamacare took effect my insurance went from \$150 a month with a \$1,200 deductible to \$900 a month and a \$10,000 deductible and it was only good through one hospital. So far the pricing has gotten worse for me and most of my doctors in my area won't take it the only doctors that do take it are shady hole in the wall clinics and no no major hospitals within a 2 hour radius of me will even consider it. They just take one look at the card and say we don't accept it. I don't get that money back and I'm locked into a 1year contract. My doctor who i pay cash for tells me to get rid of it and only get catastrophic insurance and pay cash for everything else."

— YouTube · What Happens if Obamacare Subsidies Expire? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=onsEZNtGKC&lc=UgyGfdLkWf9y-O0YSat4AaABAq>

"You do realize that those are made up prices on hospital bills, right ?! I've never had a health insurance in this country. I pay out of pocket, including for surgeries. I negotiated with/threatened hospitals many times to get a fair price. And we don't even remotely qualify for charity care or Medicaid, and prefer to see private doctors of our choice who oftentimes don't accept insurance anyway."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=Ugx5QPUJ-XCHBe6Rold4AaABAq>

Agents, brokers and plans changed without consent · 6 documents · 6 voices

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— r/HealthInsurance · 89 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qsd3bg/>

↳ (0): "Why are you trying to do this? What's your goal?"

↳ (0): "This is the right question!"

↳ (0): "It sounds like you're looking to get a secondary plan as your work plan is primary and doesn't provide the treatments you're wanting. If you go this route make sure that the secondary plan will cover non-covered charges from the primary plan. I've seen a lot of secondary plans that won't cover if the primary doesn't even if the plan normally would"

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

↳ (0): "This happens more often than people realize, and no, you are not crazy. Agents or lead generators are motivated by sales. Your agreement and signature are required. What probably occurred is a Marketplace enrollment was completed without your informed consent, often by a third-party agent or lead generator out of need to meet quotas or just greed. Checking eligibility alone does not authorize enrollment. Actual enrollment requires affirmative plan selection and attestation. If that did not occur, this is improper enrollment. Here is what you do, in order. First, call Ambetter immediately and demand the following in writing: • The original application • The agent or broker of record • The date and method of enrollment • The address used and who supplied it • Whether premium tax credits were applied Tell them explicitly you dispute the enrollment as unauthorized and demand a retroactive cancellation to the effective date. Use the phrase unauthorized enrollment without consent. That language matters. Second, contact HealthCare.gov and request a Marketplace case escalation. Ask them to flag the policy as fraudulent enrollment. This is not customer service. This is an eligibility integrity issue. Third, file a complaint with your state Department of Insurance. This creates regulatory pressure and forces documentation. Insurers and agents move fast once DOI is involved. Fourth, protect your tax position. If any premium tax credit was applied, you need a corrected 1095-A showing zero coverage. Otherwise the IRS assumes you accepted subsidized coverage and will claw it back. Fifth, do not pay the bills until the dispute is resolved. Paying can be construed as ratification. Key point: Using your old address is a red flag. That usually indicates data scraping or recycled lead enrollment, not a consumer-initiated action. This is not your fault. It is fixable. But it must be handled surgically and documented. If Ambetter or the Marketplace resists, escalate again and document everything. Paper trails win these cases. In many cases the threat to Department of Insurance is enough."

↳ (0): "CSR from Ambetter here. We do not have the enrollment information that you mention. Only the plan, aptc, effective date and information of the identity of the subscriber. What I do when I receive a call like this is that I call the marketplace and I assist the member to initiate a HICS case for fraud with the rep of marketplace sharing the enrollment dates we have on the system. An investigation is made by a case worker, and once the source it's confirmed was fraudulent they claim back the APTC sent to the health plan, the plan is retroactively cancelled and member receives a letter of termination from the health plan. 9 out of 10 times the fraud is confirmed. The exceptions happen because member did sign up and granted consent to a broker and forgot about it for the rewards card which the brokers did activities and the like so the member could get a few dollars, but I don't expect to see that happen because fewer people qualify for the Silver 94% plan with 0 member responsibility. To avoid that we now have to ask a \$5 dollars payment per month for those accounts that is refunded at the end of the year. Crazy stuff."

↳ (0): "You need to make two calls. One to the insurance commissioner in your state and ask for their help. Second call CMS and make a complaint, ask for the issue to be resolved."

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/>

↳ (0): "Brokers don't get paid from client. The insurance carriers pay the broker. ACA plans prices go by your income. Prices are ridiculous high."

↳ (0): "That's what I thought too, but I couldn't account for the discrepancy in prices between the brokers prices and healthcare.gov prices. Because one plan was \$30 higher but the more expensive plan was \$50 less from the broker. So I was trying to figure out why that was."

↳ (0): "We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

↳ BaltimoreBee (52): "Your broker is giving you misinformation and you should stop working with them and find a competent one. Married filed separately automatically disqualifies from any subsidies, it doesn't matter how much you earn. You will definitely owe back 100% of any subsidies they give you if you are married filing separately. The only way you can qualify for subsidies is if you file a joint tax return and those subsidies are based on your combined household income."

↳ Dakota51871 (23): "You're broker not only gave you false information but violate the rules and regulations of their contract with NYS Department of Financial Services. You should definitely file a complaint with DFS by calling 800-342-3736 and the attorney general health care line at 800-428-9071. They work on commission so they will say or do anything to make a sale."

↳ whim_sea (11): "Woah. I'm so glad I asked! Thank you !"

"ACA canceled my policy without my permission and won't fix it tldr: I called ACA about how to cancel my policy and made it very clear I was NOT canceling at that time, but found out next day they canceled it anyway. Now I have over a week without coverage and they won't fix their error. My new insurance starts May 1. I called ACA yesterday and had what I thought was a very clear general chat about how I would cancel the policy when I was ready, how much lead time they would need, how my insurer would be notified, whether I'd get a refund of unused premiums etc. I ended up the call with "so when I'm actually ready to cancel, I'll call you back on this number?" And she replied "yes that's right and we're available 24 hours a day" Today I got the final approval for my new insurance and called ACA to actually cancel. They said "your policy was cancelled as of midnight last night". I nearly passed out!! I told them firmly I had NOT requested this and reiterated the details of the call. It doesn't sound like they even record the calls to go back and check. But this is all on them. I didn't get any email confirmation about the policy cancellation and they don't give any transaction ids or confirmation numbers. You can only see by logging into the ACA. So now I have no coverage through the end of the month. And all ACA does is put in an escalation and get a case manager to look at it. Estimated to finish the investigation 45 days. I don't have any medical visits planned but I was hoping to get some shots for my upcoming travel. And of course if I need emergency treatment all bets are off. My insurer can and probably will say I have no coverage. ACA couldn't give me a reference case number or anything to talk to my insurer about to give them a heads up for when they receive the wrong policy cancellation request. I'm absolutely furious and low key extremely nervous about the rest of the month. The call with the supervisor today was quite long but they cannot alter the date of policy termination until the investigation is complete. Anyone got any ideas of anything I can do at this point? I know there's no way ACA is going to reimburse me for any medical expenses incurred that could be denied by any insurer. And PSA, if you ever call ACA and think you're having a general discussion like I did, make double and triple sure at the end that they haven't requested anything to change."

— r/obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1st004d/aca_canceled_my_policy_without_my_permission_and/

↳ 4ofheartz (8): "In the future, you can simply login to your ACA account & cancel it online!"

↳ Florida1974 (3): "Trust your insurer even less than ACA. They don't know shit. I've had pre-authorization for a medicine for years. Last December I go to fill it and it's like \$175 and I had already met my deductible and out-of-pocket maximum in January. I hadn't paid anything for it since January 2025. I call my insurance company, and I get an agent telling me it's a new law that Congress passed, and I called her out immediately because I follow politics closely, so I asked her to tell me what the law was, the new long she kept telling me I was incompetent. Even though she couldn't tell me the law of Congress had passed she just kept repeating it passed one. I don't usually do this, but I asked for her superior. She flat out told me that no, this is not a new congressional law, although it is a congressional law, but it was passed in 2022. I knew I was right. They had given me prior authorization for years, but only because the namebrand was cheaper than the generic. Then the generic lowered their price so low that they stopped covering the namebrand. I tried the generic and it was ineffective, and I had my first asthma attack in decades. I'm not trying to be picky, all my other meds are generics and it all is fine but this particular one, it just did not work for me. It's a maintenance asthma inhaler. So I have this prior authorization and it is useless. The pharmacy is even baffled by it. It's a DAR law, dispense as written. Well, of course it's going to be dispensed as written because I have a prior authorization. If I want that medicine, I have to pay \$175 for it, every month. So now I am on a different one and I will be going on blood pressure meds soon because it raises my blood pressure. I don't have high blood pressure, I never have until I started this medicine. It is effective, but I have to go on another medicine but it's a cheap one. They don't care about my health, they just care about the cost. I hate insurance. It is sorely needed. I had it almost all of my life and then we decided to move to Florida. I retired from my cushy corporate job, but I lost my insurance and I didn't have it for years. So I

know what it's like to go without it and even though it's a pain in the ass, I would rather have it than not And I am hoping that nothing comes up for you in the next 10 days or so. My other message was a bit snarky and I apologize. I hate dealing with anything health insurance wise, no matter who I'm dealing with. They make it so much harder than it actually is"

↳ btwdgirl (2): "Yeah I see we could have done that now! The issue was my insurer told me I had to call ACA to cancel it and actually they helpfully transferred me to ACA. I didn't even check if it was possible online. Will know better next time"

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Bronze, silver or gold: picking the tier · 109 documents · 20 voices

"Someone please explain why I (or anyone) should pay a premium that costs more than the oop max The maths aren't mathing. Someone help me understand what I am missing here. We live in NY. I am a self-employed general contractor. Wife is an attorney and recently left her job to open her own firm so we lost great health insurance through her previous employer. Cobra would cost us around \$7k/ month for 2 healthy adults and our 8yo healthy son. Now we're shopping on the marketplace in what appears to be the worst time in history to be doing so. We make too much for any subsidies, so a silver plan is coming in around \$3k/month. Catastrophic is coming in around \$750/month. After a lot of research I can't understand why I would buy anything other than catastrophic. All ACA plans include the same preventive care at no cost. All ACA plans have the same out of pocket maximum limit. Aside from a catastrophe, we would maybe spend \$1k/ year at most seeking care that isn't covered under ACA preventive care. So why would I pay \$36k/year for a silver plan when I could just buy catastrophic for 1/4 the price and pay out of pocket for everything else, knowing I have the same oop cap as the silver \$36k/year plan?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 577 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ozntee/>

↳ (0): "All ACA plans don't have the same out of pocket max.. they all have a maximum out of pocket max, but they vary. Sounds like catastrophic would be the choice for you. I have a silver plan and I like it because it has 0 deductible and covers my expensive meds and treatment. You don't need that much coverage it sounds like."

↳ (0): "Before you choose do a search to see what hospitals or providers are in network. During a period of unemployment I chose a cheap bronze plan only there were literally NO doctors or hospitals in my network within 50 miles. While all policies must cover emergency room visits, what constitutes an emergency now can be redefined by your insurance and your bills denied."

↳ (0): "It's layers and layers and layers of fucked up, isn't it?"

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

↳ bourbonfan1647 (68): "Elections have consequences. None of this is a surprise. Welcome to the "find out" phase..."

↳ Stop-Looking_For_Me (48): "Well here it is. The numbers don't lie. Healthcare is going to be fun next year for everyone."

↳ Redtoolbox1 (41): "But the billionaires got their tax cuts they so desperately needed 🙌"

"Just canceled my 2026 health insurance through Covered CA My situation is i made more money this year than i expected and now my insurance is about 450 \$ for the bronze plan the problem is everything went up for me, my car insurance went from 280 to 400 this year, my rent went up by 100 \$, my utilities went absolutely crazy, i am living in the studio apartment and used to pay 80-100 \$ max, but now every month is more and more, this month it got to 250 \$...and my apt manager said it's shared so it's not me lol So yeah, even tho i made more money than i expected, i don't have more money on hands, i used to pay 100 \$ per month for insurance and it was ok, but 450 \$ for bronze plan ??? I just can't do it... Can you guys recommend any other good alternatives in LA ? i have good health, nothing chronic and don't take any meds ? Thanks"

— r/HealthInsurance · 307 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1przn9r/>

↳ (0): "Since you're in LA, check out enrollment in the LA County Ability To Pay program. It's not health insurance, but provides healthcare through its clinics and hospitals at a flat monthly fee for lots of outpatient services and a flat per-admission fee for inpatient services."

↳ (0): "We need to form a sub for people going without"

↳ (0): "Mine went from 500 to 820. Just cant afford it now. Barely could before even working 2 jobs"

"There is no way this is correct , is it from NJ healthcare. Ok folks, my head is about to explode, I just got off the phone with NJgetcovered , plan jumped to \$2700 a month w 20K max oop. BUT what blows my mind is this, my son goes to college outside of NJ and according to get covered , I have to have him on my application BUT his policy (Horizon silver plan EPO plan) is only good in the state of New Jersey ! That can not be right can it, I am paying for health insurance for him but he "loses" it when he leaves the state???? He is a resident of NJ and we claim him on out taxes for at least one more year."

— r/HealthInsurance · 201 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1onh5id/>

↳ (0): "Need more information: * What's the gross household income? * How many folks are in the household (you, spouse, child(ren)? Marketplace plans are typically only workable in the state of origin, less plan's that have access to a national network, though these are increasingly uncommon. Your son would be covered in all 50 states for emergency medicine, but for routine care, it would be to be done at an in-network provider (which typically means someone in NJ). In small states / folks near border towns, it's possible that the network goes beyond state lines. Can't quite tell, though, based on the information provided. What state is your son's college in? Do they have any income?"

↳ (0): "Ok after spending several hours on the phone with insurance co I am screwed, Horizon offers a plan called away from home that in theory would extend him coverage but South Carolina opted out of it, he can not buy in SC because he is not a state resident and the school will not sell him a plan because he is graduating in May and lives off campus. My lovely plan will only cover life threatening items and who knows what that is until some review board decides it. Ah the USA health policies."

↳ (0): ">My lovely plan will only cover life threatening items and who knows what that is until some review board decides it Provided the reason for the visit to the ER rises to the "prudent layperson standard", coverage is in tact. Sniffles? Minor aches / pains? Not an ER visit. Sudden onset chest pain? A situation where your son believes they're at risk of losing life or limb? More reasonable to visit the ER. For all things non-emergency, your son can attempt to use telehealth through their insurance provider. For routine care (annual visits), your son can schedule those for the periods they're back in NJ."

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tmp52c/>

↳ (0): "If she is an in-network provider she has a contract with your insurance provider and has agreed to their reimbursement rates. Confirm with your insurance company that her and her office are in-network. If she's collecting the "remaining balance" from patients she's breaking her contractual obligation. Providers cannot ask you to give up your rights to not be balanced billed. Also, it sounds like you're no longer comfortable with her either way and it'd be best to find another provider"

↳ (0): "OP your insurance can also do a three-way call with the provider and you to explain everything (if they actually are in network)."

↳ (0): "I'm a psychologist. Your therapist is in network and has agreed to the rate that the insurance company set. She or he cannot "balance bill" you. Depending on your state, it may be illegal. Regardless of state, it's unethical and in violation of the agreement that the therapist made with the insurance company as an in-network provider. If you want to go hard, you can report them to their licensing board for unethical behavior. At a minimum, I would not stick with this therapist. They're either uneducated or unethical. You don't want either of those in a therapist."

"The key to avoiding high healthcare costs is to be healthy. I've been self-employed for over 16 years and have the ACA since it came out. I pick the cheapest plan which gives my coverage in case of an emergency and all my wellness care. I pay \$131 per month for a bronze plan. I have paid up to \$270 per month in past higher earning years. I pay out of pocket for things not covered if I need them and get a 45% self pay discount. I don't pay a lot for healthcare per year and focus on being active and eating healthy non processed foods. I pay less on medical costs than many pay for insurance alone per year. This has been my way to not fund a ridiculously priced industry. I'm nearing 59. Protect your health at all costs!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxcstwBmYAjgMrsGvh4AaABAg>

↳ @sct4040 (12): "Accidents happen too."

↳ @vogeljennifer6318 (8): "Although this is a great mindset, some people don't have the ability to undo medical issues that require care"

↳ @kona6451 (0): "How old are you? That sounds really cheap"

"Good video. Learned about ACA 8 years ago. Stopped our 401k contributions immediately and funded a brokerage account. Three years later we retired with a sizeable brokerage account and small IRA withdrawals keep our income low. We pay \$7 a month for a bronze plan with an HSA. We have 3 more years till Medicare"

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3I_3XBgfCw&lc=UgzYjF309QwWvC00Ald4AaABAg

↳ @scottunclocked (7): "In general No (let me explain). This is the beauty of having the taxable brokerage account. However, capital gains DO count toward your MAGI and any interest earned counts toward MAGI... So a portion of your withdrawal from a taxable brokerage may count toward your MAGI. it does count, but not like withdrawals from a traditional IRA or 401K where all of the withdrawal amounts from these count toward your MAGI because they are treated as "ordinary income"."

↳ @scottunclocked (6): "Thank you for sharing your costs with the ACA option. With getting the subsidies, you can certainly get your costs WAY down. I do wish we would have gotten started a few years sooner with stockpiling money in a taxable brokerage account. This is one thing I would do differently if I was 5-10 years from early retirement. We got started a little late on building a taxable brokerage account. Great moves on your part to prepare for this.... It is going to save you a fortune! How long have you been retired?"

↳ @dereks4228 (4): "Just remember the taxable brokerage account has no bankruptcy protection and can vanish with a serious lawsuit"

"We retired early from investing. We built up a Brokerage Account prior to retiring early. That allowed us to control our income while having cash available if needed. We were able to keep our income around 30k per year. We never paid over \$100 a month for Silver plans with eye care. Zero deductible, free, prescriptions, doctor visits and Max out of pocket \$2800. This allowed our IRAs to continue growing untouched."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 47 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgyTZQ0UtkACP1cZxu94AaABAg

↳ @Danny854-l9m (13): "You are absolutely right, Job's will pay your bills, buisness will make you rich but investment makes and keep you wealthy. I pray everyone here becomes extremely successful."

↳ @Charlottee-v4e (11): "I'm looking for something to venture into on a long term basis, I really need to create an alternate source of income."

↳ @selenanoxin2231 (10): "I employ the expertise of a professional for that, because it isn't as easy as it seems."

"We retired early and we took the silver plan from the market place. \$2400 a month and it was useless. The deductible and out of pocket was so high, the insurance never paid for anything. What a scam! It honestly drove me back to work, just for the insurance. I sure wish my husband was willing to live out of country for a time."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxWsbWgrBC4jKr28s54AaABAg>

↳ @ariefraiser140 (11): "If you guys were paying \$2400/month that means you guys had a pretty big AGI."

↳ @michaelcoglianese4292 (7): "@ariefraiser140so what? That's still ridiculously high amount for insurance"

↳ @metalgirl (2): "I agree... our insurance is twice that. Stupid high. So not fair!!!"

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxtl8/>

↳ (0): "Nope. The moving QLE requires the individual to have had qualified coverage for at least one of the 60 days prior to the move. Moving QLE is predicated on the loss of coverage or moving outside the effective coverage area of the current policy."

↳ (0): "These premiums are unsustainable. These prices are like sending a kid to college each year, and that's before your out of pocket costs. But to your question: No, simply changing residency won't allow you to insure after the fact. If you have an accident or emergency situation like a burst appendix, a new plan would not cover those bills retroactively. A cancer or cardiac diagnosis requiring treatment next month? That could work, but you would still face the up front costs of biopsy, tests and diagnosis."

↳ (0): "The thing is that medical bills without insurance are staggeringly high - far, far more than you could save from not paying these extortionate rates. You can very easily be in the \$100k+ territory for some fairly 'routine' surgeries, without even a night in hospital."

"Agreed. I pay \$100 more per month for a Gold plan with a \$1K deductible. I would rather pay \$1200 more than get hit with a \$7K plus bill. I don't ration care this way either."

— r/obamacare · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v4frri/seems_like_a_good_deal_to_me_what_am_i_missing/ozaw6l6/

"ACA until Medicare? I'm 63 and want to retire soon, so I would be losing my employer coverage at that time. During my employee coverage years, I chose an HDHP plan and put almost 10K into an HSA. I plan on getting the lowest cost Bronze plan and use the HSA funds to cover meds and any other coverages for the 2 years. I realize that if I have a major medical event, I'll need to cover a big deductible/out of pocket maximum, but even that would be less than \$20K per year for a comprehensive gold plan. I have a pre-existing condition, so a private plan is out of the question and my COBRA would cost \$1350/mth. The only downside I can think of with ACA is needing to adhere to the income limit to keep the subsidy for the 2 years. What else am I missing?"

— r/obamacare · 21 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qmvzcn/>

↳ (0): "Just remember, you can't use HSA funds to pay ACA premiums."

↳ (0): "> What else am I missing? If your income is controllable during this time (only LTCG, etc. And you have enough available cash in savings or investments that won't incur capital gains to sell) and you can get to 100-150% of FPL, then you should get a silver plan. Will have no deductibles and around \$1000 OOP max. Max cost sharing (lowered deductibles/OOP max) is at 100-150% FPL."

↳ (0): "Yes, only silver plans are eligible for income-based CSR (cost sharing reductions), which lower deductibles, max out of pockets, copays etc. The CSRs can make silver plans way better than gold. If you can get your MAGI (modified adjusted gross income) low enough, it is definitely worth considering silver plans."

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

↳ (0): "The insurance isnt going to agree to a network exception for your preferred provider. They would have to have the provider sign documents indicating they would agree to accept in network rates, and usually they wont proactively try to set that up unless the provider reaches out to them first. While the process exists, the likelihood of them approving it is extremely low. You can ask for a care manager or case manager. Thats a decent recommendation. They should be able to find you a provider that can actually treat you. Theres a good chance some of the providers were incorrect when they said they dont take marketplace plans, though its possible they were right and the insurance has an outdated directory, but 20 providers in a row seems unlikely. You wont be able to change your plan outside open enrollment. No better way other than contacting your insurance directly, unfortunately."

↳ (0): "Best advice here! Also OP - even *if* you could get your insurance to pay in-network rates (and you may be able to if for some reason there is in-fact no providers) - doing so doesn't prevent the provider from still balance-billing you what insurance doesn't pay due to the lack of contract."

↳ (0): "I would do both options. And also, I would report the insurance company and plan to your state Department of insurance. The insurance companies benefit from having fake doctors on their plans."

"Ours is actually quite a bit worse, probably due to age (late 50's). If we careen over the cliff of \$84,600 due to not having quite enough expenses or whatever, it will cost us an additional \$19,200 / year. Our anticipated income is just very, very close to the cliff, and that's best case scenario with a bronze plan and full HSA funding to get our MAGI to \$80k. If we topple over, we will pay over \$24,000 / year in premiums for a bronze plan + \$10,750 to fund the HSA. That's 41% of our gross income before we even visit a doctor or fill a prescription, not to mention federal and state taxes. Not much left. WTF, America?"

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/nm32690/

"Yep; retired at 61 and controlled my MAGI such that I paid \$0 for a Silver plan. Benefit of being conservative over many years and having enough in brokerage / savings to cover expenses, vacations, etc. for four years before Medicare kicked in. (So now I actually pay more (~\$300/mo) for Medicare + plan premium than when on ACA. 🤔)"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg

↳ @u8805a8cee (3): "I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

"Started a taxable brokerage account 5 years ago instead of maxing out our 401k. Wound up with around 300k and retired age 60 knowing this account would lower our MAGI with small IRA withdrawals. We pay \$7 dollars a month for a Bronze plan with an HSA. We can show up to 65k a year in income for the \$7 dollars a month. We withdraw 50k from IRA and the rest from the brokerage account. The HSA lowers our income 10k. Highly recommend funding a brokerage account instead of IRA a few years before retirement. Great video and ideas"

— YouTube · ACA Premium Shock? Pay Less All Year · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8zEUYMnF5vI&lc=UgypWK6z8jnk9WEZex4AaABAg>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (1): "Hi Patrick! Thank you so much for sharing this most helpful comment! You're a great example of putting some of these levers in action and really saving on your ACA health insurance premiums and how they can really make a HUGE difference! Wonderful job and thanks for watching!"

↳ @nikij.6058 (1): "Wished I would have done the same... 🤔🤔🤔"

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqibrvo/

"First time viewer... and now a subscriber. I retired early at 58, after 35 yrs in the health insurance world. I am a self proclaimed ACA expert.... and loved seeing how accurate you are at outlining the details. Well done!!! I was fortunate enough to have planned my cash bucket (CDs) and investments to allow me to keep my MAGI at the absolute bottom, so I pay \$0 premium for the best silver.... and have been trying to help everyone achieve the same status."

— YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=Ugw53JBOOcJ3-XYDzgl4AaABAq>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Thanks so much for subscribing and for the kind words! Coming from someone with your background in health insurance, that really means a lot! Sounds like you've done an amazing job planning your early retirement and keeping your MAGI low — great example for others and that's such a great service you're providing by helping others!"

↳ @heflight (0): "@Davek111 do you offer a service that helps folks keep their MAGI low?"

"62f small business owner (sole proprietor). Located in GA, which has its own exchange. AGI \$38,000 after schedule C write-offs. This year I pay \$38/mo, \$3600 MOOP, silver plan. \$15 copay for PCP, \$15 copay for mental health weekly (therapy), \$30 copay specialist. My colon ruptured out of the blue June 18. Emergency abdominal surgery, 10 days in hospital. The main hospital bill was \$90,000, my portion was \$10. I owe the surgeon \$800 and the hospital another \$3500, which I'm paying \$191/mo on a payment plan. The govt subsidy on my '24 taxes was \$816/mo. I have no idea what '26 will look like for my monthly premium. I certainly can't afford \$800+/mo! And I can't go without insurance 😞 "

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh749pf/

COBRA or a spouse's employer plan · 105 documents · 20 voices

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

↳ (0): "Man, it's a big risk, and if you lose the bet, you're well and truly bad off. One chronic illness, cancer, pregnancy, broken bone, torn ligament and you are SOL. Sure, you can be seen for emergency care under EMTALA, but they don't have to give you chemo or surgery or insulin once you're past the emergency part. 25 is typically young and healthy, but it isn't a guarantee. Best of luck to you."

↳ (0): "My MS first happened at 25, but bc I didn't have insurance until 29 to get diagnosed I have permanent damage and now disabled and unable to work."

↳ (0): "I don't want to upvote this, because it is terrible that you had to go through that, but I'll upvote anyway because it is a perfect example of how things can turn quickly."

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hsvb50/>

↳ (0): "This is a blunder by your former employer if they failed to notify your COBRA administrator. First step is to contact your former employer and get some answers and see what their solution is. Notice should have been sent to you for any changes to your coverage. Something else to consider: since you're in the new year (and I'm assuming your deductible resets on a calendar year basis), you may consider subsidized coverage through your state's ACA marketplace, or even Medicaid if you're eligible. Not enough info shared in your OP to make that determination, but it may help save some coin while you're still (again, assuming here) unemployed."

↳ (0): "I believe this would be on the COBRA vendor. Your prior employer pays the cobra vendor to send out policy documents. I'm sure there is a way for the cobra vendor to alert the ex-employer and they get the policy reinstated, especially since you're paid to date."

↳ (0): "Contact your former employer, bc they made a mistake in not communicating the proper info to the COBRA administrator. They should be able to fix this quickly, and your enrollment in the new policy should be retrospective to Jan 1. Keep your appointments. The worst case scenario is that you pay for the first PT session out of pocket and then submit the superbill to the new insurer and they will reimburse you. It usually takes 4-6 weeks for the claim to be evaluated and a check to be cut."

"The government should really open up Medicare with reasonable premiums for those 55 -65. Age discrimination is preventing a lot of people from getting hired these days. Even ACA is costing me 1K a month for me and spouse. My spouse's work insurance was much more expensive. My COBRA just ended after I lost my job 18 months ago and it was 1500 a month going up to 2K this year. I stayed on COBRA because we already satisfied the max out of pocket and it was good insurance."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Retire Before 65 · 72 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l8VY8AcaLww&lc=UgxUWCq0OC_S-rSQahN4AaABAq

↳ @DesigningRetirement (2): "Health sharing ministries like Medishare, Samaritan Ministries, and Christian Healthcare Ministries are an option some people use, but it's crucial to understand what they are and aren't before making this choice - especially for people over 50. What they are: Member-based cost-sharing programs where members contribute monthly "shares" that are used to pay each other's medical expenses. They're often significantly cheaper than ACA plans (\$300-500/month vs. \$800-1,500+) and are based on shared religious values and community support. What they're NOT: Insurance. They have no legal obligation to pay your medical bills. If the ministry determines your situation doesn't meet their guidelines, you're responsible for the full bill - and you have no legal recourse. Critical limitations for people approaching or in retirement: 1. Pre-existing conditions: Most health sharing ministries don't cover pre-existing conditions at all, or impose waiting periods of 1-3+ years. For people over 50, the vast majority have at least one pre-existing condition - high blood pressure, high cholesterol, diabetes, previous surgeries, arthritis, etc. If you develop cancer, need heart surgery, or face other major medical needs related to a pre-existing condition, your bills may not be "shared." 2. No guarantee of payment: If the ministry determines your situation doesn't qualify (didn't follow protocols, didn't get pre-approval, condition isn't "shareable" per their guidelines), you pay the full bill. There's no insurance commissioner to appeal to, no legal protection. 3. Coverage exclusions vary widely: Many exclude mental health care, some exclude certain cancer treatments, some require you to try lower-cost treatments first, some won't share bills if you didn't get pre-approval. You must read the specific guidelines carefully - not the marketing materials, but the actual sharing guidelines. Real-world outcomes - both exist: Some people use health sharing ministries for years successfully, paying for routine care and minor issues at much lower monthly cost than insurance. Other people have been left with \$50,000-200,000+ in medical debt when the ministry denied their shares for cancer treatment, heart surgery, or other major expenses - often after treatment has already occurred, when they're most vulnerable. Where they might work: Healthy people under 50 with no pre-existing conditions People with strong religious convictions about community-based sharing People who have financial resources to self-pay if shares are denied Very short-term bridge situations (though risky) Where they're dangerous: People over 50 (very high likelihood of health issues) Anyone with chronic conditions or health history People who can't afford large unexpected medical bills Anyone facing major illness (exactly when you need guaranteed coverage) My honest perspective: For most people over 50 navigating the gap before Medicare, I strongly encourage sticking with ACA-compliant insurance despite the cost. The guaranteed coverage of pre-existing conditions and legal consumer protections are worth the premium difference when you're at the age where major health issues become more likely. If ACA premiums feel truly unaffordable, explore subsidies based on current income (not last year's - this trips people up), Medicaid eligibility if income is low enough, or working with a healthcare navigator to find the most affordable ACA-compliant option. If you're still considering health sharing ministries: Read the actual sharing guidelines (not marketing materials) - understand exactly what is and isn't shareable Assume you'll need to self-pay for major illness - if you can't afford that risk, don't take it Understand you have no legal recourse if shares are denied Consider your age and health realistically - any pre-existing condition puts you at significant risk The monthly savings aren't worth six-figure medical debt if shares are denied when you need them most. That said, I respect that some people have used them successfully and are comfortable with the risks. Just make sure you understand what you're accepting before making this choice, because the

consequences of getting it wrong are severe."

↳ @patriot2510 (0): "medicare would go bankrupt in one month"

"As a 59 years old retiree, I pay \$2264 per month for COBRA health insurance for me and my wife. I just checked ACA rates for us, it was over \$1000 per month more. I don't qualify for subsidies. Something is wrong with the ACA when its so much more costly without government subsidies."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzxjuSyfTqcBbN1kp4AaABAg

↳ @beautyandplay (3): "probably better with private plans."

↳ @nata3467 (0): "how much are you and your wife making ?"

↳ @acevers (0): "That's because you were a productive person before retirement. Only bums and disabled people get deals and freebies, and your taxes pay for it. Sucks."

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qsd3bg/>

↳ (0): "Why are you trying to do this? What's your goal?"

↳ (0): "This is the right question!"

↳ (0): "It sounds like you're looking to get a secondary plan as your work plan is primary and doesn't provide the treatments you're wanting. If you go this route make sure that the secondary plan will cover non-covered charges from the primary plan. I've seen a lot of secondary plans that won't cover if the primary doesn't even if the plan normally would"

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

↳ (0): "This happens more often than people realize, and no, you are not crazy. Agents or lead generators are motivated by sales. Your agreement and signature are required. What probably occurred is a Marketplace enrollment was completed without your informed consent, often by a third-party agent or lead generator out of need to meet quotas or just greed. Checking eligibility alone does not authorize enrollment. Actual enrollment requires affirmative plan selection and attestation. If that did not occur, this is improper enrollment. Here is what you do, in order. First, call Ambetter immediately and demand the following in writing: • The original application • The agent or broker of record • The date and method of enrollment • The address used and who supplied it • Whether premium tax credits were applied Tell them explicitly you dispute the enrollment as unauthorized and demand a retroactive cancellation to the effective date. Use the phrase unauthorized enrollment without consent. That language matters. Second, contact HealthCare.gov and request a Marketplace case escalation. Ask them to flag the policy as fraudulent enrollment. This is not customer service. This is an eligibility integrity issue. Third, file a complaint with your state Department of Insurance. This creates regulatory pressure and forces documentation. Insurers and agents move fast once DOI is involved. Fourth, protect your tax position. If any premium tax credit was applied, you need a corrected 1095-A showing zero coverage. Otherwise the IRS assumes you accepted subsidized coverage and will claw it back. Fifth, do not pay the bills until the dispute is resolved. Paying can be construed as ratification. Key point: Using your old address is a red flag. That usually indicates data scraping or recycled lead enrollment, not a consumer-initiated action. This is not your fault. It is fixable. But it must be handled surgically and documented. If Ambetter or the Marketplace resists, escalate again and document everything. Paper trails win these cases. In many cases the threat to Department of Insurance is enough."

↳ (0): "CSR from Ambetter here. We do not have the enrollment information that you mention. Only the plan, aptc, effective date and information of the identity of the subscriber. What I do when I receive a call like this is that I call the marketplace and I assist the member to initiate a HICS case for fraud with the rep of marketplace sharing the enrollment dates we have on the system. An investigation is made by a case worker, and once the source it's confirmed was fraudulent they claim back the APTC sent to the health plan, the plan is retroactively cancelled and member receives a letter of termination from the health plan. 9 out of 10 times the fraud is confirmed. The exceptions happen because member did sign up and granted consent to a broker and forgot about it for the rewards card which the brokers did activities and the like so the member could get a few dollars, but I don't expect to see that happen because fewer people qualify for the Silver 94% plan with 0 member responsibility. To avoid that we now have to ask a \$5 dollars payment per month for those accounts that is refunded at the end of the year. Crazy stuff."

↳ (0): "You need to make two calls. One to the insurance commissioner in your state and ask for their help. Second call CMS and make a complaint, ask for the issue to be resolved."

"ACA until Medicare? I'm 63 and want to retire soon, so I would be losing my employer coverage at that time. During my employee coverage years, I chose an HDHP plan and put almost 10K into an HSA. I plan on getting the lowest cost Bronze plan and use the HSA funds to cover meds and any other coverages for the 2 years. I realize that if I have a major medical event, I'll need to cover a big deductible/out of pocket maximum, but even that would be less than \$20K per year for a comprehensive gold plan. I have a pre-existing condition, so a private plan is out of the question and my COBRA would cost \$1350/mth. The only downside I can think of with ACA is needing to adhere to the income limit to keep the subsidy for the 2 years. What else am I missing?"

— r/obamacare · 21 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qmvzcn/>

↳ (0): "Just remember, you can't use HSA funds to pay ACA premiums."

↳ (0): "> What else am I missing? If your income is controllable during this time (only LTCG, etc. And you have enough available cash in savings or investments that won't incur capital gains to sell) and you can get to 100-150% of FPL, then you should get a silver plan. Will have no deductibles and around \$1000 OOP max. Max cost sharing (lowered deductibles/OOP max) is at 100-150% FPL."

↳ (0): "Yes, only silver plans are eligible for income-based CSR (cost sharing reductions), which lower deductibles, max out of pockets, copays etc. The CSRs can make silver plans way better than gold. If you can get your MAGI (modified adjusted gross income) low enough, it is definitely worth considering silver plans."

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

↳ (0): "Cash on hand/assets only matters if you're 65 or older. You HAVE been eligible all along, and you should feel free to use your services. You're in the exact situation this social safety net is intended for....use it all you want until you find a job and get monthly income again. And no, it would not matter even if you weren't eligible. You could have knowingly lied and committed fraud to get enrolled in Medi-Cal, but if you haven't made claims Medicaid would never know or care. There's nothing spent by them to try to recover. They'd only come after you if you had claims."

↳ (0): "Medicaid goes by going forward current monthly income, not calendar year income. Previous months do not count at all, and there is no asset test for expansion Medicaid. The monthly income limit for 2022 was \$1,563 and for 2023 \$1,677 a month."

↳ (0): "Are you saying that the "cash on hand" question is basically moot and that it's ALL about monthly income?"

"COBRA denying everything? My company got sold at the end of last year, and we were all laid off. So I had a choice between going to the Marketplace or using (what I thought would be) a continuation of the same insurance under COBRA. I think it's a PPO or something like that, the higher priced one at work, with the lower deductible. The premium is viciously expensive either way, ACA or COBRA. We are older with pre-existing conditions, my spouse is self-employed, and now, so am I. A bronze plan would have been pointless. So COBRA seemed like the best decision for now. But nothing will go through. Nobody sent a different card or told me to call a different number. Am I missing something? They are turning down previously covered medications, they won't even pay for a dental bill, and the deductible is only \$50! (The COBRA included dental and vision coverage. I selected them all.) This was naturally far more expensive than my rent or any other monthly bill we've ever paid, and we'd love to be able to use it. We have had this insurance for years and it was never a problem, especially for prescriptions. Please tell me if I'm just missing something entirely. Thank you so much!"
— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1rah9t7/>

↳ (0): "Have you reached out to your COBRA administrator and make sure all the paperwork's were submitted correctly? Is your insurance saying your coverage is still active?"

↳ (0): "They must have messed up. Our COBRA operated identically to when we were employed, which is the law. worked great"

↳ (0): "What are the reasons that they're denying your claims?"

"ACA healthcare made it possible for me to retire. I keep my taxable income low and receive Gov subsidies on premiums. I consider the subsidies getting back some of the taxes I paid into the systems for the last 48 years. I had employer healthcare insurance for 30 years and never used one penny of it. Insurance companies made a mint off of my employer and me for decades. I never went to the Doctor until I turned 60 when I got Covid."
— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgzT3TgVH2azwWzdsxx4AaABAq>

↳ @DonaldSharpe-u9o (3): "I completely relate! It's amazing how planning your income and using the ACA effectively can make early retirement feasible. I went through a similar path, keeping taxable income low while investing in a few index funds and it helped me feel secure financially while also getting affordable healthcare coverage."

↳ @drcornelius8275 (0): "Well great for you that has little income but ACA is killing my family. Not only did we pay the same or more taxes than you have over the years, now we get to pay for your insurance too because ACA sticks us with huge premiums. Do you think that's fair? Why don't I just give you some of my belongs too while we're talking Communism."

↳ @bestiefswlady5251 (0): "@drcornelius8275 I thought that depended on the states. Some states chose to expand their Medicaid, which helps supplement the tax breaks for the ACA and some states decided not to. Are you paying an insurance directly or does it come from your employer (i'm not asking for anything personal or specific. I'm just curious in the broad sense of the word). I'm open to correction if I'm wrong!!!"

"Good information in a clear manner. I'll be watching for the 2024 info video. I chose to retire early and am currently doing COBRA coverage but would like to investigate ACA options for 2024."

— YouTube · Enrolling in Obamacare | 3 Mistakes to Avoid · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZBc-InJRAU&lc=UgxGoQIC4y8FhPwmrPp4AaABAg>

↳ @FoundersHealth (4): "Hi there! Thanks for watching. Happy to help look at options. We should get more information on the available plans for 2024 closer to the end of November. Just shoot me an email and we can set up a time to chat :) jo@founderslifeandhealth.com"

↳ @beachlady148 (0): "@FoundersHealthqqqqq Awa aaa"

"So a big nothing burger, that's what I expected. PBM's are not going to change. But they are a big driver of health insurance costs. I just went through it with an asthma maintenance medication. I can't stay on the one they pre-authorized. I am now on one that cost 3x as much. It makes absolutely no sense. I do care if it's effective and I don't know that yet because I haven't started it. The insurance company tried to blame a new act of Congress and then actually called me incompetent. There is no new act of Congress, they told me a bold faced lie. The act they are quoting was passed in 2022. It's because they want me on a certain medicine. It's likely not even a Dr on the insurance end, making these decisions. I think it's because the PMB managers, the middleman, get a bigger cut if it's certain prescriptions. I got a 90 day supply for zero dollars, as long as it works, I don't care. I'm at my deductible and out-of-pocket max in February 2025. I will never understand it. My husband has had 8 or 9 surgeries. He gets zero pushback and I know he's cost them well over \$1 million. And I swear every year, they go through and axe another one of my meds. I mostly just get routine care and meds, I've only had 3 operations in life and they were all 30 years ago. I had employer based health insurance then. You can't even get me to go to the ER, my husband went at least 4 times last year, by ambulance because of his heart. We don't fool around when it comes to that, his dad died at age 49 from a Widowmaker heart attack. My husband found him. They want to talk about reigning in insurance rates when they are the ones that approve them. I started looking it up on who approves the 26% average increase we have for 2026. This is above and beyond any subsidies. It is the state and federal governments that approve insurance rates. It makes no sense. And I would also guess that the CEOs/executive level people donate to political campaigns. I'd like to see what they've donated to Trump and the Republicans and even Democrats"

— r/obamacare · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pm9zyz/house_gop_unveils_health_care_measure_that_does/ntyfph9/

"It's a Catch-22. I need medical care to stay alive, but I need a W-2 job for high quality affordable medical care, but the job's killing me. I'm in my 40's, and I could afford to retire now if not for the health insurance issue. An ACA family plan is ridiculously expensive and all but the platinum plans are dog 🐕 (high premiums, very high deductibles, very high max OOP, and limited networks that don't cover the halfway decent docs and hospitals in my area). And the platinums are INSANELY expensive and still don't cover many of my needed specialists. And I can't build my HSA as I max out contributions and spending every year. I think my only hope is to try to find a super easy job (even if super low paying) with good benefits and see if I can survive another 7 years until our kids are all off the plan and my husband (self-employed) qualifies for Medicare. Or 5 years if I pay for COBRA for the last 2 years..."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwc78xLI9v11PhI6QR4AaABAg>

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pedcpv/>

↳ (0): "Are you in nyc? I switched to Ambetter Silver for next year bc Anthem is going to be out of network with

Mt Sinai. Hoping I can use most of my Sinai dr's"

↳ (0): "I kind of want to vomit because it's so upsetting that this experience was a "positive" one. But I also get it because the bar is SO low. Like the other commenter I was considering switching because of Sinai system dropping Anthem and most of my doctors being through them. I know the Sinai urgent care I go to sometimes said they will take it but they take HealthFirst also. I'm really not sure which one to choose..."

↳ (0): "Do you know if NYU Langone and its doctors are covered?"

"Getting blood work on ACA plans Not a huge deal in the grand scheme of things, but I generally get blood work once a year, so it's a predictable medical expense. This year it cost \$286 and I had to pay \$36 out of pocket with my employer provided health care plan. My doctor's office has a sign that basically says they test the blood in house but will provide a script if you want it sent to Quest or Lab Corp. When I look at my claims, the provider name is different than my doctor's office despite what the sign says. When I look up those providers, only one insurance company in the marketplace covers those. So I assume that means on the other plans, they would be out of network and I'd have to pay the full cost since they are HMOs and don't cover out of network. Is it possible there will be a discount even though it's out of network? I then looked up Quest on the marketplace, it looks like every city's location is listed and I see some are covered and some aren't with some plans (some don't cover any locations). But I assume I don't have control over which location my blood is sent to. So is there any way to ensure they are going to be covered. Is there any practical tips for how to handle this with the ACA plans or does it just depend on which insurance company we pick and can you figure out which is the best before you sign up?"

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vdjrvh/getting_blood_work_on_a_ca_plans/

↳ mtnagel (6): "So it looks like Ohio has a law (R.C. § 3902.51 / HB 388) against surprise billing where you go to your in-network doctor, blood is drawn there, and the specimen gets routed to a lab you had no ability to choose. Ohio's rule is that cost-sharing is limited to the amount you'd pay for in-network services. So many I'm worrying for nothing, but that seems like a hassle to deal with."

↳ Zphr (4): "Yes, it should hopefully be a non-issue. If the provider is in-network and they do the labs in-house, then regardless of the legalities of their business structure the labs should be in-network too. Anything else would be an invitation to financially exploit patients and insurers, which state regulators and legislators are rarely a fan of."

↳ Zphr (3): "Perhaps it's a state/regional thing, but the office should automatically be routing your labs to whoever is in-network with your insurance. We have been getting annual bloodwork done for multiple people with a variety of ACA insurers/policies/providers for 12 years now and have never had an issue with labwork being ruled out-of-network."

"Appreciate the info: I just looked at ACA plans for the first time last week. My wife and I are 24 months from being retired, and our combined pensions will make us ineligible for ACA subsidies (as they currently stand). Just understanding how much COBRA, ACA, or private insurance will cost us (we still have dependents under age 26), is a planning tool. If ACA cliff remains, we could end up paying \$200,000+ for health insurance between retirement and Medicare!,"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E&lc=Ugzvm7yxUJFtCV1gSbV4AaABAg>

↳ @EliavD-d5e (0): "Now I've hit \$270,590. I was having this exact conversation with my son the other night- generational wealth isn't just about getting money. It's about teaching everyone not only how to make it, but also how to maintain it. It does no good for me to provide for my family if they don't understand how to manage and sustain it."

↳ @JasonGoetze (0): "Well. A big thanks to Lady Charlotte Parnell - really appreciate her. She's honestly one of the smartest and most supportive people I've ever learned from. Her mindset and the way she explains things changed everything for me"

↳ @JoelDiaz-y6k (0): "What I like about her is her logic behind every undertaking and her ability to make a good profit regardless of the starting investment amount. Imagine having 30,850 from my 5,000 investment."

"I had expensive, crappy insurance with my last job, and now expensive crappy COBRA coverage. Ahhmerica"

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Quit Your Job! · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eD0r4XtsotU&lc=UgxjKmKLMhVnEDYkOCi4AaABAg>

↳ @TheMedicineCouch (2): "I hear you! I personally think that health insurance companies are terrible, raking in billions in profit every year, while charging high premiums and denying coverage. However, that is the system we are stuck in right now. ☹️ I wonder, do you talk with anyone to see if you could get something better/less expensive?"

↳ @jt3013 (2): "@TheMedicineCouch I've tried. My uncle is an insurance agent. Unfortunately this is the system we have"

↳ @TheMedicineCouch (1): "😞 I figured you had, just thought I would check."

"yup me too. and this letter was actually when I had employer health insurance but it was a "self funded plan" which basically meant they spent a lot of time trying to find reasons to deny you."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lz67ob/reminder_what_life_was_like_before_affordable/n2zug9e/

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

↳ @TracyMadsen-rx2fu (0): "I think you might need a different broker, that's not true. I have a silver plan PPO, have had it for about 7 years"

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

↳ wischywaschy (3): "I can't really help but I also have massive problems with IBX (self-funded plan) with an appeal process and the DOL is trying to help. IBX is a mess - it looks like they don't follow all ERISA regulations and seem very disorganized. The DOL is helpful but they are really short-staffed since they got DOGE'd, so whatever they can do for us is slow. They said to me they can do more when more people complain, so please

complain!"

↳ budrow21 (2): "I would file the appeals directly and continue working through the DoL. You don't have many other options."

↳ theoretalking (2): "Have you tried asking your employer's benefit manager and the broker to follow up with the account manager at IBX since she has not been responsive? The most people you got pushing and fighting for you, the better. sounds like you called your state's DOL? Try the US DOL here: <https://beta.dol.gov/about/agencies/ebsa/ask-ebsa> Have you tried looking up ERISA lawyers on Google? When I did that, I see a bunch lawyers that specialize in ERISA show up. It seems most (or not all) of them offer free consultation. I suggest you try that to find someone in your region."

HealthCare.gov or the state exchange on their own · 104 documents · 20 voices

"ACA isn't so affordable Long story short, we'll be losing our healthcare come June. My wife has inherited a long list of health issues, and has been hospitalized 5x since January, anywhere from a week to 2 at a time. Essentially she's been hospitalized for 2 of the last 3 months in total. There's no end in sight for this. I make 62,500 a year, and she made 70,000 a year prior to this, providing insurance from her job as well. She'll be down to whatever SSDI is come June, and has made 60% of her normal wages thus far. I estimate our income at about 90k per year after this. My job is for a semi small family company, and our insurance is ok, but asks about pre-existing conditions. I tried marketplace which said if our income was below 108k per year we qualified for discounts! Yeah no. It's at a minimum \$12k per year in premiums, plus \$18k max out of pockets. I don't know about you, but it's a bit difficult paying 30 grand per year on a 90k income BEFORE taxes. And she will absolutely max the out of pocket week one. These stays are ICU stays, we're already in the millions. If you factor out taxes, we're left with about \$70k, giving me 40k for her, myself, and our 1 year old. This sucks. My only other option would be a divorce, and since her only income would be social security she would then qualify for Medicaid, but I guess that takes 2 years after you have a disability."

— r/HealthInsurance · 323 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jtjbsg/>

↳ (0): "Your ACA subsidy is based of MAGI and not your W2 income. So you may be eligible for a larger ACA subsidy. Your spouse may be eligible for Medicare irrespective of her age, if she is eligible for SSDI"

↳ (0): "The \$18,000 maximum out of pockets is the only place that I know I have some advise on. You can apply for financial assistance wherever you get care. If you have a remaining balance after they award you financial assistance on your bill, you can make payments. For medications, you can use co-payment cards or have the medications donated to your family as you need. For it to be donated, there is a process to apply, but much less intensive than a bonafide medical bill from a hospital or physician's office. If you are able to utilize co-payment cards for the medications your family needs, it does eat at your out of pocket and deductible under some plans. For me, it has eaten roughly \$3,000.00 of my out of pocket so far, alone."

↳ (0): "The 18K is the family max, the individual out of pocket max is more like 9K. So if she is the major consumer of health care the 9K number is more applicable."

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s4qs2m/>

↳ (0): "Your husband absolutely needs to find a different new job or you do. Going without insurance is way too risky"

↳ (0): "Try to think of it this way: you can't afford not to have insurance through your employer. Also, you're not going to get much sympathy about having to pay 840 per month for 3 people."

↳ (0): "I saw you commented below you have a combined household income of roughly \$93,000. I don't know what zip code you live in, but just picking a random zip code in Kansas City, there are multiple bronze plans for both your husband and daughter in the range of \$550 per month. I believe you may be entering something in on healthcare.gov incorrectly. If your employer does not offer 'affordable' insurance per the ACA-guidelines, you could also qualify for ACA subsidies as well"

"I had to retire due to medical issues at 55 so we had to go with Marketplace. It's been pretty good, our premiums are under \$150 per month for 2 people and our deductible for family was \$800. No HSA is allowed but we created a medical bucket in our high yield savings account and just transfer money as needed. We keep our income below \$60,000 too. I fear big changes are coming for 2026 though. Guess we will cross that bridge when it comes. God bless all!"

— YouTube · Want to Retire Early? HERE ARE 4 OPTIONS FOR HEALTH INSURANCE! · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOIjsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAg>

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Yes, it is likely that we will see largely increased premiums in the upcoming year. We will release a video previewing 2026 plans soon! Thank you for your comment."

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q8a0os/>

↳ (0): "Are you sure it's because of the raise? To me it seems more likely that it is due to the price of the second lowest plan changing which then changes the subsidies for everything else. If it's truly due to a \$1 raise, you can take that \$1/hour and invest it in an IRA and reduce your income back to what it was."

↳ (0): "The increase may not be because of the raise. The premiums have increased as such from 2025 to 2026."

↳ (0): "It will probably be easier to find a new job that either pays even more or offers health insurance than to find a decent health insurance plan for \$100 per month. Start asking around for employers in your area that offer great health insurance to employees. I recommend trying local colleges and universities. They are like little mini city states so they hire people who do everything (from landscaping, to painting, to electrical repairs, to finance, to food service, to event planning). I work for a university and my health insurance plan is an \$85 per month premium."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: <https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>;

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

"I don't have that obamacare , I got mine on the exchange /s"

— r/obamacare · 50 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ofrwic/the_new_aca_rates_will_post_next_saturday_and_all/nlbnrvr/

"Is It Better to not Have Health Insurance or Choose a Very Expensive Plan? So these are the issues that we're facing if we have to choose a marketplace plan. Would you guys rather risk it and go without, or pay a lot for a plan? Here's my potential plan with a 50k income: BCBS PPO, 700/month, 9800 deductible, 11000 max oop. It would eat up my income, but if I don't have any major surgeries or a trip to the ER, then I'd be fine without. However, I'd hate to be uninsured if something happens. Realistically, what would you do? Can hospitals negotiate the price down if a bill is very expensive?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 47 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1p965n4/>

↳ (0): "My 64 year old brother was very healthy and never had to go to the doctor for anything until he was recently diagnosed with stage 4 lung cancer. If he didn't have health insurance m he'd likely go bankrupt. Don't take any chances."

↳ (0): "Chances are, he still will. >60% of medical bankruptcies held "full" insurance."

↳ (0): "For years I was someone who barely used any of my healthcare benefits. After I got bad results on a mammogram it set off a series of tests that had me halfway to my high deductible in six hours. The sticker price of my healthcare costs in the past year have exceeded a quarter million dollars and that is for a straightforward case of breast cancer. If I had been uninsured I would have gone without many of the tests, procedures, and medications I've received and even if the hospital had accepted 10% it would have exceeded the cost of my insurance premium, even after upgrading to Gold for 2025. If it's all you can afford, get the cheapest plan the marketplace has to offer. Even if it seems like it won't cover anything. If you really need it, it will cover plenty."

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

↳ Stomoyuki (49): "Medicaid eligibility limits your access to Marketplace subsidies, which is why [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling you to apply for Medicaid. My first question is why the out-of-state hospitals won't "accept" PA Medicaid. Medicaid generally provides limited out-of-state coverage, so are they looking for something beyond basic coverage for yourself? Also, you're probably not the first student in your school encountering this issue. I'd contact the student affairs/financial aid office and ask them what they recommend in your situation. They may provide hardship resources you can utilize."

↳ emacs guy (30): "Thanks for the replies, but I think I'm just going to sign up with PA State Medicaid. They will cover life threatening ER out of state but nothing else. Which should be fine, I won't be out state maybe just 4 months max. I just hope I won't get hassled by some of the hospitals if asked. I'll just deal with it then."

↳ LizzieMac123 (13): "Healthcare.gov plan but you'll have to pay full price with no income if youre not allowed to have out of state medicaid in your program."

"I've just realized that my Ambetter ACA plan is dogsh1t First I see a primary care physician who doesn't want to continue to prescribe the maintenance sleep Rx that I have been on for over 30 years, telling me that I should see a psychiatrist. So I call up Ambetter saying this, but what do you know, there are only 3 psychiatrists in the plan, and none of them want to deal with anyone having insomnia issues. I have put in an escalation with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) to allow me to get another plan (Blue Cross), which although it is \$300/m more, has my current primary-care physician in network. I have escalated wthis with Ambetter, and they are "working on it:, although they have not found a psychiatrist that will work out. I will be seeing my old doc as self-pay (\$130), also getting the Rx on my own. What the h3ll am I paying the \$80/mo for my plan for such garbage. And the ironic thing is that when I was on Medicaid, my primary-care physician was in network (I still had to pay for my Rx, since Medicaid doesn't pay for that Rx either)."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/

↳ FoxontheRun2023 (43): "You really shouldn't complain about \$80. Try paying \$850/mo for a dogshat plan."

↳ False-Can-6608 (17): "I thought the same. I feel for you, I'm over here ticked about paying \$427 a month. It is Ambetter. And I like it. Had cancer treatment in '24 and '25. No complaints. It was \$220 a month before we lost the subsidies."

↳ Sarduci (11): "\$80 a month for a plan is cheap. I was paying \$1400 a month for a \$13k deductible for 5 people. I would LOVE to have been paying only \$400 a month."

"ACA rates went down for us?? My wife and I have used healthcare.gov for 4 years now. This past year our rates were \$620 a month. We just Checked and according to healthcare.gov our new rates for the same insurance (ambetter gold tier) is \$295 a month. I was expecting it to rise substantially. We are in Arkansas, 63 and 61 yrs old. Anyone else see a decrease???"

— r/HealthInsurance · 30 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1onsnms/>

↳ (0): "Did your income go down? All else equal to last year you likely should have seen an increase."

↳ (0): "Subsidies are based on the 2nd lowest cost silver plan. It's called the benchmark plan. It's possible that the benchmark plan is substantially more costly, which would change your subsidy. I'm guessing that's what you'll find. Your subsidy is more than it was last year.... Unless you had some other change. Income, county you live in, stopped smoking, dropped a dependent, etc etc..."

↳ (0): "Yes to this. Our costs will be much less next year (assuming we can keep under the cliff) due to our subsidy being about \$500 higher based on the second lowest cost silver plan. This is in CT, but I would bet that's what's up for OP as well."

"Told it's fraud to have Marketplace and ACA-compliant Employer Insurance at the same time. Is this correct? I'm like a 5 year old when it comes to insurance things. So apologies if this is obvious. I currently have employer-offered health insurance. Per ACA it's considered affordable and it meets the minimum standards. I want to purchase an insurance plan through the Illinois marketplace exchange and have both at the same time. I do not qualify, nor was I trying to get, subsidies, tax credits or discounts. I would be paying whatever is considered full price on the exchange. In trying to get more details from a broker, explaining what I said above, he said that it'd be fraud to have both. A customer service agent through the chat on getcoveredillinois told me that I could only get secondary insurance. That all they offered in the marketplace was primary insurance, and since I had my employer-offered health insurance, and it met the ACA requirements, I could not take on another primary insurance, only secondary. And well they don't offer secondary. Is secondary insurance a different type of insurance? I thought what made it secondary is that I had another plan that was primary, not that it was a specific type of insurance. Is it correct that marketplace insurance plans are primary only? Can I get individual health insurance outside of the marketplace while still having my employer-provided insurance? The enrollment period ends today and have been going back and forth for weeks about this. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 28 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qsd3bg/>

↳ (0): "Why are you trying to do this? What's your goal?"

↳ (0): "This is the right question!"

↳ (0): "It sounds like you're looking to get a secondary plan as your work plan is primary and doesn't provide the treatments you're wanting. If you go this route make sure that the secondary plan will cover non-covered charges from the primary plan. I've seen a lot of secondary plans that won't cover if the primary doesn't even if the plan normally would"

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

↳ (0): "This happens more often than people realize, and no, you are not crazy. Agents or lead generators are motivated by sales. Your agreement and signature are required. What probably occurred is a Marketplace enrollment was completed without your informed consent, often by a third-party agent or lead generator out of need to meet quotas or just greed. Checking eligibility alone does not authorize enrollment. Actual enrollment requires affirmative plan selection and attestation. If that did not occur, this is improper enrollment. Here is what you do, in order. First, call Ambetter immediately and demand the following in writing: • The original application • The agent or broker of record • The date and method of enrollment • The address used and who supplied it • Whether premium tax credits were applied Tell them explicitly you dispute the enrollment as unauthorized and demand a retroactive cancellation to the effective date. Use the phrase unauthorized enrollment without consent. That language matters. Second, contact HealthCare.gov and request a Marketplace case escalation. Ask them to flag the policy as fraudulent enrollment. This is not customer service. This is an eligibility integrity issue. Third, file a complaint with your state Department of Insurance. This creates regulatory pressure and forces documentation. Insurers and agents move fast once DOI is involved. Fourth, protect your tax position. If any premium tax credit was applied, you need a corrected 1095-A showing zero coverage. Otherwise the IRS assumes you accepted subsidized coverage and will claw it back. Fifth, do not pay the bills until the dispute is resolved. Paying can be construed as ratification. Key point: Using your old address is a red flag. That usually indicates data scraping or recycled lead enrollment, not a consumer-initiated action. This is not your fault. It is fixable. But it must be handled surgically and documented. If Ambetter or the Marketplace resists, escalate again and document everything. Paper trails win these cases. In many cases the threat to Department of Insurance is enough."

↳ (0): "CSR from Ambetter here. We do not have the enrollment information that you mention. Only the plan, aptc, effective date and information of the identity of the subscriber. What I do when I receive a call like this is that I call the marketplace and I assist the member to initiate a HICS case for fraud with the rep of marketplace sharing the enrollment dates we have on the system. An investigation is made by a case worker, and once the source it's confirmed was fraudulent they claim back the APTC sent to the health plan, the plan is retroactively cancelled and member receives a letter of termination from the health plan. 9 out of 10 times the fraud is confirmed. The exceptions happen because member did sign up and granted consent to a broker and forgot about it for the rewards card which the brokers did activities and the like so the member could get a few dollars, but I don't expect to see that happen because fewer people qualify for the Silver 94% plan with 0 member responsibility. To avoid that we now have to ask a \$5 dollars payment per month for those accounts that is refunded at the end of the year. Crazy stuff."

↳ (0): "You need to make two calls. One to the insurance commissioner in your state and ask for their help. Second call CMS and make a complaint, ask for the issue to be resolved."

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

↳ (0): "The insurance isnt going to agree to a network exception for your preferred provider. They would have to have the provider sign documents indicating they would agree to accept in network rates, and usually they wont proactively try to set that up unless the provider reaches out to them first. While the process exists, the likelihood of them approving it is extremely low. You can ask for a care manager or case manager. Thats a decent recommendation. They should be able to find you a provider that can actually treat you. Theres a good chance some of the providers were incorrect when they said they dont take marketplace plans, though its possible they were right and the insurance has an outdated directory, but 20 providers in a row seems unlikely. You wont be able to change your plan outside open enrollment. No better way other than contacting your insurance directly, unfortunately."

↳ (0): "Best advice here! Also OP - even *if* you could get your insurance to pay in-network rates (and you may be able to if for some reason there is in-fact no providers) - doing so doesn't prevent the provider from still balance-billing you what insurance doesn't pay due to the lack of contract."

↳ (0): "I would do both options. And also, I would report the insurance company and plan to your state Department of insurance. The insurance companies benefit from having fake doctors on their plans."

"Ironically when I had health insurance through the marketplace, it was very cheap (because I was on a lower income due to working PRN), yet it was an incredible policy that covered so much more compared to the insurance I have now through my full time job. It almost seems like marketplace insurance is way better than most insurance received through an employer. I find that many insurance policies offered to employees in healthcare are often pretty pitiful policies, which is ironic because we're supposed to be practicing what we preach by being of good health and going for checkups etc."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Quit Your Job! · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eD0r4XtsotU&lc=UgxxwMkpr8W0qGofaUm14AaABAg>

↳ @TheMedicineCouch (3): "That's terrible to hear. I've worked locums for so many years now that I don't really have experience with employer insurance lately. I don't know what's going to happen in our system as costs keep rising and insurance companies keep finding ways to reduce coverage! Unfortunately, I don't see great times ahead for healthcare."

↳ @user-hn9qg5qm3o (3): "@TheMedicineCouchWhat other field do you think is much better than healthcare? I find so many younger people headed away from traditional college/university route and going for trades, but there's often a lot of hard head dudes that will bully you to death in those fields too. Grass isn't always greener elsewhere either. I sometimes think trying to find purpose in life through a career is a huge mistake."

↳ @user-hn9qg5qm3o (0): "@TheMedicineCouchCan you elaborate more on "I don't see great times ahead in healthcare." Is it a good time to get out of it? I sometimes watch this guy: https://youtu.be/bwXCLxwf_FA?si=AX8lr5pVibVBULiP";

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1inzqe8/>

↳ (0): "The income limits for Medicaid for pregnant women and new children is much higher, once your child turns 1 the income requirements change, wife is no longer considered in the postpartum period. If your wife was pregnant, or had just recently had the baby (within the last 3 months usually) when you signed up for coverage then they most likely gave baby needy newborn coverage, and wife MAGI pregnant coverage. Children born to mothers on Medicaid get guaranteed eligibility till 1 year old under expanded medicaid rules. Once baby is a year old, child and mother go back to medicaid children, and medicaid adult guidelines. If you make 65k per year you earn too much. If they lost coverage you have the right to apply for marketplace coverage outside of open enrollment period with a qualifying life event. Edit- spelling Edit- I have seen and reported blatant Medicaid fraud on numerous occasions within my job, I've seen hundreds of cases of people 100% committing fraud without a doubt. Income gets reported and they call and say they quit, income is ended, a few months later same thing. I have seen 100s of income discrepancies on one case, client never asked to provide proof, or any information about income and the fact they are no longer employed. I've completed 100s of application, I've worked 1,000s of medicaid cases, never ever seen any fraud cases. Only fraud cases I've seen are with SNAP, which they seem to take much more seriously. Medicaid fraud is expensive for tax payers when it's committed by providers, it's not usually bothered with when committed by individuals. It sounds like your situation is very different, there is proof regarding what you did with the recorded phone call, and the marketplace application you submitted. I think you have no reason to worry about them coming after you for fraud."

↳ (0): "I've read Missouri Medicaid has terrible backups in processing. Just make sure you have records of your transactions with them. <https://missouriindependent.com/2024/06/17/feds-to-scrutinize-missouris-worst-in-the-nation-medicaid-application-delays/>";

↳ (0): "Well that's just it. I have no records. My application was done 100% over the phone with a representative who never requested any documents. She messed up over the phone. And six months later when I went to fill out a change in income form, I did it at their office and turned it in. And they have no records of that either so they don't have one document from me and they approved me. All I have is an application number from before I was approved. 100% verbal with zero documentation."

"COBRA denying everything? My company got sold at the end of last year, and we were all laid off. So I had a choice between going to the Marketplace or using (what I thought would be) a continuation of the same insurance under COBRA. I think it's a PPO or something like that, the higher priced one at work, with the lower deductible. The premium is viciously expensive either way, ACA or COBRA. We are older with pre-existing conditions, my spouse is self-employed, and now, so am I. A bronze plan would have been pointless. So COBRA seemed like the best decision for now. But nothing will go through. Nobody sent a different card or told me to call a different number. Am I missing something? They are turning down previously covered medications, they won't even pay for a dental bill, and the deductible is only \$50! (The COBRA included dental and vision coverage. I selected them all.) This was naturally far more expensive than my rent or any other monthly bill we've ever paid, and we'd love to be able to use it. We have had this insurance for years and it was never a problem, especially for prescriptions. Please tell me if I'm just missing something entirely. Thank you so much!"
— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1rah9t7/>

↳ (0): "Have you reached out to your COBRA administrator and make sure all the paperwork's were submitted correctly? Is your insurance saying your coverage is still active?"

↳ (0): "They must have messed up. Our COBRA operated identically to when we were employed, which is the law. worked great"

↳ (0): "What are the reasons that they're denying your claims?"

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1lwkch/>

↳ (0): "It's a class H felony in NC for a provider that accepts medicaid (opted in) to take out of pocket payment for services that would be covered under medicaid. Say you went to a dentist that accepted it, they can only bill you for procedures not covered under medicaid like a crown. They wouldn't be able to bill you for services that are covered under medicaid like a cavity filing. If they never opted in to accept medicaid, then it is not fraud. They never agreed to medicaid terms and conditions at all. If you are concerned, before you do anything, you can always call NCDOL or medicaid and make sure you are okay."

↳ (0): "Yes, it can be. Medicaid is for people who cannot pay their own medical expenses. If you show that you have means to pay for your own medical expenses, the state will assume you do not need Medicaid and have been fraudulently receiving benefits. In my state (MD), there are some Medicaid MCOs that do not require referrals from your PCP to receive specialty care. If you are healthy enough to not need to be followed by a PCP, then it matters a lot less if you cannot find one."

↳ (0): "And provider (practitioner/facility) that is contracted with Medicaid must sign a participation agreement that includes the following: In accordance with 10A NCAC 22J .0106 Providers may bill a patient accepted as a Medicaid patient only in the following situations: For allowable deductibles, co-insurance, or co-payments; Before the service is provided the provider has informed the patient that the patient may be billed for a service that is not one covered by Medicaid regardless of the type of provider or is beyond the limits on Medicaid services; The patient is 65 years of age or older and is enrolled in the Medicare program at the time services are received but has failed to supply a Medicare number as proof of coverage; or The patient is no longer eligible for Medicaid as defined in 10A NCAC 21B."

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/ysinnk/>

↳ (0): "I wonder if the sales agent had ulterior motives (difference in commission?)"

↳ (0): "It definitely sounded fishy when I heard it. Thanks"

↳ (0): "Buy on marketplace plan. Direct is not subject to the ACA regulations."

"Help! ACA plan termination notice after reporting a change-in-life event I just received a notice today that my ACA plan has been terminated effective October stating "voluntary withdrawal" even though I never requested this, and I have always paid on time. For the life of me I cannot figure out why. The only thing I can figure out is that this is due to me reporting my daughter as married (by reporting the event as a change-of-life event). This was to remove just her, not all of us. I called [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) and they are escalating this, but I'm worried that it won't get fixed. I asked the agent and she says this happens a lot so I'm wondering if anyone else has experienced this when it wasn't due to non-payment. Does anyone have any experience with this? My son is a hemophiliac and I'm worried that I need to start looking for a new job so that I can get other coverage. BTW: I'm not getting tax credits, in case that is relevant."

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmwnck/help_aca_plan_termination_notice_after_reporting/

↳ FollowtheYBRoad (2): "Who did the notice come from? If from the insurance company, call them tomorrow and let them know that you didn't cancel. If you called [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and removed only your daughter, did you have them repeat back to you exactly what you wanted to happen?"

↳ boltyboy69 (2): "<https://thehealthcareblog.com/blog/2025/12/08/health-insurance-cancel-culture/>";

↳ LukeMurphey (1): "It was from the insurance company. That is a good point about calling them. I will do that tomorrow. What is weird is the representative pushed through a change in my application and now the ACA eligibility results says that I'm not eligible to choose a plan while at the same time saying that my coverage is ending. You may be onto something that the issue was with the insurance company all along."

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pedcpv/>

↳ (0): "Are you in nyc? I switched to Ambetter Silver for next year bc Anthem is going to be out of network with

Mt Sinai. Hoping I can use most of my Sinai dr's"

↳ (0): "I kind of want to vomit because it's so upsetting that this experience was a "positive" one. But I also get it because the bar is SO low. Like the other commenter I was considering switching because of Sinai system dropping Anthem and most of my doctors being through them. I know the Sinai urgent care I go to sometimes said they will take it but they take HealthFirst also. I'm really not sure which one to choose..."

↳ (0): "Do you know if NYU Langone and its doctors are covered?"

Medicaid or CHIP · 101 documents · 20 voices

"Fuck this country's health insurance I've dislocated both my kneecaps, now they're loose and unstable. I genuinely cannot mentally or emotionally go through that type of pain again. I've been desperately trying to buy health insurance, I missed the united healthcare deadline to enroll for 2025 because I didn't have the fucking money, I don't qualify for medicaid, I have health insurance offered through my job but didn't accept it because the insurance is \$240 (9.02% of my income) at the cheapest, and i'm barely scraping by as it is. But that gives me the kicker of not qualifying for tax credits for healthcare marketplace insurances. I genuinely have not taken my knee braces off for more than 20 minutes in three days, I cry nearly every night because of this shit. I feel like i have no choice or the ones i have are absolute shit. Pay \$300+ in health insurance, pay out of pocket for all healthcare costs and go into medical debt that i can't pay, or wait over six months and just let my knee issues get worse before i can enroll into my jobs health insurance again. I am 20 years old and have done no sports, nothing, absolutely nothing, to cause issues in my knees. And now, i live in constant fucking fear that i will end up screaming on the ground again and apparently can't do shit about it. What in the actual fuck is america"

— r/HealthInsurance · 614 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hmjm0o/>

↳ (0): "You know, \$240 for insurance you can actually use? Isn't bad at all. The new Medicare premium for 2025 is \$185. And that? Is for insurance that's about as useful as tits on a nun, and doesn't include vision or dental coverage. Secondly, the Marketplace is open for enrollment until January 15th: https://www.healthcare.gov/subscriber/?gad_source=1&gclid=CjwKCAiAmrS7BhBJEiwAei59i9Oacg0wxG2w-ZA-CIWv7rQmP1f88oKN4m5i8AvwQGxt-DXXSOE0lhoCgioQAvD_BwE&gclsrc=aw.ds You are still eligible for Marketplace coverage and subsidies if: 1. Your employer-offered insurance is more than 9.12% of your annual income, or the lowest-cost option to cover your family is 9.12% of your household's total income. 2. Your employer-offered insurance doesn't meet ACA standards (which is defined generally as those that offer coverage for doctors and hospitals, and generally pay for 60% of medical costs). If you don't qualify for Medicaid? It's because your income is too high to do so. I don't know what to tell you. It sounds like you rolled the dice, took a chance, and lost."

↳ (0): "13 years working in the world of the Affordable Care Act 8 Years of Provider Services dealing with Medical Professionals 7 Years of Customer Service dealing with individuals' questions on claims and benefits 5 years of Medical Claim Processing So what state do you live in? Does your state have a State-Run Health Insurance Marketplace? My state is still in OPEN ENROLLMENT to enroll in a Health Insurance Plan for 2025 with an effective date of February 1, 2025. The deadline for a January 1 Effective date has passed; the deadline line is midnight December 15, 2024. I am not able to use the tools I have to determine if you are eligible for Tax Subsidies to enroll in a healthcare plan with financial assistance. Your age, yearly income, or Adjusted Gross Income, the tax structure of your household, married, children, filing single, etc, are needed to determine this. Secondly, your Employer offers you a health insurance plan (ESI). Most ESI plans meet the Qualified Health Insurance standard (QHP), as set forth by the Affordable Care Act (ACA). There are two things that a QHP must meet A: They must meet "MINIMUM ESSENTIAL VALUE" - which means a healthcare plan must pay at least 60% of all claims AFTER the deductible is met B: They must meet MINIMUM ESSENTIAL COVERAGE" - meaning they MUST cover the 10 essential health care benefits as outlined in the ACA Law they are, Routine Yearly Physical Walk-In Clinic Services Emergency Room Services Laboratory Services - testing blood, Urine Testing, Biopsy services Pharmacy Mental Health Services both in-patient and out-patient Ambulance Services Prenatal Services (I don't remember them all but these are the most important) Without knowing what your employer plan looks like meaning What does it cost per pay period and what would you pay per pay period What is the Deductible on that plan and what is the Max Out of Pocket Expense on that plan ... is the ESI going to cost you more than 9.07% of your income? ...is the ESI plan just an HSA plan? I like BIG HUGE examples to make a point. Let us assume that your ESI plan reads something like this Yearly Deductible: 10,000 Yearly Max Out of Pocket Expense: \$15,000... You get injured, you get transported by ambulance, to the ER

then to Surgery, then to a recovery room, then 5 nights in a hospital with physical therapy, medications, etc...and the total amount owed to the hospital and providers on the day of discharge is \$2 Million. If you were enrolled in the ESI plan, the MOST you pay is \$15,000. Everything else is covered at 100%, you are only responsible for \$15,000. - if the same thing happened again just 4 months later or 2 months later, the total expense you would need to pay is \$0. More information is needed to guide you."

↳ (0): "Non of OPs post makes any sense. They are fishing for upvotes."

"2026 ACA prices are live on Healthcare.gov. Here's our household's official ACA pricing for next year. **Special disclaimer for 2026: Everything in this post assumes that Congress does not extend the COVID subsidy enhancements and that the default ACA subsidy rules return for 2026.** Anyone can now see the 2026 prices and plans in their area with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. If you have a local state-run exchange, then you'll be redirected. State exchanges all update on their own schedule, so 2026 prices may or may not be live just yet. For those who may not be familiar with the ACA, below is an actual real-world example of what being on the ACA can be like with the default subsidy systems. The prices below are for a married couple with an average age of 52 and with MAGI under 133% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL), which qualifies us for the maximum possible amount of ACA subsidies from both the premium tax credit (PTC) subsidy system and cost-sharing reduction (CSR) subsidy system. We have three dependent children as well, one of which will be on our ACA policy, and we live in a non-expansion state, so expansion Medicaid does not apply to us. Keep in mind that the premiums below would be much higher for a couple if they were in their 60s rather than in their 40s/50s like us. Tobacco users can expect to pay up to 50% additional premium on top of the age-rating. If we were both 62, then the unsubsidized Bronze premium below would rise from \$19,140 to \$27,168. Prices also can vary incredibly between states. If we were both 62 and living in West Virginia instead of Texas, then our Bronze premium would rise from \$27,168 to \$49,584. If instead we were living in Minnesota, then our Bronze premium would fall from \$27,168 to \$21,696. I have also included the policy options we would likely take if we were either eligible only for premium subsidies and not also cost-sharing reductions, as well as the plan we would likely take if we were ineligible for any subsidies at all. People who are over 200% FPL should generally avoid Silver plans due to the way states have elected to deal with the loss of federal funding for the cost-sharing reduction subsidy system, so while I have provided the full market price of our Silver plan, please note that almost nobody would want to ever buy that plan at that price as better Bronze and Gold options are available. ____ Our 2026 Silver plan with subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (based purely on MAGI): * \$84 in annual premium * \$0/\$0 deductible (individual/family) * \$0 PCP * \$10 specialist * \$5 urgent care * \$0/\$15 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$2,200/\$4,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ Our 2026 Silver plan without subsidies and cost-sharing reductions (full market price): * \$26,892 in annual premium * \$6,000/\$12,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$40 PCP * \$80 specialist * \$60 urgent care * \$20/\$40 tier1/tier2 scripts * 40% ER coinsurance * \$8,900/\$17,800 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 Gold plan we would pick if our MAGI was just above 200% FPL (no meaningful CSRs): * \$2,952 in annual premium * \$2,000/\$4,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$30 PCP * \$60 specialist * \$45 urgent care * \$15/\$30 tier1/tier2 scripts * 25% ER coinsurance * \$8,200/\$16,400 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____ The 2026 HSA-compatible Bronze plan we would pick if we qualified for zero subsidies/CSRs (MAGI above 400% FPL, factoring in max MAGI-reducing HSA contributions) * \$19,140 in annual premium * \$7,500/\$15,000 deductible (individual/family) * \$50 PCP * \$100 specialist * \$75 urgent care * \$25/\$50 tier1/tier2 scripts * 50% ER coinsurance * \$10,000/\$20,000 MaxOOP (individual/family) ____"

— r/obamacare · 567 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj4ejj/2026_aca_prices_are_live_on_healthcaregov_heres/

↳ bourbonfan1647 (68): "Elections have consequences. None of this is a surprise. Welcome to the "find out" phase..."

↳ Stop-Looking_For_Me (48): "Well here it is. The numbers don't lie. Healthcare is going to be fun next year for everyone."

↳ Redtoolbox1 (41): "But the billionaires got their tax cuts they so desperately needed 🙌"

"I had to retire due to medical issues at 55 so we had to go with Marketplace. It's been pretty good, our premiums are under \$150 per month for 2 people and our deductible for family was \$800. No HSA is allowed but we created a medical bucket in our high yield savings account and just transfer money as needed. We keep our income below \$60,000 too. I fear big changes are coming for 2026 though. Guess we will cross that bridge when it comes. God bless all!"

— YouTube · Want to Retire Early? HERE ARE 4 OPTIONS FOR HEALTH INSURANCE! · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOIjsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAg>

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Yes, it is likely that we will see largely increased premiums in the upcoming year. We will release a video previewing 2026 plans soon! Thank you for your comment."

"The key to avoiding high healthcare costs is to be healthy. I've been self-employed for over 16 years and have the ACA since it came out. I pick the cheapest plan which gives my coverage in case of an emergency and all my wellness care. I pay \$131 per month for a bronze plan. I have paid up to \$270 per month in past higher earning years. I pay out of pocket for things not covered if I need them and get a 45% self pay discount. I don't pay a lot for healthcare per year and focus on being active and eating healthy non processed foods. I pay less on medical costs than many pay for insurance alone per year. This has been my way to not fund a ridiculously priced industry. I'm nearing 59. Protect your health at all costs!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvoxJEWGo&lc=UgxcstwBmYAJgMrsGvh4AaABAg>

↳ @sct4040 (12): "Accidents happen too."

↳ @vogeljennifer6318 (8): "Although this is a great mindset, some people don't have the ability to undo medical issues that require care"

↳ @kona6451 (0): "How old are you? That sounds really cheap"

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

↳ Stomoyuki (49): "Medicaid eligibility limits your access to Marketplace subsidies, which is why [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) is telling you to apply for Medicaid. My first question is why the out-of-state hospitals won't "accept" PA Medicaid. Medicaid generally provides limited out-of-state coverage, so are they looking for something beyond basic coverage for yourself? Also, you're probably not the first student in your school encountering this issue. I'd contact the student affairs/financial aid office and ask them what they recommend in your situation. They may provide hardship resources you can utilize."

↳ emacs guy (30): "Thanks for the replies, but I think I'm just going to sign up with PA State Medicaid. They will cover life threatening ER out of state but nothing else. Which should be fine, I won't be out state maybe just 4 months max. I just hope I won't get hassled by some of the hospitals if asked. I'll just deal with it then."

↳ LizzieMac123 (13): "Healthcare.gov plan but you'll have to pay full price with no income if you're not allowed to have out of state medicaid in your program."

"I've just realized that my Ambetter ACA plan is dogshit First I see a primary care physician who doesn't want to continue to prescribe the maintenance sleep Rx that I have been on for over 30 years, telling me that I should see a psychiatrist. So I call up Ambetter saying this, but what do you know, there are only 3 psychiatrists in the plan, and none of them want to deal with anyone having insomnia issues. I have put in an escalation with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) to allow me to get another plan (Blue Cross), which although it is \$300/mo more, has my current primary-care physician in network. I have escalated this with Ambetter, and they are "working on it", although they have not found a psychiatrist that will work out. I will be seeing my old doc as self-pay (\$130), also getting the Rx on my own. What the hell am I paying the \$80/mo for my plan for such garbage. And the ironic thing is that when I was on Medicaid, my primary-care physician was in network (I still had to pay for my Rx, since Medicaid doesn't pay for that Rx either)."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/

↳ FoxontheRun2023 (43): "You really shouldn't complain about \$80. Try paying \$850/mo for a dogshit plan."

↳ False-Can-6608 (17): "I thought the same. I feel for you, I'm over here ticked about paying \$427 a month. It is Ambetter. And I like it. Had cancer treatment in '24 and '25. No complaints. It was \$220 a month before we lost the subsidies."

↳ Sarduci (11): "\$80 a month for a plan is cheap. I was paying \$1400 a month for a \$13k deductible for 5 people. I would LOVE to have been paying only \$400 a month."

"When I was working part-time, I was able to afford cheap healthcare insurance through the Affordable Healthcare Act. My plan under \$200 with a several thousand dollars deductible but that was a small amount compared to what I would be billed without the insurance if I had to stay in a hospital or needed long term medical care. Sure I had to cut back many things in order to afford it, but it gave me peace of mind."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236Izc&lc=UgyxFPFNgPIBBUCODYx4AaABAq>

↳ @Chris_from_Georgia (1): "What is the name of the company if you don't mind me asking?"

"ACA until Medicare? I'm 63 and want to retire soon, so I would be losing my employer coverage at that time. During my employee coverage years, I chose an HDHP plan and put almost 10K into an HSA. I plan on getting the lowest cost Bronze plan and use the HSA funds to cover meds and any other coverages for the 2 years. I realize that if I have a major medical event, I'll need to cover a big deductible/out of pocket maximum, but even that would be less than \$20K per year for a comprehensive gold plan. I have a pre-existing condition, so a private plan is out of the question and my COBRA would cost \$1350/mth. The only downside I can think of with ACA is needing to adhere to the income limit to keep the subsidy for the 2 years. What else am I missing?"

— r/obamacare · 21 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qmvzcn/>

↳ (0): "Just remember, you can't use HSA funds to pay ACA premiums."

↳ (0): "> What else am I missing? If your income is controllable during this time (only LTCG, etc. And you have enough available cash in savings or investments that won't incur capital gains to sell) and you can get to 100-150% of FPL, then you should get a silver plan. Will have no deductibles and around \$1000 OOP max. Max cost sharing (lowered deductibles/OOP max) is at 100-150% FPL."

↳ (0): "Yes, only silver plans are eligible for income-based CSR (cost sharing reductions), which lower deductibles, max out of pockets, copays etc. The CSRs can make silver plans way better than gold. If you can get your MAGI (modified adjusted gross income) low enough, it is definitely worth considering silver plans."

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

↳ (0): "The insurance isnt going to agree to a network exception for your preferred provider. They would have to have the provider sign documents indicating they would agree to accept in network rates, and usually they wont proactively try to set that up unless the provider reaches out to them first. While the process exists, the likelihood of them approving it is extremely low. You can ask for a care manager or case manager. Thats a decent recommendation. They should be able to find you a provider that can actually treat you. Theres a good chance some of the providers were incorrect when they said they dont take marketplace plans, though its possible they were right and the insurance has an outdated directory, but 20 providers in a row seems unlikely. You wont be able to change your plan outside open enrollment. No better way other than contacting your insurance directly, unfortunately."

↳ (0): "Best advice here! Also OP - even *if* you could get your insurance to pay in-network rates (and you may be able to if for some reason there is in-fact no providers) - doing so doesn't prevent the provider from still balance-billing you what insurance doesn't pay due to the lack of contract."

↳ (0): "I would do both options. And also, I would report the insurance company and plan to your state Department of insurance. The insurance companies benefit from having fake doctors on their plans."

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1so9ty7/>

↳ (0): "Sounds like a situation where you need to involve your State Department of Insurance so they can look into this further."

↳ (0): "And your state representative office"

↳ (0): "This is far beyond what anyone here can help with. Out of curiosity - what is the reason for the retroactive termination? At worst, a premium payment issue would terminate coverage effective the last month of no payment. Since your payment issues only began in December, there's another reason why Oscar retroactively cancelled your insurance for all of 2025. Are they claiming you misrepresented yourself and were in fact ineligible?"

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

↳ (0): "Cash on hand/assets only matters if you're 65 or older. You HAVE been eligible all along, and you should feel free to use your services. You're in the exact situation this social safety net is intended for....use it all you want until you find a job and get monthly income again. And no, it would not matter even if you weren't eligible. You could have knowingly lied and committed fraud to get enrolled in Medi-Cal, but if you haven't made claims Medicaid would never know or care. There's nothing spent by them to try to recover. They'd only come after you if you had claims."

↳ (0): "Medicaid goes by going forward current monthly income, not calendar year income. Previous months do not count at all, and there is no asset test for expansion Medicaid. The monthly income limit for 2022 was \$1,563 and for 2023 \$1,677 a month."

↳ (0): "Are you saying that the "cash on hand" question is basically moot and that it's ALL about monthly income?"

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1inzqe8/>

↳ (0): "The income limits for Medicaid for pregnant women and new children is much higher, once your child turns 1 the income requirements change, wife is no longer considered in the postpartum period. If your wife was pregnant, or had just recently had the baby (within the last 3 months usually) when you signed up for coverage then they most likely gave baby needy newborn coverage, and wife MAGI pregnant coverage. Children born to mothers on Medicaid get guaranteed eligibility till 1 year old under expanded medicaid rules. Once baby is a year old, child and mother go back to medicaid children, and medicaid adult guidelines. If you make 65k per year you earn too much. If they lost coverage you have the right to apply for marketplace coverage outside of open enrollment period with a qualifying life event. Edit- spelling Edit- I have seen and reported blatant Medicaid fraud on numerous occasions within my job, I've seen hundreds of cases of people 100% committing fraud without a doubt. Income gets reported and they call and say they quit, income is ended, a few months later same thing. I have seen 100s of income discrepancies on one case, client never asked to provide proof, or any information about income and the fact they are no longer employed. I've completed 100s of application, I've worked 1,000s of medicaid cases, never ever seen any fraud cases. Only fraud cases I've seen are with SNAP, which they seem to take much more seriously. Medicaid fraud is expensive for tax payers when it's committed by providers, it's not usually bothered with when committed by individuals. It sounds like your situation is very different, there is proof regarding what you did with the recorded phone call, and the marketplace application you submitted. I think you have no reason to worry about them coming after you for fraud."

↳ (0): "I've read Missouri Medicaid has terrible backups in processing. Just make sure you have records of your transactions with them. <https://missouriindependent.com/2024/06/17/feds-to-scrutinize-missouris-worst-in-the-nation-medicaid-application-delays/>;

↳ (0): "Well that's just it. I have no records. My application was done 100% over the phone with a representative who never requested any documents. She messed up over the phone. And six months later when I went to fill out a change in income form, I did it at their office and turned it in. And they have no records of that either so they don't have one document from me and they approved me. All I have is an application number from before I was approved. 100% verbal with zero documentation."

"We need Medicare-For-All/A single payer healthcare system here in the United States, especially during this time with the Coronavirus pandemic! What is more "Pro-Life" than ensuring that every person in America has guaranteed affordable healthcare regardless of their job or social status? Also, if we all had access to basic healthcare, we would all have the "freedom" to live long lives and rarely have to worry about medical bankruptcies. Sure, taxes will go up, but the overall cost will go down so much that everyone will be paying less and saving thousands of dollars every year. Furthermore, if some of us need additional healthcare than Medicare, then we have the "choice" to get additional insurance, but for others Medicare would be more than enough. Finally, if every other developed country (Canada, Germany, the United Kingdom, France, Italy, Sweden, Norway, Denmark, the Netherlands, Switzerland, Japan, South Korea, Australia, and New Zealand) can implement this system and save money, then why can't the United States do the same and help "Make America Great Again" for everybody at least on the issue of healthcare? Oh, and if American citizens die from lacking access to affordable health insurance because the Republicans believe that the government shouldn't provide it then we are failing our country's promise of defending "life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness" for its citizens as well as "promoting the general welfare" of all the people."

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=UgzfpC1om_phrxaXD0B4AaABAg

↳ @DoubleDown310 (2): "Why would they do that, when they can squeeze every penny out of every single American?"

↳ @dvran (1): "Americans wanted capitalism; here you go. Greedy healthcare companies making shareholders happy, large corporations taking over ... it's all to make more billionaires."

↳ @BeatTheBush (1): "@momosan11 I wish but I don't see that happening any time soon. Reform is hard when you have such an ingrained system that will have big money behind to resist it."

"NY has it's own exchange as well. One problem I have getting an estimate is, if my income is below 250% FPL (about \$39k), they don't exactly tell you what you get because instead of a subsidy for a 'qualified plan', you get put on the 'Essential Plan'....basically a co-pay version of Medicaid. But w/ the new Medicaid eligibility rules - like working 80 hrs/mo - I technically won't qualify. So not sure if that means I get a bigger subsidy towards a 'qualified plan' or what happens. It's almost like when the passed ACA - you have to apply to find out what you get. Either way, I am looking at about \$35k, so I'll just have to put it in and see what it comes up with."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxgNqdW1muZXeoJsaN4AaABAg>

↳ @Dave_D. (1): "@HappyonMonday If I put in \$40k, the low end where subsidies start, it will be fine, I've already played around w/ it a bunch - just drives me nuts that they can't tell you what happens below that level until you 'send it'."

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "It's crazy how different each state is! Fingers crossed for you that you get a good deal! 🍀 "

↳ @Dave_D. (0): "@TaishaKirkendall I could just say \$40k and know what I'll pay for a qualified plan....but I think I will go lower (I can control my income so that's not a problem) and just see what happens if they put me on essential but I don't qualify due to the new medicaid qualifications. I figure worst case, it would be the same subsidy as \$40k, best case it's free w/ co-pay, or, somewhere in the middle (bigger subsidy)."

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1lwkch/>

↳ (0): "It's a class H felony in NC for a provider that accepts medicaid (opted in) to take out of pocket payment for services that would be covered under medicaid. Say you went to a dentist that accepted it, they can only bill you for procedures not covered under medicaid like a crown. They wouldn't be able to bill you for services that are covered under medicaid like a cavity filing. If they never opted in to accept medicaid, then it is not fraud. They never agreed to medicaid terms and conditions at all. If you are concerned, before you do anything, you can always call NCDOL or medicaid and make sure you are okay."

↳ (0): "Yes, it can be. Medicaid is for people who cannot pay their own medical expenses. If you show that you have means to pay for your own medical expenses, the state will assume you do not need Medicaid and have been fraudulently receiving benefits. In my state (MD), there are some Medicaid MCOs that do not require referrals from your PCP to receive specialty care. If you are healthy enough to not need to be followed by a PCP, then it matters a lot less if you cannot find one."

↳ (0): "And provider (practitioner/facility) that is contracted with Medicaid must sign a participation agreement that includes the following: In accordance with 10A NCAC 22J .0106 Providers may bill a patient accepted as a Medicaid patient only in the following situations: For allowable deductibles, co-insurance, or co-payments; Before the service is provided the provider has informed the patient that the patient may be billed for a service that is not one covered by Medicaid regardless of the type of provider or is beyond the limits on Medicaid services; The patient is 65 years of age or older and is enrolled in the Medicare program at the time services are received but has failed to supply a Medicare number as proof of coverage; or The patient is no longer eligible for Medicaid as defined in 10A NCAC 21B."

"I quit a 20 year career at 50 🥲 with terrific health insurance in order to become self employed. I'm in CA and was able to get Covered CA (ACA) at first which was wonderful. Nowadays at 56 I make too much to qualify. And I have a 15 year old son at home. I get Blue Shield Gold PPO which is \$1500 a month for the two of us. 🥲 But no deductible. This was good news considering I ended up with cancer + brain surgery in the last 3 years! I pay a lot for medical insurance but it gives me peace of mind."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3I_3XBgfCw&lc=UgwwS68tKfQws0fQ-V4AaABAg

↳ @PatricLubomír-r2w (1): "Wow, you've been through so much. ❤️ Leaving a 20-year career to build your own business was a brave decision, and then facing cancer and brain surgery on top of that must have been incredibly challenging. I'm so glad you had solid coverage when you needed it most. Even though \$1,500 a month is a huge expense, I can completely understand why the peace of mind is worth it after everything you've experienced. How are you doing these days? I hope you're feeling much stronger now. And how has being self-employed been for you overall—despite the healthcare costs, has it been everything you hoped it would be?"

↳ @scottunclocked (0): "Thank you for your comments. Great example of the reason why you need good health insurance! You just never know when something major is going to hit you and it isn't worth the risk of ruining your whole retirement because of a massive health care bill. I pray you are doing better after surgery and are recovering!"

↳ @Dravlae (0): "Hope you recover well."

"How many Americans are on PPO health insurance that covers seeing specialists/doctors across state lines compared to being on insurance that only covers within the state? I'm on Medicaid in Rhode Island for disability and it's frustrating dealing with out of state approvals. Any advice welcomed. I've had long-term neurological issues like neuropathy, muscle pain, and memory issues for nearly 6 years that neurologists in my state (and in Connecticut) haven't been able to definitively diagnose. I am on SSI for disability, which means I get Neighborhood Health Plan of Rhode Island as my primary insurance, with Medicaid as the secondary. I was told by a neurologist I saw across the border in Connecticut recently (Some doctors in CT take my insurance it seems) that being seen at a bigger hospital like Mass General may lead to a definitive diagnosis. From what I was told by his office after they tried referring me to the hospital, Mass General/MGH is no longer accepting my insurance even with prior authorization, when a few years ago i was told by Mass General they were taking my insurance with those stipulations. I was told by MGH's neurology department staff (who were very nice and compassionate about my situation, to be fair to them) that it's possible the hospital chose not to contract with my insurance this year, hence the change, and that because I am on Medicaid, I couldn't even choose to self-pay to go there. They said it's possible in the future the contractual issue could change, and they also told me to try contacting Neighborhood Health myself and explain the situation and see if they could somehow get me approved to be seen at Mass General. I will be calling them this upcoming week. I was curious as to how often Americans are on health insurance plans that cover seeing specialists across state lines, how difficult it is for them to be approved to see specialists in different states, etc. I find it frustrating that my insurance doesn't work across state lines considering this is the smallest state in the country. Not every specialist is going to be here. Logistically it seems to make sense to me that CT/MA should have a deal with RI insurance to cover people if they at least get prior authorization/approval. As of right now Mass General wouldn't take me no matter what, which I find very concerning and depressing. I have had multiple neurologists say I should be seen in a place like Boston to possibly get a definitive diagnosis, why is that not enough to be seen there? That makes no sense to me."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uheytb/how_many_americans_are_on_ppo_health_insurance/

↳ Good_Educator4872 (3): "Originally they wanted to control what plans you could buy. Govt plans always limited coverage to care within the relevant political entity. No one ever accused the designers of Obamacare of being forward thinking. It was about control. The original thinking was to use the British NHS as a model. There were problems with this. We are different than EUROPEAN COUNTRIES. We have the most extensive checks and balances balance system. The states are sovereign political entities. European states have always been organized from the top down. The US. is the inverse. Our constitution is a mutual agreement among sovereign states to cede certain powers to the Federal government. This limits the federal governments ability to dictate internal state action except in delineated areas. Generally, the Fed can only exert oversight in areas the state is not currently regulating. The Federal government doesn't regulate insurance policies unless the state agrees. Insurance is the purview of the states as an example not the Federal Government"

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes. And I had a policy in RI from the market place there (recently moved out of state). It was a BCBS PPO, the lowest level with an HSA. It has a national provider network and allows for seeing doctors, specialists, labs,etc anywhere in the country. I never had even a single issue and I've got doctors in multiple states (though not in RI because well...)."

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes! It's weird because it's almost impossible to get a doctor or most specialists in RI but we have one of the very best marketplaces. But it's only the BCBS PPO with the national provider network so look for one of theirs."

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

↳ TremendouslyMuffled (20): "Medicaid is exactly what you need here, being 18 and no income means you'll almost certainly qualify, and unlike the marketplace it's open year-round"

↳ LizzieMac123 (11): "That is if a parent doesn't claim OP as a dependent on their taxes. If a parent claims OP, they have to include the household income- which is likely the case if the Marketplace told OP they were eligible, but open enrollment is closed vs. sending them to medicaid directly."

↳ Blossom73 (5): "Because you're under 19, your mom's income counts if you live with her and/or are her tax dependent. That's because children's Medicaid ends at age 19 in Texas. Once you turn 19 you unfortunately won't qualify for Medicaid in Texas unless you're pregnant, disabled, as in deemed disabled by the SSA or the state, or an extremely low income parent of a minor child. The monthly income limit for children's Medicaid in TX for a household of 2 is \$2448. \$3714 for CHIP. <https://www.snapscreener.com/medicaid/guides/texas> Is your mom married? Does she have any other dependents?"

"My self paid insurance was \$150 a month when they started Obamacare. I have the same insurance, no medical conditions, and 5k deductible. It cost \$786 a month now. Thanks, Barry!"

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=Ugy2-KWeXwafTnN1nOd4AaABAg>

↳ @jltsoyowdycjltsoyowdyc1076 (4): "Oh heavens, I'm afraid you failed to understand, that thing you were paying \$150/month for was not insurance. It was a product used to make people think they had insurance, and was very affordable, but in reality, they would have simply kicked you out if you ever needed to use expensive care. You know, like cancer, a heart problem or some pre-existing condition. But after watching this video, I'm not sure why you have to pay so much? Julie seems to be paying very little. If only there was somebody out there trying to get those costs lower... the irony is thick."

↳ @jerryrichardson2799 (2): "Nope, more like thanks Trump. You might have had a legitimate gripe if you had a "Cadillac" plan, the ACA did charge a premium on those plans, but I can tell from your description you didn't have one of those."

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Yikes that's gone up a lot! 🤔"

"The rest of the ACA is not being gutted, although it will be fraught with issues. My plan is: \- for 2025, have an income of 148.9% of poverty (I had already notified the state Medicaid office that I had a random, high-income month in January 2025, which should suffice for me not having to notify them again. \- in March 2026, re-apply for Medicaid (April is the anniversary month), which will use the 2024 tax form income (which is below 100%), taking that attitude that I believe my income for 2026 will be below 138% of poverty \- file 2025 tax form after getting approved for Medicaid \- in November 2026, apply for coverage year 2027 ACA Silver-94% plan, using the 2025 tax form as the "data source" \- for 2026 on forward, have an income of 139.1%, so as to maximize the PTC; the loss of PTC seems to be equivalent to a 6% tax rate, which would mean a net 9% tax rate (I am in the 0% federal tax rate schedule, having regular income right at the standard deduction, and long-term capital-gains on top) \- if my family size were ever to change, I would reapply with an income of 139.1% of whatever the income would be based on the poverty level being higher (it appears that the Senate version of the Big Bill allows for a stated change of income if family size changes). \- Bleed off Roth for whatever cash I need if I am up against the total income limit (for any year)"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lp1un7/if_the_bbb_passes_and_the_aca_is_gutted_what_are/n0s7jut/

Managing income to keep the subsidy · 40 documents · 20 voices

"One strategy i used was a high deductible ACA plan and fully funding a HSA account to lower my MAGI,"

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgwRt45pBiZY8nTOJTZ4AaABAg>

↳ @Retirement4life (4): "Is it possible to contribute to an existing HSA if you no longer have W2 income? Still learning, TIA"

↳ @randolphh8005 (1): "We did the same, AND contributed to Roth with some PT income. Received \$15k in credits, while contributing \$25k to HSA and Roth. Our premiums were barely \$300/month. It obviously takes some planning the year before."

↳ @LM-lb6tl (1): "Good tip. A few other ones is to use cash savings, line of credit, or high ROC dividend stocks to create a stream of income to lower your AGI until Medicare."

"ACA plans versus just enrolling through private insurer I cannot seem to find an answer to this anywhere I estimate my MAGI to be around ~40k next year. I am not offered health insurance through employer bc I work part time. I have decent amount of assets so I don't have trouble paying higher premiums each month (it also makes my income less predictable with dividends, capital gains etc but i try to keep it as close to 40k as possible with 401k contributions, trad IRA etc.) My question is -- If I go with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a plan there with a subsidy, at the end of the year does it all even out if I were to just pay the higher premium and get the tax rebate when I file taxes? My accountant complains about [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) plans when I file taxes and recommends I just get it directly with the insurer. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1or63n2/>

↳ (0): "I'm an accountant and would never suggest this unless your income was so high you could not possibly qualify for subsidies."

↳ (0): "Yeah I'm also an accountant and I am puzzled by that comment"

↳ (0): "if I understand your question correctly, yes - if you go on [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and get a policy and ask for no subsidy, you will get the subsidy when you file taxes if you qualified. Assuming your accountant files the forms. :). its not exactly hard to file the forms btw. maybe they don't like the manual entry of the 1095-a information. if you don't get the policy from the marketplace, then you will not be eligible for the subsidy."

"Thanks for posting. This is a lot to take in. We are all in a waiting game. We got notice a month or so ago that our provider is not participating in the VA marketplace next year. So we have to choose a new plan. Damn this is frustrating. Fortunately we have been able to control our income this year. So we should get affordable premiums."

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacare_a_changes_to_know_heading/n4g5n76/

"Yep; retired at 61 and controlled my MAGI such that I paid \$0 for a Silver plan. Benefit of being conservative over many years and having enough in brokerage / savings to cover expenses, vacations, etc. for four years before Medicare kicked in. (So now I actually pay more (~\$300/mo) for Medicare + plan premium than when on ACA. 🤔)"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg

↳ @u8805a8cee (3): "I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

"The way I look at it is once you are over 400% of the poverty level of income you lose 8.5% of the subsidy. So I've done Roth conversions to stay in the 12% bracket. Once I go over the next \$100 dollars would cost me 22% in income tax + 8.5% in subsidy + 15% for any capital gains I had that would have been 0% otherwise costing me a total of 45.50 for that \$100. Come 2026, if there is an income cut off to get the subsidy the goal would be to stay below that modified AGI amt. I'd then suspend any Roth conversions until reaching Medicare age."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgwDBg4aCJpYVLu5RI54AaABAg>

↳ @jasonbroom7147 (0): "Are you factoring in the immediate costs and not including the tax implications of escalating RMD's, while also not addressing any legacy goals?"

"First time viewer... and now a subscriber. I retired early at 58, after 35 yrs in the health insurance world. I am a self proclaimed ACA expert.... and loved seeing how accurate you are at outlining the details. Well done!!! I was fortunate enough to have planned my cash bucket (CDs) and investments to allow me to keep my MAGI at the absolute bottom, so I pay \$0 premium for the best silver.... and have been trying to help everyone achieve the same status."

— YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=Ugw53JBOOcJ3-XYDzgl4AaABAg>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Thanks so much for subscribing and for the kind words! Coming from someone with your background in health insurance, that really means a lot! Sounds like you've done an amazing job planning your early retirement and keeping your MAGI low — great example for others and that's such a great service you're providing by helping others!"

↳ @hefright (0): "@Davek111 do you offer a service that helps folks keep their MAGI low?"

"Yes, and that was the huge benefit of the Enhanced Tax Credit. I had to pay back the APTC 2 years in a row, almost \$60k total for family of 4 at the time, because went over MAGI by about \$2k both years. After the 2nd year it all but wiped out our savings."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wjwved/planning_to_retire_at_62_have_you_priced_the_3/pakbti3/

"That is ridiculously wrong! I am doing it right now! I'm 60 and living on my cash/CD ladder while the majority of my assets sit in my Vanguard ETFs. I have minimal capital gains and interest income... after the standard deduction my income doesn't take me even close 150% of FPL. Therefore I actually have plenty of room to do some Roth conversions. At the 150% FPL I qualify for the absolute highest subsidies. I get my ACA coverage for \$0, most of my copays are between \$0 and \$10, while my deductible is \$0."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=Ugy46l6gaydfloJhDnJ4AaABAg.A2_0CYUxLIJA2_7uy5vnw1

"Regarding the cliff: my husband and I are old genx'ers and are basically retired due to medical reasons. We live in a HCOL area. If we go ONE DOLLAR over \$84,600, our annual ACA premium will jump from approximately \$16,500 to just shy of \$34,000. IN WHAT UNIVERSE IS THAT FAIR OR LOGICAL? He just had a hip replacement that went wrong (thanks, doc), and his hospital bills are over \$200,000 and climbing. And he has to have his other hip replaced in 3 weeks! He's only 57, thin, in great shape, but had a bad luck of the draw. The worst part is that this is the "easy" stuff with our medical issues. The point is, how the hell can we have a 2-person MAGI of \$84.6k, ACA premiums of \$16.5k, max OOP of \$17k (which we have burned through), property taxes of \$15k, and not even get into the daily expenses of living? We thought we had *hopefully* saved enough for a very, very modest retirement, but since it's all in a pre-tax SEP-IRA, every withdrawal counts against our MAGI. With the dismal way things are looking, we're renovating our home now so we can sell it, cash out on the equity to have for our healthcare, and move to another state with a lower COL. That's effed up, but it's how scared we are for our future because of our upcoming medical needs. God, just re-reading everything I wrote makes me burst into tears again for the 1000th time. Maybe we should use his Canadian citizenship and head north... Sorry for the emotional post. It's been a really tough year. Hopefully someone can relate."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vgga4i/senate_dems_post_memo_on_reforms_to_make_health/p1y9oaf/

"Question about tax credit Excuse some of my ignorance because I only switched to ACA plan for my family of 3 about six months ago after switching employers. I didn't pay a lot of attention to it before because I was on a workplace health plan for 10+ years, so I've been playing catch up. My wife and I are both commission workers so I had to estimate our income when first applying. It came out to about 102k/year, and it seemed that I was told that we did not qualify for the APTC, although now I see that the limit is 106k. Our final gross income from 2025 may end up being lower than my estimation. It's possible that I was confused but I'm currently paying 700\$/mo right now, and my plan is going up to around 840\$/mo next year, but the eligibility summary is telling me that I actually am eligible for up to 247\$/mo from the APTC (as well as currently eligible, I think?). So I guess my question is, I am I think understanding now that the tax credit is only going away for those making over 400% of the federal poverty line, does that mean that I could still claim the 247\$/mo next year, as was as retroactively claim it for the previous 6 months or so when I do my taxes next year? I currently am not receiving any advanced payments. Thanks, sorry if this is a dumb basic question I should know already, but just trying to understand better."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1otf5u3/>

↳ (0): "The answer is yes. The 400% federal poverty limit for a 3 person household is \$106,600. If your modified adjusted gross income is below that you will be able to claim the premium tax credit, both this year and next year. One dollar over that and it goes away. There are ways to lower your MAGI such as an HSA if your plan is eligible or funding a traditional pre-tax IRA."

"CHIP Costs More than ACA? I am trying to get a feel for ACA costs when I retire in a few years with a family of 4 and 2 kids, adults will be about 50 and kids 16 and 13. Using the PA website (pennie) I am seeing that if I have a MAGI below \$103k, the kids will be kicked to CHIP. The issue is that CHIP will cost about \$2.5k for both of them, and then our Bronze ACA would be another ~\$5k for my wife and I, so \$7.5k total. However, if they were too old to be on CHIP I could get the same Bronze plan for about \$5.5k for a family of 4, so CHIP is actually costing us MORE. If I understand correctly, CHIP has no deductible and very low co-pays, but our kids typically only go for annual visits so our costs are typically very low so I don't think that would ever offset the extra premium cost. Has anyone else needed to INCREASE their MAGI to lower costs by avoiding CHIP? Am I missing something?"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vli30e/chip_costs_more_than_aca/

↳ FI_321 (6): "You can keep your kids on the ACA by not taking the advanced monthly premium tax credits. You will get it all back when you file your taxes and it requires enough income/savings to cover the full premium until you get it refunded. This doesn't work if you want to utilize silver plan cost sharing. I did this for several years to keep my family off Medicaid (CHIP)."

↳ Perplexed-Owl (2): "In the past when I absolutely needed to keep the kids on our ACA/non CHIP plan, we converted small portions of our IRAs to ROTH in low tax brackets. In my case, I had decently healthy kids who would spend the summer away at camps/grandparents, and they needed OOS coverage. since then, our state no longer has any plans with OOS coverage, so it is moot. (The plans have gotten so much worse- the 'network' area is three counties, so even going to an in state school is problematic) A note about teens/young adults on ACA plans. My two were already in college on fantastic financial aid packages when the OOS national network was removed. I ended up having to purchase the plans offered by the colleges, which are extremely comprehensive, but 300\$/ mo each. By the end, I was paying \$300 (kid1), \$300 (kid 2) ~\$300 (older parent on Medicare plus part G and D) \$100 (younger parent on ACA) In previous years, we had managed to get a fantastic plan for all of us for under 100\$ total. As of this moment, the cheapest bronze plan with no subsidy is \$980/ mo just for me. We squeaked by for this year with subsidies, but for 2027 we will have a family size of 2 and also need to do Roth conversions to plan ahead, so maybe 15k just for me plus another ~4K for my spouse."

↳ anabanana100 (2): "As far as I've experienced, you can choose full price CHIP or keep your whole family on an ACA plan at that MAGI. I think the eligibility statement is confusing in the application. Once you get into Medicaid-level incomes is where things get tricky. Cheapest CHIP in my county is 4.8K for 2 kids so yours seems pretty good. The biggest upside I see with CHIP is that it's very low risk should you encounter significant medical needs."

"I can't even estimate my income until my taxes are done, yet I am to estimate it during open enrollment which is before my taxes are done. And now if I get that wrong either way I have to pay? As I have pointed out in the past, MAGI is calculated differently at the marketplace than how my state calculates it. I was estimating higher just to avoid Medicaid. Now you are saying that I will be fined for under estimating, is this correct?"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yihrr/

"I have a similar situation. I retired at 59. I have decided to do conversions after 65 to keep magi lower during my ACA years. I was able to keep magi really low and get a pretty decent silver savings plan for a reasonable price by not touching my pretax accounts."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E&lc=Ugxs3Oen9-744oMHQdZ4AaABAg.ATzXh2emb0nAU-Cb9hefWM>

"My wife and I signed up for ACA for 2026 but I got rejected since I'm a vet with a VA disability rating (anybody else have this experience?). So, I use the VA and she uses ACA but we plan on her using faith based coverage in 2027 so we can start doing more Roth conversions before RMDs. I missed the boat on the bridge account but I'm doing the rule of 55 on my 401k."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=UgyAdZaJlkDYoPRSV8R4AaABAg>

↳ @keithgilbert835 (3): "Glad you have options."

↳ @BoxTruckNomads (0): "@keithgilbert835yep, it's working out!"

"Income reporting for ATPC I applied for ACA coverage in VT in Jan 26. My wife retired Jan 1 with her last pay check Jan 1 and I was going to retire mid march which I did with last pay middle of March. I estimated 2026 MAGI to be less than the 400% FPL (\$70k) That included our early 2026 earnings plus interest income for the rest of the year. We get an ACE plan with ATPC. In May, I get a letter wanting proof of income. We have no recent paystubs since we retired more than 30 days ago. Last years income doesn't reflect this year's income so tax documents don't reflect true income. I called them and they said to update my application with only current income. Our current income is only interest income which puts us under the medicaid threshold where we don't qualify for ATPC with a QHP. We are still on track for a MAGI of ~\$70k, but the online tool seems to completely disregard our early year wage income and instead bases our income on ~\$1500/mo interest income which makes us eligible for medicaid and not APTC. I called them a second time, but they seemed to just want to focus on monthly income going forward. Since it's an income change, we have a new open enrollment window for a health plan or can get medicaid. I'm trying to figure out how I can just keep the insurance we currently have and I have tried to configure the application so it bases APTC approval on the correct MAGI, but no luck. I'm guessing is that I could probably choose the same plan I have now (and may have to reset the deductables) and pay the full amount and receive the tax credits at tax time, but I don't really know. Any idea what is going on and if there is a fix to this?"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tbeakk/income_reporting_for_atpc/

↳ Comfortable_Two6272 (1): "When will your income be realized to hit the projected magi? Q4? Or earlier? If q4 from say dividends can you provide them last year's dividend info? Or if only interest then using last year's interest statements and year to date so far with an explanation letter? So far my state has not asked for mine but thats what I was advised in my state to do. (Mine is q4 dividends. But we are a non expanded state)"

↳ df33702021 (1): "My last year dividend would be less than what I expect this year. I have about \$60k (MAGI) in wage income that ended in March. I estimate ~\$10k in interest, etc that will be spread out over the remainder of 2026. So I won't hit my total estimated MAGI until end of year. I have found that if you just take your total yearly income and divide it by 12 and set payment as monthly and end of income at 12/31/26, the tool works correctly. The state enrollment tool seems to be programmed such that a new monthly income under the medicaid threshold automatically ignores past income. Similar behavior with <https://www.healthcare.gov/income-calculator/> . I suppose because medicaid eligibility is based on monthly income. I thought there were other requirements for medicaid such as amount of money in bank accounts, but the tools don't ask for that. So currently I divided out the wage income over 12 months, mark as monthly payments, and mark no termination date for the income and I'm APTC eligible again. I expect that next time I get asked for documentation (took them 3 months from initial Feb enrollment), I can just adjust my income again and kick the can down the road. I was told over the phone that an income change puts the timeline back to zero and ignore the current documentation request as it will be regenerated on the updated application. Otherwise, it seems I have to ask for a manual income evaluation, but not sure how that will go. thanks! edit: a word"

"Can anybody confirm that a traditional IRA contribution will reduce MAGI? I'm in Massachusetts and called the Health Connector (their ACA) and the person I spoke to was clueless - didn't know what MAGI is and didn't even seem to understand what an IRA contribution is. My situation: retired last year at 59, have been on COBRA which ends January 2026. Will have income from self-employment, part-time job and some interest and dividends. Let's say MAGI is \$50 thousand. If I make a \$5 thousand traditional IRA contribution in 2026 does that reduce my MAGI to \$45 thousand and result in a slightly higher subsidy and lower premium? I believe it does, but can't seem to get confirmation from anybody. And it definitely sucks that we have to deal with all this just to pay thousands of dollars for health insurance that doesn't even kick in until we pay thousands more in deductibles."

— YouTube · How Do I Pay For Health Insurance if I Retire Early? · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Au4dTiwlBUg&lc=UgznczKId5mXVCZdPj54AaABAg>

↳ @jameschaves5723 (0): "I'm in Massachusetts too. I don't think the IRA counts. The health connector is so expensive"

"MAGI calculation help Never have had an HSA until this year and I want to make sure I understand its effect on MAGI. I'm over 55 on an ACA bronze plan so that means I can contribute \$5400 per year. To retain my subsidy I have to keep my MAGI at 400% or less of the FPL for a single person. This would be of \$62,600. Lets say my MAGI for 2026 is \$68,000. By my understanding I would take $\$68,000 - \$5400 = \$62,600$ so I would keep my subsidy. If MAGI were $\$68,001 - \$5400 = \$62,601$ and I would fall off of the subsidy cliff... Am I understanding this correctly? I ask all of this because I am shuffling around investment accounts aiming for a MAGI of \$65,000, leaving wiggle room to steer clear of the cliff if I am understanding how this works. Thanks."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q6iwacl/>

↳ (0): "HSA contributions can reduce MAGI and keep you under. Traditional before tax IRA contributions can as well."

↳ (0): "Works a little different than that. You take total income and subtract Above the Line deductions to arrive at your MAGI. The most common above the line deductions are HSA contributions, IRA contributions and for 2026 up to \$2,000 in charitable contributions. One of the things that helped me a lot was moving all my "cash" from a money market fund to an ETF called BOXX as isn't taxable until withdrawal as opposed to yearly."

↳ (0): "Good info. Small clarification: CASH contributions only and the limit is 1k for a single person."

"I used the ACA from 61-65 before Medicare. My husband was two years older so he was on the plan for 2 years. It was more affordable with both of us on a plan. When he started Medicare my premiums for just me ended up costing over 534/m. When I first retired I had some savings so that wasn't included in our magi. Once I started taking Ira withdrawals with my husband taking social security and still working 3 days a week is when our income increased and it all ended up on our magi. So if you have savings that is really the best way to keep your magi low enough for subsidies without increasing the cost of your ACA plan."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=UgxzbAjqmjyPWCoVGol4AaABAg>

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (2): "Absolutely! Thanks for sharing your story."

↳ @keithgilbert835 (2): "Thanks for sharing. Glad you liked the video."

"Yeah. Took me a while to figure it out too. I kept tripping over the ACA rules until I started working with *Lina Dineikiene*. She helped me line up the timing and withdrawals so my MAGI stayed within the subsidy range. Once I saw it mapped out, it finally made sense."

— YouTube · How to Qualify for ACA Health Insurance Subsidies as an Early Retiree · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cDtnJs9uN7M&lc=Ugydxu_GGVuWu8ya0gd4AaABAq.AOcDEut4XcfAPM89sXUxKN

"What, are you saying that if I estimate my income at \$20k 4-5 months before I even have my taxes done and it actually is 14k that I would have to pay back the subsidies? How the hell is that fair, we are talking about making \$14k, am I missing something?"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n18jrl/

Went without insurance · 40 documents · 20 voices

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

↳ (0): "Man, it's a big risk, and if you lose the bet, you're well and truly bad off. One chronic illness, cancer, pregnancy, broken bone, torn ligament and you are SOL. Sure, you can be seen for emergency care under EMTALA, but they don't have to give you chemo or surgery or insulin once you're past the emergency part. 25 is typically young and healthy, but it isn't a guarantee. Best of luck to you."

↳ (0): "My MS first happened at 25, but bc I didn't have insurance until 29 to get diagnosed I have permanent damage and now disabled and unable to work."

↳ (0): "I don't want to upvote this, because it is terrible that you had to go through that, but I'll upvote anyway because it is a perfect example of how things can turn quickly."

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s4qs2m/>

↳ (0): "Your husband absolutely needs to find a different new job or you do. Going without insurance is way too risky"

↳ (0): "Try to think of it this way: you can't afford not to have insurance through your employer. Also, you're not going to get much sympathy about having to pay 840 per month for 3 people."

↳ (0): "I saw you commented below you have a combined household income of roughly \$93,000. I don't know what zip code you live in, but just picking a random zip code in Kansas City, there are multiple bronze plans for both your husband and daughter in the range of \$550 per month. I believe you may be entering something in on healthcare.gov incorrectly. If your employer does not offer 'affordable' insurance per the ACA-guidelines, you could also qualify for ACA subsidies as well"

"Any self-employed? I don't know how anyone will be able to cover the increase. I have read some will be forced to go without coverage. How will you manage the sticker shock? This is unfathomable, scary, and needless to say, appalling to hear a country as big as the US is forcing people to do this."

— r/obamacare · 98 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/

↳ anabanana100 (36): "This is the biggest source of stress in my life. It makes the future look so bleak."

↳ ForeignRevolution905 (22): "Self employed, super stressed about it. Scared to look at the new rates and hoping against hope the Dems prevail in the shutdown fight"

↳ Rigorous-Geek-2916 (18): "Mine doubled. Over \$2300/mo now. No subsidies any more. Still > 1 year to Medicare. Will need to tap into savings to pay for healthcare. Fuck the GOP"

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/>

↳ (0): "Health shares are NOT insurance."

↳ (0): "you're young and healthy with no preexisting conditions until you aren't. during a routine physical my doctor found a large mass on my thyroid. it happens in the blink of an eye."

↳ (0): "Healthshares are scams"

"I am in my 50s and cancelled. I have no insurance for the first time in my life and I work fulltime and always have. This is not sustainable. If I get sick I will either lose all of my life savings or die."

— r/obamacare · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qil7n2/my_premium_went_from_200_to_1500_and_now/o0slhth/

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1so9ty7/>

↳ (0): "Sounds like a situation where you need to involve your State Department of Insurance so they can look into this further."

↳ (0): "And your state representative office"

↳ (0): "This is far beyond what anyone here can help with. Out of curiosity - what is the reason for the retroactive termination? At worst, a premium payment issue would terminate coverage effective the last month of no payment. Since your payment issues only began in December, there's another reason why Oscar retroactively cancelled your insurance for all of 2025. Are they claiming you misrepresented yourself and were in fact ineligible?"

"Short Story: I had no health Insurance, had my appendix taken out. They sent me a bill for 21k, they found out that I did not have any insurance and dropped my cost to 9k. Completely worth it for me. Also, I set my monthly payment price."

— YouTube · The Truth About Health Insurance -- Why Entrepreneurs Should Cancel Their Health Insurance · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2IU7ErdRc44&lc=UgyovoHqp5HmC5fXwYp4AaABAg>

↳ @SnackQueen01 (5): "If you said you couldn't pay the 9k they would've dropped it even further. I was at the emergency room for chest pain, the bill was close to \$6000 then without insurance the bill dropped to \$2700 and some change then it dropped to close to \$1000 (it was \$990 and some change) and they offered me three months payments to pay that last amount."

"The ACA was made for people like me and my husband. We are both self-employed and have been for a good chunk of our lives, for my husband it's actually his whole adult life. We don't qualify for Medicaid, we make too much. We can afford to pay for some of our health insurance, but not all of it. We couldn't get health insurance any other way. We can't do catastrophic plans, we have health conditions. So it hasn't been a Band-Aid for us, it was a lifesaver. When ACA first came out, I was skeptical and wouldn't even look. Then my husband went into the hospital for 21 days. A whole had started in his colon and it was almost completely torn through, but we got there in time and he sat there for 21 days getting pumped full of strong antibiotics. And that bankrupted us. And then I signed up for the ACA and I wanted to kick myself because for four years we went without it and we could've not filed bankruptcy Had we had it I know there are people that still are falling through the cracks. Because you have to make some money to get ACA but there is also the subsidy cliff. It literally saved us. Why do people don't realize that those extended subsidies also opened up ACH to a lot of people that would have otherwise not qualified. I'm all happy to help people but it's like now people don't want the means test applied at all. The ACA is going back to its original rules. No, I do not want people to see their premiums quadruple and more, but it simply going back to what it was before Covid and it still insured around 14 million people. That may be nothing to you, but it was our literal lifeline. We either get help with healthcare or my husband goes on disability. He doesn't want that, he enjoys working. But he needs his medication and access to his doctors to keep doing that. It may be a Band-Aid for some, but it wasn't for us"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqibrvo/

"I'm a USA citizen living in Taiwan. I pay ~\$25USD/month for Health Insurance in TW. Crazy part: Out of pocket/no health insurance costs are extremely cheap still with the quality of care being equivalent to care given in USA. (I'm a licensed Healthcare provider in the USA) Example: I had no insurance. Got hurt. Went to the emergency room on a Saturday night to get X-Rays, medicine, physician assessment...it cost me ~\$60USD without health insurance. Conclusion: insurance and administration jobs are rolling in the money at the cost of Healthcare providers & patients."

— YouTube · Health Insurance for Self Employed: Beyond Marketplace Insurance! · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=allOvX_0uhs&lc=Ugy2N2nS-gX2UhhkOMI4AaABAg_9OgzM45MfRL9QZqfF_SlyO

"my monthly was \$279 and with this change it is over \$1000 a month. I just can't do that. Healthcare in the USA is a scam. NO REASON it should cost this much. I will have no health insurance in 2026"

— YouTube · Health subsidies expire, launching millions of Americans into 2026 with steep insurance hi · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mmmeHjdMChc&lc=UgxnNYa0K--mbRi7YAt4AaABAg>

↳ @Clearskysahead (1): "This is not the conversation that we should be having. We should be planning a Medicare for all program. Every other country provides medical care for its citizens, why can't we?"

↳ @Necron100-1 (1): "@Clearskysahead how about we get government out of the free market and don't require health insurance? Do you want to know why you can buy a big screen tv for less than what most people pay for a monthly health insurance premium? Because government has never tried to regulate the cost of TVs"

↳ @Necron100-1 (0): "I had the same story when ACA was enacted. I was without health insurance for 2 years. Every time the government gets involved prices go up"

"No health insurance might work when you're young and healthy, but when you get older it is necessary. I had aortic stenosis due to a genetic defect called a bicuspid aortic valve. I had no symptoms until I was critical and had no idea I ever had this. My insurance was billed 340k for my open heart surgery and all I had to pay out of pocket was \$1,300. Had I had no health insurance, I would have had to sell my house to pay for it."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=UgwZGdNoaFMpvivgvbh4AaABAq>

↳ @seapickles7754 (1): "This! I have health issues and have been saved a few times fortunately."

↳ @FKBUSH1 (0): "If you didnt have insurance it may have cost less than \$100,000. Just saying... Explain that one to me and then explain why its the ins company's fault that the prices are so different 🤔 Who's setting these varied prices?"

↳ @ouiser1955 (0): "@FKBUSH1 Unfortunately no. Hospital would discount to a minor degree but would still be enormous. I've worked in the Hospital systems for 50 years. (RN) Yes, the Hospitals jack up their prices but the Hospitals have huge overhead and that includes employees salaries. And don't forget malpractice insurance that the hospital pays... that also covers licensed personnel. Don't forget utilities, medical supplies, maintenance costs of building, etc... Not defending the hospital just stating what goes into pricing."

"@Shadow_Banned_ConservativeBefore ACA, I tried to get health care, and the cost for me was infinity dollars. Because I had pre-existing condition and no insurance company would offer me a plan. So I would disagree with your little assessment there."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgxbKTpUxHIAEi5KMYJ4AaABAq.ARNIp2Pmc7PARRj9Gg3D7o

"I had a nearly 14-year uninsured gap between an office job working for the Man and getting it with the ACA (aka Obamacare). That would be age 37 to 51, so somewhere in Tim's range and with some pre-existings like taking medicine for high cholesterol. The thing that saved me was traveling twice a year for work to Thailand and getting care there. High quality and a third or less of the U.S. cost, even though I went to one of THE most expensive places in the country (internationally accredited Bumrungrad Hospital). I'd take a \$120 battery of tests, then see doctors and get prescriptions (prescription generics much cheaper there). Was able to catch and turn around some problems early and delay a day of reckoning with others. The system in the U.S. is far more expensive than it has to be, and encourages the uninsured or underinsured to try to ignore symptoms and hope they go away. Then they land in an ER with huge bills and often no good options. The ACA stopped that for some 23 million, but in states like Texas that didn't expand Medicaid the old system with the ER is still in place for a lot of people."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236lZc&lc=UgwP61kvCYn4UMNrDF14AaABAq>

↳ @lc6636 (0): "Not impressed. The majority of the people in Thailand live in poverty."

↳ @myfriendgoo2816 (0): "@lc6636 That makes it all the more an indictment of the U.S. system that so many bankruptcies are caused by health costs that are a small fraction elsewhere. A bankruptcy stays on your record a decade and makes it hard to get credit or a job. As for Thailand, police hospitals are the backstop, and Thaksin's 30-baht scheme was enduringly popular. As they develop more, it and Malaysia next door will become more like a European model. Have been to 53 countries and the thing you hear over and over, even from admirers of the U.S., is that health care and gun violence are the two things America got wrong."

↳ @lc6636 (0): "@myfriendgoo2816 The other countries are smaller, and many in those countries buy insurance to have needed procedures in the US. The others are younger people who brag about a free service or poor people who will take anything. Move there if it appeals to you."

"I plan on looking for more of a 'catastrophic' plan, since I don't have regular medical expenses. I can't afford over 1k a month, with a \$6,800 deductible and then pay out of pocket for everything except my annual exam. One month's premium is the basic cost of my labs and exam. I will also take a trip and stock up on antibiotics - since that is 99% of the 'treatment' I receive for anything wrong, and avoid paying for urgent care or the ER. With Insurance, I pay \$60 for a Specialist. Without Insurance, I pay \$180. Half the time, I have had to pay out of pocket for tests or treatments, or spend hours attempting to get an approval. I really only want or need insurance for expenses over \$10k- I can pay for my annual visits. Honestly, I feel like insurance should pay/ reward me for any annual exams I do. "Yay! you got bloodwork! Here's a \$100 credit on your next bill for trying to catch problems early!"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5q1hev/

"I can't even bring myself to go look. I'm in Florida. And no, I didn't vote for him. We are self-employed, small business of almost 20 years. I have a part-time job outside of helping him run his business. Obviously he handles the working part but I handle a lot of the bids and billing and I'm also a gopher. It's better if he stays on the job site to keep workers going then for him to constantly run for materials. So I do a lot of that. We have always done OK with ACA. We could always afford to pay some for our healthcare, we just couldn't pay it all. Husband has heart problems because both of his parents had them too, so it's hereditary. He's not overweight, we rarely drink, maybe 10 drinks a year and that's probably overestimating, he eats a giant salad and then protein for almost every single dinner. We had a triple bypass at age 52 but that's better than his twin, who had a pacemaker at age 40. He has to see the cardiologist at least twice a year and he has to have his medication. And this past year he has had to go to the hospital four times over chest pains. Luckily it's turned out to just be a medicine tweak but now they are eyeing a valve. I have severe asthma and it's always been well controlled, but without insurance, between the two of us, it's like \$3000 a month and medication alone I hate that this is happening to us. My head still can't wrap around the fact that it's so much more important to give the wealthy tax breaks than to help the less wealthy. I can't wrap my head around that. Why did they need extended tax breaks? They don't. How much is enough? I'm going to give myself the weekend and I'm going to get on there Monday and look"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olp6mh/virginia_aca_rates_posted_today_share_your/nmk68zt/

"Broken leg might be okay with cash pay but cancer would surely be financially devastating. I was hoping catastrophic insurance changes would help. As of today, all people (not just those <30 years old) who don't qualify for subsidies are eligible for catastrophic coverage. I woke up early to look at what premiums would be for ACA catastrophic coverage only - \$2100/month for my family with a \$21,500 deductible 😞 Luckily, I have employer-sponsored health insurance through my employer right now but the job is very unstable. My husband and I decided today that our family will have to go without health insurance again if I lose my job. We had to go without health insurance for many years before I got this job because ACA premiums were too high - and they're now about 2x as high than the last time I checked our ACA options. We know our providers offer reasonable cash prices and I've discovered a whole network of cash-pay services, labs, and imaging facilities. There's even a hospital that only offers surgery for cash-pay (<https://surgerycenterok.com>) that's within driving distance and could affordably repair broken bones, etc. But cancer or a catastrophic event would bankrupt us."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nml2egf/

"Lost job, not sure what to do for insurance Hello, I live in California and I recently was let go from my job within the 60 day probationary period. I sent my unemployment application a few days ago. I have been uninsured since Feb. 1 when the coverage from the job I had prior to the one I just lost ended. I would like to get insured soon as I will be penalized by the state for going without insurance for more than 3 months. The penalty is around \$900 from what I have heard. I know I have options. I still could sign up for COBRA from the job I had before losing this one. However, that is close to \$600 per month, which I cannot afford without income or even while receiving just unemployment.. So I think its really between Medi-Cal and hopefully subsidized marketplace insurance. I was thinking I should wait until I see how much the unemployment will be before applying online because it could put me too high for Medi-Cal but I may still get subsidized marketplace insurance. I am looking for a new job but I don't expect to find an new job and get on their insurance in time since most have a waiting period. Any advice? Thanks in advance."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1rlu524/>

↳ (0): "Medicaid is the way."

↳ (0): "Here in WA my Medicaid is based on current income which for you would be \$0 as unemployment hasn't kicked in yet. Then the marketplace plans go off your latest tax return. So if you haven't filed 2025 use 2024. That will let you know how much credit you'd get from an ACA plan."

↳ (0): "Federal Marketplace (edit: website) insurance subsidies are based on one's estimate of current year's income, not prior year's income. Note: I don't have state specific knowledge."

"Well, get this we are losing our health insurance. We are self-employed. My husband had a job where he was getting insurance also and it was still running us about \$700 out of his check for a family of three and then the employer was paying the other 80% they paid almost \$17,000 and 2024 for our insurance for our family. Now I looked into getting an insurance that was pretty much the same comparable to what we have right now and the quote that we got was \$2200 a month that is craziness. We have decided to go without insurance and pay our doctor bills as we go."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236lZc&lc=UgwXv6oJkbAh-ENTRTh4AaABAg>

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but

wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9jkcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>;

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q9bscn/>

↳ (0): "DO NOT USE THIS SCAM COMPANY. PAY EXTRA FOR A BETTER OPTION. THESE PEOPLE WILL SIMPLY TAKE YOUR (AND TAXPAYER) MONEY AND FIND CHICKENSHIT WAYS NOT TO COVER YOUR CLAIMS (Like refusing to give you your PCP even though they're in network)"

↳ (0): "I still have not received any information or contact from them. No information about my plan coverage not even a welcome letter. I received a bill for sure but what it covers .. Who knows because I haven't received any information and none is available online. I'm paying 650 a month out of pocket .. All I can do is hope I don't need it and wait out until next year"

↳ (0): "i strongly suggest switching to a different carrier. these guys are worthless. when you need them to cover something, you'll probably have to hire an attorney to get them to cover anything"

"I lost my Medicaid due to this very reason. During Covid, I (and my children) qualified for Medicaid. When the restrictions kicked back in, I was unceremoniously dumped off of it without more than a months notice. I make \$100 over the limit. I applied for ACA, and quite literally cannot afford any of the plans offered. That \$100 I make over the limit? It's not enough to pay for any of the plans offered under ACA. So now I have no health insurance, a chronic illness that requires specialists and prescriptions to keep me from being bed bound, and I'm one serious health complication away from losing my house. We exist and there are a lot of us. Especially those of us that live rurally because we can't afford to live in big cities."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lv1xsc/heads_up_over_half_the_maga_murder_bills/n2bz0c5/

An HSA with a high-deductible plan · 33 documents · 20 voices

"Good video. Learned about ACA 8 years ago. Stopped our 401k contributions immediately and funded a brokerage account. Three years later we retired with a sizeable brokerage account and small IRA withdrawals keep our income low. We pay \$7 a month for a bronze plan with an HSA. We have 3 more years till Medicare" — YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgzYjF309QwWvC00Ald4AaABAq

↳ @scottunclocked (7): "In general No (let me explain). This is the beauty of having the taxable brokerage account. However, capital gains DO count toward your MAGI and any interest earned counts toward MAGI... So a portion of your withdrawal from a taxable brokerage may count toward your MAGI. it does count, but not like withdrawals from a traditional IRA or 401K where all of the withdrawal amounts from these count toward your MAGI because they are treated as "ordinary income"."

↳ @scottunclocked (6): "Thank you for sharing your costs with the ACA option. With getting the subsidies, you can certainly get your costs WAY down. I do wish we would have gotten started a few years sooner with stockpiling money in a taxable brokerage account. This is one thing I would do differently if I was 5-10 years from early retirement. We got started a little late on building a taxable brokerage account. Great moves on your part to prepare for this.... It is going to save you a fortune! How long have you been retired?"

↳ @dereks4228 (4): "Just remember the taxable brokerage account has no bankruptcy protection and can vanish with a serious lawsuit"

"One strategy i used was a high deductible ACA plan and fully funding a HSA account to lower my MAGI," — YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgwRt45pBiZY8nTOJTZ4AaABAq>

↳ @Retirement4life (4): "Is it possible to contribute to an existing HSA if you no longer have W2 income? Still learning, TIA"

↳ @randolphh8005 (1): "We did the same, AND contributed to Roth with some PT income. Received \$15k in credits, while contributing \$25k to HSA and Roth. Our premiums were barely \$300/month. It obviously takes some planning the year before."

↳ @LM-lb6tl (1): "Good tip. A few other ones is to use cash savings, line of credit, or high ROC dividend stocks to create a stream of income to lower your AGI until Medicare."

"ACA until Medicare? I'm 63 and want to retire soon, so I would be losing my employer coverage at that time. During my employee coverage years, I chose an HDHP plan and put almost 10K into an HSA. I plan on getting the lowest cost Bronze plan and use the HSA funds to cover meds and any other coverages for the 2 years. I realize that if I have a major medical event, I'll need to cover a big deductible/out of pocket maximum, but even that would be less than \$20K per year for a comprehensive gold plan. I have a pre-existing condition, so a private plan is out of the question and my COBRA would cost \$1350/mth. The only downside I can think of with ACA is needing to adhere to the income limit to keep the subsidy for the 2 years. What else am I missing?"

— r/obamacare · 21 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qmvzcn/>

↳ (0): "Just remember, you can't use HSA funds to pay ACA premiums."

↳ (0): "> What else am I missing? If your income is controllable during this time (only LTCG, etc. And you have enough available cash in savings or investments that won't incur capital gains to sell) and you can get to 100-150% of FPL, then you should get a silver plan. Will have no deductibles and around \$1000 OOP max. Max cost sharing (lowered deductibles/OOP max) is at 100-150% FPL."

↳ (0): "Yes, only silver plans are eligible for income-based CSR (cost sharing reductions), which lower deductibles, max out of pockets, copays etc. The CSRs can make silver plans way better than gold. If you can get your MAGI (modified adjusted gross income) low enough, it is definitely worth considering silver plans."

"Ours is actually quite a bit worse, probably due to age (late 50's). If we careen over the cliff of \$84,600 due to not having quite enough expenses or whatever, it will cost us an additional \$19,200 / year. Our anticipated income is just very, very close to the cliff, and that's best case scenario with a bronze plan and full HSA funding to get our MAGI to \$80k. If we topple over, we will pay over \$24,000 / year in premiums for a bronze plan + \$10,750 to fund the HSA. That's 41% of our gross income before we even visit a doctor or fill a prescription, not to mention federal and state taxes. Not much left. WTF, America?"

— r/obamacare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ojey71/any_selfemployed/nm32690/

"Started a taxable brokerage account 5 years ago instead of maxing out our 401k. Wound up with around 300k and retired age 60 knowing this account would lower our MAGI with small IRA withdrawals. We pay \$7 dollars a month for a Bronze plan with an HSA. We can show up to 65k a year in income for the \$7 dollars a month. We withdraw 50k from IRA and the rest from the brokerage account. The HSA lowers our income 10k. Highly recommend funding a brokerage account instead of IRA a few years before retirement. Great video and ideas"

— YouTube · ACA Premium Shock? Pay Less All Year · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8zEUYMnF5vI&lc=UgypWK6z8jnkb9WEZex4AaABAq>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (1): "Hi Patrick! Thank you so much for sharing this most helpful comment! You're a great example of putting some of these levers in action and really saving on your ACA health insurance premiums and how they can really make a HUGE difference! Wonderful job and thanks for watching!"

↳ @nikij.6058 (1): "Wished I would have done the same... 🤔🤔🤔"

"Was able to do both. Wanted a plan that covered the monthly premiums, but only needed catastrophic insurance as I have never had any medical issues. Needed to be able to have a higher MAGI to fill the 12% tax bracket with Roth conversions. I chose a Bronze HDHP + HSA plan from Kaiser Permanente with a \$7050 deductible. The premiums are completely covered by the tax credits as long as I keep my MAGI under \$55,700. Also, can contribute \$5,150 to an HSA account along with doing Roth conversions. I have enough brokerage funds to get by for the next 9 years to Medicare. I do leave the difference of \$55,700 to \$61,750(top of the 12% bracket) unfilled, but the premium increases outweigh the tax savings."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgxzNzu7Ex23F4Thflt4AaABAg>

↳ @Retirement4life (0): "Sorry, what was the restriction to doing your Roth conversions? You needed a higher MAGI than a certain amount? Is this related to the min to avoid Medicare or something different here? Also curious where you were able to figure out the \$57,500 number? Is there a program you like to help in calculations? Thanks!"

"I'm two years away from Medicare age and self employed. I have a bronze HSA policy this year with an \$8k deductible. I pay \$750 a month with the subsidy....the premium is \$1500. I won't qualify for subsidies next year either and I'm afraid to see what the premium will be. I'll probably just drop health insurance until I qualify for medicare and hope nothing happens. 🙌 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh6uh41/

"I used my HSA to pay for 18 months of my wife's COBRA premiums which allowed her to retire at 63 1/2. Pretty easy; just need the forethought to contribute to your HSA for such an event."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgypQPuJyvArxegEvpJ4AaABAg

"I used my HSA funds to pay for 18 months of my wife's COBRA which allowed her to retire at 63 1/2. Pretty easy really, just need the forethought to contribute to HSA."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgxqgJ4EtRMhqlqr4UJ4AaABAg.ARMfbkSgKgDARMw7ouIVYp

"Well none of these work for me. 32 years in law enforcement and got great pension, but very expensive health insurance. County give me 600 a month to pay for insurance, but the plans are super expensive. My plan for a family is 2400 a month with a 6000 deduction. Tried Obamacare but I make to much on my pension. Cobra was more then the plans and I would not get the 600 a month if I used Cobra. I do use an HSA to pay for medical stuff and write all the premiums off at end of year so its not so painful. Only choice till 65 is for me to get a job with benefits or just go without medical and use free clinic down the street. Aint America grand!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwz-0YIBEUizzYTHRZ4AaABAg>

↳ @jadexplores2100 (2): "This is exactly why I am trying to figure out if moving abroad is the better option for me between ages 55-64."

↳ @leehamilton4459 (0): "same. Retired at 55 and health insurance was covered for two years. Now I have to pay it myself and its 1500 per month for hubby and me. That is too much. I canceled it and am now looking for a full-time job that offers health insurance. Geez, retirement was short."

↳ @robertsmith6408 (0): "@leehamilton4459 me too! I am so happy being retired that the thought of working makes me depressed. I keep trying for six figures jobs, which i can do but may have to settle for a simple job but no point unless it has medical benefits. I take good care of myself so i look about 40 and i am 62. When they see my resume that i graduated college in 1984 the interview ends fast. Ageism is alive and well in the US! We do have some good news, the county may move the retirees back into the employee pool in 24, so it may go down some and once 65 on Medicare I wont pay anything because county pays my part B and supplemental."

"I'm legitimately considering dropping coverage because we spend about \$6k in premiums a year and have been to the doctor maybe twice in the last 7 years. It's an HSA too so even if we had something happen we're paying out the wazoo. I really wish they would expand catastrophic health plans. Let me pay cash to see my doctor when I have the flu or Covid, but cover me when I blow a kidney."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q6f1ge/obamacare_premiums_ju mp_114_overnight_why_48/ny8q3ha/

"I'm about a year or two younger than you and I'm in my 3rd year of being on an ACA plan. Here's what I've learned. There is NO ACA plan that will match ANYTHING you had with a former employer. ALL of the plans have higher deductibles (in the \$4000 to \$5000 range) and max out-of-pockets (around \$10,000). (Note: those numbers are for a single person). For comparison, the highest deductible I had while working was \$1700 with a max out-of-pocket of around twice that. The monthly cost for my first two years on ACA plans was around \$250 which was reasonable. This year, it's more than twice that and that includes the subsidy. Note: I've been able to increase my income thru investments during the past 3 years so the value of my subsidy has been going down. I'm seriously considering going to a non-subsidy plan next year so I don't have to cap my income. The only good news is that I now have an ACA plan that qualifies for HSA contributions which lowers my taxable income and provides tax-free money to cover the deductibles."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgxWaCXZ7asMYz8H2tl4AaABAg

↳ @scottunclocked (1): "Thank you for sharing your experiences. As I did my research, I came to this same conclusion, that what I would end up choosing was going to have some risk & tradeoffs. It is a challenging subject and you have to do research and decide what is best for you and your family. I appreciate you sharing the cost details as well, as this is very helpful for folks trying to navigate healthcare."

↳ @michaelcurtis106 (0): "@scottunclocked yeah, one problem is that the group insurances that used to be available 25 to 30 years ago are no longer available. Instead, they point you to the ACA marketplace."

"Great job on this video. I especially like your editing with the graphics and pop ups I am now in year three of early retirement. Year one we used COBRA. Last year we were on the ACA with a Gold plan. This year we have a Bronze PPO plan. I went with bronze because of the HSA option as we are contributing to it and then paying our out of pocket from the HSA. It is an amazing deal to get the MAGI reduction thanks to the HSA contribution. I have a serious heath condition that was discovered after early retirement and the ACA medical, while expensive for our needs, has been great thanks to many of the coverage reasons you mentioned. I did use lever 9 last year and the result was a lower premium the last few months of the year The ACA is in question now and much is up in the air as far as the future. I worry about what will change but would not let what ifs keep you from retiring early. Great video"

— YouTube · ACA Premium Shock? Pay Less All Year · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8zEUYMnF5vI&lc=UgytPVqZ_L-aTafnV2F4AaABAg

↳ @davidnprogress (1): "@EarlyRetirementRoadmap I understand the work that goes into these videos for sure. I know I spend way too much time on mine and they are not near as professional as yours. Keep up the good work."

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Thank you so much David for such a thoughtful comment and for watching! I also really appreciate you noticing the editing and graphics. That's all me, so your compliment means a lot, because it definitely takes a minute to do all the editing 🥹. I use the full-screen graphics to help explain the more complicated stuff especially, and the pop-ups are my way of adding a little lightness along the way. Also, your experience is incredibly valuable to share — the COBRA → ACA Gold → ACA Bronze PPO choice and using the HSA. You nailed it: if you're eligible, HSA contributions are a powerful lever because they can lower MAGI while building a medical "war chest." I'm also really sorry to hear about the health condition you discovered after retiring — but I'm glad ACA coverage has been serving you well. That's exactly why those protections (pre-existing conditions, essential benefits, etc.) matter so much. And great job using Lever #9 — updating the Marketplace estimate during the year can absolutely reduce premiums when your situation changes. I'm with you on the uncertainty too... lots is up in the air, but I agree: don't let "what ifs" be the only thing that prevents an early retirement if the rest of the plan is sound. As an early retiree too, I highly recommend it and am certainly enjoying being able to spend my time the way I want to. I highly recommend as I'm sure you do too! ;) My best to you in 2026 and hopes for your health to continually improve!"

"You have a good understanding. I retired one month shy of 59. My wife was 61, so we could use her 401K for 1/2 a year while I waited to reach 59.5. ACA was clearly the better option, as Cobra is very expensive. We used a bronze HSA-eligible plan (all bronze are now HSA eligible), and also continued to max out HSA contributions."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzzJa3tCQGozeTjVPp4AaABAg.ARn-Wp8zcSARP1GliHTt

"No. Earned income only applies to IRA's. I currently have a Bronze plan with an HSA and have been retired for 18 months now."

— YouTube · Why I Chose a Bronze ACA Plan With Heart Failure (2026 Coverage + HSA Strategy) · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vt81218uhtU&lc=UgxI5Lo_RMSc993bf14AaABAg.APOOUu89oJGAP0II4P51dw

"Low Deductible or HSA Plan for 2 adults with potential pregnancy in the future. I am leaving my job to take care of my one year old at home since daycare costs in my area are very high. I will lose my insurance through my employer; however, my employers insurance was pretty expensive and my son qualifies for FAMIS now, and with the tax credits my husbands employer (extremely small family owned business) will pay our monthly premiums for an ACA plan. We are discussing trying to have a second baby to complete our family this year and I'd like help deciding which plan will be most beneficial for us financially, and if the higher premium would be worth it for his company to cover. For my husband and myself I am looking at this plan. Would this be appropriate for us? The other HSA plans are around \$187 a month with \$7500+ Deductibles and 20k OOP max. 40 % coinsurance down all the services. I am not really sure what that means? I know what an HSA is but we honestly don't have a lot of extra funds at the moment to contribute, we are still paying off the hospital bill from last year delivering my one year old (I had a low deductible plan through work for my pregnancy and still ended up with an \$8000 hospital bill). **Sentara M Gold 1000 Ded / \$387 month premium.** Primary Care Visits- \$35 Co Pay Deductible - \$2000 OOP Max - \$19,900 **Pregnancy-** 20% Coinsurance after deductible. **Emergency Care-** 40% Coinsurance after deductible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmdev9/low_deductible_or_hsa_plan_for_2_adults_with/

↳ sweetoptat (1): "Without contributing to HSA and pregnancy/delivery complications, Sentara will be cheaper option. An HSA plan will could be a better choice in a worst case scenario: <https://preview.redd.it/bx8x10gwawqh1.png?width=1037&format=png&auto=webp&s=e8fd0c0f467dca47f62e5d77137e8587427fd0a1> If either plan has individual OOP max limit, then result could be different."

"I love this. At times I pay out of pocket direct to the lab. I was hospitalized last year and my deductible was \$7,500 which thankfully I had saved in an HSA. It's not about whether you have health insurance. It's about being able to get medical services when you need them and being able to pay for it. There are pros and cons to insurance. You have to do your own research to find the least possible price for what you want."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236IZc&lc=Ugwda9h2f_L9taZ36nl4AaABAg.9UKWECKDuNmAA3KT9mDEKf

"@RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith Just be careful to double check everything with a second source. Heck, I called the ACA call center yesterday, and their hold greeting has the wrong enrollment dates in its messaging. Nuts. I have also found that most do not understand the MAGI benefits of an HSA, so they do not provide good information. It can be a good addition to early retirement financial strategy"

— YouTube · ACA 2026 Update: The One Income Strategy That Saves Thousands · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b7tw43UuPrY&lc=UgzMwvxBrGnOm8H7mj14AaABAg.AQMI1mLhIxAQMpOGZA-zk>

"@davidnprogressI reimbursed myself for my medical expenses for about five years before the lightbulb went off, and I switched to cash flowing the expenses while stockpiling the ACA contributions as an investment account. A few years ago, I moved the HSA from my local credit union to Fidelity for a vastly improved interest rate. Wish I had known to do that sooner!"

— YouTube · Why I Chose a Bronze ACA Plan With Heart Failure (2026 Coverage + HSA Strategy) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vt81218uhdU&lc=Ugz-wboCcPlzPYW7D3J4AaABAg.APOrJfdX-yYAPQnfdFrXD>

"Also self-employed and just dealt with our health insurance today. We are trying to maximize expenses to keep our income under the \$106,000 limit that allows us to qualify for the ACA subsidy. If we happen to make more than that, we will have to pay back the difference. For example, our new plan costs \$2400 out of pocket. The subsidy covers all but \$800. So we pay \$800 monthly out of pocket unless we make more than \$106,000 in which case we have to pay it all back after we file our 2026 taxes. We chose to sign up for an HSA eligible plan to be able to deduct the HSA contributions of \$8750 for the year. It is a ridiculous game that we Americans are forced to play. I am firmly in the "Medicare for All" camp. But our leadership can't seem to do anything to make that happen."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1pn63ub/us_my_health_insurance_just_doubled_curious_how/nu8wxja/

A broker or agent · 24 documents · 20 voices

"I thought the income considered for ACA would be income after we retire not total anticipate income for this year. Husband and I are retiring in July this year. I called health broker and was told our 2026 total income does not qualify us for subsidies this year. We can definitely control our MAGI next year. But the cost of health insurance without subsidies for this year is \$2,400 a month for bronze. Crazy"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 155 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgzvkYbznI6KYejn5LV4AaABAg>

↳ @Reanimator7336 (2): "If you work at all in retirement you are not retired."

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "that is crazy - sorry! here's more about MAGI: https://youtu.be/KDE1jO1z3Sg?si=U8m89wRt_jEUXzMG";

↳ @Reanimator7336 (0): "ACA only goes by taxable income per year period. Its not what tax bracket you are in or gross income."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: <https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>;

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

"Crazy idea - what do you think? Hi, there. Without being too wordy (happy to elaborate if needed), I wanted to ask for input on this idea I have. We make too much money to qualify for ANY subsidies next year (we're not "rich", but we're above the cutoff). Because of this, our health insurance is going to go from \$900 a month for the two of us (already outrageously expensive for the high deductible, bronze plan we have) to \$3,500 PER MONTH. Yes, per month. That comes to \$42,000 per year. And again, that's before paying for any of the actual medical expenses we may incur. I have confirmed this with an insurance agent so it's not just me miscalculating (and yes, I plan to discuss this with the agent as well, but I love the Reddit forums so here I am). I'm thinking there might be something I'm not understanding, but here's my idea - couldn't we just not have health insurance and if something catastrophic comes up (cancer diagnosis, for example), we could move (we have the option to change residency because we do own a home in another state) and then use the special enrollment period to get insurance? I mean, remember - we're talking \$42,000 per year otherwise - and that's before anything even happens. Thanks for your input."

— r/HealthInsurance · 24 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxtql8/>

↳ (0): "Nope. The moving QLE requires the individual to have had qualified coverage for at least one of the 60 days prior to the move. Moving QLE is predicated on the loss of coverage or moving outside the effective coverage area of the current policy."

↳ (0): "These premiums are unsustainable. These prices are like sending a kid to college each year, and that's before your out of pocket costs. But to your question: No, simply changing residency won't allow you to insure after the fact. If you have an accident or emergency situation like a burst appendix, a new plan would not cover those bills retroactively. A cancer or cardiac diagnosis requiring treatment next month? That could work, but you would still face the up front costs of biopsy, tests and diagnosis."

↳ (0): "The thing is that medical bills without insurance are staggeringly high - far, far more than you could save from not paying these extortionate rates. You can very easily be in the \$100k+ territory for some fairly 'routine' surgeries, without even a night in hospital."

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/ysinnk/>

↳ (0): "I wonder if the sales agent had ulterior motives (difference in commission?)"

↳ (0): "It definitely sounded fishy when I heard it. Thanks"

↳ (0): "Buy on marketplace plan. Direct is not subject to the ACA regulations."

"I'm in Ohio and when I retired last year at 62 I went through an insurance agent to help me with my ACA. No charge. She was able to answer a lot of my questions. This year with on SS for income I'm down to a pittance for my premium, as long as I don't go over my income estimate."

— YouTube · 6 Retirement Health Insurance Options BEFORE Medicare Eligibility Kicks In · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOx1T4WKebc&lc=UgzshUvN_8zY2EIJMFI4AaABAg

↳ @Oglulubell (0): "How do you find an insurance agent?"

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAg

↳ @TracyMadsen-rx2fu (0): "I think you might need a different broker, that's not true. I have a silver plan PPO, have had it for about 7 years"

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/>

↳ (0): "Brokers don't get paid from client. The insurance carriers pay the broker. ACA plans prices go by your income. Prices are ridiculous high."

↳ (0): "That's what I thought too, but I couldn't account for the discrepancy in prices between the brokers prices and healthcare.gov prices. Because one plan was \$30 higher but the more expensive plan was \$50 less from the broker. So I was trying to figure out why that was."

↳ (0): "We used a broker for many years and last year they found plans that we didn't even see on the marketplace. We usually get a letter in October from the broker telling us to call if needed. We didn't get that this year. We have always had good luck with brokers and I never felt like they were trying to up charge me. My husband and I have discussed how they make their money, but it wasn't through us."

"Get government OUT of healthcare and insurance! Back when Obumer first messed with it and caused premiums to start to rise (both ACA and non ACA plans as the new costs for new required benefits, legal and regulatory compliance, etc has to be absorbed via any and all health insurance plans regardless of an ACA plan or not). We went from 3 people being covered on what would be about a "silver" on the ACA or a mid plan was \$238 per month. Today for two people it is over \$1,300 per month and there are areas that are even higher than the state and county / area that we live in. On a per covered basis our health insurance premiums are up 410%. Even a few years ago when we moved from one state to another we paid around \$492 per month....four years later, just over \$1,300. thank you government. Just the insurance premiums and rent (no power, water, food, gas, car insurance or any other expenses) costs me \$40,200 per year and that gets paid with after tax dollars so you do the math. just the fixed cost of a roof and insurance with nothing else and we need to earn around \$47,000 before taxes to cover that. God forbid we want to eat, have car insurance and other insurance, fuel for the car, car repairs, clothing, phone service, etc. Again, great work to the tick in Congress for screwing everyone over rather than just helping the few that need, ACTUALLY need the help. All the fraud out there so far should give everyone some idea of the money we flush down the drain. I wager if it was totaled up it would be around \$500 billion per year or more and that is already after the gubment makes so many other things artificially expensive....college tuition anyone? Nothing my insurance agent loves more than sitting across the table from me as we review the plans that, even after I spend \$16,000 per year on premiums for I still have very high deductibles making it really cost me around \$25,000 before insurance does anything when you add premiums and deductibles together (and no I don't count \$15 off some pharma scrip as mattering). What they need to do is allow, the law prevents this for most people - that's right the government is making it illegal for you to purchase certain types of plans less you fall into a small criteria. what am I ranting about? Disaster style policies. Everyone needs to be able to get those but for most plans you have to be under a certain income or under 30 years of age or just unemployed and need a bridge. My spouse and I don't need all the "benefits" we just want emergancy coverage and disease treatment type stuff. There is so much that pad plans, even in hers (and she is almost 50!) still has all this child birthing stuff, breast feeding classes, etc. all for "free" even though she is almost 50 and also can't even have kids in the first place but, same risk pool as everyone else rather than being prices as an individual like with your car insurance."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=UgzNhfDE0RdaDEBn28x4AaABAg>

↳ @bookmark692 (0): "The Messiah picked winners and losers with health insurance. F'D everyone, except the politicians."

"A few years ago when my wife passed I went to an agent as I was clueless about health insurance. He walked me through and explained everything I was looking at. I've since become more comfortable with the process but still list him as my agent in appreciation for how he helped me."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_witho_ut_an_agent_on_their/o95pinv/

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but

wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9jkcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>";

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q9bscn/>

↳ (0): "DO NOT USE THIS SCAM COMPANY. PAY EXTRA FOR A BETTER OPTION. THESE PEOPLE WILL SIMPLY TAKE YOUR (AND TAXPAYER) MONEY AND FIND CHICKENSHIT WAYS NOT TO COVER YOUR CLAIMS (Like refusing to give you your PCP even though they're in network)"

↳ (0): "I still have not received any information or contact from them. No information about my plan coverage not even a welcome letter. I received a bill for sure but what it covers .. Who knows because I haven't received any information and none is available online. I'm paying 650 a month out of pocket .. All I can do is hope I don't need it and wait out until next year"

↳ (0): "i strongly suggest switching to a different carrier. these guys are worthless. when you need them to cover something, you'll probably have to hire an attorney to get them to cover anything"

"Trust your insurer even less than ACA. They don't know shit. I've had pre-authorization for a medicine for years. Last December I go to fill it and it's like \$175 and I had already met my deductible and out-of-pocket maximum in January. I hadn't paid anything for it since January 2025. I call my insurance company, and I get an agent telling me it's a new law that Congress passed, and I called her out immediately because I follow politics closely, so I asked her to tell me what the law was, the new long she kept telling me I was incompetent. Even though she couldn't tell me the law of Congress had passed she just kept repeating it passed one. I don't usually do this, but I asked for her superior. She flat out told me that no, this is not a new congressional law, although it is a congressional law, but it was passed in 2022. I knew I was right. They had given me prior authorization for years, but only because the namebrand was cheaper than the generic. Then the generic lowered their price so low that they stopped covering the namebrand. I tried the generic and it was ineffective, and I had my first asthma attack in decades. I'm not trying to be picky, all my other meds are generics and it all is fine but this particular one, it just did not work for me. It's a maintenance asthma inhaler. So I have this prior authorization and it is useless. The pharmacy is even baffled by it. It's a DAR law, dispense as written. Well, of course it's going to be dispensed as written because I have a prior authorization. If I want that medicine, I have to pay \$175 for it, every month. So now I am on a different one and I will be going on blood pressure meds soon because it raises my blood pressure. I don't have high blood pressure, I never have until I started this medicine. It is effective, but I have to go on another medicine but it's a cheap one. They don't care about my health, they just care about the cost. I hate insurance. It is sorely needed. I had it almost all of my life and then we decided to move to Florida. I retired from my cushy corporate job, but I lost my insurance and I didn't have it for years. So I know what it's like to go without it and even though it's a pain in the ass, I would rather have it than not And I am hoping that nothing comes up for you in the next 10 days or so. My other message was a bit snarky and I apologize. I hate dealing with anything health insurance wise, no matter who I'm dealing with. They make it so much harder than it actually is"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1st004d/aca_canceled_my_policy_without_my_permission_and/ohpu0tq/

"ACA or individual plan Recent layoff and my insurance runs out EOM. COBRA is too expensive so I choose several options from the Marketplace to consider, but not sure if I should consider an individual plan from somewhere like Florida blue or United. I have had several agents reach out (I made the mistake of entering info on an aggregator when I thought I was on United's site.) Is it worth my time to get a quote? I don't trust the agents, but some are saying they can quote me low monthly costs vs the marketplace. What am I missing if I can get a lower cost? I do go to doctors semi-regularly but this year should be in a good place to not have to go unless something pops up. I got medication refills for the next 3-4 months coverage. I figure even if I have to go to the urgent care that won't happen more than once or twice. I just feel like what I get from the agents would be conditional and I wouldn't realize it until it is too late. Any thoughts on going through the marketplace vs Ind. plans?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s6e74c/>

↳ (0): "You shouldn't bother considering non-ACA compliant coverage. It's just a waste of money. With that being said, off marketplace plans do exist with some carriers in some states - if you're not eligible for subsidies, you can explore those options. But a broker wouldn't be the place to do so - you can see all options directly on the carriers websites, so UHC.com, etc."

↳ (0): "Thanks all. I had a feeling those agents weren't the best choice, but good to understand why. I'll stick with ACA."

↳ (0): "They are cheaper because most of the time they are medically underwritten. Anything you are being treated for right now would likely be excluded from coverage. There are the rare private plans where this is not the case, but they are few and far between. As small business owners my husband and I looked at many options for the two of us. ACA was the only comprehensive option."

"It is not open enrollment for ACA, so you would need a life event to enroll right now. And I hope no one sees this and uses it because I would be too afraid of what it might be. I'm trying to be kind. I used a broker many years to sign up for ACA, but they don't do much of what you told me, they just helped me pick a plan that might be best for me. I have no idea what they get, but I worked with the same one for years and her name happened to be the same as mine."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_witho
ut_an_agent_on_their/o94hc0r/](https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_witho_ut_an_agent_on_their/o94hc0r/)

"I've been in the insurance business since 2011 and remember the first open enrollment on October 1, 2013. Many agents thought they would make a lot of money enrolling entire families with full subsidies and promised compensation. But just months later, many left the market when commissions went unpaid. This happened early in my career and left a lasting impression on how I view the ACA. I don't understand why so many agents invest so much time in ACA today. I know it will eventually improve, but in the meantime, why not focus on selling Medicare plans, which offer more reliable income and better persistency than ACA? The ACA market is too volatile—caught in political power struggles—and you can lose a client simply because they got a new job with health benefits or got married. I have an ACA plan (self-employed insurance agent) with no subsidies and pay \$550 for mediocre health insurance. I just received notice that my Aetna CVS ACA plan is leaving the Texas market at the end of the year."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca
changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n3xep4/](https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n3xep4/)

"This is easy. Call the marketplace directly. They are super helpful! I have a plan now for over 5 years when I decided to retire early. This year it is \$105/month for a silver plan with a -0- deductible. Or if you are really lazy just call an insurance broker and they can walk you thru it but I have had friends where they were given the wrong info and were trying to be sold a more expensive policy not through the marketplace. Your choice but it is easy with a simple call"

— YouTube · 6 Retirement Health Insurance Options BEFORE Medicare Eligibility Kicks In · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOx1T4WKebc&lc=Ugz_HpKamLxbpLPx1FF4AaABAg.9I1f9Ivn0EK9I1wRND6X1S

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! ***NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.*** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjvhr9/please_help_best_insurance_in_nj_for_someone/

↳ No-Produce-6720 (8): "I'm not sure if you're meaning to say Medicare, but there is no federal Medicaid. Medicaid is only issued based on the state in which you live. There is no federal option, so I'm unsure what you're referring to there. Aside from that, you need to start at [healthcare.gov](https://www.healthcare.gov). That will point you in the right direction for ACA coverage or Medicaid."

↳ katsrad (7): "One thing is that there isn't a federal medicaid it is going to be provided by the state. There is Federal Medicare which is different and based on age or if you are disabled. The other is use [healthcare.gov](https://www.healthcare.gov) to

look for plans you are eligible for and if you are eligible for any subsidies. Anything outside that can deny you coverage for pre-existing conditions or not pay claims for those."

↳ gingercatlover1 (2): "Yes, we do! There are a lot of resources."

"I have a very good broker I've worked with since 2021. For 2026 I went with an Ambetter higher deductible bronze plan with a lower monthly premium then purchased a gap plan from UBA to cover the high deductible should something happen. I am generally healthy and do wellness visits that are covered. So my monthly expense went up from 7.50 a month in 2025 for my Silver plan to 40.00 per month for this selection in 2026. It also has better prescription coverage than I've had in 2025."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgxjMpss4oRZv7Vk8qt4AaABAq>

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "That's awesome! With the bronze plan you can now use an HSA too! ☺"

"As an ACA marketplace broker, I have to do this with customers periodically. Looks legit to me"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wogzsr/legit_or_scam_help/pbxzcl1/

"@KevinKnauss Wow! Thank you for all of this information! I truly appreciate it! So since I don't have any friends or relatives who can recommend a good broker, then I should google their names to see if they have a website and if it has current ACA info on it? I am in New Jersey. Would you have anyone you would recommend? I would have to find a broker who works with AmeriHealth NJ or Horizon Omnia, I think, because after looking at the getcovered nj website, they seem like the best deals. I will also be getting a dental plan through the broker. (Horizon Family Grins, Dominion Nat'l, Delta Dental)"

— YouTube · How To Estimate Your Income For the ACA Health Insurance Subsidy · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z9N6S-PVqgw&lc=UgyhaLeyC0pMiDguNpl4AaABAq.9Q0rEBFdw0W9Q0x7E4xVA8>

Direct primary care and paying cash · 18 documents · 18 voices

"The key to avoiding high healthcare costs is to be healthy. I've been self-employed for over 16 years and have the ACA since it came out. I pick the cheapest plan which gives my coverage in case of an emergency and all my wellness care. I pay \$131 per month for a bronze plan. I have paid up to \$270 per month in past higher earning years. I pay out of pocket for things not covered if I need them and get a 45% self pay discount. I don't pay a lot for healthcare per year and focus on being active and eating healthy non processed foods. I pay less on medical costs than many pay for insurance alone per year. This has been my way to not fund a ridiculously priced industry. I'm nearing 59. Protect your health at all costs!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxcstwBmYAjgMrsGvh4AaABAq>

↳ @sct4040 (12): "Accidents happen too."

↳ @vogeljennifer6318 (8): "Although this is a great mindset, some people don't have the ability to undo medical issues that require care"

↳ @kona6451 (0): "How old are you? That sounds really cheap"

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

↳ (0): "In short, yes, a provider can always run your information through a carrier website and see if you have insurance or not. Ask for the cash price- say you want to pay cash and not go through insurance."

↳ (0): "They said if I have coverage of any kind (that they don't take of course), then I don't have the option to pay anything but the full cost of the visit :/ I've heard some doctors are more lenient on this than others, which makes me think I should just look for a new doctor. But that feels like a whole other can of worms right now and just kind of overwhelming tbh"

↳ (0): "I mean, OP can ask, but many behavioral health providers don't maintain separate cash-price vs. insurance-price fee schedules. They tend to be more transparent and open about their fees in general, meaning their published fee is the same regardless of payer (although may vary as a function of sliding scales or "scholarships")."

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1lwkch/>

↳ (0): "It's a class H felony in NC for a provider that accepts medicaid (opted in) to take out of pocket payment for services that would be covered under medicaid. Say you went to a dentist that accepted it, they can only bill you for procedures not covered under medicaid like a crown. They wouldn't be able to bill you for services that are covered under medicaid like a cavity filing. If they never opted in to accept medicaid, then it is not fraud. They never agreed to medicaid terms and conditions at all. If you are concerned, before you do anything, you can always call NCDOL or medicaid and make sure you are okay."

↳ (0): "Yes, it can be. Medicaid is for people who cannot pay their own medical expenses. If you show that you have means to pay for your own medical expenses, the state will assume you do not need Medicaid and have been fraudulently receiving benefits. In my state (MD), there are some Medicaid MCOs that do not require referrals from your PCP to receive specialty care. If you are healthy enough to not need to be followed by a PCP, then it matters a lot less if you cannot find one."

↳ (0): "And provider (practitioner/facility) that is contracted with Medicaid must sign a participation agreement that includes the following: In accordance with 10A NCAC 22J .0106 Providers may bill a patient accepted as a Medicaid patient only in the following situations: For allowable deductibles, co-insurance, or co-payments; Before the service is provided the provider has informed the patient that the patient may be billed for a service that is not one covered by Medicaid regardless of the type of provider or is beyond the limits on Medicaid services; The patient is 65 years of age or older and is enrolled in the Medicare program at the time services are received but has failed to supply a Medicare number as proof of coverage; or The patient is no longer eligible for Medicaid as defined in 10A NCAC 21B."

"I did not have health insurance until I was thirty five. I used Planned Parenthood for women's health, walk in clinics (cash pay) in the rare event I got sick, and paid cash for dental cleanings and exams (no cavities). When I decided to start a family, I got health insurance."

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgxYkKzxxCIWdiWSr554AaABAg>

↳ @bradleyonabudget (10): "Oh wow, you really managed to make it work! There's resources out there. Good call once you started a family :)"

"How many Americans are on PPO health insurance that covers seeing specialists/doctors across state lines compared to being on insurance that only covers within the state? I'm on Medicaid in Rhode Island for disability and it's frustrating dealing with out of state approvals. Any advice welcomed. I've had long-term neurological issues like neuropathy, muscle pain, and memory issues for nearly 6 years that neurologists in my state (and in Connecticut) haven't been able to definitively diagnose. I am on SSI for disability, which means I get Neighborhood Health Plan of Rhode Island as my primary insurance, with Medicaid as the secondary. I was told by a neurologist I saw across the border in Connecticut recently (Some doctors in CT take my insurance it seems) that being seen at a bigger hospital like Mass General may lead to a definitive diagnosis. From what I was told by his office after they tried referring me to the hospital, Mass General/MGH is no longer accepting my insurance even with prior authorization, when a few years ago i was told by Mass General they were taking my insurance with those stipulations. I was told by MGH's neurology department staff (who were very nice and compassionate about my situation, to be fair to them) that it's possible the hospital chose not to contract with my insurance this year, hence the change, and that because I am on Medicaid, I couldn't even choose to self-pay to go there. They said it's possible in the future the contractual issue could change, and they also told me to try contacting Neighborhood Health myself and explain the situation and see if they could somehow get me approved to be seen at Mass General. I will be calling them this upcoming week. I was curious as to how often Americans are on health insurance plans that cover seeing specialists across state lines, how difficult it is for them to be approved to see specialists in different states, etc. I find it frustrating that my insurance doesn't work across state lines considering this is the smallest state in the country. Not every specialist is going to be here. Logistically it seems to make sense to me that CT/MA should have a deal with RI insurance to cover people if they at least get prior authorization/approval. As of right now Mass General wouldn't take me no matter what, which I find very concerning and depressing. I have had multiple neurologists say I should be seen in a place like Boston to possibly get a definitive diagnosis, why is that not enough to be seen there? That makes no sense to me."

— r/obamacare · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uheytb/how_many_americans_are_on_ppo_health_insurance/

↳ Good_Educator4872 (3): "Originally they wanted to control what plans you could buy. Govt plans always limited coverage to care within the relevant political entity. No one ever accused the designers of Obamacare of being forward thinking. It was about control. The original thinking was to use the British NHS as a model. There were problems with this. We are different than EUROPEAN COUNTRIES. We have the most extensive checks and balances balance system. The states are sovereign political entities. European states have always been organized from the top down. The US. is the inverse. Our constitution is a mutual agreement among sovereign states to cede certain powers to the Federal government. This limits the federal governments ability to dictate internal state action except in delineated areas. Generally, the Fed can only exert oversight in areas the state is not currently regulating. The Federal government doesn't regulate insurance policies unless the state agrees. Insurance is the purview of the states as an example not the Federal Government"

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes. And I had a policy in RI from the market place there (recently moved out of state). It was a BCBS PPO, the lowest level with an HSA. It has a national provider network and allows for seeing doctors, specialists, labs,etc anywhere in the country. I never had even a single issue and I've got doctors in multiple states (though not in RI because well...)."

↳ littleheaterlulu (3): "Yes! It's weird because it's almost impossible to get a doctor or most specialists in RI but we have one of the very best marketplaces. But it's only the BCBS PPO with the national provider network so look for one of theirs."

"I am self-employed and I'm not able to get health insurance. So I have a health share Network and I have a direct Primary Care subscription that I pay for. As close to insurance as I can possibly get"

— YouTube · My Husband Doesn't Believe In Health Insurance · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Lub47Wc4TI8&lc=UgwMLPM581oaQyNwNAh4AaABAg>

↳ @thecatnextdoor12 (1): "Just curious, how much does this cost?"

↳ @angryarkie1642 (0): "The Cat Next Door It's expensive for what it is. It sounds fancy, but it is called by many as concierge medicine. With that said, if that is what can be afforded it is better than nothing."

↳ @KMF3 (0): "@thecatnextdoor12 for the healthcare share Network I pay \$172 a month and for the direct Primary Care subscription I pay \$85 a month. Christian Healthcare Ministries has a \$500 deductible I believe. That's who I have for the health share Network"

"Cobra Lapsed.... STRESSED.... Long story short, I had a choice last November between relocating or severance package and chose the severance package that came with Cobra coverage. The company sponsored coverage ended on 5/31 and if I continue to self pay I would have coverage til May 27 next year. TLDR I was abroad in June and didn't pay my first month of self payment in time. Upon return, I saw a letter stating that the grace period for each coverage period is the end of that respective month. For example, July's grace period ends tomorrow, July 31, 2026, and August's ends on August 31, 2026. I reached out immediately, assuming I could still activate the account since I was within the July grace period. But of course that's when I learned how this all worked, huge mistake on my part and I am so mad at myself. I am currently in appeal process, on the second appeal now where they're now needing approval from my company to reinstate the account. The team at health equity said usually they are able to reinstate the account through second appeal based on what they have seen? (I talked to 3 different phone representatives) I talked to the benefit team at my former employer and they seem to be willing to help but did ask why the payment lapsed. I explained my situation. How likely is my account able to be reinstated? There are some benefits I'd really like to utilize from my former plan and I know I really fucked up and slipped up. Huge life lesson here.... Any advise or folks with experience on this would be appreciated :(Stressed out. I did reach out to marketplace to get an application in place just in case the appeal is denied, but I am really hoping for the best."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vbdehm/>

↳ (0): "I cannot speak to the likelihood of reinstatement, but can speak to the timeline you're working against for Marketplace. You have 60 days from when your COBRA subsidy expired to choose a policy. You're running on borrowed time, since it's essentially day 60. What state are you in? Have you found new employment? Are you married? Trying to get more information to see if Medicaid is at all an option, since that program is always enrolling new members so long as they meet eligibility criteria."

↳ (0): "the insurance broker I worked with said if application is in before day 60 they will still honor it thankfully. yes another life lesson here for sure. smh on my part sigh"

↳ (0): "Update on this: Luckily I got off exchange Blue shield silver insurance in time within the 60 days deadline (cheaper than the covered California silver loaded version) Now just crossing my fingers that the appeal with Cobra / My former employer goes through so my cobra account can be reinstated. But in the mean time I am covered if all else fails. Still hoping for the best....!"

"I don't think I understand. If the generic dropped their prices very low, why don't you just buy the generic out of pocket? If the insurance covered the brand name but doesn't now, do they cover the generic? I don't understand prescription coverage. I have a bronze plan with no prescription coverage, or very little. I'm honestly not sure because I don't use it. I just use GoodRx. Have you check Good Rx and Mark Cuban's plan for the generic drug you need? Some of my generics are under \$12 for a three-month supply."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omvf7n1/

"I should first say that I can arrange my affairs to qualify for Medicaid or the ACA (it just depends on how much capital-gains I take vs. Roth distributions). I used to be on Medicaid, but with the upcoming change to Medicaid requiring work requirements (I consider myself fully retired), I wanted to get into an ACA plan (at the bare minimum 138% of poverty income rate); there was also some screwing things with Medicaid such as me not being able to get the plan to do mail-order Rx filling (an important thing since I travel a lot), to say nothing of getting my sleep Rx covered properly (I could get my Medicaid PCP to write the script, but I would have it filled at Health Warehouse), so presuming I could have gotten a proper PCP in the new ACA plan, I would be saving money on Rx. But since I can't get a proper PCP from the ACA plan - nor a psychiatrist that my PCP told me I had to see - I'm stuck going back to my old PCP as a self-pay patient, and getting the sleep Rx from the old mail-order place. And of course, I'm paying \$80/mo for the privilege of this rotten service. That said, I was able to get my annual blood test, and I will getting a feces test for colon cancer, from the new ACA plan (I would have gotten it no matter what plan I would be on). Yes, my new PCP sucks, and I have fired him (I told him that I don't trust him with my health management); I guess I could looks for another one, even a nurse-practioner, but how do you find one that will do the job. Do I say, "Hi, I am a subscriber with the AmWorse Premier plan, and I am looking for a PCP; one of the requirements I have for my PCP is that I get my 10mg Zolpidem Rx - that I have had for 30 years or so, and that I could prove for the last 12 years from my old PCP - which I consider an essential part of my health maintenance. If you run your practice such that you can't do this, then I cannot give you my business"."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omz7nsn/

"I'm 60, retired and without health insurance. My pension puts me over the max income to receive any subsidy amount. I just can't justify 16-18k annually for so-so coverage. The providers I see give me very generous discounts and I use CostPlus pharmacy but it is a very big risk to be uninsured. Unfortunately, I retired right before we knew the enhanced subsidies were not going to be extended. I am single and basically one serious illness away from losing everything. My semi-decent pension will not be able to cover even a short hospitalization."

— YouTube · \$ How MUCH ACA Marketplace PREMIUMS Are Going UP In 2027 · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOGTkeTtK0Y&lc=Ugwhp02bcNjY6t3rVf4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Oh no! I'm sorry to hear that. There are some other options like farm bureau health insurance (depending on where you live) or healthshare programs."

↳ @ThatGirlinStitches (1): "@Trilobites-and-Tentaculitos It's not that simple. 1500+ monthly premium isn't so easy for a person with a modest pension. Not much left after paying rent, utilities and basic living expenses. There isn't any tax breaks to speak of for those under age 65 and without a spouse or dependents. The cost of medical coverage is too high in this country."

↳ @cindyhenry1410 (0): "Wow this scares me!!"

"I've been looking into DPC. I'm very confused. Maybe you can clarify. I spoke with two DPC providers I found on line. One said I would need health insurance, the other said there were no monthly fees and they went by my insurance. I thought the whole point of DPC was that it cuts health insurance out of the picture. Thank you so much for your video by the way!! Once I get this figured out, I will save a lot of money!"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=Ugy!g-vZ-aj7IlnhUbR4AaABAg>

↳ @VictoriaDorsano (1): "Sorry for the delay here. They sometimes will ask for insurance to know that you're covered for other circumstances or if they need to refer out. A true DPC should not require insurance though. There are a lot of "hybrid" DPCs out there that market as a DPC but are actually more concierge primary care and actually ask for insurance. Keep trying some other providers near you! There are ones out there that won't require insurance."

↳ @keithcostello3883 (0): "I appreciate the likes but what do I do if every DPC network I speak to says I need health insurance? I thought the whole point of DPC is that I don't need insurance. Please if anyone can help, that would be great."

↳ @keithcostello3883 (0): "@VictoriaDorsano thank you"

"I know where we are, we are short of doctors. A primary care physician in my area has a patient load of about 4000 people. One year I went through four hematologists, it was the same office, I didn't change providers, that's how fast they went through them. One of my docs told me that they burn you out and doctors quit. In January, my primary care physician wanted to refer me to a cardiologist, his first appointment was in December. There is definitely a lack of doctors here. So what people are going to are what I called concierge NPs. I have a friend that is an NP and she opened a business last year, so her business has been open less than a year and she has already hired three full-time people to help her. She uses a Sub subscription based model, but the lowest Sub subscription is \$25 a month and that gets you access to her via phone, text and FaceTime. That's actually not a bad deal. I understand that doesn't help with your medication's but she can write prescriptions and my insurance will pay for the medication. She's my friend so she just helps me out because I will call my doctor and have bronchitis and I don't get a callback for 10 days. Her subscriptions go all the way up to \$450 a month but that's for people that are on the GLP one drugs and that includes the medicine. She will also do house visits at that level. And she is not lacking for patients, hence why she's hired three full-time people to help with the phone calls and scheduling. It's becoming more and more common in other parts of the country too. If you think about it, it's cheaper than going to urgent care or even the ER. Because you can sign up for one month and cancel the next month. And you aren't sitting in the ER or urgent care for hours. She trust my judgment, I'm middle-aged, I know when I have bronchitis. I had a leg wound get infected once and I just sent her a picture and she called in antibiotics. And then about an hour later, the meds are ready at the pharmacy. It's too easy. I'm just trying to put this out there, because you might want to look if it's available in your area. I called them concierge NP's and I don't know why but I do. Now she doesn't take insurance, but she will give you the paperwork to file with it, if you want to do that. She can order labs and x-rays and all of that, but I don't do any of that with her because my insurance won't cover that because she's an out of network doctor. They will cover her meds that she writes. I don't go rushing thinking that they will write controlled substances because she rarely does that. She did it for me, for anxiety meds, because my doctor up and left the area. Took me a bit to find a new one, so she did write that for me, but she knows me, I'm her dog sitter. She wants me healthy so I can watch her dogs."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vu2o9i/were_short_about_96000_doctors_insurance/p50g5f8/

"I havent had insurance in years. Been blessed to not need anything major. I got quotes for health insurance and when I added how much it costs yearly my self pay doctor's appts were a quarter of the price. So I just get a quote every year and put that monthly amount into a savings instead of insurance company."

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgzA4bLnZOHz7gYNR0F4AaABAq>

"We have a DPC membership for the everyday healthcare needs (annual wellness/sick visits, minor injuries or wounds like stitches, lab work, prescriptions, etc) and then we have a non-profit health share for the large medical bills. Both memberships are around \$700 for my entire family. I have used the health share since 2021 and they have paid for everything we have submitted (and within about 2 weeks) and we joined the DPC last December, so it has been a year. I have been sick and just texted my doctor last week for advice on what I can do to get rid of my annoying cough. It is nice to be able to have access to a doctor when needed and I can get seen if I need to (usually same or next day, depending on the situation). I realize this solution is not for everyone, but it has worked well for our family."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1pn63ub/us_my_health_insurance_just_doubled_curious_how/nuc8qjw/

"The most recent example I have - last year - my kids (three kids) had to do their back to school boosters that are required. We had them done and they were mistakenly billed to insurance (which was rejected b/c i don't carry it) and I was passed a bill for \$800. I called and said "I told you I was cash pay, and to not run it through insurance." They said "oh, that was our mistake, we'll recode you as self-pay," and then I got a bill for \$30. We all know insurance is a scam, but seeing a \$770 swing on it was pretty mind blowing."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1w2kg0j/us_how_many_of_you_are_going_without_health/p7059ag/

"I think they'll try to bring back the fee for not having health insurance. If that happens, it proves they aren't for the people—they're protecting insurance CEOs. I dropped my insurance and switched to Direct Primary Care. Insurance is a pyramid scheme: the money flows to the top instead of to the people who actually need care."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=UgxMkKDMaNc-1jd0Ev54AaABAg>

↳ @conceptsofplans (0): "They're also floating 50-year mortgages while Republicans talk about raising the retirement age. If you're paying off a home for your entire lifetime, you're probably not retiring at all."

"I have healthshare plan for catastrophic, and a concierge doc. I don't do traditional insurance. Telling them you're paying cash drops the prices an astronomical amount."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1w2kg0j/us_how_many_of_you_are_going_without_health/p6u6ljv/

"My cobra payment was about 55% of the full self payment I had been making before I was forced out of my plan."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wI GOZsc&lc=UgwQAz8B8T49H5VvSh54AaABAg>

An accountant or planner and Roth conversions · 8 documents · 8 voices

"That is ridiculously wrong! I am doing it right now! I'm 60 and living on my cash/CD ladder while the majority of my assets sit in my Vanguard ETFs. I have minimal capital gains and interest income... after the standard deduction my income doesn't take me even close 150% of FPL. Therefore I actually have plenty of room to do some Roth conversions. At the 150% FPL I qualify for the absolute highest subsidies. I get my ACA coverage for \$0, most of my copays are between \$0 and \$10, while my deductible is \$0."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=Ugy46lgaydfloJhDnJ4AaABAg_A2_0CYUxLIJA2_7uy5vnw1

"My wife and I signed up for ACA for 2026 but I got rejected since I'm a vet with a VA disability rating (anybody else have this experience?). So, I use the VA and she uses ACA but we plan on her using faith based coverage in 2027 so we can start doing more Roth conversions before RMDs. I missed the boat on the bridge account but I'm doing the rule of 55 on my 401k."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=UgyAdZaJlkDYoPRSV8R4AaABAg>

↳ @keithgilbert835 (3): "Glad you have options."

↳ @BoxTruckNomads (0): "@keithgilbert835yep, it's working out!"

"In the past when I absolutely needed to keep the kids on our ACA/non CHIP plan, we converted small portions of our IRAs to ROTH in low tax brackets. In my case, I had decently healthy kids who would spend the summer away at camps/grandparents, and they needed OOS coverage. since then, our state no longer has any plans with OOS coverage, so it is moot. (The plans have gotten so much worse- the 'network' area is three counties, so even going to an in state school is problematic) A note about teens/young adults on ACA plans. My two were already in college on fantastic financial aid packages when the OOS national network was removed. I ended up having to purchase the plans offered by the colleges, which are extremely comprehensive, but 300\$/ mo each. By the end, I was paying \$300 (kid1), \$300 (kid 2) ~\$300 (older parent on Medicare plus part G and D) \$100 (younger parent on ACA) In previous years, we had managed to get a fantastic plan for all of us for under 100\$ total. As of this moment, the cheapest bronze plan with no subsidy is \$980/ mo just for me. We squeaked by for this year with subsidies, but for 2027 we will have a family size of 2 and also need to do Roth conversions to plan ahead, so maybe 15k just for me plus another ~4K for my spouse."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vli30e/chip_costs_more_than_aca/p31rvcp/

"Yes I'm a CPA the first year under ACA I got a refund of 400 dollars from insurance company. I knew that would not last they would figure out a way to avoid that."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qr4vwl/how_is_it_possible_that_health_insurers_have_had/o2quu9s/

"@mongo2044 I think you are misunderstanding his use of the word "manipulation". Using Roth income, post taxed funds, income, and retirement distributions, you can control your MAGI to get you to your desired income level to qualify for what type of ACA plan you desire. This is not illegal and is a part of retirement planning. I am doing this. I chose a Bronze HDHP+HSA plan. As long as I keep my MAGI under \$55,700 it will be fully subsidized. I chose this plan as I have always been in good health, and it will allow for a higher MAGI for me to do Roth conversions up to the \$55,700 level. Will also allow me to additionally contribute \$5,150 to an HSA account. If something were to happen to me, it has max out of pocket of \$7,050 then 100% coverage."

— YouTube · 9 Health Insurance Options for Early Retirement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qt0r9YBsUzM&lc=UgxBcUQAE0ABwBYBXGI4AaABAg.A43tY4kt2r2A4457uLTjxu>

"I retired two years ago at 59, I have money in a brokerage acct to help bridge the GAP until I can collect SS (min 62) and Medicare 65. Can probably make it longer but healthcare is a cost you have to plan for. I pay 1250 a month and I am a very healthy guy. I do not get an Obamacare subsidy because my income is too high. It is too high because I decided Roth conversion make FAR better sense in the long run than saving a few hundred per mos right now. Do the math before you just take the knee jerk reaction. If you have a healthy IRA/401k converting money to a Roth now and staying in the 22% and less tax bracket will almost always work out FAR better than not doing it in an effort to keep your income low to qualify for Obamacare subsidy."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E&lc=Ugz1PpY1vpQdz11rgcN4AaABAg>

"@Davek111 Kudos to you. This is exactly my strategy when I plan on retiring at the end of the year at 55. I will have no income other than investment income which I intend on keeping low enough (while making Roth conversions) and still receive the healthcare subsidy. Don't the healthcare subsidies differ greatly by state? I've been told MA (my state) has some of the most generous subsidies in the country. Was wondering what state you live in."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=Ugy46l6gaydfloJhDnJ4AaABAg.A2_0CYUxLIJA6-t0KJO2wN

"I am about to retire at 56. I will use cobra for the first year for large lump sum Roth conversion. The cobra will also cover my international travel."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugz7rUmiJj2YZf7qEMJ4AaABAg

Took a job, or kept one, for the insurance · 6 documents · 6 voices

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

↳ Mysterious_Might008 (10): "My bronze ACA plan (TX) has a flat \$50 office visit for my PCP. Specialist office visits are flat \$100. So, I wouldn't be afraid of getting a diagnosis based on office visit fees. As of 2026, all bronze ACA plans are HDHPs. Lab work and other diagnostic procedures are a different story: that's where the mystery hit to the wallet really happens."

↳ SunLillyFairy (8): "Yep! I got charged over \$300 for a diagnostic Vit D test because my ACA insurance deemed it "medically unnecessary" (even though it came back low, they said it wasn't low enough to be necessary), so I didn't even get the contracted rate. I fought it. It took months to get it resolved, and while waiting the lab said I was past due and wouldn't do further lab work, and also kept sending me notices that they were sending me to collections (even though they knew I was appealing through insurance). In the end the insurance changed the category and I paid less than 50.. but SO lame."

↳ MrLB____ (8): "Yes, I agree total scam. You could even buy insurance from the hospital itself via the affordable care act go to their own net work, all owned by the same company the doctor office hospital scam their own insurance company LOL Then insurance scams them back"

"We retired early and we took the silver plan from the market place. \$2400 a month and it was useless. The deductible and out of pocket was so high, the insurance never paid for anything. What a scam! It honestly drove me back to work, just for the insurance. I sure wish my husband was willing to live out of country for a time."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxWsbWgrBC4jKr28s54AaABAg>

↳ @ariefraiser140 (11): "If you guys were paying \$2400/month that means you guys had a pretty big AGI."

↳ @michaelcoglianese4292 (7): "@ariefraiser140so what? That's still ridiculously high amount for insurance"

↳ @metalgirl (2): "I agree... our insurance is twice that. Stupid high. So not fair!!!"

"I've made the decision to quit my dead-end job at Starbucks with nothing lined up. I posted my plan on Reddit and several posters asked me "but what about your health insurance?!?" People really think it's crazy that I'm leaving my toxic job because I will lose these benefits. I have not used my health insurance once in my three years there. I'm young and healthy so I don't need to visit a doctor. The only thing is if I were to get in a big accident or suddenly fall extremely ill. But I would just deal with it if it happens. It's just terrible that people stay in soul-sucking jobs just for health insurance, and I'm not going to be one of those people. I'll figure it out. So many jobs, including low-level retail jobs if I needed to go that route again in desperation, have health insurance included, so I will be just fine."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236IZc&lc=UgyJ3WQDGA0qwi3PR4AaABAq>

↳ @tammihazard8362 (0): "They are fanatical on there"

"Excellent David ! .. I'm lovin' the ACA although dancing the (M)AGI shuffle is getting tiresome (don't worry...I'm not going back to work just for the health insurance), but that's most likely because it's currently tax season. Once 4/15 passes everything will return to normal... ..my taxes are currently in the hands of my tax CPA, so I'm enthusiastically awaiting completion. 2025 was a semi-complicated tax year (lots of trading in taxable brokerage account), and I'm eager to see if my tax calculations are correct. ..Also, you're totally correct about ACA surprises at tax time. My first year of being fully subsidized (2022) I was unaware of the subsidy so I was paying full freight on my monthly premiums. The result was a massive tax refund for that year. My tax CPA told me that this was rare, and most people are the opposite, just like you said... they end up making more money than anticipated and end up with ACA sticker shock. Great video !"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How We Got Health Insurance · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lwy4jmmT1k&lc=UgzbiNXKiEDRa4KE7ml4AaABAq>

↳ @davidnprogress (1): "Taxes! That has been fun here in early retirement, and is a bit of a regret since I did not have a good understanding of long-term gains until just before retiring. 0% tax at our income level?!"

↳ @Mitch-Lifestyle (0): "@davidnprogress Yep...same here (0% taxes). I think what catches most people off guard (myself included) is that they don't realize how tightly coupled ACA and the IRS are. If I had done my own taxes, it's most likely that I wouldn't have gotten the premiums refunded for tax year 2022. People who spend their life as a working stiff, we don't get free stuff, so the very thought of even looking for a subsidy refund never would have crossed my mind !"

"Yes health insurance is why I have to delay retirement. I need my pension, 403b, and SS all together to make it in the U.S. because CoL is so dang expensive. And "barista FIRE" sounded like that FIRE (financially independent retire early) movement paired with working PT as a barista - and I was right. lol"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E&lc=Ugx7zEyCW-1h-bcmmsgN4AaABAq>

"That's right. And I have no debt but now healthcare premiums cost as much as a mortgage for my wife and I. Thinking of going without health insurance insurance for about 7 years. I really don't want to spend the next 7 years working just for health insurance, even part time."

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgyX7V9DV5qpyT5MBFZ4AaABAq.AU9ErdIEPfyAUtq0zo2f-A>

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Wishing premiums matched what they can pay · 13 documents · 13 voices

"My health insurance just went to \$60,000 a year for a silver PPO Prepare for sticker shock. Just checked the IL exchange today, and my BCBS HDHP went from \$1200 a month after subsidies to \$2925 after subsidies (**the plan cost is 60k per year**) the reasons for this are two-fold 1. Expiration of enhanced subsidies 2. The site allowing junk insurers to claim SLC status (benchmark) with plans no one can use. For my area it is an OSCAR HMO which virtually no hospital system or doctor accepts. OSCAR has a 1 star rating from the BBB and dozens of lawsuits against it for failure to pay claims. so I now have to hunt around for a HMO, and my family will lose its doctors. The PPACA as originally passed prevented insurance premiums from eating up more than a certain percentage of your annual income. At 84k for a family of 4, I would pay 42% of my total income in premium payments so I will lose my doctor(s) at the very least and pay way beyond what the law said I was going to. pretty sure I am seeing why some politicians are saying we should tear up the PPACA altogether, because it clearly isn't working, and made a bad situation worse"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,000 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1okz6n1/>

↳ (0): "OP didn't ask for guidance or request any answers. Locking before it spirals even further. Edit: Just to address OP's misguided frustration over the PPACA: In 2021, the Biden administration introduced *enhanced advanced premium tax credits* (eAPTCs) through the American Rescue Plan Act. They were further extended through the Inflation Reduction Act. Through these eAPTCs, folks beyond 400% of the federal poverty level could guarantee they'd spend no more than 8.5% of their household income on health insurance premiums through Marketplace (provided they chose a silver benchmark plan). The reason your subsidies are falling flat is because these enhanced subsidies are not being renewed. This is reason number one behind the government shutdown. One side wants to make these eAPTCs permanent. I'll let you deduce who that is. The PPACA didn't "make a bad situation worse". The current majority party has worked tirelessly to make it worse."

↳ (0): "Wait, how is \$2,925 per month \$60,000 per year?"

↳ (0): "Seems insurance going up regardless of subsidies"

"I retired at 47 and the ACA subsidies are returning to exactly the way they worked then. I surely didn't expect the enhanced subsidies to become permanent. I would love it if they did, but people who pursue early retirement have a plan for maximizing subsidies and this shouldn't be a major hurdle for them. Keeping your MAGI low as an early retiree isn't particularly hard and should have been planned for. I'm still hoping for the return of the enhanced subsidies as they make a lot more sense. The cliff was always such a terrible part of the original ACA."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_is_sue/nn3h71t/

"As nice as it is, the ridiculous gulf between with subsidy monthly premium cost at 400% FPL and 400% FPL+\$1 cliff needs to be addressed. My Bronze plan if under 400% FPL is around \$50/month. One dollar over the 400% FPL it jumps to \$1048/month. Jesus Christ how regressive can you get that me making \$62,601 (a buck over the 400% threshold) pays the same amount as someone making \$10,000,000 a year for the same plan? Sure, if it would really help the program charge me \$100/month at less than 400% FPL, and drop the insane cliff bullshit. Say add 10% to the cost for every \$10k above the 400% FPL? This madness is going to kill a lot of people as it stands; shit even with a low cost premium, so many can not cover the deductible, co-pays, etc."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pupkpu/hakeem_jeffries_says_obamacare_subsidy_extension/nvtftj4/

"I picked the 2nd lowest cost Silver plan. I wish they would just not put such a dogshit plan up since it drives the Premium Tax Credit down."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omt8tqt/

"This is kind of ridiculous, but I also have Health First and if I was receiving one cent Health premium bills, I would be calling when I got the first one to see if this was an error or if I truly needed to pay it and then I would pay it if I did owe it I have debited \$.57 before at the store, so I know it's possible to debit a penny or to charge a penny per month So sorry, I can't have that much sympathy for her when she received bills and even a letter that her insurance was ending and she decided to ignore it and think it was a rounding error or an error on their part You don't mess around with insurance because it can snowball. You need to become an expert and your insurance plan and that's exactly what I have done. I've had Health First for about five years now and a couple years ago, I knew I had paid too much. They kept saying I hadn't, Health First. So I filed a grievance and I listed out every payment I had made to any doctor or any prescription. They still wouldn't admit fault, but I got a check for the exact amount. I said I had overpaid by. What changed is you used to go to the doctor and you would pay your co-pay if you had one but other than that, they would bill you. Because they would build the insurance and see what it would be paid and if there was anything left over that was owed, then they would bill you. Now they're trying to collect everything upfront. That year I had went to a dermatologist and when I left and went through the checkout part, they told me it was \$143.50. I had had a full body check and I had had two moles removed. I knew I had reached my out-of-pocket maximum. And I told them that. So then they say I had to pay \$30 which is my co-pay for a specialist. I didn't want to do that, but I caved and did it. I go home and call my insurance company and they say no, you are right, you have met your out-of-pocket max, you didn't owe anything. It took my insurance nearly 3 weeks to get a hold of their billing department and they wanted to give me a credit. How do they know I'm coming back next year??? they don't Send me a check. And they did. But it is your job to know your insurance plan and if you don't, you need to be calling and asking. And I know they don't make it easy. Part of your insurance coverage is on this website and your prescriptions are on a different website and something else is on a different website, they do not make it easy. But it's in your best interest to learn it. So I do see it that it was this woman's fault, she should've called, on that First bill that she got this set of Penny, I would never assume anything with insurance. To me, she looks like a fool for losing her insurance over a penny a month or five cents a month or whatever it was. She tanked herself by not paying that. I would've sent a check every month for a Penny. Or I would've debited it or put it on a credit card. I have the hospital here try to go after me over \$.57. I paid it and I had the confirmation page because I print all of that out. It turns out they decided to take that \$.57 and put it on something else, even though on the screen it showed me it was going towards the bill that I owed \$.57 for. Oh, I got on the phone and raised hell and they actually ended up just erasing the \$.57 altogether. It turns out even though it's showing me that that \$.57 went towards the \$.57 bill I owed, but if you owed anything prior, they can change it and put it towards that. And I didn't know anything prior, it all had just crossed in the mail. The minute I get a bill for something healthwise, it gets paid and goes back out in the mail the next day. I don't like doing online payments when it comes to health bills. I prefer to send a check still."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1s8bxnc/an_insurer_canceled_a_womans_coverage_over_a/odismhs/

"I have 18 more years to go. About half our portfolio is Roth. We're also contributing to a taxable account. We should be able to keep our MAGI down to qualify for subsidies. We like to retire by age 58."

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3I_3XBgfCw&lc=Ugw0yiA9CO38f9mm9RR4AaABAq

↳ @scottunclocked (0): "Thanks for sharing. That is awesome that 1/2 is in Roth & starting to think about early retirement 18 years in advance. I bet you will be ready to retire even sooner with you starting your prep so early! Good luck in your preparations."

"I asked for the same. I have my plan, but want to see other options I may not have thought of. For me, I plan to retire at 54 and I will have access to my 401k through the Rule of 55 at that point. I have a taxable brokerage and a smaller Roth, too. My hope is to live off of 20k or so in dividends that the brokerage kicks out, and targeted sales of other holdings in there that don't have a low cost basis. If needed, I can draw 1-2% from 401k, but will try not to. All the money I have put into my Roth is MAGI invisible and accessible, but I want it to continue to compound. So, Cash, taxable divs, small targeted brokerage sales, careful 401k draws, and Roth basis. I should be able to spend 70K without all of it being visible (only divs and cap gains) after the standard deduction and stay qualified for subsidies. I also plan to pay off the balance of my mortgage just prior to retiring to eliminate \$24k in needed spend due to mortgage payments. I could live my same lifestyle with \$24k less draw."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvbI8&lc=Ugx7ppDMreOUaE9H3JZ4AaABAq.AVEI2UZMHtEAVH3SoCOuCD>

"They get to pay the full price like me who doesn't qualify for a subsidy. They will realize there is no affordable in the affordable care act. It needs to be fixed because it's never been affordable. Democrats had 4 years to fix it under Biden. If they loved their subsidies so much, they should have stretched them out for extra years. Healthcare charges are completely unrealistic and bloated. A primary care visit should not cost \$480. We have Obamacare insurance and still pay \$275-375 for a basic primary care visit at the University of KY. And are lousy Obamacare deductible is over \$13,000. And for a family of four, we are paying \$1,300 a month. Fix healthcare! Stop letting doctors and hospitals charge so much. A basic PT visit shouldn't cost \$560 for an hour of stretching and ice."

— YouTube · What Happens if Obamacare Subsidies Expire? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=onsEZNtGKC&lc=UgxjhcPZQ79CG0ACCbR4AaABAq>

"Just found your channel! Great video. I was thinking that when I retire at 59.5, for the first year I would pay the full unsubsidized amount to take pressure off as I get my retirement sea legs, knowing that I can get a refund of about \$550/month if I'm eligible at tax time, which I'm pretty sure I will be. After a couple years I should know where I stand. I feel that's preferable to sweating every month during that first year. That said, I didn't know you could update your profile during the year, so that may change things!"

— YouTube · ACA Premium Shock? Pay Less All Year · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8zEUYMnF5vI&lc=UgzCfklzFQuttMcT8ix4AaABAq>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Thank you so much, and I'm glad the video helped and I'm also very glad you watched and discovered my channel! Yeah, I think a lot of people don't know you can update your income estimate with the ACA throughout the year, so I'm happy to spread the news so more people know! ;)"

"Great video. Thank you very much. I would like to know who decide what plan belongs to what level? Shopping medical insurance is confusing at best. I wish I can buy the health insurance in the grocery store, everything is clearly priced, the quality is open for your exam, sometimes you even have the food samples for tasting."

— YouTube · How The Obamacare ACA Health Insurance Subsidy Is Calculated · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YftaFfME8-Y&lc=UgyOaHEnC6jYNPDv4bV4AaABAg>

↳ @KevinKnauss (1): "The plans are assigned to a metal tier level based on their actuarial value rating. They must meet certain minimum requirements. For example, a Bronze 60 is estimated to cover 60% of the average person's medical expenses. At least in California, all of the metal tier levels offered through Covered California must have the exact same member cost sharing for copayments, coinsurance, deductible, and maximum out of pocket amounts. To achieve this the plan has to calculate the cost of health care for a specific region and then look at their experience with paying claims. You will note that some plans are much more expensive for the same metal tier level. That reflects the size of the providers in-network (doctors, hospitals, labs, etc.) and the type of plan: HMO, EPO, PPO."

↳ @erguy6319 (1): "@KevinKnauss Thank you!"

"I wish my premiums could go exclusively to helping people like you husband get the health care they need and not shareholders and executives. My mom's cancer treatment was also absurdly expensive and if it had been pre-ACA she'd likely be dead. Congrats on your husband's remission!"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pb2hse/cancer_is_expensive/nroj3e3/

"I wish I could afford health insurance. I fall in the line not poor enough to get any help and dont make enough to afford a policy and the deductibles."

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgyKr6jKZ9Mn1mrrRCh4AaABAg>

"As someone with chronic conditions, I never even considered not having insurance. I wish I could afford to not have a gold plan."

— YouTube · I'm Young & Healthy, Can I Skip Health Insurance? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WTtjmdyTCRM&lc=UgyoB8wFDRdHnI31DZI4AaABAg>

Should have chosen or estimated differently · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Billed \$1600 so far for free preventative colonoscopy I'm 52 years old and never had a colonoscopy so I thought I would take advantage of the \$0 out of pocket preventative colon cancer screening through my ACA health plan. I had the colonoscopy last month and a couple days ago I got an email from the hospital saying that I have a bill. It's \$1600 for the colonoscopy. I went to reddit of course and saw that reddit seems to agree that it should have been free. No polyps were found. I spent hours on the phone yesterday with the hospital and the insurance company. The lady at the hospital told me that I was mistaken about preventative care being free. She said that there are thousands of different plans and each plan does it differently. She said they submitted my claim and the insurance paid for part of it and that I am responsible for the other \$1600. After talking to her for a while I wasn't getting anywhere so we agreed to disagree and I called the insurance company. The insurance rep spoke English as a second language and didn't seem to understand the point I was making. She told me how much the total was, how much insurance had paid, and how much I was responsible for. When I said things like "I think there is a mistake, this should be free of charge since it was preventative" she simply repeated the totals as if she didn't understand. She was supposed to call me back at 2pm today and never called. I guess I will be spending tomorrow on the phone again trying to get the \$1600 taken off my bill. Nobody I have talked to so far is aware of the ACA policy that preventative care is covered in full. They seem to think that I am just saying that to get out of paying my bill. Any advice for what I can say tomorrow. Edit: OK, I just got off the phone with the United Healthcare rep. She said that there was no mistake. She said I had 2 procedures done and only one was preventative. I asked her for the diagnostic codes for the procedures and she only gave me one code G0121. She seemed like she wanted to get me off the phone so I didn't argue. She apologized several times and said there was no mistake, I have to pay the \$1600. I had a referral for "Screening for colon cancer Z12.11" and have no knowledge of any second procedure. EDIT 2 OK I got some more info today. I confirmed that my plan offers the colon cancer screening at 0% copay and no deductible. The insurance says that I got the colon cancer screening paid for (they paid \$150). But I was charged \$1600 for an endoscopy that was not preventative care. All the CPT codes are missing for the non-preventative endoscopy. Here it is called a HC colonoscopy. The person I talked to said that my primary code was Z12.11 and my secondary code was K57.30 <https://preview.redd.it/3qbqhqlod7ug1.png?width=700&format=png&auto=webp&s=7ec1b565073bcc88f0403c5064e0be6ec17b28b6> <https://preview.redd.it/09k2gdppd7ug1.png?width=691&format=png&auto=webp&s=9e15198b82f8833f30009a763184c6e58817a42f> Update 3 I talked to a different insurance rep today and got a completely different reason for my bill. This one acknowledged that I only had one procedure and that it was a colonoscopy, not an endoscopy. She said that while a colonoscopy can be preventative, mine was not preventative because I had it done in a hospital. I asked her where I should have gone to get a preventative colonoscopy and she said that I should have gone to an office. I told her I went to my doctor's office and they referred me to the hospital. She said she understands it is frustrating and offered to help me file a claim adjustment request. So in 10 to 15 days I should be getting the decision. I still think it makes no sense because they paid the claim submitted by the doctor who performed the colonoscopy even though he did it at a hospital. But the claim submitted by the hospital was not preventative because the colonoscopy happened at a hospital."

— r/HealthInsurance · 233 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sg3ast/>

↳ (0): "If it's a true ACA plan, you'd be correct and there seems there would be some sort of issue with them processing. Where did you get your ACA plan? Do you have a copy of the EOB you can post?"

↳ (0): "Did you confirm the doctor you used was in network?"

↳ (0): "Also - an issue we ran into once is that the procedure the colonoscopy being done by the doctor is indeed included but not the facility fee. So you have to pay a facility fee - and even if they are in network they could be not covered."

"I estimated my income for 2025 within \$1200 of what it actually was and I still owe \$680! Very frustrating. I can easily pay it but there are probably people who can't. I don't understand how my subsidy amount was off by \$54 per month. I absolutely would overestimate, wish I would have done it for 2026."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/o7l2a6a/

"@davidnprogressI reimbursed myself for my medical expenses for about five years before the lightbulb went off, and I switched to cash flowing the expenses while stockpiling the ACA contributions as an investment account. A few years ago, I moved the HSA from my local credit union to Fidelity for a vastly improved interest rate. Wish I had known to do that sooner!"

— YouTube · Why I Chose a Bronze ACA Plan With Heart Failure (2026 Coverage + HSA Strategy) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vt81218uhdU&lc=Ugz-wboCcPlzPYW7D3J4AaABAg.APOrJfdX-yYAPQnfkDfrXD>

"I retired at 59 a few years ago and have been taking advantage of the ACA health insurance. I found the Bronze plan to meet our needs and have \$0 monthly premiums. As Erin mentions, I'm manipulating my "income" as I've been living off of after tax savings. What I wish I had is a table showing income level (married couple) and monthly cost for a Bronze plan. When filling out the info on the ACA website, I entered \$48,000 income and got my premiums totally covered. Maybe I could have more income and still be totally covered? Maybe I'd choose to claim more income and pay some premium as I'm eventually going to have to move my IRA savings into income. Anyone know of such a table or formula? Thanks"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpCfE&lc=UgzCg4N-tU7dq7fzFtJ4AaABAg>

↳ @horacepierce9210 (0): "I'm in the exact same situation as you, except I also covered my son through age 26. Since I couldn't find a table for planning, I used the tool and just kept entering different incomes to generate the associated insurance cost (50K, 60K, 70K, 80K, 90K, 100K). I captured the data in a spreadsheet and use it for analyzing strategies (like how much to pull from IRA, and how much to use in Roth conversions). In any case, if you're using a bronze plan, be sure to fully fund your HSA (maximize it for year). Since HSA contribution is deducted from income, it will be tax-free growing account that will really help you in the future."

↳ @craigerl (0): "@horacepierce9210 . Thank you very much for your reply and advice. I had no idea that I could contribute to a HSA. I just opened an account on Fidelity and moved \$9550 from my Individual (after tax) account to the HSA and then moved the same amount from my Rollover IRA to my Roth IRA. I'm assuming that my MAGI will remain the same. Thanks again."

"I wish I knew this last year, I went through the market place and had to pay close to \$600. Cobra was for me over \$1k couldn't do it. Oh well, now I have 3 weeks till Medicare."

— YouTube · 6 Retirement Health Insurance Options BEFORE Medicare Eligibility Kicks In · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOx1T4WKebc&lc=UgyTbmc4q4hx5RyMyJR4AaABAg>

"I totally agree with you on "never go cheap on healthcare" but I wish I did larger Roth Conversion when I was on ACA."

— YouTube · Healthcare Before 65: In-Depth ACA vs. Roth Conversion Analysis · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gUjrNm-VLF8&lc=UgwDMADRL27zUJcPdc14AaABAg.AEZqhlMpg6cAE_7FqY1Mn1

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Free to work for themselves or retire early · 29 documents · 20 voices

"\$2600/mth, \$6k deductible for wife and I Blue Shield Bronze HSA PPO w/ \$6k deductible is looking like \$2650/mth for 2026, for wife and I (middle aged, in good health). This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed. This is completely unaffordable. Having already cut all our costs to the bone, I only have one option, which is to raise my rates, and hope that my competitors will also be raising theirs too so mine aren't extortionate. The only other thing I could do it seems is to become younger, which I'll try and organize, but seems to have some complex issues. This is going to massively, massively spike inflation."

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o9m8gp/>

↳ (0): "Please don't worry the golden ballroom and Arch monument funding is safe."

↳ (0): "But what about Argentina???"

↳ (0): "They're good, we just doubled down and sent another 20 billion"

"[US] How many of you are going without health insurance? Like everybody else my health insurance almost doubled this year, and I'm honestly not sure I can take another (probably) 20% increase next year. It's to the point where I'm sacrificing contributing to retirement to pay for health insurance (I'm 35, healthy, single and literally have never used my insurance) Are there any options out there other than marketplace for those who are self employed?"

— r/selfemployed · 23 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1w2kg0j/>

↳ (0): "Hey OP. Before you drop it — "healthy and never use it" is exactly the profile one bad day wrecks. It's not the doctor visits. It's the accident or the scan that comes back wrong. Insurance isn't for the year nothing happens; it's for the year something does. I'm 29 and a self-employed health insurance broker myself (total transparency), and that's the only reason I have it (the big what-ifs) A better question than "should I keep insurance?" is "what's the cheapest real coverage for someone healthy?" Worth knowing: **Private, medically underwritten plans** can be priced based on your actual health instead of averaging you in. Often cheaper if you're genuinely healthy. They can also decline you, so if there's anything in your history, it's usually not the route. **High-deductible plan plus an HSA.** Low premium, and the HSA money is yours — it rolls over and follows you, unlike a deductible that resets every January. **Skip health shares.** They aren't insurance, aren't regulated like it, and aren't legally required to pay anything. People find that out at the worst time. At 35 and healthy, price a bronze marketplace plan against an underwritten private one and compare. Your income decides which wins — under the subsidy threshold, the marketplace math changes completely."

↳ (0): "I'm saving this comment"

↳ (0): "I only have it thanks to my wife's work."

"The subsidy is the ONLY reason I have been able to quit working at 62 and have insurance."

— YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=Ugytp8nxLMd_bBU8xgx4AaABAg

↳ @Sebastian-CoveredCA (3): "Absolutely! I know a fellow broker who's helped countless people retire early by leveraging ACA subsidies. More people deserve to know about these affordable options — I might even make a video on this soon thanks to your comment."

↳ @JackBenny-o1g (0): "I dont qualify for them now. Cant retire."

↳ @anniesshenanigans3815 (0): "@JackBenny-o1g why is that?"

"Excellent video!! I retired early and I'm 62 and on the ACA. My biggest concern right now is the current administration is trying to kill the ACA. I have 3 years left until Medicare and feel really vulnerable. I feel like I'm living on a hope and a prayer until 65. Keep the great content coming!!!"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugx20_ft51xWWyopGPR4AaABAg

↳ @janetmartin9372 (2): "No. The previous administration added additional subsidies in 2021 and 2023 on top of the original aca. They scheduled them to expire end of 2025. Why should middle income people pay subsidies to higher income people to help them pay their health insurance? We are back to regular aca and there is help for those up to 400 percent of poverty level."

"Yes, because middle-aged people like generation X, which is what I am, we don't need healthcare at all. Because we have never been screwed when it comes to insurance. I'm tired of this young versus old battle. We are either in this together or we aren't. You pick if it's more important to do thing for your own generation or to do it for the most people possible, we both know which is the right answer I played the corporate game and made sure I got a pension, but I can't exactly draw off of that pension at age 38, which is when I left that company. I still had another 30+ years to work at that age. I didn't realize how lucky I was to have benefits like I did and I hated corporate America. I am not sad that I left and the ACA actually saved mine and my husband's ass as we are both self-employed. But I know we can do better. For all, not just for the young, you got plenty of time before you can even think of retirement."

— r/obamacare · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vd44zd/appalling_cruelty_and_al_i_to_fund_more_tax_cuts/p174eq9/

"IMO, you are SO right to caution about health insurance cost, and include it in retirement plans. When I retired at 56, I continued with my former company's (supposed) subsidized retiree plan. I particularly needed full coverage for my wife, and her prior illness made it impossible to shop around.. Between the premium and deductible, it was \$15k per year. And, this was over 10 years ago. Thank goodness for Medicare. Between Medicare Part B & D, plus a supplemental Part B plan for my wife and I, and a very small deductible, our cost per year is a little more than \$9k. Bankruptcy due to health expenses is the single biggest financial problem facing retirees in America."

— YouTube · 6 Retirement Health Insurance Options BEFORE Medicare Eligibility Kicks In · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOx1T4WKebc&lc=UgzxiHN7eM_jHcBuNPN4AaABAg

"The ACA helps people other than self-employed people too. Might wanna look into exactly who the ACA covers. And so sorry I'm self-employed, we built a small business, but that means I shouldn't have healthcare. We could always afford to pay some, we couldn't afford it all. And yes, I spent my years in corporate America, I got a pension before I was 40. But unlike a lot of sloth like Americans, I am not going to retire at age 38. And you also might want to look into the protections that the ACA has given anyone that has any kind of insurance, whether it be ACA, employer sponsored, Medicaid, Medicare, any of it. The most important one is the fact that insurance cannot deny you because of pre-existing health conditions. Another important one is your children can be on your health insurance until they are 26. A 3rd important one is that women, get a free wellness exam every year, no matter what their plan is-meaning deductibles, co-pay, out-of-pocket maximum. None of that matters, women get a free wellness exam, and that is what catches breast cancer, and other uterine cancers, cervical cancer , etc early and saves lives. I love how uneducated people are on what the ACA actually does. If it wasn't around, my husband would either be dead or on disability. Instead, he's still working at the business he built from the ground up, not once, but twice. Because we moved to a different state. Small businesses, entrepreneurship, all of that is part of the bedrock that is the American economy."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1q5pt0g/congress_working_hard_on_passing_the_shower_act/ny286yi/

"Frankly, I just had a serious medical procedure yesterday and I don't feel like debating with you. My husband and I have been on the ACA since the beginning (we are/were both self-employed) and have watched it deteriorate every year as various changes have been made. However, the worst of those, including the cliffs, have come with the return of the turd and his legion of lackeys in Congress. I edited my comment to delete the words that triggered you, however, I still stand firmly by my comment. I worked in the medical field for over 35 years before I retired and am well versed in the insurance issues. FWIW, I am deeply sorry for the loss of your mom. It is absolutely heartbreaking. I also lost several family members during Covid, all of whom were vaccinated but sadly were in various high-risk groups. Their deaths did NOT have to happen and their blood is on his hands. I wish you all the best. Hopefully our country can move forward with a better healthcare system for all of its citizens."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vgga4i/senate_dems_post_memo_on_reforms_to_make_health/p1xtne1/

"Like you, we retired early using ACA. We withdraw from our pretax. I hadn't thought about buying stocks to generate DIV for MAGI. Great useful idea."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=Ugz_QaCXh1oEYlf5CA4AaABAq

↳ @mockware (2): "Remember that if you choose your ETF and/or funds appropriately, the dividends will also be taxed like long-term capital gains which means you can get that 0% rate as well."

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "You are very welcome. Glad it was helpful and best wishes to you. This Journey is exciting."

"The same could be said for those on welfare who use the money they receive from the Government (tax payers) to buy cigarettes, alcohol and junk food).. Nobody seems to care about that or that our tax payer money is often mis- appropriated by our state/local Government on a daily basis. Sorry but this hit a nerve with me and I'm not using ACA or any other Government subsidies at this time... I think we have EVERY right to use ACA if we retire early! Thanks Julie!"

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=UgwJUQSkOUxtXTF6AE94AaABAq>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "It is very frustrating they way the system works! you're welcome! 😊 "

"They are nuts. I retired early but my income is too high for subsidies but I would totally take advantage of subsidies if I made little enough. It's a benefit available to anyone. Enjoy it. Another good video."

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=UgyNk-jYaavHHmiZeWN4AaABAq>

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "Thank you! Having too high of an income is a good problem to have! 😊 "

"The trick is in the subsidies. I retired at 60 and had ACA until 65 but really couldn't have done it without the subsidies. I set my IRA withdrawals to max out the subsidies and used savings for the rest of life. The caveat is that you have to have the savings to make up the difference. Where I'm at, Kaiser is on the exchange. They're not perfect but I guess they're near the top of the list. And it was painless to switch the ACA plan to Medicare. If the subsidies go away, it's going to hurt a lot of people."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/nj49wwj/

"No, you cannot switch plans midyear unless you have a life event, which is marriage, by a house, birth of a child, that's the only time you get special enrollment period. Otherwise you have to wait until November or so when open enrollment starts. I have ACA too, and I had a problem with the dermatologist a couple years ago. I always go and get a full body check because I have a lot of moles. I went a couple of years ago and I had two moles removed and they automatically get sent out for a biopsy. They told me my portion was \$147. And I said no, I met my deductible and out-of-pocket max months ago, so I should owe nothing. Then they hit me with while you at least have to pay the \$30 co-pay for a specialist. I shouldn't have had to pay that, but I did, because they weren't going to let me leave without paying something. I went home and called my insurance and I was correct, I should not have paid a dime. I had met my deductible and out-of-pocket max by February of that year and it was like August by then. My insurance company spent a week trying to get a hold of the billing department. And their excuse was they have different systems and they show different things and it showed that I owed \$147 or whatever it was but they admitted they were wrong. But what the dermatologist wanted to do was give me a credit. How in the hell do you know that I'm coming back to this particular place? You do not know that and neither do I so send a damn check. And they did. Every mole I have ever had removed automatically get sent for a biopsy and I have had probably seven moles removed. And I really don't see how ACA is going to help you. You need to talk to your insurance company."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tnbh0m/imperial_problems_and_a/ca/onyolxp/

"I retired early at the end of Aug last year and continue to use ACA coverage (I was self-employed, so have used ACA insurance since its inception -- many years with little to no assistance via subsidies/tax credits). I don't feel the least bit guilty for receiving ACA subsidies now in early retirement. Like you, I am a rule follower and am using ACA insurance as designed. And I have always paid my taxes and continue to do so in early retirement. Thanks for another great video Julie!"

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=Ugx8eFzUWDVtvqSEI-94AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (0): "That's awesome! Thank you for sharing and you're welcome! ☺"

"I've been in the insurance business since 2011 and remember the first open enrollment on October 1, 2013. Many agents thought they would make a lot of money enrolling entire families with full subsidies and promised compensation. But just months later, many left the market when commissions went unpaid. This happened early in my career and left a lasting impression on how I view the ACA. I don't understand why so many agents invest so much time in ACA today. I know it will eventually improve, but in the meantime, why not focus on selling Medicare plans, which offer more reliable income and better persistency than ACA? The ACA market is too volatile—caught in political power struggles—and you can lose a client simply because they got a new job with health benefits or got married. I have an ACA plan (self-employed insurance agent) with no subsidies and pay \$550 for mediocre health insurance. I just received notice that my Aetna CVS ACA plan is leaving the Texas market at the end of the year."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1m2m8ak/important_aca_changes_to_know_heading_into_2026/n3xleep4/

"I have never had a steady income. My 2 years back is totally different than this year. Same for 2027. This is the norm for a lot of people who are relying on ACA: self-employed, seasonal workers, people piecing together multiple part-time jobs. This is all unpredictable by nature. I wonder if there will even be humans in this "reconciliation system" or will it be like the IRS where there's no way to contact them except they freely collect your money."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v39ojp/this_is_the_optimal_strategy_for_those_that_can/oz3fstm/

"I retired at 58, 60 now and those ACA plans aren't cheap. The Bronze plan I have is the same one I had last year and it's the least expensive plan while keeping my doctors and services I'm happy with. I am basically doing what you are describing. It's really good to hear from someone that is basically in the same boat. I do audits every month to see the progress and make adjustments as I'm going along."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=Ugy8nXMFglGcCSD9C_p4AaABAg

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "Great to hear others navigating this too! Thanks for sharing."

"I retired at 53 and have the ACA silver plan too. Currently 59 and wondering when I get to 62 whether to start social security or continue with the pretax IRA distributions until 65 when Medicare starts. If I start social security I'd have to stop or substantially reduce the distributions not to have too large an AGI and lose the ACA subsidy."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=Ugyb_0GJY1fxpJYAb94AaABAg

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "This sounds very similar to our plan with the ACA but we have SS at age 67 or 2037. Hope we can keep all the numbers in line until then."

↳ @1971_Chevelle_SS (1): "@RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith. Just curious, what's your reasoning to not take SS at 62 to reduce spending down your retirement savings? I'm thing using SS for living expenses and keeping that amount invested and compounding would more than offset the added benefit of waiting. Additionally, if I expire, the IRA can be passed on whereas the SS benefit can't."

↳ @1971_Chevelle_SS (1): "@RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith. I'm kind of leaning toward 62, thinking by not taking the amount of the SS benefit from the IRA will make the break even over 20 years. Take a \$25k a year SS at 62 example, that's \$125k benefits in 5 years, take that \$125k left in the IRA at a reasonable 6% interest it'll grow to about \$169k. Take \$25k + 30% is \$32.5k for \$7.5k difference. It's 22-1/2 years to break even or 89-1/2 years old. Additionally, the risk of dying before then and the time value of money appear to make claiming early look like the best choice if that makes sense. Maybe I'm missing something though, and would like to figure it out before I get to 62 in a couple more years."

"I have a fiduciary who helps me do the same (and helped me retire early successfully). I retired at 57 in 2020 and ride the fine line to keep ACA subsidy to help with much of the costs. I've gone over the line a couple times and had to reimburse a few months, but it is way better than paying full out of pocket."

— YouTube · How Do I Pay For Health Insurance if I Retire Early? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Au4dTIwLBUg&lc=UgwWAFgynt-y-RtfnR94AaABAg_AQITq3jgh4XARy7Hqli_jl

"That's where I'm at right now. I want to retire because my elderly parents are needing assistance in their home, but I've continued to work due to needing health insurance. I just asked ChatGPT if we qualify for ACA. Our youngest is in college and lives at home still. I carry the insurance. I didn't want to yank his health coverage out from under him just because I want to retire (I'll be 62 in October). But, guess what! We just found out we qualify for ACA because we don't make a lot of money! I've never been so happy to be so poor in all my life, lol! 😂 We've saved responsibly over the years and the healthcare issue was the only thing from keeping us from being able to retire. HALLELUJAH!!!! 🎉 🎉 🎉 🎉"

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=UgwHff4X8gD4WW5bh1J4AaABAg_AT_iF2mw-5EATaChQBBG5l

Covered at a price they can pay · 21 documents · 20 voices

"The government should really open up Medicare with reasonable premiums for those 55 -65. Age discrimination is preventing a lot of people from getting hired these days. Even ACA is costing me 1K a month for me and spouse. My spouse's work insurance was much more expensive. My COBRA just ended after I lost my job 18 months ago and it was 1500 a month going up to 2K this year. I stayed on COBRA because we already satisfied the max out of pocket and it was good insurance."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Retire Before 65 · 72 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l8VY8AcaLww&lc=UgxUWCq0OC_S-rSQahN4AaABAq

↳ @DesigningRetirement (2): "Health sharing ministries like Medishare, Samaritan Ministries, and Christian Healthcare Ministries are an option some people use, but it's crucial to understand what they are and aren't before making this choice - especially for people over 50. What they are: Member-based cost-sharing programs where members contribute monthly "shares" that are used to pay each other's medical expenses. They're often significantly cheaper than ACA plans (\$300-500/month vs. \$800-1,500+) and are based on shared religious values and community support. What they're NOT: Insurance. They have no legal obligation to pay your medical bills. If the ministry determines your situation doesn't meet their guidelines, you're responsible for the full bill - and you have no legal recourse. Critical limitations for people approaching or in retirement: 1. Pre-existing conditions: Most health sharing ministries don't cover pre-existing conditions at all, or impose waiting periods of 1-3+ years. For people over 50, the vast majority have at least one pre-existing condition - high blood pressure, high cholesterol, diabetes, previous surgeries, arthritis, etc. If you develop cancer, need heart surgery, or face other major medical needs related to a pre-existing condition, your bills may not be "shared." 2. No guarantee of payment: If the ministry determines your situation doesn't qualify (didn't follow protocols, didn't get pre-approval, condition isn't "shareable" per their guidelines), you pay the full bill. There's no insurance commissioner to appeal to, no legal protection. 3. Coverage exclusions vary widely: Many exclude mental health care, some exclude certain cancer treatments, some require you to try lower-cost treatments first, some won't share bills if you didn't get pre-approval. You must read the specific guidelines carefully - not the marketing materials, but the actual sharing guidelines. Real-world outcomes - both exist: Some people use health sharing ministries for years successfully, paying for routine care and minor issues at much lower monthly cost than insurance. Other people have been left with \$50,000-200,000+ in medical debt when the ministry denied their shares for cancer treatment, heart surgery, or other major expenses - often after treatment has already occurred, when they're most vulnerable. Where they might work: Healthy people under 50 with no pre-existing conditions People with strong religious convictions about community-based sharing People who have financial resources to self-pay if shares are denied Very short-term bridge situations (though risky) Where they're dangerous: People over 50 (very high likelihood of health issues) Anyone with chronic conditions or health history People who can't afford large unexpected medical bills Anyone facing major illness (exactly when you need guaranteed coverage) My honest perspective: For most people over 50 navigating the gap before Medicare, I strongly encourage sticking with ACA-compliant insurance despite the cost. The guaranteed coverage of pre-existing conditions and legal consumer protections are worth the premium difference when you're at the age where major health issues become more likely. If ACA premiums feel truly unaffordable, explore subsidies based on current income (not last year's - this trips people up), Medicaid eligibility if income is low enough, or working with a healthcare navigator to find the most affordable ACA-compliant option. If you're still considering health sharing ministries: Read the actual sharing guidelines (not marketing materials) - understand exactly what is and isn't shareable Assume you'll need to self-pay for major illness - if you can't afford that risk, don't take it Understand you have no legal recourse if shares are denied Consider your age and health realistically - any pre-existing condition puts you at significant risk The monthly savings aren't worth six-figure medical debt if shares are denied when you need them most. That said, I respect that some people have used them successfully and are comfortable with the risks. Just make sure you understand what you're accepting before making this choice, because the

consequences of getting it wrong are severe."

↳ @patriot2510 (0): "medicare would go bankrupt in one month"

"Thanks for posting. This is a lot to take in. We are all in a waiting game. We got notice a month or so ago that our provider is not participating in the VA marketplace next year. So we have to choose a new plan. Damn this is frustrating. Fortunately we have been able to control our income this year. So we should get affordable premiums."

— r/obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1m60tzo/important_obamacare_a_changes_to_know_heading/n4g5n76/

"First time viewer... and now a subscriber. I retired early at 58, after 35 yrs in the health insurance world. I am a self proclaimed ACA expert.... and loved seeing how accurate you are at outlining the details. Well done!!! I was fortunate enough to have planned my cash bucket (CDs) and investments to allow me to keep my MAGI at the absolute bottom, so I pay \$0 premium for the best silver.... and have been trying to help everyone achieve the same status."

— YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=Ugw53JBOOcJ3-XYDzgl4AaABAg>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Thanks so much for subscribing and for the kind words! Coming from someone with your background in health insurance, that really means a lot! Sounds like you've done an amazing job planning your early retirement and keeping your MAGI low — great example for others and that's such a great service you're providing by helping others!"

↳ @hefright (0): "@Davek111 do you offer a service that helps folks keep their MAGI low?"

"Always been that way. I have had multiple jobs over the decades. Sometimes I hit the jackpot and get great coverage, then I have years of useless healthcare coverage. Those years I get the basic bloodwork and X-rays on my own dime (literally I am paying the preventative care). The issue now is after a lifetime of work I want to retire. How do I get covered for the 60-65 gap? ACA is "limited coverage", almost criminal costs. This country needs a generational shakeup."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/nj43xoe/

"Can I make my healthcare any more affordable? Hello! I live in Texas. We just welcomed our 4th child and my health insurance premium through work is going to go up to \$1,000/paycheck. This constitutes about 19% of my salary and it's also not a great plan; we paid \$11,000 out of pocket this year, which brings costs up to 25-30% of our paycheck. It's a silver PPO plan with Anthem, which felt like the sweet spot between an affordable premium and a manageable out of pocket cost. Is there anything to be done about this beyond finding a different job? I'm kind of lost. I looked at marketplace coverage, but the plans are even worse, and it's not clear to me how much it would actually cost, since only some of my family get a tax credit (but not me.)"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wggh2p/can_i_make_my_healthcare_any_more_affordable/

↳ AccordingCandidate58 (4): "Yes, you can get more of a catastrophic plan off the marketplace. It cut my premiums in half when I switch over a year ago \$1550 down to \$750 ish for a family of 3 monthly. They basically check prescription records for approval (so you need to be semi healthy to get approved) but if you can get approved it should cut your payments way down. Im guessing your talking about \$1000 per check every 2 weeks and hopefully not \$4000 a month because that would be crazy. I got a United Healthcare PPO with a \$3,000 max out of pocket per person. The broker I used was My Private Health Insurance . Try that"

↳ 142riemann (3): "OP, talk to your HR. Also send an email to HR asking for better choices at the next open enrollment (usually at the end of the year, which is only a few months away). If they value you as an employee, they will try to find cheaper options. I have no advice to give about TX, other than to please vote this November."

↳ branchymolecule (3): "it takes longer than a that for a company to contract with a health insurance company."

"We only had one psychiatrist in our town. And he literally disappeared overnight and I'm not exaggerating. I played hell finding another psychiatrist. We had no other ones in our area. And this was before telehealth became really popular, so that wasn't a route I could go I ended up signing up for a plan with a local nurse practitioner. Now my insurance doesn't cover this, but it's only \$25 a month and she just writes the prescription that I need a psychiatrist for. I am not driving an hour away until Health is hit or miss. Sometimes the pharmacy won't cover telehealth because they aren't local doctors. The NP route are becoming more and more popular. I still have health insurance, but I go to her for the little things. I don't have to wait four days to get in or two weeks, she answers immediately. She helped me a bunch of times. I fell off my bike and cut my leg open and it got infected. I called my doctors for my insurance, they called back 10 days later. I had already called the NP that I pay \$25 a month for and she had an antibiotic and some cream at the pharmacy within 10 minutes of me texting her, I included pictures. So you may want to look in your area and see if any NP's are doing this. My friend that's an NP, she has different levels or different packages I guess and the cheapest one is \$25, which is the one I have and I can text her or call her anytime The plans go all the way up till like \$400 a month and that gets you in person home visits anytime you want them. These are becoming very popular. I call it concierge NP's because that's kind of what it is. We have two around here and I know both of them. I use the one that I do because I'm also her dog sitter. She just wanted me to prove that I had been on this medication for at least two years and she looked through my pharmacy records and seen that I was. Then she had no problems prescribing it. Then this advice is for everyone out there. Even if you have health insurance and it may be a shitty plan, these are popping up all over. She can write lab orders, imaging orders, she can write anything a doctor does. I don't know if my insurance would cover it, but I do know they cover the prescriptions that she writes. I do all my imaging and lab works through my insurance because I'm going to guess it wouldn't cover it because she's not in network. But signing up for something like this gives you a back up and it's coming very handy for me and it's very affordable at \$25 a month. That's cheaper than going to an urgent care."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omuregf/

"The only thing I'm not sure of is. How does a family making Over a hundred thousand dollars a year , not have health insurance through their employer , which I thought they were mandated to take. I have an employer that offers a health care plan that does meet minimum standard. But the price is SO high. I have to take Obamacare. Technically , it is an affordable plan under the guidelines."

— YouTube · ACA/Obamacare Subsidies 2026 - Humongous Changes...Premiums Going Up! · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G9mAZNAJMBQ&lc=UgynJAdN0FFrHHsiEzJ4AaABAg>

↳ @georgebitting3203 (1): "You are Exactly Right!"

↳ @franklebatista1091 (0): "Also, you will not get it if you work only a PT"

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

↳ fizzy-logic (19): "There's way too much going on in that post for me to break it down for you, and way too much both of you haven't made sure to understand about how it all works. There's just too much to walk you through. I normally think it's best to investigate how things work and take care of insurance yourself, as brokers can sometimes steer people wrong, but in your case you may need an insurance broker. BUT also you need to read up on how this shit works, desperately. The fact you said you didn't pay premiums, but you also didn't use it, implies you think that somehow you only pay for insurance if you actually need to use it. I'm not trying to be mean at all, but that lack of the most basic understanding of how insurance works is going to hurt you, your health, your family and your wallet. It's time to learn this stuff, and it won't be something you can read one article in one day and be done. You need to put time into it. But I will add that if someone is offered insurance through work, they are not eligible for any ACA subsidies unless that plan is expensive enough to be deemed unaffordable by ACA standards. You'd have to look up how to determine if the cost was high enough to let you get ACA subsidies, and I honestly don't know that you're gonna do that on your own. Get a broker for all of this mess, or better yet, an organization that helps people file as sort of a charitable work, I think there are some groups that do that. You can look at the ACA website for a list of facilitators in your area, they are free to you. The reason I'd look for someone like that rather than a broker, if possible, is since a broker isn't going to get commission if you are taking a work plan versus an ACA plan, you'll have to get lucky and hope someone gives you good advice even if it turns out they won't be getting a commission (if it turns out you and your wife are better going with her work plan). And there are absolutely brokers who would help even if they need to advise you to take the work plan instead, but there are also ones who convince people to take bad plans and/or fail to explain how it works properly. You can get badly burned financially if you take an ACA plan, didn't understand how it worked, and end up owing back thousands. Same can be said if you get sold a junk, non-ACA insurance plan that doesn't really cover anything when you need it. Added: If your wife is on an ACA plan when she actually has the option to get insurance from work, btw, and that insurance doesn't meet the standard to let her still get ACA credits, she can end up owing back the full amount of credits. This all gets reconciled at tax time - so the credits you get in 2026 are reconciled when you file your 2026 taxes in April of 2027. She would owe back whatever the full monthly premiums were without credits if it turns out she wasn't eligible to have them."

↳ LacyLove (18): "1 She cannot continue to get subsidies if her plan is affordable. 2 yes 3 yes 4 yes 5 no and it begins in November for coverage beginning in 2027. 6 That depends solely on the plans. 7 yes 8. She needs to enroll in her work plan ASAP. Then cancel her marketplace plan. You are 33 years old, it is time you learn about this stuff. You literally have the world's answers at your fingertips. Use them."

↳ Jcarlough (9): "Great questions! It's unfortunate that at 33 years-old you still are inexperienced at a key

component of “adulthood” but kudos for recognizing this and wanting to learn. I *am* curious on your health insurance situation for the past seven years no plan is going to allow a dependent stay enrolled once you hit 26 UNLESS you met the disabled dependent definition. Were you out of the US this whole time? Regardless, to answer your questions. 1. Yes. Your wife’s employer offering affordable health insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage (most do) WILL disqualify her for continuing subsidies. 2. Yes. Failure to enroll also disqualifies her from continuing to receive subsidies. 3. The rest of your questions are irrelevant due to the above. Really, since you currently do not have health insurance, it sounds like your best option is for your spouse to enroll you both into her new employer’s plan.”

"I got laid off last year at age 58. Company closed after many years in business. I got onto Obamacare because Cobra was outrageous. I had a ZERO premium. My income was 6 months of unemployment, 3 months of severance and \$1k a month from a pension from a previous job. I went to the doctor every couple of months to monitor my blood pressure. I got a colonoscopy and many blood tests. I only paid about \$10 each doctor visit. Nothing for the colonoscopy. Practically nothing for blood tests and nothing for my blood pressure meds. I was EXTREMELY pleased with it. This year it's a whole different story. My income was TOO low to qualify for the subsidies. So now I have to either pay \$1k a month and keep Obamacare or go on Medicaid and pay nothing. I don't want Medicaid. Last week I got a job. I will be making over \$60k a year. \$60k is TOO high of an income to get the subsidies. 🙄 I need to keep Obamacare for 3 months until the company health insurance kicks in."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Retire Before 65 · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I8VY8AcaLww&lc=Ugyx4mZcn12wDukM7Wd4AaABAg.ASgHuO47ZVEASh6mZ_fHp0

"We got our ACA approved for next year. Our payment is \$600/month for a great plan, I'm pleased."

— YouTube · I Chose My 2026 ACA MARKETPLACE Health Insurance! It's NOT As BAD As I THOUGHT! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wQf0o9gkMg&lc=UgzfK5FjA4eS3kpOVB14AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "That's awesome! Thanks for sharing! 😊 "

↳ @Wayneman50 (1): "With or without a subsidy?"

↳ @Wayneman50 (1): "\$1800/month without, \$918 with. \$684 this year. 35% increase even with subsidy. Just ridiculous. If Trump wants to help the American people reign in these insurance companies. Oh wait, they probably donated to your campaign. Sorry, my bad."

"Lost job, not sure what to do for insurance Hello, I live in California and I recently was let go from my job within the 60 day probationary period. I sent my unemployment application a few days ago. I have been uninsured since Feb. 1 when the coverage from the job I had prior to the one I just lost ended. I would like to get insured soon as I will be penalized by the state for going without insurance for more than 3 months. The penalty is around \$900 from what I have heard. I know I have options. I still could sign up for COBRA from the job I had before losing this one. However, that is close to \$600 per month, which I cannot afford without income or even while receiving just unemployment.. So I think its really between Medi-Cal and hopefully subsidized marketplace insurance. I was thinking I should wait until I see how much the unemployment will be before applying online because it could put me too high for Medi-Cal but I may still get subsidized marketplace insurance. I am looking for a new job but I don't expect to find an new job and get on their insurance in time since most have a waiting period. Any advice? Thanks in advance."

— r/HealthInsurance · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1rlu524/>

↳ (0): "Medicaid is the way."

↳ (0): "Here in WA my Medicaid is based on current income which for you would be \$0 as unemployment hasn't kicked in yet. Then the marketplace plans go off your latest tax return. So if you haven't filed 2025 use 2024. That will let you know how much credit you'd get from an ACA plan."

↳ (0): "Federal Marketplace (edit: website) insurance subsidies are based on one's estimate of current year's income, not prior year's income. Note: I don't have state specific knowledge."

"I need it for 10 months next year, then I'll be on Medicare. I'm only paying \$50 per month now for a bronze plan with a \$7000 deductible. I don't have any health issues so it's been great. I'm sure it'll be way more than \$50 next year."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wq0np5/has_anyone_else_received_an_estimate_from_your/pc0vf1w/

"Excellent David ! .. I'm lovin' the ACA although dancing the (M)AGI shuffle is getting tiresome (don't worry...I'm not going back to work just for the health insurance), but that's most likely because it's currently tax season. Once 4/15 passes everything will return to normal... ..my taxes are currently in the hands of my tax CPA, so I'm enthusiastically awaiting completion. 2025 was a semi-complicated tax year (lots of trading in taxable brokerage account), and I'm eager to see if my tax calculations are correct. ..Also, you're totally correct about ACA surprises at tax time. My first year of being fully subsidized (2022) I was unaware of the subsidy so I was paying full freight on my monthly premiums. The result was a massive tax refund for that year. My tax CPA told me that this was rare, and most people are the opposite, just like you said... they end up making more money than anticipated and end up with ACA sticker shock. Great video !"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How We Got Health Insurance · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lwy4jmmT1k&lc=UgzbiNXXKiEDRa4KE7ml4AaABAq>

↳ @davidnprogress (1): "Taxes! That has been fun here in early retirement, and is a bit of a regret since I did not have a good understanding of long-term gains until just before retiring. 0% tax at our income level?!"

↳ @Mitch-Lifestyle (0): "@davidnprogress Yep...same here (0% taxes). I think what catches most people off guard (myself included) is that they don't realize how tightly coupled ACA and the IRS are. If I had done my own taxes, it's most likely that I wouldn't have gotten the premiums refunded for tax year 2022. People who spend their life as a working stiff, we don't get free stuff, so the very thought of even looking for a subsidy refund never would have crossed my mind !"

"Tomorrow is my retirement anniversary date. 3 years retired now, currently age 60. Been using ACA Bronze plans each year so far. I manage my reportable income so that the premium for the bronze plan has been fully subsidized. It is high deductible insurance, but thats ok for me as I usually only see my doctor for the annual physical. I max out an HSA too, whichh helps lower my MAGI. Ive even been able to do some small Roth conversions while still keeping my MAGI in check. I hope to keep doing this the next 5 years until medicare age. Hopefully ACA is not killed off by politicians. This year I am very aware of the income cliff."

— YouTube · \$1Can Destroy Your ACA Subsidy in Early Retirement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Th4776liNeM&lc=Ugyfy8xDPCjPA67Owmx4AaABAq>

↳ @keithgilbert835 (1): "Congratulations! Thanks for sharing"

"I was on Medicaid under the ACA in New York State for years. It was great insurance! Little paperwork."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=Ugy00s8N-mOMvEdKHbR4AaABAq>

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (2): "Nice. Glad that worked for you and I am glad you had coverage. Feel free to keep sharing your story in the community here. It really does help others."

"I'm an early retiree and HAD a great plan, until my Mom passed away. She had a chunk of money in Traditional IRA/401k which became an Inherited IRA for me. The "Secure Act" requiring this to be liquidated within 10 yrs along with annual RMD, was not part of my plan. To add, at the 10yr mark I will hit 64, so all the added MAGI will take place prior to Medicare. So now it's a decision between 3 paths 1) Liquidate it all in 1yr. Major tax and health insurance hit for that year. But could keep low ACA for (or even Medicaid) the remaining years. Additional bonus is growth after move (if simply doing "in kind" move for liquidation) is now capital gains instead of income. Also taking it early minimizes likelihood of having IRMA for 2 yrs once on Medicare. 2) Spread it out over remaining years, being careful to not hit the ACA cliff. Will still pay more for ACA, but keeps taxes on Inherited IRA in lower brackets. 3) Some combo of the above. Especially since ACA and Healthcare options may change over the next 8 years. Of course my Roth conversion plans are on hold as of now."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgzszM-kZkW4HY0w2Ox4AaABAg

"@mongo2044 I think you are misunderstanding his use of the word "manipulation". Using Roth income, post taxed funds, income, and retirement distributions, you can control your MAGI to get you to your desired income level to qualify for what type of ACA plan you desire. This is not illegal and is a part of retirement planning. I am doing this. I chose a Bronze HDHP+HSA plan. As long as I keep my MAGI under \$55,700 it will be fully subsidized. I chose this plan as I have always been in good health, and it will allow for a higher MAGI for me to do Roth conversions up to the \$55,700 level. Will also allow me to additionally contribute \$5,150 to an HSA account. If something were to happen to me, it has max out of pocket of \$7,050 then 100% coverage."

— YouTube · 9 Health Insurance Options for Early Retirement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qt0r9YBsUzM&lc=UgxBcUQAE0ABwBYBXGI4AaABAg.A43tY4kt2r2A4457uLTjxu>

"well the problem is if someone has say 300k in roth funds and that's it..and no ss benefits we don't qualify for aca..which is ridiculous in ACA eyes have income...so i had to take ss benefits to qualify for ACA so have 30k of ss benefits..and only pay \$60 a month but really wanted to wait to get ss but have no choice now"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=Ugxul7gB4tMrPU9ICZZ4AaABAg>

"If your self employed and shopping on the marketplace for insurance stop now and send me a text trust me I'll find you a much better plan with much better benefits. I specialize in helping self employed find much more affordable coverage and better benefits."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/14bmtej/wife_and_i_are_both_selfemployed_is_there_decent/jgm6m95/

"Doesn't matter how good things are, people simply like to complain. Dallas here. I am very happy with my plan. The only issue is the subsidy framework but that is a political issue unfortunately."

— r/Obamacare · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1r9z0th/a_positive_anecdote_of_using_americanaca_health/o7iixz/

Medicaid worked for them · 7 documents · 7 voices

"The income requirement is ridiculous. Medicaid saved me at least \$20k when I had to find my own insurance for my family after a layoff. The tech job market was terrible and it took me 10 months to find something. Even cutting out all unnecessary spending we were burning cash. I am fortunate in that I was/am in a much better financial place than most people and I could absorb the hit without collateral damage. They are going to wipe a lot of people out when they crash the economy if this becomes the law."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kzrpq7/it_appears_that_the_big_bill_now_has_a_minimum/mvidpyu/

"When I was an independent contractor, I was shelling out \$1800/month for health insurance for a family of four. Let that sink in. \$1800-a-month! Fortunately, the contract paid well so it was worth it. And, yes, there are cheaper options via Bronze or Silver plans but, for our family needs, a Gold plan made more sense. As BTB mentioned, California has subsidies if you are in a lower income bracket and we also have Medi-Cal (aka Medicaid or free government insurance) for those in the lowest income brackets."

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=UgxO0HHlarKOQILHo854AaABAg>

↳ @BeatTheBush (0): "\$1800 is more than what I spend in a month. OMG"

"I retired 24 years ago at 45 financed mostly by slow flipping houses I live in. \$250k cap gain tax free. When ACA started I qualified for Medicaid. \$0 cost, \$0 copay, \$0 deductible. Best insurance I ever had. At 65 Medicare + Medicaid so parts B and D, copays, deductible all free. Plus a free phone via Lifeline. Waiting until 70 to take SS. Also sweet is I don't even have to file income tax!"

— YouTube · New Health Insurance Rules Just Created a Hack For Retirees · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MZfLaPA1bsM&lc=UgxHu3N_p-xbF-wp6vt4AaABAg

↳ @devilsfansfan6393 (1): "Medicaid insurance is crap, no good doctors accept it"

↳ @ginaforfsu (1): "A lot of the middle class supplements healthcare for those with far more money and worth. The tax strategy is legal, but it's not moral. My neighbor retired with \$2M and a few rental properties and pays nothing for healthcare. I haven't received child support for 3 years and frequently pick up part-time work to pay bills and save for my own retirement, yet I get to help pay for her healthcare."

↳ @MotionRetirement (0): "Thanks for watching and sharing!"

"I have medicaid Medicare I never paid a medical bill in my life just add medicaid to that Medicare and they will subsidise the cost of everything"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=UgxIN2b2TBw3QJ-CYJt4AaABAg.APW1NV9i66IAPWETYA2so5>

"Please help! Best insurance in NJ for someone disabled with chronic illness and schizophrenia ASAP!! **NJ FamilyCare, or state Medicaid, is very different from federal Medicaid and I'm looking for people who have understanding of NJ STATE resources rather than federal insurance.** I'm 25F, have a diagnosis of schizoaffective disorder, opioid use disorder on MAT injections and fibromyalgia, and I see multiple providers every month including weekly therapy, bi-weekly medication, zero to 2-3 hospitalizations or inpatient psych treatments a year, monthly suboxone injections, monthly pain management/rheumatology and physical therapy, and like 6-7 monthly medications and bloodwork every 3-6 months for those meds. My insurance migrated to a plan that doesn't have mental health care, so I'm looking for a new insurance on very short notice. I am unemployed and my income is under 23k, but my parents (who make >150k) have agreed to help me financially for the next 6-12 months, so reasonably my budget is a hundred or couple hundred dollars a month. So, I can either go NJ FamilyCare Horizon BCBS, or a private insurance like Aetna PPO or Horizon BCBS PPO or HMO. I have had private, family based top or silver tier PPOs usually Aetna or BCBS sometimes through a third-party employer plan since I was diagnosed years ago, and the provider network is large with the care excellent but it is very expensive, too expensive to reasonably use it the amount I'd like to if money wasn't an issue. Wide network, but extremely pricey, too pricey to fully utilize, and difficult to navigate when claims are denied by the company. Services known as first-line treatments for SMIs such as schizophrenia like ACT, CSC CI and ICMS, case management, day programs or psychiatric rehabilitation are generally off the table and Medicaid/NJFC only. Terrible, TERRIBLE customer service network with no case management, healthcare consolidation, or help when things go wrong with services or coverage and you try to call their phone line. I called a broker through Health Benefits 360 who recommended NJ Family Care as I am in the income bracket and said it's the best fit for my situation with chronic illness, frequent healthcare use, SMI (serious mental illness) and other mental health and substance abuse recovery resources for the most affordable price. However, I've done some research and the network seems much much smaller and I don't know if the quality of these providers is great, good or poor, I had a friend on Medicaid during college who received very poor quality of services, though they were free, and she had chronic conditions, but I don't know if she was on the state or federal coverage. Based on my situation above, can you recommend which insurance would be the best fit for me, even if it's not something that I have mentioned? More than anything, please understand I want to receive good quality care as first priority and have the financial means to not have to compromise on that. It needs to be a widely accepted insurance, either Aetna or BCBS preferably so that my current providers will migrate over, and a plan that CAN be used frequently well and not in a way that rips me off. But in terms of the exact best plan, I could really use some help and ASAP. I need to be ready to switch within this week so that I can start my coverage on October 1st. Also, feel free to recommend websites where I can get connected to a good broker that will help. I need a broker as I am too disabled to complete a long application alone. Specifically, brokers that understand my situation and do both private insurance and Medicaid. COBRA is not an option unless someone knows a cheaper way to receive it. Edit: Just spoke to broker and another option is ObamaCare or ACA-capped insurance. Thank you very much."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wjvhr9/please_help_best_insurance_in_nj_for_someone/

↳ No-Produce-6720 (8): "I'm not sure if you're meaning to say Medicare, but there is no federal Medicaid. Medicaid is only issued based on the state in which you live. There is no federal option, so I'm unsure what you're referring to there. Aside from that, you need to start at [healthcare.gov](https://www.healthcare.gov). That will point you in the right direction for ACA coverage or Medicaid."

↳ katsrad (7): "One thing is that there isn't a federal medicaid it is going to be provided by the state. There is Federal Medicare which is different and based on age or if you are disabled. The other is use [healthcare.gov](https://www.healthcare.gov) to

look for plans you are eligible for and if you are eligible for any subsidies. Anything outside that can deny you coverage for pre-existing conditions or not pay claims for those."

↳ gingercatlover1 (2): "Yes, we do! There are a lot of resources."

"I had medicaid Medicare pay for all my medical bills through my whole life I never paid a medical bill in my life I never paid a health insurance bill in my life you can do the same thing I did so health insurance is free in the States just got medicaid Medicare and will be completely for free just saying 😊 "

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America I People Are Canceling Coverage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=Ugy72dHKUWY9vuzDHjV4AaABAg.APW2lv8_YObAPWGT9FqVb

"Dude I already did that I went on medicaid Medicare now my health insurance is completely free no premiums no deductibles no nothing you can do the same thing if you can't afford it it's that simple just saying 😊 "

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America I People Are Canceling Coverage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=Ugzn0W-NpnBIVrP33bx4AaABAg.APVzraI5WH9APWFScBLFuo>

The ACA saved them: pre-existing conditions covered · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/>

↳ (0): "Health shares are NOT insurance."

↳ (0): "you're young and healthy with no preexisting conditions until you aren't. during a routine physical my doctor found a large mass on my thyroid. it happens in the blink of an eye."

↳ (0): "Healthshares are scams"

"Turning 60 in October and in early retirement due to a reduction in force. I'm now on ACA and thankful for not having to pay \$1100 a month for medical insurance. Thanks ACA and Julie!"

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=Ugy7Cfqjo1j4MsBFqGB4AaABAg>

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Well congrats on retiring! 🎉🎊 You're welcome! I'm also grateful for ACA! 😊 "

"When I was in my early thirties I had appendicitis, my insurance ended shortly after and I was stuck paying the aftercare. Meanwhile I was looking for new insurance and I got complications of the surgery. To make a long story short, I ended up with a very large medical bill. (They gave me 28 years to pay!) The rare complication made me uninsurable, so I wasn't able to get insurance until I heard about the ACA bridge program that was for uninsurable people until the ACA was implemented— so I racked up more medical debt. Shortly after that a family member living abroad got cancer and needed her payments up front before treatment, I couldn't not help. Already financially strained, I started a go fund me for her and got \$0, which is not uncommon! I always tell people to take my story as a warning, make sure you always have medical insurance. I too had insurance on and off when I was young, not anymore!"

— YouTube · I'm Young & Healthy, Can I Skip Health Insurance? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WtjmdyTCRM&lc=UgwJ15O0yVvXengFhdl4AaABAg>

"A while back, I got the best plan in my state and they paid none of my medical expenses. Now my state has only one plan and no doctor in my area will take it. If it weren't for the ACA I wouldn't be able to get health insurance because I had a rare (but resolved!) complication of an appendectomy. Even though I was healthy I was deemed "uninsurable" just prior to the implementation of the ACA. So while I am glad we have some aspects of the ACA, currently in my state it's not so great. Certainly our healthcare system needs to change!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance After Quitting Your Job · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2xGHnufEwvs&lc=Ugwrqd3CNjbfjCQmgX94AaABAg>

↳ @BeatTheBush (1): "These laws can really screw some people and sentence them to death basically."

↳ @larryjones9773 (1): "@BeatTheBush And it will get worse on 11/10/20, if the Supreme Court determines that the ACA is unconstitutional. The hearing starts on 11/10/20, and Amy Coney Barrett will probably be at this hearing."

"I'm American and moved to Canada 30 years ago, and am a citizen, thankfully. Initially, for my family, we had a premium for health insurance of \$500.00 a year. That was eventually eliminated. No premiums, co pays, deductibles and no such thing as a pre-existing condition not covered. The only expense seeing a doctor or going to a hospital is parking. A civilized health care system in a civilized country."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America I People Are Canceling Coverage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=Ugyg1SRRBMjyn6_CDat4AaABAg

"I'm 60 and I'm on SSDI. My husband is 66 and is retired and on Social Security. He has Medicare and I have absolutely zero insurance. I cannot qualify for an ACA insurance because we do not file our income taxes together. Thus a requirement. Also I tried getting Medicaid but wow between my income of SSDI and his SS , we actually make too much. So basically I'm uninsurable."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugx52_kXdsYWhMXm_WR4AaABAg

Found a better or cheaper plan by shopping · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Great video Erin. You are truly the best at explaining these financial concepts on YouTube. There is one other option that might be available for some people. I recently lost my COBRA coverage, and was planning on moving to an ACA plan. The ACA plans were very expensive for me, so I contacted an insurance broker who was able to get me coverage for \$600 less per month. I believe it's insurance used by an association of people who are self employed or run small businesses. I think it's cheaper because I am getting a group rate."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpcfE&lc=UgxdZnnFFEMvll3FaXN4AaABAg>

↳ @jinxjink7457 (1): "How in the world was COBRA cheaper than ACA?! COBRA is criminally exorbitantly pocket-draining lol. I see premiums for >\$1k, so I'm surprised you were struggling with shifting from COBRA to ACA."

↳ @Steve-w7x6h (0): "@jinxjink7457 Without subsidies from the government, the ACA policies were much more expensive. They went up a lot from last year also."

↳ @WestonMorrisdoBrasil (0): "@jinxjink7457 Some companies self insure rather than using an insurance company for their employees. Depending on the medical costs incurred by the employees, that companies medical insurance costs could be relatively low."

"Imperial Health on ACA I just wanted to post about my experience with Imperial which I purchased on the exchange. I have used "Obamacare" since it first started. I was without insurance before that as I hired a broker to find me insurance while I was self employed and because of a medication I took at the time .. no one would cover me so ACA was a god send. Until about 2 years ago .. I never really had medical issues. I visit a doctor 4 times a year maybe and used teladoc but about 2 years ago I got very sick which required emergency room care, paddles to the chest to get my heart working right and 5 days in the hospital. Bill before insurance came to just about \$80,000. Add to that some additional aftercare added later. Insurance did their part and I averted financial catastrophe. Yay ACA!!!!!!!!!!!!!! This year selections on ACA in Arizona seemed far less than usual and the company I had been using was priced out of reach so I selected Imperial Health Gold Standard. It costs me just \$200 less than what my rent does a month but .. When you need it the cost pales in comparison to hospital costs. About a week or so after choosing the plan I got the bill. Paid on November 24. Then .. nothing. I got a receipt but didnt hear anything else From Imperial Health Insurance for weeks. Wasn't even sure I was going to have insurance since I received no confirmation. Nothing. Second week of December I start looking around on the net for information and many of their links dont work. The links that do work point you at websites that look like they haven't been updated since 1990. A little nervous but I figure "hey if removing polished (functioning) websites and extra paper helps keep the cost down cool" Finally I find a number and call only to do the phone chase through different people out of country trying to find out if I am indeed covered for the coming year. I do get my membership number and am assured I will be covered. This took about 3 hours. With it I find my online membership card. I am now HOURS into this. I discover the pcp they picked for me is 60 miles from where I live. I do not live in some remote area. I live in Mesa AZ so I know there must be closer doctors. Problem is, while my last insurance company allowed you to change PCP online .. there was no provision for doing so with Imperial health so back to the phones. A primary reason I selected Imperial Insurance is because on ACA it stated that Imperial health Insurance covered my PCP who I used for 5 years+ and the hospital my doctor was associated with. I got it changed and was told to expect a packet from them with my card and that the first card would have the Assigned PCP and a little later I would get the card with my chosen PCP. The company was a little behind and was just sending out "Packages" And I waited. it was nerve racking as I had always received at least a welcome to the company letter/email something but nothing .. just ghost. No "packet" no nothing. Comes Jan1 .. still no card. Now I already downloaded the card from the site I found but .. not everyone knows how to dig through internet garbage to get to that point and had I indeed needed doctoring on the 1st .. I would have been unable to prove I had insurance. I paid for insurance that would begin on the 1st and had no way of proving I had insurance on the 1st. On Jan 2nd .. I try to call to find out where the "Packet and card were. Automated service said would I like a call back .. Nope I will wait .. Great you are number 250 on line. I guess a bunch of other people were wondering where their card was as well!?!? The morning of the 3rd I picked up my card at the mail. There was a single sheet. at the bottom was a paper thin card. Fine we are saving money. The letter had a brief three sentences that said here is your card and if you want to know anything go to Imperial health . com. There is virtually no useful information at the site they direct you to. You will have to do long term digging from there. Personal .. here is your plan and here is what is covered is not available at that site or its links Had I not started to chase this down earlier I would have had to submit a request to change pcp and wait 24 hrs plus or use the one they gave me which was 60 miles away. No snap shot of coverage no nothing .. here is your card 2 days late and if you want to know anything .. go to our shitty website and try and find out. Luckily I take care of my health so hope to have a year like last year where I used insurance 4 times but if this is their level of organization up front .. I am very concerned what will happen if an emergency arises .. I am not two weeks into Insurance with Imperial Health, cant afford to go without insurance and cant change it but .. If your still selecting for Feb1 start .. I would look elsewhere. This company does not seem to have its shit together and trust me .. when the medical bills start flying .. you need a company that has their shit together. We learned that with my Emergency and with my wifes cancer diagnosis and treatment. I do not feel confident with Imperial health but

wont go without insurance so now I am stuck Edited to add I have been trying this website since I received my membership number so about 3 weeks. This is what I get .. a spinning wheel that says Processing and this will spin forever. Tried it in Brave, Firefox and Edge. None of them can open this page. It contains information about my plan .. I cant see it!? I have been trying for almost a month. I think the site servers are overwhelmed so I cant arrange autopay, see my policy or .. anything but that spinning circle. <https://preview.redd.it/cokxg0a9jkcg1.jpg?width=3060&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=83258471e1a05666f536b5fd6d325b744f7507d6>";

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q9bscn/>

↳ (0): "DO NOT USE THIS SCAM COMPANY. PAY EXTRA FOR A BETTER OPTION. THESE PEOPLE WILL SIMPLY TAKE YOUR (AND TAXPAYER) MONEY AND FIND CHICKENSHIT WAYS NOT TO COVER YOUR CLAIMS (Like refusing to give you your PCP even though they're in network)"

↳ (0): "I still have not received any information or contact from them. No information about my plan coverage not even a welcome letter. I received a bill for sure but what it covers .. Who knows because I haven't received any information and none is available online. I'm paying 650 a month out of pocket .. All I can do is hope I don't need it and wait out until next year"

↳ (0): "i strongly suggest switching to a different carrier. these guys are worthless. when you need them to cover something, you'll probably have to hire an attorney to get them to cover anything"

"UHC has 49m members, so that's about \$125/member. About \$600 annually. Considering my health insurance premiums were 15k last year, I currently have bigger fish to fry than getting UHC to take a pay cut. Saving \$600 is a 4% savings, it's immaterial."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w7m4qf/paid_premium_denied_care/p7xha0m/

"Mine went up 500 percent. The Biden subsidies cut my premium in half even after I upgraded to a silver plan. Between losing the subsidies and many people unable to afford insurance next year due to this, I can't even imagine how high it will be."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ktzzh8/house_republican_tax_bill_skipped_aca_credits/mum7u36/

"That's horrible, try to see if you can get an off exchange plan, I was paying around \$1500 for a group plan with an Ichra through marketplace (no subsidies) last year got on a private plan with a United Healthcare PPO with a \$7k max out of pocket. We had to get approved with underwriting, (they basically checked prescription records) but it cut my premiums in half to \$780 ish. I used a broker "My Private Health Insurance""

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1txq1je/drowning_in_monthly_health_insurance_payments/oqcf5j2/

"I filed last year with about 95k gross before adjustment jointly. Wife retired with NO medical. She is 64 with one year to go for Medicare. She found a plan, short term with a big credit and premium of \$900 less (\$800) credit. The marketplace(ins company) rep even confirmed we qualifying. I somehow think we make too much and I will be stuck paying the full premium at some point."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Tax Credit Explained · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8go8HuwI8xk&lc=UgwZe4VoE5Huv0iQXs14AaABAq>

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Steering income to stay under the line: Roth conversions, fewer hours, turned-down work · 78 documents · 20 voices

"I had to retire due to medical issues at 55 so we had to go with Marketplace. It's been pretty good, our premiums are under \$150 per month for 2 people and our deductible for family was \$800. No HSA is allowed but we created a medical bucket in our high yield savings account and just transfer money as needed. We keep our income below \$60,000 too. I fear big changes are coming for 2026 though. Guess we will cross that bridge when it comes. God bless all!"

— YouTube · Want to Retire Early? HERE ARE 4 OPTIONS FOR HEALTH INSURANCE! · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOIjsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAg>

↳ @iHealthBrokers (3): "Yes, it is likely that we will see largely increased premiums in the upcoming year. We will release a video previewing 2026 plans soon! Thank you for your comment."

"If I thought I would stop working and be off my employer medical plan next year and do not qualify for Medicaid or Medicare at this time would this yr be a good time to do a big Roth conversion as subsidies are based out the expected income in a yr and the conversion would be done the year before?"

— YouTube · Retirees: How to Protect ACA Subsidies in 2026 · 119 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HgCQfekSc&lc=Ugy7u93Ti2GBNPWYb7R4AaABAg>

"Good video. Learned about ACA 8 years ago. Stopped our 401k contributions immediately and funded a brokerage account. Three years later we retired with a sizeable brokerage account and small IRA withdrawals keep our income low. We pay \$7 a month for a bronze plan with an HSA. We have 3 more years till Medicare"

— YouTube · How I'm Covering Health Insurance Before Medicare After Retiring at 54 · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G3l_3XBgfCw&lc=UgzYjF309QwWvC00Ald4AaABAg

↳ @scottunclocked (7): "In general No (let me explain). This is the beauty of having the taxable brokerage account. However, capital gains DO count toward your MAGI and any interest earned counts toward MAGI... So a portion of your withdrawal from a taxable brokerage may count toward your MAGI. it does count, but not like withdrawals from a traditional IRA or 401K where all of the withdrawal amounts from these count toward your MAGI because they are treated as "ordinary income"."

↳ @scottunclocked (6): "Thank you for sharing your costs with the ACA option. With getting the subsidies, you can certainly get your costs WAY down. I do wish we would have gotten started a few years sooner with stockpiling money in a taxable brokerage account. This is one thing I would do differently if I was 5-10 years from early retirement. We got started a little late on building a taxable brokerage account. Great moves on your part to prepare for this.... It is going to save you a fortune! How long have you been retired?"

↳ @dereks4228 (4): "Just remember the taxable brokerage account has no bankruptcy protection and can vanish with a serious lawsuit"

"ACA healthcare made it possible for me to retire. I keep my taxable income low and receive Gov subsidies on premiums. I consider the subsidies getting back some of the taxes I paid into the systems for the last 48 years. I had employer healthcare insurance for 30 years and never used one penny of it. Insurance companies made a mint off of my employer and me for decades. I never went to the Doctor until I turned 60 when I got Covid."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyzw5Ac7pA&lc=UgzT3TgVH2azwWzdsxx4AaABAq>

↳ @DonaldSharpe-u9o (3): "I completely relate! It's amazing how planning your income and using the ACA effectively can make early retirement feasible. I went through a similar path, keeping taxable income low while investing in a few index funds and it helped me feel secure financially while also getting affordable healthcare coverage."

↳ @drcornelius8275 (0): "Well great for you that has little income but ACA is killing my family. Not only did we pay the same or more taxes than you have over the years, now we get to pay for your insurance too because ACA sticks us with huge premiums. Do you think that's fair? Why don't I just give you some of my belongs too while we're talking Communism."

↳ @bestiefswlady5251 (0): "@drcornelius8275 I thought that depended on the states. Some states chose to expand their Medicaid, which helps supplement the tax breaks for the ACA and some states decided not to. Are you paying an insurance directly or does it come from your employer (i'm not asking for anything personal or specific. I'm just curious in the broad sense of the word). I'm open to correction if I'm wrong!!!"

"Manipulating income for Silver Plan w/ CSR So I've very tentatively looked into early retirement, meaning 5 years before Medicare eligibility and I was just tapping around on an AI asking questions and so I have a question to real people who might know something about this: The AI, Gemini, said that if you keep your income between \$15,060 and \$22,590 that you can get a subsidize silver plan with cost sharing reductions for next to nothing, relatively speaking. First question: is this still a thing, or was the AI trained on old information? Second question: My main source of income before Social Security and a pension would kick in would be income from a Roth IRA. Gemini said that income from a Roth IRA, since it's not taxable, would not count. So I could get a part-time job and earn within the range written above and then get additional income from my Roth IRA and still be eligible for relatively low cost health insurance through a silver plan with cost sharing reductions. Is this true? Thanks."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti1dc8/manipulating_income_for_silver_plan_w_csr/

↳ Zphr (24): "Yes, it's true. I am assuming from your numbers that you are single and I see from one of your replies that you are in Ohio. Your numbers are from last year though. They update for inflation each year. Ohio is an expansion Medicaid state, which means income up to 138% of the Federal Poverty Level (\$21,597 for a single this year) will qualify you for expansion Medicaid. Starting next year that benefit comes with a part-time community engagement requirement of 20 hours per week in work, volunteering, or part-time enrollment as a student. That's one option open to you. If you keep your income between 138% FPL and 150% FPL (\$21,598 to \$23,474), then you will qualify for a CSR Silver 94 plan with maximum premium subsidies and maximum cost sharing reduction subsidies. You can see 2026 prices (pre and post-subsidy) and plans in your county with some anonymous data (age/zip/income/etc) in about three minutes at <https://www.healthcare.gov/see-plans/#/>. You would be looking at around \$80/month or less for either the benchmark or under-benchmark Silver plan in your county, those being the least and second least expensive Silvers on offer in your county. Untaxed Roth withdrawals do not add to your income for ACA purposes, so you will need another source in order to develop qualifying income. That could be interest, dividends, employment, stock sales that produce cap gains, Roth conversions, traditional retirement account withdrawals, or your SS and pension income once they start. For context, we've been using the ACA for 12 years now and have had a CSR Silver 94 that entire time. Our policy this year has a \$7/month premium, \$0 deductible, a \$2,400 MaxOOP, and is with the top-rated ACA insurer in our state. It's a great policy, though all of our CSR Silver 94 policies have been just fine."

↳ MrLB____ (8): "Listen to this guy  "

↳ wijwijwij (4): "You can get CSR up to 250% of FPL, but if you arrange your MAGI to be just under 200% FPL you get pretty good value. So look at the FPL figure and determine 200% as a target you might shoot for staying under (\$31920 for 2026 figure). There isn't a clawback of CSR benefits if your income ends up exceeding that target. Things like low copays and low max out of pocket make this a viable choice. Only if you choose a Silver plan. If you have pretax 401k or trad IRA assets, you can convert some to Roth IRA if you want to generate MAGI without actually taking on part-time work."

"I'm retiring early, doing Roth conversions, and paying pretty much the full price for an ACA plan. I am very hopeful that this albatross of a program (the ACA) is either axed entirely, or means testing is put in place so that people with a net worth in the millions can't legally pay less for their healthcare plan than a working family of four, struggling to make ends meet. It is unconscionable, what the subsidies have done to this program, especially when you also understand how much it has driven up the overall cost of healthcare. Americans spend more on healthcare these days than they do housing! It's awful and it's all because of the ACA."

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgwKhDfdkjAscNLrBdt4AaABAg>

↳ @jodi7947 (4): "No, our health insurance both sucked and could drop you prior to the ACA. We do need a new system! Hopefully, young citizens will demand new rights and changes to many things that are untenable. It is high time to overhaul the whole US system."

↳ @TheUnRetired (3): "The ACA isn't the real problem; there are way deeper, more fundamental issues than the ACA. But we aren't here to talk politics; rather, practically dealing with the system we have so people can retire early."

↳ @jasonbroom7147 (3): "@TheUnRetired - Healthcare costs have outpaced inflation, wage growth, and even GDP, for decades. That is driven by govt. involvement, including Medicare, Medicaid, and now the ACA. Subsidies for ACA plans have dramatically exacerbated the issue, driving total healthcare up by literally trillions of dollars in just the last 5 years. Again, it now surpasses the cost of housing, which is simply absurd. I agree we have to work with whatever system is in place, but would you be surprised if the subsidies are eliminated because they are simply too expensive for American tax-payers to continue paying? It's one thing I can absolutely see happening, in the not-too-distant future. That's why I'm focusing on Roth conversions instead of trying to game the broken ACA system. It's not only a safe bet, it is a conscionable action; I sleep better at night, knowing I'm not paying less for healthcare than someone working 50 hours a week, trying to raise a young family. YMMV."

"The way I look at it is once you are over 400% of the poverty level of income you lose 8.5% of the subsidy. So I've done Roth conversions to stay in the 12% bracket. Once I go over the next \$100 dollars would cost me 22% in income tax + 8.5% in subsidy + 15% for any capital gains I had that would have been 0% otherwise costing me a total of 45.50 for that \$100. Come 2026, if there is an income cut off to get the subsidy the goal would be to stay below that modified AGI amt. I'd then suspend any Roth conversions until reaching Medicare age."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgwDBg4aCJpYVLu5RI54AaABAg>

↳ @jasonbroom7147 (0): "Are you factoring in the immediate costs and not including the tax implications of escalating RMD's, while also not addressing any legacy goals?"

"It's the extended tax credits, for those above 400% of poverty level. Biden raised the subsidy cliff and that is scheduled to expire this year. It would shut out people above that level for any subsidy. For example I believe 400% is around \$80,000 for two people. So my husband and I right now pay \$527 a month for our plan on \$72k of income. If our small business became more profitable or if I work more, we would be shut out. Our plan is \$2800 a month without the subsidy. That's unsustainable. For lower income persons on the marketplace the loss of enhanced subsidies will mean that many of the Silver plans with cost sharing and zero to no premium will go up substantially. This will disproportionately affect Medicaid non expansion states where ACA enrollment is high. It will have a tremendous impact on a lot of folks."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1kminjg/obamacare_in_trouble/msawz3h/

"People don't understand that in retirement, you control your income and can therefore control your subsidies. It's definitely important to minimize expenses to succeed. I retired at 42, have a portfolio of \$1.6M, and receive subsidized ACA healthcare. I just keep my income between \$40-50k per year. The real difficulty is the insurance companies that leave the marketplace (I will need to change to a new insurance plan for the third time in 3 years next year) which compromises continuity of care."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65: The ACA Reality Nobody Tells You · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Qz8CyPjA5s&lc=UgwgypO3actEHjWxsp4AaABAg>

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (2): "That is very true. We have heard many people talk about the change from year to year in the ACA plans. Thanks for sharing!"

"When I retire next year, I plan on doing an audit in November, as you suggested. Then I will do a Roth conversion in an amount that gets me to my ACA MAGI sweet spot."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=UgwlpL21aktwccQyW2F4AaABAg>

↳ @tonypeters3884 (4): "@RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith One thing that surprises me is that a gold plan is cheaper than both bronze and silver. \$1.00/month for bronze, \$74.83/month for silver, and \$7.30/month for gold. For reference, a 58 y/o male in Colorado with \$30,000 MAGI."

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (2): "That is a great plan! Is there anything else about the ACA that has surprised you?"

↳ @keithgilbert835 (1): "@tonypeters3884 thanks for sharing"

"Couldn't the extra expense of losing the ACA Credit and paying all of those extra taxes early magnify an unhappy path on the Monte Carlo? Potentially running you out of money. If you are on the happy path and have to pay a ton of taxes, you are safe and will never run out of money. I did my Roth conversions to allow me the flexibility to get the ACA credits for the 6 years prior to Medicare. If I'm lucky enough to have enough money @75 to put me in a high tax bracket. I'll happily pay the taxes! As that would mean my plan executed perfectly. I have no children and if I really can't spend the money I can do QCD's to minimize the tax."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 8 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgzzY6ZcfBQ3L6Vv3ON4AaABAg>

"Here's what I do not understand as a new retiree. I enjoyed an ACA subsidy this year. For 2026, I start Medicare in May. How do I choose a plan for 4 months out of the year and decide whether it is worth keeping income low to receive a subsidy for 4 months or just suck it up and pay the premium so I can do some Roth conversions."

— YouTube · Retirees Face a Healthcare Shock in 2026 | Planning for the ACA Cliff · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YdESV6dQQLM&lc=Ugy_mik7l2H7hmHqHNt4AaABAg

↳ @LilaB3an (1): "If you're only paying the additional healthcare costs for 4 months instead of 12, then the hit will be only 1/3rd as much as shown in the video. Whether that makes it worth it or not in your specific case ... only you can do the math."

↳ @britune (0): "Google short term health insurance. There are short-term healthcare plans to bridge situations like this that may be more affordable for you."

"Was able to do both. Wanted a plan that covered the monthly premiums, but only needed catastrophic insurance as I have never had any medical issues. Needed to be able to have a higher MAGI to fill the 12% tax bracket with Roth conversions. I chose a Bronze HDHP + HSA plan from Kaiser Permanente with a \$7050 deductible. The premiums are completely covered by the tax credits as long as I keep my MAGI under \$55,700. Also, can contribute \$5,150 to an HSA account along with doing Roth conversions. I have enough brokerage funds to get by for the next 9 years to Medicare. I do leave the difference of \$55,700 to \$61,750 (top of the 12% bracket) unfilled, but the premium increases outweigh the tax savings."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies | Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 7 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgxzNzu7Ex23F4Thflt4AaABAg>

↳ @Retirement4life (0): "Sorry, what was the restriction to doing your Roth conversions? You needed a higher MAGI than a certain amount? Is this related to the min to avoid Medicaid or something different here? Also curious where you were able to figure out the \$57,500 number? Is there a program you like to help in calculations? Thanks!"

"Melanie and I had no idea about the ACA floor until we did our research before we retired. Now we know exactly how to manage our MAGI to keep our ACA subsidies in our early retirement."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=Ugzd5_2oxUhLFN8ND-14AaABAg.AZlgtuApDhZAZlhXiwt8P4

"I retired at 47 and the ACA subsidies are returning to exactly the way they worked then. I surely didn't expect the enhanced subsidies to become permanent. I would love it if they did, but people who pursue early retirement have a plan for maximizing subsidies and this shouldn't be a major hurdle for them. Keeping your MAGI low as an early retiree isn't particularly hard and should have been planned for. I'm still hoping for the return of the enhanced subsidies as they make a lot more sense. The cliff was always such a terrible part of the original ACA."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_issue/nn3h71t/

"Great video! I retired last May at age 59. In order to get ACA subsidies, we did a huge Roth conversion in 2025 (losing subsidy for that year), then we'll use the Roth funds to supplement our taxable IRA income for the next 5+ years, until I can get Medicare. That allows us to keep our MAGI below the limit of 4xFPL, and maintain our preferred standard of living. Your video has given more details about keeping ACA subsidies, so thank you!"
— YouTube · ACA Premium Shock? Pay Less All Year · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8zEUYMnF5vI&lc=UgymV1hZmuAk58MKjIB4AaABAg>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (3): "My pleasure! Thanks for watching and taking the time to leave a comment, and congratulations on your retirement last year at 59! Great job working to keep your MAGI below 400% FPL to get subsidies to help with those premiums, especially with the enhanced subsidies having expired at the end of 2025. I'm so happy you found out some more ways from the video to help keep your MAGI down -- that's really my total reason for creating this video - in the hope it will help others dealing with the high cost of health insurance these days. Take care, Mike"

↳ @patrickoconnor2547 (1): "Smart move. We opened a brokerage account 5 years prior to retirement. Show very little income. Enjoy"

"Good info. I've been managing my MAGI carefully for 4 years so as to qualify for extensive premium tax credits. My family of 3 pay just \$260 per month for a silver plan. With this Congress and its focus on drastically reducing federal spending, it is very unlikely that the enhanced premium tax credits and the elimination of the subsidy cliff put in place during the pandemic will be extended. So, I'm planning with that as my assumption."
— YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=UgzrjozoTn9IOHYR19h4AaABAg>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Thanks for sharing and watching! Well done managing your MAGI so strategically! You've been taking full advantage of the ACA premium tax credits, and that \$260/month for a family silver plan is a great outcome. I agree—given the current political climate and renewed focus on cutting federal spending, it's wise to plan as if the enhanced subsidies and the removal of the subsidy cliff will expire after 2025. While it's always possible Congress could act to extend them again, there's no active legislation right now pushing for that. Planning conservatively puts you in the best position either way."

"For me, the decision was a little of both, subsidized health care, and modest Roth conversions. As a single person, I manage my MAGI to 40k per year for considerable subsidy, and some conversions to take my MAGI to 40k. One other thing I do is select an ACA bronze plan that is HSA eligible. Allows me to max out my HSA, which also lowers my MAGI, allowing for a little more Roth conversion."
— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgyCXXK4NdUnY32fVAxd4AaABAg>

"I have a similar situation. I retired at 59. I have decided to do conversions after 65 to keep magi lower during my ACA years. I was able to keep magi really low and get a pretty decent silver savings plan for a reasonable price by not touching my pretax accounts."
— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E&lc=Ugxs3Oen9-744oMHQdZ4AaABAg.ATzXh2emb0nAU-Cb9hefWM>

"I'm adding to what Seaweed said in their post. I'm in a similar situation to you. I've been able to play with my assets to keep my income below 400%. Also, I only use about half my ACA credit so I don't have to worry about a repayment. Then at tax time, I receive the additional premium credit which helps fund the next year's monthly premium."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/o7kq8hw/

Bills, EOBs and fighting charges · 53 documents · 20 voices

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oig6zm/>

↳ (0): "My recent short 3 hour visit to ER costs (EKG and blood test) over \$10k. Your assumptions of "thousands" is off by an order of magnitude."

↳ (0): "The income limit for hospital assistance is not based on what you think you could justify paying on a bill. It's based solely on their guidelines. Not everyone who is uninsured gets assistance."

↳ (0): "Health Actuary here. This is the "wrong" answer, but I'd be lying if I said I wouldn't go uninsured in your position."

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tmp52c/>

↳ (0): "If she is an in-network provider she has a contract with your insurance provider and has agreed to their reimbursement rates. Confirm with your insurance company that her and her office are in-network. If she's collecting the "remaining balance" from patients she's breaking her contractual obligation. Providers cannot ask you to give up your rights to not be balanced billed. Also, it sounds like you're no longer comfortable with her either way and it'd be best to find another provider"

↳ (0): "OP your insurance can also do a three-way call with the provider and you to explain everything (if they actually are in network)."

↳ (0): "I'm a psychologist. Your therapist is in network and has agreed to the rate that the insurance company set. She or he cannot "balance bill" you. Depending on your state, it may be illegal. Regardless of state, it's unethical and in violation of the agreement that the therapist made with the insurance company as an in-network provider. If you want to go hard, you can report them to their licensing board for unethical behavior. At a minimum, I would not stick with this therapist. They're either uneducated or unethical. You don't want either of those in a therapist."

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

↳ (0): "Did they drop you because you didn't pay your deductible or because you didn't pay your premium? You say deductible, but the circumstances seem like you didn't pay your premium. The terminology really matters here. If you didn't pay your premium, yes, they will drop you, as will any insurance company. This is typically automatic, as are the letters that are generated to notify you of this. Just trying to get the facts straight. Without accurate facts, no one can provide accurate guidance."

↳ (0): "First, I don't suspect CareFirst would cancel your coverage because of a diagnosis. Granted, it might feel that way, but consider they'd cancel *all* policies for people with an expensive chronic condition following that logic. It was canceled for nonpayment, which you seemed to have remedied. Provided your retroactive payment was enough for reinstatement (and the reinstatement part is what's getting gummed up), you can take this to the VA Bureau of Insurance, as Marketplace plans are regulated at the state level: <https://www.scc.virginia.gov/consumers/insurance/file-an-insurance-complaint/>;

↳ (0): "automatic resolute arrest chase sip nail rain head treatment crawl *This post was mass deleted and anonymized with [Redact](<https://redact.dev/home>)*";

"I can't afford COBRA and I'm under court orders... I recently changed jobs. My benefits with my new employer don't kick in for 60 days. I'm under court orders (Child Support) to provide coverage or I risk paying 100% of any medical costs out of pocket. My children's other parent is not willing to work with me and has a history of taking advantage of situations that cause me financial hardship. They are already aware of the lack of coverage since recent Rx had to be paid out of pocket. Although my new position pays better than the last, COBRA coverage is \$1961.25 monthly to continue. Considering my other expenses to just survive, I can't afford an additional \$2k/mo even if it's only for two months. I have two children that are Special Needs so having a PPO plan was the choice to ensure we could see (almost) any doctor we needed. There is no option to only provide coverage for my children. I don't know what to do. I can start looking at other providers. I was told to ask for "Special Enrollment Period" plans as the coverage would only be needed for two months (until my new employer's benefits kick in). It was recommended to check healthcare.gov and affordablehealthplans.com . My concern is running into similar, unaffordable pricing. I need advice. I'm lost and feel like I'm going to face major medical bills here soon if I don't figure out a plan. I'm at work so I can't provide 100% of my attention to searching plans until later this evening. Help me, Reddit Community. You're my only hope."

— r/HealthInsurance · 42 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1w02ffv/>

↳ (0): "Your loss of insurance due to you leaving your job that included health insurance opens a special enrollment period in your state's health insurance marketplace (ACA Marketplace). The marketplace is operated either by your state or the federal government, depending on where you live. All plans available in the marketplace meet certain core standards including coverage of essential services and coverage for preexisting conditions. This last point is really important. Plans bought outside the marketplace may not include coverage for medical issues a person already has. In your children's cases, that would mean their health conditions wouldn't be covered, making the insurance less than useful. Depending on your income, you may get a subsidy for buying a plan through the Marketplace. Given today's date (August 28th) most plans may not go into effect until October 1. Costs incurred prior to the effective date won't be covered by insurance. Medicaid coverage is available in all states, depending on income and other factors. In most states, Medicaid expanded to cover a wide range of people. The Marketplace in your state will indicate if Medicaid is an option in your state. In some cases, Medicaid can be retroactive. You might also consider pursuing CHIP or Medicaid for individuals with disabilities, depending on the exact nature of your children's medical issues."

↳ (0): "Thank you. I'll look into these options."

↳ (0): "How long have you gone without health insurance? COBRA can be signed up for/used retroactively. So for 60 days from the last date of employment you have a window where you can wait to sign up if you need it, and it covers you retroactively for those 60 days. It's a rare instance where you only have to pay for it if you need to use it. For instance, if you do nothing now, and then your child has a large medical expense, you can sign up after the event of the expense, get coverage, and the event will be paid for as long as you signed up within the first 60 days."

"Nothing new. I had to pay upfront for my doctor's portion and the robotic tech assisting her or they would not do the surgery. I was told by her staff because patients will not pay their bill. Then they are at a loss. I also had to pay half the hospital bill for the surgery. The rest I had to set up a payment plan on file. All together about \$2700.00 out of pocket upfront. This surgery was not an emergency, but something I needed to have done to help me. Healthcare is terrible in America. You pay high premiums and still have to pay more bills."

— r/obamacare · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vno39p/hospitals_are_asking_insured_patients_to_prepay/p3jxpv/

"Am I misinterpreting my plan or is my insurance violating the ACA Two months ago I had my first annual gyno exam. A few days later I check my myChart and I have a 177.77 bill, which surprised me. I check my BCBS member portal and the EOB. They both say the total was 336, a discount was applied, plan paid 0.00, leaving me to pay a 177.77 copayment. (The insurance claim and EOB both specifically call it a copay). I thought it was a weird amount for a "copayment". I called customer service because I thought Under the Affordable Care Act your insurance can't charge you copayment, coinsurance, or a deductible on preventative care (i.e. routine gyno exams). The guy told me he saw I was entitled to a one covered yearly exam and would investigate it for me and call me back. Then they told me that the billing department says it was billed correctly because my benefits say "Annual Gynecological Exam - one per benefit period Covered - 100% after 100% copay" That wording is extremely confusing to me and more confusing is that my member handbook in the portal literally says... You have coverage for preventive care as required by the Affordable Care Act. As part of this law, you do not have a copayment, coinsurance or deductible when you receive preventive care, which include: • Routine gynecological exams Is this not contradiction and violation of the ACA? The provider was in network and all of the codes were correct."

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wnogvc/am_i_misinterpreting_my_plan_or_is_my_insurance/

↳ emmyjag (64): "What were the billing codes? The routine physical exams that are covered at no cost to you are very very narrowly defined, and any deviation changes the billing code from your free preventive exam to a diagnostic exam"

↳ positivelycat (37): "Sounds like your insurance processed incorrectly then. Try calling again sometimes you get someone newer who don't know what they are talking about"

↳ Melodic_Turnover_340 (18): "Diagnosis: Z01419 Procedure: 99385 I'm pretty sure those are the ones necessary for preventive and not diagnostic ?"

"I'm in a red state GA (but I believe we were blue or purple in the previous election) I've never despised anyone as much as I despise Trump. I did not vote for that POS. I was in active treatment for cancer last year and this year. I cannot afford to move (to a blue state) due to my medical bills from cancer. But I'm still very grateful I had insurance coverage during my battle. Your solution would not only harm those you hate, but some of us are on your side."

— r/obamacare · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1og3h64/the_new_aca_costs_are_coming_in/nle1xx5/

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— r/HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1so9ty7/>

↳ (0): "Sounds like a situation where you need to involve your State Department of Insurance so they can look into this further."

↳ (0): "And your state representative office"

↳ (0): "This is far beyond what anyone here can help with. Out of curiosity - what is the reason for the retroactive termination? At worst, a premium payment issue would terminate coverage effective the last month of no payment. Since your payment issues only began in December, there's another reason why Oscar retroactively cancelled your insurance for all of 2025. Are they claiming you misrepresented yourself and were in fact ineligible?"

"What do you do for Health Insurance? As someone who is self employed, how do you cover insurance? I have a High Deductible Health Plan through the marketplace. My plan this year is over \$1k a month and has a household out of pocket of \$11k before the insurance pays out anything. That means I pay a minimum of \$12k per year. I would have to spend \$23k before any help for medical bills would be provided. 😬 I don't have a PCP because I'm super healthy & 30 years old and almost never see a doctor. If I do have a reason to visit, I run by a walk in clinic and pay out of pocket. I keep the insurance in case of an emergency, but that is SOOO MUCH MONEY just in case of an emergency. Does anyone have any better options?"

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/w3xbi0/>

↳ (0): "Got married to someone who has insurance through their work."

↳ (0): "The government and health insurers certainly don't make being self-employed easy! Depending on your line of work, your business expenses, and how much you need to earn to live, you could try netting under 400% of the federal poverty limit which would allow you to qualify for federally subsidized health insurance. You could also research [catastrophic health plans](<https://www.healthcare.gov/glossary/catastrophic-health-plan/>) and look into qualifying for a hardship exemption. Short of marrying someone with job-based health insurance or relocating (as others have suggested), the only other possibility I can think of is to simply earn as much as possible so you can absorb the cost of health care premiums."

↳ (0): "Married with a woman with health insurance"

"62f small business owner (sole proprietor). Located in GA, which has its own exchange. AGI \$38,000 after schedule C write-offs. This year I pay \$38/mo, \$3600 MOOP, silver plan. \$15 copay for PCP, \$15 copay for mental health weekly (therapy), \$30 copay specialist. My colon ruptured out of the blue June 18. Emergency abdominal surgery, 10 days in hospital. The main hospital bill was \$90,000, my portion was \$10. I owe the surgeon \$800 and the hospital another \$3500, which I'm paying \$191/mo on a payment plan. The govt subsidy on my '24 taxes was \$816/mo. I have no idea what '26 will look like for my monthly premium. I certainly can't afford \$800+/mo! And I can't go without insurance 😞 "

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/nh749pf/

"I am self employed and got dropped on June 25th because of income verification. The phone number didn't work and I submitted an appeal but assuming this is all AI handled and they won't care that I'm self employed with wildly ranging income throughout the year. I did have to submit a P&L showing my income which seemed so needless. I have until August 1st and then my \$1.00 premium goes to \$486."

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0ynbzt/

"Accidentally went to OON primary care doctor and stuck with a huge bill TL;DR: Scheduled a primary care visit for an interim med refill, ended up with a \$662 bill because my specific plan isn't in-network for primary care. Billing refuses to adjust beyond \$50, won't let me pay cash rate, and I don't qualify for financial aid. MyChart currently shows the estimated cash-pay is \$303. Looking for any realistic options to dispute or reduce this. I'm in WA state and could really use advice on whether I have any remaining options here. Last fall, I scheduled a primary care visit with a clinic that's part of a large hospital system. Before booking, I checked their website and saw that my Marketplace insurance (Ambetter) was listed as in-network. I admittedly did not call my insurance to verify the specifics of my individual plan — I understand that's ultimately my responsibility. That said, I was in the middle of a very busy week and relied on the website information in good faith when scheduling. The visit was very straightforward: an interim refill of my long-standing ADHD medication, which I've been stable on for years. The new doctor reviewed the records that my psychiatrist had already released, confirming my stable medication history. I was temporarily on an Ambetter plan and my regular psychiatrist wasn't in-network at the time, so this was just to avoid a gap in treatment. The doctor asked for a urine drug screen, which I hadn't anticipated. My psychiatrist has never required one, and the year before, a similar interim refill at the same clinic didn't include it. I also wasn't told beforehand that it would incur a separate out-of-pocket charge or how much it would cost. A month later, I received a bill for \$662. Only then did I learn that while the hospital system lists Ambetter as in-network, my specific Ambetter plan is only considered in-network for specialist visits — not for primary care. So the visit processed as out-of-network. I requested a billing review and, after multiple calls, was reluctantly offered a \$50 adjustment. I don't qualify for financial assistance, and they wouldn't let me pay the cash-pay rate because I was technically insured at the time of service. When I explained my situation and financial stress, they were dismissive and said the only option is a payment plan—and they won't place my account on hold while I figure out next steps. What's especially frustrating is that their MyChart currently lists the estimated cash-pay cost for CPT 99204 plus the urine test as $\$233 + \$70 = \$303$. Even after the \$50 adjustment, I'm being charged more than double that. I fully understand I'm responsible for checking network status, and I'm not trying to avoid paying something. But it's hard to reconcile being charged such a ridiculous amount for what was essentially a simple refill appointment. At this point I'm trying to understand whether I have any realistic options left, or if this is just one of those expensive lessons."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1rcdnxm/>

↳ (0): "IMO, the \$50 credit was a win. I've seen many instances where providers/facilities don't even do that. Outside of possibly negotiating a prompt pay discount, I'm not sure that you have any other options. And since they've written off the \$50, that may not even be an option."

↳ (0): "It doesn't help you now and I'm not sure if Ambetter has this option, but for future reference, some insurance companies (Oscar) have the option to fill a gap prescription and/or virtually see a PCP that can write one. And as you've learned, always check if your specific plan is covered and In Network. I think that most people don't get that offices don't universally accept every plan from a company."

↳ (0): "Controlled substances for ADHD are almost always excluded from services like that."

"Ambetter admitting to missing three P2P's and recording inaccurate data I have Ambetter through the ACA marketplace and have been trying since March to get ivabradine (Corlanor) 5 mg approved for Inappropriate Sinus Tachycardia (IST). The medication was denied, so my cardiologist and I started the appeal process. We submitted multiple documents and were repeatedly told some variation of, "We just need one more document and you should be approved." Over the next few months, I received conflicting information from different representatives. One rep told me my doctor never submitted an appeal, while another confirmed that the appeal had been received. I was also repeatedly transferred to an offshore team that often couldn't locate my account or case information and could only read from a script. Eventually, Ambetter told us a peer-to-peer (P2P) review was needed. My doctor scheduled and waited for three separate P2P calls. On each occasion, they reserved two hours of their time and never received a call from Ambetter. When I questioned this, I was initially told that my physician likely missed the calls. After pushing for escalation, I was given a complaint number and promised a callback. No one ever called. I later reached someone on the escalation team who seemed genuinely helpful. He reviewed the case notes and stated that he could see all three missed P2P reviews. He also found documentation indicating that my physician's office had supposedly been contacted before a P2P had even been approved, which didn't make sense chronologically. He told me he had rarely seen a case file this disorganized and said he would immediately contact the pharmacy medical director. After I was on hold for approximately 90 minutes, the call disconnected. The next day, I called back with all of my reference numbers and complaint information. The escalation team transferred me back to the main customer service line. Pharmacy transferred me back to escalation. Escalation then sent me back to the main line again. At one point, the pharmacy representative called for me and was literally transferred back into his own department. To make matters worse, I ended up in the ER during this process and nearly lost my job because my symptoms remained uncontrolled while I fought through these delays. At this point, I'm preparing to file a complaint with my states Department of Insurance. My physician's office has documentation of the missed P2P appointments. Has anyone dealt with anything similar with their insurance? Beyond filing with the state and pursuing external review, is there anything else I should be doing? I pay \$550 a month for just me. TL:DR: My insurance has no internal workflow/communication, recorded inaccurate data, and has no actual escalation team. I'm at a loss of how to navigate other than filing with the state."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tx9333/>

↳ (0): "First off, Ambetter sucks. Not just a little, but a lot. The pharmacy area is a joke. The initial round of reviews are done by non US based pharmacists with questionable decision making. Most often this results in denials that are overturned later on. Their decisions on step therapy often recommend options that are not appropriate for patients. The escalation and P2P processes are astoundingly bad. Lots of no callbacks on escalations, never scheduled or no response to P2P requests, and missed scheduled P2P. The only way i've found to push the process forward (from my experience and peers) is to have the patient file a grievance with their state insurance commissioner's office. I usually get a follow up from Ambetter within 24 hours of receipt of the complaint. The key is that on the provider side they must track every call, fax, and email. Have receipts. We print off a detailed log, along with recommended wording for a state grievance. Patients understand we're on their side, but with the low reimbursements that Ambetter offers, it's often done at a deficit for the practice."

↳ (0): "In the future, file a grievance immediately with the insurance once you are beyond 7-14 calendar days from the initial request. Then, file a complaint with the division of insurance immediately if they don't resolve your grievance within 7-14 calendar days. Aka don't pass 30 days without a call to the state division of insurance. Complaint filing should be an easy process at the state level, they want and need to know."

↳ (0): "I'm sorry you're going through this. The first step is to confirm which state your Ambetter plan is based in,

since the appeal process can vary by state. As an agent, when a prior authorization is denied, I immediately submit an expedited appeal so the member can get a final resolution quickly. If that appeal is denied, I help them file an Independent Review Organization (IRO) request right away. The full process usually takes about 14 days. Most denials happen because the medical criteria simply aren't met — for example, when the provider prescribes something off-label, experimental, or fails to submit the required documentation. If the denial is due to a health plan error, the IRO often overturns it at no cost to the member. Sometimes appeals succeed because the Medical Director contacts the provider's office for more information. However, since Medical Directors handle dozens of cases per shift, if they can't connect with the provider promptly, the denial is usually upheld. The IRO process is more thorough because it requests documentation directly from the provider and reviews everything comprehensively. In certain states, like Florida, Centene Pharmacy Services handles appeals directly, leaving agents with little influence. Also, the so-called "Member Escalation Team" is essentially experienced customer service representatives — they don't escalate issues beyond standard procedures. True escalation happens through appeals or grievances, where the health plan must act according to your Evidence of Coverage and applicable law. Corporate staff may get involved, but unless your contract or policy language allows exceptions, their role is limited. Recommended Steps Call Ambetter and request to file an appeal as the patient for the denied prior authorization. Note the complaint number if your state allows appeals by phone, or complete the appeal form and send it to your state's designated address. Wait for the letter of determination. If denial is upheld, submit an IRO request. If the IRO also upholds the denial, you can file a complaint with your state's Department of Insurance. You can also skip directly to the Department of Insurance, but they'll usually redirect you back into the same process I described — only with corporate agents involved. That may be preferable if you'd rather speak with someone based in the U.S., since most contact center agents are overseas. Good luck — persistence is key in these cases, and following the proper steps gives you the best chance of success"

"Yep! I got charged over \$300 for a diagnostic Vit D test because my ACA insurance deemed it "medically unnecessary" (even though it came back low, they said it wasn't low enough to be necessary), so I didn't even get the contracted rate. I fought it. It took months to get it resolved, and while waiting the lab said I was past due and wouldn't do further lab work, and also kept sending me notices that they were sending me to collections (even though they knew I was appealing through insurance). In the end the insurance changed the category and I paid less than 50.. but SO lame."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/on2q8w9/

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

↳ wischywaschy (3): "I can't really help but I also have massive problems with IBX (self-funded plan) with an appeal process and the DOL is trying to help. IBX is a mess - it looks like they don't follow all ERISA regulations and seem very disorganized. The DOL is helpful but they are really short-staffed since they got DOGE'd, so whatever they can do for us is slow. They said to me they can do more when more people complain, so please

complain!"

↳ budrow21 (2): "I would file the appeals directly and continue working through the DoL. You don't have many other options."

↳ theoretalking (2): "Have you tried asking your employer's benefit manager and the broker to follow up with the account manager at IBX since she has not been responsive? The most people you got pushing and fighting for you, the better. sounds like you called your state's DOL? Try the US DOL here: <https://beta.dol.gov/about/agencies/ebsa/ask-ebsa> Have you tried looking up ERISA lawyers on Google? When I did that, I see a bunch lawyers that specialize in ERISA show up. It seems most (or not all) of them offer free consultation. I suggest you try that to find someone in your region."

"I don't need to read it and I know that. Trump doesn't want to help every day Americans. If he could kick everybody off of every program, he would. Poor people are ick to him. Unless you're obscenely wealthy, you don't count. He doesn't care if you live or die. Our lives changed after we enrolled in ACA. I was skeptical for the first few years and wouldn't even look. My husband has been a small business owner almost just entire adult life and I have been self-employed for 20 years now. We were destitute trying to cover my asthma meds. Two inhalers cost \$1000 per month. I actually had friends that would give them to me, when they could. The ACA gave us the one thing we could not handle on our own, which was health insurance. We could afford paying some, but not all. People don't realize the protections the ACA gives anyone that has any health insurance and the biggest one is insurance companies cannot deny for pre-existing conditions. If the ACA goes under, the protections go with it And they can't get it repealed so they are trying to kill it. I always knew it would be on the chopping block, just a matter of when. He's touched Medicaid, food stamps, this one's a no-brainer. I don't need the money to get my own health insurance. I need the protections we have and some subsidy money, paid to the insurance company He would have some people that would just pocket the money, how are they going to check they actual used it for insurance? How was the not socialism?? Dr. Oz says they have a plan but they don't want to tip their cards. I don't believe it. They're scrambling to put some Quick, not thought out, goofy plan. The cheap ones would all be catastrophic plans. Again, he can't and won't understand because he's never had to worry about a medical bill. If we lose health insurance, we would be homeless, that is how greatly it would affect us. My husband has to have his heart medication. He's not obese, he is extremely active and he eats a big salad with every dinner. It's not anything he did, it's hereditary, from both sides. He would die without his medicine, and there is no way we can afford it on our own. But I would sell everything I own to keep him alive as long as I could. Every time he has chest pains, he has to go to the hospital. Because we can't take a chance. He had a triple bypass at age 52 but I know he has been in the hospital at least three times this year, he is always admitted. It's so great to have to worry about this shit on top of everything else in life. I have never hated anyone like I hate this man. I do, I explicitly, completely hate him. Because the cruelty is the point, it's punishment for not being obscenely wealthy"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1our4kv/obamacare_could_collapse_under_trumps_new_plan/noeif0f/

"This video was awesome. Your presentation was very concise and clear to understand. I'm not sure you can help me but I try anyway. I have been in a health insurance nightmare for the last ten years. Thank God for Obamacare, however, I'm in a red state that will NEVER expand medicaid coverage. I'm 35 now and receive monthly LTD income (untaxed). I became disable at age 26 but, was given a technical denial from SSDI because I didn't have enough work credits. I also was denied SSI because my LTD income exceeded the threshold amount. I'm still disable an unable to get medicaid or medicare. Basically, I'm too young and not broke enough. 😞😞 ACA has told me I can't get their insurance because my long term disability is untaxed. Now I'm up to my neck with medical bills due to needing ongoing healthcare all because I got cancer when I was young and starting my career. What a screwed up health-care system. Thanks America! 🙄😞 "

— YouTube · Enrolling in Obamacare | 3 Mistakes to Avoid · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZBc-IntJRAU&lc=Ugx5-E1Q0dCqQPYuG4p4AaABAg>

↳ @FoundersHealth (0): "Oh my! That is a difficult one. What state are you in? Each state has different requirements so it will help me to understand the path forward if I know what state you are in. Feel free to reach out to me directly too. Shoot me an email at jo@founderslifeandhealth.com and we can figure out a time to chat."

↳ @cynthiaivers1708 (0): "Why are you blaming America for your health condition?"

"Duane, great info. I retired at age 50 and the ACA has been the way to go. Each state will vary I noticed when I did my research with the subsidy amount and income limits. In CT where I live, \$18,750 is the highest amount that would put one into our HUSKY program (free no cost insurance.) On the other side, one could make \$100,000 and still get a \$364.34 subsidy in our state. Folks also need to realize that monthly medical insurance cost is now a tax write off, along with any vision or dental plans one would have. Where as before when we worked, our employers benefited from that write off; \$250 per month yields a \$3000 write off. Whatever interest, investment income one is living on that's taxable, it's great that these medial costs along with your actual medical bills and RX can all be written off to lower your annual income amount come tax season. All your videos are beneficial for anyone considering retiring early."

— YouTube · 6 Retirement Health Insurance Options BEFORE Medicare Eligibility Kicks In · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOx1T4WKebc&lc=UgzWE208kd0UZT4ZaDR4AaABAg>

↳ @thinkplanetearth2946 (1): "Is that right @LoadedForBass? Insurance premiums and prescriptions are a tax write off? Is that every state or just CT where you live? I live in NY."

↳ @LoadedForBass (1): "@jamesbon1 In my case, no. That's where a good financial advisor comes into play. They can look over your portfolio and see where they can get a monthly draw and avoid penalties an such."

↳ @LoadedForBass (0): "@thinkplanetearth2946 Yes your accountant will write those off on your federal and in CT our tax info works off the federal info. When you work for a company we can't write if off because the employer contributes to our plans to help lower the costs, so they get that write off benefit. Once you are paying for your own medial/ dental / vision insurance you can write that off now. All medical and RX bills are also write-offs. If you use Walgreens (and I'm sure all major pharmacies have it) you can log into your account and print out all your RX's for the year so you don't have to keep a record of that."

"I make \$400 over the limit for free health insurance I have 2 kids a fiancé we live on our own with a car payment and car insurance we're already stretched thin. We went to the hospital for a simple iv because we had a stomach bug and couldn't stop puking so we were extremely dehydrated to the point where we were confused and dizzy. I got a \$2000 hospital bill for a SIMPLE IV that i was only hooked up to for an hour and then we left. The cheapest plan I found had a \$8400 deductible which I absolutely cannot afford. I was just trying to get insurance to pay for my \$2000 iv but in my case the monthly payment for the 2k hospital bill would cost me less than having to pay for the cheapest insurance i could find."

— YouTube · How to Buy Health Insurance on HealthCare.gov (or your State's Marketplace) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fND9DallI2Y&lc=Ugw8cl6lZWVLHEtzpfF4AaABAg>

↳ @SelfEmploymentSidekick (2): "Ugh. I really hate how this works. I remember finding a \$200 line item on a doctor's bill for "Ear wax extraction" because the pediatrician used a cotton swab in my kid's ear real quick during his regular check up. And then there are cases like yours where it would be cheaper to just pay the ridiculous bill rather than pay a ridiculous premium and STILL have to pay the ridiculous bill. Unfortunately, I don't know the best solution for this. I'm just doing my best to help people understand the different options that are available. But I realize the available options aren't good enough."

↳ @pinkorganichorse (0): "When you get free Healthcare, my young son and I can't get any because our premium is too high directly because we are supplementing your subsidy."

"Cobra Lapsed.... STRESSED.... Long story short, I had a choice last November between relocating or severance package and chose the severance package that came with Cobra coverage. The company sponsored coverage ended on 5/31 and if I continue to self pay I would have coverage til May 27 next year. TLDR I was abroad in June and didn't pay my first month of self payment in time. Upon return, I saw a letter stating that the grace period for each coverage period is the end of that respective month. For example, July's grace period ends tomorrow, July 31, 2026, and August's ends on August 31, 2026. I reached out immediately, assuming I could still activate the account since I was within the July grace period. But of course that's when I learned how this all worked, huge mistake on my part and I am so mad at myself. I am currently in appeal process, on the second appeal now where they're now needing approval from my company to reinstate the account. The team at health equity said usually they are able to reinstate the account through second appeal based on what they have seen? (I talked to 3 different phone representatives) I talked to the benefit team at my former employer and they seem to be willing to help but did ask why the payment lapsed. I explained my situation. How likely is my account able to be reinstated? There are some benefits I'd really like to utilize from my former plan and I know I really fucked up and slipped up. Huge life lesson here.... Any advise or folks with experience on this would be appreciated :(Stressed out. I did reach out to marketplace to get an application in place just in case the appeal is denied, but I am really hoping for the best."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vbdehm/>

↳ (0): "I cannot speak to the likelihood of reinstatement, but can speak to the timeline you're working against for Marketplace. You have 60 days from when your COBRA subsidy expired to choose a policy. You're running on borrowed time, since it's essentially day 60. What state are you in? Have you found new employment? Are you married? Trying to get more information to see if Medicaid is at all an option, since that program is always enrolling new members so long as they meet eligibility criteria."

↳ (0): "the insurance broker I worked with said if application is in before day 60 they will still honor it thankfully. yes another life lesson here for sure. smh on my part sigh"

↳ (0): "Update on this: Luckily I got off exchange Blue shield silver insurance in time within the 60 days deadline (cheaper than the covered California silver loaded version) Now just crossing my fingers that the appeal with Cobra / My former employer goes through so my cobra account can be reinstated. But in the mean time I am covered if all else fails. Still hoping for the best....!"

Checking the marketplace and doing the math · 27 documents · 20 voices

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>

↳ (0): "Premiums just went through the roof! Judging by estimated cost increases and comparing to what we've been paying ... yeah, I'd say that's about right. I would definitely call someone tho!"

↳ (0): "Welcome to the new normal. Pay or die"

↳ (0): "In America it's 'pay and still die'."

"Just got booted from my insurance Not sure what to do now. Just got cut off of medicaid after they looked at my most recent tax return. I live in Michigan and I make like \$1,700 more than their limit on average they say. I work as a school bus attendant and I make \$17/hr. My hours suck. I follow the school year calendar for both public schooling and special education. I go from working a 30 hour week, 4 times a month to working 20 hours 1 week, than 15, than 30, than 20 just because of how many days I have off due to weather or teacher education days or just randomly scheduled off days which are way too numerous. Still trying to find a secondary job or just a better primary job and having trouble with that. I'm 22 years old with a medical history large enough to fill up a old timey vacuum box if it was all printed out. I need health insurance as a constant. Now I'm looking at insurance plans and I'm not sure what to pick. Realistically I know that the numbers it's showing me are not something I can pay every month consistently since it says \$330/month starting out for plans with a \$10,600 deductible. I did not click the premium tax credit because it's confusing as heck and my tax returns are usually pretty small every year. Not sure what to do at this point or who to ask at this point to try and figure all this out. Edit and update: Thanks to everyone's advice I was able to find a plan that suits me for health, but also partially covers dental and vision for only \$49/month"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wenhgc/just_got_booted_from_my_insurance/

↳ Budget-Schedule-3040 (36): "You need to check the premium tax credit and shop silver-tier plans, full stop. The tax credit will make the silver plans much more affordable, and silver plans will have the lowest deductible and copays. If your income is in the low/mid \$20k range there likely are \$0 deductible silver plans available. It sucks having to calculate income but should be doable since it's already September. Only 3.5 months left in the year"

↳ Stomoyuki (14): "This is excellent advice. The premium tax credit doesn't depend on your refund but your expected household income (and other factors), so it will probably make a significant dent in the prices you're seeing. Losing Medicaid should also give you a Special Enrollment Period, allowing you to shop for insurance when the general populace can't. It can still be very confusing, and I'd recommend contacting a Marketplace navigator to help you figure everything out."

↳ No-Individual-5527 (9): "Sounds like the most liked and approved of plan. Looks good, thank you so much"

"Does choosing not to renew marketplace coverage count as a QLE for joining my wife's employer plan outside of open enrollment? My wife's job is a small business that offers a subsidized plan for employees and children of employees. They offer a plan for spouses as well, but it isn't subsidized, so in the past it has been a little more expensive than what I can find on the marketplace. Her open enrollment is in October and when I saw prices this year I assumed I would still be able to find it cheaper through the marketplace. However, marketplace prices were higher this time, but I didn't discover this until after open enrollment closed through her employer. So now I'm trying to figure out if choosing not to renew my marketplace plan would qualify me for a special enrollment period through her employer. I know many of the answers will be "you need to talk to her employer," which unfortunately is easier said than done. Since it is a small business, there is no HR department, there is only her boss (the general manager and one of the owners), and in the past her boss has dragged her feet on answering any insurance related questions until we were practically begging her to reach out to her agent the day before my daughter was going to lose coverage. So I'm trying to avoid asking her boss unless I absolutely need to. It is a BCBS of TN plan if that helps answer my question."

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pg1m66/>

↳ (0): "Probably not since loss of coverage must be involuntary. That said Open Enrollment is still available so you are lucky that you can still get ACA compliant insurance through the marketplace. The premium cost will depend on your income as well as whether you would have been able to get insurance through your wife that is affordable which for 2026 is 9.96% of income. Employers risk loss of tax deductible status for ALL employees if they don't adhere to Open Enrollment periods or if there is a genuine Qualifying Life Event"

↳ (0): "Unfortunatley no. QLEs mostly hinge on the gain of new coverage or the loss of eligibility to the old/existing coverage- you're still eligible to have a marketplace plan, you're choosing not to. It's not a QLE- it's considered a "voluntary" loss of coverage if you don't renew. For example if you got your coverage from your job and then left that job, you lost eligibility to be on the employer plan as an employee (since you're no longer an employee) THAT would be a QLE. If you thought there was a chance you might prefer your wife's coverage, you should have signed up for it- then, if you wanted a marketplace plan instead, you could have used that as a QLE (gain of new coverage) to then drop her work plan- but it doesn't really work backwards, unfortunately."

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

↳ TremendouslyMuffled (20): "Medicaid is exactly what you need here, being 18 and no income means you'll almost certainly qualify, and unlike the marketplace it's open year-round"

↳ LizzieMac123 (11): "That is if a parent doesn't claim OP as a dependent on their taxes. If a parent claims OP, they have to include the household income- which is likely the case if the Marketplace told OP they were eligible, but open enrollment is closed vs. sending them to medicaid directly."

↳ Blossom73 (5): "Because you're under 19, your mom's income counts if you live with her and/or are her tax dependent. That's because children's Medicaid ends at age 19 in Texas. Once you turn 19 you unfortunately won't qualify for Medicaid in Texas unless you're pregnant, disabled, as in deemed disabled by the SSA or the state, or an extremely low income parent of a minor child. The monthly income limit for children's Medicaid in TX for a household of 2 is \$2448. \$3714 for CHIP. <https://www.snapscreener.com/medicaid/guides/texas> Is your mom married? Does she have any other dependents?"

"Looking to possibly leave my job to start an in home daycare with my wife. The plan is to have my wife start off first while I still work and analyze if the income coming in makes sense and if leaving my current position will boost our income if I help her full time by bringing in more children. The only way I leave is if we work numbers and the amount at the end of every month is more than what I am making right now at a steady consistent rate. The biggest fear factor I have is that I have health/dental/vision insurance for all of my family. Leaving hurts my gut because while I was shopping around for healthcare for my family the least expensive one I found was around 805/month and that was just for HEALTH insurance."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Options for the Self Employed or Are Leaving Your Job · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ceyE3F7SK1k&lc=UgwaUBI9OyGnjyDellN4AaABAq>

↳ @MaximizingEcommerce (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. Depending on your beliefs (and health background), you may want to look into a cost sharing ministry as opposed to traditional health insurance. Regarding the risk, the question I would ask myself in your shoes is whether or not this opens doors to potentially additional profit/income opportunities..."

↳ @thehealthinsuranceguide (0): "Hi Manchester - How is the home daycare working out? Depending on your situation now (since it has been two years) your options may vary, and yes, health coverage can be pricey on the private side compared to a company plan that pays a lot of the cost for you. First check would be to see if you'd qualify for a significant subsidy. If not, or the subsidy is minimal, I'd check out the private underwritten plans. There are a couple that are available with lower premiums and better benefits because you have to be healthy enough to qualify to get on them. Did you get the health coverage all figured out? What did you end up going with?"

"Imperial problems and ACA So my dermatologist has been unable to communicate with my ACA insurance (Imperial) to get the necessary approval to biopsy some spots. The doctor's office basically came back to me saying they have done all they can do and are giving up and i was "welcome to self pay". I have called imperial to get answers to other questions and have gotten false information or "We don't know and we don't have a department either we or you can talk to to find out". I requested a manager callback and received none. Any suggestions on how to deal with this? Is there some kind of oversight organization or patient advocate organization I can go to to complain? Is there a path to being able to switch insurance via marketplace mid year? I tried calling the marketplace today, but they are closed for the holiday....I intend to follow up there but wanted to also cast a net here in case people have info that can help. Thank you in advance!"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tnbh0m/imperial_problems_and_a_ca/

↳ RoundChampionship840 (8): "Report this to your state insurance commissioner"

↳ branchymolecule (4): "I don't think it works that way anymore. Beware of cancelling your coverage."

↳ StephenDolo (3): "You can apply for Medicaid and get quickly denied/ and that will trigger a Special enrollment period, where you can switch plans middle of the year. Google ACA SEP, there are many different life events that can trigger a SEP where you can switch plans."

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

↳ fizzy-logic (19): "There's way too much going on in that post for me to break it down for you, and way too much both of you haven't made sure to understand about how it all works. There's just too much to walk you through. I normally think it's best to investigate how things work and take care of insurance yourself, as brokers can sometimes steer people wrong, but in your case you may need an insurance broker. BUT also you need to read up on how this shit works, desperately. The fact you said you didn't pay premiums, but you also didn't use it, implies you think that somehow you only pay for insurance if you actually need to use it. I'm not trying to be mean at all, but that lack of the most basic understanding of how insurance works is going to hurt you, your health, your family and your wallet. It's time to learn this stuff, and it won't be something you can read one article in one day and be done. You need to put time into it. But I will add that if someone is offered insurance through work, they are not eligible for any ACA subsidies unless that plan is expensive enough to be deemed unaffordable by ACA standards. You'd have to look up how to determine if the cost was high enough to let you get ACA subsidies, and I honestly don't know that you're gonna do that on your own. Get a broker for all of this mess, or better yet, an organization that helps people file as sort of a charitable work, I think there are some groups that do that. You can look at the ACA website for a list of facilitators in your area, they are free to you. The reason I'd look for someone like that rather than a broker, if possible, is since a broker isn't going to get commission if you are taking a work plan versus an ACA plan, you'll have to get lucky and hope someone gives you good advice even if it turns out they won't be getting a commission (if it turns out you and your wife are better going with her work plan). And there are absolutely brokers who would help even if they need to advise you to take the work plan instead, but there are also ones who convince people to take bad plans and/or fail to explain how it works properly. You can get badly burned financially if you take an ACA plan, didn't understand how it worked, and end up owing back thousands. Same can be said if you get sold a junk, non-ACA insurance plan that doesn't really cover anything when you need it. Added: If your wife is on an ACA plan when she actually has the option to get insurance from work, btw, and that insurance doesn't meet the standard to let her still get ACA credits, she can end up owing back the full amount of credits. This all gets reconciled at tax time - so the credits you get in 2026 are reconciled when you file your 2026 taxes in April of 2027. She would owe back whatever the full monthly premiums were without credits if it turns out she wasn't eligible to have them."

↳ LacyLove (18): "1 She cannot continue to get subsidies if her plan is affordable. 2 yes 3 yes 4 yes 5 no and it begins in November for coverage beginning in 2027. 6 That depends solely on the plans. 7 yes 8. She needs to enroll in her work plan ASAP. Then cancel her marketplace plan. You are 33 years old, it is time you learn about this stuff. You literally have the world's answers at your fingertips. Use them."

↳ Jcarlough (9): "Great questions! It's unfortunate that at 33 years-old you still are inexperienced at a key

component of “adulthood” but kudos for recognizing this and wanting to learn. I *am* curious on your health insurance situation for the past seven years no plan is going to allow a dependent stay enrolled once you hit 26 UNLESS you met the disabled dependent definition. Were you out of the US this whole time? Regardless, to answer your questions. 1. Yes. Your wife’s employer offering affordable health insurance that meets Minimum Essential Coverage (most do) WILL disqualify her for continuing subsidies. 2. Yes. Failure to enroll also disqualifies her from continuing to receive subsidies. 3. The rest of your questions are irrelevant due to the above. Really, since you currently do not have health insurance, it sounds like your best option is for your spouse to enroll you both into her new employer’s plan.”

"Mathematically, it doesn't matter. Your taxes will be the same either way. The difference is just timing. You will pay more for insurance every month, and maybe get a tax refund or pay less for insurance every month and maybe have a balance due with your taxes. Roth IRAs should not produce any income. Personally, my income is somewhat variable and I do not take the advanced Premium Tax Credit, and instead just take whatever credit I'm entitled to (if any) on my tax return. Yes, I am paying more every month for insurance, but since I am self employed it avoids an annoying recursive tax calculation, and it all works out in the end."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/o7mgorh/

"I can't even estimate my income until my taxes are done, yet I am to estimate it during open enrollment which is before my taxes are done. And now if I get that wrong either way I have to pay? As I have pointed out in the past, MAGI is calculated differently at the marketplace than how my state calculates it. I was estimating higher just to avoid Medicaid. Now you are saying that I will be fined for under estimating, is this correct?"

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yihrr/

"Complicated situation involving COBRA and deceased spouse. Any suggestions? Hi all, tl;dr: How do I get off COBRA and on to my employer's health insurance outside of open enrollment? **NOTE: I am ONLY looking for completely 100% LEGAL options. No funny business. No risk to my family's health insurance coverage, no risk of lapse in coverage, etc.** I'll try to keep this simple and only include important details. Located in New York state My wife got a new job in 2023 with awesome health insurance (NYSHIP Empire plan). She was diagnosed with brain cancer 6 months later and had to stop her job to do treatment. Her job kept her on the payroll for a year and then we did COBRA for her insurance, because while it was expensive (3400/month for our family - 2 kids), it completely covered her treatment - not even any copays. It was fuss free and seemed worth it at the time. While she was expected to beat the cancer, she had a massive relapse in summer 2025 and was in hospice from June thru Nov, when she passed. the entire time, we've been paying for her cobra and while I've had to fight for some things, it's mostly been good. My workplace is a startup/small business that participates in one of these group insurance for startup things that's externally managed (justworks). Open enrollment was last December. I was distraught after her death/ not really looking at every detail at the time, so I figured that I'd just cancel cobra a few months after she passed, once the dust settled, hospital bills were all done, etc, and move to my employer's plan, since we no longer need the super coverage. Unfortunately, I'm being told that voluntarily cancelling cobra doesn't count as a qualifying life event (QLE), that I have to have an involuntary loss of coverage in order to jump on to my employer's plan out of the normal open enrollment. I've asked justworks and they've said there's nothing they can do. I clearly explained the situation to them, asked for an extension on the open enrollment period due to extenuating circumstances, offered to back-pay premiums to the open enrollment period, etc). They say they've reviewed the situation and have no avenues to help me, and that I have to wait for the next open enrollment period, or have some QLE that justifies getting on to the plan. I've asked the COBRA company about how to generate an involuntary loss of coverage. I haven't heard back from them, but I'm not expecting that to be a possibility. The list of options as I see it is: 1) Continue paying cobra until the next open enrollment (cost: about \$37,000 at the current rate for the remaining time - this is rough) 2) Find another job, quit mine and get on their plan - but I like my job and am unlikely to find a comparable one. moreover, that would likely be a net loss, as I'm paid well. I'd sooner take option #1 than this. 3) Find another job that pays health insurance from day 1, get hired, take a vacation from my good job, jump on their plan, quit a week later, and use that as a QLE to get on my good employer's plan. Kind of a dick move and probably difficult to pull off, but I think technically this would work? 3b) I have friends that own businesses. I could possibly ask one of them to, as a favor, hire me for a month, give me health insurance (I'd pay them for it, etc), then I quit and jump on my employer's plan. The issues with this are a) I'm not sure it's above board legally, because I'd just be doing this to generate a QLE - is this legal?) b) I need to convince one of them to let me do it, which is a bit of a long shot. and c) is there a minimum amount of time that I'd need to hold another policy for it to "count"? 4) Get lousy insurance from the NY state marketplace, drop cobra, and hold it until open enrollment with my employer in December. My kids and I are relatively healthy, so this might be fine? Does anyone have any better suggestions? None of these options are particularly compelling. I'm hoping someone knows some specific (SAFE, LEGAL and LEGIT) method I can use/nobody has thought of. yet. Thank you!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1r7ttk3/>

↳ (0): "I am sorry for your loss. The simplest (least moving parts) plan is that the expiration of COBRA eligibility is a QLE baked into program design. COBRA doesn't last forever. The basic coverage concept is for 18 months after an employee separates. If the employee is found to be disabled by the federal government within 60 days of the separation, the COBRA period is extended to 29 months (that lines up with federal benefits programs). If an employee dies, their family members that were participating in an employer's health insurance program can participate in COBRA for 36 months. You may be getting close to the 18 month window. I don't know if periods "stack," (e.g., if the employee dies while on COBRA, can the 36 month option be triggered?). You wife'

employer's HR department or the plan administrator should be able to tell you when your COBRA eligibility ends. That will trigger a 60 day eligibility period for enrollment in a marketplace offering or other ACA compliant program. Best wishes for your future."

↳ (0): "Best as I can tell, we have 36 months available to us due to the NY state mini cobra as well as the death of my spouse. This takes us to summer 2027, but I'd switch to my employer in Dec 2026 during general enrollment."

↳ (0): "As you've learned, canceling COBRA voluntarily is not a QLE. Your option 4 would not work since you also need a QLE to get insurance on the marketplace outside of open enrollment. Since you're on COBRA, when is that scheduled to end? In most cases, you can only stay on for 18 months. Once that's up, that's your QLE to enroll in your employer's plan."

"Needing advice on what to do due to disabled household (looking for Marketplace insurance) Hello there. I'm recently officially (not state wide, though I'm starting the application process soon) disabled per my doctors and unable to return to work. I live with my parents and my aunt, all who are also disabled, although my Dad also works a low paying job to provide additional income. My aunt has never worked but pays us rent and has her own bills to pay on. Basically I am concerned about applying for marketplace insurance (Cobra, just for myself is going to be over 700\$ through my previous workplace, which I nor my family can afford monthly). I will solely be relying on my parents' income which I feel terrible about. Obviously as I am chronically ill I can't go without insurance or my medicine. I am worried that with including the entire household yearly income even though most of that money cannot help towards my insurance, that it will raise the price for me. This is all very new, scary and foreign to me. What are the options and how does this usually work through Marketplace? I'm 28 in TN. I'll be honest I'm not entirely sure what the household income is but I can say at least it is over 30k. *Maybe* nearing 45k annually. Not currently receiving disability but am about to start the application process, probably not eligible for Medicaid until then? But my family members are on Medicaid. Sorry and thank you in advance."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pvw5jg/>

↳ (0): "You have a lot of moving parts here. How old are you? State of residence? Total household income? Are you claimed as a dependent? Do you receive disability? Are you Medicaid eligible? Are your other family members on Medicaid? Impossible to give you advice without more information."

↳ (0): "Apologies. I've been a bit scatterbrained with tons of worry/stress and have memory issues. I'm 28 in TN not claimed as a dependent. I'll be honest I'm not entirely sure what the household income is but I can say at least it is over 30k. *Maybe* nearing 45k annually. Not currently receiving disability but am about to start the application process, probably not eligible for Medicaid until then? But my family members are on Medicaid."

↳ (0): "When the aca marketplace asks your household income, they are asking about your TAX household- who you file taxes with. Not just who you happen to live with. So, if your parents are not claiming you on their taxes, its just yourself. Tennessee is one of 10 states that did not expand medicaid to include eligibility due to low/no income- so youre going to need a state disability approval to get original medicaid. (This is what your family members have). The problem you face now is you have no income/low income and unless you'll make at least 15,650 as your modified adjusted gross income (MAGI) you dont qualify for any aca subsidies either. Youd have to pay full price for an ACA marketplace plan. Head over the healthcare.gov and fill out an application to see what is available to you- compare those plans and pricing to what your cobra would cost you. Its a shame there are still 10 states holding out on expanded medicaid, it really leaves many people in a bind- not making enough for a subsidy but not having expanded medicaid as an option either. If you were in an expanded medicaid state, simply making less than that 15k would be enough for medicaid to be approved (there are a few states with a work requirement but most just grant it based on income)."

"Did 17 months of COBRA and switched to Obamacare during ACA marketplace open enrollment. I manipulate MAGI to get the highest possible ACA tax credit. Obamacare is dying just in time for me to start medicare and medicare supplements. Of course medicare supplements are dying too. Once medicare supplements get too expensive, I will leave the U.S. to live in an underdeveloped country and pay cash for medical treatment. My wife will be on Obamacare for several more years. As she is still in her 50s, Obamacare should still be cheaper for a while. Once it gets too expensive, that will be another potential trigger to leave the U.S. With Canada getting Associate EU membership, if that comes with a Schengen passport for Canadians, then because I hold a Canadian passport too, we will relocate to Canada for several years while my wife goes through the process to become a Canadian citizen. Then after that, if Obamacare and medicare supplements are still broken, will move to the EU, say Portugal, Malta, or Greece, warm places where English speakers don't have a hassle."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1woyyo6/for_people_retiring_before_65_how_are_you/pbrm9kq/

"Lost my job, I can likely qualify for Medicaid but wondering if it will have bad implications at tax time So I lost my main job this week. I do have a second little 1099 side hustle that's good for about \$400 a month which is only a little over half my mortgage cost and I have some savings I can dip into. My ACA premium ended up being my second highest monthly bill because I estimated my income higher and because of Trump screwing those of us that use the program. My question is can I switch to Medicaid halfway through the without having to worry about paying back the subsidy? I'm applying for Medicaid today but obviously won't have an approval decision before my premium is due on July 1st, so I will probably have to pay my July premium. It would hurt financially to have to keep paying this inflated amount for the premium till the end of the year when I'm no longer making anywhere near that but I don't want to create an even bigger financial headache come tax time. Any insight appreciated thanks 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ufejkl/lost_my_job_i_can_likely_qualify_for_medicare_but/

↳ O_o-22 (2): "So the electricity bill used to not be that bad with the AC running in the summer tho last summer it did get high. I hadn't had the unit serviced so yesterday I took the panels off and cleaned the coils. One side was very covered in wispy cottony stuff and I've got some new furnace filters coming so hoping that will cut the costs down, especially this wee since it's supposed to be in the 90s all week. I haven't even had the air on at all in the last two weeks because it's been cool."

↳ Jujulabee (1): "Your premium subsidy is calculated based on annual income as reported to the IRS. If you lost your job presumably your annual income will drop significantly. If you become employed before the end of the year then you would calculate. Also keep in mind that unemployment insurance payments are calculated for income. Medicaid eligibility is based on monthly income and so if your monthly income is low enough to qualify your taking Medicaid wouldn't have impact on your taxable income for the purpose of calculating amount of premium."

↳ O_o-22 (1): "Yeah I knew it would count as income but I'm guessing I'll only get \$1000 a month or so. That is enough to pay my mortgage and all utilities so I'll be alright if it goes through."

"ACA or individual plan Recent layoff and my insurance runs out EOM. COBRA is too expensive so I choose several options from the Marketplace to consider, but not sure if I should consider an individual plan from somewhere like Florida blue or United. I have had several agents reach out (I made the mistake of entering info on an aggregator when I thought I was on United's site.) Is it worth my time to get a quote? I don't trust the agents, but some are saying they can quote me low monthly costs vs the marketplace. What am I missing if I can get a lower cost? I do go to doctors semi-regularly but this year should be in a good place to not have to go unless something pops up. I got medication refills for the next 3-4 months coverage. I figure even if I have to go to the urgent care that won't happen more than once or twice. I just feel like what I get from the agents would be conditional and I wouldn't realize it until it is too late. Any thoughts on going through the marketplace vs Ind. plans?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s6e74c/>

↳ (0): "You shouldn't bother considering non-ACA compliant coverage. It's just a waste of money. With that being said, off marketplace plans do exist with some carriers in some states - if you're not eligible for subsidies, you can explore those options. But a broker wouldn't be the place to do so - you can see all options directly on the carriers websites, so UHC.com, etc."

↳ (0): "Thanks all. I had a feeling those agents weren't the best choice, but good to understand why. I'll stick with ACA."

↳ (0): "They are cheaper because most of the time they are medically underwritten. Anything you are being treated for right now would likely be excluded from coverage. There are the rare private plans where this is not the case, but they are few and far between. As small business owners my husband and I looked at many options for the two of us. ACA was the only comprehensive option."

"We, 63.5 yo, estimated our MAGI at \$75,000 for 2025 during Open Enrollment. Due to a Roth conversion our income was actually \$85,000. Now we get to come off the ACA by less than \$1000 and now have to pay over \$3000 per month for crappy insurance. Ah, America, you've really become the Land of Opportunity. Anyone want to buy some blood? It's back to work time."

— YouTube · New Health Insurance Rules Just Created a Hack For Retirees · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MZfLaPA1bsM&lc=UgxvtOo7RA4j813nzP14AaABAg>

↳ @hownwen (2): "Ugh....careful planning is key"

"Health insurance options and 1099 vs standard employment I recently started working for a small trucking company. Before I got hired, I asked if they offered health insurance and was told that they did but it was expensive. Since my wife also works for a super small company that has made it hard to get insurance through, we've always gotten insurance through me, so when I quit my job, we both got dropped at the beginning of the month. I've asked about insurance a few times and have always gotten the runaround. They also gave me the option of being a general contractor, but I chose W2 because I knew it'd have insurance implications. Fast forward to today, my wife and I both have drs appointments coming up and no insurance, so I decided to get on marketplace to see if we could just grab a plan there. Holy shit. They are more than our rent. If that's what we have to do then so be it, but I'm wondering if I should switch over to being a general contractor at work to get better tax benefits. No clue if anyone has ever been in this situation or what to do."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wf9fw5/health_insurance_options_and_1099_vs_standard/

↳ rob4lb (3): "Presumably if you move to being a general contractor, the only insurance option you will have will be the Marketplace."

↳ throwfarfaraway1818 (2): "Yes, pressure your employer. Its bizarre and concerning that they refuse to share the insurance info with you and let you enroll. Major red flag."

↳ ShortUSA (2): "Here's a swath are financial differences (annual): 1. As was mentioned, if 1099 you'll owe an additional 7-8% in FICA taxes 2. Health insurance cost about \$20-25k. You can pay \$7500 for a cheap plan, if healthy great, if you get sick you'll pay the 7-8k deductible+. Or you could pay \$14,000 for an expensive plan, but with only a \$2000 deductible+. As an employee your employer will pay part of this. Do the math given what they pay. 3. Dental is like health insurance, but with much lower numbers. Total berries more, but think about \$1200 per year if your teeth are generally healthy. If you're employed your employer might pay some. 4. Vision is again like previous two, but lower numbers than dental. 5. If self employed you can readily tax deduct business expenses, as an employee, not so much, but ideally your employer pays them. ... The other thing worth considering is that 1099 employees generally lose work before employees. The employer sees employees as a larger commitment. They'll keep employees busy before assigning work to contractors. Being self employed gives you more flexibility to do other things while contacting: YouTube channel, another job, etc."

"I have been on an ACA plan since 2019 after retiring early at age 53. Each ACA plan resets on January 1, and you estimate your income for the upcoming (new) plan year when you enroll during open enrollment in the end of the previous year. It does not matter what your income was in previous years, you are basically starting over each plan year. I sold off a portion of my taxable account in January to fund the next few year's of living expenses. I knew I was going to do this when I enrolled in my 2024 ACA plan last December. I lost almost all of my subsidy for 2024 based on my estimated long-term gain from that sale. I also paid my estimated federal income tax liability for that sale in the first quarter of 2024. When I shop for my 2025 ACA plan, I will be using a much lower estimated income and will qualify once again for a subsidy."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgzKGIHHA73RBDXUC9B4AaABAg.A4Gpm4D0327A4MEdOQG2C7>

"We have to select a family plan from Jan 1, 2025 for jointly filing tax, but my wife will be joining Medicare mid next year. Can I change my ACA health insurance plan from family to single coverage after she joins Medicare? Will the monthly premium and subsidies be recalculated at that time?"

— YouTube · How to Qualify for ACA Health Insurance Subsidies as an Early Retiree · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cDtnJs9uN7M&lc=Ugynk7D0vI4RYLmHbZh4AaABAq>

↳ @earlyretirementadvisor (0): "Your family coverage will adjust when your wife switches to Medicare. She will still count toward the household for purposes of determining the income thresholds for subsidies as well, which is to your benefit. Here's my link to schedule a quick meeting. I'm happy to chat and help. <https://calendly.com/earlyretirementadvice/free-retirement-assessment>";

"When the ACA first rolled out, I couldn't afford it. The premiums quoted to me would have taken 2\3 of my monthly income, I went several years without health insurance. My 2026 Silverscript premium doubled. 😞 "

— YouTube · Obamacare enrollees get first look at 2026 prices as premiums soar · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2Aznbv0Pnoc&lc=UgyUIqex7WjlcPqU52x4AaABAq>

↳ @SuperBoomtown (0): "I hear 'ya masia1950. I just may have to self-medicate in 2026"

"Switching from marketplace to employer plan midyear - does my deductible reset? My partner's open enrollment is coming up and we've been going back and forth about whether I should drop my individual marketplace plan and jump onto their employer plan. On paper the employer plan looks cheaper because the premium share is lower. But I've been burned before by looking only at the monthly number and missing everything else. The part I can't sort out is how the deductible timing works. If I switch midyear, does my out-of-pocket progress from my current plan carry over at all, or does the clock restart at zero on the new plan? I already hit a decent chunk of my deductible this year from a few visits and a lab situation that got more complicated than expected. Starting over in October or November feels like it could cost me more than just staying put through December and switching in January. I spent enough years in HR to know that the smart-sounding answer is usually "it depends," which is not actually helpful when you're trying to run real numbers. What I want to know is whether anyone has done this calculation and landed somewhere clear, or whether there's a specific question to ask the new plan before making the switch. Special enrollment rules are also a little murky to me here, since I wouldn't be losing coverage. I'd be choosing to leave it. I'm not sure whether that even qualifies me for a special enrollment period on the employer side, or whether I'm dependent on my partner's open enrollment window being the entry point. Has anyone actually worked through this math midyear and figured out a clean way to compare? Or is the answer almost always just wait for January?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wkoqz4/switching_from_marketplace_to_employer_plan/

↳ chickenmcdiddle (15): "It'll almost certainly reset. The only time I've really seen deductibles / OOPM progress transfer is when an employer makes a plan change mid-year and offers this as a benefit to the employees to minimize disruption."

↳ Stomoyuki (3): "Yes, it will reset. OP should probably wait until January to switch plans if they've already met most of their deductible."

↳ Guilty-Committee9622 (3): "Yes it resets. You can pick it up now and use it as a 2ndry coverage. Meaning what hits your marketplace oop, you file on his insurance to pick up. Then drop marketplace end of calendar year."

Skipping care and rationing prescriptions · 12 documents · 12 voices

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

↳ Mysterious_Might008 (10): "My bronze ACA plan (TX) has a flat \$50 office visit for my PCP. Specialist office visits are flat \$100. So, I wouldn't be afraid of getting a diagnosis based on office visit fees. As of 2026, all bronze ACA plans are HDHPs. Lab work and other diagnostic procedures are a different story: that's where the mystery hit to the wallet really happens."

↳ SunLillyFairy (8): "Yep! I got charged over \$300 for a diagnostic Vit D test because my ACA insurance deemed it "medically unnecessary" (even though it came back low, they said it wasn't low enough to be necessary), so I didn't even get the contracted rate. I fought it. It took months to get it resolved, and while waiting the lab said I was past due and wouldn't do further lab work, and also kept sending me notices that they were sending me to collections (even though they knew I was appealing through insurance). In the end the insurance changed the category and I paid less than 50.. but SO lame."

↳ MrLB____ (8): "Yes, I agree total scam. You could even buy insurance from the hospital itself via the affordable care act go to their own net work, all owned by the same company the doctor office hospital scam their own insurance company LOL Then insurance scams them back"

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

↳ (0): "Two reasons you might not be seeing subsidies on ACA plans: * your annual income is too low, or you entered it incorrectly. Your annual income must be over the poverty line to be eligible for subsidies * you answered the questions about employer coverage incorrectly, and you're not seeing subsidies because the application believes you have affordable employer coverage available"

↳ (0): "Can you expand on the international bit? That might change things quite a bit"

↳ (0): "The baby will be born there, but it will be a US citizen after some paperwork. My partner and I are both US citizens."

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

↳ (0): "In short, yes, a provider can always run your information through a carrier website and see if you have insurance or not. Ask for the cash price- say you want to pay cash and not go through insurance."

↳ (0): "They said if I have coverage of any kind (that they don't take of course), then I don't have the option to pay anything but the full cost of the visit :/ I've heard some doctors are more lenient on this than others, which makes me think I should just look for a new doctor. But that feels like a whole other can of worms right now and just kind of overwhelming tbh"

↳ (0): "I mean, OP can ask, but many behavioral health providers don't maintain separate cash-price vs. insurance-price fee schedules. They tend to be more transparent and open about their fees in general, meaning their published fee is the same regardless of payer (although may vary as a function of sliding scales or "scholarships")."

"Agreed. I pay \$100 more per month for a Gold plan with a \$1K deductible. I would rather pay \$1200 more than get hit with a \$7K plus bill. I don't ration care this way either."

— r/obamacare · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v4frri/seems_like_a_good_deal_to_me_what_am_i_missing/ozaw6l6/

"Mathematician, Yes u are right, that is why I can't afford health insurance either , so I take care of my health, eat right and exercise and the rest I live in the hands of God."

— YouTube · My Husband Doesn't Believe In Health Insurance · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Lu_b47Wc4Tl8&lc=Ugw3wAubFYn6_lysEFh4AaABAg.99jl4DaK1hX99jJf3FYFAw

"Accidentally went to OON primary care doctor and stuck with a huge bill TL;DR: Scheduled a primary care visit for an interim med refill, ended up with a \$662 bill because my specific plan isn't in-network for primary care. Billing refuses to adjust beyond \$50, won't let me pay cash rate, and I don't qualify for financial aid. MyChart currently shows the estimated cash-pay is \$303. Looking for any realistic options to dispute or reduce this. I'm in WA state and could really use advice on whether I have any remaining options here. Last fall, I scheduled a primary care visit with a clinic that's part of a large hospital system. Before booking, I checked their website and saw that my Marketplace insurance (Ambetter) was listed as in-network. I admittedly did not call my insurance to verify the specifics of my individual plan — I understand that's ultimately my responsibility. That said, I was in the middle of a very busy week and relied on the website information in good faith when scheduling. The visit was very straightforward: an interim refill of my long-standing ADHD medication, which I've been stable on for years. The new doctor reviewed the records that my psychiatrist had already released, confirming my stable medication history. I was temporarily on an Ambetter plan and my regular psychiatrist wasn't in-network at the time, so this was just to avoid a gap in treatment. The doctor asked for a urine drug screen, which I hadn't anticipated. My psychiatrist has never required one, and the year before, a similar interim refill at the same clinic didn't include it. I also wasn't told beforehand that it would incur a separate out-of-pocket charge or how much it would cost. A month later, I received a bill for \$662. Only then did I learn that while the hospital system lists Ambetter as in-network, my specific Ambetter plan is only considered in-network for specialist visits — not for primary care. So the visit processed as out-of-network. I requested a billing review and, after multiple calls, was reluctantly offered a \$50 adjustment. I don't qualify for financial assistance, and they wouldn't let me pay the cash-pay rate because I was technically insured at the time of service. When I explained my situation and financial stress, they were dismissive and said the only option is a payment plan—and they won't place my account on hold while I figure out next steps. What's especially frustrating is that their MyChart currently lists the estimated cash-pay cost for CPT 99204 plus the urine test as $\$233 + \$70 = \$303$. Even after the \$50 adjustment, I'm being charged more than double that. I fully understand I'm responsible for checking network status, and I'm not trying to avoid paying something. But it's hard to reconcile being charged such a ridiculous amount for what was essentially a simple refill appointment. At this point I'm trying to understand whether I have any realistic options left, or if this is just one of those expensive lessons."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1rcdnxm/>

↳ (0): "IMO, the \$50 credit was a win. I've seen many instances where providers/facilities don't even do that. Outside of possibly negotiating a prompt pay discount, I'm not sure that you have any other options. And since they've written off the \$50, that may not even be an option."

↳ (0): "It doesn't help you now and I'm not sure if Ambetter has this option, but for future reference, some insurance companies (Oscar) have the option to fill a gap prescription and/or virtually see a PCP that can write one. And as you've learned, always check if your specific plan is covered and In Network. I think that most people don't get that offices don't universally accept every plan from a company."

↳ (0): "Controlled substances for ADHD are almost always excluded from services like that."

"I plan on looking for more of a 'catastrophic' plan, since I don't have regular medical expenses. I can't afford over 1k a month, with a \$6,800 deductible and then pay out of pocket for everything except my annual exam. One month's premium is the basic cost of my labs and exam. I will also take a trip and stock up on antibiotics - since that is 99% of the 'treatment' I receive for anything wrong, and avoid paying for urgent care or the ER. With Insurance, I pay \$60 for a Specialist. Without Insurance, I pay \$180. Half the time, I have had to pay out of pocket for tests or treatments, or spend hours attempting to get an approval. I really only want or need insurance for expenses over \$10k- I can pay for my annual visits. Honestly, I feel like insurance should pay/ reward me for any annual exams I do. "Yay! you got bloodwork! Here's a \$100 credit on your next bill for trying to catch problems early!"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5q1hev/

"Well, get this we are losing our health insurance. We are self-employed. My husband had a job where he was getting insurance also and it was still running us about \$700 out of his check for a family of three and then the employer was paying the other 80% they paid almost \$17,000 and 2024 for our insurance for our family. Now I looked into getting an insurance that was pretty much the same comparable to what we have right now and the quote that we got was \$2200 a month that is craziness. We have decided to go without insurance and pay our doctor bills as we go."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236lZc&lc=UgwXv6oJkbAh-ENTRTh4AaABAq>

"There are a lot of variables in something like a surgery, but OP i was answering to you mentioning Dr. visits. I have gotten accurate answers between my doc and insurance, (MODA), on what my costs will be for various specialist visits, lab work, tests, and simple procedures (like having a skin growth removed and biopsied). I think it's sad, although understandable, when folks avoid going to a doctor and getting evaluated because they don't know how much it's going to cost. Some of the mystery can *maybe* be taken out of it, depending on your carrier, by inquiring as to out how much the provider charges and then contracting your insurance to know what the contracted rate is/if they have one, and how much of it will be your responsibility."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/on4sgla/

"I get why this feels frustrating the worst part isn't even the deductible; it's the random bills that make people scared to get care in the first place. I've seen a lot of people avoid doctors for the same reason, which is honestly pretty messed up."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/ooq5lek/

"I haven't paid for health insurance in over 20 years, and I stopped going to US hospitals when I need care. I fly to Bangkok in business class and visit Bumrungrad Hospital for all my medical needs. Airfare, hotel, and procedures are completed for less than a visit to a sub-standard US hospital. On my first visit, I registered, saw a specialist (without a referral), visited the on-site pharmacy, got a drink at the McDonald's on the 2nd floor, walked by the Starbucks on the ground floor, and was in a taxi in 41 minutes."

— YouTube · Obamacare enrollees get first look at 2026 prices as premiums soar · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2Aznbv0Pnoc&lc=Ugy7kNsxzGeGkJAxP2R4AaABAq>

↳ @Doobie-doot2 (0): "Well, if you ever have a medical emergency, prey you have no delays at the airport."

"I've got health insurance, which is bad. I haven't been to the dentist in probably 15 years or better. I just went for the first time I'm finally going to get dentures, I'm so excited.♥ might I add? It took me having a severe infection in my gums and mouth to do this, which is sad...."

— YouTube · How I live without health insurance · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f1WINStYu30&lc=UgwKyVz9wMwfyY2VsVJ4AaABAq>

Private Worries

Premiums they can't pay (subsidy loss, doubling) · 104 documents

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oninso/>

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

"We retired early from investing. We have paid around \$100 per month for health insurance. We built up a Brokerage Account years earlier. That allows us to earn income and have cash available if needed. Keeping us under 30k magi, the sweet spot. While our retirement accounts are untouched and doubling!!"

— YouTube · How Do I Pay For Health Insurance if I Retire Early? · 201 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Au4dTlwLBUg&lc=Ugw2OuP5vUj89sl-Mbd4AaABAq>

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s4qs2m/>

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

"I make too little to qualify for Obamacare credits? Did this happen to anybody else? I am a grad student living off loans and I'm doing some virtual assistant work that only makes \$250/month. Apparently I don't qualify for any credits, so the lowest cost health plan would be a \$297/month premium. I can't afford it. I'm looking into indigent care, but I don't understand how people making more than me are paying \$0 for health insurance while I'm paying \$300. What is this?"

— HealthInsurance · 146 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1opphmn/>

"He's lucky he has the option for health insurance, I can't afford health insurance without going homeless"

— YouTube · My Husband Doesn't Believe In Health Insurance · 139 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Lub47Wc4TI8&lc=UgzW5rlmzoxkTvrqr6x4AaABAq>

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q8aooS/>

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"Healthcare costs are absolutely ridiculous. Before Obamacare my husband and I and our 10 children we paid \$550 family deductible for a year. Today it's 6,000 per person \$8,000 per family. Before Obamacare my husband was paying \$87 a month for health insurance. Now it's 200 a week. And the funny thing is we find that they really don't pay for anything through the year because we're paying for everything to meet our deductible. So health care insurance is actually just catastrophic insurance"

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · 79 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=UgxF5s855b01F-cCv3R4AaABAg>

"ACA not very affordable anymore ACA is not really affordable without the extra subsidy, but California fines you 100 per month for not having it. It's not really fair to fine people who truly can't afford it. I work front desk hotel. The cheapest plan for me is 200 per month. I have to pay 100% out of pocket until I reach 7200 for the year. Just 2 visits to the dermatologist is costing me 1400 on top of the 200 I already pay. ​ If I want something with normal co-pays, it's going to cost me 400 per month. I make between 45K-50K, but the cost of living is so high in California that there isn't much left for stuff like health insurance. It's really not fair that California fines you at this point when the premiums have literally doubled in price. It's very frustrating."

— obamacare · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/

"2027 shock 2026 me and dependent \$500 month 2027 \$959 month Got a letter from Florida Blue that if my income and subsidy is the same then this is what my premium will be. I know premiums went up but geez double? I'm limited to what plans I can get because I take a drug that's \$2200 a month. That only gets covered if it's on the formulary and I pay my out pocket maximum. So I can't even think about going to a lower end plan because those don't cover my drugs at all even with prior authorization. Any Florida Blue folks out there in the same boat? Any hope that when open enrollment starts maybe higher premiums will be offset with higher subsidies ? We're all winning right?"

— obamacare · 55 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wyq35r/>

"I can't afford COBRA and I'm under court orders... I recently changed jobs. My benefits with my new employer don't kick in for 60 days. I'm under court orders (Child Support) to provide coverage or I risk paying 100% of any medical costs out of pocket. My childrens' other parent is not willing to work with me and has a history of taking advantage of situations that cause me financial hardship. They are already aware of the lack of coverage since recent Rx had to be paid out of pocket. Although my new position pays better than the last, COBRA coverage is \$1961.25 monthly to continue. Considering my other expenses to just survive, I can't afford an additional \$2k/mo even if it's only for two months. I have two children that are Special Needs so having a PPO plan was the choice to ensure we could see (almost) any doctor we needed. There is no option to only provide coverage for my children. I don't know what to do. I can start looking at other providers. I was told to ask for "Special Enrollment Period" plans as the coverage would only be needed for two months (until my new employer's benefits kick in). It was recommended to check healthcare.gov and affordablehealthplans.com . My concern is running into similar, unaffordable pricing. I need advice. I'm lost and feel like I'm going to face major medical bills here soon if I don't figure out a plan. I'm at work so I can't provide 100% of my attention to searching plans until later this evening. Help me, Reddit Community. You're my only hope."

— HealthInsurance · 42 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1w02ffv/>

"Health insurance over 30% of my income It's open enrollment for the ACA right now, and I'm not sure what to do. I applied but the cheapest policy is 200/month more than my current policy. Where's the subsidy? I'm making 17/hr (not being paid over summer - school schedule) my current insurance is over 600/month and the aca is offering over 800/month. I can't afford this. I'm generally panicking because my financial situation changed, and we have a baby on the way. We were expecting to have a higher household income but currently I'm the only one earning. I'm debating canceling the insurance altogether. It won't cover the baby regardless (international stuff - but their healthcare will be covered over there until we bring the baby back). I've got other financial fears I need help figuring out too, but mainly just trying to get my head around the insurance. We don't qualify for medicaid (wtf) we don't qualify to rent an apartment (wtf) I'm debating living in my car if I lose my current housing situation, but when baby arrives it'll need more than a back seat. If I don't have to pay health insurance, then i could do better financially. I have decent savings, but once that's gone, it's gone. If I do cancel, then if something happens where I need care, then I might have to die before the baby is here because I can't afford treatment. I wish I could format my question more directly but I'm kinda overwhelmed and it's hard to write well while I'm all stressed and panicky. I thought when open enrollment came I'd be able to get on a plan that was paid for by the fed, and so I could drop my work coverage. That's turning out not to be the case. Am I missing something? Can someone help me figure out what to do?"

— HealthInsurance · 32 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1owfr9u/>

"Paxlovid \$1600? Anthem ACA in Indiana is pretty terrible -- the cheap "negotiated rate" for 5 days of the anti-COVID medication paxlovid is nearly \$1600. I'm skipping it since I can't afford it even with the \$1000 one-time use coupon from Pfizer. The whole year has been basically Anthem denying all my medications or offering a price that's way higher than those weird "discount cards" like GoodRx. Pretty terrible. Anyone else angry yet are ready for actual universal health care? I retired early and this is literally the only insurance plan available to me in my state. These insurance company scammers and big pharma scammers need to be fixed. Things are getting unsustainable. I understand that there's an active movement to dismantle and destroy ACA without any replacement, so that's part of the problem, but really we need actual universal healthcare and to tear down the existing scam organizations."

— HealthInsurance · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj8crd/paxlovid_1600/

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

"Self-employed independent white male. My premiums tripled. It's a big deal. I'll send you my address so you can make up the difference. I'll refund it when the 10 year (and counting) congressional fix that you refer to is implemented."

— obamacare · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ps7j5o/premiums_triple_congress_goes_homes/nv7gfug/

"Why am I still seeing 2026 subsidies on Healthcare.gov? This just seems incredibly irresponsible. People who don't follow news at all may merrily sign up for a plan they can't afford without subsidies, having no idea that they may be on the hook for the whole premium. <https://preview.redd.it/cvlhcg00pwyf1.png?width=1610&format=png&auto=webp&s=1517d5176586f1322a9622bacb5637f875ba9e74>";

— obamacare · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1omsfqj/>

"I thought the same. I feel for you, I'm over here ticked about paying \$427 a month. It is Ambetter. And I like it. Had cancer treatment in '24 and '25. No complaints. It was \$220 a month before we lost the subsidies."

— obamacare · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omssbpq/

"I dropped it after the 3rd year. My premiums went up 400% each year and my income didn't increase, it actually decreased in that time. I've only had health insurance 2 years of my 50 years and still can't afford it."

— YouTube · Millions of Americans drop Affordable Care Act coverage after premiums spike · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wakcL0IHxuA&lc=Ugz1jZurYG4Y7aAaFhN4AaABAg>

Paying the subsidy back at tax time · 33 documents

"Is it beneficial to slightly overestimate projected income, to avoid possibly having to pay back subsidies at tax return time? I am trying to get ready to pull the trigger and retire at 62.5 years old. I plan to calculate my income from my Roth IRA (and a tiny part time job). Is it safer to slightly overestimate my income when signing up for ACA, to hopefully avoid the potential of having to pay back anything if I go over what I projected?"

— obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"pleasant surprise but want no surprise in tax planning re aca just finished with my 2025 taxes and i will be getting a massive refund while i was expecting to owe a small check to irs 2025 was my full year of r/fire : i have no w2 income and relied on my investment dividends, tax free interests. i fired in mid 2024; so i had half year of w2 income and when i enrolled for aca in late 2024 for 2025 plans i wasn't sure what to put in my income and i only put in estimated total for qualified dividends and omitted (tax free municipal) interest which made a big chunk of my total cash for the year. i believe that i got subsidized aca rate for 2025. later in 2025 during my tax planning session i understood that i was to include tax free interest when enrolling aca. as a result i anticipated that i would be repaying the aca subsidies when i file 2025 return. but i was getting a big tax credit instead; my refund has been approved. when looking over the return i can see that a large portion of the refund is labeled medical and i didn't itemized any medical expenses; i only included the "standard" (i forgot the form number now) sent by aca does anyone understand this? for 2026 enrollment my aca premium is big and totally unsubsidized i believe because i enter a bigger (including tax free interest) income compared to 2025. should i expect at least some credit when 2026 return is filed?"

— obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sx0pb6/pleasant_surprise_but_want_no_surprise_in_tax/

"Yes, and that was the huge benefit of the Enhanced Tax Credit. I had to pay back the APTC 2 years in a row, almost \$60k total for family of 4 at the time, because went over MAGI by about \$2k both years. After the 2nd year it all but wiped out our savings."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wjwjed/planning_to_retire_at_62_how_ave_you_priced_the_3pakbti3/

"Yea, this was my situation last year. I lost my job due to a health issue and had to enroll with a marketplace plan. I had no clear indicator on what my income was going to be for the full year - as it wasn't clear when I would be returning to work. I hadn't yet made 15k (FPL) for the year, but on my estimate for income I just assumed I'd be out of work for 2 months and calculated that way. Figured that if I went back to work earlier, or got a better job - I'd just pay them the difference on my taxes. But after 4 major surgeries, I didn't work again at all last year (meaning I did not earn enough to 'qualify' for the program and would need to pay back the subsidies in their entirety if this provision was in place). After a couple months, I attempted to apply for short term disability, but was delayed/denied repeatedly. Under this provision, I would have ended up owing \$6,000+ on my taxes in addition to all of my other financial hardships."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yyfl6/

"Going into my fourth month without a job. I need to cancel my plan if i reach 6 months of no work right? i lost my job in December and thought id find a job by february but rhings fell through. its been really difficult finding a new job and i feel hopeless I'll find one soon. im scared I'll have to pay back if i exceed 6 months without a job so its recommended i cancel then right? then if i find a job I'll have to wait until enrollment but better than paying this shit back without having \$\$"

— obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/

"I also have an income that fluctuates. During previous ACA enrollments, we are asked to provide estimated income for the upcoming year to determine tax subsidy eligibility. When I file my taxes a year later, (and include the data from my 1095-A form) any deviation in my estimated income will result in a change to my tax liability. If for some reason I made more than what my estimated income was, I will pay back that portion/percentage of the tax subsidy(and vice versa if I make less). The BBB has changed it to any income overage over the estimated income given upon application will trigger a FULL repayment of the ENTIRE subsidy. I'm having difficulty even finding information on what the subsidies will be next year when they expire. Let alone what the actual policy costs are jumping up to."

— obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5p4pr7/

"I'm adding to what Seaweed said in their post. I'm in a similar situation to you. I've been able to play with my assets to keep my income below 400%. Also, I only use about half my ACA credit so I don't have to worry about a repayment. Then at tax time, I receive the additional premium credit which helps fund the next year's monthly premium."

— obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/o7kq8hw/

"How to estimate income for marketplace health insurance So, I got laid off this year (2025) but made enough money to not qualify for any ACA subsidies. So I've been paying health insurance from the marketplace out of pocket. I'm receiving unemployment income until mid January 2026. In shopping for 2026 health insurance coverage from my states marketplace, I need to update my income. For 2026, my only guaranteed income is the last two unemployment payments I will receive. Negligible. I am supposed to estimate my projected income for 2026.. I truly have no idea how to estimate this so I'm thinking, I will just project something low like \$3000 / month or \$36000 for the year. This should qualify me for ACA subsidies so my monthly health insurance is discounted. Then when I actually get a job, I will almost likely be on that employer's group plan and will drop the health insurance from the marketplace. If I earned more money in 2026 than \$3000/ a month or \$36000 for the year, when I do my 2026 taxes in early 2027, I might have to repay some or all the discounts I received but this would be negligible to me at this point. The important thing for me right now is to keep my monthly healthcare costs low until I get a job. Is my line of thinking correct? That is, projecting a low income for 2026 (because I clearly have no idea what my income for 2026 will be) to avail discounted health insurance while I have no job and just pay the undeserved discounts back in case I earn more in 2026."

— obamacare · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olyzi2/>

"ACA. It's not that big a deal to estimate your income; just do your best and set some extra money aside in case you owe at tax time. Or if you prefer, estimate on the high end for your income and file for a refund at tax time. Going "straight through private companies" doesn't mean you're getting real, normal insurance direct from the source. It just means you're getting subpar, non-compliant insurance that leave you with few protections. I didn't understand this when I first had to get my own insurance. I called BCBS directly, because it's the insurance I had with my previous employer, and I wanted a quote for "what I had before." They sent me straight to healthcare.gov for their ACA plans."

— HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wkwbkf/looking_for_affordable_health_insurance/paz8zn7/

"marketplace, healthcare, overlap, tax, implications... I am not sure this is the right sub Reddit for my question but hopefully someone can help or shed light on my situation. it's pretty simple. I recently started a new job after working for a small business and purchasing my own independent insurance for many years. I did not select my new employer sponsored insurance plan until August 31 of this year even though I was hired July 1 of this year. I assumed that coverage began September 1 but upon completion of paperwork, realize it started August 1. I'm not really sure how that's possible but that is what my plan states. So, I didn't know I had to cancel my marketplace plan immediately and somehow thought that they just canceled each other out. That sounds really stupid when I say it out loud, but I thought if I got one coverage, it would just terminate the other coverage, but I realize now it does not work that way. So now when I get my 1095 a at the end of the year, it will show that I had a Marketplace plan with high discount for all of Aug and 9 days of Sept (unless I'm stuck with the whole month of September as well. It depends if they can prorate the days.) that I technically did not qualify for. I'm essentially on the hook for the contributed amount, correct? I don't qualify for the discount. I just don't understand why I have to pay back that money if I didn't use the plan (or can't because the other insurance is primary and Trump's the marketplace plan) because all of my appointments and prescriptions are gonna be rerun through the new insurance. I was told I had to do that manually regardless. Does anything I'm saying have truth to it? Am I missing something? If I do everything correctly and go through any insurance claim for an appointment or prescription during that timeframe to have my primary insurance run and pay the difference, what are my tax implications? If I do none of that, what are my tax implications? Does it eventually catch up to me or do I have to deal with it at the end of the year in some way shape or form? TLDR: I had marketplace insurance as well as employer sponsored insurance that overlapped. What happens on my 1095 a when it comes time to pay taxes? Will I suffer an expensive payback situation for credits that I received at the same time as my other plan was active? I mean expensive is relative. I think the credits are like maximum \$500 a month so if I was charged for two months it would be about \$1000. it's an extra thousand dollars that I don't have to put towards health insurance though."

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wdgszl/marketplace_healthcare_overlap_tax_implications/

"You should work with an insurance broker (no charge to you). I quit my job at 62 and I qualified for a low premium plan (with the ACA subsidies). What you qualify for/subsidies are based on your taxable income and not assets. Unfortunately costs went way up this year but probably still far less expensive than COBRA. I'll be on Medicare in a few months but I still have to make sure my taxable income for the entire year is low so I don't have to pay back the subsidies for the 1st half of the year. I am grateful for savings and the ability to pull from Roth investments to keep the annual income low enough."

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1so1ega/62_no_insurance/ogg9pki/

"What, are you saying that if I estimate my income at \$20k 4-5 months before I even have my taxes done and it actually is 14k that I would have to pay back the subsidies? How the hell is that fair, we are talking about making \$14k, am I missing something?"

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n18jelr/

"Hi Travis, Thanks for the video. I had purchased subsidized health care from the marketplace for 2018 but had not been informed by marketplace that the medical plan Dean Health had automatic renewal. So in mid Jan 2019 when I received the premium bill (saying I was late)from Dean I was extremely agitated and called both Dean and marketplace and they ended the coverage on that day, Jan 22 I believe. Isn't that illegal when none of the paperwork from marketplace mentions automatic renewal? Now the IRS tells me I have to file a form 8962 for 2019 but I did not get a 1095A from marketplace for 2019. So many hassles. Very unfair. I have good health and never go to doctors. What should I do ?"

— YouTube · Health Insurance Tax Credit Explained · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8go8HuwI8xk&lc=UgwvdDOrGXC28xk_rA94AaABAq

"Help with ACA If anyone could help me with this, I'd really appreciate it. My family of 4 (me, my wife, and 2 adult children 21 and 23, both in college), are on ACA/Obamacare. I'm employed but as an independent hourly IT contractor through my LLC (no benefits, paid weekly and pay quarterly taxes). My wife does not work. My gross income this year will be around \$134,000 (I expected \$125,000 and put that down as my income in 2026 and received the tax credits). But both my children were able to get paid internships over the summer. My older kid probably made about \$16K and the younger one about \$12K (both put the money towards student loans). We didn't anticipate this when we signed up for the ACA. Since this puts us at \$162,000, well over the \$128,000 (400% FPL for family of 4), what can I do to avoid having to repay a huge sum due to being over the threshold? I have an IRA and 401K and my wife also has one from the years she did work. Should I set them up for my kids too? Thanks for any advice."

— obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wq33vw/help_with_aca/

"Edit: if I filed married filing separate and split the subsidy I only pay back my portion and my wife would the same paying back here portion. What happens if she doesn't pay back her portion?"

— obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rt6ha2/filed_for_divorce_in_july_wife_refuses_to_sign/oacekzi/

"Very good info. I've kept mine under the FPL and was okay with my choices especially for the price I had to pay. With the new work requirements I will go onto the ACA for 2.5 years before I hit 65. So if my income is 10K more than I anticipated, do I have to pay back the entire ACA subsidy or just the difference? Say I estimated 25K but at year end it turns out to be 35K and the subsidies would have been 1000/mo for the 25K and 900/mo for 35K. I have Vanguard Healthcare and they pay a big dividend at year end."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=UgzHQgWnvBMELkKZ2iJ4AaABAq>

"The non-ACA plans are often not good, and you often won't know it until it's too late. Please, please do yourself a favor of studying how ACA plans work. The possibility of having to pay back credits, when that happens and how much it might be, is one of the most vital things people need to understand about how these plans work. I have an ACA plan. Knowing how it works can help you prevent getting into a situation where you have to pay back credits, or at least be aware of it when your income changes and you know you'll have to pay some back, you can plan for it and not be surprised. And to help you decide whether or not to do things that might cause a spike in taxable income if you have a choice (esp important for people with investment income, or those deciding whether or not to decline a little overtime if you know it could put you owing back a lot of money, etc). Knowing how it all works can also help you save quite a lot of money in some instances. Such as if you are on the borderline of being eligible for a Silver plan with CSRs, if you know about this, you can do things to lower your taxable income a little and get a very good plan with low rates and low max oop. But if you aren't educating yourself on how it all works, you may miss out on things like that. I'll add this: For all we know, it's possible you already have a killer silver plan with CSRs for \$100 a month, and you don't realize how good it is. I get how that can happen, it's easy to not know how good your plan is until you see what else is out there. It's not just the monthly premium you need to look at, but what that premium gets you. As in, what is the deductible, what is the max out of pocket, what are co-pays for office visits, etc? A good CSR plan might have very low or \$0 deductible, and a low max out of pocket. But if you haven't educated yourself on health insurance, you could be looking at a \$2K max out of pocket and thinking this is BS! I need better for my \$100 a month! And all the while it's a great plan you won't be able to beat."

— HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wkyb3r/where_do_i_start_looking_for_individual_health/pb0uizi/

"Not sure if you know the answer to this but someone else might so here it goes: Let's say my wife can enroll in her new employer's healthcare very soon and not have to wait a certain amount of days or until 2027 and our kid and I stay on the ACA plan after removing her from it. Her new job comes with a decent pay bump and I since her income goes into the ACA subsidy calculation even though she'll no longer be on it, how would that work with the subsidy we are currently receiving for the rest of 2026? Would it be adjusted downward for the remainder of 2026 to account for the higher family income or would we continue to receive the same subsidy and just need to pay back whatever the difference ends up being at tax time?"

— HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1whx8qz/family_currently_on_aca_but_spouse_got_new_job/pa73pmq/

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— obamacare · 1 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1r5uq2v/>

Going without coverage and hoping nothing happens · 90 documents

"My family's health insurance is set to go from \$170 per month in 2025 to \$1560 in 2026 due to expiring ACA credits. A few clarifying points: - I earn approx \$125k as the sole provider for my family of 4 - I am self employed - This is the cheapest possible plan I could find anywhere - Coverage for this plan is terrible and helps me exactly \$0 with our family's actual health expenses I don't even know how I'm supposed to form thoughts around this. I can barely breathe let alone wrap my mind around this. How the hell am I supposed to survive in this country the way it is now? It seems like the world is actively punishing people who have families, or anyone who is not a multimillionaire. This is just one problem in a cornucopia of financial disasters handed to me as a millennial parent. This is not even mentioning how the new student loan rulings will add hundreds of dollars per month of financial burden, nor how I will forever be priced out of the housing market and am doomed to ever increasing rent month after month, or how food costs have practically doubled for my family over the past 5 years. How bad is it to go without health insurance in the new year? I literally have no idea what else to do..."

— HealthInsurance · 776 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ohoyrp/>

"Just looked at ACA premiums for 2026. There's no way. My husband (28m) and I (26f) are opting to go without health insurance at this time. If by some miracle the federal government decides to extend tax credits in 2026, then we will reconsider, but with the current outlook for premiums we just can't do it. I feel like crying honestly. We both work so hard and make fine money for our age and where we live. But between a mortgage we were forced into entering (long story, had to do with a landlord going bankrupt) and just general expenses, we can't afford even a base insurance plan. The lowest we were eligible for was \$650 a month and a \$20,000 deductible. The math just doesn't work. I see everyone raising alarm bells about going without insurance, having something catastrophic happen, and then going bankrupt. But honestly? Bankruptcy doesn't sound that bad comparatively. We'd go bankrupt with or without health insurance with those deductibles. I'm trying to have a positive outlook here, and I was really banking on being able to get us a catastrophic plan, but even that is not financially feasible for us. I am honestly in disbelief at the way healthcare in this country is handled. I can't even imagine how it is for people who have it so much worse than us."

— HealthInsurance · 660 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oninso/>

"Declined my \$10K COBRA plan – how I decided to go uninsured instead I'm 25f in NYC. When I left my previous job in March 2025 to start my own thing, I realized my health insurance premium was over \$10K a year, previously was fully covered by my employer. I decided to decline \$10K COBRA after thinking through this hypothetical scenario: >The Devil tells you there's a 0.5% chance you'll face a life-threatening event this year. If it happens, it could cost \$500K or your life – or both. Would you pay \$10K now just so if that 0.5% hits, you'd only owe \$4K (deductible)? $0.5\% \times \$500,000 - \$10,000 + \$4,000 = \$-3,500$ (P.S. Replace \$500K with whatever major medical cost you'd expect without insurance, and \$10K with your own annual premium. You can probably deduct a few basis points off that 0.5% risk if you're young, eat healthy, and exercise regularly, like me) So well well, I've been uninsured since then. This is how I get by: if you live in the big city, there're urgent cares everywhere. I've self-paid for everything – urgent care (labs, X-ray), annual physical, dental cleaning&exam, OB/GYN, flu shots, prescriptions. My primary care doctor hates insurance, dealing with insurance eats up his patients time, so it was self-paying anyway. I know the risks and I'm certainly not happy about it. But, resonating what others said here previously, I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never accept a system that makes people feel *lucky* to afford treatment for a life-threatening condition... hallelujah"

— HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oq2gfe/>

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hsvb50/>

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oig6zm/>

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 🙄 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>

"Help! Husband lost his job and we can't afford insurance through my employer! UPDATE: It is MUCH less expensive to insure all 3 of us instead of just me and my daughter through the marketplace! I can get insurance for all 3 for closer to 450 a month by adding him on the policy. Who knew? Thank you everyone for your suggestions! My husband lost his job yesterday. Our insurance will end on April 1. We are both 44 and we have a 13 year old daughter. He starts his new job next week BUT his new employer will not offer any benefits assistance. We live in Missouri. I checked with my employer and it will cost 840 a month on our plan. I tried Healthcare.gov and it was going to be 930 for the cheapest plan (for just me and my daughter, my husband is going to go without insurance. We are not eligible for Medicaid. Where can we find affordable insurance?"

— HealthInsurance · 159 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1s4qs2m/>

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wase0r/>

"The key to avoiding high healthcare costs is to be healthy. I've been self-employed for over 16 years and have the ACA since it came out. I pick the cheapest plan which gives my coverage in case of an emergency and all my wellness care. I pay \$131 per month for a bronze plan. I have paid up to \$270 per month in past higher earning years. I pay out of pocket for things not covered if I need them and get a 45% self pay discount. I don't pay a lot for healthcare per year and focus on being active and eating healthy non processed foods. I pay less on medical costs than many pay for insurance alone per year. This has been my way to not fund a ridiculously priced industry. I'm nearing 59. Protect your health at all costs!"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=UgxcstwBmYAJgMrsGvh4AaABAg>

"Is It Better to not Have Health Insurance or Choose a Very Expensive Plan? So these are the issues that we're facing if we have to choose a marketplace plan. Would you guys rather risk it and go without, or pay a lot for a plan? Here's my potential plan with a 50k income: BCBS PPO, 700/month, 9800 deductible, 11000 max oop. It would eat up my income, but if I don't have any major surgeries or a trip to the ER, then I'd be fine without. However, I'd hate to be uninsured if something happens. Realistically, what would you do? Can hospitals negotiate the price down if a bill is very expensive?"

— HealthInsurance · 47 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1p965n4/>

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/>

"I've just realized that my Ambetter ACA plan is dogsh1t First I see a primary care physician who doesn't want to continue to prescribe the maintenance sleep Rx that I have been on for over 30 years, telling me that I should see a psychiatrist. So I call up Ambetter saying this, but what do you know, there are only 3 psychiatrists in the plan, and none of them want to deal with anyone having insomnia issues. I have put in an escalation with [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) to allow me to get another plan (Blue Cross), which although it is \$300/m more, has my current primary-care physician in network. I have escalated wthis with Ambetter, and they are "working on it:, although they have not found a psychiatrist that will work out. I will be seeing my old doc as self-pay (\$130), also getting the Rx on my own. What the h3ll am I paying the \$80/mo for my plan for such garbage. And the ironic thing is that when I was on Medicaid, my primary-care physician was in network (I still had to pay for my Rx, since Medicaid doesn't pay for that Rx either)."

— obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nqhi12x/

"Something is irreparably broken with the way things are right now. No way should my healthy, middle-class family of 5 be expected to pay \$3,000+/month for a high-deductible insurance plan with pitiful coverage that's not accepted by most quality providers. Even if the subsidies are extended, I still have a huge issue with government tax dollars being funneled to health insurance companies to pay for these ridiculously high premiums. We've had to switch to cash pay with no insurance in the past, and cash-pay prices are reasonable, especially as compared to what's billed to insurers."

— obamacare · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oluqzl/thoughts_on_howwhen_the_shutdown_will_end_now/nmkopxl/

"I am in my 50s and cancelled. I have no insurance for the first time in my life and I work fulltime and always have. This is not sustainable. If I get sick I will either lose all of my life savings or die."

— obamacare · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1qil7n2/my_premium_went_from_200_to_1500_and_now/o0slhth/

"[US] How many of you are going without health insurance? Like everybody else my health insurance almost doubled this year, and I'm honestly not sure I can take another (probably) 20% increase next year. It's to the point where I'm sacrificing contributing to retirement to pay for health insurance (I'm 35, healthy, single and literally have never used my insurance) Are there any options out there other than marketplace for those who are self employed?"

— selfemployed · 23 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1w2kg0j/>

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

"Health insurance Canceled Me I am seeking urgent legal assistance regarding a serious issue with my health insurance coverage through the Marketplace and Oscar Health. I maintained active health insurance coverage throughout 2025 with Oscar Health and paid all monthly premiums on time without any lapse. In May 2025, I also reported a salary change to the Marketplace, and no issues were identified at that time. On December 31, 2025, I was unexpectedly charged \$529 after already paying my premium. When I contacted the insurance company, I was told this was due to a failure to apply my premium tax credit through HealthCare.gov. I was later informed that this was an error and that my correct monthly premium should have been approximately \$35. I was told the overcharge would be refunded. Shortly after, I had a medically necessary procedure scheduled related to a prior kidney condition and surgery. During that same week, I was informed by the provider that my insurance was inactive. I immediately contacted the insurer and explained the billing error. The following day, I was instructed to pay \$157 to reinstate my coverage, which I did in good faith because I required ongoing medical care. I was told the issue had been resolved. However, shortly thereafter, I began receiving notifications that my claims including hospital care, surgery, and procedures were denied. I was then informed that my coverage for 2025 had been retroactively voided. Additionally, my Form 1095-A has been marked as voided, creating significant tax implications. I have now been dealing with this issue for nearly 30 days. I am receiving medical bills and collection calls stating that I had no insurance coverage for all of 2025, despite having paid premiums consistently and followed all instructions given to me. At no point did I provide false or misleading information. The issue appears to stem from a subsidy/tax credit error that was acknowledged and supposedly corrected. Despite this, my coverage has been retroactively terminated, and I am now facing substantial financial and medical consequences. They are saying I didn't have coverage on 2025. Speaking with marketplace and Oscar they don't know the answers...."

— HealthInsurance · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1so9ty7/>

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— Medicaid · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1lwkcch/>

Plan switched or enrolled without consent · 3 documents

"My employer fired me after I challenged them of taking me off the health care insurance Hey everyone. I don't normally post stuff like this, but this whole situation has been insane and I could really use some outside perspective. I also want people to know how easily something like this can happen to them and the. The outcome of having health issues later. I worked for a company called Diamond Blade Warehouse (main office in Vernon Hills, IL, with multiple locations around the country). I was with them for almost three years. I left a different job to work there because I thought it'd be a good fit. Like any job, there were parts I liked good people on the sales side, some solid customers , but behind the curtain, it was a mess. I was a commission-based W-2 employee, meaning if I didn't hit commissions, I didn't get paid. No hourly, no base, no nothing. Just straight commission on a W-2... which already didn't sit right, but I needed the income. Earlier this year, out of nowhere, I was told I'd be switched to 1099. No paperwork, no conversation, no explanation. Just "you're 1099. "They just wanted the "benefits" of a contractor without actually making me one. Then on September 3rd, 2025, I got an email from accounting saying my health insurance coverage would end because they weren't applying my wages to the premium anymore. I replied, politely, that I wanted to keep my coverage and would pay out of pocket. I even jokingly said " I think you'd have to fire me to take away my benefits like that." Within ONE HOUR, my company email was disabled and I got a text message saying I was being terminated for "low sales." Convenient timing, right? And here's where it gets even worse. That same day, the COBRA plan administrator sent me a COBRA election notice that looked like it was printed off Google Images, wrong dates, wrong termination info, wrong deadlines. I tried responding, but their spam blocker was set so strict that my replies bounced. I literally had to switch email accounts just to contact them. They sent me a second COBRA notice the same day, also wrong. I asked for a corrected one and the administrator replied in ALL CAPS, basically yelling at me, demanding multiple months of payment upfront... even though the dates were wrong. Instead of fixing the spam blocker so I could communicate normally, management started relaying messages through my sales manager via text. It was like a weird game of corporate telephone. Completely unprofessional and honestly, absolutely ridiculous. Then comes the cherry on top: Months earlier, my manager texted me saying that the CFO, Bronwyn Jacobson, "didn't want me on the company's insurance" and was sweating him about it. In mid-August, she asked again if it was "ok to take me off." I never agreed. Two weeks later... terminated. I've already filed a complaint with the U.S. Department of Labor (EBSA) for COBRA violations, ERISA interference, retaliation, and misclassification. They're reviewing everything. I'm physically exhausted, financially strained, and emotionally worn down from dealing with this, but I'm speaking up because people deserve to know what companies pull when they think no one's looking. If any Redditors have advice, legal, emotional, or just practical, on navigating this, please drop it below. And if anyone's been through something similar, you're not alone. This one messed me up, and I don't want it happening to someone else."

— HealthInsurance · 105 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ovsnbg/>

"I don't know if it's changed, but when I was on the marketplace a decade ago, the application hard stopped if you didn't put in an SSN. So how are there applications without SSN's? Which is one problem I have with the statement they made about it. Also, if they identify problematic brokers, why not kick them off but still allow new brokers to sign up especially this close to open enrollment for the year. This is going to cause a restriction and how many agents are allowed to assist people. I feel like this is just going to hurt consumers more than the potentially fraudulent brokers. Usually, when I heard stories about fraudulent brokers signing people up for the marketplace, it wasn't people that never existed. It was people that came to them looking for plans and then they would either back out of getting a marketplace plan and then the broker still just enrolled them, especially if they qualified for a full subsidy or close to a full subsidy. Or they would encourage people to understate their income so that they would get a bigger subsidy and people would be more inclined to sign up and then get surprised at tax time."

— HealthInsurance · 89 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodklt/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbmia90/

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

A plan they can't use: deductibles and networks · 77 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>

"Dropping our ACA plan Today is the day my family is dropping our ACA plan. Our options were to stay on our same plan and be financially strained, or switch to a different plan with an absurdly high deductible. Neither option made sense for us. Luckily, my family is healthy right now. I'm just posting this for solidarity with all the other individuals and families in the same boat. Obviously, not having health insurance comes with a risk, but for us, that risk made more sense than continuing to pay into a broken system. We found a Direct Primary Care (DPC) provider near us, so we know we'll at least have basic, and great care. We are exploring other alternatives as well. Oh, and for those of you who are also exiting the marketplace this year, you must proactively do this or you will be automatically re-enrolled. Happy last day to enroll everyone!"

— HealthInsurance · 763 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pn7457/>

"Turns out my ACA compliant plan is a phantom/shell company Canceling my family health insurance today- turns out it was a total scam Imperial Health Insurance It turns out the insurance provider I have is essentially a ghost network, a shell plan, a phantom policy. 15,000 deductible. Bought through the official marketplace, supposedly fully 'ACA compliant', a bronze plan. First I discovered the doctors that are listed on our cards do not take our insurance. They said I have to call around and try to convince a doctor for husband and I or a pediatrician to take it. NONE have offered or even entertained this. I cannot take my children to get seen at a pediatrician. They both have ADHD. They had ONE provider listed as a child psychiatrist in their network and it essentially does not exist except on a screen. They have three numbers that all route to a voicemail that never calls back. I looked the doctor up and the practice does not exist. The 'cherry on top'? My son broke his arm and they refused to pay for a dime of it because it turns out there are no emergency providers in my county that take our insurance. WTF?! I asked if there were perhaps some in another county? They said no that would be out of network. WTF again?! The hospital/ER took our insurance card and looked at us like we were trying to pull a fast one or something. Like we were presenting a Monopoly or UNO card perhaps. NO medications are covered, except through a supposed online pharmacy that does not answer phones and has a PO Box for a physical address. Why the HELL was I paying \$600 a month for NOTHING? I feel so STUPID. I feel I have failed my family for making such a stupid decision, but I thought it was the RIGHT thing to do. I could've been saving all that and paying out of pocket for services. I want my money back, can I sue them?! TLDR; it turns out my ACA plan is a complete shell plan, a phantom policy, a ghost network that does NOT exist except to collect premiums. Canceling it TODAY. I WISH our employer covered healthcare. Any advice on how to report these fraudsters? It CAN'T be legal what they are doing. It just can't."

— HealthInsurance · 299 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vnue4v/>

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oig6zm/>

"Income priced me out of subsidies. General advice requested. I'm 61 and recently retired. My income now prices me out of subsidies. Last year my BCBS Silver plan was \$568/month. Next year this plan would be \$1702/month. I'm 61 with pre-existing conditions. I take 7 prescription drugs. I see my PCP once a year, rheumatologist twice a year, and the occasional orthopedist if needed. Last year I spent \$1489 of my \$5000 deductible. Out of pocket expenses were \$2790 out of \$8000. The marketplace yields 52 total plans for consideration. Given my info above, what general advice would you give to me in selecting a plan. Ex — may as well choose a high deductible plan given my past usage. Any guidance is appreciated. I really liked it when I was employed and had two group plan options!"

— HealthInsurance · 186 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1op6cfa/>

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? So I live in a crappy red state that doesn't support its citizens. When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the clown in the White House, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— HealthInsurance · 77 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wase0r/>

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

"One strategy i used was a high deductible ACA plan and fully funding a HSA account to lower my MAGI,"

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgwRt45pBiZY8nTOJTZ4AaABAq>

"IL started Get Covered IL last year in anticipation of these subsidies going away. It migrated those already on the marketplace for 2026 and mine only increased by .26 for 2026. I have a high deductible and it's an HMO. When I checked on the marketplace, it would've been \$188 more per month."

— obamacare · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1omsjln/will_large_states_like_california_create_public/nmrqp1n/

"I completely empathize re the cost but I still think it's worth having. I absolutely have to have it because I have a serious illness. I'm 44f. My monthly is \$605 and my deductible is 12k which I will probably hit after a hospital visit last month. It completely sucks but not having it would suck 1000x more. As it is I try so hard to stay out of the hospital. Last week I collapsed in an urgent care because I waited too long to get help. Thankfully it's attached to a hospital so they called a code blue on me and brought me over lickity split. But I was focused on how much it would cost and whether I could get through it myself, not what I reasonably should have been considering. When I was on the floor of the hospital staring at the ceiling I was thinking oops. Guess I let this go too far. But I try hard to avoid it because it's so freggin expensive. That same visit I left AMA because it's so much more expensive if they admit me."

— obamacare · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/ospvrf7/

"When I dropped my health insurance, the health system I use now offers me half off on visits. Why could they not do that when I had insurance? When the ACA subsidies were dropped with the help of the orange clown, my health insurance went from \$200 a month to almost \$700. I ended up dropping it as work was a little slow and this was a lot of money for something that didn't help much. I had a \$8000 yearly deductible, office visits were higher than they should have been, and almost no drugs were reduced more than the discount card I used at the pharmacy. Basically a lot of money for crappy coverage. Now that I don't have insurance, doctors's visits are half off. Some other visits like urgent care and blood work are half off the full price. Why couldn't I get that price with insurance? It would have lowered the cost of insurance by (I guess) half and I may have ended up keeping it. Why are we being charged an inflated cost with insurance. I feel like I paid more in the end for doctors appointments and such with insurance when you take the high deductible in consideration. It just all sounds like a scam to be and the doctors and insurance companies are in on it together."

— obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wb6cxw/when_i_dropped_my_health_insurance_the_health/

"It's a Catch-22. I need medical care to stay alive, but I need a W-2 job for high quality affordable medical care, but the job's killing me. I'm in my 40's, and I could afford to retire now if not for the health insurance issue. An ACA family plan is ridiculously expensive and all but the platinum plans are dog 🐕 (high premiums, very high deductibles, very high max OOP, and limited networks that don't cover the halfway decent docs and hospitals in my area). And the platinums are INSANELY expensive and still don't cover many of my needed specialists. And I can't build my HSA as I max out contributions and spending every year. I think my only hope is to try to find a super easy job (even if super low paying) with good benefits and see if I can survive another 7 years until our kids are all off the plan and my husband (self-employed) qualifies for Medicare. Or 5 years if I pay for COBRA for the last 2 years..."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwc78xLI9v11PhI6QR4AaABAq>

"Just checked my policy apparently until I pay my deductible of 1800 of a doctor visit I would have to pay the full amount at the doctors. I honestly have no idea why I got health insurance. I feel scammed."

— YouTube · How Health Insurance Works I What is a Deductible? Coinsurance? Copay? Premium? · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xs7MNNqdN-o&lc=UgzbyN1xEpdDQ0j963p4AaABAq>

"Getting blood work on ACA plans Not a huge deal in the grand scheme of things, but I generally get blood work once a year, so it's a predictable medical expense. This year it cost \$286 and I had to pay \$36 out of pocket with my employer provided health care plan. My doctor's office has a sign that basically says they test the blood in house but will provide a script if you want it sent to Quest or Lab Corp. When I look at my claims, the provider name is different than my doctor's office despite what the sign says. When I look up those providers, only one insurance company in the marketplace covers those. So I assume that means on the other plans, they would be out of network and I'd have to pay the full cost since they are HMOs and don't cover out of network. Is it possible there will be a discount even though it's out of network? I then looked up Quest on the marketplace, it looks like every city's location is listed and I see some are covered and some aren't with some plans (some don't cover any locations). But I assume I don't have control over which location my blood is sent to. So is there any way to ensure they are going to be covered. Is there any practical tips for how to handle this with the ACA plans or does it just depend on which insurance company we pick and can you figure out which is the best before you sign up?"

— obamacare · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vdjrvh/getting_blood_work_on_aca_plans/

"and a criminal system when I just noticed my deductibles are set so high. Now I understand every year will be as if I didn't have any healthcare coverage. I only go to the doctor yearly for minor things. Therefore, I'll be paying for my bills out of pocket. Then January 1st will be reset again. Also, the coinsurance and copays % may never kick in either yearly until something catastrophic happens (may God forbid)..... That's a crime for us to pay monthly for years after years to only have coverage for something extraordinary that may never happen and we don't want it to happen either. My deductible is 7,000. I never exceed it yearly."

— YouTube · How Health Insurance Works | What is a Deductible? Coinsurance? Copay? Premium? · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xs7MNNqdN-o&lc=Ugwdfdod3L_uT_Flam14AaABAg.9wIRtKMZUOe9wnQRsGBzPy

"Also using ACA plan; key note are premiums, deductibles and out of pocket max. But I have shopped plans and one or two ER visits or a single surgery/major procedure or chronic illness yearly cost for healthcare ive found an average of 15k to well over 25k. (again yearly!) And thats just whats in network, not always including meds and out of network services including vision and dental being billed separately on many plans. Absolutely abhorrent. We pay so much more for worse healthcare. Where a tax of a fraction of a cost per individual would cover everyone."

— obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/osrrfc0/

"What do you do for Health Insurance? As someone who is self employed, how do you cover insurance? I have a High Deductible Health Plan through the marketplace. My plan this year is over \$1k a month and has a household out of pocket of \$11k before the insurance pays out anything. That means I pay a minimum of \$12k per year. I would have to spend \$23k before any help for medical bills would be provided. 🤔 I don't have a PCP because I'm super healthy & 30 years old and almost never see a doctor. If I do have a reason to visit, I run by a walk in clinic and pay out of pocket. I keep the insurance in case of an emergency, but that is SOOO MUCH MONEY just in case of an emergency. Does anyone have any better options?"

— selfemployed · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/w3xbi0/>

"Both my ACA and employer plans have/had an excellent state wide network. Out of state hospitals would be out of network with my "good" employer insurance too."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/nj3t4ms/

"The problem is how high the damn premiums are. The lowest option for my husband and I without a subsidy is a catastrophic premium of \$1,050 a month with the huge deductible of \$21,200 that pays nothing until we reach the deductible. My husband is our only source of income and he is an independent truck driver. You need folks like him to eat. So is this really how it was intended to work? I seriously doubt it."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oodemw/aca_the_cliff_is_a_big_issue/nn3vg5t/

"That is ridiculously wrong! I am doing it right now! I'm 60 and living on my cash/CD ladder while the majority of my assets sit in my Vanguard ETFs. I have minimal capital gains and interest income... after the standard deduction my income doesn't take me even close 150% of FPL. Therefore I actually have plenty of room to do some Roth conversions. At the 150% FPL I qualify for the absolute highest subsidies. I get my ACA coverage for \$0, most of my copays are between \$0 and \$10, while my deductible is \$0."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement! (All You Need to Know) · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BykvxJEWGo&lc=Ugy46l6gaydfloJhDnJ4AaABAg.A2_0CYUxLIJA2_7uy5vnw1

Lost Medicaid or earn too much for it · 10 documents

"Girlfriend had \$0 monthly premium; now will be \$890. She doesn't make \$700 a month... We're in Alabama. She has BCBS Blue Standardized Silver EPO. I'm not knowledgeable enough to know why, but I'm assuming her premium shot up because of the ACA subsidy cuts. Apparently she is in the "Medicaid gap"... Not entirely sure what to do except tell her to drop it until we can find a better solution, as much as I hate saying that. We weren't planning on getting married, but I'm beginning to consider it so my employer can get her on family coverage under my policy... Next November...."

— HealthInsurance · 780 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pff3oz/>

"The "Medicaid Gap" is a joke. For context, I live in Mississippi. (And honestly that should already tell you everything you need to know.) (And yes, I already posted this but I didn't realized the rant/vent flair would lock the comments. Whoops! So let's try this again) For the past two years, I've been able to get an affordable marketplace plan with Ambetter. It was the first time I was able to get health insurance since I got knocked off my dad's when I turned 26. (I'm now 31) Without this insurance, I wouldn't have been able to get diagnosed with ADHD, get help with my anxiety and depression, treat my Hypothyroidism and Anemia. Like this has been life changing for me. I work for a small business and unfortunately, I didn't make enough money in 2025 to qualify for the tax credit towards insurance premiums like I have the past couple of years. Which means I'm now expected to pay \$650 every single month for health insurance as a single person with no children. I'm absolutely not doing that because that's not something I can afford. And because Mississippi hates poor people (despite us being the poorest state in the country, but yknow whatever I guess), I now fall into the "Medicaid Gap" as if I was ever eligible for Medicaid in the first place. And because of that, it doesn't seem like there's any kind of affordable options. God forbid we expand Medicaid so the poor people can get health care. GOD FORBID. Luckily it seems like I'll at least be able to continue to afford my thyroid medicine and antidepressants still since I was already on the generic. (Ambetter fully covered Generic and GoodRx says between those two, it shouldn't be too much out of pocket.) But now I won't be able to afford my ADHD medicine and my mental health appointments where I also get my antidepressants and it just fucking sucks, man. I just feel so defeated. I was finally taking better care of myself and now it's about to come to a screeching halt. Anyway, thanks for listening to me vent. I know I'm not the only one in this situation. I'm just hoping something changes for us in the future.



"

— HealthInsurance · 138 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q4ew3x/>

"When Medicaid work requirements enter, we get 3% of those eligible getting coverage. That's quantifiable. The state of Georgia as a microcosm. Of what's to come. That's reality. Go fuck yourself"

— obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lv1xsc/heads_up_over_half_the_maga_murder_bills/n22ybrd/

"Thank you! I'm happy your mom has been able to afford her medicine. It's so sad that we pay so much and get so little in return. I try not to stress about it but fuck it's so hard not too. Then I'm scared it might go up next year and regardless i need my insurance for my family. I make too much for Medicaid I'm stuck in the middle. With my insurance my Ozempic is 800 and Farxiga is 400"

— obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vnce2d/a_shocking_92_percent_of_us_adults_are_not_going/p3ii1am/

"I lost my Medicaid due to this very reason. During Covid, I (and my children) qualified for Medicaid. When the restrictions kicked back in, I was unceremoniously dumped off of it without more than a months notice. I make \$100 over the limit. I applied for ACA, and quite literally cannot afford any of the plans offered. That \$100 I make over the limit? It's not enough to pay for any of the plans offered under ACA. So now I have no health insurance, a chronic illness that requires specialists and prescriptions to keep me from being bed bound, and I'm one serious health complication away from losing my house. We exist and there are a lot of us. Especially those of us that live rurally because we can't afford to live in big cities."

— obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lv1xsc/heads_up_over_half_the_maga_murder_bills/n2bz0c5/

"Yes. We have no Roth, a 401k my husband didn't get until his employer had to offer them a couple years back, no other investments and no savings. My hubby still works and earns about 52k/yr. I am on SSA and get 365/month. We live paycheck to paycheck, barely, in California. We make too much for Medicaid, too young for Medicare and our silver plan went from fifteen dollars a month in 2025, to over 900 month in 2026. We have prescriptions and use the doctor. I have a cancer history. I just feel defeated."

— YouTube · New Health Insurance Rules Just Created a Hack For Retirees · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MZfLaPA1bsM&lc=Ugwn53ohRS3iFN8eITF4AaABAq.AQy3WwKT6LgAQyKGCiK-ZU>

"You can go start a business and not have to worry about insurance. That is not true. Because we own a business. We don't have enough employees to be required to provide health insurance, but without the ACA, my husband would be dead. He inherited a bad heart from both parents. He was in the hospital for 21 days and then about broke his financially, we had just started the business not that long before. The ACA isn't perfect but it's made for people just like me and my husband, we own a small business and we make too much for Medicaid but we can't pay full price for healthcare because it would be about \$3000 a month with a very high deductible. I'm glad to see that there is a red voter here that is willing to discuss and not just fight. That's what we need to be doing and that's what we always did, for hundreds of years. This hatred for each other is getting us nowhere. And we have no reason to hate each other other than which way we vote, it's almost like a form of segregation, oh we hate you because you vote red or we hate you because you vote blue I've lived in blue state and I've lived in a red state. There really isn't that much difference between them. Because that blue state had a lot of red voters and this red state has a lot of blue voters and it was once a swing state. I don't know if healthcare for all is the answer, but I do know we are paying a lot of middlemen a ton of money. And the CEOs of these healthcare industries, they own the pharmacy, benefit manager, they own the pharmacy, they're now starting to buy the doctors practices and they must do all they can to provide for their stockholders, they own every part of health insurance. How is that not a monopoly? Refreshing to talk with you. I know it seems like we are 1,000,000 miles apart, but we are definitely that way if we can't even talk and we haven't been talking for quite a long time. We need to start talking to each other again and not just hating. I have Republican friends, a lot of my friends are republican. There is exactly one couple that we can actually talk politics with without their being any animosity. We have lost one family member to politics, it was my uncle, and when he found out I was a Democrat, which was never hidden, but also never discussed, he would not talk to me. And I really needed him after my mom died unexpectedly. This shouldn't be happening in families or friendships. I could shake your hand through this device I would because we need more rational people on both sides. We may not agree, but we gotta start talking to try to find some middle ground. The politicians sure aren't doing that, it benefits them for us to be so divided. Remember, they work for us, all of us. We managed to make it work for hundreds of years and suddenly we can't talk to each other. I'm middle-aged, 51 years old. I've seen a few politicians. And there is a comment thread, they promised the moon just like in high school government, and we the people need to realize what they feasibly can do or can't do. I know I feel like the government is against the people. And it's not just because my party isn't in the highest office. I'm not happy with my own party. But I'm not happy with yours either."

— obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vs55qt/us_can_afford_universal_health_care_were_already/p4luzz8/

"Questions about how to file taxes with premium tax credits for a dependent? My taxes have always been super simple and straightforward. I work full time and have 2 kids, but I don't have employer health benefits and have had Medicaid for all 3 of us since my divorce. My 19 year old son was dropped from Medicaid coverage and I signed him up for an ACA policy through a broker who told me it wouldn't affect my taxes. My son is autistic and is a full time college student. He lives at home and I've always claimed him as a dependent. He doesn't have a job, but did have a little income from a summer internship. But since he has this policy does he have to file taxes? He didn't make enough money last year to meet the FPL for an individual and I didn't earn enough to meet the FPL for a family of 3. I think as far as the federal government is concerned he should still have Medicaid, but we live in a red state that didn't expand Medicaid, so there's no coverage for 18-24 year old students who don't have children. Do I file my taxes as usual with my children as dependents and then file taxes for him with his 1095-a and put that he can be claimed as a dependent? Do I not claim him as a dependent even though he is most definitely a dependent? He's the only one with an ACA policy and I do not know what I'm doing and I'm afraid since he didn't make enough money that he'll have to pay back thousands of dollars in subsidies. Thanks for any advice!"

— obamacare · 1 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1r5uq2v/>

"I'm stuck in one of those states that have a Medicaid gap. That is to say I retired early thinking I could live off of my savings, so I have too much in assets to qualify for Medicaid, but I also don't have a huge amount of reportable income, so I don't qualify for a subsidy. The American healthcare system is a NIGHTMARE!!!! I've come to the conclusion that they really just want everyone to ork until they have one foot in the grave."

— YouTube · Enrolling in Obamacare | 3 Mistakes to Avoid · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZBc-IntJRAU&lc=Ugz8NLmiGhxXWuJYnPt4AaABAg>

"@FoundersHealth Thank you so much for responding. I have a health situation right now and I just need to get whatever insurance I can get, as quickly as possible, so I think I'm just going to sign up for whatever seems like the best option and then if I don't like it, I'll change it during open enrollment. I can do that, right? I have a Marketplace account and I was just looking at my options and I saw a few that didn't seem to bad. My issue with the potential Medicaid appeal is that, I can't get access to the pay stubs from one of my part time jobs, because I have to log into a special account to get them and my password doesn't work. HR refuses to do anything about it. So I had to get them to give me a letter stating how many hours I'm contracted for, and how much my hourly rate is, instead. And last year's tax return won't work either, because I was only working one part time job, up until September, when I got another one at a school. So the tax return won't be accurate proof of my current income level, until next year. But regardless, I'm still making over the limit to qualify for Medicaid anymore, anyway, so I don't really see that it matters."

— YouTube · Enrolling in Obamacare | 3 Mistakes to Avoid · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZBc-IntJRAU&lc=UgzXSSKmF-3-6yHfiLV4AaABAg.AGni54LMtPOAGuo45_iLtB

Lost the job, COBRA too expensive, early retirement · 114 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come if it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hsvb50/>

"The government should really open up Medicare with reasonable premiums for those 55 -65. Age discrimination is preventing a lot of people from getting hired these days. Even ACA is costing me 1K a month for me and spouse. My spouse's work insurance was much more expensive. My COBRA just ended after I lost my job 18 months ago and it was 1500 a month going up to 2K this year. I stayed on COBRA because we already satisfied the max out of pocket and it was good insurance."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Retire Before 65 · 72 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l8VY8AcaLww&lc=UgxUWCq0OC_S-rSQahN4AaABAq

"I retired at 18 months before Medicare using COBRA. My HR dept states my premium, including vision, will be \$950. My plan is to ride COBRA until the next marketplace window opens and see if that would be a better choice. It turns out to be more than 75% of COBRA, I'll just ride the COBRA train all the way to Medicare. My HSA is toast by November 2026 at best. My advice to folks is fund your HSA fully, every year you can, ahead of retirement"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance · 62 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E&lc=UgxxgRFbJsGUoWVlIRxB4AaABAg>

"No longer eligible for medicaid I've (26m) had illinois medicaid for the past 3/4ish years. My redetermination period was to be completed by Aug 2025. I've submitted the redetermination letter through mail last month and called the automated number today to check the status for them to tell my benefits have ended because of exceeding income. I've always done the medicaid application/redetermination including my parents in my household with their income (retirement, neither of them work anymore). Prior to this year, only my father had income through retirement. However, this/last year my mother also started getting retirement benefits which apparently pushed the household income past the medicaid income cap for 3 people. So now I am no longer eligible for medicaid. Have I been fucking up this whole time when doing the redetermination including them in my household? They don't have to file taxes because their total income from unemployment benefits is still low enough where they don't have to so I'm not claimed as a dependent or anything. What do I do moving forward? Do I start an entirely new application on the website with only my information and none of my parents'? Or am I screwed now and have to buy health insurance through marketplace now? Edit: Thanks for the replies/help; I'll reapply without their information. Also, I guess I didn't really specify my financial situation in the original post like I thought I did. I left my job a couple months prior to this whole thing. I then moved back in with my parents shortly after and have been living very modestly though my savings. I don't have an income as of this very moment."

— Medicaid · 30 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1n1vwy0/>

"Bronze HSA vs other plans, what am I missing? I'm looking at the plans available for my wife and I for a potential early retirement, the options don't really make sense to me. Comparing the Bronze HSA plan to the Silver, Gold and Platinum plans it seems that the Bronze HSA plan premium plus the out of pocket maximum is cheaper, or similar to just the premium of the gold and platinum plans? Why would anyone opt for those plans when they could be at the OOP maximum on the Bronze for less money? Even looking at the Silver plans the premium plus the deductible is similar / less than the Bronze HSA OOP maximum. And the fact that the Bronze HSA plan qualifies you for an HSA is just gravy. You can cover most of your medical expenses tax free. So why do the gold and platinum tiers exists? This is for two people near 60 in California under 400% FPL. Maybe the numbers don't look so weird for people in other circumstances?"

— obamacare · 21 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pzpu11/>

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

"COBRA denying everything? My company got sold at the end of last year, and we were all laid off. So I had a choice between going to the Marketplace or using (what I thought would be) a continuation of the same insurance under COBRA. I think it's a PPO or something like that, the higher priced one at work, with the lower deductible. The premium is viciously expensive either way, ACA or COBRA. We are older with pre-existing conditions, my spouse is self-employed, and now, so am I. A bronze plan would have been pointless. So COBRA seemed like the best decision for now. But nothing will go through. Nobody sent a different card or told me to call a different number. Am I missing something? They are turning down previously covered medications, they won't even pay for a dental bill, and the deductible is only \$50! (The COBRA included dental and vision coverage. I selected them all.) This was naturally far more expensive than my rent or any other monthly bill we've ever paid, and we'd love to be able to use it. We have had this insurance for years and it was never a problem, especially for prescriptions. Please tell me if I'm just missing something entirely. Thank you so much!"

— HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1rah9t7/>

"Yep; retired at 61 and controlled my MAGI such that I paid \$0 for a Silver plan. Benefit of being conservative over many years and having enough in brokerage / savings to cover expenses, vacations, etc. for four years before Medicare kicked in. (So now I actually pay more (~\$300/mo) for Medicare + plan premium than when on ACA. 🙄)"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAq

"I don't need health insurance if I can afford to quit my job and recover my mental state because working long hours is causing me insanity 🤪"

— YouTube · How I Got Health Insurance After I Quit My Job · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Sv-zQAg0uWk&lc=UgxCUFw8MyVNtP0US9F4AaABAq>

"Started a taxable brokerage account 5 years ago instead of maxing out our 401k. Wound up with around 300k and retired age 60 knowing this account would lower our MAGI with small IRA withdrawals. We pay \$7 dollars a month for a Bronze plan with an HSA. We can show up to 65k a year in income for the \$7 dollars a month. We withdraw 50k from IRA and the rest from the brokerage account. The HSA lowers our income 10k. Highly recommend funding a brokerage account instead of IRA a few years before retirement. Great video and ideas"

— YouTube · ACA Premium Shock? Pay Less All Year · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8zEUYMnF5vI&lc=UgypWK6z8jnk9WEZex4AaABAq>

"Manipulating income for Silver Plan w/ CSR So I've very tentatively looked into early retirement, meaning 5 years before Medicare eligibility and I was just tapping around on an AI asking questions and so I have a question to real people who might know something about this: The AI, Gemini, said that if you keep your income between \$15,060 and \$22,590 that you can get a subsidize silver plan with cost sharing reductions for next to nothing, relatively speaking. First question: is this still a thing, or was the AI trained on old information? Second question: My main source of income before Social Security and a pension would kick in would be income from a Roth IRA. Gemini said that income from a Roth IRA, since it's not taxable, would not count. So I could get a part-time job and earn within the range written above and then get additional income from my Roth IRA and still be eligible for relatively low cost health insurance through a silver plan with cost sharing reductions. Is this true? Thanks."

— obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti1dc8/manipulating_income_for_silver_plan_w_csr/

"Living off Cash (for a few years) I'll be 53 next year, and would like to quit my job and live off saved cash for 3-4 years before potentially rejoining the workforce. Since my income would be \$0 for those years, how would I go about getting health insurance? When I enter estimates in the ACA, they tell me to apply for medicaid. I also own a house that has an estimated value of 500k and have over 500k in retirement, but I don't want to touch the retirement until I'm 59. Would getting health insurance for my 3-4 years "off" be problematic because of my assets? And, would I have to receive medicaid or is there a way to still get a private insurance plan even with no income? I'm not trying to get "free healthcare," but if my income is zero for a few years, do I even have a choice? Thanks,"

— HealthInsurance · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tm0cfj/>

"My premium is 2700 month with 16k dollars maximum. So if i break my leg I am only out about 48000 dollars. Hopefully if I break one leg next year I can break 2 legs and second one is free. What a great deal. This is really screwed up. I have to quit my job and get rid of my income. Then premium is only 250 a month. Black market income is what a lot of us will have to find."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1omjomk/4x_increase_in_premiums/nmqgoz1/

"Yea, this was my situation last year. I lost my job due to a health issue and had to enroll with a marketplace plan. I had no clear indicator on what my income was going to be for the full year - as it wasn't clear when I would be returning to work. I hadn't yet made 15k (FPL) for the year, but on my estimate for income I just assumed I'd be out of work for 2 months and calculated that way. Figured that if I went back to work earlier, or got a better job - I'd just pay them the difference on my taxes. But after 4 major surgeries, I didn't work again at all last year (meaning I did not earn enough to 'qualify' for the program and would need to pay back the subsidies in their entirety if this provision was in place). After a couple months, I attempted to apply for short term disability, but was delayed/denied repeatedly. Under this provision, I would have ended up owing \$6,000+ on my taxes in addition to all of my other financial hardships."

— obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yyfl6/

"Ambetter admitting to missing three P2P's and recording inaccurate data I have Ambetter through the ACA marketplace and have been trying since March to get ivabradine (Corlanor) 5 mg approved for Inappropriate Sinus Tachycardia (IST). The medication was denied, so my cardiologist and I started the appeal process. We submitted multiple documents and were repeatedly told some variation of, "We just need one more document and you should be approved." Over the next few months, I received conflicting information from different representatives. One rep told me my doctor never submitted an appeal, while another confirmed that the appeal had been received. I was also repeatedly transferred to an offshore team that often couldn't locate my account or case information and could only read from a script. Eventually, Ambetter told us a peer-to-peer (P2P) review was needed. My doctor scheduled and waited for three separate P2P calls. On each occasion, they reserved two hours of their time and never received a call from Ambetter. When I questioned this, I was initially told that my physician likely missed the calls. After pushing for escalation, I was given a complaint number and promised a callback. No one ever called. I later reached someone on the escalation team who seemed genuinely helpful. He reviewed the case notes and stated that he could see all three missed P2P reviews. He also found documentation indicating that my physician's office had supposedly been contacted before a P2P had even been approved, which didn't make sense chronologically. He told me he had rarely seen a case file this disorganized and said he would immediately contact the pharmacy medical director. After I was on hold for approximately 90 minutes, the call disconnected. The next day, I called back with all of my reference numbers and complaint information. The escalation team transferred me back to the main customer service line. Pharmacy transferred me back to escalation. Escalation then sent me back to the main line again. At one point, the pharmacy representative called for me and was literally transferred back into his own department. To make matters worse, I ended up in the ER during this process and nearly lost my job because my symptoms remained uncontrolled while I fought through these delays. At this point, I'm preparing to file a complaint with my states Department of Insurance. My physician's office has documentation of the missed P2P appointments. Has anyone dealt with anything similar with their insurance? Beyond filing with the state and pursuing external review, is there anything else I should be doing? I pay \$550 a month for just me. TL:DR: My insurance has no internal workflow/communication, recorded inaccurate data, and has no actual escalation team. I'm at a loss of how to navigate other than filing with the state."

— HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tx9333/>

"I wasn't anticipating making a lot when I quit my job. So I got the government subsidized health insurance and then towards the end of the year I got a new client and made a lot of money and did not make any changes. Low and behold, I owe the government approximately \$2500 back when I filed my taxes"

— YouTube · How To Get Better Health Insurance If You're Self Employed I TIPS TO SAVE ON YOUR MEDICAL · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0eQnHCaWhT8&lc=UgwC9G5F_HnwoQXN6lh4AaABAq

"Actually, before the BBB, I was on Medicaid, and I wasn't working, and had a 7-figure net liquid wealth. There are a lot of early retirees - at least the ones that had taken the cheese and done big Roth IRA conversions - who were doing this. Instead, I'm on an ACA plan that is worse than Medicaid, and that costs the feds more."

— obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1u7ye86/youre_not_put_on_this_pla_net_to_sit_at_home_and/os55gew/

"Covered california. I always supported aca for the pre existing conditions alone. Never thought i would need it but when i got laid off in 2019 i used it for 6 months because Cobra was ridiculous and unaffordable."

— obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o5lrn3/the_media_is_reporting_maj_ority_of_people_on_the/njcf5yg/

Lead Sources

HealthCare.gov or the state exchange · 54 documents

"ACA \$1,900 per month on \$5,000 per month income? Is this normal? My husband was laid off last week during the mass tech layoffs. Our insurance was through his company. I own my own business, and net after expenses and taxes \$5,000/month on average. I have variable income. I went onto the ACA marketplace today, entered all of our info, my income, his income zero, our two young children, and I was given a price of \$1,900/month for the cheapest plan with a \$16,000 deductible. How is this affordable on an income of \$5,000? I am not understanding. Should I call? Editing to add that a lot of people responding to my post seem to think I am oblivious to the political situation related to this. Yes, I did write to my representatives weeks ago (but it obviously did nothing because I live in the red state of Kansas. I vote blue and always have because I am a woman who prefers bodily autonomy to the alternative.) I am one person who has zero political power or sway. I am sharing my numbers to see what is happening with others, who are powerless to do anything as well at the federal level to make this better. Just thought I would clarify that for everyone. Also, COBRA for us would be \$3,500/month for a high deductible plan for those who thought this would be a cheaper option."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1,646 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om828r/>

"There is no way this is correct , is it from NJ healthcare. Ok folks, my head is about to explode, I just got off the phone with NJgetcovered , plan jumped to \$2700 a month w 20K max oop. BUT what blows my mind is this, my son goes to college outside of NJ and according to get covered , I have to have him on my application BUT his policy (Horizon silver plan EPO plan) is only good in the state of New Jersey ! That can not be right can it, I am paying for health insurance for him but he "loses" it when he leaves the state???? He is a resident of NJ and we claim him on out taxes for at least one more year."

— r/HealthInsurance · 201 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1onh5id/>

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

"My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise... what do I do? 27F, entry level job after graduating college, trying to buy a house and start a family. Bit of a rant here... You saw the title. My healthcare.gov insurance went from \$120 a month in 2025 to \$340 in 2026 because I got a \$1/hour raise. I am flabbergasted. I can't afford to pay over \$200/month more for my health insurance because I make an extra \$160/month?!?! In what world does that make sense?! There is a PCP in my area that does not take insurance, but provides most of the services I require for a \$90/month subscription. It's what I want to go with. They suggested I go with a catastrophic health plan in case of car wreck, etc. He said it should be about \$90/month. When I researched catastrophic health plans, the lowest premium is over \$200/month. I can't afford this AND pay rent AND pay car payment AND pay car insurance AND pay all my other bills AND save money for house/ children/ emergencies. It's safe to say I'm panicking. I payed the insurance for January but I couldn't save anything. I can't keep this plan. I'm currently feeling very defeated by a system that seems to be set up to keep the majority down... I'm so tired of this. Where is universal healthcare? What should I do? Where can I find a catastrophic health plan for around \$100 a month?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 137 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q8a0os/>

"Got Cancer, and Long Time Insurance Dropped Me TLDR: Got cancer, insurance terminated, I don't know what to do. I was diagnosed with cancer in May - Chronic Myeloid Leukemia, which is very treatable with expensive meds, but 100% fatal if not treated. I've had CareFirst Blue Cross Coverage through the VA Marketplace from 2022-present. CareFirst saw my diagnosis, and promptly cancelled my coverage with a technicality. I've been digging through the bureaucracy with no success, and don't know if I have legal options to restore my coverage and resume foregone cancer treatment. On July 1st CareFirst (CF) cancelled my coverage, which I first learned of from my oncologist 23 days after termination was apparently complete. My credit card had a fraudulent charge, so I replaced it in May - but forgot my premium payments were on the card, and my premium payment didn't process in June. I received no notification or calls before the letter from CF dated July 15 (although I didn't open it until later). I overnight mailed a check on July 25, and CareFirst (CF) cashed it July 28th. The VA Marketplace sent a eligibility / reinstatement form on July 24th, which CF told me they would process. The CF agents said it was in processing with the enrollment department. I called a total of 16 times between July 23 and this writing. In the 8th-13th calls to CF agents, they repeated the reenrollment was pending with the enrollment department. In my 14th call, they told me that - actually - I have no enrollment request, and that all of the previous agents were just attaching additional notes on the termination file. All previous agents had made an error, and that I needed to restart with the VA Marketplace. The first 13 calls never even started an appeal or reinstatement request. The CareFirst agent informed me that the only way I can restore coverage is to cancel this and reapply. Finally I unenrolled with my VA State Marketplace and applied to reenroll with my same program. Then they did the first clear and quick response of this whole mess: They immediately denied my reenrollment. This doesn't just mean I lost one insurer- they now made me ineligible for other insurance without a qualifying life event. (I've been employed for 3 years employed with a decent salary by a small non-profit that offers only a health reimbursement, thus the VA Marketplace ACA coverage). I cannot access cancer treatments, and am forgoing care. The list price on the cancer drug I need, at my current pharmacy, is far higher than my salary. I found a discount pharmacy that lowers it to about my salary. I will continue paying some things out of pocket, and skipping others, hoping I survive until I can restart 2026 ACA coverage. CareFirst says they sent me one letter in June, but I never received any such letter. They also acknowledge that their billing department never called, emailed, or made any effort to contact me. They cancelled my care without ever confirming I had any notification. Then they made me run a gauntlet of impenetrable bureaucratic mess through confusion and clear, blatant errors (I don't think their agent confusion was intentional deception - just incompetence). CareFirst found I have an expensive disease, and illegally cancelled my coverage. I am at the end of my rope. I am trying every approach possible to get my coverage and cancer treatment restored. Can anyone advise on my options? I see an option to request a written appeal, but that feels like asking the executioner to reconsider, given that they clearly are not acting in good faith already. I talked with some other insurance providers, and they told me I'd be rejected unless it was a Marketplace (ACA) plan that requires acceptance. I can only imagine a few options: * I vacate my condo and move to Maryland to get a 'qualifying life event'. But for various reasons, that would be really hard to deal with while already fighting cancer and trying to keep up with a demanding job. * I have access to a large press contact list, so I could try emailing my story to ~310 reporters, but I feel like that's more vengeful than productive. And I don't have the mental energy to be fielding a ton of media interviews. * I can also get a lawyer, but I'm not sure how much that would change. I don't want to be fighting this forever, I just want to get my health care and live my life. Any advice, especially ideas specific to Virginia? Edit: corrected 'deductible' to 'premium'. Update: I'm doing well now, no thanks to 'Carefirst' Blue Cross Blue Shield. I paid out of pocket for expensive chemotherapy for little while. I also fought and fought, tried to get a lawyer, and eventually realized they had no chance of ever getting me back onto the plan. Ironically, they tried to keep my premium payment that I sent via overnight cashier's check as soon as I realized there was a gap. But restoring my coverage? They wouldn't dream of it. The only way I could get back on coverage was to get married. That was already in the works, but it accelerated a courthouse elopement before our actual wedding. I'm now on my

spouse's coverage, and I am continuing the medications I need, and am relatively healthy. I also feel more comfortable because if they try to drop again it would need to go through a large employer's HR, so theoretically they can't unilaterally drop me. I don't know if this was convenient incompetence, weaponized incompetence, or just an active, unwritten rule to get drop high cost patients however they can. I just know that CareFirst doesn't care, and the system we have in the US sucks. It's more expensive, less dependable, and more difficult to navigate than any other developed country. Thankfully, I'm no longer one of the people this system is leaving without care, but I'm more convinced than ever that this system is the worst."

— r/HealthInsurance · 119 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1mqwvbc/>

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"ACA rates went down for us?? My wife and I have used healthcare.gov for 4 years now. This past year our rates were \$620 a month. We just Checked and according to healthcare.gov our new rates for the same insurance (ambetter gold tier) is \$295 a month. I was expecting it to rise substantially. We are in Arkansas, 63 and 61 yrs old. Anyone else see a decrease???"

— r/HealthInsurance · 30 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1onsnms/>

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

"Total healthcare coverage for everyone would be simple. Just switch everyone to Medicare with Plan G. Charge a flat rate and the money would be there and the insurance companies would be cut off at the knees from their current theivery of our money and our tax money thru subsidies. They currently get BILLIONS of dollars in subsidies to cover people. Thru the ACA AND thru the Medicare Advantage plans. That money would be better spent just covering everyone and cut out the damn middle man. The flat fee could be something very small like maybe 50 dollars. Or if that sounds too simple, put it on a sliding scale. or Use the IRMA rule. But this has been so obvious to me since I started getting coverage thru the marketplace and found out that my subsidy is about 1400 a MONTH that taxes are being paid to these scammers. And I have to jump thru all sorts of hoops to just get a damn test."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwKReZ8eEKFhxX5ehx4AaABAq>

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

"Some people have a low literacy level. Or aren't proficient in English. Or have a mental disability. Or lack access to the Internet. Or just find selecting an ACA marketplace plan to be confusing. I have a bachelor's degree. I've been a SNAP and Medicaid eligibility worker for over a decade. I still found it difficult to assist my daughter with choosing a marketplace plan, and figuring out which plan would be best for her needs."

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wodkl/please_explain_the_vanceoz_announcement_yesterday/pbns7id/

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

Employer / COBRA / spouse's plan · 47 documents

"Former employer canceled COBRA health insurance policy without notifying me I just found out my former employer in the state of Washington canceled my COBRA health insurance policy. Not because they notified me, but because my pharmacy called me and said my policy was no longer valid. WTF COBRA is supposed to be valid for 18-36 months and I am fully paid up. I just had major surgery and have PT scheduled in 4 days that has already been deferred for 2 weeks (because I was at my yearly limit of PT) if I don't make the appointment I may never correctly recover and regain full use of my arm. Apparently, my former employer is getting rid of Aetna and getting a new Health Insurance plan from a different provider. So my Aetna policy terminated at the beginning of 2025. Neither my former employer nor Aetna notified me about this, is that even legal? My COBRA provider told me over the phone that my coverage is supposed to switch to the new policy, but my former employer didn't send them the correct documents and that plan is not active for me so now I am stuck with no Health Insurance in need of immediate healthcare. What are my options? UPDATE: I contacted my former employer, who didn't have a good answer for why I wasn't notified. But did state that they had gotten a new health insurance policy with a different company. They then gave me a plan number and group number and told me to use that info to create an account on the website on the new insurance provider. I attempted to do so and the web form said that wasn't a valid policy and refused to let me create an account. After an additional back and forth with HR from my old company they said to call the new Health Insurance provider. So after 30 minutes of being on hold with them, they told me the policy number I had been given was for a different person who happened to have a different first name, same last name, different birthday and different address. Apparently that incorrect info was given to the HR lady at my company by their insurance vendor. After contacting four different companies, and spending more than an hour on the phone I am still without health insurance while needing PT to recover from a major surgery and unable to renew my prescriptions. For those that said this was a simple issue that I could clear up with a quick call to my former employer, I'm calling you on your BS. It's not, and there is incompetence up and down the chain of everyone involved here. FURTHER CONTEXT: I have accepted an offer for a new job (one with better health insurance) and should be starting at the end of the month. I only need my COBRA health plan for another month to get through all the post surgery PT, maybe get a Flu and COVID shot and get my prescriptions for this month. And however long it takes to get the new health insurance actually functional. As such it doesn't feel worth it to sign up for an ACA plan for less than a month of coverage and then have to deal with the overhead of cancelling that plan and setting up another new one. I just want the COBRA coverage they told me would be available for a whole year to actually work. UPDATE 2: I got a different (supposedly correct) policy number from my former employers HR, tried to use that to create an account on Regence's website and it still failed. I called Regence (was on hold for a whole hour) gave them the new policy number and was told over the phone I am actually in their system and I SHOULD have an active policy. I also read back the group # I had been given by HR and found out that was also incorrect (way to go former employer 0/2). I have no way to verify it's functional other than going to PT tomorrow and seeing if they can bill Regence. UPDATE 3: I filled a complaint with the state insurance commissioner, not just for the recent fiasco but also for the situation that caused me to quit my job in the first place where I believe the company may have actually acted illegally. I don't expect anything to come of it but maybe future me will be pleasantly surprised."

— r/HealthInsurance · 273 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1hsvb50/>

"Insurance Bill I Never Signed Up For So I just did my 2025 taxes, and when I first submitted them they got rejected for not including a 1095. I have insurance through my husband's job so this was weird, but I did check my Marketplace eligibility but never signed up for a plan. I ended up including a letter in my taxes that said I checked my eligibility but did not receive coverage from the marketplace. Fast forward to last night. I went to dinner with my mom and she brought me some mail I got from her house. They were bills and delinquency notices from the insurance company Ambetter. Somehow I was signed up for this insurance and these bills were sent to my mom's house, I have not lived there for 6 years. I did some googling and I'm not the only person that has been signed up for insurance without my consent. My question is what the hell do I do?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1qyg8ms/>

"ACA healthcare made it possible for me to retire. I keep my taxable income low and receive Gov subsidies on premiums. I consider the subsidies getting back some of the taxes I paid into the systems for the last 48 years. I had employer healthcare insurance for 30 years and never used one penny of it. Insurance companies made a mint off of my employer and me for decades. I never went to the Doctor until I turned 60 when I got Covid."

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyz5Ac7pA&lc=UgzT3TgVH2azwWzdsxx4AaABAq>

"Good information in a clear manner. I'll be watching for the 2024 info video. I chose to retire early and am currently doing COBRA coverage but would like to investigate ACA options for 2024."

— YouTube · Enrolling in Obamacare | 3 Mistakes to Avoid · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZBc-IntJRAU&lc=UgxGoQIC4y8FhPwmrPp4AaABAq>

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pedcpv/>

"I retired a year and a half ago at 58 and used COBRA until it ran out in January. That was almost \$800 a month. Now I'm on an ACA plan that's not quite as good as what I had, but it's close enough and is only \$305 per month. I expect it to go up each year because everything else does, but I can't imagine getting decent coverage for any less, so I think I'll stick with it for another 5 years until Medicare unless things change dramatically."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? Here's How To Afford Health Insurance · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q-0gmK2mR8E&lc=Ugyuh5mpyU8hVARpKwJ4AaABAq>

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

"IBX made a typo retroactively cancelling our coverage. 9 months later it's still broken. Who can help me fix this? I'm drowning This nightmare has been going on for over nine months. I'm drowning My husband enrolled our family in his employer's group plan 12/1/25. They terminated him 12/23/25 and provided coverage until 12/28/25 when we switched to COBRA. It's taken me 8 months, but an account manager at IBX (Independence Blue Cross) finally confirmed that one of their agents made a typo switching us over to COBRA that accidentally terminated our group coverage retroactively on 12/3/25. So for any claim submitted after 12/28, for date of service between 12/3 and 12/28 was denied due to lack of coverage. The problem I'm having is that I have spent almost all year trying to get this resolved. Member services at IBX have been useless. Finally got it escalated with HR at the employer and after an enormous back and forth they theoretically got coverage reinstated and reprocessed, but that's where the story ends. It's been six weeks after the portal showed processing finished, none of the providers have been paid. IBX agents promise to call me back with answers, and they never do. When I called them out on social media, they told me to send my details to them through their website comment form. The employer's benefit manager connected me to the insurance broker they use. The benefits manager wanted me to file appeals with IBX through her, because things were such a mess, and the broker claimed to be willing to help until I told them I wasn't comfortable with sharing my private medical records with them. They connected me to an account manager at IBX and have ignored every email I've sent since then. The account manager at IBX who's spoken to me twice, and had agreed that there are a significant number of problems with processing and denials that need to be fixed, said she'd help and call me back, but she never did. I have her direct line phone number, but she hasn't responded to a single voicemail. No one at IBX will give me any of the records they hold in writing because they all tell me they don't have the ability to do that, but they'll escalate and ask. What I'm asking for are things that their own plan document says I have the right to have. My records, anything they used to determine a denial, responses to complaints that have been made, etc. They won't even give me a copy of the appeals they filed on my behalf, because they told me not to file them myself because the account was such a mess. They were denied, but I don't even know what they appealed! There are processing errors in every month we had a claim, which they've admitted, but they never get fixed, and we kept getting told they were going to reprocess them and they'd be fixed. This is a self funded plan, so PA DoI can't/won't help. I called the Department of Labor and a very bored sounding guy said he'd call HR at the employer and see what was going on. He's call me back when he got information. That was last week. Not heard anything from anyone (and the phone number the PA DoI gave me for the DoL leads to a Medicare fraud phone scam, and the gentleman at the DoL told me it sounded legit, so I don't have any faith in either of them) I don't know what to do next. I've got over \$10k in outstanding bills my insurance should have covered nearly in full, I've got irregularities everywhere in deductibles and out of pocket maximums they can't clarify or explain, hospital systems are getting angry about unpaid bills and I can't get help. No employment attorney will touch it because the payout is so low and no one else seems to care because I have no teeth. **Tl;dr** Insurance company typed the wrong date when we switched to COBRA and accidentally cancelled our group coverage retroactively. All our claims were denied, coverage was eventually reinstated, claims reprocessed but done incorrectly and none of the providers have been paid. I can't get any information in writing, I kept being told not to file appeals and now no one will return calls or emails. It's an ERISA plan so the state can't help and DoL is not inspiring hope and no attorney wants it because it's relatively small. How do I fix this? I can't keep doing this alone"

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wj676/ibx_made_a_typo_retroactively_cancelling_our/

"ACA and PTCs, Early Retirement Asking for confirmation of my understanding, under post-OBBA law. *TLDR*, my basic question is, with one spouse on Medicare and one purchasing insurance through ACA, are we still a household of two and is joint MAGI used to determine eligibility? Does MFS change that? Practically speaking, I have retired at age 62 (got laid off and not finding any opportunities) and my COBRA benefits end in March. I'm reviewing longer-term financial planning options to work toward getting PTCs for the next three years until I go on Medicare. Best I can tell, the OBBA brought back the 400% FPL cliff (which is what we've been arguing about) which in 2026 will be \$62,600 MAGI for a household of one, and \$84,600 for a household of two. My spouse is currently on Medicare so I only need to purchase ACA insurance for myself. In this situation are we still a household of two, and does our joint MAGI count? I don't think Married Filing Separate would change that. Using online calculators for my state and county, if we are truly a household of two and total household MAGI is used then we need to remain under \$84,600 MAGI to get PTCs. If we do that, then we will pay \$0 in insurance premiums for me for Bronze level coverage (which is fine, I'm reasonably healthy). However, if our MAGI is \$84,601 or higher then my monthly premiums would be over \$1400/mo for the same coverage. Does this sound correct? Thanks! ***Followup.*** This is the final strategy: \- Decline COBRA coverage for 2026; \- Sign up for ACA coverage with PTCs; \- Actively manage MAGI to less than \$84,600 to retain those PTCs; \- Make a solid Roth conversion in calendar year 2025 to have liquid cash for the next three years; \- Pay the estimated taxes due on the conversion by January 15; \- Don't get sick for the next three years."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1otm8of/>

"Covered california. I always supported aca for the pre existing conditions alone. Never thought i would need it but when i got laid off in 2019 i used it for 6 months because Cobra was ridiculous and unaffordable."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o5lrn3/the_media_is_reporting_majority_of_people_on_the/njcf5yg/

"I used my HSA to pay for 18 months of my wife's COBRA premiums which allowed her to retire at 63 1/2. Pretty easy; just need the forethought to contribute to your HSA for such an event."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgypQPuJyvArxegEvpJ4AaABAq

"Cobra Lapsed.... STRESSED.... Long story short, I had a choice last November between relocating or severance package and chose the severance package that came with Cobra coverage. The company sponsored coverage ended on 5/31 and if I continue to self pay I would have coverage til May 27 next year. TLDR I was abroad in June and didn't pay my first month of self payment in time. Upon return, I saw a letter stating that the grace period for each coverage period is the end of that respective month. For example, July's grace period ends tomorrow, July 31, 2026, and August's ends on August 31, 2026. I reached out immediately, assuming I could still activate the account since I was within the July grace period. But of course that's when I learned how this all worked, huge mistake on my part and I am so mad at myself. I am currently in appeal process, on the second appeal now where they're now needing approval from my company to reinstate the account. The team at health equity said usually they are able to reinstate the account through second appeal based on what they have seen? (I talked to 3 different phone representatives) I talked to the benefit team at my former employer and they seem to be willing to help but did ask why the payment lapsed. I explained my situation. How likely is my account able to be reinstated? There are some benefits I'd really like to utilize from my former plan and I know I really fucked up and slipped up. Huge life lesson here.... Any advise or folks with experience on this would be appreciated :(Stressed out. I did reach out to marketplace to get an application in place just in case the appeal is denied, but I am really hoping for the best."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1vbdehm/>

The carrier directly (Ambetter, Oscar, BCBS...) · 25 documents

"Billed \$1600 so far for free preventative colonoscopy I'm 52 years old and never had a colonoscopy so I thought I would take advantage of the \$0 out of pocket preventative colon cancer screening through my ACA health plan. I had the colonoscopy last month and a couple days ago I got an email from the hospital saying that I have a bill. It's \$1600 for the colonoscopy. I went to reddit of course and saw that reddit seems to agree that it should have been free. No polyps were found. I spent hours on the phone yesterday with the hospital and the insurance company. The lady at the hospital told me that I was mistaken about preventative care being free. She said that there are thousands of different plans and each plan does it differently. She said they submitted my claim and the insurance paid for part of it and that I am responsible for the other \$1600. After talking to her for a while I wasn't getting anywhere so we agreed to disagree and I called the insurance company. The insurance rep spoke English as a second language and didn't seem to understand the point I was making. She told me how much the total was, how much insurance had paid, and how much I was responsible for. When I said things like "I think there is a mistake, this should be free of charge since it was preventative" she simply repeated the totals as if she didn't understand. She was supposed to call me back at 2pm today and never called. I guess I will be spending tomorrow on the phone again trying to get the \$1600 taken off my bill. Nobody I have talked to so far is aware of the ACA policy that preventative care is covered in full. They seem to think that I am just saying that to get out of paying my bill. Any advice for what I can say tomorrow. Edit: OK, I just got off the phone with the United Healthcare rep. She said that there was no mistake. She said I had 2 procedures done and only one was preventative. I asked her for the diagnostic codes for the procedures and she only gave me one code G0121. She seemed like she wanted to get me off the phone so I didn't argue. She apologized several times and said there was no mistake, I have to pay the \$1600. I had a referral for "Screening for colon cancer Z12.11" and have no knowledge of any second procedure. EDIT 2 OK I got some more info today. I confirmed that my plan offers the colon cancer screening at 0% copay and no deductible. The insurance says that I got the colon cancer screening paid for (they paid \$150). But I was charged \$1600 for an endoscopy that was not preventative care. All the CPT codes are missing for the non-preventative endoscopy. Here it is called a HC colonoscopy. The person I talked to said that my primary code was Z12.11 and my secondary code was K57.30 <https://preview.redd.it/3qbqhqlod7ug1.png?width=700&format=png&auto=webp&s=7ec1b565073bcc88f0403c5064e0be6ec17b28b6> <https://preview.redd.it/09k2gdppd7ug1.png?width=691&format=png&auto=webp&s=9e15198b82f8833f30009a763184c6e58817a42f> Update 3 I talked to a different insurance rep today and got a completely different reason for my bill. This one acknowledged that I only had one procedure and that it was a colonoscopy, not an endoscopy. She said that while a colonoscopy can be preventative, mine was not preventative because I had it done in a hospital. I asked her where I should have gone to get a preventative colonoscopy and she said that I should have gone to an office. I told her I went to my doctor's office and they referred me to the hospital. She said she understands it is frustrating and offered to help me file a claim adjustment request. So in 10 to 15 days I should be getting the decision. I still think it makes no sense because they paid the claim submitted by the doctor who performed the colonoscopy even though he did it at a hospital. But the claim submitted by the hospital was not preventative because the colonoscopy happened at a hospital."

— r/HealthInsurance · 233 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sg3ast/>

"Health insurance will cost us almost \$18,000 this year. Please help! My job offers insurance via Aetna and I found out today it's going up again, to almost \$1500/mo for just me, my husband, and my infant. And they already cover 75% of my personal plan, the rest is the family portion. The problem is my husband is self-employed and receives no tax credits or help in the marketplace because a plan is offered through my work. The cheapest crappy plan wouldn't save us all that much, if he were to go get his own plan and leave me and the baby on my work plan. I don't know what to do. That's crippling, it costs more than our mortgage. Should I go down to part time and sacrifice my other job benefits so I'm "no longer eligible" and we can try to get credits/cheaper plan? Do I go without insurance and try to save the money to "cash price" at the doctor? My husband owns a small business so it's not as simple as him just getting another job for the insurance. I have to make a decision in the next two days and I'm so stressed. Location : Georgia, USA Income : \$90,000 UPDATE : if anyone would like an update - we got our health insurance cost down, thankfully. The insurance broker we were working with wasn't as helpful as I expected and told us to mark "no" for tax credits/subsidies. When I did more research (thanks everyone), if it was over 9% of our income, we were eligible for about \$350 credit plus a cheaper plan. When I reached out to the broker to confirm she acted like she didn't realize we'd be eligible 😬 It's only going to cost a little over half what we were looking at after our applications. Moral of the story - do your own research."

— r/HealthInsurance · 165 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1jkr7v3/>

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99, This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oiti3k/>

"Is my therapist scamming me? (updated below) First of all I am in therapy partly for trust issues and paranoia with women. So keep that in mind. I have Anthem bronze pathway epo in California. (I just chose the cheapest possible plan. \$741 😊) The insurance only covers in network providers. I met my out of pocket max and the EOBs say I owe \$0 now. I just realized that my credit card has also been getting charged \$200 per session by the therapist. Based on the emails I agreed to her billing plan. I wasn't absorbing it though. I was thinking sure, whatever, I'll meet my OOPM soon and then it will be \$0, like everything else. I chose her because she's in network. This situation fits what I've read about balance billing. I have a hard time believing that my 50+ yo therapist would do something illegal like this. I can't believe she wouldn't know the laws. I don't trust her but she's smart. Rationally this seems far fetched. From anthem: "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. We understand how concerning it is to be billed when your Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows no member responsibility, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Upon reviewing your 2026 claims submitted by x, most of the claims indicate no member responsibility, which means you should not owe anything for those services. We found only two claims where a member responsibility was applied: Claim number x (Date of Service: 03/05/2026-03/09/2026) Member responsibility: \$180.00 Claim number x (Date of Service: 02/24/2026) - Member responsibility: \$60.00 If you have already made payments that correspond to these two claims, then any additional charges from this provider may not be accurate. For the other claims that show \$0.00 member responsibility, we recommend that you share a copy of your EOB with your provider, as it reflects how the claims were processed. Sincerely, Elaine S. Customer Service Representative" What should I do? We are supposed to meet on Tuesday. **UPDATE:** I cancelled our appointment and asked for a breakdown of charges, in a neutral way, implying anthem must have messed up. Anthem again confirmed she should not be charging me. Her stated rate is \$235. Anthem has been giving her \$97.87 per session. So she's taking home \$297.87?? she wants me to believe that anthem only gives her \$35, and that balance billing is ok? I can't believe this. does she think I'm dumb and rich? is she dumb, or a thief? she was kind of a decent therapist! My claims history shows that she has submitted 10claims. Each claim shows multiple sessions each day. totaling 19 sessions. She charged me \$198 the first 3 charges and \$200 the last 2. 5 total charges to my credit card which aligns with the number of times I remember seeing her. I have not seen her 19times and I've definitely never seen her 3x in one day. I never got any kind of receipt with the charges. I just noticed them. Is it common to not send a receipt? **UPDATE 2:** a lot of her claims were on dates I was gone on a trip for a month taking care of a dying family member. The very first claim for a 60 minute therapy session for which Anthem paid her \$97.87 was actually our 14m48s introductory phone consult (she had flaked twice. She was 9th on my list and no one else was available. Should I just keep seeing her...? 😊) **UPDATE 3:** I sent Anthem screenshots of texts, emails, and phone history showing her first claim was a lie, and that I was out of the country during a majority of her other claims. I cannot believe I was out of the country with my dying mother, with no return date, and this woman was using my name to make hundreds of dollars. What the flipping fuck. I want to be HER therapist and analyze her pathology. Also, she gave away my time slot while I was gone with no conversation, and I was hurt but I decided to respect that I couldn't expect her to hold a spot for me when I left and stopped communicating. Ha! I wonder if I had never reached back out, how long she would have kept pretending we were having sessions. **UPDATE 4:** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secured message. I'm really sorry you're going through this, it can be very upsetting and confusing to see charges and visit records that don't match your recollection, especially when it involves multiple charges to your card. We understand your concern, and we appreciate you bringing this to our attention. Please be advised that we process claims exactly as they are billed and submitted by your provider. Claims are reviewed based on the information received, your plan benefits, and the provider's network status. Anthem also follows the provider's contract to determine the allowed amount and how much is applied to your responsibility, such as deductible, copayment, or coinsurance. For specific details about the billing codes used and the charges submitted, we recommend contacting your provider or facility directly, as they can explain how the claim was filed and the

amounts billed for each service. If you believe your claims were not processed correctly, you have the right to request a review by filing an appeal, and we'll be happy to guide you through that process. Appeals must be submitted within 180 calendar days of the last processing date. Please include your member identification number, the claim number in question, the details of your appeal and any additional medical information or documentation supporting your appeal. For a standard appeal, a decision will be made within 30 calendar days after the receipt of the documentation. You can send appeals by mail to the following address:..." Sounds like Anthem wants me to do a load of paperwork when I've already submitted evidence of fraud. :(I asked them to forward to their fraud department. TBD. **UPDATE 6** From therapist responding to me asking for a breakdown of her charges: "Hi x, Thank you for sending this, and thank you for following up with Anthem. Yes, it's completely fine to skip tomorrow. I'm going to look into the insurance issue on my end and see what I can find out about why Anthem is showing \$0. Once I have more clarity, I'll get back to you. Warmly, x" 😊 me: "Thanks x. Can you send me a superbill today explaining the details of the \$198 and \$200 charges?" I just read her reflections email on our last session and it was so insightful and helpful. Maybe we can both compartmentalize her fraud... 😊 **UPDATE 7** Sent by: Anthem Support "Dear Valued Member: Thank you for your secure message. I'm really sorry you're going through this—what you're describing sounds incredibly frustrating and concerning. Thank you for clearly outlining the dates and your experience, especially noting when you were out of the country and had no communication or sessions with X. I completely understand why this situation doesn't feel right. To help ensure this is properly reviewed and investigated, the best next step is to report the situation directly to our Special Investigations Unit (SIU). They are specifically trained to handle cases like this and can take the appropriate actions to protect you and review any questionable billing activity. You may contact the Special Investigations Unit (SIU) at 888-231-5044 to report the concern. Reaching out to them will allow a dedicated team to look into the details you've shared and work toward a resolution. If you have any supporting documents—such as dates of service, billing statements, or records of your absence—having those ready can also be helpful during the review." I'm waiting to see whether the therapist will send the requested breakdown of the costs. kind of for sick entertainment purposes at this point tbh. She didn't send yesterday as requested. I keep thinking about the good parts of our dynamic and thinking about maybe making things work. A bit like the toxic relationships I wanted her to help me with, actually ... I'm back to sending a hundred exhausting , failed emails to therapists on psychology today, like the good old days. **UPDATE 8** From therapist: "Hi x, Thank you for your patience on this. I've been talking with Anthem and it turns out there was coverage confusion on their side that made your benefits show up in a really confusing way on my end. Bottom line: I overcharged you. Your copay is \$60 per session, and you should only have been paying \$60 each time. Based on the payments showing on your end (5 sessions: \$200, \$200, \$198, \$198, \$198), you paid a total of \$994. You should have paid \$300 total (\$60 x 5). That means I owe you a refund of \$694. I'm really sorry for the confusion. I appreciate you catching this; it would have turned into a big accounting discrepancy for my books too. Whew! Can you tell me what you prefer for the refund, Zelle or Venmo? Once you confirm, I can send it right away. Warmly, x" I actually met my deductible after 3 sessions. She's still lying. Wow. I said yes an"

— r/HealthInsurance · 122 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1tmp52c/>

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

"I already got my letter from bcbs telling me my insurance is going up in January because they are not extending credits . They need to know now ."

— r/obamacare · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1njh7e7/government_funding_battle_brewing_over_enhanced/neqb60x/

"2 Month Review of Ambetter Fidelis Insurance (NY State of Health/ACA) Hey r/HealthInsurance, I wanted to leave a review of the Ambetter Fidelis Insurance, which I got through the NY State of Health marketplace (ACA). I figured this was useful, because anyone facing the daunting task of finding health insurance when not employed by a traditional employer, knows that this is a very confusing and terrible place to be in. TLDR, I expected it to be TERRIBLE, but it's just "bad". Perhaps the "least bad" among the NY ACA options. Which is actually better than I expected, and thus I'm overall pleasantly satisfied with it. Background: \- I switched from employer insurance to self-employed \~2 years ago, and have been on COBRA until \~2 months ago \- I'm on a specialty injection medication (Dupixent). And it was really important to get this covered, because it'd be \$40K/yr out of pocket otherwise. I reviewed all the available plans in NY State of Health, looking for the cheapest option that did list Dupixent in its formulary, which would be a strong positive signal that I *could* get covered under the plan. Ambetter Fidelis was the cheapest option when I considered the low monthly premium (\~\$700), plus the relatively lower max out-of-pocket (\~\$8K, which I would max out since Dupixent is expensive), and the HSA tax savings benefit (-\~\$1700), and it listed Dupixent on its [formulary](<https://www.fideliscare.org/Portals/0/Formularies/QHP-2025-formulary-Fidelis-Care.pdf>). I was a bit leery of Ambetter Fidelis, because it has [atrocious](<https://www.yelp.com/biz/fidelis-care-new-york-new-york>) [reviews](<https://www.bbb.org/us/ny/long-island-city/profile/health-insurance/ambetter-from-fidelis-care-0121-66199/customer-reviews>). But... pretty much all the insurances have atrocious reviews. So going with a different plan would be more expensive without any stronger guarantee. At first, I was pretty turned off by Ambetter Fidelis: \- their website is TERRIBLE. Slow, unintuitive, broken, down, their voice line tells you to check the website, and the website tells you to call the voice line for more information. \- when you try to call them, you're put through a ringer of TERRIBLE automated voice robots. I've done this so many times, that if you need to talk to a person, here's what you do: call 1-888-343-3547, press: 1122270 (slowly) \- none of my pre-existing doctors offices took them, so I had to pay out of pocket per visit (\$300+) \- after my doctor/pharmacy submitted the prescription request for Dupixent, of course they deny it. But even worse, it's this confusing hell, because the customer service says they have no record of a prior auth from my doctor's office. It turns out the prior auth is handled between my pharmacy and Ambetter Fidelis, but the Ambetter Fidelis reps can't see it? So I was blaming my doctor's office for awhile, when it wasn't their fault. But over time, I've actually become relatively satisfied with them: 1) I had an elbow injury, and through their terrible website I found a sports specialist doctor that is covered by Ambetter. The doctor is quite good, and the co-pay was only like \$25 per visit. The doctor wanted an MRI, but he knows ambetter requires Xrays before MRI's, which is slightly annoying, but whatever. 2) I had an X-ray done, copay was \$30 3) It was a bit of a 2 week song & dance to get ambetter to approve the MRI, but it was approved, and I got an MRI, copay was \$193 at the office. And then Fidelis charged me an additional \$675, since there's a large deductible. This kinda sucks, especially since it's already the end of the year, so this won't go towards my yearly OOP max. But I need this, so whatever. 4) Dupixent was just "approved" today. Have to complain that they called me telling me there's an important message for me, and to call them back. And I need to call them back and spend 15 minutes in a robot answering machine hell before getting to anyone. But whatever, I'm happy that Dupixent was approved. So just waiting another few days for my pharmacy to actually ship Dupixent to me, and see what the deductible will be. So... lots of friction, lots of annoyances, lots of unexpected costs. But healthcare is expensive. And this is the cheapest option I could find. And Dupixent is covered, which is like \$40K/yr on its own, and that's basically all I care about. It was a plus that I could actually find a sports specialty doctors office that is in network with them. Which gives me confidence I can find some decent other doctors that I need. Presumably I won't have such crazy copays/deductibles in the future, since I'll already be paying the max OOP. Anyway, hope that helps. Happy to answer any questions!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 14 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pedcpv/>

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"Was able to do both. Wanted a plan that covered the monthly premiums, but only needed catastrophic insurance as I have never had any medical issues. Needed to be able to have a higher MAGI to fill the 12% tax bracket with Roth conversions. I chose a Bronze HDHP + HSA plan from Kaiser Permanente with a \$7050 deductible. The premiums are completely covered by the tax credits as long as I keep my MAGI under \$55,700. Also, can contribute \$5,150 to an HSA account along with doing Roth conversions. I have enough brokerage funds to get by for the next 9 years to Medicare. I do leave the difference of \$55,700 to \$61,750(top of the 12% bracket) unfilled, but the premium increases outweigh the tax savings."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Strategies I Roth Conversions vs. ACA Subsidies · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8f3BWkXpGO4&lc=UgxzNzu7Ex23F4Thflt4AaABAg>

"I'm confused why the same plan my girlfriend and I choose went up for her, but stayed the same for me? We both signed up for Oscar Gold Elite last year and each have our incomes which are unfortunately low. Same jobs and same income for this year... But for some reason my premium for the same plan stayed at the exact same price of \$40, but hers more than doubled to \$100. We use our premium tax credits but she uses the insurance more than I do because she had asthma but does that have anything to do with it? I'm a bit confused because I don't understand this stuff very well despite watching many videos on it. Any help is greatly appreciated."

— r/HealthInsurance · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pbs65i/>

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"Im 33, my job doesnt offer health insurance. I bought a plan for \$130 a month directly through blue cross blue shield"

— YouTube · 9 Health Insurance Options for Early Retirement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qt0r9YBsUzM&lc=Ugxt9DMCwoEBE4QubuF4AaABAq>

Medicaid / CHIP · 23 documents

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnycy/>

"Turning 26, being dropped coverage and can't do State Medicaid I'm turning 26 years old, and I'm being dropped from my parent's health plan. I live in PA and have no income. I'm still in Medical School for 1 more year, and they offer no SHIP/healthcare plans of their own. I qualify for PA State Medicaid, but I will be doing several out of state hospital rotations, and they will not accept that I only have a State Medicaid. What are my options? I went to HealthCare.gov, and as soon as I say I have no income, all they do is redirect me to sign up with State Medicaid?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wgdp40/turning_26_being_dropped_coverage_and_cant_do/

"Medi-Cal vs. Covered California / Medi-Cal eligibility I am a working-age California resident. In the first quarter of last year, I left a job voluntarily. Because it was voluntary I did not bother to apply for unemployment. I did not have another job lined up. As I had coverage with Kaiser through my employer, my first call was to them to ask about Cobra. I was pretty quickly transferred to a Kaiser agent who wanted to work through a Covered California application with me. We did that, but at the end of the process they had some technical failure with regard to me verifying my SSN, so they gave up and transferred me to a Covered California agent. I did not quite know how to answer their question about income, because my answer was basically, "I expect to be employed again at some point this year, but it's hard to say when, and so anything I tell you will only be a guesstimate." So the CC agent concluded that since my total 2022 income from the job I just left fell under the limit, and since I did not have any other income, I was eligible for Medi-Cal. This seemed odd to me since my occupation pays fairly well and I did expect to be employed again at some point that year. "Can't I just get subsidies through CC and then pay them back once I'm working again?" I asked. Their answer was that with Medi-Cal, so long as I advise them of any changes to income, I don't actually have to pay anything back. I didn't really expect to use the plan anyway, i.e. I just wanted catastrophic coverage, and so I agreed to do that. So for the past 11 months, I've been on Medi-Cal. I have not used the plan in any way, have not seen a doctor, have not called anyone about anything with the exception of the initial application process. It is time to renew my eligibility, and here is my concern: When I went through the application process last year, they asked about "cash on hand." Now, at the time I did have some money in the bank, but that money was set aside for living expenses like rent and food, which I considered to be priorities that came before health insurance. It felt like the question was more about "disposable cash" and so I reported that no, I did not have cash on hand. Looking back, that was probably the wrong answer. There was zero intent to deceive on my part, however I'm now concerned that I've basically been enrolled in Medi-Cal fraudulently. As it turns out, I am still unemployed. I am very close to being out of cash, am living on credit card advances, and I have a traditional IRA that I will tap into as a last resort. So, unlike last year, I'm pretty sure that I am now legitimately eligible for Medi-Cal. (I don't think my IRA counts as an asset but please correct me if I'm wrong.) Let's say I renew and at some point thereafter I obtain services. Might they do some digging and discover that I did actually have some cash in 2022? My understanding is that if I am eligible for Medi-Cal then I am NOT eligible for CC subsidies, so even though at this point I would feel better about reversing course and getting myself on a CC plan, that may not be financially feasible for me. I would like to have a conversation with someone from Medi-Cal about this, but not sure how wise it would be for me to share what I have shared here. Maybe it would be better to just return my renewal docs and proceed as if I've been eligible all along? Does it even matter since I haven't actually obtained any services? Am I just being paranoid? Apologies for the long-winded post. Just wanted to provide some context so that hopefully someone might have some valuable insight and/or advice. Thanks!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/112izqi/>

"Medicaid nightmare So I have Missouri Medicaid for my wife and daughter (1 year old). When my daughter was born, we decided it was best for my wife to stay home. So we needed insurance. I went to Marketplace to look, and told me I had to apply for chip/medicaid before proceeding. So I called, spent 7 hours on hold, got ahold of someone, they asked me all the questions and I gave them all our information and income info they needed. Two months later, I received a letter saying they're accepted. Fast forward to July, I get a small raise. I go to my local DSS office and report an income change within 10 days, filled it out in the buy and turned it in before leaving. Never hear anything so I assumed it was still within the limit. Get a letter a couple weeks ago saying we make too much and my wife and daughters plans were being changed. I always expected that but never understood how they qualified to begin with while I always made over \$65k/yr. Turns out when I called to get the details on their new plan, they tell me they only have 1 job out of three jobs I have, only making \$409 a month? They didn't even have any records of my full time job despite filling out an income increase form in office TWICE. Plus they only put down the first letter of my first name so identity issues was always a problem also. So now I'm scared they will think I committed fraud when I've been nothing but upfront with them from the beginning. Them over the phone and in the office haven't been documenting my info properly or at all."

— r/Medicaid · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1inzqe8/>

"NC - Can't find a provider through Medicaid; is it fraud to seek medical treatment as a self-pay patient?? Hi Everyone, I'm in NC and recently switched to Medicaid when the expanded coverage went into effect last year. Before that I had BCBS through the insurance marketplace. While covered under BCBS I had a birthmark removed and biopsied (Nevus Sabaceus of Jadassohn) and was advised that if the surrounding area had any changes to size/shape/color post removal to seek treatment immediately. I noticed two days ago the birthmark area had darkened and raised into a small bump. So, naturally, I called my dermatologist to schedule another consultation. When I spoke to them they let me know they don't take Medicaid, so of course my next question was if I can come in as a self-pay/cash patient just for the initial assessment. The nurse/MA I spoke to told me this was considered insurance fraud and I could lose coverage if I do this. So, I spent an hour calling every dermatologist within 50 miles (I live in western North Carolina) that accepted my insurance. ONE of them is accepting new patients, but only with a PCP referral. Okay, progress, so I call my PCP to get one. Nobody picks up. Next I decide to reach out to UHC to see if I can change PCP's since my current one (that was automatically assigned to me) was unavailable. The dude I've been on the phone with for 30 minutes, a member services advocate, and I have now called about 10 PCP's to get set up with a new patient appointment, just so I can get a referral for an issue I know exists, so I can beg the only dermatologist available within a 2 hour drive to please see me as a new patient. Even if it is illegal/fraud to pay cash for medical treatment that could prevent a more serious issue, wouldn't there be some kind of exception for a situation like this? Like, I would take out a loan if I had to since removing it now wouldn't be too crazy, but if I wait until UHC can find me a PCP to GIVE ME A REFERRAL ONLY it would be months, close to a year from now. Additionally I have no issue breaking the law if it comes down to it in the quest to not die of melanoma, I was just wondering if this is actually a thing."

— r/Medicaid · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Medicaid/comments/1lwkch/>

"Yep! I got charged over \$300 for a diagnostic Vit D test because my ACA insurance deemed it "medically unnecessary" (even though it came back low, they said it wasn't low enough to be necessary), so I didn't even get the contracted rate. I fought it. It took months to get it resolved, and while waiting the lab said I was past due and wouldn't do further lab work, and also kept sending me notices that they were sending me to collections (even though they knew I was appealing through insurance). In the end the insurance changed the category and I paid less than 50.. but SO lame."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/on2q8w9/

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went through him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/>

"This video was awesome. Your presentation was very concise and clear to understand. I'm not sure you can help me but I try anyway. I have been in a health insurance nightmare for the last ten years. Thank God for Obamacare, however, I'm in a red state that will NEVER expand medicaid coverage. I'm 35 now and receive monthly LTD income (untaxed). I became disable at age 26 but, was given a technical denial from SSDI because I didn't have enough work credits. I also was denied SSI because my LTD income exceeded the threshold amount. I'm still disable an unable to get medicaid or medicare. Basically, I'm too young and not broke enough. 😞😞 ACA has told me I can't get their insurance because my long term disability is untaxed. Now I'm up to my neck with medical bills due to needing ongoing healthcare all because I got cancer when I was young and starting my career. What a screwed up health-care system. Thanks America! 🙏😞 "

— YouTube · Enrolling in Obamacare I 3 Mistakes to Avoid · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZBc-IntJRAU&lc=Ugx5-E1Q0dCqQPYuG4p4AaABAg>

"I should first say that I can arrange my affairs to qualify for Medicaid or the ACA (it just depends on how much capital-gains I take vs. Roth distributions). I used to be on Medicaid, but with the upcoming change to Medicaid requiring work requirements (I consider myself fully retired), I wanted to get into an ACA plan (at the bare minimum 138% of poverty income rate); there was also some screwing things with Medicaid such as me not being able to get the plan to do mail-order Rx filling (an important thing since I travel a lot), to say nothing of getting my sleep Rx covered properly (I could get my Medicaid PCP to write the script, but I would have it filled at Health Warehouse), so presuming I could have gotten a proper PCP in the new ACA plan, I would be saving money on Rx. But since I can't get a proper PCP from the ACA plan - nor a psychiatrist that my PCP told me I had to see - I'm stuck going back to my old PCP as a self-pay patient, and getting the sleep Rx from the old mail-order place. And of course, I'm paying \$80/mo for the privilege of this rotten service. That said, I was able to get my annual blood test, and I will getting a feces test for colon cancer, from the new ACA plan (I would have gotten it no matter what plan I would be on). Yes, my new PCP sucks, and I have fired him (I told him that I don't trust him with my health management); I guess I could looks for another one, even a nurse-practioner, but how do you find one that will do the job. Do I say, "Hi, I am a subscriber with the AmWorse Premier plan, and I am looking for a PCP; one of the requirements I have for my PCP is that I get my 10mg Zolpidem Rx - that I have had for 30 years or so, and that I could prove for the last 12 years from my old PCP - which I consider an essential part of my health maintenance. If you run your practice such that you can't do this, then I cannot give you my business"."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omz7nsn/

"Not an ACA story, but I carried the BCBS PPO plan with the highest cost specifically because it offered flexibility in where we went for care & my daughter had multiple medical issues. The day before she was due to travel to Philadelphia/UPenn for surgery on a rare brain tumor, I got a call saying the hospital was in a dispute with BCBS over reimbursement rates & wasnt currently accepting BCBS...but we were of course welcome to pay cash for the CTs, MRI, surgery & hospital stay. Recently saw Trinity isn't currently accepting Humana. It's madness when people's lives are literally at risk."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1o4ov1l/aca_plans_not_accepted_by_leading_hospitals_and/njwnczn/

"Part of the reason that health care was cheaper in the past, including the 70s and 80s, was that there was much less that the medical field could do for you. During the 1970s and 1980s, we got MRIs and other advanced diagnostic/imaging techniques, cardiac bypass procedures, and chemotherapy. Those developments have saved many lives, but are not cost-free. If your kid was diagnosed with leukemia in the 1970s, the doctors told you to let him have as much ice cream and as many pony rides as he wanted, until he died within the next six months. Now, that kid gets chemotherapy that saves his or her life. The treatment is very expensive. The prognosis for breast cancer is much better than it was fifty years ago, due to advances in treatment. The same is true with many other cancers. The development of colonoscopy has saved many lives through early detection of colon cancer (before colonoscopy, my grandfather died of colon cancer at 63). But, the last time that I had a colonoscopy, the total "sticker price"--anesthesia, GI doctor charge, facility charge--was about \$6,000.00 (Since my State mandates that insurers made the procedure available without a separate out-of-pocket charge, I paid nothing directly. But, of course, my fees for the procedure was "baked into" my health insurance premium, and into the premiums of all other policyholders. And my premium included the colonoscopy-related charges for all other insureds). Fifty years ago, a lot of middle-aged men died of "indigestion" while watching TV after supper. Now, they go on statins, get a cardiac cath procedure, and/or cardiac bypass, and keep living. In the time since the early 1980s, HIV has gone from being a death sentence to a treatable, chronic, condition. Starting around twenty years ago, and continuing to the present, a majority of HIV+ patients die of causes unrelated to their HIV+ positive status. Until the mid-90s, the average life span from the first onset of AIDS-related symptoms was 18 months. The strides that medicine has made in the last fifty years are breathtaking. But they do have an economic cost. The medical care that we got in 1970s was cheaper than it is now because it is a very different product, in ways that improve patient outcomes."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1w4vjg1/health_insurance/p85l6jw/

"I got a 13 cent raise that puts me \$100 above the income qualifier for Medicaid. I applied for ACA- the cheapest plan is \$600 a month, and the deductible is insane. There is no budgeting for this. I'm not buying "fun" things and choosing to just not save my money. I cannot afford \$600 a month for health insurance period. I don't have streaming services. I only eat at home. I don't buy luxury items of any kind. I have no spare income every month. Your solution is not a solution whatsoever. It's you assuming that poor people are just lying about what they can afford, and are spending money on things other than bills. It's insulting, and, frankly, demeaning."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mmpvpr/why_young_americans_dread_turning_26_health/n85eeqo/

An agent or broker · 22 documents

"I thought the income considered for ACA would be income after we retire not total anticipate income for this year. Husband and I are retiring in July this year. I called health broker and was told our 2026 total income does not qualify us for subsidies this year. We can definitely control our MAGI next year. But the cost of health insurance without subsidies for this year is \$2,400 a month for bronze. Crazy"

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 155 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=UgzvkYbzn16KYejn5LV4AaABAq>

"Great video Erin. You are truly the best at explaining these financial concepts on YouTube. There is one other option that might be available for some people. I recently lost my COBRA coverage, and was planning on moving to an ACA plan. The ACA plans were very expensive for me, so I contacted an insurance broker who was able to get me coverage for \$600 less per month. I believe it's insurance used by an association of people who are self employed or run small businesses. I think it's cheaper because I am getting a group rate."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 25 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgxdZnnFFEMvll3FaXN4AaABAg

"Health Insurance Carrier strongly recommending that I don't purchase insurance through healthcare.gov I just got off the phone with sales agent of the largest health insurance carrier in my state. I had previously applied through healthcare.gov and confirmed that I was ineligible for any tax credits/subsidies but found a plan I like. I then contact the health insurer directly to see if there was any difference in premiums by applying directly through them. The price is identical but I was told to purchase the plan directly anyway because there could be "miscommunication" between the marketplace exchange and the insurer. That seemed odd to me. As someone who supports the ACA and wants to ensure it lasts and improves, I would like to enroll through healthcare.gov. My thinking is that the program's success is measured in part by the number of users who shop/purchase through healthcare.gov. Is there any real downside to using the marketplace exchange?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 16 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/ysinnk/>

"Help! ACA plan termination notice after reporting a change-in-life event I just received a notice today that my ACA plan has been terminated effective October stating "voluntary withdrawal" even though I never requested this, and I have always paid on time. For the life of me I cannot figure out why. The only thing I can figure out is that this is due to me reporting my daughter as married (by reporting the event as a change-of-life event). This was to remove just her, not all of us. I called [Healthcare.gov](<http://Healthcare.gov>) and they are escalating this, but I'm worried that it won't get fixed. I asked the agent and she says this happens a lot so I'm wondering if anyone else has experienced this when it wasn't due to non-payment. Does anyone have any experience with this? My son is a hemophiliac and I'm worried that I need to start looking for a new job so that I can get other coverage. BTW: I'm not getting tax credits, in case that is relevant."

— r/HealthInsurance · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmwnck/help_aca_plan_termination_notice_after_reporting/

"I'm in Ohio and when I retired last year at 62 I went through an insurance agent to help me with my ACA. No charge. She was able to answer a lot of my questions. This year with on SS for income I'm down to a pittance for my premium, as long as I don't go over my income estimate."

— YouTube · 6 Retirement Health Insurance Options BEFORE Medicare Eligibility Kicks In · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOx1T4WKebc&lc=UgzshUvN_8zY2EljMFI4AaABAg

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"I just talked to my Insurance broker last week (I'm on Cobra until 2/2027). FYI, the ACA only has HMO plans, no more PPO plans, she told me. I can't find any doctors who take the HMO plans, even the top tier ones."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgwScHrO5XRAM7MD7Cp4AaABAq

"Have used a broker to sign up for the last 2 years - why are his prices higher than the ones listed on the healthcare.gov site? TLDR : the copious info is below but 1) worried a broker is trying to up charge me to sign up through him for 2026 insurance (a more expensive plan I wasn't considering from gov site is actually \$50/month cheaper thru him, the cheaper plan I thought I might pick on the gov site is \$30 more a month from the broker) 2) how can I review the answers I put into my gov 2026 application before I got the info from the insurance broker because I can't seem to find a way to review that on healthcare.gov So..... 2 years ago I signed up through a local insurance broker because I was coming off Medicaid and couldn't get the healthcare.gov website to show me what I'd be getting for a subsidy. I assume it wouldn't give me that info till I was determined ineligible by my states dhhs which is a slow process. I even called them and told them to end my coverage through them on the last day of December hoping that would make it so I was able to see my subsidy but it didn't. So I went through this broker and got signed up cheap (\$45) a month on priority. Last year since he had made the process so painless I went though him again but it went up to \$120 a month which hurt a bit but he had said some program had expired making my insurance more expensive for this past year even tho my income only went up a couple thousand dollars. Looking back now I prob should have delved into that huge increase further. I called him again at the end of October and he said to call him back in a week since he didn't have access to the new numbers yet but after seeing all the people shocked by their increases I decided to fill out an application on healthcare.gov just to see what kind of increase I might be in for. My income also went up so I put in a new estimate (which I don't remember what I put) and if I keep my current plan it will go up to \$215. There's also a cheaper plan I could get instead that will likely fulfill my needs for \$159. The insurance broker sent me an email listing 2 plans neither of which is my current one. It lists one for \$208 but the gov site lists the same plan for \$186. The gov site lists another plan I wasn't even considering due to expense for \$239 but from the broker that same plan is \$183. In order to have complete info I wanted to review my gov application because I don't remember exactly what I put for my income info. For the broker I told him \$28k for the year but I either listed \$28k or \$26,600 on my gov application. I was trying to review my application details again but have been clicking round and round on the gov site and it won't let me review those details anywhere as far as I can see. I need to have those details before I can ask this broker what's up with the different prices and make a selection. Low key worried he may be pulling a fast one on me but I thought these brokers didn't charge for their services (that may have been true under Biden but who knows what rule changes Trump may have made allowing for up charging) Phew, any info appreciated 🙏 "

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1or1c2m/>

"Is my insurance broker correct that filing taxes separately would make me eligible for a Marketplace subsidy, even though my spouse and I are married and our combined income is too high to qualify? I'm in NY. My income is about \$42k, which qualifies me for a subsidized Marketplace plan on my own. My spouse makes about \$100k, so our **combined household income is too high for us to qualify for Marketplace subsidies**. My insurance broker told me that if my spouse and I file our taxes **married filing separately**, I can qualify for a subsidized Marketplace plan for myself. The broker said I was approved and signed me up for the plan, and because we're filing separately, the broker **did not include my spouse's income on my application**. This just feels...fishy? I'm starting to think the broker may have given me incorrect information. **If I accept the subsidized plan based on what the broker told me and then file our taxes separately, is that actually allowed? Or could I end up owing the subsidy back/facing some kind of penalty when I file my taxes?** I called NY State of Health/the Marketplace, but I'm having a really hard time getting a straight answer. NYS of Health reps keep giving me very scripted, very covering-their-ass answers, and after a **40+ minute phone call, I still don't actually know whether what the broker did was correct** 😊 Has anyone dealt with this exact situation or knows how the Marketplace handles subsidies when married couples file separately?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1woe9l3/is_my_insurance_broker_correct_that_filing_taxes/

"A few years ago when my wife passed I went to an agent as I was clueless about health insurance. He walked me through and explained everything I was looking at. I've since become more comfortable with the process but still list him as my agent in appreciation for how he helped me."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_without_an_agent_on_their/o95pinv/

"Trust your insurer even less than ACA. They don't know shit. I've had pre-authorization for a medicine for years. Last December I go to fill it and it's like \$175 and I had already met my deductible and out-of-pocket maximum in January. I hadn't paid anything for it since January 2025. I call my insurance company, and I get an agent telling me it's a new law that Congress passed, and I called her out immediately because I follow politics closely, so I asked her to tell me what the law was, the new long she kept telling me I was incompetent. Even though she couldn't tell me the law of Congress had passed she just kept repeating it passed one. I don't usually do this, but I asked for her superior. She flat out told me that no, this is not a new congressional law, although it is a congressional law, but it was passed in 2022. I knew I was right. They had given me prior authorization for years, but only because the namebrand was cheaper than the generic. Then the generic lowered their price so low that they stopped covering the namebrand. I tried the generic and it was ineffective, and I had my first asthma attack in decades. I'm not trying to be picky, all my other meds are generics and it all is fine but this particular one, it just did not work for me. It's a maintenance asthma inhaler. So I have this prior authorization and it is useless. The pharmacy is even baffled by it. It's a DAR law, dispense as written. Well, of course it's going to be dispensed as written because I have a prior authorization. If I want that medicine, I have to pay \$175 for it, every month. So now I am on a different one and I will be going on blood pressure meds soon because it raises my blood pressure. I don't have high blood pressure, I never have until I started this medicine. It is effective, but I have to go on another medicine but it's a cheap one. They don't care about my health, they just care about the cost. I hate insurance. It is sorely needed. I had it almost all of my life and then we decided to move to Florida. I retired from my cushy corporate job, but I lost my insurance and I didn't have it for years. So I know what it's like to go without it and even though it's a pain in the ass, I would rather have it than not And I am hoping that nothing comes up for you in the next 10 days or so. My other message was a bit snarky and I apologize. I hate dealing with anything health insurance wise, no matter who I'm dealing with. They make it so much harder than it actually is"

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1st004d/aca_canceled_my_policy_without_my_permission_and/ohpu0tq/

"It is not open enrollment for ACA, so you would need a life event to enroll right now. And I hope no one sees this and uses it because I would be too afraid of what it might be. I'm trying to be kind. I used a broker many years to sign up for ACA, but they don't do much of what you told me, they just helped me pick a plan that might be best for me. I have no idea what they get, but I worked with the same one for years and her name happened to be the same as mine."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rmyvm7/this_is_for_anyone_without_an_agent_on_their/o94hc0r/

Google and online research · 8 documents

"Billed \$1600 so far for free preventative colonoscopy I'm 52 years old and never had a colonoscopy so I thought I would take advantage of the \$0 out of pocket preventative colon cancer screening through my ACA health plan. I had the colonoscopy last month and a couple days ago I got an email from the hospital saying that I have a bill. It's \$1600 for the colonoscopy. I went to reddit of course and saw that reddit seems to agree that it should have been free. No polyps were found. I spent hours on the phone yesterday with the hospital and the insurance company. The lady at the hospital told me that I was mistaken about preventative care being free. She said that there are thousands of different plans and each plan does it differently. She said they submitted my claim and the insurance paid for part of it and that I am responsible for the other \$1600. After talking to her for a while I wasn't getting anywhere so we agreed to disagree and I called the insurance company. The insurance rep spoke English as a second language and didn't seem to understand the point I was making. She told me how much the total was, how much insurance had paid, and how much I was responsible for. When I said things like "I think there is a mistake, this should be free of charge since it was preventative" she simply repeated the totals as if she didn't understand. She was supposed to call me back at 2pm today and never called. I guess I will be spending tomorrow on the phone again trying to get the \$1600 taken off my bill. Nobody I have talked to so far is aware of the ACA policy that preventative care is covered in full. They seem to think that I am just saying that to get out of paying my bill. Any advice for what I can say tomorrow. Edit: OK, I just got off the phone with the United Healthcare rep. She said that there was no mistake. She said I had 2 procedures done and only one was preventative. I asked her for the diagnostic codes for the procedures and she only gave me one code G0121. She seemed like she wanted to get me off the phone so I didn't argue. She apologized several times and said there was no mistake, I have to pay the \$1600. I had a referral for "Screening for colon cancer Z12.11" and have no knowledge of any second procedure. EDIT 2 OK I got some more info today. I confirmed that my plan offers the colon cancer screening at 0% copay and no deductible. The insurance says that I got the colon cancer screening paid for (they paid \$150). But I was charged \$1600 for an endoscopy that was not preventative care. All the CPT codes are missing for the non-preventative endoscopy. Here it is called a HC colonoscopy. The person I talked to said that my primary code was Z12.11 and my secondary code was K57.30 <https://preview.redd.it/3qbqhqlod7ug1.png?width=700&format=png&auto=webp&s=7ec1b565073bcc88f0403c5064e0be6ec17b28b6> <https://preview.redd.it/09k2gdppd7ug1.png?width=691&format=png&auto=webp&s=9e15198b82f8833f30009a763184c6e58817a42f> Update 3 I talked to a different insurance rep today and got a completely different reason for my bill. This one acknowledged that I only had one procedure and that it was a colonoscopy, not an endoscopy. She said that while a colonoscopy can be preventative, mine was not preventative because I had it done in a hospital. I asked her where I should have gone to get a preventative colonoscopy and she said that I should have gone to an office. I told her I went to my doctor's office and they referred me to the hospital. She said she understands it is frustrating and offered to help me file a claim adjustment request. So in 10 to 15 days I should be getting the decision. I still think it makes no sense because they paid the claim submitted by the doctor who performed the colonoscopy even though he did it at a hospital. But the claim submitted by the hospital was not preventative because the colonoscopy happened at a hospital."

— r/HealthInsurance · 233 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sg3ast/>

"18 currently unemployed and need insurance To start off I've never used Reddit really so I'm not sure if this is appropriate here but it seems like the place to go. I turned 18 in June and haven't had health insurance for YEARS. It honestly wouldn't be a crazy issue for me if I wasn't dealing with some reproductive health issues and wanting birth control. I used to just go to the ER when things happened or visit Planned Parenthood but my mom seems against it now because of money. It'd be over \$1,000 per month for me to just be placed on her own plan so I'm at a wall. I went to [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) and I was told that I qualified for a marketplace plan yet open enrollment has closed. I don't believe I account for a special enrollment period because I never really had insurance to begin with. I don't understand what to do in my case. I still live with my mother, I have a job interview lined up but everything feels like a waiting game except I never actually get the medical attention I really need. I'm frustrated and just want to see an GYN or somebody that can help me, I'm very tired."

— r/HealthInsurance · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wdtqmh/18_currently_unemployed_and_need_insurance/

"I've made the decision to quit my dead-end job at Starbucks with nothing lined up. I posted my plan on Reddit and several posters asked me "but what about your health insurance?!?" People really think it's crazy that I'm leaving my toxic job because I will lose these benefits. I have not used my health insurance once in my three years there. I'm young and healthy so I don't need to visit a doctor. The only thing is if I were to get in a big accident or suddenly fall extremely ill. But I would just deal with it if it happens. It's just terrible that people stay in soul-sucking jobs just for health insurance, and I'm not going to be one of those people. I'll figure it out. So many jobs, including low-level retail jobs if I needed to go that route again in desperation, have health insurance included, so I will be just fine."

— YouTube · How to Survive Without HEALTH INSURANCE in Today's World · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYCLf236IZc&lc=UgyJ3WQDGaGA0qwi3PR4AaABAq>

"ACA and PTCs, Early Retirement Asking for confirmation of my understanding, under post-OBBA law. *TLDR*, my basic question is, with one spouse on Medicare and one purchasing insurance through ACA, are we still a household of two and is joint MAGI used to determine eligibility? Does MFS change that? Practically speaking, I have retired at age 62 (got laid off and not finding any opportunities) and my COBRA benefits end in March. I'm reviewing longer-term financial planning options to work toward getting PTCs for the next three years until I go on Medicare. Best I can tell, the OBBA brought back the 400% FPL cliff (which is what we've been arguing about) which in 2026 will be \$62,600 MAGI for a household of one, and \$84,600 for a household of two. My spouse is currently on Medicare so I only need to purchase ACA insurance for myself. In this situation are we still a household of two, and does our joint MAGI count? I don't think Married Filing Separate would change that. Using online calculators for my state and county, if we are truly a household of two and total household MAGI is used then we need to remain under \$84,600 MAGI to get PTCs. If we do that, then we will pay \$0 in insurance premiums for me for Bronze level coverage (which is fine, I'm reasonably healthy). However, if our MAGI is \$84,601 or higher then my monthly premiums would be over \$1400/mo for the same coverage. Does this sound correct? Thanks! ***Followup.*** This is the final strategy: \- Decline COBRA coverage for 2026; \- Sign up for ACA coverage with PTCs; \- Actively manage MAGI to less than \$84,600 to retain those PTCs; \- Make a solid Roth conversion in calendar year 2025 to have liquid cash for the next three years; \- Pay the estimated taxes due on the conversion by January 15; \- Don't get sick for the next three years."

— r/obamacare · 7 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1otm8of/>

"I'm one of those "coast fire" as many YouTuber called. But because I am only 41 year old and scared to live without health insurance, I'm stuck working. Although I'm happy with my job, it still hurts not being able to jump off the working life just for the health insurance."

— YouTube · Is It UNETHICAL to Get ACA Subsidies in EARLY Retirement? (An Early Retiree's Perspective) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDJZHalcgJw&lc=UgxpCp84r7CYLYFAIvV4AaABAg>

"JOSH. GREAT VIDEO, I have used the exchange for 4 years now, kaiser , same provider I have always had since birth, major hospital 2 miles away has everything, 65k annual AGI , pay 160 a month , no Brainer, cobra is ridiculous, most common stuff can also be handled online prescriptions e-visits etc, perfect for early retirement as long as you don't need the income to sustain debt, this is key,"

— YouTube · How to Qualify for Obamacare Premium Credits · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eJnDBpVoSYU&lc=UgxDTHTFAgGI82dcuvC94AaABAg>

"I just found this thread after doing an online search for complaints about Imperial Insurance in Arizona. I made the mistake of signing up for Imperial through the health marketplace, effective January 1. My previous insurance, Banner Aetna, withdrew from the marketplace, so I had to find new insurance. I knew I was taking a chance with an untested insurance company, but everything else was so much more expensive. Well, you get what you pay for. I, too, never received any plan documents in the mail or even via email. Every piece of information about my plan I had to go looking for online. Well I did get a flimsy insurance card with a primary care doc I'd never seen. Changing that to my own PCP with Imperial took multiple calls. But that's not the worst of it. Please see next paragraph. Nowhere in my Imperial portal am I able to access my Explanations of Benefits, nor can I see any information about providers I've seen and what Imperial has paid or not paid for. Contrary to their claims, Imperial DOES NOT send out EOBs to its customers. At all. And they have contradicted themselves because after I complained to them, they actually admitted in an email to me that they only provide EOBs to providers! I'm flying blind here -- how do I know whether the amount on a bill from a provider is accurate and should be paid by me? I jumped through all the hoops and filed a complaint with the Arizona Department of Insurance and Financial Institutions in early March. A couple of weeks later they closed the case stating that "The information we reviewed indicates that Imperial has acknowledged your concerns, and they have communicated their finds with you in written correspondence." Ha. All Imperial did was copy some EOBs (not all of them) and mail them to me. I just hope and pray that I don't have any serious health event this year, as my trust in Imperial "Health" is nil."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q9bscn/imperial_health_on_aca/odyfwn8/

"Based on my analysis I would have to agree - - - - -My income is below 400% of poverty level. To my shock and surprise my premiums will NOT be increasing in 2026 compared to 2025. I went to healthcare.gov (which has been opened for preview for 2026 plans) entered my zip code and entered the same income information for 2026 that I had for 2025. I honestly just about fell out of my chair....I was expecting a large increase based on all the information that I have been seeing. My income is moderate (not low, but not high either). I researched and found out that in 2026 those that earn over 400% of the poverty level (\$62,600 for a single person) will NOT receive a premium tax credit in 2026. I did check that out by entering the \$62,601 (\$1 over 400%) as my income and healthcare.gov did provide information that I did NOT qualify for any credit. Perhaps the large increases are for people/families that have higher incomes (incomes over 400% of the poverty level). In any event, based on my results, I can say that not all folks that get health insurance from the ACA via healthcare.gov will have increases in premiums. BTW, I am self-employed (have been for over 20 years) and have had my insurance through the ACA on healthcare.gov since it came in to being. I am an American....not a Republican nor a Democrat....just an American who identifies as that first and as an Independent second."

— YouTube · Obamacare enrollees get first look at 2026 prices as premiums soar · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2Aznbv0Pnoc&lc=UgxFDAjHcqGq1lr6PV4AaABAg.AOt69wUjx1TAOtEerh_rB

Health sharing ministries and short-term plans · 7 documents

"Anyone considering a health share in place of ACA? We are a healthy family of 5. I am 30, my wife is 27, and our kids are all under 3. We were paying \$1181 a month this year until our 3rd born came along. Then it went up to \$1580 for the same plan. Now enrolling for next year, they want \$2800 a month for the same plan. It's just not affordable and really doesn't even make sense to buy it at that rate. I don't want to go completely uninsured because of the kids and we have a lot of assets to lose. So instead of the ACA I have been looking at health sharing companies. I know they get a lot of negative flack on here because they are not traditional insurance. But the option isn't really between the ACA. It's between that and having nothing. I have looked at a bunch, Zion health share seems fairly reputable and being that we are younger and have no pre existing conditions, I think most things would be covered. Anyone else in the same boat of looking at alternatives?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 46 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oxm828/>

"Finally found a decent deal this year at age 62 . I had health insurance first two years after retiring in 2014 (am a retired RN). Paid \$ 663/ month for health insurance the first year and \$ 677/ month the following year.They wanted to jack it up to \$ 913 /month when I turned 58.I said no,went without for 5 years.In the meantime I was able to get out of debt.Thank God,nothing catastrophic happened to me . This month I was able to obtain some decent health insurance at \$ 673/ month ,which includes some supplements to defray some out of pocket costs. Sounds expensive,but trust me in South Florida \$ 673/month is a deal. Since my RN pension is now supplemented by Social Security benefits,the premium hit is easier to take. Medicare in two years."

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=Ugwp_Ute8re04Vpyk8d4AaABAg

"[US] Health insurance as a solo small business owner is killing me financially, how are you handling it? Running a small boutique for a few years now and the one thing that never gets easier is health insurance. Coming from a corporate background where HR handled everything, I had no idea how brutal the individual market was until I was actually in it. Right now I'm paying more per month for my own coverage than I used to pay toward rent. And the deductibles aren't even that good. I looked at marketplace plans, looked at shortterm options, even went down the health sharing ministry rabbit hole for a while before deciding it felt too risky for my situation. What I keep running into is that the options are either expensive and okay, or cheaper and kind of terrifying. There's no middle ground that actually makes sense. For those of you running smaller operations, especially retail or service businesses where you're the only employee or close to it, what have you actually landed on? Did you find something through a professional association or a local chamber? Did you just accept the high premium and build it into your pricing? I track my finances pretty obsessively so I know exactly what this is costing me each year, and it's genuinely one of my biggest line items. Curious what other people have figured out."

— r/selfemployed · 10 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1vk17ni/>

"I found Healthshare networks to be the most affordable and have been with Liberty Healthshare for 5 years. I've had no issues with their coverage. I've had just routine claims and haven't had anything major. ACA was not a good option for me. I make a little to much to qualify for subsidies which makes the premiums too high and the deductible was astronomical. As usual, I'm trapped in the doughnut hole. It was essentially overpriced catastrophic insurance in my situation. COBRA was also too pricey. Healthcare coverage was and still is, for me, the most financially challenging part of retiring early."

— YouTube · 6 Retirement Health Insurance Options BEFORE Medicare Eligibility Kicks In · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hOx1T4WKebc&lc=UgyJWdwoqUxuUaR70Ft4AaABAg>

"My new individual Cigna plan is \$534 a month with 7.5k deductible and ZERO ER visit coverage. One trip to the ER will bankrupt me. We don't even have what's called catastrophic insurance anymore like we did 20 years ago. If they don't fund the ACA, I'm dropping my plan and putting that \$534 a month into an account to pay the cash fees for urgent care, ER, doctors, good rx for scripts, etc. That is my shitty plan. Thanks, trump and all you idiots who voted for him."

— YouTube · MAGA Supporter Shocked After Her Health Insurance Premiums Skyrocket · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RrX65kYTMk&lc=Ugw1i0JPPYio1saEPeZ4AaABAg>

"We have a DPC membership for the everyday healthcare needs (annual wellness/sick visits, minor injuries or wounds like stitches, lab work, prescriptions, etc) and then we have a non-profit health share for the large medical bills. Both memberships are around \$700 for my entire family. I have used the health share since 2021 and they have paid for everything we have submitted (and within about 2 weeks) and we joined the DPC last December, so it has been a year. I have been sick and just texted my doctor last week for advice on what I can do to get rid of my annoying cough. It is nice to be able to have access to a doctor when needed and I can get seen if I need to (usually same or next day, depending on the situation). I realize this solution is not for everyone, but it has worked well for our family."

— r/selfemployed · https://www.reddit.com/r/selfemployed/comments/1pn63ub/us_my_health_insurance_just_doubled_curious_how/nuc8qjw/

"Regarding cancer, couldn't you theoretically go to a foreign country for that? Really the only concern is acute emergencies that cost over \$150k (NICU stay, full body burns, aneurysms, etc. falls here). What is the actual probability of facing these sorts of claims? I looked at the catastrophic plans and they are just as expensive as the Bronze marketplace plans. Is there any alternative?"

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmmap5/why_not_health_cost_sharing_ministries/pba46qk/

HealthSherpa and quote sites · 1 documents

"I signed up for MoveHealth meeting for tomorrow. I am getting VSP thru COBRA/RMAP only for 2026 as my COBRA runs out mid next year and I did not want a double deduction (reset as you renew plan). Debating ACA credit vs ROTH conversions. My gut is ROTH as max MAGI I could have us \$78,880. Thanks Joe"

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVy_wz5Ac7pA&lc=UgxXUACr60z2c18cAVx4AaABAq

Dislikes

Deductibles too high to use the plan

"ACA premiums.... What's going on with ACA Marketplace insurance right now is absurd. The same plan I pay \$77 for (with tax credit) is now \$368. I currently have a \$150 deductible, \$1500 OOP max, \$250 ER copay, \$1 primary care visits, \$1-\$15 prescriptions, and a \$30 specialist, imaging and surgery copay. The same plan for 2026 now has a \$2700 deductible, \$8250 OOP max, \$1,000 ER copay AFTER deductible, \$30 primary care visit, and \$80 specialist, imaging and surgery copay... for almost quadruple the price. Without the tax credit, the plan premium is \$696.46 for next year. If someone hit their OOP max for the year with this plan without a tax credit, their healthcare would cost about \$16,000 for the year. If someone hit their OOP max with a similar tax credit as mine for the year, their healthcare would cost \$12,666. For the record, the projected income I gave on my application was \$38,000....."

— r/HealthInsurance · 665 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1om4uju/>

"Husband brings home \$5400 a month, health insurance costs \$1300...family of 4. What the hell. It was \$900 a month and I already felt like we were being stretched thin. I am a stay at home mom to two young children, daycare cost more than my paycheck, and I didn't have a career worth staying in. My husband and I both intend on picking up a side gig, probably DoorDash or something, just to get by. But how can we ever get ahead if health insurance keeps rising like crazy? My husbands job does offer health insurance but it's basically the same price with a higher deductible. The plan we are looking at on the Marketplace has a \$0 health deductible and a \$1500 drug deductible, with max OOP of \$19500 for my family. His health insurance as a \$6000 deductible per person, \$12000 for family and the max OOP is the same. So really the biggest question is do we want a lower deductible or lower max OOP, since the premiums are roughly the same...and we think we want the lower deductible. If 96K a year isn't enough for a family of 4 in Ohio now....then the middle class is fuckin dead."

— r/HealthInsurance · 664 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pcor72/>

"My new ACA premiums and deductible - considering just not having health insurance for a few years. So I had a life event last month that required me to get ACA. My monthly premium was \$485 and my deductible was \$7600. Just got an email saying my current health insurance will not be offered next year. Instead my new premium will be about \$560 and my deductible will be about \$11000. Also it seems many of my co-insurance will be higher by about \$70. And I'm not sure what else has changed for the worse. At this point I'm seriously considering not having health insurance for a few years. It seems cheaper to just plan a 3-week trip overseas and get better healthcare for much cheaper. You heard me - better! I just don't want to enable this defunct healthcare system anymore. If I'm in an accident I hope EMTALA saves my broke behind - in both senses of the phrase. I'll pay what I can then declare bankruptcy. If not life threatening, I'll take it overseas. A roundtrip ticket to India costs \$1500, \$1000 if you wait a month or so. That's less than three months premium. Over a year I can save up \$7000 in premiums. Saving up for one year buys me a full check up and a vacation trip. What do you think? Anyone considering the same thing? For those with kids - you have my sympathies."

— r/HealthInsurance · 574 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1onw7d8/>

"\$2600/mth, \$6k deductible for wife and I Blue Shield Bronze HSA PPO w/ \$6k deductible is looking like \$2650/mth for 2026, for wife and I (middle aged, in good health). This is a CoveredCA ACA plan, and I'm self-employed. This is completely unaffordable. Having already cut all our costs to the bone, I only have one option, which is to raise my rates, and hope that my competitors will also be raising theirs too so mine aren't extortionate. The only other thing I could do it seems is to become younger, which I'll try and organize, but seems to have some complex issues. This is going to massively, massively spike inflation."

— r/HealthInsurance · 357 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1o9m8gp/>

"Sat through new job orientation in a deep red state and the cognitive dissonance was something else Just started a new job in a red state. Orientation day, 50+ new hires packed into a hall, and eventually we get to the health insurance and benefits section. That's when the room came alive. People complaining left and right about insurance companies ripping them off. My meds aren't covered. My deductible is insane. I can't get the care I actually need. Half the room had a story. And honestly, looking around, a lot of these folks clearly have real health issues and genuinely need coverage that works. Meanwhile HR is up there basically doing damage control, pitching workarounds and cheaper tiers like "this plan gets you more bang for your buck" which is corporate speak for "we know it's bad, here's how to make it slightly less bad." Here's the part that got me. Based on where I am and the conversations around me, most of this room votes red every single time. The same people furious about unaffordable meds and garbage coverage are voting for the party actively working to gut affordable healthcare. They'll rage at the insurance company all day but never connect it to the ballot they cast. Nobody in that room made the connection. Not one person. They see the symptom every day and keep voting for the disease. I just sat there quietly filling out my forms."

— r/obamacare · 325 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1v5g93m/sat_through_new_job_orientation_in_a_deep_red/

"Thinking of going uninsured for 2026 and paying the penalty.. Thoughts? Im 26 in California, I qualified for medical with my previous job but with this new job I make too much so I was looking at Covered California. For 2026 the CHEAPEST BRONZE plan I could qualify for will cost me \$340 with subsidies included and an insane deductible of \$7000. I think its ridiculous that a healthy 26 year old that eats right and goes to the doctors once a year just for consultation will pay that. Im Seriously considering going uninsured and I understand the potential risks. One bad injury or emergency hospital trip could cost me thousands. But if I get a high hospital bill I could work it out with their financial services department. based on my obligatory expenses I could justify I dont have money to pay this hypothetical bill. My question is: What do you guys recommend? Am I doing the math right? How much would I pay in tax penalties if I make 52k year. Edit*** Thank you guys for all the advice — a lot of you were right to point out how easy it is to underestimate how expensive and financially destructive a single hospital visit can be. That's exactly why I made this post, and I really appreciate the reality check. I ended up finding a catastrophic plan that meets California's standards and has zero deductible, which honestly feels like the best of the worst options right now. This doesn't mean I'm happy about it — I just made the most practical choice I could. We should never have to accept a system that makes people feel lucky just to afford to get sick. But we already normalized this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 222 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oig6zm/>

"I had to retire due to medical issues at 55 so we had to go with Marketplace. It's been pretty good, our premiums are under \$150 per month for 2 people and our deductible for family was \$800. No HSA is allowed but we created a medical bucket in our high yield savings account and just transfer money as needed. We keep our income below \$60,000 too. I fear big changes are coming for 2026 though. Guess we will cross that bridge when it comes. God bless all!"

— YouTube · Want to Retire Early? HERE ARE 4 OPTIONS FOR HEALTH INSURANCE! · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmu0NOljsfU&lc=Ugyd3n-O0reHcMX3grJ4AaABAg>

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"anyone here avoid seeing doctors or specialist due to not knowing total cost? I personally don't have an issue with buying things, fixing things because i know the cost before everything starts, however, because of this health insurance, not knowing what it will be cost bothers me so much that i avoid seeing doctor as much as possible, yes, I have a high deductible plan, the insurance thinks, the first \$3k is basically free money, but i don't want to risk going to a doctor and get like \$700 surprised bill, which I often seeing here. This works great for health insurance companies that collects high premium and know people will try to avoid seeing doctors as long as possible. Whoever came up with the high deductible is a genius businessman. sucks for consumers and it should be illegal."

— r/obamacare · 54 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1tjgmbk/anyone_here_avoid_seeing_doctors_or_specialist/

"Im diabetic and havent had health insurance in close to 10 years. My appointments are \$150 each, which i have twice a year, and my quarterly medication is \$25. Im a single 33 year old male who is otherwise healthy and the cheapest health insurance i found was about \$350 per month, and i still wouldve had to pay a \$125 deductible for my appointments and \$20 for my medication. It makes no sense at all."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · 48 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=UgzcKI2noYKjBKSf5Yx4AaABAg>

"I need OP to sit down as this may shock them. This is better than my current 2025 plan. I have no children, so just for me. I have zero health issues, and never go to the doctor. Even fifteen years ago I was spending \$150/month for \$3000 deductible as a young person. The idea of a \$15/month plan has never been close to a reality for me. I've never seen a \$0 deductible plan. My genuine concern is my plan will jump to \$600, \$700, even \$800/month and my deductible will go from \$12000 to \$15000 or more. This is back breaking to strained budgets."

— r/obamacare · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1oj7nbz/2026_aca_plans_this_is_criminal_look_at_this/nm1cx41/

"If I tell my doctor's office I don't have insurance, can they look up whether that's true or not? Context: I've been on Medicaid (in Illinois) for the last few years. I filled out my redetermination in September as usual, then got a letter at the very end of November that I no longer qualify (my income went up and I'm now at around ~\$25,000/year, before I was hovering right around the cut off, which is about \$21,000 I believe). So now I'm looking at Marketplace plans and man....they are all so so awful!! The deductibles are crazy, and it's basically a choice between paying hundreds a month in order to maybe pay \$20-40 each time you go to the doctor, or paying \$10-\$30 a month but paying \$100-\$300 every time to go to the doctor. I take psychiatric medications that I rely on. I've been stable on the same ones for a few years now. I only see my doctor (psychiatrist) four times a year, and it's basically just as a requirement for her to be able to approve my refills. My psychiatrist's office offers sliding scale for uninsured patients, and I would only need to pay about \$35 per visit with them (plus about \$13/month for my meds with GoodRx coupons). This is a setup I could afford, so I was leaning towards just not buying health insurance at all for the coming year and paying for my care out of pocket this way. HOWEVER. I'm 29 years old, and this year two people I know who are even younger than I am were diagnosed with cancer. My parents got in a very scary car accident about two weeks ago (they rolled down a mountain but are miraculously fine because my dad's car is basically a tank). My point being, life has been reminding me a lot recently that no one knows what's going to happen tomorrow, and I feel like having SOME kind of coverage for if things go horribly horribly wrong would probably be in my best interest. I've also read a lot of reddit horror stories of otherwise 'healthy' young people deciding to forego insurance and regretting it after developing unexpected and expensive illnesses. So. I went back to the Marketplace website to look at the plans again. Found one that's \$6/month, has a \$7500 deductible, and covers almost nothing, *but* would be an affordable fail-safe if, god forbid, something really terrible and/or expensive were to happen. My psychiatrist's office does not take this plan. I called them and basically asked, 'If I hypothetically had insurance that you all don't take, would I still be eligible for the sliding scale cash price?' They told me no, that I would have to pay the full cost of the visit, which would be \$300 each time. This finally brings me to my question (thank for for sticking with me if you've read this far lol): **is there anyway for my doctor's office to *know* whether or not I actually have insurance, if I tell them that I don't?** I don't want to come across as if I'm trying to scam the system (although the healthcare system in the US is a nightmare and tbh I wouldn't judge anyone for doing so). But I just literally can't afford to keep seeing my doctor if it's going to be \$300 an appointment. But I also don't want to forego coverage completely. My ideal way to move forward would be to buy the \$6/month plan for emergencies, and just tell my psych that I don't have coverage so I could pay the sliding scale cost for the appointments. Is this something anyone has experience with?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 22 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px9csk/>

"I had used e health before but never.... I had used e health before but never again. They advised me to take a policy that had absolutely zero help to me. They then apologize and fit me with a different policy. One again zero benefit. I went over all my providers etc over and over again to make sure i was covered. Now I find out my doctors and hospitals aren't in network! I am now stuck with this policy I pay for and can't use. I would never use again or recommend to anyone."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/67f12fd9611d20f324a40>

"I receive \$85.00 a month for over the.... I receive \$85.00 a month for over the counter products I might need. I was saving the \$85.00 dollars to put with the next month and buy something that cost \$139.00. Went to do it and found I lost that first months \$85.00. You HAVE to use the entire amount monthly or you lose it for that month. Secondly, they give you an online catalog to shop from. The prices are ridiculous. Many times they don't have a product you need. By the way you can use your monthly \$85.00 at CVS, WALMART, and a few others. Notice I said at. You can't use your benefits online with any other stores YOU MUST GO IN TO THE STORE. I'm disabled and can't get to the closest Walmart unless a neighbor is available. Before you go with EHEALTH consider the hassles. I hope this helps with your decision."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/66be3b5eb4e4754b27bfb97a>

"False representation. First of all they call me and they ring my phone off the hook and get me to take one of their plans and tell me that I'm going to have free medical and dental and vision and I have to talk to three people on the phone before that happens and when I finally do find out what I qualify for none of it I don't get free dental and vision I just get the medical and I'm promised a benefit card where I can buy food and gas That's the biggest lie I have ever heard in my life I've had this insurance three times and the card is not accepted anywhere and you have to do tutorials online to even earn money and you don't earn as much money as you lately people to believe. And you take my insurance away from me after telling me it's free after about 3 months you take it away and then a month later you calling me back again trying to get me back on it so what is the point in the purpose? I do not want any part of this company it's a scam from the get-go. You people lie about benefit cards and they're not worth deadly squat. And today I got a call from a lady trying to get sell me this insurance and I told her I said look I've already had this card in this insurance three times three times and all three times the card wasn't accepted anywhere. I said it's no good it's it's a light I can't use it why would I want something that I couldn't use? And that woman paused for a minute and she said you're right she said you are right. Then she puts me on the phone with another person which is a man and he asked me the same stupid questions that she did and says I'm going to have free dental and vision along with free medical care then he wants to put me on the phone with somebody else I mean that's ridiculous why why three people what is going on with that and by the time you get to the third person who tells you what you're qualified for you're not qualified for any of that stuff at all so why do you guys have to scheme to get people to sign up are you getting a cut for it or what"

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a6bc5e0b6e698f6a00f2097>

"If you're a woman - do NOT get Ambetter. . I'm self-employed and paying for Ambetter from the marketplace, which is commercial insurance and supposed to be decent for the co-pay about \$400. Everything about this insurance is bad. 1. ZocDoc, the largest online scheduling system for doctors, doesn't even recognise Ambetter in my state and I can't use the convenient website to schedule any of the appointments. I can't overstate how inconvenient that is. 2. Impossible to find providers - the website doesn't update them frequently, you have to call multiple times to find someone who actual is in network. The number of providers is so tiny you have to wait for weeks to get an appointment. 3. Doesn't cover anything! Refused to cover my yearly mammograms (prescribed by my doctor based on my personal medical history!) and covers literary ZERO of anything fertility-related. Not a single fertility test is covered. This insurance is a punishment for women, please stay away. I'm leaving 2 stars because customer service actually was trying to help me and I was able to reach a human being relative easy."

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69039842f7718f8c00735d85>

Premiums they can't pay after the subsidy loss

"My premium just went up 1500% Posting again because mods removed it since I guess I didn't use the right flair originally I don't know what to do. It's now higher than my mortgage. It is literally impossible for me to pay for now. I won't have insurance anymore starting on the 1st. I have a ton of medication that I need to function. I'm scared Age 36 State Arkansas Income 30k a year Household size of 3. Partner recently laid off. Not married. All my info is updated through the marketplace. The cheapest thing they suggested is \$500. The bill I received for next month is \$744. I rounded up in the comments to \$800 because it's basically the same thing. My Medicaid coverage was \$48 before hand. Someone whose comment is no longer visible said they were happy my premiums went up because they think I voted for Trump. Trump is an evil person and I would rather die than vote for him. Leftists exist in Arkansas. Sorry your stereotypes are incorrect Do only republicans comment on this subreddit or something? Why is everyone treating me like a liar?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 416 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1px2s56/>

"Insurance carriers increased rates on ACA plans with based off the expectation of lower enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are put back in, what happens to the now jacked up rates that were already approved by states and sold during open-enrollment? Carriers have increased full cost rates ahead of schedule because they expect a drop in enrollment due to the expiring ACA subsidies. If subsidies are reinstated, what happens to the already inflated rates? Each insurance carrier must get its rate increase approved by the state annually, often months before open enrollment. This year, carriers justified rate hikes primarily by citing: 1. Lower projected enrollment numbers due to expiring ACA subsidies 2. The rising cost of GLP-1 weight loss drugs (even though most ACA marketplace plans don't cover these) I'm re-emphasizing because I fear people will still confuse the question. I am not talking about increases people are seeing based off loss of their personal subsidy, I am talking about the plan's actual cost. Aka, what someone would pay if they didn't receive subsidy. My state approved my insurance company for a 27% increase for 2026. They have again applied that increase disproportionately, increasing the individual plans more than their group plans. My personal non-subsidized cheapest HSA eligible ACA plan went up 40% on just the premium, with increases in the cost-sharing amounts as well. This is about average across my local market. Their group rate plans only went up by single digit amounts. Even if the government reinstates subsidies, I'm not hearing anyone addressing the issue of rate increases that relied on inaccurate enrollment projections. Open enrollment has already begun. Will these companies be forced to rework their approved plans retroactively? Are we going to get refunds? I don't see it happening. If they don't, the insurance companies will profit even more from this political situation. This event has allowed them to quickly raise plan costs beyond their actual expenses. If it's too late for 2026, what's the chances they'll actually lower rates even for 2027?"

— r/HealthInsurance · 229 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oonov2/>

"My premium increased 590%. Is this normal? I understand without the enhanced subsidies we'd be seeing double or triple premiums next year. However, my premium skyrocketed. In 2025, I paid \$80 and my premiums are set to increase to \$552. The lowest option available was \$300 for catastrophic insurance which wouldn't work for me. I had to go with the \$450 option. I put that my income was \$730 biweekly after deductions. My take home pay is \$1200 a month. My friend in Florida makes the same as me and her premium only increased from \$11 to \$50. My coworker in Wisconsin is also getting a similar low cost option. I am so confused why my premium increased so much. Did anyone else in Illinois experience this? Hearing about our premiums doubling or tripling scared me, but this is another level. Edit: also, my parents are helping to pay part of my premiums for now. Otherwise, I'd be out of luck. Even though I'm grateful, it doesn't feel good having to rely on my parents for this. But knowing my health history I could end up in serious trouble if I go uninsured. Update: After a month on the marketplace plan, I was found eligible for Medicaid so it ended up working out at the end. I was worried since I'd been denied for Medicaid in the past. It looks like the increased premiums finally made me eligible."

— r/HealthInsurance · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pnyycy/>

""Get Covered Illinois"--2026 premium notices sent out today. This year, Illinois switched over to its own program, rather than using Healthcare.gov. 2026 premiums hit the street today. The unsubsidized premium for me and my wife (both in our early to mid-60s) is \$2,915.99. This represents a 17% premium increase from 2025. In Illinois, my carrier, Blue Cross/Blue Shield, had gotten approved for an average 27% premium increase across all of its policy forms; I'm not sure why we got the smaller percentage increase. I had thought that people our age would have been hit with the highest percentage increase in premiums. The automatic renewal letter that I got described my projected monthly subsidy, and my "monthly premium" (in other words, the subsidized premium). I figured out the total unsubsidized premium by adding those figures together. Because of the way that the numbers were laid out in the letter, it appears that the people who run the Illinois program believe that Federal subsidies will be renewed for 2026."

— r/HealthInsurance · 131 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1oiti3k/>

"If they don't renew the enhanced subsidies... What is your "we can't afford this" premium? Our bronze plan with a 15k deductible is already \$600/mo for 2 married healthy people in the early 40s, no kids. Next year it's supposed to be like \$1600. We are just over the subsidy cliff so we'll be paying full freight. That's almost 20% of our income for the protection racket. I honestly don't know what to do. I don't feel like living only to pay for health insurance and giving up on savings or a vacation. It's not like we live super large but we make just over 100k and for people in a rural area that's ok. Erase \$20k from that and everything maths a lot harder! I'm sick of this shit. Why do we put up with this? I yearn for the days of Obama but I am so angry they designed this law with this "cliff" system. Are there any other options for catastrophic insurance?"

— r/obamacare · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1nv7jge/if_they_dont_renew_the_enhanced_subsidies/

"Man, health insurance prices are wild right now. My premium just jumped AGAIN this year and I genuinely don't know how people with families are supposed to keep up. It feels like every year the coverage shrinks and the bill grows."

— YouTube · Health Insurance Prices Are Out of Control in America | People Are Canceling Coverage · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PnJ8dGEc0hE&lc=Ugz61D8mrVjl84umMI54AaABAg>

"ACA not very affordable anymore ACA is not really affordable without the extra subsidy, but California fines you 100 per month for not having it. It's not really fair to fine people who truly can't afford it. I work front desk hotel. The cheapest plan for me is 200 per month. I have to pay 100% out of pocket until I reach 7200 for the year. Just 2 visits to the dermatologist is costing me 1400 on top of the 200 I already pay. If I want something with normal co-pays, it's going to cost me 400 per month. I make between 45K-50K, but the cost of living is so high in California that there isn't much left for stuff like health insurance. It's really not fair that California fines you at this point when the premiums have literally doubled in price. It's very frustrating."

— r/obamacare · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/

"2027 shock 2026 me and dependent \$500 month 2027 \$959 month Got a letter from Florida Blue that if my income and subsidy is the same then this is what my premium will be. I know premiums went up but geez double? I'm limited to what plans I can get because I take a drug that's \$2200 a month. That only gets covered if it's on the formulary and I pay my out pocket maximum. So I can't even think about going to a lower end plan because those don't cover my drugs at all even with prior authorization. Any Florida Blue folks out there in the same boat? Any hope that when open enrollment starts maybe higher premiums will be offset with higher subsidies ? We're all winning right?"

— r/obamacare · 55 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wyq35r/>

"A freaking nightmare. We have to enroll by Dec. 15 for Jan. 1 effective date. I have a decent silver plan, but the premium will increase by 300 percent without subsidies, which means I will just sign up for a cheaper bronze plan if there is no change by the 15th. People like me don't want to be stuck in a lowered plan if we find out after the 15th that we will get subsidies and we don't want to risk going without insurance for a period. Knowing the GOP, they will deliberately delay this if they are going to offer subsidies just for the opportunity to be cruel."

— r/obamacare · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1p58mgp/maybe_the_aca_will_survive_after_all/nghi12x/

"I remember. I have to point this fact out to people all the time. There is a whole group, mostly MAGA, who think the ACA caused it to happen. Prior to the ACA I had years of 30%+ premium increases."

— r/obamacare · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1urupru/aca_insurers_proposed_doubledigit_premium_hikes/owk0052/

"Self-employed independent white male. My premiums tripled. It's a big deal. I'll send you my address so you can make up the difference. I'll refund it when the 10 year (and counting) congressional fix that you refer to is implemented."

— r/obamacare · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ps7j5o/premiums_triple_congress_goes_homes/nv7gfug/

"I thought the same. I feel for you, I'm over here ticked about paying \$427 a month. It is Ambetter. And I like it. Had cancer treatment in '24 and '25. No complaints. It was \$220 a month before we lost the subsidies."

— r/obamacare · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1ti8lp5/ive_just_realized_that_my_ambetter_aca_plan_is/omssbpq/

Owing money back at tax time

"Is it beneficial to slightly overestimate projected income, to avoid possibly having to pay back subsidies at tax return time? I am trying to get ready to pull the trigger and retire at 62.5 years old. I plan to calculate my income from my Roth IRA (and a tiny part time job). Is it safer to slightly overestimate my income when signing up for ACA, to hopefully avoid the potential of having to pay back anything if I go over what I projected?"

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/

"pleasant surprise but want no surprise in tax planning re aca just finished with my 2025 taxes and i will be getting a massive refund while i was expecting to owe a small check to irs 2025 was my full year of r/fire : i have no w2 income and relied on my investment dividends, tax free interests. i fired in mid 2024; so i had half year of w2 income and when i enrolled for aca in late 2024 for 2025 plans i wasn't sure what to put in my income and i only put in estimated total for qualified dividends and omitted (tax free municipal) interest which made a big chunk of my total cash for the year. i believe that i got subsidized aca rate for 2025. later in 2025 during my tax planning session i understood that i was to include tax free interest when enrolling aca. as a result i anticipated that i would be repaying the aca subsidies when i file 2025 return. but i was getting a big tax credit instead; my refund has been approved. when looking over the return i can see that a large portion of the refund is labeled medical and i didn't itemized any medical expenses; i only included the "standard" (i forgot the form number now) sent by aca does anyone understand this? for 2026 enrollment my aca premium is big and totally unsubsidized i believe because i enter a bigger (including tax free interest) income compared to 2025. should i expect at least some credit when 2026 return is filed?"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sx0pb6/pleasant_surprise_but_want_no_surprise_in_tax/

"If you end up making more money than you told them on the application when you signed up for the aca you have to pay it back. That happened to me once in 2022, had to pay back \$12,000 for my family of 3, than 2024 I lost subsidies and I as paying \$1550 for family of 3 and than switched to a private plan off the exchange for \$750 monthly on a United PPO with a \$3000 max out of pocket per person. I used a broker to get the plan My Private Health Insurance. Try that if you can get approved, they do a prescription check, so thats the catch, you cant have major health conditions. But the premium is the premium, nothing to do with my taxes which is nice when your self employed"

— r/obamacare · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wkyblg/switching_from_obamacare_individual_insurance/paufjj4/

"Yea, this was my situation last year. I lost my job due to a health issue and had to enroll with a marketplace plan. I had no clear indicator on what my income was going to be for the full year - as it wasn't clear when I would be returning to work. I hadn't yet made 15k (FPL) for the year, but on my estimate for income I just assumed I'd be out of work for 2 months and calculated that way. Figured that if I went back to work earlier, or got a better job - I'd just pay them the difference on my taxes. But after 4 major surgeries, I didn't work again at all last year (meaning I did not earn enough to 'qualify' for the program and would need to pay back the subsidies in their entirety if this provision was in place). After a couple months, I attempted to apply for short term disability, but was delayed/denied repeatedly. Under this provision, I would have ended up owing \$6,000+ on my taxes in addition to all of my other financial hardships."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lpx1me/change_in_the_senate_version_of_bill/n0yyfl6/

"Yes, and that was the huge benefit of the Enhanced Tax Credit. I had to pay back the APTC 2 years in a row, almost \$60k total for family of 4 at the time, because went over MAGI by about \$2k both years. After the 2nd year it all but wiped out our savings."

— r/obamacare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wjwved/planning_to_retire_at_62_have_you_priced_the_3/pakbti3/

"Going into my fourth month without a job. I need to cancel my plan if i reach 6 months of no work right? i lost my job in December and thought id find a job by february but rhings fell through. its been really difficult finding a new job and i feel hopeless I'll find one soon. im scared I'll have to pay back if i exceed 6 months without a job so its recommended i cancel then right? then if i find a job I'll have to wait until enrollment but better than paying this shit back without having \$\$"

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1sigc4v/going_into_my_fourth_month_without_a_job_i_need/

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. Would the safest choice be covering both of us through Mouser for about \$352 per month for medical, even though that is a lot of money for us? 5. Since I never paid for or activated my old Marketplace plan and BCBS says it is terminated, can I enroll in another Marketplace plan now, or must I wait until Open Enrollment? (and when is that?) 6. Between the PPO

and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"I also have an income that fluctuates. During previous ACA enrollments, we are asked to provide estimated income for the upcoming year to determine tax subsidy eligibility. When I file my taxes a year later, (and include the data from my 1095-A form) any deviation in my estimated income will result in a change to my tax liability. If for some reason I made more than what my estimated income was, I will pay back that portion/percentage of the tax subsidy(and vice versa if I make less). The BBB has changed it to any income overage over the estimated income given upon application will trigger a FULL repayment of the ENTIRE subsidy. I'm having difficulty even finding information on what the subsidies will be next year when they expire. Let alone what the actual policy costs are jumping up to."

— r/obamacare · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1mbsi9a/npr_reporter_wants_to_hear_how_youre_prepping_for/n5p4pr7/

"How to estimate income for marketplace health insurance So, I got laid off this year (2025) but made enough money to not qualify for any ACA subsidies. So I've been paying health insurance from the marketplace out of pocket. I'm receiving unemployment income until mid January 2026. In shopping for 2026 health insurance coverage from my states marketplace, I need to update my income. For 2026, my only guaranteed income is the last two unemployment payments I will receive. Negligible. I am supposed to estimate my projected income for 2026.. I truly have no idea how to estimate this so I'm thinking, I will just project something low like \$3000 / month or \$36000 for the year. This should qualify me for ACA subsidies so my monthly health insurance is discounted. Then when I actually get a job, I will almost likely be on that employer's group plan and will drop the health insurance from the marketplace. If I earned more money in 2026 than \$3000/ a month or \$36000 for the year, when I do my 2026 taxes in early 2027, I might have to repay some or all the discounts I received but this would be negligible to me at this point. The important think for me right now is to keep my monthky healthcare costs low until I get a job. Is my line of thinking correct? That is, projecting a low income for 2026 (because I clearly have no idea what my income for 2026 will be) to avail dicounted health insurance while I have no job and just pay the undeserved discounts back in case I earn more in 2026."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1olyzi2/>

"I'm adding to what Seaweed said in their post. I'm in a similar situation to you. I've been able to play with my assets to keep my income below 400%. Also, I only use about half my ACA credit so I don't have to worry about a repayment. Then at tax time, I receive the additional premium credit which helps fund the next year's monthly premium."

— r/obamacare · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1rfjsqf/is_it_beneficial_to_slightly_overestimate/o7kq8hw/

"marketplace, healthcare, overlap, tax, implications... I am not sure this is the right sub Reddit for my question but hopefully someone can help or shed light on my situation. it's pretty simple. I recently started a new job after working for a small business and purchasing my own independent insurance for many years. I did not select my new employer sponsored insurance plan until August 31 of this year even though I was hired July 1 of this year. I assumed that coverage began September 1 but upon completion of paperwork, realize it started August 1. I'm not really sure how that's possible but that is what my plan states. So, I didn't know I had to cancel my marketplace plan immediately and somehow thought that they just canceled each other out. That sounds really stupid when I say it out loud, but I thought if I got one coverage, it would just terminate the other coverage, but I realize now it does not work that way. So now when I get my 1095 a at the end of the year, it will show that I had a Marketplace plan with high discount for all of Aug and 9 days of Sept (unless I'm stuck with the whole month of September as well. It depends if they can prorate the days.) that I technically did not qualify for. I'm essentially on the hook for the contributed amount, correct? I don't qualify for the discount. I just don't understand why I have to pay back that money if I didn't use the plan (or can't because the other insurance is primary and Trump's the marketplace plan) because all of my appointments and prescriptions are gonna be rerun through the new insurance. I was told I had to do that manually regardless. Does anything I'm saying have truth to it? Am I missing something? If I do everything correctly and go through any insurance claim for an appointment or prescription during that timeframe to have my primary insurance run and pay the difference, what are my tax implications? If I do none of that, what are my tax implications? Does it eventually catch up to me or do I have to deal with it at the end of the year in some way shape or form? TLDR: I had marketplace insurance as well as employer sponsored insurance that overlapped. What happens on my 1095 a when it comes time to pay taxes? Will I suffer an expensive payback situation for credits that I received at the same time as my other plan was active? I mean expensive is relative. I think the credits are like maximum \$500 a month so if I was charged for two months it would be about \$1000. it's an extra thousand dollars that I don't have to put towards health insurance though."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wdgszl/marketplace_healthcare_overlap_tax_implications/

"ACA. It's not that big a deal to estimate your income; just do your best and set some extra money aside in case you owe at tax time. Or if you prefer, estimate on the high end for your income and file for a refund at tax time. Going "straight through private companies" doesn't mean you're getting real, normal insurance direct from the source. It just means you're getting subpar, non-compliant insurance that leave you with few protections. I didn't understand this when I first had to get my own insurance. I called BCBS directly, because it's the insurance I had with my previous employer, and I wanted a quote for "what I had before." They sent me straight to healthcare.gov for their ACA plans."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wkwbkf/looking_for_affordable_health_insurance/paz8zn7/

"Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith.... Devoted Health is engaging in bad-faith claims adjudication by intentionally weaponizing administrative obstacles to systematically withhold mandated Medicare benefits under National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3. Detailed Description: I am escalating this dispute because Devoted Health is utilizing intentional administrative barrier tactics to evade its federal statutory obligations under my Devoted Choice Giveback ("Pay Back") PPO plan. The plan explicitly affirmed my clinical eligibility for chronic low back pain acupuncture in a formal postal letter and established a precedent by successfully reimbursing session one. Their subsequent withholding of payments for five identical, consecutive sessions is not an operational oversight; it is a calculated non-delivery of baseline federal Medicare benefits. Devoted's out-of-state corporate management team is exploiting its remote structure to issue repetitive, bad-faith demands for "insufficient information". Because the billing codes, clinician credentials, and clinical documentation submitted for the unpaid sessions are completely identical to the approved first session, these demands constitute an intentional strategy to create a cycle of administrative exhaustion. By forcing a local Hawaii senior to finance a federally protected benefit out-of-pocket, Devoted Health is in direct, willful breach of its CMS contract. I request that CMS bypass the plan's failed internal grievance metrics, launch an immediate compliance audit into Devoted's Hawaii PPO reimbursement protocols, and compel immediate restitution. Devoted Health formally established eligibility criteria and authorized coverage for the chronic low back pain acupuncture treatments via written postal correspondence. Under established Medicare Advantage guidelines, an insurer cannot arbitrarily revoke or obstruct an active, written authorization when the subsequent medical claims present identical clinical indicators and treatment modalities. Arbitrary and Capricious Claims Processing: The plan's administrative team has acted inconsistently by successfully reimbursing the initial acupuncture session, yet denying or withholding payment for the subsequent 5 identical sessions. Because the exact same provider information, billing codes, and clinical documentation were submitted across all claims, the plan's repeated assertion that there is "insufficient information" constitutes an arbitrary administrative barrier. Improper Adjudication and Unreasonable Administrative Burden: By demanding additional, unspecified information for ongoing sessions that identical documentation already sufficed to cover, Devoted Health is creating an uncertified administrative hurdle. This violates CMS expectations for fair claims processing, shifting an unlawful financial and administrative burden onto the beneficiary after prior approval was secured. Violation of CMS Chronic Low Back Pain Coverage Mandates: National Coverage Determination (NCD) 150.3 dictates that Medicare covers up to 12 initial acupuncture sessions within a 90-day window for chronic low back pain. By withholding payment for 5 consecutive sessions within this approved window, Devoted Health is failing to deliver the baseline federal benefits mandated under its Medicare Advantage contract. Demand for Prompt Equitable Estoppel and Immediate Reimbursement: Because the beneficiary reasonably relied on Devoted Health's explicit written assurances and the initial successful reimbursement to continue necessary medical treatments, the plan is legally and equitably estopped from denying coverage. Devoted Health must immediately resolve this internal processing error, honor their written commitment, and issue full reimbursement for the 5 outstanding sessions to prevent further financial injury to the beneficiary. On top of it all, they have escalated the excessive stress on MY HEALTH."

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a8d09f0594549203e916983>

"This company seems scammer on pay back program to be a scammer for.... This company seems to be a scammer for sure. The pay back program is a scam. RUN from this company as fast as you can run. Customer service is great, but don't have a claim."

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69eea91c7998fc3575de2684>

"In 2025 I signed up for health care.... In 2025 I signed up for health care from Ambetter for the months April thru August as I was going on Medicare on Sept 1, 2025. I missed a payment in July (my debit card had been hacked and it had to be investigated to issue me a new card #) for the month of August, in August I made up the payment. In late 2025 I received refunds from Ambetter of my premium payments. I did not understand but didn't think anything of it as I was now on Medicare. In June 2026 I received a bill from my Primary Care doctor for three visits I had made in June, July and August 2025. When looking into this I found that Ambetter had canceled my membership, due to the 1 missed payment, all the way back to the beginning (April 2025) so in June, July, August I had no health coverage. In July 2026 I contacted Ambetter. I sent them proof that I had made all the necessary payments and was told that they can re-instate me to September 2025. In mid-August 2026 I received another bill from my PCP. I contacted Ambetter again and was told that I needed to repay my premiums that had been refunded (\$239.21) by August 8 and it was now August 24. I had never received communication that I was supposed to pay this by August 8 and they have never given me proof that they had told me this. I was told I could make the payment and see what happens. Well my reinstatement was denied because I had not made the payment by August 8. AGAIN I WAS NEVER TOLD THAT I NEEDED TO PAY BY AUGUST 8. I have filed a grievance with them over this affair. If that fails I will have to pay almost \$500 to my PCP through no fault of my own."

— TrustPilot · ambetterhealth.com · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9c3c2750b54069d8dcfd95>

Narrow networks and doctors who don't take the plan

"Pregnant, called 20+ "in-network" OBs and none accept my plan, what actually works here? I really need advice from anyone who has dealt with marketplace insurance issues like this. I recently got laid off and lost my Aetna PPO. I enrolled through HealthCare.gov and now have WellPoint Essential Bronze POS 4500 (covers my husband, toddler, and me). I'm currently 4 weeks pregnant. My previous OB does not take this plan, and visits would be \$500 out of pocket, so I started trying to find a new provider. Here's everything I've done so far: \- Used the Sydney Health app and contacted customer service \- They emailed me a 14-page list with 52 providers within 20 miles I started calling down the list and got EIGHT (8) pages in. I have now called 20+ providers. Results: Most said they do NOT take my plan at all Some said they only take WellPoint Medicaid for pregnancy None accepted my specific marketplace plan At that point I called the member services number for WellPoint. I got transferred 3 times Finally reached someone who tried calling providers herself. It was late in the day, so offices didn't answer. She said she will call again tomorrow and try to schedule me with someone within 20 miles She also told me to report all the providers I contacted who don't actually accept my plan so they can update the directory Additional complication: \- I do NOT qualify for Texas STAR Medicaid for pregnant women because our income is about \$600 over the monthly limit, even including the unborn fetus \-I also do NOT qualify for CHIP perinatal because I already have marketplace insurance Even if I dropped my current plan to try for CHIP: It would only cover pregnancy, labor, and delivery. I have autoimmune conditions and take ongoing medications. I would lose access to the medications I need for daily functioning So that option doesn't really work for me either. Right now, I technically have insurance but I still have zero confirmed access to prenatal care What are my next steps? My mother-in-law suggested asking for a care coordinator or case manager. My father-in-law suggested requesting a gap exception so I can continue seeing my current OB but pay in-network costs instead of \$500 out of pocket, since the insurance has not provided usable in-network options. Questions: 1. Has anyone had success with a gap exception for pregnancy? 2. Did your insurance actually find you a provider, or did you have to escalate further? 3. Has anyone switched plans outside open enrollment due to something like this? 4. Is there a better way to find OBs that actually take this specific plan? I'm in the DFW, Texas area. I'm trying to stay calm since I'm early, but I know I need to get care lined up soon and this process has been exhausting. Any advice or experiences would help a lot"

— r/HealthInsurance · 20 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1slok4v/>

"Also using ACA plan; key note are premiums, deductibles and out of pocket max. But I have shopped plans and one or two ER visits or a single surgery/major procedure or chronic illness yearly cost for healthcare ive found an average of 15k to well over 25k. (again yearly!) And thats just whats in network, not always including meds and out of network services including vision and dental being billed separately on many plans. Absolutely abhorrent. We pay so much more for worse healthcare. Where a tax of a fraction of a cost per individual would cover everyone."

— r/obamacare · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uanxix/aca_not_very_affordable_anymore/osrrfc0/

"I've been on the ACA since 2015 except this year as my honey got a job that covered his spouse for the first time. I've never had a claim denied, never had an abnormal wait time for a doctors appointment due to insurance. We have 3 major medical groups in our area, your ACA plan will put you into one of those groups. Thats it, then you are in line with everyone else that goes to that group of doctors/hospitals. My ACA plans never required approvals, I didn't pick those types of plans, I just had to be mindful of in network and out of network. My husband is on an employer plan and just had to wait several weeks to get in with a throat specialist and several more weeks for surgery as they are that backlogged...nothing to do with insurance, just staffing constraints. Now in some areas it can take months to get an appointment if you are new to the Dr. as they only allow for so many new patient visits per month. I wonder if that is the issue they are having. It can be a real concern when you are having to switch Drs a lot due to ever changing insurance on top of the fact of course those that don't take new patients."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1pd4kh7/fed_up_with_fake_news/ns2kqlm/

"My company plan was a third of the price of the ACA plan, Cobra or Medicare. And when I changed I had to change several doctors. Most appointments are check ups so waiting isn't a big problem, but appointments I used to get in 3-5 days are now weeks, and some are months. A side note: there are some cheaper Medicare advantage plans available, but it means I have to go to all network doctors as many of mine don't take HMO's. So going it on your own you have Medicare A and B. A is free B is a few hundred dollars. The you need part D, part N (or G) and vision, dental and dermatology plans. That's what it takes to match what I had in my employee plan. If M4A is run like it is today, it's not less expensive or a good plan. Second note: mine was an individual plan, family plans got substantially more expensive."

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vu7oma/people_with_existing_corporate_health_plans_and/p54f5gr/

"There is at least one major flaw in ACA. The idea behind ACA was to provide affordable access to healthcare. Unfortunately, it provides just affordable access to insurance, and that insurance is not accepted by many physicians. Seriously. I live in a major metro with a huge base of primary care physicians as well as specialists. And my experience has been that most doctors don't accept my ACA policy. I have to drive 45 minutes to get to my primary care physician, simply because he was the only doctor I could find who accepted my coverage. So when politicians pat themselves on the back for ACA, I submit that they haven't improved healthcare at all. They've just made it easy for us to find insurance."

— YouTube · Early Retirement Health Insurance Before Medicare: A Step-by-Step Framework · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NAYG0yvzBI8&lc=Ugwov4rykJWpFucCV-B4AaABAg>

"Ask i know it's that when obamacare took effect my insurance went from \$150 a month with a \$1,200 deductible to \$900 a month and a \$10,000 deductible and it was only good through one hospital. So far the pricing has gotten worse for me and most of my doctors in my area won't take it the only doctors that do take it are shady hole in the wall clinics and no no major hospitals within a 2 hour radius of me will even consider it. They just take one look at the card and say we don't accept it. I don't get that money back and I'm locked into a 1 year contract. My doctor who i pay cash for tells me to get rid of it and only get catastrophic insurance and pay cash for everything else."

— YouTube · What Happens if Obamacare Subsidies Expire? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=onsEZNtGKC&lc=UgyGfdLkWf9y-O0YSat4AaABAg>

"You do realize that those are made up prices on hospital bills, right ?! I've never had a health insurance in this country. I pay out of pocket, including for surgeries. I negotiated with/threatened hospitals many times to get a fair price. And we don't even remotely qualify for charity care or Medicaid, and prefer to see private doctors of our choice who oftentimes don't accept insurance anyway."

— YouTube · People are Canceling Health Insurance due to Cost in 2025! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gnvuim3bXOQ&lc=Ugx5QPUJ-XCHBe6Rold4AaABAq>

"Claims are a nightmare, reps need training, website needs to provide understandable information. I have been calling in for EIGHT MONTHS about a claim that was double billed. Instead of fixing the claim, they split it into two claims and moved around random amounts of money so that neither I nor their own representatives can figure out what happened. THEIR ONLINE CLAIMS PAGE IS A NIGHTMARE! So, I'm supposed to just "shut up" and pay whatever the hospital bills me. I had Aetna Medicare before and never had a problem. One of my providers that I really like won't take Aetna anymore, that's the only reason I switched. I'm going back to Aetna next year and I'll find a new provider. The reps are nice, but they struggle to be helpful, as each person I talk to tells me something different. I ask the right questions in the most basic way and still can't get a straight answer. It's just not worth it to have to call over and over and over again for months to try and get it figured out."

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9b1821f755b887a714df2e>

"Medicare Advantage plan sucks. Medicare Advantage plan sucks. Very limited doctor choice that narrowed during the year, overwhelming paperwork, extreme hassles over required referrals to specialists, no customer service. Can't wait to escape from this hell."

— TrustPilot · UnitedHealthcare · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9950f04670b34ee49383d8>

"I deal with devoted health here in.... I deal with devoted health here in Louisiana it's a new company I am in network with lcmc health I'm having no problems with devoted accepting my in-network doctors with lcmc health however when I am sent to a specialty doctor nobody wants to deal with them then they send you a list of doctors they deal with that is out of network lcmc then when you go see there out of network doctors and they send you to a specialty clinic not in especially clinics want to deal with the devoted health insurance plan I have a book written on this that I have sent to devoted health that I have archived to prove what I am saying I went to see a gastrologist Dr David Treen he is a well-known doctor with very high credentials however when Dr train sent me to a clinic that he was working with to have imaging done the clinic he works with does not want anything to do with devoted out matter of fact medical clinics that these doctors have set me too what to deal with devoted health if you had time to read a book I would let you read my text messages back and forth with devoted health how they say is we're sorry you're going through this I'm having to do the work that devoted out in my doctors should be doing because nobody wants to accept the voted Health here in Louisiana yes personal care providers in network with lcmc they accept devoted health and yes a couple of there specialty clinics deal with devoted out truly changed my life but when the specialty Clinic send you to another clinic you're running into a dead end Street the clinics that the doctors deal with does not accept the devoted Health Plan all you have to do is call Miss Sylvia at Dr bastian's office lcmc Health oakwood Clinic and she will let you know the problem she having trying to doctors especially clinics that will accept devoted health devoted health is a new broken insurance company that ask you to keep things in network which I tried to do until they pull me out of network sending any the doctors that they want me to deal with that a too damn far to travel especially at my age however I got there the doctor saw me Dr train then the clinic he sent me to send me back and says they do not accept devoted health insurance yes they are out of network however devoted pulled me out of lcmc network to go to the doctors they want me to go see however the doctors that I went to see that they wanted me to go see they sent me to the doctors in the clinic that they deal with and none of their associates want to deal with devoted health explain this to me all I can say come open enrollment I may be going back to People's Health devoted is dragging elderly people in with their perks oh yes they have good freebies and perks they even pay you to do a health assessment which is no problem because you do it on the phone then they give you a decent over the counter allowance and with the elderly people barely scraping by this sounds good however when it comes to medical specialty clinics nobody wants to deal with devoted health quit selling your plans with your perks I'll elderly people that are barely scraping by the perks look good a lot of people sign on to devoted health because of the perks however the healthcare part of devoted health sucks as stated your regular personal care providers except devoted but none of the specialty clinics they deal with except devoted health insurance if I could send you the text messages that has been sent to devoted already you would understand I promise you I have over 20 pages of responses to devoted out the dressing this problem and all they can say is we're sorry that I am going through this devoted needs to get on track because they suck thank you"

— TrustPilot · Devoted Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a21c05fc83eec34fdcd42d6>

Marketplace and Medicaid paperwork, verification, errors

"Texas, my wife's benefits deadline is October 1, my insurance was terminated, and I genuinely have no idea what I am doing I'm 33, my wife is 28, and we live in Texas. I am so crippled by this situation and don't know how to proceed, I've been delaying this for months out of panic and confusion and now I have to act fast. My parents handled this stuff my entire life, so I never learned how any of it works. My wife and I left their abusive household because they kept harassing her, and now we really do not have anyone helping or guiding us through things like this. My wife came to the United States in February and recently started working at Mouser Electronics. I drive Uber and do not have employer health insurance. I came back to the United States earlier this year and enrolled in a Blue Cross Blue Shield Marketplace plan, but I never paid any of the premiums. I never used the insurance either. I did not understand what I was supposed to do, so I basically ignored it, which I realize was a mistake. BCBS has now confirmed that my policy is terminated, so I am currently uninsured. My wife has her own separate BCBSTX MyBlue Health Bronze plan. BCBS says her policy is active, her monthly premium is \$0, and her balance is \$0. I do not know whether the actual premium is somehow \$0 or whether a Marketplace tax credit is paying it. I also do not know whether her new insurance offer from Mouser changes her eligibility for that \$0 plan. Her Mouser benefits deadline is October 1, and I am scared of fucking this up. Yesterday, my friend's wife died from stage 4 colon cancer. I stayed with him through the night, and my head is still completely messed up from it. Now I am sitting here worrying about my own wife because she has not had a proper checkup since coming to the country. She needs a general checkup, a gynecologist, and an evaluation for breast pain. We have also been trying to conceive for 3.5 years, so we need to begin asking about fertility testing. I know those things do not automatically mean something terrible is wrong, but after what happened yesterday, I am struggling to think clearly. I just want my wife to be examined and taken care of. These are the prices from the Mouser benefits booklet: PPO or HPN medical for my wife only: \$75.40 every two weeks without the annual physical discount, about \$163.37 per month Medical for employee plus spouse: \$162.35 every two weeks, about \$351.76 per month Buy-Up dental for my wife only: \$10.07 every two weeks, about \$21.82 per month Vision for my wife only: \$2.76 every two weeks, about \$5.98 per month As far as I understand it, these are our choices: \-- Option 1: She keeps her current \$0 Marketplace medical plan and gets only dental and vision through Mouser. This would cost about \$27.80 per month. The \$28 is only for dental and vision. Her medical coverage would remain the separate Marketplace plan. \-- Option 2: She gets Mouser medical, dental, and vision for herself. This would cost about \$191 per month. I would remain uninsured. \-- Option 3: She enrolls both of us in Mouser medical but gets dental and vision only for herself. This would cost about \$380 per month total. Adding me increases the medical cost by approximately \$188 per month compared with covering only her. Mouser cannot give me spouse-only medical coverage. My wife must enroll in medical for me to be covered through her job. I am self-employed through Uber and do not have access to another employer plan, so I do not think the working-spouse surcharge applies to us. The PPO has a \$2,500 individual deductible, a \$7,000 individual out-of-pocket maximum, \$25 primary-care visits, and \$50 specialist visits. It also has a broader network. The HPN HSA has a \$1,700 individual deductible and a \$5,800 individual out-of-pocket maximum. Mouser also contributes money to the HSA, but the provider network is more limited and there is no out-of-network coverage. My wife also wants braces. The Buy-Up dental plan says adult orthodontia is covered at 50 percent after the deductible, with a \$2,000 lifetime maximum. I realize that probably still leaves us paying several thousand dollars. so we will likely just do this overseas or something. Here is what I desperately need help understanding: 1. Does Mouser offering my wife affordable medical insurance mean she could lose the Marketplace tax credit that currently makes her premium \$0, even if she declines Mouser's medical plan? 2. Could we owe money back at tax time if she keeps the \$0 Marketplace plan after becoming eligible for Mouser insurance? 3. Is there a way to find out exactly how much of her Marketplace premium is being paid by a tax credit? 4. 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and HPN HSA, which would make more sense when she needs a gynecologist, breast evaluation, possible imaging or testing, and a fertility evaluation? 7. Can she use her currently active Marketplace plan to get checked now and then switch when Mouser coverage begins? 8. What exact order should we do this in? Should we call the Marketplace first, schedule her appointments first, or submit the Mouser benefits first? I am overwhelmed by the premiums, deductibles, tax credits, networks, enrollment deadlines, and the possibility of unexpected bills. I am terrified of paying too much for something we do not need, paying too little and discovering nothing is covered, or making a mistake that leaves us owing thousands of dollars. I just want my wife to receive a proper checkup, make sure we both have reasonable coverage, and avoid making a financial mistake that follows us for years. Any clear, step-by-step guidance would genuinely help us right now, more than I can explain..."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wg5ai2/texas_my_wifes_benefits_deadline_is_october_1_my/

"marketplace, healthcare, overlap, tax, implications... I am not sure this is the right sub Reddit for my question but hopefully someone can help or shed light on my situation. it's pretty simple. I recently started a new job after working for a small business and purchasing my own independent insurance for many years. I did not select my new employer sponsored insurance plan until August 31 of this year even though I was hired July 1 of this year. I assumed that coverage began September 1 but upon completion of paperwork, realize it started August 1. I'm not really sure how that's possible but that is what my plan states. So, I didn't know I had to cancel my marketplace plan immediately and somehow thought that they just canceled each other out. That sounds really stupid when I say it out loud, but I thought if I got one coverage, it would just terminate the other coverage, but I realize now it does not work that way. So now when I get my 1095 a at the end of the year, it will show that I had a Marketplace plan with high discount for all of Aug and 9 days of Sept (unless I'm stuck with the whole month of September as well. It depends if they can prorate the days.) that I technically did not qualify for. I'm essentially on the hook for the contributed amount, correct? I don't qualify for the discount. I just don't understand why I have to pay back that money if I didn't use the plan (or can't because the other insurance is primary and Trump's the marketplace plan) because all of my appointments and prescriptions are gonna be rerun through the new insurance. I was told I had to do that manually regardless. Does anything I'm saying have truth to it? Am I missing something? if I do everything correctly and go through any insurance claim for an appointment or prescription during that timeframe to have my primary insurance run and pay the difference, what are my tax implications? If I do none of that, what are my tax implications? Does it eventually catch up to me or do I have to deal with it at the end of the year in some way shape or form? TLDR: I had marketplace insurance as well as employer sponsored insurance that overlapped. What happens on my 1095 a when it comes time to pay taxes? Will I suffer an expensive payback situation for credits that I received at the same time as my other plan was active? I mean expensive is relative. I think the credits are like maximum \$500 a month so if I was charged for two months it would be about \$1000. it's an extra thousand dollars that I don't have to put towards health insurance though."

— r/obamacare · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1wdgszl/marketplace_healthcare_overlap_tax_implications/

"My broker Carlos R Hernandez. My broker Carlos R. Hernandez signed me up for Cigna health insurance. At least I thought he did. After months of waiting and multiple phone calls, I never received ID cards. I could not log into mycigna.com. I could not log into the Colorado marketplace at connectforhealthco.com. Turns out Carlos entered my information incorrectly. My zip code was wrong. My address was wrong. My email was wrong. After multiple phone calls to Cigna and the Colorado Marketplace, I was finally able to track down all of these errors. I told Carlos. He invited me to find another broker. That is the only good advice Carlos provided!"

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/65bc12c06eb9707ce31b6ad1>